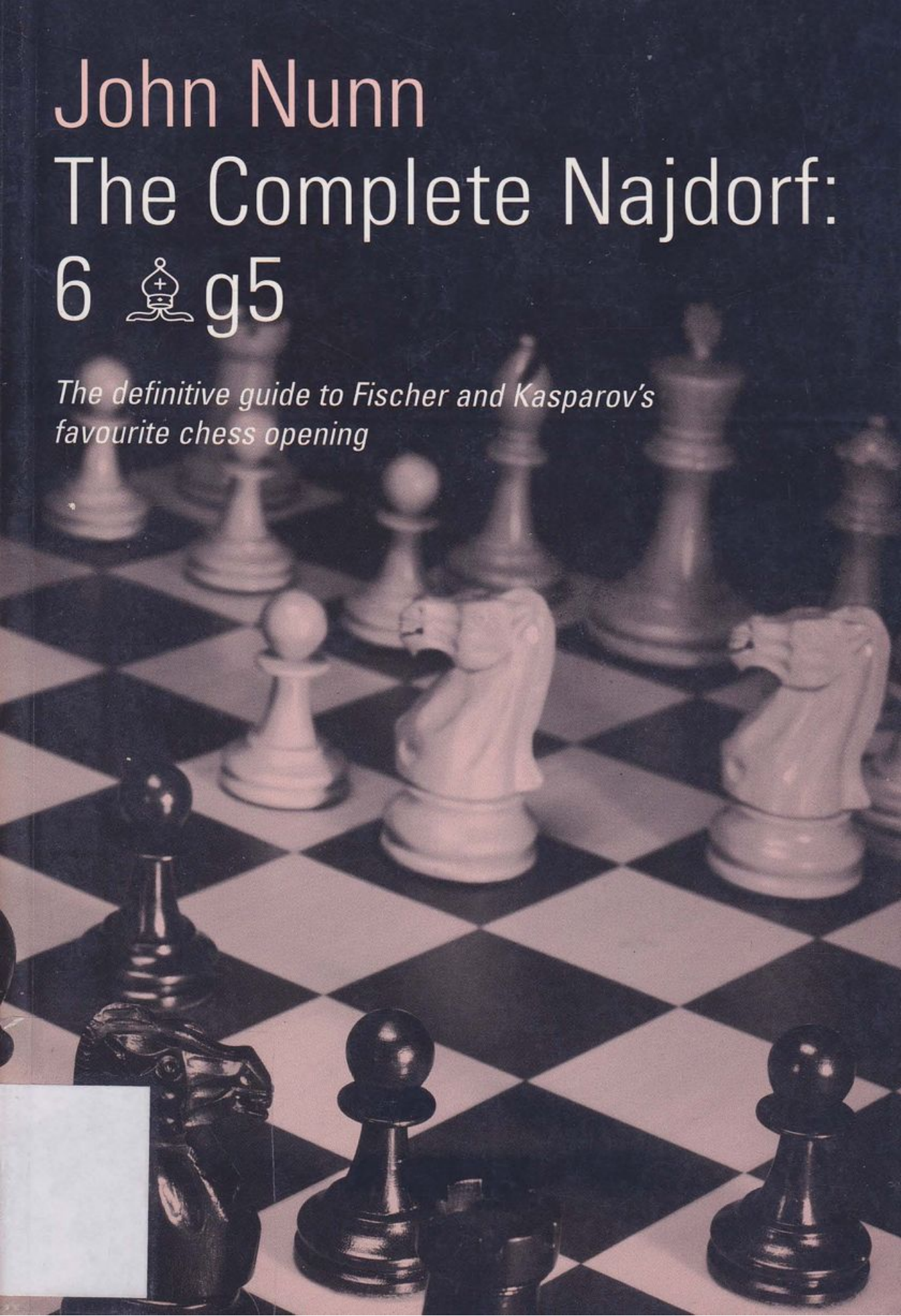
John Nunn

The Complete Najdorf: 6 ♗g5

The definitive guide to Fischer and Kasparov's favourite chess opening




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The Complete Najdorf: 6 ♗g5

John Nunn

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Introduction

Since publication of *The Najdorf for the Tournament Player* in 1988, the volume of theory in the Najdorf Sicilian has increased by leaps and bounds. The Najdorf is regularly employed throughout the chess world, from club match to world championship, from rapid chess to correspondence; new lines arise and are overturned at a furious pace. Any hopes of covering the whole Najdorf in one volume were quickly dashed when I assembled the material and observed that it included 18,000 games. The book you are holding is, therefore, the first of two *Complete Najdorf* volumes; this one covers all the lines arising after 6 ♗g5. These include some of the sharpest lines known to opening theory, such as the notorious Poisoned Pawn and Polugaevsky Variations.

Unlike many contemporary opening books, you will find very few complete games. As soon as the assessment of the position becomes clear, then I stop the analysis and give the evaluation. Alas, it is all too easy these days to drop complete games into a book – a couple of mouse clicks, and a page is filled. A few carefully selected complete games can be beneficial, but in my view an opening book should be about the opening; including hundreds of irrelevant complete games only serves to distract from the main point of the book – in any case nobody ever plays them through. Even the flimsy justification that it is helpful to see typical plans in the resulting middlegame positions doesn't apply to the 6 ♗g5 Najdorf; the typical plan is to randomly hack towards the opposing king.

I have also largely refrained from pointing out analytical errors by others. It is just too easy, with *Fritz* humming away quietly in the background, to uncover mistakes made by those without access to such tools. The object of this book is to offer, so far as is reasonably possible, correct analysis, and not to dwell lovingly on other people's oversights.

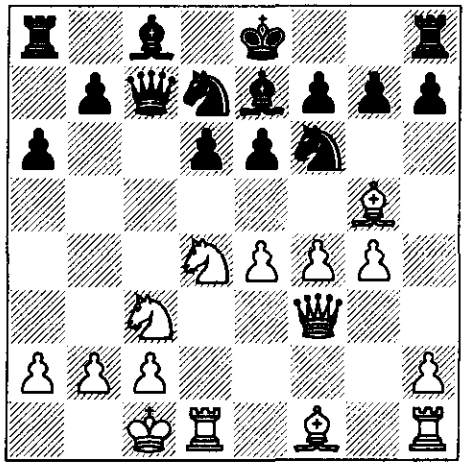
I would like to thank all those who helped with this book: in no particular order, Maurice Johnson, who helped supply a large number of correspondence games; Daniel Olim, for turning over his Najdorf notebook; Graham Burgess, for editing the book and, finally, my wife Petra for typesetting and proof-reading.

John Nunn
November, 1996

1 Main Line with 10 g4

Many years ago this was regarded as the fundamental line of the 6 ♗g5 Najdorf. Subsequently the Poisoned Pawn and Polugaevsky variations were developed and stole much of the limelight. Moreover 10 ♗d3 began to take over from 10 g4 as the most popular 10th move against the main line. 10 g4 went out of fashion and became a backwater of the Najdorf. Although the Poisoned Pawn has lost none of its glamour, 10 ♗d3 has in its turn fallen into disrepute because of difficulties both with 10...h6 and with 10...b5. The result is that 10 g4 is once again a common sight in grandmaster games. A great deal of new material has arisen since publication of *The Najdorf for the Tournament Player*, so this chapter is greatly expanded.

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♗e7 8 ♕f3 ♕c7 9 0-0-0 ♘bd7 10 g4 *(D)*



B

10 ... b5

The alternatives are:

1) **10...♖b8** (there doesn't seem to be any real reason why Black should commit himself to this so soon) 11 ♗xf6 gxf6 (11...♗xf6 12 g5 ♗e7 13 f5 gives White a head start over line B below) 12 f5 ♘e5 13 ♕h3 h6 (it looks too dangerous to castle when White has the extra tempo g4) 14 ♕h5 ♔f8, Borsavolgyi-Mozes, Hungary Cht 1991, 15 ♘ce2, followed by ♘f4, is ±.

2) **10...♘c5** 11 e5! is very strong as 11...dxe5 12 fxe5 ♕xe5 13 ♗f4 traps the queen.

3) **10...0-0** and now:

3a) **11 ♗g2** ♘c5 (11...♖b8 12 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 13 g5 ♗xd4 14 ♖xd4 e5 15 ♖d2 exf4 16 ♕xf4 ♘e5 17 h4 ♗e6 18 h5 f6 19 g6 h6 20 ♗h3 ♗xh3 21 ♖xh3 ± Hernandez-Nascimento, Gran Canaria 1989) 12 e5 (12 ♕g3 ♗d7 13 ♗xf6 gxf6? {13...♗xf6 ∞} 14 ♖he1 ♖ac8 15 ♘f5! ♗c6 {or 15...exf5 16 ♘d5 ♕d8 17 exf5 ♖e8 18 g5 fxg5 19 ♖xe7! +−} 16 ♘d5 ♗xd5 17 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 18 exd5 ± Paglilla-Adla, Argentine Ch 1989) dxe5 13 fxe5 ♘d5 14 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 15 ♖he1 ♘g6 16 g5 ♖b8 17 ♔b1 ± Kaak-Zuk, corr 1994.

3b) **11 ♗h4** b5 12 g5 ♘e8 13 ♘f5! (13 ♗h3 ♘c5 14 f5 b4 15 ♘ce2 ♗b7 16 ♘g3 d5 17 f6 dxe4 ∓ Joseph-De Valliere, corr 1988) exf5 14 ♘d5 ♕d8 15 exf5 ♖a7 16 ♕e3 ♘c5 17 ♖e1 ±.

3c) **11 ♗xf6** ♗xf6 12 g5 ♗xd4 13 ♖xd4 b5 14 ♗g2 (14 h4 ♗b7 15 ♗h3 ♘c5 16 a3 ♗c6 17 h5 a5 18 g6 h6 19 b4 axb4 20 axb4 f5! 21 bxc5 dxc5 22 ♖dd1 b4 ∓ Nisipeanu-Ardeleanu, Romania Ch 1992; 14 f5 ♘e5 15 ♕g3 ♕c5 16 ♖d2 b4 17 ♘d1 exf5 18 ♗g2 f4 19 ♕xf4 ♗e6 ∓ Radecke-Vitolinš, Porz 1992) ♗b7 15 ♖hd1 ♘c5 16 a3 ♖ac8 17 ♖1d2 (17 ♕h3 f5 18 exf5 ♖xf5 19 ♖xd6 ♗xg2 20 ♕xg2 ♖xf4 = Larsen-Andersen, corr 1986) ♗c6 (17...♖fd8 18 ♕d1) 18 ♖xd6 a5 19 ♕f2 ♘b7 20 ♖6d4 b4 21 axb4 axb4 22 ♖xb4, Shirov-Vitolinš, Riga 1985, and Black doesn't have enough for the two pawns, although he did win in the end.

4) **10...h6** 11 ♗xf6 (11 ♗h4 b5 {11...g5 12 e5 dxe5 13 fxg5 hxg5 14 ♗g3 ♖b8?! 15 h4 gxh4 16 g5 ♘h5 17 g6 fxg6 18 ♘xe6 ♕b6? 19 ♘d5 +– Kutuzović-Ott, Harkany 1994} 12 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 13 g5 ♘d7 14 g6 {the adsitional move ...h6 has actually weakened Black's kingside} ♘f6 15 gxf7+ ♔xf7 16 ♗h3 ♗d7 17 ♖hg1 ± Schmidt-Kuntz, corr 1968) with the alternatives:

4a) **11...♘xf6** 12 g5 hxg5 13 fxg5 ♘d7 14 g6 ♘e5 15 gxf7+ ♘xf7 16 ♕g3 ♗g5+ 17 ♔b1 ♗d7 18 ♗h3 ♖h6 19 ♖hf1 ± Bakker-Do, corr.

4b) **11...gxf6** (Black has spent a tempo on the fairly useless ...h6) 12 f5 (playing as in the usual ...gxf6 line seems best; 12 ♗h3 b5 {12...♘b6 13 f5 e5 14 ♘de2 ♗d7 15 ♘g3 0-0-0 16 ♘f1 ± Piuva-Kaunonen, corr 1988} 13 g5 hxg5 14 ♗xe6 fxe6 15 ♘xe6 ♕c6 16 ♘d5 ♖a7 17 e5 was unclear in Licina-Savić, Pula 1989) ♘e5 13 ♕h3 ♗d7 14 fxe6 fxe6 15 g5 fxg5 16 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 17 ♕xe6 ♕d7 18 ♕b3 ± Fairclough-Hon Kah Seng, Thessaloniki OL 1984.

4c) **11...♗xf6** (best, as this reveals the only advantage to not having played ...b5 – White cannot meet ...♗xf6 by ♗xb5) 12 h4 and now:

4c1) **12...b5?** 13 ♗xb5 +–.

4c2) **12...♗e7** 13 g5 (13 ♗g2 ♘b6 14 g5 ♗d7 15 g6 0-0 16 gxf7+ ♖xf7 17 ♗h3 ♕c8 18 ♕g3 ♘c4 = Cvijić-Palos, Banja Vrucica 1987) ♘f8 14 gxh6 ♖xh6 15 h5 ♘h7 16 ♗e2 ♗d7 17 ♖hg1 ♗f8 with equality, Koppe-Hadenau, corr 1988.

4c3) **12...♖b8** 13 g5 (13 ♘db5 axb5 14 ♘xb5 is also promising) ♗e7 14 g6 ♘f6 15 gxf7+ ♔xf7 16 ♗h3 b5 17 f5 e5 18 ♘e6 ♕c4 19 ♕g3 ♗xe6 20 ♕g6+ 1-0 Karabalis-Ezzidin, Hessenliga 1994.

4c4) **12...g6** 13 g5 ♗g7 14 h5 ♘f8 15 gxh6 ♗xh6 16 ♔b1 ♗d7 17 f5 gxf5 18 exf5 0-0-0 19 fxe6 fxe6 20 ♗h3 ♗g7 21 ♘ce2 ± Pantaleoni-Turci, Reggio Emilia 1988.

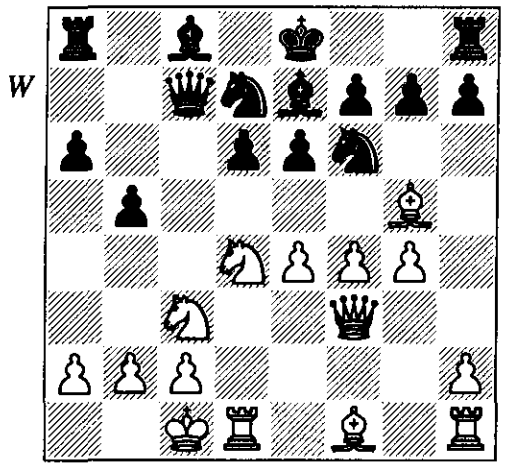
4c5) **12...♕b6!** 13 ♘de2 (13 ♘ce2 g5!?) ♘c5 (13...g5 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxg5 e4 16 ♕xe4 hxg5 17 h5 ♘e5 18 ♘d4 ♗d7 19 ♖h3 0-0-0 ∞ Molvig-Kristensen, Copenhagen 1995) 14 g5 ♗e7 15 ♘d4 ♗d7 16 ♗c4 ♕b4 17 ♗e2 0-0-0 18 ♔b1 ♔b8 19 a3 ♕b6 20 ♕e3 ♖c8 = Bordos-Szirmai, Zalakaros 1994.

We return to the main line after 10...b5 *(D)*:

11 ♗xf6

Other moves:

1) **11 ♗d3** (this position can also arise from chapter 2 after 10 ♗d3 ♗b7 11 g4) ♗b7 12 ♖he1 ♘c5 (or 12...b4 13 ♘ce2 ♘c5 14 ♘g3 0-0 15 ♕e2 ♖fc8 16 ♔b1 ♘xd3 17 ♖xd3 a5 with equality, Semionova-Pesout,



Pardubice 1992) 13 ♔b1 b4 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 15 ♘ce2 h6 16 ♘b3 ♘a4 17 ♘ed4 0-0 ∓ Kakuk-Kacincova, Balatonbereny 1993.

2) **11 ♗g2** ♗b7 12 ♖he1 (12 ♕e2 b4 13 ♘b1 ♘c5 14 e5 dxe5 15 ♗xb7 ♕xb7 16 ♕xe5 ♖c8 17 f5, Stanchev-Liangov, Stara Zagora 1989, 17...♕xh1! −+) b4 (12...♘b6 13 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 14 g5 ♗e7 15 h4 b4 16 ♘ce2 g6 17 ♔b1 d5 18 e5 ♘a4 19 h5 ♕b6 20 ♖h1 ∞ Sakharov-Korchnoi, USSR Ch 1960) 13 ♘d5 exd5 14 exd5 ♔f8 15 ♘f5 ♖e8 ∓ Bernstein-Fischer, USA Ch (New York) 1957/8.

3) **11 a3** (after this a transposition into lines considered later is likely) and now:

3a) **11...♗b7** 12 h4 (12 ♗xf6 and now both 12...gxf6 and 12...♘xf6 transpose into later lines) ♘c5 13 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 14 g5 ♗xd4 15 ♖xd4 0-0-0 (15...0-0 would be similar to line 3 in the note to Black's 10th move) 16 ♗h3 ♔b8 17 ♖hd1 g6 18 ♕e3 ♗c6 19 ♗f1 h6 20 b4 ♘b7 21 ♖4d2 hxg5 22 hxg5 ± Hendriksen-Eliason, corr 1960.

3b) **11...♖b8** 12 ♗h4 (12 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 transposes into the note to White's 12th; 12...gxf6 transposes into the analysis of 11...gxf6 below) ♘c5 (12...h6 13 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 14 ♗xb5 axb5 15 ♘dxb5 ♕b6 16 ♖xd6 ♕c5 17 ♕d3 ∞ Rizzo-Pavel, corr 1985) and now:

3b1) **13 ♗xf6** gxf6 (13...♗xf6 14 ♗xb5+ ♔f8 15 ♗c4 ♕b6, Hartston-Portisch, Bath Echt 1973, and now 16 b4! was good for White) 14 f5 b4 15 axb4 ♖xb4 ∞ Stean-Momeni, Teesside 1973.

3b2) **13 g5** ♘fxe4 14 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 15 ♕xe4 ♗b7 16 ♘xe6 fxe6 17 ♕xe6 ♗xh1 18 ♗h3 (18 g6 d5 19 ♕f7+ ♔d8 20 ♖xd5+ ♗xd5 21 ♕xd5+ ♕d7 22 ♗xe7+ ♔xe7 23 ♕e5+ ♕e6 24 ♕c7+ ♔f6 25 ♕c3+ is also a draw) ♗f3 19 ♖e1 d5 20 g6 ♗e4 21 ♖xe4 dxe4 22 ♕f7+ ½-½ Dementiev-Sadov, USSR 1976.

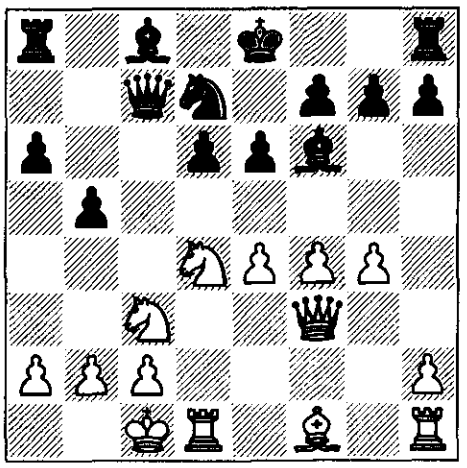
3b3) **13 ♖g1** b4 14 axb4 ♖xb4 15 g5 ♘fd7 16 ♗e1 ♕b6 17 ♘d5 exd5 18 ♗xb4 ♕xb4 19 exd5, Semionova-Ioseliani, Sochi wom Ct (2) 1983, 19...♘a4! 20 ♘b3 ♘dc5 21 f5 ♘xb2 22 ♔xb2 ♘a4+ 23 ♔c1 ♕a3+ 24 ♔d2 ♕b4+ either forces a draw or induces the white king to venture to e3.

11 ... ♘xf6

Both the other recaptures are playable. For a long time theory (and *The Najdorf for the Tournament Player*!) just gave '11...♗xf6? 12 ♗xb5', but this sacrifice does not have the lethal effect that was once supposed.

11...gxf6 was once adopted by Fischer, who followed it up with the apparently suicidal ...0-0. However, there is no mate and this line, while risky for Black, has not been definitely refuted.

Dealing first with **11...♗xf6** *(D)*, White may reply:



1) **12 ♗xb5** and now:

1a) **12...axb5?** (this really is bad for Black) 13 ♘dxb5 ♕a5 (13...♕c5 14 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 15 e5 ♗e7 16 ♕xa8 1-0 Bikady-Djurić, Huy 1992) 14 ♘xd6+ ♔e7 15 e5 ♗xe5 16 fxe5 ♘xe5 17 ♕e4 +– Dlauchy-White, Balatonbereny 1994.

1b) **12...0-0** 13 ♗xd7 (13 e5 dxe5 14 ♘xe6 fxe6 15 ♕xa8 axb5 16 ♘xb5 ♕b6 17 ♘d6 exf4 ∓ Gerola-Innorta, corr 1986) ♗xd7 14 g5 ♗e7 15 h4 ♖ab8 16 f5 ♕b7 17 ♘b3 ♖fc8 18 f6 ♗f8 19 h5 ± Outerelo-Ugalde, Spain Cht 1993.

1c) **12...♖b8!** 13 ♗xd7+ ♗xd7 14 ♕d3 (14 ♘b3 0-0 15 g5 ♗e7 16 h4 ♖fc8 17 ♖h2 a5 18 f5 a4 19 f6 ♗f8 20 ♘d4 a3 ∓ Kalmar-Csuri, corr 1987; 14 ♘ce2 g6 15 g5 ♗g7 16 f5 ♗e5 17 fxg6 hxg6 18 ♖hf1 ♗b5 19 ♖f2 ♗xe2 20 ♖xe2 ♕c4 21 ♘b3 a5 ∞ Noble-Cayford, corr) ♖b6 15 g5 ♗e7 16 h4 0-0 17 f5 ♖fb8 18 f6 ♗f8 19 h5 d5 20 exd5 ♖xb2 ∞ Dutta-Britton, Hastings 1995.

2) **12 ♘cxb5** axb5 13 ♘xb5 ♕b8 14 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 ∞.

3) **12 e5** ♗b7 13 ♘dxb5 axb5 14 ♘xb5 ♕xc2+! 15 ♔xc2 ♗xf3 16 ♘c7+ ♔e7 ∓ Turner-Polnarieva, St Ingbert 1990.

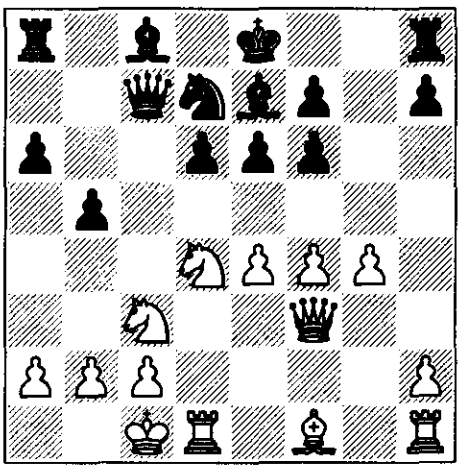
4) **12 g5** (the most promising move if White does not want to sacrifice on b5) ♗xd4 13 ♖xd4 ♗b7 (13...0-0 transposes to line 3c of the note to Black's 10th move) 14 ♗e2 0-0 15 ♖hd1 ♘b6 (15...♖ac8 16 ♖1d2 ♘b6 17 a3 d5 18 exd5 {18 e5!?} ♘xd5 19 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 20 ♕h3 f5! 21 ♕e3 ♕c5 with an equal position in Eisen-Cayford, corr 1990) 16 ♕e3 ♖ac8 17 f5 d5 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 exd5 ♗xd5 20 ♖h4 g6 21 ♗g4 ♖fe8 22 ♖xd5 exd5 23 ♗e6+ ♖xe6 24 ♕xe6+ ± Becerra Rivero-Herrera, Cuban Ch 1991.

Now we move on to the two important recaptures:

A: 11...gxf6
B: 11...♘xf6

A)

11 ... gxf6 *(D)*



12 f5

By far the most popular move. White at once blockades the doubled f-pawns and prepares to exert pressure on e6. The defect is that Black's knight is given an excellent square on e5.

Other moves:

1) **12 h4** b4 (12...♗b7 13 g5 b4 14 ♘ce2 ♘c5 15 ♘g3 d5 16 ♘h5 0-0-0 17 gxf6 dxe4 18 ♕e3 ♗d6 19 ♔b1 ♔b8 20 ♗h3 ♗d5 ∓ Barthel-Daemering, wom Bundesliga 1993) 13 ♘ce2 ♗b7 14 ♘g3 d5 15 ♗g2 dxe4 16 ♘xe4 0-0-0 17 ♖he1 h5 ∓ Kholmov-Suetin, Moscow Z 1964.

2) **12 ♗g2** and now:

2a) **12...♗b7** 13 ♖he1 (13 a3 ♘b6 14 f5 e5 15 ♘b3 ♖c8 16 ♕e2 ♘c4 17 ♘d5 ♗xd5 18 ♖xd5 ♕b6 ½-½ Kavakul-Asaturoglu, Lucerne OL 1982) 0-0-0! 14 a3 ♘b6 15 ♖d3 ♔b8 16 ♖ed1 d5! 17 exd5 ♘xd5 18 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 19 ♕f1 ♗c5 = Gligorić-Fischer, Zurich 1959.

2b) **12...b4** 13 ♘a4 (13 ♘d5 exd5 14 exd5 ♘c5 15 ♖he1 ♗d7 {15...♔f8 16 ♖e3 f5 17 gxf5 ♗f6 18 ♖de1 ♗d7 19 ♘e6+ ♘xe6 20 dxe6 ∞ Mandić-Klubis, Novi Sad 1988} 16 ♖e3 ♔d8 17 ♖de1 ♗f8 ∓ Righi-O'Neill, Novi Sad OL 1990) ♗b7 14 ♕b3 ♖b8 15 f5 e5 16 ♘e2 ♕a5 17 ♖d5 ♗xd5 18 exd5 h5 −+ Babić-K.Mowsziszian, Berlin Summer 1994.

3) **12 ♗d3** b4 (12...♗b7 13 ♔b1 ♖c8 14 ♖he1 ♕a5 15 ♘ce2 b4 16 ♕h3 h6 17 ♘g3 ♔f8 18 ♖f1 ♕b6 19 ♘ge2 ♘c5 = Mazi-Gallob, Finkenstein 1995) 13 ♘ce2 ♗b7 14 ♔b1 (14 ♘g3 0-0-0 15 ♔b1 ♔b8 16 ♕e2 ♘c5 17 ♘b3 ♔a7 18 ♖hf1 ♖c8 19 ♖c1 ♕b6 20 f5 ♘xb3 21 axb3 ♕a5 ∞ Vasiliev-Zhukhovitsky, Smolensk 1991) ♘c5 15 ♖he1 (15 f5 d5 16 fxe6 dxe4 17 exf7+ ♔f8 18 ♗xe4 ♗xe4 19 ♕xe4 ♘xe4 20 ♘e6+ ♔xf7 21 ♘xc7 ♖a7 22 ♖d4 ♘f2 23 ♖f1 ♘xg4 24 ♘d5 ♖d8 = Padevsky-Evans, Havana OL 1966) d5 16 ♘g3 0-0-0 17 e5 fxe5 18 fxe5 ♗h4 19 ♖e2 ♗xg3 20 ♕xg3 ♖dg8 21 ♕f4 ♕e7 22 ♘b3 ♘xb3 23 cxb3 ± Papenbrock-Rondio, corr 1990.

4) **12 a3** and now:

4a) **12...♘c5** 13 f5 ♖b8 14 fxe6 fxe6 15 g5 fxg5 16 b4 g4 17 ♕xg4 ♘b3+ 18 ♘xb3 ♕xc3 19 ♕h5+ ♔d8 20 ♗h3 ♗d7 21 ♖d3 ♕f6 22 ♔b1 ± Tolush-Aronin, USSR Ch 1957.

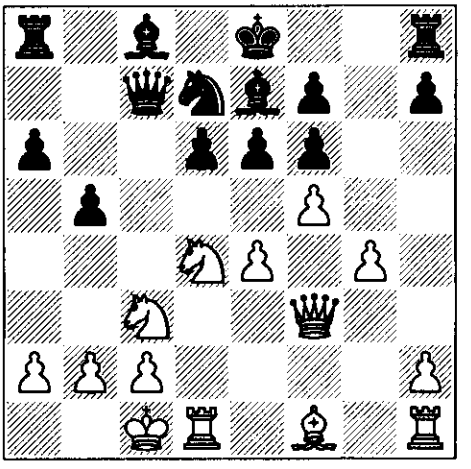
4b) **12...♘b6** 13 h4 ♗d7 14 g5 0-0-0 15 a4 ♘xa4 16 ♘xa4 bxa4 17 ♗xa6+ ♔b8 18 ♗b5 ♗xb5 19 ♘xb5 ♕b7 20 ♕e2 ± Pavlov-Donner, Halle Z 1963.

4c) **12...♗b7** 13 f5 (13 h4 ♖c8 14 g5 ♘c5 15 ♗g2 e5?! 16 fxe5 fxe5 17 ♘f5 ♖g8 18 ♕h5 ± Falkowski-Herborn, corr 1987) e5 14 ♘de2 (14 ♘b3 ♖c8 15 ♗d3 ♘c5 16 ♔b1 ♘d7 {not the sternest test of White's play} 17 h4 h5 18 gxh5 ♗f8 19 ♘c1 ± Rusenescu-Jesso, corr 1967) ♘b6 (14...♖c8 15 ♘g3 h6 16 h4 ♖g8 17 ♗e2 d5 18 exd5 ♗xa3 19 ♘ge4 ♗f8 20 d6 ± Litwin-Zienau, corr 1964) 15 ♘d5 (15 ♘g3, as in the other examples, looks better) ♗xd5 16 exd5 ♖c8 17 ♘c3 ♘c4 18 ♗xc4 bxc4 19 ♔b1 ♖b8 20 ♔a2 h5 21 gxh5 ♗f8 ∞ Mednis-Fischer, USA Ch (New York) 1959/60.

4d) **12...♖b8** (this position can also arise after 11 a3 ♖b8 12 ♗xf6 gxf6) 13 f5 (13 ♗g2 0-0 14 ♖hg1 ♔h8 15 ♕h3 ♖g8 16 ♕h5 ♖g7 17 ♘d5 exd5 18 ♘f5 ♘c5 19 ♘xg7 ♔xg7 20 g5 fxg5 ∓ Manduch-Debnar, Slovakian Cht 1995; 13 h4 b4 14 axb4 ♖xb4 15 g5 {15 b3 ♗b7 16 ♗c4 ♕a5 17 g5 ♘c5 18 ♖he1 f5 ∓ Šibarević-Polajzer, Zurich 1990} ♕b6 16 ♘b3 f5 17 exf5 ♗b7 18 ♕h3 ♗xh1 19 ♕xh1 ♕e3+ 20 ♔b1 ∓ Hauswald-Bellas, corr 1986) ♘e5

14 ♕h3 0-0 (the normal position, but with a3 and ...♖b8 added; this should favour Black, because now he has the chance to open the queenside with ...b4) 15 ♕h6 ♔h8 16 g5 ♖g8 17 gxf6?! (not a critical line) ♘g4 18 ♕h5 ♗xf6 ∓ J.Nielsen-Hugolf, corr 1969.

Back to the main line after 12 f5 *(D)*:



12 ... ♘e5

Or:

1) **12...b4?!** 13 fxe6 bxc3 14 exd7+ ♗xd7 15 e5! and now:

1a) **15...♕b8** 16 ♕xc3 fxe5 17 ♘f5 ♗xf5 18 gxf5 ♗f6 19 ♕c6+ ♔e7 20 ♗c4 ± Kupreichik-Szekely, Lvov 1986.

1b) **15...cxb2+** 16 ♔b1 ♖a7 17 exf6 ♗f8 18 ♗g2 +–.

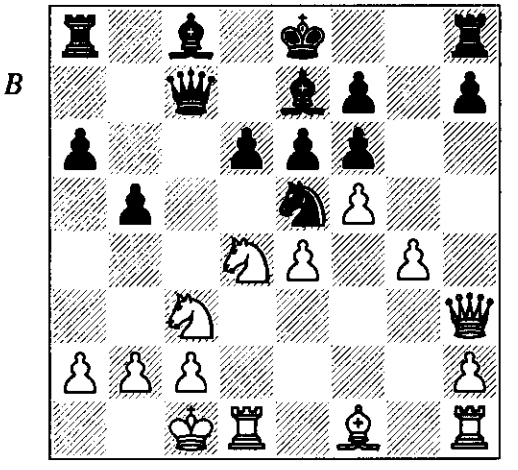
1c) **15...♖b8** 16 exf6 ♗f8 17 g5! ♖xb2 18 ♗h3 ♖xa2 19 ♘b3 ♔d8 (19...♗xh3 20 ♕xh3 ♕c5!? 21 ♖de1+ ♔d8 22 ♖e3 ♕a3+ 23 ♔d1 ♖a1+ 24 ♘xa1 ♕xa1+ 25 ♔e2 ♕xh1 26 ♖e8+! +–) 20 ♗xd7 ♔xd7 21 ♖d3 ♖a4 22 ♖xc3 ± Estrin-Sergievsky, Minsk 1962.

2) **12...♘c5** 13 fxe6 (13 ♗g2 b4 14 ♘ce2 e5 15 ♘b3 ♗b7 16 ♘g3 a5 17 ♔b1 a4 ∞ Morris-Browne, Lone Pine 1979) fxe6 14 b4 (14 a3 0-0 15 ♗d3 ♖b8 16 h4 b4 17 axb4 ♖xb4 18 ♕e3 ♕b6 ∓ Capelan-Donner, Solingen 1968) ♘a4 (14...0-0 15 g5? {15 bxc5 dxc5 16 ♘b3} fxg5 16 ♕g3 ♘a4 17 ♘xa4 bxa4 18 h4, Steinbruck-Bandt, corr, 18...e5! ∓) 15 ♘xa4 bxa4 16 ♖d3 0-0 17 ♖c3 ♕b6 18 ♘c6 ♖f7 19 ♘xe7+ ♖xe7 20 ♗c4 ± Hübner-Hort, Wijk aan Zee 1979.

3) **12...e5?** 13 ♘d5 ♕b7 14 ♘e2 ♕c6 15 h4 ♗b7 16 g5 ♖c8 17 ♘ec3 ♕c5 18 b4 ♕c6 19 ♗d3 ♘b6 20 g6 ♔d8 21 g7 +– Mäki-Briffel, Novi Sad OL 1990.

13 ♕h3 *(D)*

Or 13 ♕g3 ♗d7 (13...0-0 14 ♔b1 ♔h8 15 ♗d3 ♖g8 16 h3 ♗d7 17 ♘ce2 ♕c5 18 ♕g2 ♘c4 = Roeberg-Balzar, Gießen 1992; 13...b4 {there is no reason to force White to play ♘c3-e2-f4, since he often adopts this manoeuvre voluntarily} 14 ♘ce2 ♕b7 15 ♘f4 ♖g8 16 h3 ± Ueter-Van der Veen, 2nd Bundesliga 1990) 14 ♔b1 (14 h4 ♖g8 15 ♗h3 ♕c8 16 fxe6 fxe6 17 ♕e3 ♕c5 18 ♕h6 ♘f7! = Okner-Malishauskas, corr 1992) 0-0-0?! 15 a4! ± Roeberg-Chandler, Doernigheim 1994.



13 ... 0-0 *(D)*

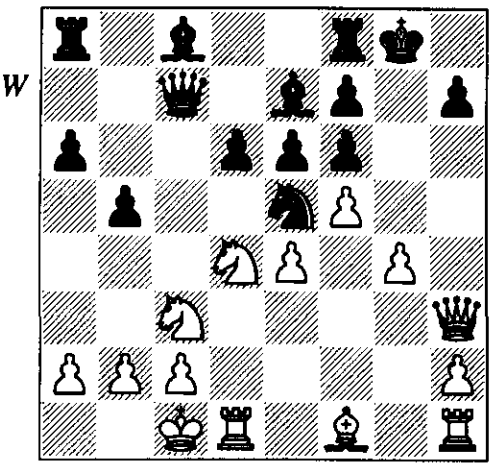
Other moves are inferior:

1) **13...♗d7** 14 ♖g1 0-0-0 (14...b4 15 ♘ce2 ♕a5 16 fxe6 ♗xe6 17 ♘xe6 fxe6 18 ♕b3 ♖d8 19 ♘d4 ♕b6 20 ♘xe6 1-0 Brustman-Byczynska, Poland Cht 1993) 15 ♘ce2 ♔b8 16 ♘f4 ♖c8 17 ♕b3 (17 fxe6! fxe6 18 ♕b3 ±) ♘c6 18 ♘xc6+ ♕xc6 19 ♗d3 ♗d8 20 fxe6 ± ½-½ Olthof-Umezinwa, Philadelphia 1990.

2) **13...b4** (a common mistake by Black in this line; White's knight is heading for f4 in any case, so why spend a tempo pushing it there?) 14 ♘ce2 exf5 (14...♗b7 15 fxe6 ♗xe4 16 exf7+ ♔xf7 17 ♗g2 ♗xg2 {17...d5 18 ♗xe4 dxe4 19 g5 ± Neumann-Frank, Gießen 1994} 18 ♕xg2 ♕c4 19 ♔b1 ♖ac8 20 ♕h3 ♖c5 21 ♖hf1 favours White, Koglin-Mai, wom Bundesliga 1994) and now White has a pleasant choice:

2a) **15 exf5** ♗b7 16 ♗g2 ♗xg2 (16...0-0-0 17 ♘f4 ♖df8 18 ♘d5 ♗xd5 19 ♗xd5 ♖fg8 20 ♕f1 ♕b6 21 ♕e2 ♗f8 22 h3 ± Szczepankiewicz-Chabaj, corr 1992) 17 ♕xg2 ♖c8, Mulling-Herborn, corr 1986, 18 ♘f4 ±.

2b) **15 ♘xf5** ♗xf5 16 gxf5 (16 exf5 ♖c8 17 ♘d4 ♕b6 18 ♗e2 d5 19 ♕b3 ♗c5 20 ♕a4+ ♔e7 21 ♘b3 ± Bergdahl-A.Andersson, corr 1967) ♖c8 (16...h5 17 ♘f4 ♖c8 18 ♕b3 ♕c6 19 ♘d5 a5 20 a4 ♔f8 21 ♖g1 +– Tortarolo-Girault, Cannes 1990; 16...♘c4 17 ♘f4 ♘b6 18 ♕b3 a5 19 ♗b5+ ♔f8 20 ♖hg1 ♕c5 21 ♕g3 1-0 Dieta-Carvalho, corr 1974) 17 ♕b3 (17 ♘d4 ♘c6 18 ♕b3 ♘xd4 19 ♖xd4 +– Riemer-Ceterski, corr 1982) ♘g4 18 ♘d4 ♘f2 19 ♗xa6 ♖a8 20 ♗b5+ ♔f8 21 ♕e3 +– Mokos-Gubis, Slovakia Cht 1995.



14 ♖g1

There are several other possibilities:

1) **14 ♗d3** normally transposes into the note to White's 15th after 14...♔h8 15 ♖hg1.

2) **14 ♕h5** ♔h8 15 h4 ♖g8 16 g5 b4 (16...♗d7 17 ♔b1 ♕b7 18 ♗g2 ♖g7 19 ♖hf1 ♖f8 {Black's play is too passive} 20 ♘ce2 ♖gg8 21 ♘g3 ♗d8 22 ♗h3 ♕c8 23 ♕h6 ♖e8? 24 fxe6 fxe6 25 ♖xf6 ♘g6 26 ♖f7 1-0 Pinkas-Jakubiec, Polish Ch 1993) 17 ♘ce2 fxg5 18 hxg5 ♗xg5+ 19 ♔b1 ♖g7 20 ♘f4 ♕e7 21 ♘d3 ♗b7 ∓ Turlej-Jedrzejowski, corr 1992.

3) **14 ♘f3** b4 (14...♗d7 15 fxe6 fxe6 16 ♘xe5 dxe5 17 ♗d3 ♔h8 18 ♖df1 ♖g8 19 ♕f3 ♖af8 20 h4 ♖g7 21 ♗e2 ♗c6 ∓ Frysiak-Rosinski, corr 1992) 15 ♘b1 ♗b7 16 ♘xe5 dxe5 17 ♗d3 a5 18 ♕h6 exf5 19 gxf5 ♔h8 20 ♖dg1 ♖g8 21 ♖g3 a4 22 a3 ♕b6 ∓ Trzulja-Nemeth, Stockerau 1993.

4) **14 g5** fxg5 (14...b4? 15 gxf6 ♗xf6 16 ♖g1+ ♔h8 17 ♕h6 ♕e7 18 ♘c6!! ♘xc6 19 e5! ♗g5+ 20 ♖xg5 f6 21 exd6 led to a brilliant White win in Kholmov-Bronstein, USSR Ch 1964) 15 fxe6 fxe6 16 ♘xe6 ♕d7 17 ♘d5 ♖f3 (17...♕xe6 and 17...♗d8

are also satisfactory) 18 ♕h6 (not 18 ♘b6? ♖xh3 19 ♘xd7 ♗xd7 20 ♗xh3 g4 ∓) ♕xe6 19 ♕xe6+ ♗xe6 20 ♘xe7+ ♔f7 21 ♘f5 ♗xf5 22 exf5 ♖d8 with an edge for Black.

5) **14 ♘ce2** ♔h8 (14...♗d7 15 ♘f4 ♕c8 16 ♕h6 ♔h8 17 ♘h5 ♖g8 18 ♘xf6 ±) 15 ♘f4 ♖g8 and now:

5a) **16 fxe6** fxe6 17 ♘fxe6 ♗xe6 18 ♘xe6 ♕c8 19 ♘d4 ♕xg4 (or 19...♘xg4 20 ♕h4 ♘e3 21 ♗h3 ♕c7 22 ♖d3 f5 23 ♕f2 ± Walther-Pommerening, corr 1975; 19...♖xg4 20 ♘f5 ♕c7 21 ♗e2 ♖gg8 22 ♕b3 ♖g5 23 h4 ♖gg8 24 ♖hg1 ♖ac8 25 ♖xg8+ ♖xg8 26 ♕e6 +– Oechslein-Fleischmann, corr 1968) 20 ♕xg4 ♘xg4 21 ♘f5, Spassky-Donner, Leiden 1970, 21...♗d8! =.

5b) **16 ♖g1** transposes into the note to White's 16th move.

5c) **16 ♗e2** (this line is one of White's more promising possibilities) ♗b7 (16...♕b7 17 ♖he1 ♕xe4 18 ♘h5 ♕b7 19 ♕h4 ♖g5 20 ♕f2 ♗d7 21 h4 ♖gg8 22 ♘xf6 ♗xf6 23 fxe6 ± Nejezchlebova-Kubikova, corr 1991) 17 fxe6 fxe6, Kotkov-Belinkov, USSR 1971, 18 ♘fxe6 ♕a5 19 ♘f5 ±.

6) **14 ♕h6** ♔h8 and now:

6a) **15 ♖d3!?** ♘xd3+ (15...♘xg4 16 ♕h4 ♖g8 17 ♖h3 ♖g7 18 ♖g1 exf5 19 exf5 +–; 15...♖g8 16 ♖h3 ♖g7 17 g5 ♕d8 18 ♖g1 ♕g8 ±) 16 ♗xd3 ♖g8 (16...b4 17 e5! bxc3 18 fxe6 cxb2+ 19 ♔b1 +–; 16...exf5 17 ♘d5 ♕d7 18 ♘xf6 +–; 16...♗b7 17 fxe6 ♖g8 18 ♘d5 ♗xd5 19 exd5 f5 20 h4 ±; 16...e5 17 ♘d5 ♕b7 18 ♘xf6 +–; 16...♕c5!?) 17 ♖f1 ♖xg4 (17...♗f8 18 ♕h4 ♕c5!?) 18 e5! ♕d8 (18...dxe5 19 fxe6 f5! 20 ♘d5 is unclear, but not 20 ♖xf5 exd4! –+) 19 ♘c6 ♕f8 20 ♕h3 exf5 21 ♘d5 ∞ Muraveva-Gadzinskaya, corr 1992.

6b) **15 g5** ♖g8 (not 15...♕d8? 16 ♘c6 ♘xc6 17 g6 +– Pjaeren-Grigorian, USSR 1974) 16 g6 (16 gxf6 ♘g4 17 ♕h5 ♗xf6 ∓; 16 ♖g1 fxg5 17 fxe6 ♖g6 18 ♕h5 ♗xe6 ∓ Ludvigsen-Forsberg, corr 1974; 16 ♗h3 is bad after 16...fxg5 or 16...♗f8 17 ♕h5 ♖xg5) fxg6 and now:

6b1) **17 ♘xe6** ♗xe6 18 fxe6 ♖ac8 19 ♕d2 (not 19 ♖d2? ♕a5 20 ♕h3 {20 ♔b1 ♖xc3 21 bxc3 ♕xc3 –+ Romanowski-Jedrzejowski, corr 1984} f5 21 ♖d5 fxe4 22 ♕e3 ♖gf8 23 ♕xe4 ♗g5+ 24 ♔b1 ♖xc3! 25 bxc3 ♕xc3 ∓ Kolmann-Jedrzejowski, corr 1990) ♘c4 20 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 21 ♕d5 ♖ge8 (21...b4 22 ♕xc4 ♖xc4 23 ♘d5 ♖e8 24 ♖he1 ♗d8 25 b3 ±) 22 ♖d4 (22 a3 ♗f8 23 ♖d4 ♕c7 24 ♖f1 ♕e7 25 a4 ♖c5 ∓ Walther-Albrecht, corr 1988) ♕c7 23 ♖f1 ♕b6 24 ♖d3 ♖c5 25 ♕d4 ♕d8 26 ♘d5 ♖c4 27 ♕e3 ± Boll-Pommering, corr 1978.

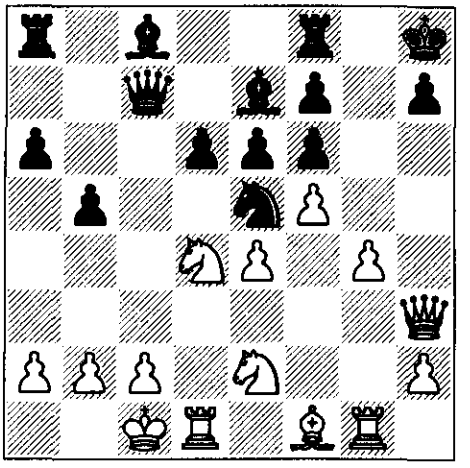
6b2) **17 fxe6** ♗b7 18 ♘d5 (18 ♗e2 b4 19 ♘d5 ♗xd5 20 exd5 ♕a5 21 ♔b1 ♕xd5 22 ♖hg1 ♕e4 23 ♖g3 ∞ Stypka-Malishauskas, Katowice 1993) ♗xd5 19 exd5 f5 (activating the dark-squared bishop; 19...♕c5 20 ♗g2 a5 21 h4 f5 22 ♕f4 a4 23 ♔b1 a3 24 b3 ♗f6 25 ♖h3 ∞ ♘g4?! 26 h5 ♗xd4 27 hxg6 ♖xg6 28 ♖xd4 ± Fonseca-Tilak, Dubai OL 1986; 19...♖ac8 20 ♕d2?! f5 21 h4 ♗f6 22 h5 ♘c4 23 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 24 hxg6 ♖xg6 25 ♕h2 ♖c7 ∓ Kelson-Trammell, Reno 1994) 20 ♗g2 (20 ♖g1 ♖ac8 21 ♕f4 ♗f6 22 ♔b1 ♘c4 23 ♕f2 ♕c5 24 c3 ♕xd5 25 ♗g2 ♕c5 26 ♖d3 b4 –+ Halamus-Jedrzejowski, corr 1994; 20 ♗e2 ♖ac8 21 ♔b1

♗f6 22 ♖d2 ♘c4 23 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 24 ♘c6 ♗xb2 ½-½ Staudler-Hutschenreiter, corr 1988; 20 ♕d2 ♗f6 21 ♘c6 ♖ac8 22 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 23 c3 b4 24 c4 a5 ∓ Ziukin-Nalbandian, Sas van Gent jr Ech 1992) ♗f6 21 h4 (21 ♔b1 ♖ac8 22 h4? ♘c4 23 ♕f4 ♘xb2 0-1 Fahner-De Vriendt, corr 1986) ♖ac8 22 ♘c6 ♘xc6 23 dxc6 ♕a5 24 ♗d5 ♗e5 25 ♕e3 ± Saarman-Sikkila, corr 1992.

14 ... ♔h8

15 ♘ce2 *(D)*

White may adopt various move-orders here, but however White continues, he will often play ♘ce2 sooner or later. However, there is a clear distinction between lines in which ♗d3 precedes ♘ce2 and those in which ♘ce2 is played first, blocking in the f1-bishop. The main line deals with variations without ♗d3. The alternative is 15 ♗d3 (15 ♕h6 ♖g8 16 g5 should be answered by 16...fxg5 – see line 6b of the previous note) ♖g8 (15...♗d7 16 ♘ce2 ♕b6 17 ♕h6 ♖g8 18 ♖g3 ♖g7 19 ♖dg1 ♖ag8 20 ♖h3 d5 21 fxe6 fxe6 22 exd5 ♘xd3+ 23 ♖xd3 exd5 ∞ Wind-Haag, Wiesbaden 1988) 16 ♘ce2 (16 ♖g3 ♗d7 17 ♘f3 b4 18 ♘xe5 fxe5 19 ♘e2 b3 20 axb3 a5 21 ♔d2 a4 22 bxa4 ♖xa4 23 ♕h5 ♗g5+ 24 ♔e1 ♗e8 with equality, as in the game Zahn-Brustman, Dortmund wom 1989) ♕b6 (16...♗d7 17 ♖g3 ♖ac8 18 ♘f4 d5 19 ♘h5 ♘xd3+ 20 ♖dxd3 dxe4 ∓ Borbely-Csuri, corr 1991; 16...♕c5 17 ♔b1 ♗d7 18 c3 b4 19 ♗c2 a5 20 ♖g3 ♖ab8 21 cxb4 ♖xb4 ∓ Kotylak-Jedrzejowski, corr 1992; 16...♘xd3+?! 17 ♖xd3 e5 18 ♖c3 ♕d7 19 ♘c6 ♗b7 20 ♘xe7 ♕xe7 21 ♘g3 d5 22 exd5 ♖ad8 23 ♘h5 ♗xd5 24 ♕h4 ♖g5 25 ♖h3 ± Sawadkuhi-Enders, Hamburg 1993) 17 ♖g3 (or 17 ♖df1 ♗d7 18 ♖g3 ♘xd3+ 19 ♖xd3 e5 20 ♘b3 b4 21 ♕g2 ♗b5 22 ♖h3 ♖ad8 23 ♖d1 ♗c4 ∓ Mathes-Huchenreiter, corr 1988) ♗d7 18 ♖dg1 ♖g5 19 ♔b1 ♖ag8 20 ♘f3 ♘xf3 21 ♖xf3 exf5 22 exf5 b4 23 ♖ff1 ♗c6 24 ♕g3 d5 ∞ Korolev-Lipiridi, corr 1991.



15 ... ♖g8

The most common possibility, but some other moves have been tried:

1) **15...♕b7** 16 ♕b3 ♘c4 17 ♘g3 ♕c7 18 ♘h5 ♖g8 19 ♕c3 e5 20 ♘f3 ♗b7 21 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 22 ♕xc4 bxc4 23 ♖de1 c3 24 bxc3 d5 25 ♘d2 dxe4 26 ♘xe4 ♖gd8 = Renteria-Nalbandian, Matinhos Wch jr 1994.

2) **15...♗d7** 16 ♘f4 ♖ac8 17 ♖g2 ♕b7 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♘fxe6 ♖g8 20 ♗d3 ♖g6 21 ♕e3, Stripunsky-Nalbandian, Rostov 1993, 21...♗xe6 22 ♘xe6 f5! ∞.

3) **15...♗b7** 16 ♗g2 (16 ♘f4 ♗xe4 17 fxe6 d5 18 exf7 ♖xf7 19 ♘fe6 ♕c8 ∞; 16 g5?! fxg5 17 ♕h6 ♖g8 18 ♗g2 ♖ac8 19 fxe6 ♖g6 20 ♕h3 fxe6 ∓ Dobsa-Mescheder, corr 1992) ♖g8 17 ♗h1 (17 ♗f3 d5 18 exd5 ♘xf3 19 ♘xf3 ♗xd5 ∓) ♖ac8

18 ♔b1 (18 ♘f4 d5 19 exd5 ±) d5 19 exd5 (19 fxe6 dxe4 20 exf7 ♘xf7 ∞) exf5 (19...♗xd5 20 fxe6 ♗xh1 21 exf7 ±) 20 gxf5 ±.

16 ♖g3

Once again, White's move-order is fairly flexible. White can also try to play without an immediate ♖g3, for example **16 ♘f4 d5** (Fischer suggested 16...♕b7 17 ♖e1 ♕b6, but presumably the critical test is 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♘fxe6 ♗xe6 19 ♘xe6, which appears good for White) **17 fxe6** (17 exd5 exf5 18 ♗g2 ∞) **dxe4** and now:

1) **18 ♖g3** ♗xe6 with a further branch:

1a) **19 ♘fxe6** fxe6 20 ♘xe6 ♕b6 (20...♕c8 21 g5 ±) 21 g5 ♕f2 22 ♖d2 ♕e1+ 23 ♖d1 ♕f2 (24 ♖e3!?) ½-½ Manik-Debnar, Slovakian Ch 1994.

1b) **19 ♕xh7+** ♔xh7 20 ♖h3+ ♔g7 21 ♘fxe6+ fxe6 22 ♘xe6+ ♔f7 23 ♘xc7 ♖a7 24 ♖h7+ ♖g7 25 ♖xg7+ ♔xg7 26 ♘d5 (26 ♘e6+ ♔f7 27 ♘d4 ♘xg4 =) ♘xg4 27 ♗h3 f5! = Dimitrov-Lautier, Adelaide jr Wch 1988.

2) **18 ♘d5** ♕c5 and now:

2a) **19 ♘f5!** ♗xe6 (19...♗d8 20 ♕h6 ♘d3+!? ∞; 19...♕xg1 20 ♘fxe7 ♗xe6 {20...♕xg4? 21 ♕xg4 ♖xg4 22 ♘c7 ♖b8 23 ♖d8+ ♔g7 24 ♘f5+ ♔g6 25 e7 +−} 21 ♘xg8 ♗xg4 22 ♕h6 ♗xd1 23 ♘gxf6 ♕g6 24 ♕xg6 hxg6 25 ♔xd1 ♖d8 26 ♔e2 ±) 20 ♘fxe7 ♗xd5 21 ♘xg8 ♖xg8 22 ♖g3 ♘f3 23 ♕h6 ♖g6 24 ♕f4 b4, Fiorito-Van de Plassche, corr 1990, 25 h4! ♘xh4 (25...♘d4 26 c3) 26 ♖h3 ♘f3 27 ♖h5 ♘d4 28 ♕xe4 +−.

2b) **19 ♘xe7** ♕xe7 20 ♘f5 ♕xe6 21 ♕h6 ♗d7! (21...♗b7 22 ♖d6 ♘xg4 23 ♕f4 ♕xa2 24 ♖xg4 ♕a1+ 25 ♔d2 ♕xb2 26 ♖xg8+ ♖xg8 27 ♘d4 ♕b4+ 28 ♔d1 1-0 Nicholson-Girault, Cannes 1990) 22 ♖d6 (22 ♔b1 ♘xg4) ♘xg4! 23 ♖xg4 ♕xf5, Gligorić-Fischer, Belgrade Ct 1959, 24 ♖f4 ♕g5 25 ♕xf6+ ♕xf6 26 ♖dxf6 e3! 27 ♖xf7 ♖g1! 28 ♖xd7 e2 29 ♖d1! exd1♕+ 30 ♔xd1 ♔g7 31 ♔e1 ♖f8 32 ♖xf8 ♔xf8 33 ♔f2 ∓.

16 ... ♗d7

The main line, but various other moves are also playable:

1) **16...d5?** 17 exd5 exf5 18 gxf5 ♖xg3 19 hxg3 ♗d7 20 ♘f4 +−.

2) **16...♗b7** (this may be more promising than the main variation; Black is prepared to sacrifice the e6-pawn if necessary) 17 ♗g2 d5 (or 17...♘c6 18 ♕h6 ♘xd4 19 ♘xd4 e5 20 ♘e2 ♖ac8 21 ♖d2 ♕d8 22 ♘c3 ♖c5 23 ♘d5? ♗xd5 24 exd5 ♖c4 25 ♗f3 ♖f4 26 ♖h3 ♖g7 27 ♗e2 ♕b6 ∓ Maciejewski-Malishauskas, Miedzybrodzie 1991) 18 ♘f4 ♖ac8! (not 18...♗c5? 19 ♕xh7+! ♔xh7 20 ♖h3+ ♔g7 21 ♘dxe6+ fxe6 22 ♘xe6+ ♔f7 23 ♖h7+ +− Hamalainen-Gullulu, Arnhem jr Ech 1988) 19 ♖d2 ♗d6 20 fxe6? ♘c4 21 exf7 ♗xf4 22 fxg8♕+ 0-1 Gaida-Jedrzejowski, corr 1992.

3) **16...♕b7** 17 ♘f4 (17 ♗g2 ♗d7 18 ♘f4 ♖ae8 19 ♕h4 ♕c8 20 ♘h5 ♖g5 21 ♗f3 ♕c4 22 ♗e2 ♕c8 23 ♖c3 ♕a8 24 ♖h3 ♔g8 25 fxe6 fxe6 26 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 27 ♕xh7+ ♔f8 28 ♖f1 +− Am.Rodriguez-Martin del Campo, Capablanca mem 1989) ♖b8 (17...♕xe4!? may be possible, for example 18 ♘h5 ♕b7 19 ♗g2 d5 20 ♕h4 ♖g5 21 ♘f3 ♘xf3 22 ♗xf3 ♕c7 23 ♖h3 ♔g8 ∞; 17...♗d7 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♘dxe6 ♗xe6 20 ♘xe6

♖ac8 21 ♗g2 ♕d7 22 g5! fxg5 23 ♕f5 ± Ivanović-Jacimović, Yugoslav Ch 1985) 18 ♗g2 ♗d7 19 ♕h4 ♕c8 20 ♗f3 ♖g5 (20...♖g7!? 21 ♘h5 ♖g5 22 ♗e2 ±) 21 ♗e2 ♕g8 22 ♖dg1 b4 23 ♘h3 ♖g7 24 g5 fxg5 25 ♘xg5 ± Eisen-Domenden, corr 1990.

17 ♘f4 ♖ac8

17...♕c8 18 ♗e2 b4 19 ♕h6 ♖g5 20 ♖dg1 a5 21 ♘h5 ♕f8 22 ♕xf8+ ♗xf8 23 ♘xf6 ± Van der Tak-Widera, corr 1990.

18 fxe6!?

Or **18 ♔b1** (18 ♘h5 b4 19 ♕h4 ♖g5 20 ♗e2 ♕d8 21 ♖f1 a5 22 ♔b1 a4 23 ♘f4 ♕g8 24 ♖fg1 ♘c4 ∞ Van der Kleij-Van der Plassche, corr 1987) **♕b7** and now:

1) **19 ♗g2** ♕b6!? 20 ♕h4 (20 fxe6 fxe6 21 ♘dxe6 ♗xe6 22 ♘xe6 ♕f2 23 ♘d4! looks good for White) ♖c4 21 ♖h3 (21 ♘de2!?) ♖g7 22 ♘de2 (22 c3 b4!) ♘xg4 23 ♘h5 ♖g8 24 ♗f3? (24 ♘hf4 ♖g7 25 ♘h5 =) exf5 25 ♖g1 (25 ♘hf4 ♖g7 26 ♘d5 ♕d8 27 b3 ♖c5 28 ♘ef4 ♘e5 ∓) ♕e3! −+ Wolff-de Firmian, New York 1989.

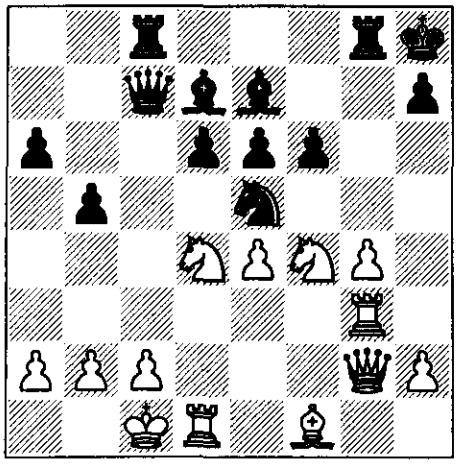
2) **19 ♗d3!?** ♘xd3?! (19...d5!? 20 exd5 ♘xd3 21 ♖gxd3 e5 22 d6! ♗d8 23 ♘de6! fxe6 24 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 25 fxe6 ♕g7 ∞) 20 cxd3 e5 21 ♘d5 ♗d8 22 ♘c2 b4 23 d4! a5 24 ♕h6 ♕c6 25 ♖c1 ♖g7 26 ♘xf6 ♗xf6 27 ♕xf6 ± Stripunsky-Istratescu, Bucharest 1994.

18 ... fxe6

19 ♕g2! *(D)*

19 ... ♗f8

The critical moment, since in the main line Black gradually falls into an inferior position. The alternatives are:



1) **19...♕a5?** (only puts the queen offside) 20 ♔b1 d5 21 exd5 exd5 22 ♘xd5 ♗xg4 23 ♘xe7! +−.

2) **19...♖xg4?** 20 ♖xg4 ♘xg4 21 ♘fxe6 ♗xe6 22 ♘xe6 ♕c6 23 h3 +−.

3) **19...♘c4?** 20 ♘dxe6 ♗xe6 21 ♘xe6 ♕d7 22 ♘f4 ♘e5 23 ♘d5 +− Kotronias-Tzoumbas, Greek Ch 1995.

4) **19...♘xg4** 20 ♘fxe6 ♗xe6 21 ♘xe6 ♕d7 22 ♘d4 ♘e3 (22...♘e5 23 ♕f2, intending ♗h3) 23 ♕h3! ♕xh3 24 ♗xh3 ♖xg3 (24...♘xd1? 25 ♗xc8 ♖xg3 26 hxg3 ♘f2 27 ♗xa6 ♘xe4 28 ♘f5 ±) 25 hxg3 ♖g8 26 ♖g1 ±.

20 ♘fxe6 ♗xe6

White has the advantage, for example 21 ♘xe6 ♕f7 (21...♗h6+ 22 g5! ♕e7 23 gxh6 ♕xe6 24 ♕f2!) 22 ♘xf8 ♖gxf8 23 ♔b1 ♖c6 24 ♗d3 ♕e6 25 g5 fxg5 26 ♖xg5 and White has a clear extra pawn, Brodsky-Stoica, Romania 1994.

B)

11 ... ♘xf6

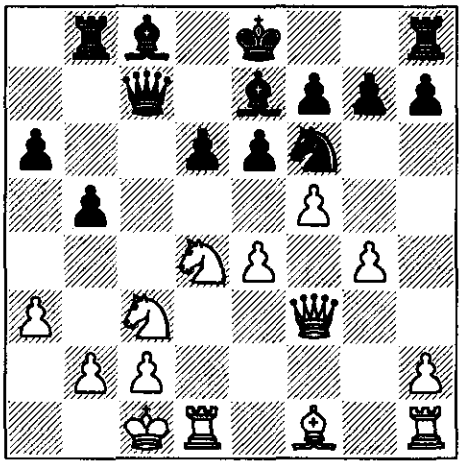
12 g5

Here we will analyse an interesting side-line, which is based on the idea of preventing ...♘d7 by playing

an early f5 to exert pressure on e6. The immediate **12 f5** is bad because of 12...b4 13 ♘ce2 (13 fxe6 bxc3 14 exf7+ ♔xf7 15 ♖g1 {15 g5 ♗g4; 15 e5 ♗b7} ♔e8 16 g5 ♕b7 −+ Kover-Pires, corr 1980) e5 14 ♘b3 ♘xe4 (the simple 14...♗b7 15 ♘g3 ♖c8 16 ♗d3 d5 also looks good for Black) 15 ♕xe4 ♗b7 16 ♖d5 ♖c8 17 ♘a1 ♕c4 18 ♕xc4 ♖xc4 19 ♗g2 ♗xd5 20 ♗xd5 ♖xg4 ∓ Damink-Nivard, corr 1991. It follows that White needs to preface f5 by a3 in order to maintain the knight on c3. The position White is aiming for arises after **12 a3** ♖b8 13 f5, but there is no perfect move-order to reach this position. The move-order we give here, with 12 a3, can be met by 12...♘d7, when White may have nothing better than 13 g5 transposing to line B1 below. It follows that if White wants to adopt this system, he should try 11 a3 ♖b8 12 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 13 f5, although this has the (admittedly much smaller) defect that Black can try 12...gxf6!?.

In any case, here is the analysis: **12 a3 ♖b8** (12...♘d7 13 ♗g2 {an interesting attempt to avoid a transposition; 13 g5 leads to line B1 below, while 13 f5 ♘e5 14 ♕g3 ♖b8 15 g5 b4 16 axb4 ♖xb4 is obviously fine for Black} 0-0 14 e5 d5 15 ♘f5 ♘b6 16 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 17 g5 b4 18 ♘b1 ♗d7 19 ♖d3 bxa3 20 ♘xa3 f6 21 ♕e3 ♖ab8 ∞ Hector-Rowson, Copenhagen 1996) **13 f5** *(D)* (13 g5 ♘d7 is again B1; the idea of playing f5 first is to prevent ...♘d7 when g5 finally does come) and now:

B



1) **13...d5** 14 fxe6 fxe6 15 exd5 0-0 16 ♘c6 ♖b6 17 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 18 ♕e3 ♖b8 (18...♖d6 19 ♗h3!) 19 d6 ♕b7 (19...♕d7 20 ♗h3 b4 21 axb4 ♖xb4 22 ♖hg1 +− Pletanek-Pesout, Pardubice 1992) was Szilagyi-Tobor, corr 1984, and now 20 ♗e2! b4 21 ♗f3 ♕f7 22 axb4 ♖xb4 23 ♖hf1 +−.

2) **13...exf5** 14 gxf5 (14 ♘xf5!) b4 15 axb4 ♖xb4 16 ♘b3 ♗b7 17 ♖d4 ♖xd4 18 ♘xd4 ♕b6 19 ♘b3 0-0 20 ♗d3 ♖c8 21 ♖e1 ♘d7 22 ♔b1 ♗f6 ∓ Van Kempen-Hovingh, corr 1987.

3) **13...b4?!** 14 axb4 ♖xb4 15 g5 0-0 (15...♘d7 16 fxe6 ♗xg5+ 17 ♔b1 ♘b6 18 ♕xf7+ ♕xf7 19 exf7+ ♔d7 20 ♗h3+ ♔c7 21 ♗xc8 ♔xc8 22 ♘e6 ♗f6 23 ♘d5! +− Thipsay-Howell, London 1985) 16 gxf6 (16 ♖g1!?) ♗xf6 17 ♘b3 ♗d7 18 ♖g1 a5 19 ♕g3 ♗e5 (19...a4? 20 ♖xd6! axb3 21 e5 +−) 20 ♕h4 ♕b6! 21 ♖g3! a4 22 f6 g6, Psakhis-Cvitan, Hartberg 1991, and now Psakhis gives 23 ♖h3 h5 24 ♗e2! axb3 25 ♗xh5 ♖a8!? 26 ♗xg6! ♖a1+ 27 ♔d2 ♖xd1+ 28 ♘xd1 ♖d4+ 29 ♔e2 ♕b5+ 30 ♔e3! +−.

4) **13...0-0** (this looks risky) 14 g5 and now:

4a) **14...♘d7** 15 f6 (15 ♕h5 ♘e5 16 ♖g1 {16 ♗h3 ♕c4 17 f6 ♗d8 18 ♖hf1 ♗b6 = Savon-Donner, Wijk aan Zee 1972} ♖e8 17 ♖g3 g6 18

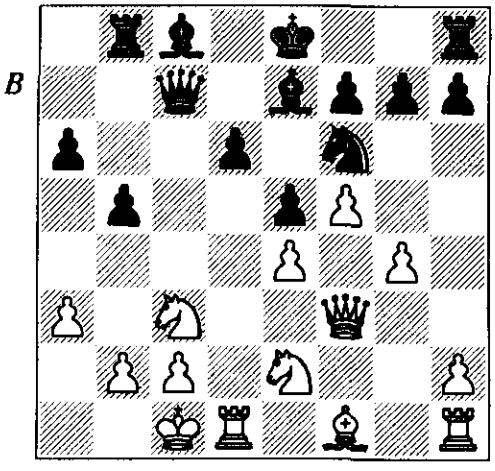
♕h4 ♗f8 19 ♘f3 b4 20 ♘xe5 dxe5 21 axb4 ♖xb4 22 ♖h3 h6 23 gxh6 ♔h7 24 fxg6+ fxg6 25 ♕f6 ♗xh6+ 26 ♖xh6+ 1-0 Howell-Britton, Oakham 1994) and now:

4a1) **15...♗d8** 16 ♕g3 (16 fxg7!? ♔xg7 17 ♕h5 ♘e5 18 ♕h6+ ♔g8 19 ♗h3!? b4 looks incredibly dangerous, but I cannot see a forced win, for example 20 ♗f5 ♘g6 21 ♗xg6 fxg6 22 axb4 ♖xb4 23 ♖hf1 ♕g7 or 20 ♘f5 f6! 21 gxf6 ♖xf6) b4 17 axb4 ♖xb4 18 h4 ♕b6 19 ♘b3 ♗c7 (19...♘e5!?) 20 fxg7 ♔xg7 21 ♕f3 ♗b7 22 ♗h3 ♗d8 23 ♘d5 ♘e5 24 ♕h5 ∞ Kulling-Freeman, corr 1985.

4a2) **15...gxf6** 16 gxf6 ♘xf6 (or 16...♗xf6 17 ♖g1+ ♔h8 18 ♗h3 b4 19 ♘d5!? ∞) 17 e5 dxe5 18 ♘c6 ♔h8 19 ♘xb8 ♕xb8 20 ♗g2 (20 ♖g1 ±) b4 21 axb4 ♕xb4 22 ♖he1 ♕f4+ 23 ♕xf4 exf4 24 ♗f3 = Kavalek-Donner, Wijk aan Zee 1969.

4b) **14...♘e8** 15 ♖g1 (15 f6 gxf6 could transpose to 4a2 above) b4 16 axb4 ♖xb4 17 ♖g3 (17 f6 ♗d8 18 ♖g3 is another idea) ♕c5 (17...g6 18 ♗e2 {18 b3 ♕c5 19 ♗c4 ♘c7 20 f6 ♗d8 21 h4 ♘b5 22 ♘cxb5 axb5 23 c3 ♖xc4 24 bxc4 ♕a3+ 25 ♔d2 b4 ∓ Pares Vives-Quinteros, Torremolinos 1975} ♕b6 19 ♘b3 a5 20 f6 ♗d8 21 ♖h3 ♗a6 22 ♗xa6 ♕xa6 23 ♘c5 ♕c6 24 ♘d3 ♖d4 25 ♖h6 ± Szilagyi-Raymaekers, corr 1980) 18 ♘b3 ♕e5 19 ♗d3 (19 f6 ♗d8 20 ♗d3 gxf6 21 h4 ♗b7 22 ♘d2 f5 ∓ Brustman-Peptan, Timisoara wom Z 1993) a5 20 ♘d2 a4 21 f6 (21 ♘c4 ♖xc4 22 ♗xc4 a3 23 f6 axb2+ 24 ♔b1 ♗d8 25 ♖dg1 gxf6? {25...♗b6 ∞} 26 gxf6+ ♔h8 27 ♕g4 h6 28 ♕h3 +– Guizar-Martinovski, corr 1989) ♗d8 22 ♘c4 ♕c5? (22...♖xc4 23 ♗xc4 a3 ∞) 23 e5 g6 24 ♘e4 ♕a7 25 exd6 ♗b7 26 ♕e3 +– Shamkovich-Grigorian, USSR Ch 1971.

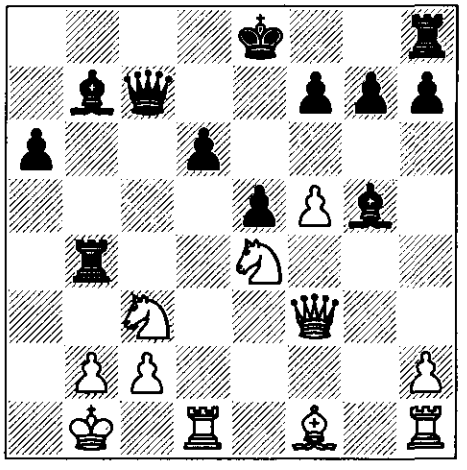
5) **13...e5** 14 ♘de2 *(D)* (14 ♘b3 b4 {14...♗b7 15 g5 ♘d7 16 h4 ♗c6 17 ♗h3 f6 18 ♕h5+ ♔f8 19 ♘d5 ♗xd5 20 ♖xd5 ♖c8 21 ♖d2 ± Fichtl-Bönsch, Halle 1974; 14...h6 15 h4 ♗b7 16 g5 ♘d7 17 ♔b1 hxg5 18 hxg5 ♖xh1 19 ♕xh1 ♗xg5 20 ♗xb5 ± Pähtz-Beck, Vienna 1996} 15 axb4 ♖xb4 16 ♗d3 ♗b7 17 g5 ♘d7 18 h4 ♘c5 19 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 20 f6 gxf6 21 ♖hf1 ∞ Bak-Ferens, corr 1993) and now:



5a) **14...♗b7** 15 g5 (15 ♘g3 ♗a8 16 g5 ♘d7 17 f6 gxf6 18 ♘h5 ♖g8 19 gxf6 ♗f8 20 ♗h3 ± Botterill-Mecking, Hastings 1971/2) ♘xe4 16 ♘xe4 d5 (after 16...♖c8, then not 17 ♕d3? ♕xc2+ 18 ♕xc2 ♖xc2+ 19 ♔xc2 ♗xe4+ 20 ♔b3 ♗xh1 –+ but 17 c3 ±) 17 ♘4c3 d4 18 ♘e4 ♗xg5+ 19 ♔b1 0-0 20 ♘2g3 ♔h8 21 h4 ♗e3 22 f6 g6 23 h5 b4 24 hxg6 fxg6 25 ♗c4!! ♗f4 26 ♖xh7+ ♕xh7 27 ♖h1 ♗h6 28 f7 ♕g7 29 ♖h2 ♗xe4 30 ♘xe4 g5 31 ♘d6 ♖b6 32 ♘f5 g4 33 ♕g3 ♕g5 34 ♕xe5+ ♔h7 35 ♗d3 1-0 Nunn-B.Lalić, Bayswater 1996.

5b) **14...b4** 15 axb4 ♖xb4 16 g5 (16 ♘g3 ♗b7 17 h4 ♘d7 18 ♘h5 0-0 19 g5 ♖c8 20 ♗d3? ♖xb2 21 ♗xa6 ♖xc2+! 22 ♔xc2 ♗xe4+ –+ Markowitsch-Wikander, corr 1979) ♘xe4 17 ♘xe4 ♗b7 18 ♘2c3 (18 ♘2g3 {interesting as it allows White's queen to operate along the third rank, thereby preventing the various perpetual checks that might arise after ...♖xb2+} ♗xg5+ 19 ♔b1 ♗f4 20 ♗g2 ♗xg3 21 ♘xd6+ ♕xd6 22 ♕xg3 ♕e7 23 ♗xb7 ♖xb7 24 ♕xg7 ♖f8 25 ♕g2 f6 26 ♕c6+ ♔f7 27 ♖hg1 a5 28 ♖d6 1-0 Howell-Mai, Hamburg 1995) ♗xg5+ 19 ♔b1 *(D)* and now:

B



5b1) **19...♕b6** (probably the best move) 20 ♕d3 (20 b3 ♖xb3+ 21 cxb3 ♕xb3+ 22 ♔a1 ♕a3+ drawing; 20 ♗b5+ axb5 21 ♖hg1? {21 ♘xd6+ ♕xd6 22 ♕xb7 ♖xb2+ 23 ♔xb2 ♕b4+ 24 ♔a2 ♕c4+ is also a draw} ♗d2! 22 ♖xg7 ♗xc3 23 ♘f6+ ♔e7 24 ♕xc3 ♔xf6 –+ Hurter-Zschunke, corr 1983) ♖xb2+ 21 ♔a1 0-0! (or 21...♗xe4 22 ♘xe4 0-0 23 ♕xd6 ±) 22 ♕xd6 (22 ♘xg5 ♖b8; 22 ♘a4 ♕b4 23 ♘xg5 ♖b8! 24 ♘xb2 ♗d5! 25 ♕b3 ♗xb3 26 cxb3 ♕xb3 27 ♖d2 ♕c3 ∓) ♕xd6 23 ♘xd6 ♖xc2 24 ♘xb7 ♖xc3 =.

5b2) **19...0-0** 20 ♖g1! (20 ♘d5 ♗xd5 21 ♖xd5 ♖fb8 22 ♖b5 axb5 23 ♘xg5 h6 24 ♘e4 d5 –+ Epshtein-Andreeva, USSR 1972) and now Black does not appear to have a fully satisfactory continuation:

5b21) **20...♖c8** 21 ♕d3 ♕b6 22 ♕xd6 ♖xb2+ 23 ♔a1 ♗e3 24 ♖xg7+ 1-0 Pioch-Podzielny, corr 1984.

5b22) **20...f6** 21 ♕d3 ♗xe4 22 ♘xe4 ♖fb8 23 b3 ♔h8 24 ♘xg5 (24 ♕xd6?? ♖xb3+ –+) fxg5 25 ♖xg5 e4 26 ♕e3 +– Szilagyi-Guizar, corr 1980.

5b23) **20...♖xb2+** 21 ♔xb2 ♗xe4 22 ♘xe4 ♖b8+ 23 ♕b3! ♖xb3+ 24 cxb3 +–.

5b24) **20...♗d8** 21 ♕g4 g6 22 ♘f6+ +–.

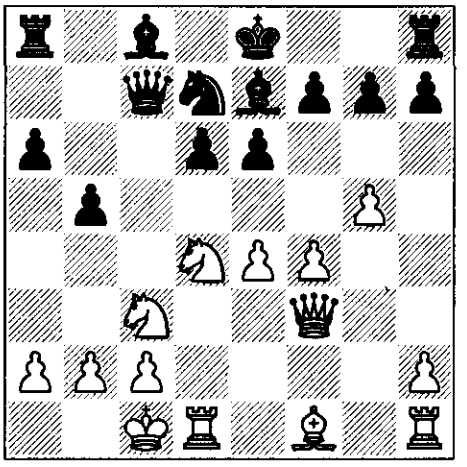
5b25) **20...♖b8** 21 b3 ±.

5b26) **20...♕b6?** 21 ♖xg5! ♗xe4 22 ♘xe4 ♖xb2+ 23 ♔c1 ♖c8 24 ♘c3 ♕b4 25 ♗c4! ♖xc4 26 ♖dg1 ♖xc3 (26...g6 27 fxg6 hxg6 28 ♖xg6+) 27 ♕a8+ 1-0 Szilagyi-Trembacz, corr 1975.

5b27) **20...h6** 21 ♕d3 (21 b3!?) ♕b6 22 ♕xd6 ♖xb2+ 23 ♔a1 ♕xd6 24 ♖xd6 ♖xc2 25 ♗d3 ♖xh2 26 ♘xg5 hxg5 27 ♖xg5 ± Debski-Jakubiec, corr 1988.

12 ... ♘d7 *(D)*

W



In my database, there are examples of no fewer than 11 different moves having been tried at this point. The two main lines are 13 a3 and 13 f5, which we consider under B1 and B2 below. The former has more or less vanished from active tournament play, leaving White's hopes for an advantage resting almost solely on 13 f5. We can comfortably ignore most of the other nine moves, but here is a round-up of the more sensible options:

1) **13 ♗g2** ♗b7 14 ♖he1 0-0-0 (14...b4 15 ♘d5 exd5 16 exd5 ♔f8 17 ♘f5 ♖e8 18 ♕e4 ♘c5 19 ♕d4 ♖g8 20 ♖e3 ♗c8 21 ♗h3 ♗xf5 22 ♗xf5 g6 23 ♗g4 ♗d8 ∓ Gräf-Dittler, Würzburg 1991) 15 ♔b1 ♘c5 16 ♕f2 b4 17 ♘ce2 ♗xe4 18 ♗xe4 ♘xe4 19 ♕f3 d5 20 ♘g3 ♘xg3 21 hxg3 g6 ∓ Karim-Saavedra, Novi Sad OL 1990.

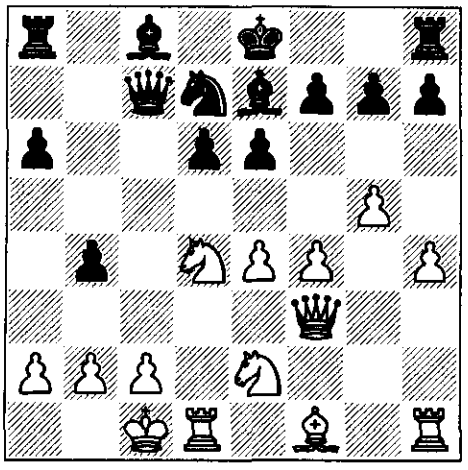
2) **13 ♕h3** (this move, which intends 14 g6, is worth further investigation) ♘c5 (13...b4 14 ♘ce2 ♘c5 15 ♕e3 ♗b7 16 ♗g2 ♖c8 17 ♔b1 0-0 18 ♖d2 ♘a4 19 ♘b3 ♘b6 20 ♘a5 d5 ∓ Rush-Fairclough, Thessaloniki OL 1984) 14 b4 ♘a4 15 ♘xa4 bxa4 16 g6 ♗f6 17 gxf7+ ♕xf7 18 e5 dxe5 19 fxe5! (19 ♗g2 exd4 20 ♗xa8 0-0 21 ♕d3 ♕c7 22 ♗e4 h6 23 ♔b1 a5 24 ♖hg1 axb4 25 ♕g3 b3!? 26 cxb3 axb3 27 axb3 d3 28 ♖xd3 ♗a6 29 ♖d2 ♖b8 ∓ Hort-Gligorić, Wijk aan Zee 1971) ♗g5+ 20 ♔b1 0-0 21 ♗c4 ♖b8 22 a3 ♖e8 23 ♘f5 a5 24 ♖hg1 h6 25 ♘d6 +– Gobitti-Battaglia, corr 1982.

3) **13 ♗d3** b4 (13...♗b7 14 ♖hg1 b4 15 ♘ce2 0-0-0 16 ♔b1 ♔b8 17 c3 bxc3 18 ♖c1 ♕b6 19 ♖xc3 ♘c5 20 ♖gc1 ♖c8 21 ♕e3 h6 22 h4 hxg5 23 hxg5 = Hajdu-Mihalko, Hungary Cht 1994) 14 ♘ce2 (14 ♘d5 exd5 15 exd5 ♘c5 looks unsound) ♗b7 15 ♕h3 0-0-0 16 ♔b1 ♔b8 17 ♕e3 ♕b6 18 h4 ♖c8 19 h5 e5 20 fxe5 dxe5 21 ♕g3 ♖hd8 22 ♘f3 ♗d6 23 ♘d2 ♘c5 with an equal position, Antonio-Momeni, Dubai 1992.

4) **13 ♗h3** b4 (13...♗b7? 14 ♗xe6 fxe6 15 ♘xe6 ♕c4 16 ♘xg7+ ♔d8, Suri-Stoecklin, Ticino 1992, 17 ♘f5 ±) 14 ♘ce2 ♘c5 (14...♗b7 15 ♔b1? {15 ♘g3 will probably transpose to Slobodjan-Alonso below; 15 ♗xe6!? fxe6 16 ♘xe6 ♕c4 17 ♘xg7+ ♔f8 18 ♖d4! ♕xa2 19 ♖xb4 ♘c5 ∓} ♘c5 16 ♘g3 d5! 17 f5!? dxe4 18 ♕g4 exf5 19 ♘dxf5 g6! ∓ Smyslov-Fischer, Belgrade Ct 1959) 15 ♘g3 (15 ♘b3 ♗b7 16 ♘xc5 dxc5 17 ♖hg1 g6 18 ♕e3 c4 19 ♕d4 0-0 20 ♕d7 ♕c5 21 f5 ♖ad8 ∓ Schuh-Holler, Wuert 1993) ♗b7 16 ♕e3 0-0-0 17 ♖hf1 ♔b8 18 f5 h6 19 f6 gxf6 20 gxf6 ♗f8 21 ♕e1 h5 ½-½ Slobodjan-Alonso, Havana 1994.

5) **13 h4** b4 14 ♘ce2 *(D)* and now:

B



5a) **14...♘c5** 15 ♘g3 g6 (15...♗d7 16 f5 g6 {16...♖c8 17 ♖h2 e5 18 ♘b3 a5 19 f6 gxf6 20 gxf6 ♗f8 21 ♘f5 ♘e6 22 ♔b1 a4 23 ♘c1 ♖g8 24

♕d3 was unclear in Dragomirescu-Musat, Romania Cht 1992} 17 f6 ♗d8 18 h5 ♖f8 19 hxg6 hxg6 20 ♖h7 ♕a5 21 ♘gf5!? ♗c7 22 ♘g7+ ♔d8 23 e5? {23 ♔b1 ∞} d5 24 ♕h3 ♗xe5 ∓ Mukhin-Utemov, Moscow Ch 1994) 16 ♖h2 (16 ♗g2 ♗b7 17 ♕f2 0-0-0 18 ♘b3 ♘xb3+ 19 axb3 ♔b8 20 ♖d3 h6 21 gxh6 ♖xh6 22 ♘e2 ♖c8 23 c4 bxc3 24 ♖xc3 ♕a5 ∓ Prié-Sellos, Paris Ch 1988) ♗b7 17 ♕e3 d5 18 e5 0-0-0 19 h5 ♔b8 20 ♔b1 ♖c8 21 ♗d3 ♕b6 22 ♘ge2 a5 23 hxg6 hxg6 24 ♖dh1 ♖xh2 25 ♖xh2 ♘xd3 26 ♕xd3 ♗a6 with equality in Aldama-Vera, Cuban Ch 1993.

5b) **14...♗b7** 15 ♘g3 d5 (15...♖c8 16 ♖h2 ♘c5 17 ♗h3 d5 18 e5 ♕a5 19 ♔b1 ♘a4 20 f5 ♘c3+!? 21 bxc3 bxc3 22 ♔a1 ♖c4 23 fxe6 0-0 24 exf7+ ♔h8 25 ♘de2?! ♕a3 26 ♘xc3 ♖xc3 −+ Ullrich-Soukup, Prague 1991) 16 e5 ♗c5 (16...g6 17 ♗d3 ♘c5 18 h5 0-0-0 19 ♖h2 ♕b6 20 ♘b3 a5 21 ♘xc5 ♗xc5 22 ♔b1 ♔b8 23 hxg6 hxg6 24 ♖xh8 ♖xh8 25 ♖h1 ∓ Komljenović-Bukić, Yugoslav Ch 1972) 17 ♖h2 ♕b6 18 ♕d3 a5 19 ♖hd2 ♗a6 20 ♕f3 0-0 21 ♗xa6 ♖xa6 22 ♕e2 a4 ∓ Weder-Franke, corr 1987.

Now we move on to the two main lines:

B1: 13 a3
B2: 13 f5

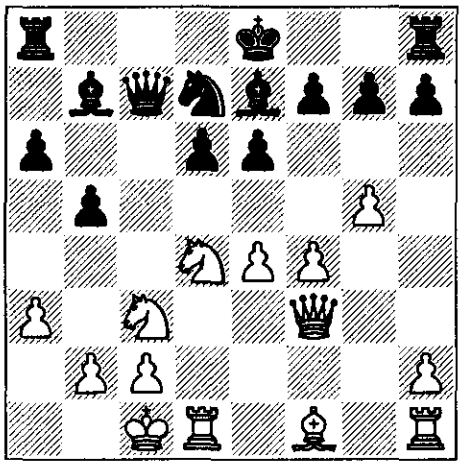
B1)

13 a3

All the evidence suggests that this move causes no problems against accurate defence.

13 ... ♖b8

Aiming for ...b4 is the fastest way to generate counterplay. At one time **13...♗b7** *(D)* (13...♘c5 and 13...♘b6 can be answered by 14 h4 followed by f5) was quite popular, but according to current theory it is too slow. White can try:



1) **14 h4** d5 15 exd5 ♘b6 16 f5 ♘xd5 17 fxe6 0-0-0 18 ♗g2 ♘xc3 19 ♕xb7+ ♕xb7 20 ♗xb7+ ♔xb7 21 bxc3 ♗xa3+ 22 ♔b1 fxe6 23 ♘xe6 = Sherwin-Fischer, USA Ch (New York) 1959/60.

2) **14 ♖g1** g6 (14...♘c5 15 ♗h3 g6 16 ♕e3 ♕b6! 17 f5 e5 18 ♘d5 ♗xd5 19 exd5 exd4 20 ♕xd4 0-0! 21 f6 ♖fe8 is equal) 15 ♗h3 0-0-0? (15...♘c5! transposes to the previous bracket) 16 ♗xe6! fxe6 17 ♘xe6 ♕b6 18 ♘xd8 ♖xd8? (18...♕xd8!? ±; 18...♗xd8 19 ♘xb5 axb5 20 ♕c3+ ♘c5 21 ♕xh8 ♗xe4 ±) 19 ♕h3! b4 20 axb4 d5 21 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 22 exd5 +− Spassky-Eliskases, Mar del Plata 1960.

3) **14 ♔b1** d5 15 exd5 ♘b6 16 ♗g2 ♘xd5 17 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 18 ♕g4 ♗xg2 19 ♕xg2 0-0 20 f5 exf5 ½-½ O'Kelly de Galway-Fischer, Leipzig OL 1960.

4) **14 ♗h3** and now:

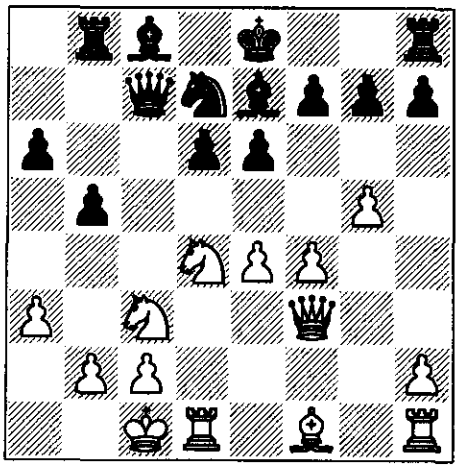
4a) **14...♘f8** 15 f5 e5 (alternatively 15...♗xg5+?! 16 ♔b1 e5? 17 ♘dxb5 axb5 18 ♘xb5 ♕c6 19 ♘xd6+ ♔e7 20 ♕h5 1-0 Erbacher-Aaldijk, corr 1977) 16 f6 exd4 17 fxg7 ♖g8 18 gxf8♕+ ♔xf8 19 ♖xd4 ♗xg5+ 20 ♔b1 ♖g6 21 ♖hd1 ♖f6 22 ♗f5 ± Cappello-Grassia, corr 1962.

4b) **14...♕c4** 15 ♖he1 g6 16 ♔b1 ♘b6 17 ♕g3 b4 18 ♗f1 ♕c5 19 ♘b3 ♕c7 20 axb4 ± Sapunov-Pavlov, Bulgaria 1976.

4c) **14...0-0-0** 15 f5 (15 ♗xe6!? fxe6 16 ♘xe6 ♕b6 {16...♕c4 17 ♘d5 ♗xd5 18 exd5 ♔b7 19 b3 ♕c8 20 ♖d3 ♘b6 21 ♖c3 ± Tal-Gligorić, Moscow 1963} 17 ♘d5 ♗xd5 18 exd5 g6 19 ♖he1 ♔b7 20 ♕c3! ± Mukhin-Petrushin, USSR 1965) ♗xg5+ 16 ♔b1 e5 17 ♘dxb5 axb5 18 ♘xb5 ♕c5 19 ♘xd6+ ♔b8 20 ♘xf7 (20 ♕b3; 20 b4!?) ♕e7 21 ♘xh8 ♖xh8 22 ♖he1 ♗f4 (22...♘c5 ±) 23 ♕b3 ♘c5 24 ♕b5 ♕c7 25 b4 ♘a6 26 ♖d7 wins for White, Gligorić-Fischer, Bled Ct 1959.

4d) **14...♘c5** 15 ♖he1 (15 ♕e3 g6 16 f5 gxf5 17 exf5 0-0-0 18 fxe6 ♔b8 19 ♖hg1 fxe6 20 ♘xe6 ♘xe6 21 ♗xe6 +– F.Olafsson-Gadia, Mar del Plata 1960; 15 ♖hg1?! g6 16 ♕e3 ♕b6 ∞) g6 16 ♕g3 ♕b6 17 f5 e5 18 ♘d5 ♗xd5 19 exd5 exd4 20 f6 ♖a7 21 b4 ♘a4 22 ♕h4 ♘c3 23 ♖xd4 a5 24 ♔d2 ± Perfors-Murray, corr 1967.

We return to the main line after 13...♖b8 *(D)*:



14 h4

Various other moves have been tried:

1) **14 b4** (this move can be played in various situations; it usually slows Black down temporarily, but once Black has regrouped his attack will be even stronger) ♘b6 15 h4 ♗b7 (15...♘a4 16 ♘dxb5 axb5 17 ♗xb5+ ♖xb5 18 ♘xb5 ♕d7 19 ♕d3 ♗b7 20 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 21 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 22 ♖xd6 ♗xe4 23 ♖e1 ± Cledon-Jimenez, corr 1985) 16 f5 e5 17 ♗xb5+ axb5 18 ♘dxb5 ♕c6 19 f6 gxf6 20 ♖hf1 ♖d8 21 ♖f2 ♗a6 ∓ Spatz-Riedel, wom Bundesliga 1992.

2) **14 ♖g1** (this move also occurs in many lines; it is a way of supporting g5 in order to continue f5) b4 15 axb4 ♖xb4 16 ♗h3 (16 b3 ♗b7 17 ♗c4, Ma-Hills, corr 1989, 17...♖xc4 18 bxc4 0-0 ∓) ♕c5 17 ♘ce2 ♘b6 18 ♘b3 ♕c4 19 ♘c3 ♕c7 20 f5 ♘c4 21 ♖d4 a5 22 f6 gxf6 23 gxf6 ♗f8 ∞ Shkurowitsch-Kammel, corr 1988.

3) **14 ♕h3** (just as at move 13, this is certainly worth considering) and now:

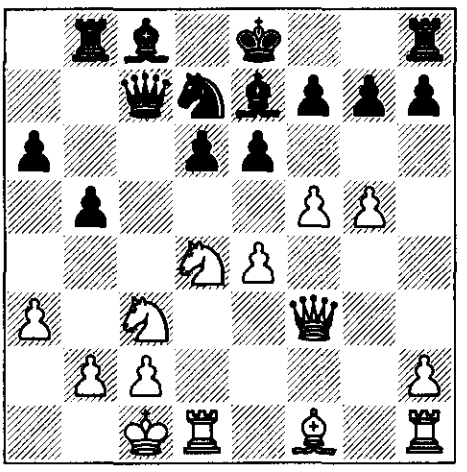
3a) **14...0-0** 15 ♖g1 ♘c5 (alternatively 15...♘b6 16 f5 e5 17 ♘f3 f6 18 ♗d3 {18 ♖g4!?} ♕c5 19 gxf6 ♗xf6 20 ♘g5 h6 21 ♘e6 ♗xe6 22 fxe6 ♕f2 23 ♕xh6 ♕f4+ 24 ♕xf4 exf4 25 ♘d5 ± Zolnierowicz-Gallagher, Baku 1988) 16 ♖g4 (crude, but in this game very effective) b4 17 ♖h4 h6 18 axb4 ♖xb4 19 ♘f5 exf5 20 ♘d5 ♕b7 21 ♗xa6! (a beautiful

move) ♘xa6 22 ♖xh6 f6 (22...gxh6 23 ♘f6+ ♗xf6 24 gxf6 +–) 23 ♖h8+ 1-0 Tomasević-Osterman, corr 1981.

3b) **14...♘c5** 15 b4 (this is more awkward than normal as 15...♘d7 runs into 16 g6) ♘a4 (15...♘b7 16 ♖g1 ♗d7 17 f5 d5 18 g6 ♗f6 19 gxf7+ ♔f8 20 fxe6 ♕f4+ 21 ♔b1 ♗xd4 22 e7+ 1-0 Zivković-Todorović, corr 1978) 16 ♘xa4 bxa4 17 g6 e5 (17...fxg6 18 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 19 ♕xe6 a5 ∞) 18 ♕xh7!? (wins a pawn but takes the white queen out of play) ♖f8 19 ♘e2 a5 20 b5 ♕c5 ∞ Horton-Stewart, corr 1977.

4) **14 f5** *(D)* (a very unconvincing move) and now:

B



4a) **14...♗xg5+** 15 ♔b1 ♘e5 16 ♕h5 with another branch:

4a1) **16...♕d8** 17 ♘xe6 (17 fxe6 0-0 {17...g6 18 exf7+ ♔xf7 19 ♕e2 ♖f8 ∞} 18 ♗h3 g6 19 ♕e2 b4 20 axb4 ♖xb4 21 ♘d5 ♖xd4 22 ♖xd4 fxe6 23 ♘c3 ♕b6 24 ♖hd1 ♗e7 25 ♘a4 ♕a7 ∞ Van der Wiel-Andersson, Moscow IZ 1982) ♗xe6 18 fxe6 0-0 19 ♖g1 h6 20 ♗h3 b4 21 axb4 ♖xb4 22 exf7+ ♘xf7 23 ♗e6 ♕f6 24 ♗b3 ♖b7 25 ♖gf1 g6 26 ♕xh6 ♗xh6 27 ♖xf6 ± Kallinger-Peli, corr 1991.

4a2) **16...♕e7** 17 ♖g1 ♗f6 18 fxe6 g6 19 exf7+ ♕xf7 20 ♕h6 ♗g7 21 ♕h4 0-0 22 ♗e2 (22 ♘d5 ♖b7 23 ♗h3 ♗xh3 24 ♕xh3 ♘c4 25 ♔a2 ♗xd4 26 ♖xd4 ♕f2 –+ Rakitin-Gutkin, USSR 1971) b4?! 23 axb4 ♖xb4 24 ♘d5 ♖a4 25 ♖gf1 ♕a7 26 ♘e7+ ♔h8 27 ♖xf8+ 1-0 Guerrini-Donarelli, corr 1984.

4b) **14...♘c5** 15 b4 (15 ♕g4 b4 16 axb4 ♖xb4 17 g6 ♗f6?! {better is 17...fxg6} 18 gxf7+ ♕xf7 19 fxe6 ♘xe6 20 ♘f5 ♗e5 21 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 22 ♖xd6 0-0 23 ♗xa6 ♗xa6 24 ♕xe6 +– Rozmbersky-Hitzgerova, Plzen 1995) ♘a4 16 ♘xa4 bxa4 17 g6 (17 f6!?) hxg6 18 fxe6 0-0 19 exf7+ ♖xf7 20 ♕g3 ♗f6 21 ♖g1 a5 22 b5 ♕c5 23 ♘c6 ♗g4! ∓ Vasiukov-Ulianov, Sochi 1966.

4c) **14...♘e5** 15 ♕g3 b4 16 axb4 ♖xb4 17 ♗h3 (17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♗h3 ♘c4 19 ♘b3? {19 ♗xe6 ∞} a5 20 ♖he1 a4 –+ Wiker-Ferens, corr 1989) ♕b6 18 fxe6 ♖xd4 19 exf7+ ♘xf7 20 ♗xc8 ♗xg5+ 21 ♔b1 0-0 22 ♗e6 ♗f6 23 ♖df1 ♔h8 24 ♖hg1 = Jenkins-McLelland, corr 1982.

5) **14 ♗h3** ♘c5 (14...b4? 15 axb4 ♖xb4 16 ♗xe6! ♘e5 17 ♘d5 ♘xf3 18 ♘xc7+ ♔d8 19 ♗xc8 ♖xd4 20 ♘d5! ♗xg5 {20...♖xd5 21 ♖xd5 ♔xc8 22 h4 +–} 21 ♖xd4 ♘xd4 22 ♗xa6 +–; 14...0-0? 15 g6! hxg6 16 ♘xe6 fxe6 17 ♗xe6+ ♖f7 18 ♘d5 ♕d8 19 ♖hg1 ♘f6 20 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 21 ♕g3 +–; 14...♕c4?! 15 ♘b3! ♗b7 16 ♖hg1 g6 17 ♕e3 h6?! 18 gxh6 ♘f6, Sevecek-Gudim, corr 1967, 19 ♘a5 ♕c7 20 ♘xb7 ♕xb7 21 e5 ±) and now:

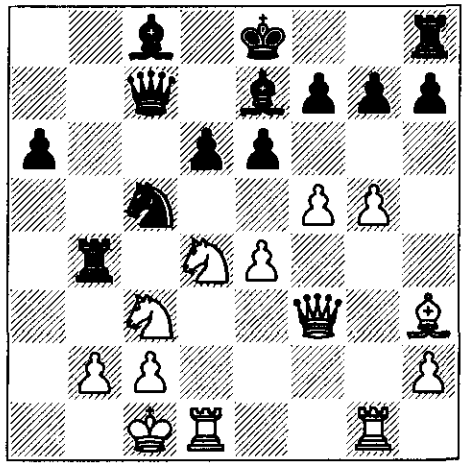
5a) Not **15 f5** due to 15...♗xg5+ 16 ♔b1 ♗f6 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♖hf1 b4 –+ Semer-Portilho, corr 1978 or

15...b4 16 axb4 ♖xb4 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 g6 ♗g5+ 19 ♔b1 ♗f6 –+ Felden-Röllig, German jr Ch 1993.

5b) **15 b4** ♘a4 16 ♖d3 (16 ♘xa4 bxa4 17 ♖d3 ♗d7 18 ♖c3 ♕b6 19 ♖d1 a5 20 b5 0-0 21 ♗f1 ♖fc8 ∓ Muhana-Belmonte, corr 1980) ♗d7 (16...♗b7 17 ♖g1 ♕c4 18 ♘xa4 bxa4 19 f5 e5 20 f6 exd4 21 fxe7 ♗c8 22 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 23 ♕d1 ♔xe7 24 ♖xd4 ♕a2 ∓ Niewiadomski-Markolić, corr 1982 is also promising) 17 ♖g1 (17 ♖hd1 a5 18 ♘xa4 bxa4 19 ♖c3 ♕b7 20 b5 0-0 21 ♗f1 ♖fc8 22 ♖xc8+ ♖xc8 23 ♕d3 ♖c5 ∓ Palmiotto-Gatto, corr 1977) a5 18 f5 ♘xc3 19 ♖xc3 ♕a7 20 fxe6 fxe6 21 ♕e3 h6?! (21...axb4 ∞) 22 gxh6 gxh6 23 ♘f3 ♕a8?!, De Sortis-Palmiotto, corr 1968, 24 ♖c7! ±.

5c) **15 ♘f5?!** exf5 16 ♘d5 ♕d8 17 exf5 ♗b7 18 f6 gxf6 19 ♖he1 ♗xd5 20 ♖xd5 fxg5 21 fxg5 ♖g8! with a distinct advantage for Black.

5d) **15 ♖hg1** b4 16 axb4 ♖xb4 17 f5 *(D)* and now:



5d1) **17...♕a5** 18 ♘c6 ♕a1+ 19 ♔d2 ♕xb2 20 ♖b1 ♘b3+ 21 ♔e1 ♕xc2? 22 ♘xb4 +– Geisel-Schmidt, corr 1987. However, Black had an amazing defence in 21...♖xe4+ 22 ♔d1 ♘d4!! 23 ♕xe4 (23 ♕d3 ♘xc6!) ♘b5 with totally unclear play.

5d2) **17...♕b6** 18 fxe6 (18 f6 gxf6 19 gxf6 ♗f8 20 ♘b3 ♖xb3 21 cxb3 ♘xb3+ 22 ♔c2 ♕xg1! –+) fxe6 19 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 (19...♘xe6 20 ♘d5 ♕c5 21 ♘xb4 ♕xb4 22 e5 ♗b7 23 ♕f5 ♕f4+ and now 24 ♕xf4 ♘xf4 25 exd6 ♘e2+ 26 ♔b1 ♘xg1 27 dxe7 ♘xh3 28 ♖d8+ is a draw, but 24 ♔b1! ♕xf5 25 ♗xf5 ♘xg5 26 exd6 ♗f6 27 ♖d3 is ±) 20 ♗xe6 ♘xe6 21 ♘d5 ♕a5 22 ♘xb4 ♕xb4 (22...♕a1+ 23 ♔d2 ♕xb2 24 ♕b3 ♗xg5+ 25 ♔e1 ♗h4+ 26 ♔d2 is probably also a draw) 23 e5 ♕f4+ 24 ♕xf4 ♘xf4 25 exd6 ♗xd6 26 ♖ge1+ ♔d7 with equality, Dura-Slavko, corr 1987.

5d3) **17...♕b7** (safest) 18 f6 (18 fxe6 fxe6 19 b3 ♖f8 {19...a5 20 ♗f1 g6 21 ♘db5 ♔d7?! 22 ♕f7 ♔c6 23 ♘xd6 ♗xd6 24 ♖xd6+! ♔xd6 25 e5+ ♔c6 26 ♗g2+ ♘e4 27 ♗xe4+ ♖xe4 28 ♕xb7+ ♗xb7 29 ♘xe4 +– Fijlstra-Van Aurich, corr 1975} 20 ♕e3 a5 21 ♗f1 ♗d7 22 ♗d3 ♕b6 23 e5 ♖xd4 24 ♕xd4 dxe5 25 ♕g4 ♖f4 is unclear, Shurovich Khasin-Tulfer, corr 1993) gxf6 (18...♗f8 19 b3 a5 {19...gxf6 20 ♘d5 exd5 21 exd5 ♗xh3 22 ♖ge1+ ♗e6 23 ♕xf6 ♖g8 24 dxe6 fxe6 25 ♘xe6 ∞ Van Vugt-De Ridder, corr 1973} 20 ♖ge1 a4 21 ♘d5 ♖xd4 22 ♖xd4 axb3 23 ♖b4 ♕a7 24 cxb3 ± Backhaus-Fauth, corr 1979) 19 gxf6 ♗f8 (19...♗d8!? 20 ♖g7 ♖f8 21 b3 a5 22 ♔b2? a4 23 ♘a2 ♖b6 ∓ Timperi-Thornros, corr) 20 b3 (20 ♕h5 ♖xb2 21 ♖g7 ♖b4 ∓) a5 (20...♗h6+? 21 ♔b2 ♗d7 22 ♕h5 {22 ♘d5 exd5 23 exd5 ♗xh3 24 ♖ge1+ ♗e6 25 ♕h5 ♗f4 26 dxe6 +– Reppe-Heath, corr 1974} ♗e3 23

♕xh7! ♖f8 24 ♖g8 +– Buljovčić-Bertok, Yugoslavia 1965; 20...♕b6 21 ♘d5 exd5 22 ♗xc8 ♖xd4 23 ♖xd4 ♘xb3+ 24 ♕xb3 ♕xd4 25 ♗d7+ ♔xd7 ½-½ Schreiber-Maeder, corr 1973) and now:

5d31) **21 ♖ge1** a4 22 ♘d5 ♖xd4 23 ♖xd4 axb3 24 ♖b4 ♕a7 25 cxb3 ♕a1+ 26 ♔d2 ♕b2+ –+ Stelmann-Brendsson, corr 1972.

5d32) **21 ♕e3** h5 22 ♖g7 (22 ♘f5? exf5 23 exf5+ ♖e4 24 ♘xe4 ♕xe4 25 ♕c3 ♕b4 26 ♕xb4 axb4 27 ♖d4 ♘d7 28 ♖xb4 ♘xf6 ∓ Mori-Flacker, corr 1987) ♕b6? (22...♗xg7 23 fxg7 ♖g8 24 ♕h6 f6 ∞) 23 ♘d5 exd5 24 exd5+ ♔d8 25 ♘c6+ ♔c7 26 ♖xf7+ 1-0 Rosinov-Falke, corr 1979.

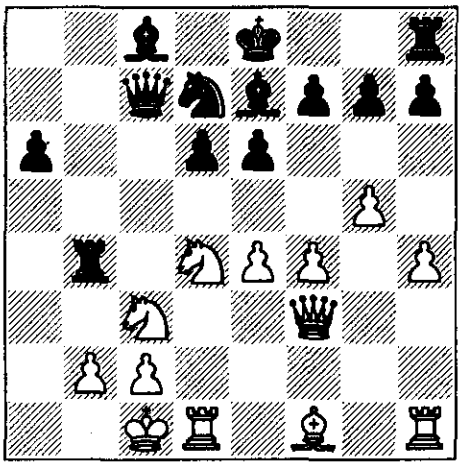
5d33) **21 ♘d5** exd5 (21...a4 22 ♕c3 ♖xd4 23 ♖xd4 exd5 24 ♗xc8 ♕xc8 25 ♖xa4 d4 26 ♖xd4 ♗h6+ 27 ♔b1 ♗f4 28 ♖d5 ± Breum-Maeder, corr 1967) 22 ♗xc8 (22 exd5 ♖xd4 23 ♖xd4 ♘d7 24 ♕c3 ♘b6 25 ♖e1+ ♔d8 26 ♗xc8 ♗h6+ 27 ♔b1 ♕xc8 28 ♕xa5 ± Fechner-August, corr 1975) ♕xc8 23 exd5 ♕b7? (23...♖xd4 24 ♖xd4 ♘d7 ∞) 24 ♖de1+ ♔d7 25 ♖g7 ♔c8 26 ♖e8+ ♔d7 27 ♖b8! ♕xb8 28 ♖xf7+ ♔e8 29 ♕h5 1-0 Frey-Maeder, corr 1968.

14 ... b4

14...♘c5 has been played a couple of times, but 15 f5 is a strong reply.

15 axb4 ♖xb4 *(D)*

16 ♗h3



Or:

1) **16 f5** ♘e5 (16...♘c5 17 ♗h3 transposes into the main line) 17 ♕e2 (17 ♕f2 ♕b6 18 b3 ♘c6 19 ♗c4 e5 20 ♘d5 ♕a7 21 ♘xb4 ♘xb4 22 f6 gxf6 23 gxf6 ♗f8 24 ♕d2, Peiron Luch-Fernandez, corr 1987, 24...♕xd4! 25 ♕xb4 ♕a1+ =) ♕b6 18 ♘b3 h6 19 gxh6 ♖xh6 20 ♕g2 ♗f6 ∓ Domenden-Woldmo, corr 1990.

2) **16 h5** and now:

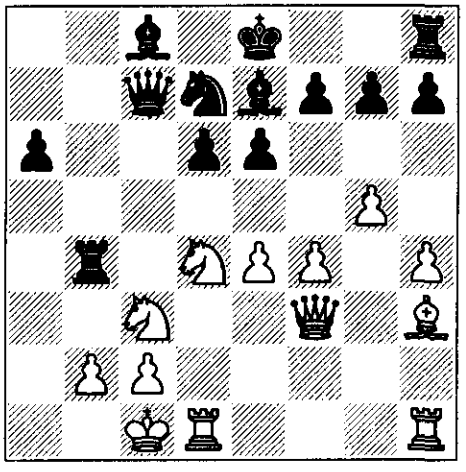
2a) **16...♘c5** 17 g6 (this type of attack is much less effective when White lacks his dark-squared bishop; the problem is that the bishop on e7 can move to f6, and White has no way to counter the power of this piece) 0-0 (or 17...♗f6 18 gxf7+ ♔xf7 19 ♕e3 ♗d7 ∓) 18 h6 fxg6 19 hxg7 ♖f7 20 ♖d2 (20 ♗h3 ♗f6 21 e5 ♗xe5 22 ♘ce2 ♗xg7 –+; 20 ♕h3 ♖xg7 21 ♗e2 e5 22 ♘f5 ♖xe4 23 ♘h6+ ♔h8 –+ Godino-Ramos, corr 1991) ♖xg7 21 ♔b1 ♗f6 22 e5 ♗b7 23 ♕h3 dxe5 (23...♖xd4 24 ♖xd4 dxe5 25 ♖c4 exf4 26 ♗g2 ♗xg2 27 ♕xg2 ♖f7 ∓ Gligorić-Tringov, Amsterdam IZ 1964) 24 ♘xe6 ♘xe6 25 ♕xe6+ ♕f7 26 ♕d6 ♗e7 27 ♕b8+ ♕f8 28 ♕xf8+ ♔xf8 29 ♘d5 exf4 wins for Black, Herrmann-Maeder, corr 1969.

2b) **16...♕b6** 17 ♘b3 ♘c5 (or 17...♗b7 18 g6 0-0 19 h6 fxg6 20 hxg7 ♖f6 21 ♕h3 h5 22 ♗d3 ♘c5 23 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 24 ♖hg1 ♗c8? {24...♔xg7 ∞} 25 e5 ♖fxf4 26 ♕xh5! 1-0 Lobigas-Micheli, Skopje OL 1972) 18 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 19 ♗d3 (19

♗e2 ♗b7 20 ♕d3 0-0 21 ♖h3 e5 22 g6 fxg6 23 hxg6 h6 24 f5 ♖c8 25 ♘d5 ♗g5+ 26 ♔b1 ♖d4 ∓ Heinrich-Mittag, corr 1978) ♗b7 20 ♖hg1 ♗d8 21 ♕e2 ♗b6 22 ♖g3 ♕f2 23 ♖f3 ♕xe2 24 ♘xe2, Anstock-Tischer, corr 1982, 24...♔e7 ∓.

After 16 ♗h3 Black has a wide choice. Of the four moves given below, the last appears safest and assures Black of at least equality.

Returning to the main line after 16 ♗h3 *(D)*:



B11: 16...♘c5
B12: 16...♕b6
B13: 16...0-0
B14: 16...♕c5

Not 16...♘b6?! 17 f5 ♘c4 18 fxe6 0-0 19 b3 fxe6 20 ♕g3 ♕a5 21 bxc4 ♖xc4 22 ♘b1! ± Barczay-Tatai, Bari 1970.

B11)

16 ... ♘c5

Black's practical results with this move have been rather poor.

17 f5 ♕b7

Or **17...♕b6** (17...0-0 18 f6 ♗d8 19 fxg7 ♔xg7 may not be as bad as it looks, for example 20 ♕h5 ♕a5 with counterplay; 17...♕a5? 18 ♘c6 wins material as 18...♕a1+ 19 ♔d2 ♕xb2 loses to 20 ♖b1!) **18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♘xe6** and now:

1) **19...♗xe6** 20 ♗xe6 ♘xe6 21 ♘d5 ♕a5 22 ♘xb4 ♕xb4 (22...♕a1+ 23 ♔d2 ♕xb2 is met by the simple 24 ♕c3) 23 e5 ♕f4+ 24 ♕xf4 ♘xf4 25 exd6 ♗d8 26 d7+ ♔e7 27 ♖he1+ ♘e6 28 ♖e4 +– Hermanski-Pytel, Poland 1976.

2) **19...♘xe6** 20 ♘d5 ♕c5 (not 20...♕a5? 21 ♕c3! +–, but 20...♕b7 21 ♕c3 ♖a4!? is possible) 21 ♘xb4 ♕xb4 22 e5 ♗b7 23 ♕e3! ♗xh1 (if 23...♕f4 or 23...♕c5 then 24 ♖he1; 23...♕xh4 24 ♔b1! ♗xh1 {24...♕xg5 25 ♕a7 ±} 25 ♗xe6 ♕xg5 26 ♕a7 ±) 24 ♗xe6 ♖f8 (24...♕xh4 25 ♕a7 ♗c6 26 ♕b8+ ♗d8 27 ♕xd6 1-0 Mauro-Berluti, corr 1992) 25 ♔b1 ♕e4 was unclear in Tosi-La Rosa, corr 1986.

18 ♖hf1

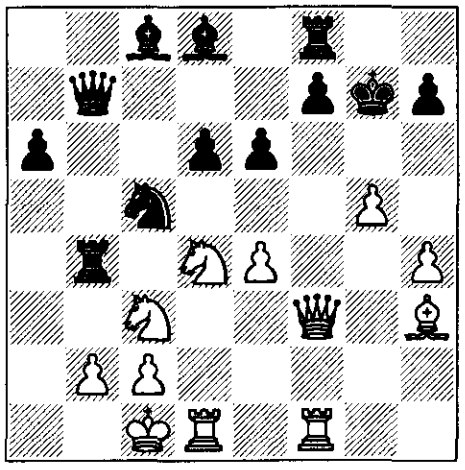
The alternative is 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♖hf1 (19 b3 ♖f8 20 ♕e3 g6 21 ♗g4 ♕b6 22 e5 dxe5 23 ♕xe5 ♗d6 24 ♕g7 ♕a5 25 ♔b1 ∞ Matulović-Bogdanović, Sarajevo 1966) ♖f8 20 ♕e3 g6 (20...♖xf1 21 ♖xf1 ♕b6 22 ♕f2 ♖xd4? {22...♔d8! ∞} 23 ♘d5! ♖xd5 24 exd5 ♘a4 25 ♕xb6 ♘xb6 26 dxe6 ± Adorjan-Tatai, Amsterdam 1970) 21 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 22 e5 d5 23 ♖f1? ♖xb2 ∓ Gibellato-Negro, corr 1974.

18 ... 0-0

18...♖f8 19 ♕h5 e5 20 ♘e6 ♗xe6 21 fxe6 ♖xb2 22 ♖xf7 ♖xc2+ 23 ♔xc2 ♕b3+ 24 ♔d2 ♕b2+ 25 ♔e1 ♕xc3+ 26 ♔e2 ♕c2+ 27 ♔f1 ♖xf7+ ∓ Levchenkov-Zhuravliov, USSR 1971.

19 f6 ♗d8

20 fxg7 ♔xg7 *(D)*



21 ♕h5

This has been the most popular move, which is surprising as two alternatives have both been rewarded with success:

1) **21 b3** ♔g8 22 ♕h5 ♕b6 23 ♘d5 exd5 24 ♗xc8 ♖xd4 25 ♗f5 ♘xb3+ 26 cxb3 ♖xd1+ 27 ♖xd1 ♕c7+ 28 ♔b1 f6 29 g6 is winning for White, Estrin-Liangov, Bulgaria 1970.

2) **21 ♘d5** ♖xb2 (or 21...♖a4 22 ♔b1 exd5 23 ♗xc8 ♕xc8 24 ♘f5+ ♔g8 25 ♘h6+ ♔g7 26 ♕c3+ d4 27 ♖xd4 ♖xd4 28 ♕xd4+ ±) 22 ♘f5+ exf5 23 ♕c3+ ♔g8 24 ♕xb2 fxe4 25 ♗xc8 ♕xc8 26 ♕c3 ♕g4 27 ♖f4 ♕e2 28 ♖e1 ♕b5 29 ♖f5 ♕d7 30 ♖ef1 ♕e6 31 ♘e3 1-0 Habermann-Maeder, corr 1970. At first sight an early resignation, but the threat of ♘g4-h6 cannot be met.

21 ... ♖xb2!

This is the best move, for example 21...♘xe4 (21...♔g8 22 ♕h6 ♖c4 23 ♗f5 exf5 24 exf5 f6 25 gxf6 ♖xf6 26 ♖g1+ ♔h8 27 ♖de1! ♗e6 28 ♕e3 ♖xd4 29 ♕xd4 ♗f7 30 ♘d5 ♕c6 31 ♔b1 ♕a4 32 ♘xf6 ♗a2+ 33 ♔c1 1-0 Tabban-Bouaziz, Tunis 1971) 22 ♗xe6 ♖xd4 23 ♕h6+ ♔g8 24 g6 ♖xd1+ 25 ♘xd1 hxg6 26 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 27 ♗xf7 +– Gutman-Lapienis, USSR 1969.

22 ♖g1

Alternatively:

1) **22 ♕h6+** ♔g8 23 ♗f5 exf5 24 exf5 ♘a4! (not 24...f6 25 gxf6 ♖xf6 26 ♖g1+ ♔h8 27 ♖de1 ♘e6 28 ♕h5 ♘f8 29 ♕g5 1-0 Fabbri-Baldocchi, corr 1970) 25 ♘xa4 ♖b1+ 26 ♔d2 ♕g2+ 27 ♔d3 ♕g3+ 28 ♔c4 d5+ 29 ♔xd5 ♗b7+ 30 ♔c4 ♖b4+ 31 ♔xb4 ♗e7+ 32 ♘c5 ♗xc5+ 33 ♔xc5 ♖c8+ 34 ♘c6 ♕c3+ 35 ♔b6 ♖xc6+ 0-1 Oechslein-Schmaus, corr 1968.

2) **22 ♖f4** ♕b4 23 ♖f3 (23 ♕h6+ ♔g8 24 g6 hxg6 25 ♖g1 ♘d3+ 0-1 Miličević-Barlov, Vrnjacka Banja 1979) ♘a4! 24 ♖df1 ♔g8 25 ♘de2 ♕a3 26 ♔d1 ♗a5 27 g6 ♘xc3+ 28 ♘xc3 ♕a1+ 29 ♔d2 ♗xc3+ 30 ♖xc3 hxg6 31 ♖g3 ♖b1 ½-½ Rusz-Maeder, corr 1973.

3) **22 ♖f6** ♘a4 23 ♘xa4 ♖b1+ 24 ♔d2 ♖xd1+ 25 ♔xd1 ♕xe4 26 ♗f1 e5 27 ♕h6+ ♔g8 28 ♗d3 ♕g4+ 29 ♘e2 e4 30 ♗c4 was unclear in Hannebauer-Strauss, corr 1990.

22	**...**	**♗a5!**
23	**♕h6**	**♔g8**
24	**g6**	**fxg6**
25	**♖df1**	**♘d3+!**
26	**cxd3**	**♖ff2!**
27	**♖xf2**	**♖xf2**
28	**♘ce2**	**♖xe2**

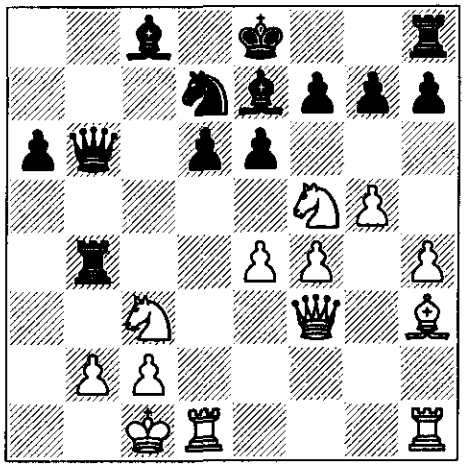
The position is extremely complicated. The one practical example led to a drawn ending after 29 ♖xg6+ hxg6 30 ♕xg6+ ♔f8 31 ♕f6+ ♕f7 32 ♕h8+ ♔e7 33 ♘xe2 ♗d7 34 e5! ♗c7 35 exd6+ ♗xd6 36 ♕h6 ♕f6 37 ♕xf6+ ½-½, Dunhaupt-Maeder, corr 1978.

B12)

16 ... ♕b6

17 ♘f5 *(D)*

Or 17 ♘b3 (17 ♘xe6 fxe6 18 ♗xe6 ♖xb2 19 e5 dxe5 20 ♕d5 ♗a3 21 ♗xd7+ ♔f8 22 ♕f3, Petryk-Dobosz, Poland 1970, 22...e4! −+) a5 18 ♘a2 ♖c4 19 ♗f1 ♖c7 20 ♘c3 ♘c5 (20...♗a6 21 ♗xa6 ♕xa6 22 ♕f1 ♕b6 23 ♖h3 ♖b7 24 f5 ♘c5 25 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 26 f6 gxf6 27 gxf6 ♗f8 28 ♘a4 = Jirku-Burić, corr 1986) 21 ♗b5+ ♗d7 22 ♗xd7+ ♖xd7 23 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 24 f5 0-0 25 f6 ♗d8 26 ♕g4 ♕b4 27 ♖h3 ♖b7 = Delaporte-Malezieux, corr 1988.



B

17 ... ♗f8

It is hard to credit that retreating the bishop to its original square can be the best move, but it avoids opening lines for White's attack and at the same time renews the threat to the b2-pawn. The alternatives are:

1) **17...exf5** (maybe the most obvious move, but it appears to give White a dangerous attack) 18 ♘d5 ♕c5 (18...♕a5 19 ♕c3 ♕a1+ 20 ♔d2 ♕xb2 21 ♘xb4 ♕xc3+ 22 ♔xc3 ± Schäfer-Braune, corr 1982; 18...♕b7 19 ♕c3! ♖xe4 20 ♗xf5 ±) 19 exf5 ♗b7 20 ♖he1 (20 f6 gxf6 21 ♗xd7+ ♔xd7 22 gxf6 ♗f8 {22...♖a4 23 c3 ♗xd5 24 ♖xd5 ♕c4 25 fxe7 ♖a1+ 26 ♔c2 ♖xh1 27 ♕xh1 ♕xf4 28 ♖d4 ± Abraham-Heinrich, corr 1981} 23 c3 ♔d8 24 ♖he1 ♖b5 25 ♕g4 ♗xd5 26 ♖xd5 ♕xd5 27 ♖e8+ ♔c7 0-1 Kroener-Rosenhahn, corr 1974) ♗xd5 21 ♖xd5 ♕c7 (21...♕c6 22 f6 gxf6 23 gxf6 ♘xf6 24 ♖c5 1-0 Pytel-Hausner, corr 1970) 22 ♖d3 ♘c5! (22...♔d8 23 ♖de3 ♖e8 24 f6 gxf6 25 gxf6 ♘xf6 26 ♖c3 ♕b8 27 ♕c6 1-0 Hessmer-Rosenhahn, corr 1974) 23 ♖de3 0-0 24 ♖xe7 ♕a5 25 ♖e8? (25 ♕a3 ∞) ♕a1+ 26 ♔d2, Vl.Georgiev-Isonzo, Halle jr Wch 1995, 26...♖d4+ 27 ♔c3 ♕a5+ 28 ♔xd4 ♕b4+ 29 ♔d5 ♕b7+ −+.

2) **17...♖xb2** 18 ♘xg7+ ♔f8 (not 18...♔d8? 19 ♗xe6) 19 ♘xe6+ fxe6 20 ♗xe6 ♔e8 (20...d5 21 ♖xd5 ♗a3 22 ♗xd7, Matteg-Hutschenreiter, corr 1982, 22...♖b4+! 23 ♔d2 ♖d4+ 24 ♖xd4 ♕xd4+ 25 ♕d3 ♕xd7 =) and now:

2a) **21 ♗xd7+** ♗xd7 22 e5 ♗f5 23 ♖h2, Jaudran-Meifert, corr 1972, 23...dxe5 24 fxe5 ♖f8! ∓.

2b) **21 ♗a2!?** ♘c5 22 ♘d5 ♕b7 23 ♕c3! ♖xa2 24 ♕xh8+ ♔d7 25 ♕g7 ♔d8 26 ♕g8+ ♔d7 27 ♘f6+ ♗xf6 28 ♕xa2 wins for White, Sowinski-Brackzo, corr.

2c) **21 e5** dxe5 22 ♕h3 ♘f8 23 ♗xc8 ♗a3 24 ♖d5! (24 ♖he1? ♖b4+ 25 ♔d2 ♕f2+ 26 ♘e2 ♖d4+ 27 ♔c3 ♖xd1 28 ♖xd1 ♕xe2 ∓ Kholmov-Savon, USSR Ch 1970) ♖b5+ 25 ♔d1 (25 ♔d2 ♕f2+ 26 ♔d1 ♖xd5+ 27 ♘xd5 ♕d4+ 28 ♕d3 transposes) ♖xd5+ 26 ♘xd5 ♕d4+ 27 ♕d3 ♕a1+ 28 ♔d2 (28 ♔e2 ♕xh1 29 ♘f6+ ♔e7 30 ♕xa3+ ♔d8 31 ♗xa6 ♕g2+ 32 ♔d1 ♕g1+ 33 ♔d2 ♕f2+ 34 ♔c1

♕g1+ 35 ♔b2 ♕d4+ 36 ♔a2 ♘d7 37 ♘xd7 ♔xd7 38 ♗b5+ ♔c7 39 ♕a5+ ♔b8 40 fxe5 ♖c8 41 ♗a4! ♖c7 42 ♕b5+ ♖b7 43 ♕e8+ ♔a7 44 ♗b3 ♖b6 45 ♕e7+ ♔b8 46 ♕e8+ ♔a7 47 ♕e7+ ½-½ Arbinger-Müller, corr 1973) ♕xh1 29 ♘f6+ ♔e7 (or 29...♔f7 30 ♕c4+ +–) 30 ♕xa3+ ♔d8 31 ♕d6+!♔xc8 32 ♘d5 ♕g2+ 33 ♔c3 ♕h3+ 34 ♔b2 ♘e6 35 f5 ♔b7 36 fxe6 and wins, Espi-Ibran, corr 1990.

18 ♘e3

Other moves:

1) **18 ♖he1** ♖xb2 19 ♕d3!? (19 ♕e3 ♕b4 20 ♖d4 ♕b6 21 ♖ed1 d5 22 exd5 ♗a3 23 dxe6 ♖xc2+ 24 ♔xc2 ♕b2+ 25 ♔d3 ♘c5+ 26 ♔c4 ♕b3# Bloks-G.Welling, Netherlands 1976; 19 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 20 ♖xd6 ♖xc2+ 21 ♔xc2 ♕xd6 22 e5 ♕c5 23 ♖a1 0-0 ∓ Battiato-Palmiotto, corr 1984) d5!? 20 exd5 ♗a3 21 ♕e3 ♖xc2+! 22 ♔xc2 ♕b2+ 23 ♔d3 ♘c5+ 24 ♕xc5 ♗xc5 ∓ Mann-Bodor, corr 1989.

2) **18 b3** d5 19 ♖he1 (19 ♘g3 ♘c5 20 ♘xd5 exd5 21 ♗xc8 ♘xb3+ 22 cxb3 ♖xb3 0-1 Kalveris-Chizelle, corr 1979) d4 20 h5 exf5 21 ♘d5 ♕a5 22 exf5+ ♔d8 ∓ Jansen-Zagorovsky, corr 1968.

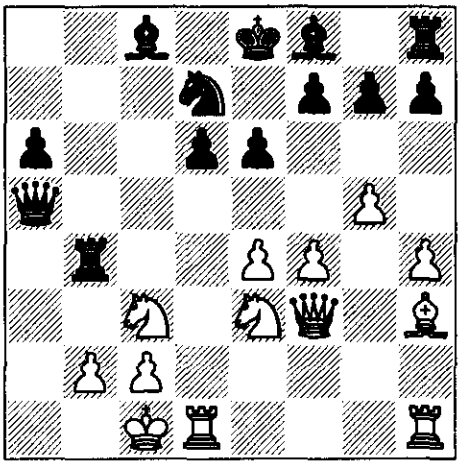
18 ... ♕a5 *(D)*

19 ♕e2

Or:

1) **19 ♔b1** ♗b7 20 f5 (20 ♖de1 ♘c5 21 ♘ed1 g6 22 ♖h2 ♗g7 23 ♖he2 0-0 ∓) ♘e5 21 ♕f2 ♕c5 22 ♘a2 ♖xe4 23 ♖he1 ♗e7 24 ♕g3 ♗c8 25 ♘c1 exf5 26 ♘xf5 ♗xf5 27 ♗xf5 ♖xe1 28 ♖xe1 g6 29 ♘d3 ♕c7 ½-½ Damele-Stassi, corr 1981.

2) **19 ♔d2** ♘c5 20 ♖a1 ♕d8 (another piece returns to its original



square, but the weakness of e4 suddenly becomes the dominant feature of the position) 21 b3 ♗b7 22 ♘c4 ♘xe4+! 23 ♘xe4 d5 24 ♘f6+ gxf6 25 ♘a5 ♗a8 26 ♖he1 ♖d4+ 27 ♔c3 (27 ♔c1 ♗b4 28 ♕f2 ♗c3 29 ♖a2 0-0 –+) ♗b4+! 28 ♔xd4 ♕b6+ 29 ♔d3 ♕b5+ 0-1 Necesany-Zagorovsky, corr 1972.

3) **19 b3** ♖xb3 20 cxb3 ♕xc3+ 21 ♔b1 ♕xb3+ 22 ♔a1 g6 wins for Black.

4) **19 ♗f1** ♘b6 20 f5 ♘a4?! (20...♕a1+ 22 ♔d2 ♕xb2) 21 fxe6 fxe6 22 ♘c4 ♕c5 23 b3 ♘xc3 24 ♕xc3 a5 25 ♖h3 e5 26 ♖hd3 ♗g4 27 ♖d5 ♕c7 28 ♖1d2 ± Salm-Bulla, corr 1975.

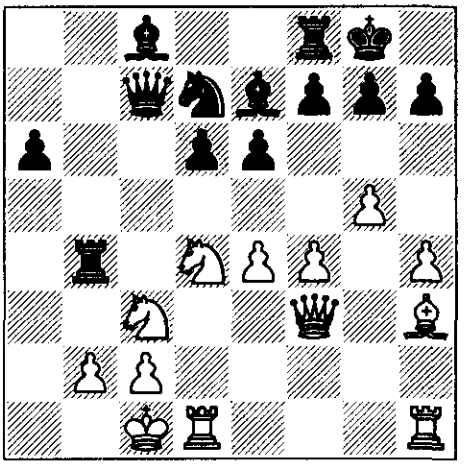
19 ... ♘b6

Or 19...♗e7 20 ♘c4 ♕c7 21 ♘d2 ♘c5 22 f5 a5 23 ♖dg1 ♗a6 24 ♕h5 g6 25 ♕f3 gxf5 26 exf5 d5 (26...♗b7) 27 fxe6 fxe6 28 ♗xe6 ♘xe6 29 ♘xd5 ± Ertl-Keller, corr 1980.

After 19...♘b6 Black has at least equality. Boetew-Tenev, corr 1987 continued 20 ♔b1 ♗b7 21 f5?, and now 21...♘a4 22 ♘xa4 ♖xa4 would have been winning for Black.

B13)

16 ... 0-0 *(D)*



17 ♘xe6

This move does not lead to any clear advantage for White, so line 4 below is especially interesting:

1) **17 ♘f5** ♘c5! 18 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 19 h5?! (19 ♕e3 ♗b7 20 ♖d4 =) ♗b7 20 h6 ♗xe4 21 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 22 hxg7 ♖c8 23 ♖h2 ♖a4 24 ♔b1 d5! ∓ Minić-Fischer, Rovinj-Zagreb 1970.

2) **17 ♖hf1** ♕c5! 18 ♘b3 (18 ♕f2 ♘b6 19 f5 ♘a4 20 f6 ♘xc3 21 bxc3? {21 fxe7 ♘a2+ 22 ♔b1 ♘c3+ is a draw} ♕xc3 22 ♖d3 ♕b2+ 23 ♔d2 ♗d8 ∓ Planinc-Bukić, Yugoslavia Ch 1972) ♕b6 19 f5 ♘c5 20 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 21 f6 ♗d8 22 fxg7 ♔xg7 23 ♖d2 ♕e5 24 ♖df2 ♖b7 = Timoshchenko-Grigorian, USSR 1971.

3) **17 f5** ♘e5 18 ♕g3 ♕b6 19 f6 ♗d8 20 ♘f5 exf5 21 ♘d5 ♕a5 22 ♘xb4, Zerbe-Rolle, corr 1975, and now 22...♘c4! −+.

4) **17 g6** ♘c5 (not 17...hxg6? 18 ♘xe6 fxe6 19 ♗xe6+ ♔h8 20 h5 g5 21 ♘d5 ♕d8 22 h6 1-0 Mann-Bader, corr 1981) and now:

4a) **18 gxh7+** ♔xh7? (18...♔h8 19 ♖hg1 ♗f6 is less clear) 19 ♕h5+ ♔g8 20 ♗f5! 1-0 Elkind-Rodriguez, USA 1981, as 20...exf5 21 ♘d5 ♕b7 22 ♖hg1 leads to a deadly sacrifice on g7.

4b) **18 gxf7+** ♖xf7 19 h5 (19 ♕e3 ♕b6 20 e5 ♗b7 21 ♖hg1 dxe5 22 fxe5 ♗xh4 −+ Radumilo-Gostisa, corr 1982) ♗g5 20 ♘f5 ♗b7?! 21 fxg5 exf5 22 g6 ♖f6, Simoni-Chiesa, corr 1977, 23 gxh7+ with a clear advantage for White.

17 ... fxe6
18 ♗xe6+ ♔h8
19 ♘d5 ♕c4!

19...♕b7 20 ♘xe7! ♖xb2 (alternatively 20...♘e5 21 ♗xc8 ♕xe7 22 ♕a3 ♘c6 23 ♗f5 wins) 21 ♘g6+ hxg6 22 h5 1-0 was the game Estrin-Obukhovsky, USSR 1971.

20 ♗f5

The critical line, but White should probably head for a draw by means of 20 ♗xd7 ♗xd7 21 ♘xe7 ♗a4! 22 ♕d3 ♕a2 23 ♕a3 ♕xa3 24 bxa3 ♖xe4 25 ♘d5 ♖e2 26 ♖d2 ♖xd2 27 ♔xd2 ♗c6 28 c4 ♗xd5 ½-½ G.Kuzmin-Grigorian, USSR 1971.

20 ... ♖xf5

Not 20...♘c5 (20...♗d8? 21 ♕h5! ♖xf5 22 exf5 +−) 21 ♘xe7 ♗xf5 22 ♘xf5 ♖xb2 23 ♔xb2 ♖b8+ 24 ♔c1 ♘b3+ 25 ♕xb3 ♖xb3 26 ♖xd6 ± Estrin-Sorokin, corr 1971.

After 20...♖xf5 Black stands well, e.g. 21 exf5 ♗b7 22 ♖he1 ♗f8 23 ♖e8 ♖b5! (23...♔g8 24 ♖d8 ♗xd5 25 ♕xd5+ ♕xd5 26 ♖xd5 ♘b6 27 ♖5xd6 ♖xb2 28 f6 +−) 24 b3 ♕c5 25 c4 ♕a3+ 26 ♔d2 ♖xb3 ∓ Nocci-Conti, corr 1989.

B14)

16 ... ♕c5

The safest choice.

17 ♘b3

Or **17 ♕d3** (17 ♕e3 is untested) **♕b6** (17...♘b6 18 f5 ♘c4 19 ♘b3 ♕e5 20 ♖df1 a5 21 fxe6 fxe6 22

♕d4 a4 23 ♕xe5 dxe5 ∓ Krabbé-Mescheder, corr 1986, is a natural and interesting plan for Black) and now:

1) **18 b3** ♘c5 19 ♕e3 e5? 20 ♘d5 exd4 21 ♕d2 ♘xb3+ 22 cxb3 ♕c6+ 23 ♔b2 ♖xb3+ 24 ♔xb3 ♗e6 25 ♕xd4 1-0 Den Broeder-Vermeulen, corr 1976.

2) **18 ♘f5** ♘c5! 19 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 20 ♕xd6 ♖xb2 (20...♕xd6 21 ♖xd6 ♘xe4 22 ♘xe4 ♖xe4 23 ♖hd1 ♔e7 24 ♖c6 ± Yuferov-Borodin, corr 1987) 21 ♕xb6 ♖xb6 22 ♖d4 ♖c6 23 e5 ♗d7 = Estrin-Prokofiev, corr 1972.

3) **18 ♘b3** ♘c5 19 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 20 f5 ♕e5 21 ♖hf1 0-0 22 fxe6 fxe6 23 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 24 ♕f3+ ♔e8 25 ♖f1 ♗b7 ∞ Bennewitz-Kahl, corr 1982.

After 17 ♘b3 the queen must go to b6, but it has accomplished its mission of *deflecting the knight* away from the attack on e6.

17 ... ♕b6

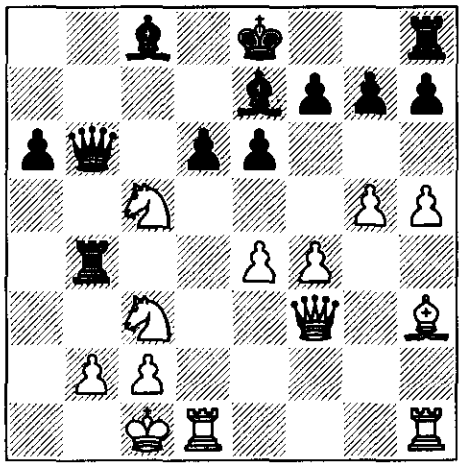
18 h5

18 f5 (18 ♘a2 ♖c4 19 ♕d3 ♖c7 20 ♔b1 ♗b7 21 h5 d5 22 g6 dxe4 23 ♕d4 ♗f6 24 ♕xb6 ♘xb6 25 ♖d6 ♘c4 wins for Black, Gaprindashvili-Ivanka Budinsky, Vrnjačka Banja 1971) ♘c5 19 ♘xc5 dxc5 (19...♕xc5 20 fxe6 fxe6 21 ♖hf1 ♖f8 22 ♕h5+ g6 23 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 24 ♕f3 ♗g7 25 ♖f1 ♔d8 26 ♖e1 ♕a5? {26...♖b7 ∓} 27 ♕f7 ♗e5 28 ♕f8+ ♔d7 29 ♗xe6+ 1-0 Baldascini-Scacco, corr 1974) 20 f6 gxf6 21 gxf6 ♗f8 (21...♗d6!?) 22 b3 c4 23 ♘a2 ♖b5 24 ♔b2 cxb3 25 cxb3 ♕a5?! (at some stage, Black should play ...♗d6-e5) 26 ♖d3 ♗a3+ 27 ♔b1 ♗b7 28 ♖hd1 ♗c6 29 ♗g2 ♖g8 30 ♕e2 e5 31 ♕c2 ♖c5 32 ♕d2 ♕xd2 33 ♖1xd2 +– Drude-Schonberger, corr 1988.

18 ... ♘c5

19 ♘xc5 *(D)*

Or 19 ♘d2 ♗b7 20 b3 f5?! (an unnecessary weakening of Black's kingside) 21 ♖he1 0-0 22 h6 g6 23 ♘a2 ± Maciejewski-Abramowicz, corr 1993.



19 ... dxc5

Or **19...♕xc5** and now:

1) **20 ♗g2** ♕b6 21 b3 0-0 22 h6 g6 23 ♘a4 ♕a5 24 ♕c3 f6 25 gxf6 ♗xf6 26 ♕c6, Ricketts-Kerr, corr England 1993, 26...♗d4 ∓.

2) **20 ♖hg1** ♕a5 21 ♔b1 ♕a3 22 b3 a5 23 ♖d3 a4 24 ♘a2 ♖b8 25 f5 axb3 26 cxb3 ♗a6 27 ♖c3 ♗c4 28 ♘c1 d5 29 fxe6 fxe6 30 ♗xe6 ♖f8 ∞ Tseitlin-Savon, USSR Ch 1971.

3) **20 g6** fxg6 (20...0-0 21 gxf7+ ♖xf7 22 ♖hg1 ∞) 21 hxg6 h6 22 ♗g4 ♕a5 23 b3 (23 ♖d3 0-0 24 ♖h5 ♕a1+ 25 ♔d2 ♖f6 26 f5 ♗b7? 27 ♕h3 ♗f8 {27...♗xe4 28 ♖xh6 +–} 28 ♕h4 ♕f1 29 ♗e2 +– Prosorow-Vaisman, corr 1976) ♕a3+ 24 ♔d2 ♖d4+ 25 ♔e2 ♖xd1 26 ♖xd1 ♕c5 27 ♕e3 ♕c6 28 ♕h3 (28 ♖d3 0-0 29 ♕h3 ♖f6 30 f5 ♕c5 31 fxe6 ♕f2+ 32 ♔d1 ♕g1+ 33 ♔d2 ♖f2+ 34 ♘e2

♗g5+ 35 ♖e3 ♗xe3+ 36 ♔xe3 ± Planinc-Savon, Mar del Plata 1971) ♖f8 29 ♖d4 a5 30 ♗xe6 ♗a6+? (30...♗f6) 31 ♗c4 ♖xf4 32 ♘d5 ♗f6? 33 ♕e6+ ♔d8 34 ♘xf6 ♗xc4+ 35 ♖xc4 ♖xf6 36 ♕xf6+ 1-0 Armas-S.Grünberg, Hungary 1973.

20 g6

Or 20 h6 g6 21 b3 0-0 22 ♕e3 ♖d8 23 ♖xd8+ ♕xd8 24 ♖d1 ♖d4 25 ♗g4 ♗b7 26 e5 ♔f8 ½-½ as in Schranz-Middendorf, corr 1986.

20 ... fxg6

White's position is unenviable because Black has a second promising continuation in 20...♖xb2!? 21 gxf7+ ♔xf7 22 h6 g6 23 ♖dg1 ♖f8 24 f5 ♔g8 25 ♕h5 exf5 26 exf5 ♗f6! 27 fxg6 ♖b1+ 28 ♘xb1 ♕b2+ 29 ♔d2 ♖d8+ 0-1 Sardini-Gaspero, corr 1984.

21 hxg6 h6

22 ♘d5

22 b3 is bad, for example 22...0-0 23 ♘a2 (23 ♗f1 ♗g5 24 ♘e2 c4 25 ♖h3 cxb3 26 cxb3 e5 –+ Tsepurnoi-Borwell, corr 1978) ♖b5 24 ♘c3 ♖a5 25 ♘e2 ♗f6 26 c4 ♖a1+ 0-1 Bogojević-Lukin, corr 1991.

22 ... exd5

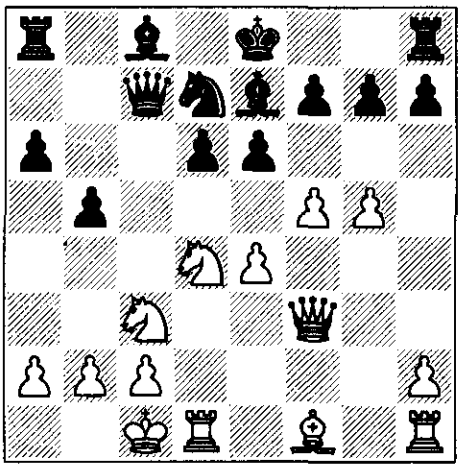
23 ♗xc8 0-0

Black has a very comfortable position and the only real question is whether White can equalise: 24 ♕g4 (24 e5 ♖xb2 25 ♗e6+ ♔h8 –+) ♖xe4 25 ♖de1 (25 ♗f5 ♗f6 26 ♗xe4 ♗xb2+ 27 ♔d2 ♕b4+ 28 c3 ♗xc3+ 29 ♔c2 ♕b2+ 30 ♔d3 dxe4+ 31 ♔xe4 ♖e8+ 32 ♔d3 ♕b3 0-1 Kaplan-Browne, Madrid 1973) ♗f6 26 c3 ♕c7 (26...♕a5 27 ♖xe4 dxe4 28 ♕h3 ♕a1+ 29 ♔c2 ♕a4+ 30 ♔b1 ∞ Nocci-Voltolini, corr 1986) 27 ♖xe4 dxe4 28 ♗xa6 ♔h8 29 ♗c4 ♕a5 (29...e3!?) 30 ♕g2 (30 ♔c2 ♖b8 31 ♖b1 ♕a4+ 32 b3 ♕a2+ 33 ♖b2 ♕a1 34 ♕g3 ♖d8 35 ♗e2 ♖d2+ 36 ♔xd2 ♕xb2+ 37 ♔e3 ♕xc3+ ∓ Seppala-Honkaniemi, corr 1979) ♖d8! 31 ♕xe4 ♗xc3! 32 ♕b7 ♗d2+ 33 ♔b1 ♗xf4 34 ♕e7 ♕b6 35 ♕f7 ∓ ½-½ Pantaleoni-Rothaler, corr 1992.

Line B14 has effectively put 14 a3 out of business.

B2)

13 f5 *(D)*



The modern treatment of 10 g4 is based on this move. Now the way splits again. The first alternative, taking on g5, is Black's most solid option. White can only hope to obtain a slight edge and in most cases rather drawish opposite-coloured bishop positions result. The defect from Black's point of view is that his winning chances are virtually zero. The second line is more double-edged. Black is willing to accept a certain loss of time to further his strategic ambitions. White normally has to react quickly and aggressively, for if Black completes his development in safety then White will be clearly worse. White very often sacrifices

material to attempt a breakthrough and play is exceptionally tactical.

B21: 13...♗xg5+
B22: 13...♘c5

Or:

1) **13...♘b6** (dubious) 14 f6 gxf6 (14...♗f8 15 fxg7 ♗xg7 16 ♗xb5+ axb5 17 ♘dxb5 ♕e7 18 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 19 ♖hf1 ♕xg5+ 20 ♔b1 f6 21 e5 f5 22 ♕c6 ±) 15 gxf6 ♗f8 16 ♖g1 b4 17 ♘d5! exd5 18 exd5 ♗b7 19 ♕e3+ ♔d8 20 ♘c6+ ♗xc6 21 dxc6 h5 22 ♔b1 ♕xc6 (22...♔c8 23 ♕e8+ ♕d8 24 ♕xf7 ±) 23 ♗g2 d5 24 ♗xd5! ♘xd5 25 ♖g5 ♔c7 26 ♖gxd5 ♗d6? (26...♖g8! ∞) 27 ♖xd6 ♕xd6 28 ♖xd6 ♔xd6 29 ♕e7+ +– Klompus-Bergqvist, corr 1980.

2) **13...♘e5** (this appears dubious because it leaves e6 too weak) and now:

2a) **14 ♕h5** g6 15 ♕h6 ♘g4 16 ♕h4 ♘e3 17 ♖e1 ♘xf1 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♖hxf1 ♕c5 20 e5 d5 21 ♕f4 ♖f8 22 ♕g4 ♖xf1 23 ♖xf1 ♗d7! ∞ Klompus-Zschinzsch, corr 1980.

2b) **14 ♕h3** b4 15 ♘ce2 exf5 16 ♘xf5 ♗xg5+ 17 ♔b1 0-0 (17...♗xf5 18 ♕xf5 ♖c8 19 ♘d4 ♗e3, Molnar-Sleisz, Hungary Cht 1994, 20 ♗xa6 ±) 18 ♕g3 ♗f6 19 ♘f4 ♗xf5 20 exf5 ♖ac8 21 ♖d2 ♘c4 22 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 23 ♘d5 ♗e5 ∓ Hansel-Bauer, Porz 1990.

2c) **14 ♕g3** and now:

2c1) **14...b4** 15 ♘ce2 with a final branch:

2c11) **15...♘c6** 16 g6 fxg6 17 fxg6 ♘xd4 18 ♘xd4 ♗f6 19 gxh7 ± Arsenev-Tunik, USSR 1979.

2c12) **15...♗b7** 16 fxe6 (16 ♗g2 is very awkward for Black as there is no good way to defend e6) ♗xe4 17 ♗g2 ♗xg2 18 ♕xg2 0-0 19 ♘f4 ♕c4 20 ♘d5 ♖a7 21 b3 ♕c5 22 ♘f5 fxe6 23 ♘fxe7+ ♔h8 24 ♖hf1 ♖e8 25 ♕f2 ♕xf2 26 ♖xf2 exd5 27 ♘xd5 ± Pavlov-Minić, Hamburg Echt 1965.

2c13) **15...♗d7** 16 ♘f4 (16 h4 ♘c6 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♗h3 ♘xd4 19 ♘xd4 ♖c8 20 ♕b3 +– Hakki-Braso, Erevan OL 1996) ♖c8 17 ♖d2 (17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♖d2 ♕a5 19 ♔b1 ♖c3 20 bxc3 bxc3 21 ♖d3 ♘xd3 22 ♘xd3 0-0 23 h4 ± Gimeno-Salamero, Aragon Ch 1992) ♘c4 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♘fxe6 ♗xe6 20 ♘xe6 ♕a5 21 ♗xc4 ♖xc4 22 ♔b1 ♖xe4 23 ♖d5! +– Strautinš-Staerman, USSR 1969.

2c14) **15...exf5** 16 exf5 (16 ♘xf5 ♗xf5 17 exf5 ♕c4 18 ♔b1 ♕g4 19 ♕xg4 ♘xg4 20 ♖d4 ♘e5 21 ♗g2 ♖a7 22 h4 with a clear advantage for White, Hamilton-Basanta, Canada Z 1989) ♗b7 (16...g6 17 ♗g2 ♖b8 18 f6 ♗d8 19 ♘f4 ± Surowiak-Gierasinski, corr 1993) 17 ♗g2 ♗xg2 18 ♕xg2 ♖c8 19 ♘f4 ♕c4 20 ♔b1 ♖c5, Papp-Somlo, Szeged 1993, 21 b3! ♕c3 22 ♘d5 +–.

2c2) **14...♗d7!?** 15 ♗h3 (15 h4 g6 16 fxe6 fxe6 17 ♗h3 ♕c8 18 ♘ce2 ♘f7 19 ♕b3 ♘d8 20 e5 d5 21 ♘f4 ♖f8 22 ♕g3 ♗c5 23 h5 ♗xd4 24 ♖xd4 ♘c6 25 ♖d2 ± Kalvelis-Chrenov, corr 1971) ♕c8 16 ♖hf1 g6! (16...♘c6 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♘xc6! ♕xc6 {18...♗xc6 19 ♘d5} 19 g6 h6? {19...b4 ∞} 20 ♖f7 ♖g8 21 ♖xe7+ ♔xe7 22 ♘d5+! ♔e8 23 ♕h4 1-0 da Costa-Carvalcho, corr 1985) 17 ♔b1 (17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♘ce2 h6 19 gxh6 ♖xh6 20 ♘f4 g5 21 ♘d3 ∞) h6 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 gxh6 ♖xh6 20 ♘ce2 g5 21 ♘f3 ♕c5 22 ♘xg5?! ♖g6 23

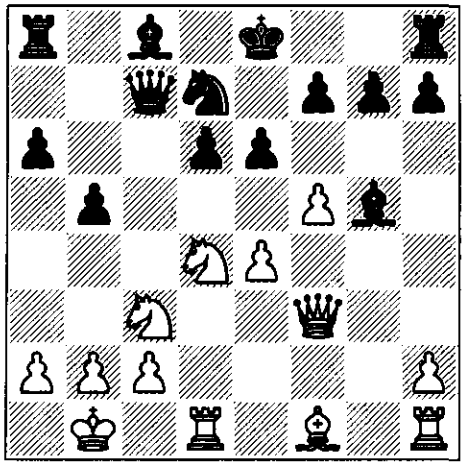
♗xe6 ♖xg5 24 ♗xd7+ ♘xd7 25 ♕h3 0-0-0 ∓ Eisen-Carlson, corr 1988.

B21)

13 ... ♗xg5+

Compared to 13 h4, by playing 13 f5 White gets his attack in one move more quickly, but the defect is that it leaves the g5-pawn hanging. Taking it off does seem to be a natural way to exploit White's omission, but matters are not so clear. The hanging bishop on g5 makes it impossible for Black to keep his extra pawn, and the upshot is usually a position in which Black has a good dark-squared bishop and control of e5, while White has an excellent knight on d5.

14 ♔b1 *(D)*



14 ... ♘e5

By far the most popular move. Alternatives are inferior, except for 14...0-0, which is worth a look:

1) **14...♘c5** and now:

1a) **15 fxe6** ♗xe6 16 ♖g1 is dangerous for Black, e.g. 16...♗h6 17 ♘d5 ♗xd5 18 exd5 or 16...♕d8 17 e5 ♖c8 18 ♘xe6 ♘xe6 19 ♖xd6 +– Frick-Kagambi, Novi Sad OL 1990.

1b) **15 ♕h5** ♗h6 (15...♗e7 16 fxe6 ♘xe6 17 ♘d5 ♕b7 18 ♘f5 {18 ♘xe7 ♕xe7 19 ♘f5 g6 20 ♘xe7 ±} g6 19 ♕e2 gxf5 20 exf5 ♖b8 21 ♗g2 ♕a7 22 ♖he1 ♗h4? 23 fxe6 ♗xe6 24 ♗h3 0-0 25 ♕h5 ♗d8 26 ♕h6 1-0 Skolarski-Schmitz, West Germany 1987) 16 fxe6 ♗xe6 17 ♘f5 ♗xf5 18 exf5 0-0 19 ♖g1 ♔h8 20 ♘d5 ♕d8 21 f6 ♖g8, Samardzić-Stanić, Croatia Cht 1994, 22 ♘e7! ±.

1c) **15 ♗xb5+** (although quite popular, this is not especially convincing) axb5 16 ♘dxb5 ♕e7 (not 16...♕a5 17 ♘xd6+ ♔e7 18 ♕h5 +–) 17 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 18 ♖hg1 h6 19 e5 ♗b7 (19...♕a7 20 ♘xf7 ♔xf7 21 ♕h5+ ♔f8 22 ♖xg5 ♘e4 23 ♘xe4 ♕xa2+ 24 ♔c1 ♕a1+ 25 ♔d2 ♕xb2 26 ♘c3 ♕b6 ∞ Pane-Cova, corr 1986) 20 ♕f2 ♖a5 21 f6 gxf6 22 h4 f5 23 hxg5 hxg5, Venni-Panizzi, corr 1987, 24 ♕d4 ±.

2) **14...♘f6** 15 ♖g1 (15 fxe6 fxe6 16 e5 ♗b7 17 ♕g3 dxe5 {17...♗xh1 18 ♕xg5 dxe5 19 ♘xe6} 18 ♘xe6 ♕e7 19 ♗xb5+ axb5 20 ♘xb5 ♘e4 21 ♘bc7+ +– Karabalis-Brescher, Bruchkoebel 1993) ♗h6 16 fxe6 fxe6 (16...♗xe6 17 e5 +–) 17 e5 ♗b7 18 ♕h3 dxe5 19 ♘xe6 ♕e7 20 ♗xb5+ axb5 21 ♘xb5 ♘d5 22 ♕h5+ ♔d7, Matilla-Andreu, corr 1988, and now 23 ♘ec7! +–.

3) **14...b4** 15 fxe6 ♘f6 16 ♘d5 ♘xd5 17 exd5 0-0 (17...♗f6 18 ♘f5! ±) and Black is just a tempo down over Kotronias-Djurhuus below, so 18 ♗d3 is ±, for example 18...♗f6 19 ♕f5 or 18...fxe6 19 ♗xh7+.

4) **14...0-0** and now:

[4a] **15 fxe6** ♘b6 16 ♘d5 (16 ♗h3 fxe6 17 ♗xe6+ ♗xe6 18 ♘xe6 ♖xf3 19 ♘xc7 ♖a7 20 ♘e6 ♗e7 21

♘d4 ♖f7 22 ♘c6 = Pare-Paredes Prats, corr 1989) ♘xd5 17 exd5 ♗f6 (Tisdall gives 17...fxe6 18 ♕h5 ♗f6 19 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 20 dxe6 ±, but I cannot see how White maintains any advantage after 18...e5) 18 ♗d3! ♗xd4 19 ♗xh7+ ♔xh7 20 ♖xd4 ♔g8 21 ♖h4 fxe6 22 ♕h3 ♖f5 23 ♖h8+ ♔f7 24 ♖g1! +– Kotronias-Djurhuus, Gausdal 1995.

4b) **15 ♕g3** ♗f6 16 fxe6 ♘b6 17 ♘d5 (17 exf7+ ♖xf7 18 ♗h3 ♗xh3 19 ♕xh3 ♖c8 20 a3 ♗e5 21 ♖d3 ♕b7 22 ♕e6 ♕d7 23 ♕xd7 ♘xd7 with equality, Kovacs-Kofidis, Balatonbereny 1992) ♘xd5 18 exd5 ♗e5 (18...♗xd4 19 ♖xd4 fxe6 20 dxe6 ♗xe6 21 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 22 ♖xd6 ♖ad8 23 ♖xd8 ♖xd8 24 ♗d3 g6 25 a4 ♖d5 26 axb5 axb5 27 ♖f1 ♔g7 28 ♔c1 ♗f5 gives rise to an equal position, Antoniou-Lukey, Moscow OL 1994) 19 ♕h3 g6 20 ♘f3 ♗f6 21 ♗g2 ♗b7 22 ♘d4 ♗xd4 23 ♖xd4 fxe6 24 ♕xe6+ ♔h8 25 ♖d2 ♖ae8 26 ♕g4 ♕c5 ∓ Penttinen-Pisulinski, Lubniewice 1994.

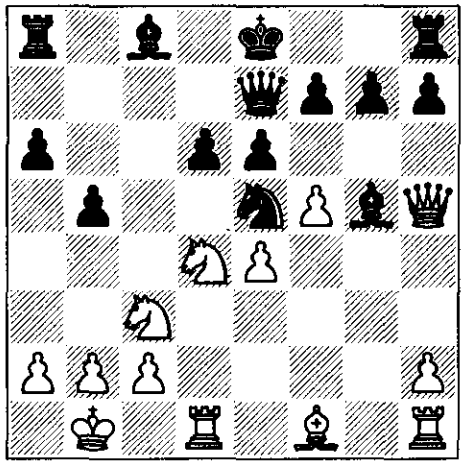
15 ♕h5

Other moves are not worth considering, since Black just keeps the pawn.

15 ... ♕d8

Black has a couple of minor possibilties here in **15...h6** 16 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 17 fxe6 0-0 18 h4 ♗d8 19 ♘d5 ♕b7 20 ♗h3 ± Rovley-Pedersen, corr 1989 and **15...♗f6!?** (this seems playable) 16 fxe6 g6 (or 16...♗b7 17 ♗xb5+ axb5 18 ♘dxb5 ♕e7 19 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 20 ♘xb7 g6 21 ♕h6+ ♗g7 22 ♕f4 +– Hoehne-Janoschka, Hessen 1991) 17 ♘d5 ♕d8 18 ♕h6 (18 exf7+ ♔xf7 19 ♕e2 ♗g4 20 ♘c6 =) fxe6 19 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 20 ♗h3 ♘f7 21 ♕e3 0-0 22 ♖hf1 ♕e7 ∓ Molaschi-Bina, corr 1975.

However, the main alternative is **15...♕e7** *(D)* and now:



1) **16 h4** ♗f4 (16...♗f6 17 fxe6 g6 18 exf7+ ♕xf7 19 ♕h6 ∞) 17 ♗h3 (17 fxe6 g6 18 ♘f5!?) g6 18 ♕e2 ♗d7 19 ♖df1 ♗h6 20 h5 ♖c8 21 hxg6 hxg6 22 f6 ♕f8 ∓ Arencibia-Gamundi, Cordoba 1995.

2) **16 ♖g1** ♗f6 (16...h6 17 fxe6 g6 18 exf7+ ♔xf7 19 ♕e2 ♔g7 20 ♘d5 ♕d8 21 ♖d3 ♖a7 {it is risky to give up the e5-knight, even for a rook!} 22 ♖dg3 ♖f7 = Rother-Lutz, Bundesliga 1990) 17 fxe6 (17 ♗h3 g6 18 ♕h6 ♗d7 19 ♖g3 ♗h4 20 fxe6 ♗xe6 21 ♘xe6 fxe6 22 ♗xe6 ♕xe6 23 ♕xh4 0-0 24 ♘d5 ♖a7 = Valentin-Sahetchian, Paris 1993) g6 18 exf7+ ♕xf7 19 ♕h6 ♗g7 20 ♕d2 0-0 = Diaz-Ch.Toth, Matanzas Capablanca mem 1993.

3) **16 fxe6** g6 17 exf7+ ♔xf7 (17...♔f8 18 ♕e2 ♗g4 19 ♕g2 ♗xd1 20 ♘d5 ♕xf7 21 ♕xg5 {the game doesn't look too clear at this stage} h6 22 ♕g3 ♗f3? {22...♗g4} 23 ♗g2 ♗xg2 24 ♕xg2 ♔e8 25 ♖f1 ♕b7 26 ♖f6 +– Boonekamp-Chevallier, Paris 1993) 18 ♕e2 and now:

3a) **18...♔g7** 19 ♘d5 (19 h3 ♖f8 20 ♗g2 ♖a7 21 ♖hf1 ♕d8 22 ♖xf8 ♕xf8 23 ♘d5 ♗d8 24 ♕e3 ♖f7 25 ♕g3 ♔h8 26 h4 ♕h6 27 ♖h1 ♕d2 ∓ Mascle-Jean, Torcy 1991; 19 ♕g2 ♖a7 20 ♗e2 ♖f8 21 ♖df1 ♗h4 22 ♘f5+ ♗xf5 23 exf5 ♕g5 24 ♕d5 ♖xf5 25 ♖xf5 ♕xf5 26 ♖f1 ♕d7 27 ♘e4 = Ott-De Boer, Wuert 1992) ♕a7 20 ♕g2 ♗h4 21 ♘f5+ ♗xf5 22 exf5 ♖hf8 23 ♕e4 ♗f6 24 ♘f4 gxf5 25 ♕xf5 ♔h8 26 ♘e6 ♖f7 27 ♗g2 ♖e8 28 ♗d5 with a slight advantage for White, Ostrava-Volgograd, corr match 1971.

3b) **18...♗g4!** (forcing the exchange of queens favours Black) 19 ♕f2+ ♕f6 20 ♕xf6+ ♗xf6 21 ♗e2 ♗c8! 22 ♖hf1 ♔g7 23 ♘d5 ♗d8 24 ♖f4 ♖a7 25 h4? (an instructive error; 25 ♖g1 ∓) h5! (now the h4-pawn is permanently weak) 26 ♖df1 ♖f7! 27 ♖xf7+ ♘xf7 ∓ Shabalov-Hellers, New York 1993.

4) **16 ♘xe6** ♗xe6 (not 16...g6? 17 ♕xg5 fxe6, Timman-Ljubojević, Nikšić 1983, and now 18 ♕h6 b4 19 ♘e2 ♗b7 20 fxg6 ♘xg6 21 ♗g2 ±) 17 fxe6 g6 18 exf7+ ♔xf7 with the variations:

4a) **19 ♕h3** ♔g7 20 ♘d5 ♕d8 (20...♕a7 21 ♕e6 ♕c5 22 h4 ♖ae8 23 ♕h3 ♗h6 24 h5 a5 25 ♗e2 b4 26 ♖dg1 ♕c8 27 ♕xc8 ♖xc8 28 ♘e7 +– Brodsky-Coleman, Isle of Man 1996) with another branch:

4a1) **21 ♕c3** ♖a7 22 h4 ♗xh4 23 ♘f4 ♕f6 24 ♕d4 ♖f7 25 ♖xh4 ♕xh4 26 ♘e6+ ♔h6 27 ♗e2 ♖e8 28 ♕xd6 ♘c4 29 ♗xc4 bxc4 ∓ Kroeger-Tuschinske, Germany 1995.

4a2) **21 ♕g3** ♗h4 22 ♕c3 ♖a7 23 ♕a3 ½-½ Groszpeter-Gallagher, Biel 1990.

4a3) **21 ♗e2** ♖f8 22 ♖hf1 ♖a7 23 ♕a3 ♖xf1 24 ♖xf1 ♕b8 25 ♕g3 ♕d8 26 ♕a3 (26 a3 ♖f7 27 ♖xf7+ ♘xf7 28 a4 ♕e8 29 ♕c3+ ♔g8 30 axb5 axb5 31 ♕d4 ♕d7 32 ♗f1 ♘e5 33 ♕c3 ♕g4 34 ♕e1 ♘f3 35 ♕e2 = ♘d2+?? {oops} 36 ♕xd2 1-0 Rajala-Debacker, corr 1989) ♕b8 27 ♕g3 ♗h6 28 ♕h4 ♖f7 29 ♖xf7+ ♘xf7 30 a4 ♗g5 = Outerelo-Vera, Aceimar 1995.

4b) **19 ♕e2** ♔g7 (19...♖ac8 20 ♘d5 ♕d8 21 ♕f2+ ♔g7 22 ♕a7+ ♕d7 23 ♕xa6 ± Shmuter-Schulte Bartold, Berlin 1993) 20 ♘d5 and now:

4b1) **20...♕a7!?** 21 ♕g2 (21 h4 ♗h6 22 ♗h3 {22 h5 ♖af8 23 hxg6 ♖f2 24 ♕h5 hxg6 =} ♖hf8 23 ♖hf1 ♖xf1 24 ♖xf1 ♘c4 25 ♕d3 ♖e8 26 ♔a1 ♘d2 27 ♘f6 ♖e5 28 ♘d7 {28 ♘g4! ♘xf1 29 ♕xd6 ±} ♖xe4 29 ♗f5 ♘xf1 30 ♗xe4 ♕xd7 ∓ Sammalvuo-Åkesson, Hallsdal 1996) ♗h6 22 ♗e2 ♖hf8 23 ♖hf1 ♔h8 24 ♕h3 ♗g7 25 ♘f4 ♖f6 26 ♘e6 ♕d7 27 ♖xf6 ♗xf6 28 ♖f1 ♗g7 29 ♕b3 was equal in Ernst-Van Wely, Reykjavik 1994.

4b2) **20...♕d8** and now White has tried several moves without obtaining any advantage:

4b21) **21 ♗h3** ♖f8 (21...♖a7 22 ♕g2 ♖f8 23 ♗e6 ♗h4 24 ♖hf1 ♕g5 25 ♕h3 ♖xf1 26 ♕xf1 ♘c4 27 ♕d3 ♕e5 28 ♕d4 ♕xd4 29 ♖xd4 ♗g5 = Shmuter-Grünfeld, Rishon le Zion 1994) 22 ♖hf1 ♖a7 23 ♗e6 ♘c4 24 ♖xf8 ♕xf8 25 b3 ♘e5 26 ♖f1 ♕d8 27 ♕f2 ♖b7 28 ♕d4 (28 ♘f4 ♗xf4 29 ♕xf4 ♖b8 30 ♗g4 ½-½ Rowley-Shoppee, corr 1989) ♕e8 29 ♗h3 a5 30 ♘e3 ♗xe3 31 ♕xe3 b4 32 ♕d4 ♕c6 33 ♗e6 ♕c5 34 ♕d2 ♖c7 35

♖f2 ♕c3 36 ♕f4 ½-½ Ervin-Gligorić, USA 1972.

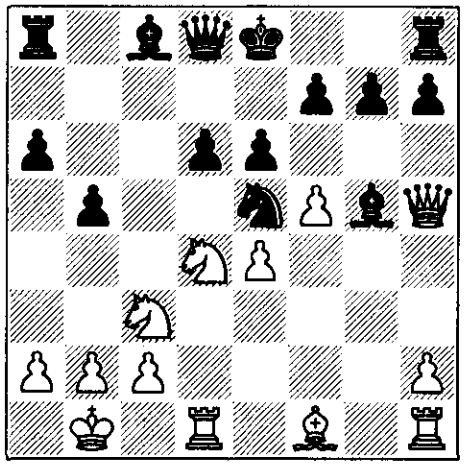
4b22) **21 ♕e1** (if White could play h4-h5 he would gain the advantage, but Black prevents this) ♗h4 22 ♕c3 ♖a7 23 ♕a3 ♗f2! 24 ♘f4 ♕f6 25 ♘d5 ♕d8 26 ♘f4 ½-½ Hellers-Howell, Groningen 1984.

4b23) **21 h4** ♗xh4 22 ♗h3 ♖f8 (22...♗g5 23 ♕h2 ♖a7 24 ♘f4 ♗xf4 25 ♕xf4 ♖f7 26 ♗f5 ♕f6 27 ♕h6+ ♔g8 28 ♖hg1 ∞ Kuhnert-Blasing, corr 1990) 23 ♗f5 ♗g5 24 ♕h2 h6 25 ♘f4 ♗xf4 26 ♕xf4 g5 27 ♕h2 ♕f6 ∓ Hobusch-Mescheder, corr 1977.

4b24) **21 ♕f2** ♖f8 22 ♕d4 ♗h4 23 ♗d3 ♗f2 24 ♕c3 ♖a7 25 ♖hf1 ♕h4 ½-½ Kolev-Michelakis, Groningen 1993.

4b25) **21 ♗g2** ♖f8 22 ♖df1 (22 ♖hf1 ♖xf1 23 ♖xf1 ♖a7 24 ♘f4 ♗xf4 25 ♖xf4 ♕g5 26 ♕e3 ♖e7 27 ♕g3 ♕xg3 28 hxg3 ♘c4 ∓ Theeg-Rolle, corr 1981) ♕a5 23 h4 ♕d2 24 ♕xd2 ♗xd2 = Bebenek-Jaloszynski, corr. 1992.

Returning to the main line after 15...♕d8 *(D)*:



16 ♖g1

The most popular move. Others:

1) **16 h4** (it is surprising that this move is not more popular) ♗f6 17 fxe6 0-0 18 ♗h3 and now:

1a) **18...♘g6** 19 exf7+ ♖xf7 20 ♗e6 ♗xe6 21 ♘xe6 ♕e8 (21...♕e7 22 ♘g5 is no better) 22 ♘g5 ♗xg5 23 hxg5 ♘f8 24 g6 ♖f6 25 ♘d5 ♖xg6 26 ♘e7+ ♕xe7 27 ♕d5+ ♖e6 28 ♕xa8 wins for White, Epishin-Karpman, Minsk 1990.

1b) **18...g6** 19 ♕e2 ♔h8 20 h5 g5 21 ♘d5 fxe6 22 ♗xe6 ♘c4 23 ♘xf6 ♗xe6, Stripunsky-Jaworski, Ceske Budejovice 1995, 24 ♘xh7! +–.

1c) **18...♖e8** 19 ♘c6 ♕c7, Psakhis-Grünfeld, Israel 1996, 20 ♘d5 ♕xc6 21 ♘xf6+ gxf6 22 ♕h6 ♗xe6 23 ♖dg1+ ♘g6 24 h5 ♗xa2+ (or 24...♗xh3 25 hxg6 fxg6 26 ♖xg6+ +–) 25 ♔a1! +–.

1d) **18...♔h8** 19 ♘d5 fxe6 20 ♗xe6 g6 (20...♖a7 21 ♖df1 g6 22 ♕e2 ♗g7 23 h5 ♖xf1+ 24 ♕xf1 ♗xe6 25 ♘xe6 ♕e8 26 ♘ec7 ♕f7 27 ♕xf7 ♘xf7 28 hxg6 ± Shabalov-Fedorowicz, New York 1992) 21 ♕e2 ♘c4 22 ♗xc8 ♗xd4 23 ♖xd4 ♖xc8 24 h5 ♕g5 25 hxg6 ♕xg6 26 ♖d3 ♖ce8 27 ♖dh3 ± Chorfi-Brunner, Novi Sad OL 1990.

2) **16 fxe6** g6 (16...0-0 17 ♗h3 g6 18 ♕e2 ♔h8 19 ♘d5 ♖a7 20 ♖dg1 fxe6 21 ♗xe6 ♗h4 22 ♖f1 ♖e8 23 ♗xc8 ♕xc8 24 ♕e3 ♖g7 25 ♖hg1 ♕d8 ± Zindel-Nemet, Geneva 1992) 17 exf7+ ♔xf7 18 ♕e2 ♗g4 (18...♔g7 19 ♘d5 ♖a7 20 ♕g2 ♖f7 21 ♗e2 ♖hf8 22 ♖df1 ♗h4 = Miljanović-Arsović, Belgrade 1993) 19 ♘c6! (19 ♕f2+ ♕f6 ∓) ♗xe2 (19...♕c8 20 ♘xe5+ dxe5 21 ♕f2+ ♔g7 22 ♗e2 ±) 20 ♘xd8+ ♖hxd8 21 ♗xe2 ♖ac8 22 ♘d5 = Malachi-Serebrjanik, Israel 1993.

3) **16 ♘xe6** ♗xe6 17 fxe6 and now:

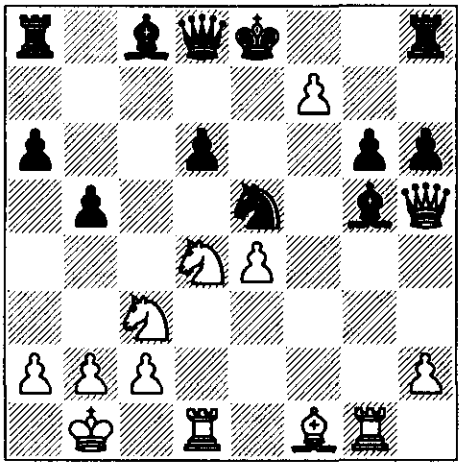
3a) **17...0-0** 18 ♗h3 (18 ♖g1 h6 {18...♗f6 19 ♗h3 ±} 19 ♗h3 g6 20 exf7+ ♔g7 21 ♕e2 ♖xf7 22 ♘d5 ♖aa7 23 a3 ♖f8 24 ♖gf1 ♖af7 25 ♖xf7+ ♖xf7 26 ♖f1 ♕e8 27 ♖xf7+ ♕xf7 with equality, Sanchez Almeyra-Gallagher, Ticino 1992) g6 19 ♕e2 fxe6 (19...♔g7 20 ♘d5 fxe6 21 ♗xe6 ♖e8 22 ♗g4 ♖f8 23 ♕g2 ♖a7 24 ♖hf1 ♖af7 25 ♖xf7+ ♖xf7 26 ♗e6 ♖f8 27 ♕g1 ♔h8 28 ♕a7 ± Goldberg-Rother, 2nd Bundesliga 1992) 20 ♗xe6+ ♔h8 21 h4 ♗f6 22 h5 g5 23 ♖hf1 h6 24 ♘d5 ♗g7 25 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 26 ♖f1 ± Adams-Hodgson, Wijk aan Zee 1993.

3b) **17...g6** 18 exf7+ (18 ♕h3 0-0 19 exf7+ ♔h8 20 ♕e6 ♘xf7 21 h4 ♗xh4 22 ♗e2 ♖a7 23 ♘d5 ♘e5 ∓ Cullip-Gallagher, London Lloyds Bank 1990) ♔xf7 (18...♘xf7 19 ♕g4 ♗h4 20 ♗g2 ♖a7 21 e5 ♘xe5 22 ♕d4 ♖f7 23 ♘e4 ♗e7 24 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 25 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 26 ♖xd6 ± Bailey-Basanta, Canada Z 1989) 19 ♕h3 (19 ♕e2 ♖f8 {19...♔g7 20 ♗h3 ♖e8 21 ♖hf1 ♖a7 22 ♕f2 ♖f7 23 ♕d4 ♗f6 24 ♘d5 ♘f3 25 ♕e3 ± Thorhallsson-Christiansen, Reykjavik 1988} 20 h4 ♗xh4 21 ♕h2 g5 22 ♗e2 ♔g7 23 ♕h3 ♕c8 24 ♕e3 ♕c5 25 ♕d2 ♖f2 ∓ Wittmann-Freitag, Oberwart 1991) ♔g7 (19...♖a7?! 20 ♘d5 ♔g7 21 ♕a3! ♕b8 22 h4! ±) 20 ♕e6 ♘f7 21 h4!? ♗f6 (alternatively 21...♗xh4 22 e5! ♘xe5 23 ♖xd6 ♕f6 24 ♗g2 ♖ae8 25 ♕xf6+ ♗xf6 26 ♖xa6 ± {26 ♗e4? ♘c4!}) 22 ♕h3 (22 h5 ♕c8! 23 h6+ {23 ♕xc8 =} ♘xh6 24 ♕xd6 ♘f7! 25 ♕g3 ♗xc3 26 bxc3 ♖d8! 27 ♖xd8 ♕xd8 ∓ de Firmian-Browne, USA Ch 1987) ♕c8 23 ♘d5 ♕xh3 24 ♖xh3 ♗e5 25 ♗e2 ♖a7 26 h5 ♘g5 27 h6+ ♔f7 28 ♖e3 ♖f8 = Ertl-Schafer, corr 1990.

16 ... ♗f6

Or **16...h6** (16...♗e3? 17 ♖xg7 ♕f6 18 ♖g3 ♗f2 19 ♖g2 ♗xd4 20 ♖xd4 ♘c4 21 ♗xc4 ♕xd4 22 fxe6 +– Luther-Buhr, Hamburg 1993) **17 fxe6** (17 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 18 fxe6 0-0 19 exf7+ ♖xf7 20 ♗h3 ♖f2 21 ♗e6+ ♔h7 22 ♖df1 ♖xf1+ 23 ♖xf1 ♕e7 24 ♗h3 ♖f8 = Iodice-Bosca, corr 1991) **g6** (17...0-0 18 ♘f5 fxe6 19 ♘xh6+ gxh6 20 ♕xh6 ♘f3, Bøye-Nielsen, corr 1984, 21 ♗e2! ♘xg1 22 ♕g6+ ♔h8 23 ♕h5+ ♔g7 24 ♖xg1 ♖f7 25 ♖xg5+ ♔f8 26 ♕h8+ ♔e7 27 ♖g8 +–) **18 exf7+** *(D)* and now:

B



1) **18...♔f8** 19 ♕e2 ♖a7 (or 19...♖h7 20 ♘f3 ♕f6 21 ♘xe5 dxe5 22 ♘d5 ±) 20 ♘f3 ♕f6 (20...♘xf3? 21 ♕xf3 ♖xf7 22 ♕d3! ±) 21 ♘xg5 hxg5 22 ♘d5 ♕f3 23 ♕e1 ♖xh2 24 ♗d3 ♗e6 25 ♕b4 ♖d7 26 ♘b6 ♖d8 27 ♗xb5 axb5 28 ♖xd6 ♖xd6 29 ♕xd6+ ♔xf7 30 ♕xe5 ♖h1 31 ♕c7+ ♔g8 32 ♕d8+ ♔f7 33 ♕c7+ ♔g8 34 ♕d8+ ♔f7 ½-½ Groszpeter-Ruck, Hungary Ch 1995.

2) **18...♔xf7** 19 ♕e2 ♔g7 (the line 19...♔g8 20 h4 ♗xh4 21 ♘c6 ♕b6 22 ♕h2 ♕xc6 23 ♕xh4 ♖a7 24 ♗e2 gives White some play for the pawn, Pinkas-Nowak, Poland Cht 1990, but is unconvincing) and now:

2a) **20 ♘d5** ♖a7! (20...♖f8 21 ♕g2 ♖a7 22 ♕g3 ♔h7 23 ♗h3 ♗h4 24 ♕c3 ♗f2 25 ♖gf1 ♗xh3 26 ♕xh3 ♗xd4 27 ♖xf8 ♕xf8 28 ♖xd4 ♕f2 = Wolff-Browne, Philadelphia 1989) 21 ♕e1 ♔h7 22 ♕c3 ♖f7 23 ♗h3 ♖hf8 24 ♗xc8 ♕xc8 25 ♕g3 ♖f2 26 c3 ♘c4 ∓ Dijkstra-Poel, corr 1992.

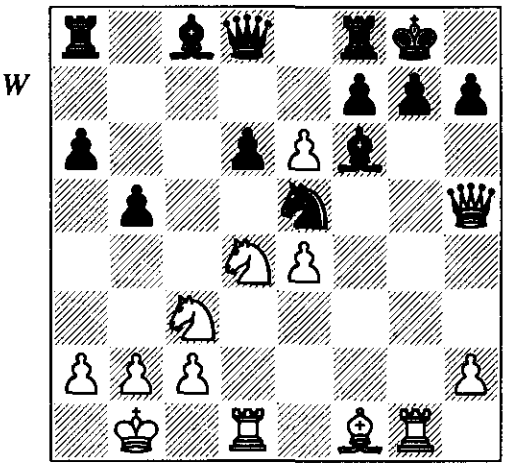
2b) **20 h4** ♗xh4 21 ♘f5+ ♗xf5 (21...♔h7 22 ♖xd6 ♕f8 23 ♕h2 ♗xf5 24 ♕xe5 ♕e7 25 ♕xe7+ ♗xe7 26 ♖c6 ♖hc8 27 ♖b6 ± Bronstein-Browne, Reykjavik 1990) 22 exf5 ♖f8 (22...♖e8 23 ♗h3 ♗g5 24 fxg6 ♘c4 25 ♕d3 ♕e7 26 ♖gf1 ♖f8 27 ♖fe1 ♕f6 28 ♖e6 ♕f3 29 ♕xf3 ♖xf3 30 ♗g2 +– Tischbierek-Schurade, East German Ch 1986) 23 ♘e4 (23 fxg6!? ♖f2 24 ♕e4 ♘f3 25 ♖h1 ±) ♗e7 24 ♘c5 ♖f6 25 ♘e6+ ♖xe6 26 fxe6 ♕b6 27 ♖g3 ♖c8 28 ♕e4 ♕f2 29 ♖g2 ♕f6 30 ♕b7 ♖f8 31 ♗e2 ♕xe6 32 ♕xa6 ± Peli-Schäfer, corr 1993.

17 fxe6 0-0 *(D)*

Or **17...g6** (with the queen on e7 simply 17...♗xe6 would be possible here) **18 exf7+ ♔xf7** and now:

1) **19 ♕e2** ♖f8 (19...♗g7 20 ♕f2+ ♕f6 21 ♕g3 ♖f8 22 ♘d5 ♕d8 23 ♕b3 ♔e8 24 ♗h3 ♖a7 25 ♗e6 ♗d7 26 ♕h3 ± Luther-Vaulin, Kecskemet 1993) 20 ♘d5 (20 ♕e3 ♘g4 21 ♕h3 ♔g8 22 ♘d5 ♘f2 23 ♕b3 ♔g7 24 ♖d2 ♘xe4 25 ♖d1 ♗xd4 26 ♖xd4 ♕g5 27 ♕e3 ♕xe3 28 ♘xe3 ♗b7 ∓ Enders-Ftačnik, Bundesliga 1995) ♔g8 21 ♘f5 ♔h8 22 ♘xf6 (22 ♘fe3 ♗g7 23 ♗g2 ♖b8 24 ♖d2 ♗e6 25 c3 ♖f7 26 ♖gd1 a5 27 h3 ♖fb7 28 ♕f2 ♕g8 29 ♕h4 h6 30 ♕g3 ♗f7 ∓ Wehmeier-Heppekausen, corr 1991) ♖xf6 23 ♘e3 ♕f8 24 ♗g2 ♖a7 25 ♖gf1 ♖af7 26 ♖xf6 ♖xf6 27 ♖f1 ♖xf1+ 28 ♕xf1 ♕xf1+ 29 ♘xf1 ♔g7 ∓ Gentschev-Timochenko, corr 1992.

2) **19 ♕h6!** ♗g7 (19...♗g4 20 ♘c6! ♕d7 21 ♘xe5+ ♗xe5 22 ♗e2 ±) 20 ♕f4+ ♕f6? (20...♔g8 ±) 21 ♕g3 (Black cannot develop normally) ♕d8 22 ♘f5 ± ♗f8 23 ♗e2 gxf5 24 ♗h5+ ♔e7 25 exf5! ♗xf5 26 ♖ge1 ♔e6 27 ♘e2! ♗xc2+ 28 ♔xc2 ♖c8+ 29 ♔b1 ♖c4 30 ♘f4+ ♖xf4 31 ♕xf4 ♕f6 32 ♕e4 ♕g5 33 ♕d5+ 1-0 Ivanchuk-de Firmian, Reggio Emilia 1989.



18 ♗h3

18 ♘f5 fxe6 19 ♘xd6 (19 ♖xd6 ♕c7 20 ♘d5! exd5 21 ♖xf6 ♗xf5 22 ♖xf5 ♖xf5 23 ♕xf5 =) ♕e7 20 ♗h3 ♖d8 21 ♘xc8 ♖dxc8 22 ♘e2 ♖c6 23 ♘d4 ♖b6 = Engel-Ballmann, corr 1988.

18 ... g6

Not 18...♔h8 19 ♘d5 fxe6 20 ♗xe6 ♖a7 21 ♗f5 ♗xf5 22 exf5 ♕e8 23 ♘xf6 gxf6 24 ♕h6 ♖ff7 25 ♖g3

♕f8 26 ♕xf8+ ♖xf8 27 ♘e6 ± Derlich-Riedel, wom Bundesliga 1993.

19 ♘d5

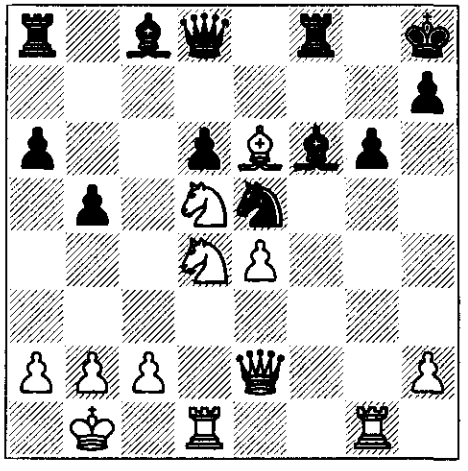
19 ♕e2 ♔h8 20 ♖gf1 (20 ♘d5 transposes to the main line) ♗g7 21 ♕g2 ♘c4 22 e5?! ♗xe6 23 ♗xe6 ♘e3 24 ♕e2 ♘xf1 25 ♗h3 ♘xh2 26 ♘c6 ♕h4 27 ♕xh2 dxe5 with a distinct advantage for Black, Matulović-Quinteros, Wijk aan Zee 1974.

19 ... ♔h8

20 ♕e2 fxe6

Or 20...♖a7 21 ♖gf1 fxe6 22 ♗xe6 ♗g7 23 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 24 ♘b6 ♗xe6 25 ♘xe6 ♕b8 26 ♘d5 ♕c8 27 ♕e3 ♖f7 28 ♘xg7 ♔xg7 = B.Jönsson-Nolsoe, Hafnarfjordur 1995.

21 ♗xe6 *(D)*



21 ... ♗h4

The alternatives are:

1) **21...♖e8** 22 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 23 h4 ♘c4 (alternatively 23...♗xh4 24 ♖h1 ♖b8 {24...♖c4?! 25 b3 ♖c8 26 ♕h2 g5 27 ♘f5 ♖e6? 28 ♕h3 ♖e8 29 ♘de7! 1-0 Groszpeter-Orso, Hungary Ch 1979} 25 ♕h2 g5 26 ♘f5 ♖b7 27 ♘de3 ♖d7 28 ♖d5 ♘f7 29 ♕g2 ♖g8 30 ♕d2 ± Guroff-Zoller, corr 1989) 24 h5 ♗xd4 25 ♖xd4 gxh5 26 ♕xh5 ♖g8 27 ♖dd1 ♕e8 28 ♖xg8+ ♕xg8 29 b3 ♘a3+ 30 ♔b2 ♘xc2 31 ♕h6 ± Mecking-Quinteros, Manila IZ 1976.

2) **21...♖a7!?** 22 ♘xf6 (22 ♕g2!?, intending ♕h3) ♖xf6 23 ♗d5 ♖e7 24 h4 (24 a3!?) ♕f8 25 a3? (25 ♕e3 =) ♗g4! 26 ♖xg4 ♖f2 27 ♖g2 ♖xe2 28 ♖xe2 h5 ∓ Psakhis-Cvitan, Geneva 1992.

22 ♖gf1

Or:

1) **22 ♖df1** ♖e8 23 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 24 ♕e3 ♖f8 25 ♘e6 ♖xf1+ 26 ♖xf1 ♕d7 27 ♘ec7 ♕g7, Goldberg-Hutschenreiter, corr 1989, 28 ♕h3! ±.

2) **22 ♖g2** ♖e8 23 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 24 ♕e3 ♗f6 25 h4 ♘c4 26 ♕h3 ♗xd4 27 ♖xd4 ♖f8 28 ♖d1 ♕e8 29 b3 ♘e5 30 h5 ♖f3 31 ♕h4 gxh5 32 ♘e7 ± Nyman-Gorski, corr 1981.

22 ... ♖e8

23 ♘f4

23 ♗f7 (spectacular but not good) ♗g4 24 ♗xe8 ♗xe2 25 ♖f8+ ♔g7 26 ♘e6+ ♔h6 27 ♘xd8 ♗xd1 28 ♘e6 ♗g4 29 ♘ec7 ♖c8 ∓ Wilke-Nagler, corr 1988.

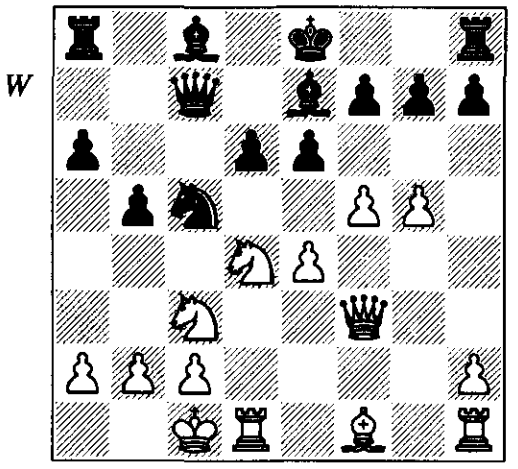
After 23 ♘f4 White has a slight advantage, for example 23...♗xe6 24 ♘fxe6 ♕d7 25 ♖f4 ♗d8 26 ♘xd8 ♖axd8 27 ♘f3 ♕g7 28 ♕f2 ♘xf3 29 ♕xf3 ± ♖f8? 30 ♖xd6! ± Bauer-Lehmann, corr 1987.

Although 13...♗xg5+ is theoretically adequate, it has never really caught on, perhaps because it results in positions offering few winning chances to Black.

B22)

13 ... ♘c5 *(D)*

Now White has two main possibilities, of which the second is currently critical:



B221: 14 h4
B222: 14 f6

Other moves are less frequently played. Line 2 deserves attention:

1) **14 fxe6** fxe6 15 ♗h3 b4 16 ♘ce2 ♗xg5+ 17 ♔b1 ♕f7? (17...♗f6 ∓) 18 e5 d5 19 ♕g2 ♗h6 20 ♖hf1 ♕g6 21 ♕f3 ♗d7 22 ♘g3 0-0-0 23 ♘b3 ♘e4 24 ♕d3 ♗b5 25 ♕d4 ∞ Mukhin-Danov, Irkutsk 1966.

2) **14 g6** hxg6 15 fxg6 fxg6 16 b4 ♘a4 17 ♘xa4 bxa4 18 e5 dxe5 19 ♗d3 ♗g5+ 20 ♔b1 ♗f4 21 ♕xa8 (21 ♘b5! axb5 22 ♗xb5+ and 23 ♕xa8 is better for White) exd4 22 ♗xg6+ ♔e7 23 ♖hf1 e5 24 ♕e4 ♕c4 25 ♖xf4 ♕xb4+ ½-½ Markzon-de Firmian, New York 1991. A lucky escape for de Firmian.

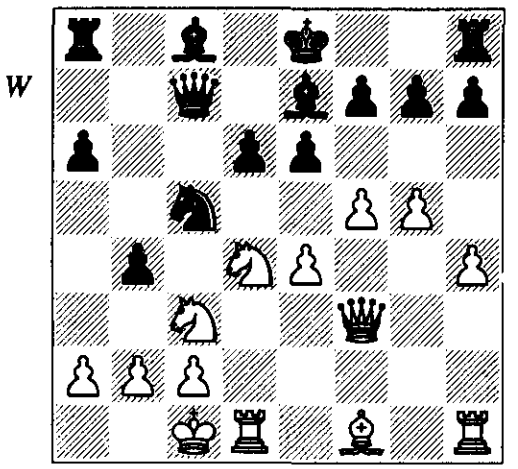
3) **14 b4?!** ♘a4 15 ♘xa4 bxa4 16 fxe6 ♗xg5+ 17 ♔b1 0-0 18 exf7+ ♖xf7 19 ♕d3 ♖b8 20 a3 ♗f6 21 ♖g1 ♔h8 22 ♕c4 ♗b7 23 ♘f5 ♗e5 ∓ Matulović-Masić, Vršac 1969.

4) **14 ♖g1!?** (this is worth a closer look) b4 15 ♘ce2 ♗b7 (15...e5 16 f6 exd4 17 fxe7 d3 18 cxd3 b3 19 axb3 ♘xd3+ 20 ♔b1 ♘e5 21 ♕c3 ♕xe7 22 ♕b4 ½-½ Boleslavsky-Aronin, USSR Ch 1957) 16 fxe6 (16 g6 hxg6 17 fxe6 f5? {17...♗f6} 18 ♕g3 0-0-0 19 exf5 g5?! 20 ♗g2 +– Pinkas-Kubikova, Trnava 1990) fxe6 17 ♘f4 0-0 18 ♘fxe6! ♘xe6 19 ♕b3 ♔h8 20 ♘xe6 ♕b6 21 ♘xf8 ♖xf8 22 ♕g3 +– Ueter-Spittler, Bundesliga 1988.

B221)

14 h4 b4 *(D)*

Or 14...♗d7 15 b4 (15 ♖d2 b4 16 ♘d1 g6 17 f6 ♗f8 18 h5 ♖g8 19 hxg6 ♖xg6 20 ♕e3 ± De Vries-Posch, corr 1990) ♘a4 16 ♘xa4 bxa4 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♗h3 ♕c4 19 ♖hf1 ♕xa2 20 ♕f7+ ♔d8 21 ♘xe6+ ♗xe6 22 ♕xe6 ♕xe6 23 ♗xe6 ± Kir.Georgiev-Grünfeld, Haifa Echt 1989.



There are two main responses to Black's pawn push:

B2211: 15 ♘ce2
B2212: 15 fxe6

Or **15 ♘b1?!** and now:

1) **15...e5** 16 ♘b3 ♗b7 (16...♘xe4 17 ♕xe4 ♗b7, attempting to emulate the main line, fails after 18 ♕c4! ♕xc4 19 ♗xc4 ♗xh1 20 ♖xh1 h6 21 g6 ± Westeras-Knjasewa, corr) 17 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 18 ♘d2 0-0-0 (18...♖c8 19 ♗c4 a5 20 ♕b3 ♖f8 21 ♖hg1 ±

Edelstein-Schuetze, corr 1986) 19 ♘b3 ♕c7 20 ♔b1 ♔b8 21 ♖g1 ♖dg8 22 ♗d3 h6 23 f6 gxf6 24 gxf6 ± Blazkowa-Kalikova, Czech Republic wom Ch 1995.

2) **15...♗b7** (this gives Black the advantage) 16 fxe6 fxe6 17 ♘d2 e5 (17...0-0-0 18 ♗h3 ±) 18 ♘f5 0-0 19 ♗c4+ ♔h8 20 g6 ♘xe4! (20...hxg6? 21 ♕g4! d5 22 ♘xe7 ♕xe7 23 exd5 ♖ad8 24 ♕g5! ♖fe8 25 ♘f3 ♖d6 26 h5 gxh5 27 ♕xh5+ ♖h6 28 ♕g6 1-0 Ljubojević-de Firmian, Wijk aan Zee 1986) 21 ♘xe4 (21 h5 h6! defends and 21 ♕h5 ♘f6 22 ♕h6 loses its appeal after 22...♗d8!) hxg6 22 ♗e6 ♖f6! 23 ♕g4 (23 ♖hg1? ♖xe6 24 ♖xg6 ♖xg6 25 ♕h5+ ♖h6 26 ♕f7, Ljubojević-Hodgson, Wijk aan Zee 1986, and now 26...♖g8! 27 ♘xe7 ♖c8! would have won for Black) ♖xe6 24 ♘fg3 (24 ♘d4 ♖f6 25 h5 g5 26 ♘xf6 ♗xh1 27 ♖xh1 ♗xf6 28 ♘e6 ♕e7 ∓) ♕c8! (24...♗xe4? 25 ♘xe4 ♕c8 {25...♖c8 26 ♖h2 ♕d7 27 ♘g5 ♗xg5 28 hxg5+ ♔g8 29 ♖f1 +−} 26 ♖df1 d5 27 h5 g5 28 ♘xg5 ♖f6 29 ♘f7+ ♔g8 30 ♕g6! ♕e6 31 ♘h6+ ♔h8 32 ♘f7+ ♔g8 = Hagen-Lehmann, corr 1989) 25 ♖h2 d5 26 ♘g5 (26 h5 g5 27 ♘xg5 ♖f6 28 ♕e2 ♕c7 29 ♖g2 e4 −+ Manduch-Vlasak, corr 1988) ♖c6 ∓ 27 ♕e2?! ♕c7 28 ♖d2 ♖f8 29 ♕e1 e4 30 ♖xd5? ♖c3! and Black is winning, Kubis-Vlasak, corr 1988.

B2211)

15 ♘ce2 e5

Black has a playable alternative in 15...♗b7 (15...♘xe4 16 fxe6 0-0 17 ♗h3 d5, Leroy-Telbis, corr 1981, 18 ♘f4 ±) 16 ♘g3 (16 fxe6 0-0 17 ♘g3 fxe6 18 ♕g4 ♔h8 19 ♔b1 ♖f2 ∓ Poli-Pacioni, corr 1986) d5 (16...e5 17 ♘b3 transposes to the next note) 17 fxe6 0-0 (17...fxe6 18 exd5 ♖f8 19 ♕h5+ g6 20 ♕xh7 ♕xg3 21 ♕xg6+ ♔d8 22 ♗h3 ♔c7 23 ♗xe6 ♗d6 24 ♔b1 ± Ljubojević-Browne, Manila 1976) 18 ♕g4 (18 exf7+ ♖xf7 19 ♘gf5 ♘xe4 20 ♗h3 ♔h8 21 ♕e3 ♗c5 22 h5 ♖af8 ∓ Collett-Namark, corr 1984) fxe6 19 ♘xe6 ♘xe6 20 ♕xe6+ ♔h8 21 exd5 ♖ae8 22 d6 ♕b6 23 ♕d7 ♗c6 24 dxe7 ♗xd7 25 exf8♕+ ♖xf8 26 ♖xd7 ♕e3+ 27 ♖d2 ♖d8 28 ♗d3 ♕xg3 29 ♖e2 a5 30 b3 g6 ½-½ Wedberg-de Firmian, Gausdal 1982.

16 ♘b3

16 f6 exd4 17 fxe7 d3! 18 cxd3! ♘xd3+ 19 ♔b1 ♘e5 is certainly not better for White, Geszosz-Bielczyk, Trzyncu 1970/1.

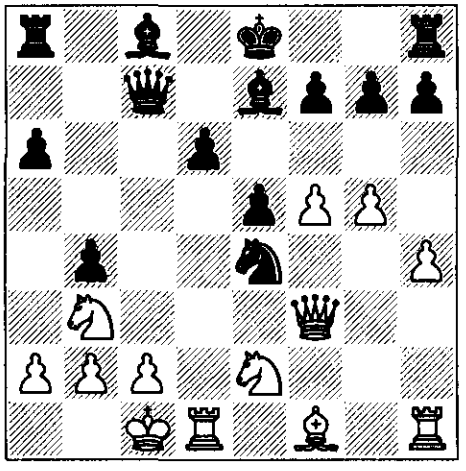
16 ... ♘xe4! *(D)*

This move effectively put the entire line out of commission for White. The alternative favours White, e.g.: **16...♗b7 17 ♘g3 ♖c8** (17...0-0-0 18 ♗c4! ♘xe4 19 ♗d5 ♘xg3 20 ♕xg3 ♔b8 21 ♖he1 ♖c8 22 ♕g2 ♗xd5 23 ♖xd5 ♕b6 24 ♖e4 ± Ljubojević-Portisch, Lucerne OL 1982) **18 ♖h2 d5** and now:

1) **19 ♘xc5** ♗xc5 20 exd5 0-0 21 ♗d3 ♕a5 22 ♔b1 ♗g1 23 f6 (23 ♖xg1 ♗xd5 24 ♕e3 ♕xa2+ 25 ♔c1, Polovodin-Azmaiparashvili, USSR 1980, and now 25...♖fd8 −+) g6 24 ♘f5 ♗xh2 (24...♖fe8 25 h5 gxf5 26 ♕xf5 e4 27 g6 ♕xd5 28 gxf7+ ♔xf7 29 ♕xh7+ ♔e6 30 ♖e2 +− Timmerman-Bauk, corr 1984) 25 ♘e7+ ♔h8 26 h5 ♖c7 27 hxg6 fxg6 28 ♕h3 ♗xd5 29 b3 ♖e8 30 ♕h6 ♖cxe7 31 fxe7 ♔g8 32 ♕xh2 ♖xe7 33 ♗xa6 ♕xa6 34 ♖xd5 ♕e6 35 ♖d1 ♖e8 36

♕d2 ♕e7 ½-½ Poli-Damele, corr 1986.

2) **19 f6!** gxf6 (19...♘xb3+ 20 axb3 gxf6 21 gxf6 dxe4 22 ♕g4 ♗c5 23 ♘f5 ♖d8 24 ♘g7+ ♔f8 25 ♘e6+ 1-0 Pähtz-Mikhalchishin, 1983) 20 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 (forced as 20...♗xc5 21 ♕xf6 wins) 21 gxf6 ♗f8 (21...dxe4 22 ♕g4 ♗d6 23 ♘f5 +–) 22 exd5 ♖d8 23 ♖e2 ♖xd5?! (but Black stood much worse in any case) 24 ♖xd5 ♕xd5 25 ♕h5 ♗d6 26 ♘f5 e4 27 ♖xe4+ 1-0 Timman-Ree, Arnhem-Amsterdam 1983.



17 ♕xe4

White has no promising line here. Accepting the sacrifice leads to a draw at best, but the alternative appears little better: 17 ♗g2 (but not 17 f6? ♗b7 18 fxe7 ♖c8 –+; 17 ♘g3? ♘xg3 18 ♕xa8 ♘xh1 19 ♗xa6 0-0 –+; 17 ♘d2 d5 18 ♘xe4 dxe4 19 ♕g4 ♗b7 20 ♖h2 0-0 21 f6 ♗c5 22 ♔b1 ♖fd8 ∓ Kustra-Surowiak, corr 1994) ♗b7 18 ♕e3 d5 (18...♘c3 19 ♗xb7 ♘xe2+ 20 ♕xe2 ♕xb7 21 ♖hf1 ♖c8 22 f6 gxf6 23 gxf6 ♗f8 24 ♘d2 ♕b5 25 ♕g4 ♕c6 26 ♕f5 ♕d7 27 ♕d3 ♕b5 28 ♕f5 ½-½ Sanakoev-Maeder, corr 1990) 19 ♗xe4 dxe4 20 ♘g3 a5 (20...♖c8 21 ♖h2 a5 22 ♔b1 {22 f6 probably transposes} a4 23 ♘c1 ♗c5 24 ♕e2 ♕c6 25 ♘h5 0-0 26 f6 g6 27 ♘g7 ♖fd8 –+ Hantusch-Kimpinsky, corr 1972) 21 f6 gxf6 22 gxf6 ♖c8 (not 22...♗f8? 23 ♘xe4 a4 24 ♘d4! exd4 25 ♖xd4 ♕e5 26 ♖e1 ♗d5 27 ♖xd5 ♕xd5 28 ♘g5+ ♔d7 29 ♖d1 +– Fercec-Koznjak, Pula 1995) 23 ♖h2 ♗f8 (23...♗xf6? 24 ♘h5 ♗e7 25 ♘g7+ ♔f8 26 ♘e6+! fxe6 27 ♕h6+ and White forces mate) 24 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 (24...a4 25 ♘d4 ♖d8 26 ♖hd2 exd4 27 ♘d6+ ♔d7 28 ♘xf7 ♗c5 29 ♘xh8 ♖xh8 30 ♖g1 ♔c6 ∓ Venni-Amoribello, corr 1991; 24...h5? 25 ♘g5 ♗h6 26 ♘d4 ♕c5 27 ♖e2 e4 28 ♕f4 +– Venni-Anelli, corr 1986) 25 ♕xe4 ♗h6+ 26 ♔b1 0-0 27 ♖g2+ ♔h8 28 ♖dg1 ♕c6 29 ♕xe5 (29 ♕f5 ♖fd8 30 ♖e2 {30 ♖g7? ♗xg7 31 ♖xg7 ♖d1+ 32 ♘c1 ♖xc1+ 33 ♔xc1 ♕h1+ 34 ♔d2 ♖d8+ 35 ♔e3 ♕e1+ 36 ♔f3 ♕f1+ 37 ♔g4 ♖d4+ –+} ♗f4 31 ♘c1 ♖g8 32 ♖g7 ♖xg7 33 fxg7+ ♔g8! 34 ♘d3 ♖d8 ∓ 35 a3? bxa3 36 ♘xe5 a2+ 0-1 Wedberg-de Firmian, Oslo 1984) ♖fe8 30 ♕g3 a4 31 ♘c1 ♕xf6 32 ♖f2 ♕d4 33 ♕f3 a3 34 ♘d3 ♗e3 35 ♖g4 ♗xf2 36 ♖xd4 ♗xd4 37 ♕xf7 axb2 38 ♕f3 ♖cd8 39 ♕h1 ♖g8 0-1 Hubers-Hotting, corr 1990.

17 ... ♗b7
18 ♖d5 ♖c8
19 c3

Not 19 ♔b1? ♗xd5 20 ♕xd5 ♕xc2+ 21 ♔b1 0-0 and White can hardly move a thing; Black will win the pawn on f5 and gain a substantial material plus. After 19 ♘a1 ♕c4 20 ♕xc4 ♖xc4 21 ♗g2 ♗xd5 22 ♖xd5 ♖xh4 23 ♖g1 Black had an even better position than in the main

variation, Smart-Winslow, London 1985.

19 ... ♕c4
20 ♕xc4 ♖xc4
21 ♗g2 ♗xd5

Other moves:

1) **21...♖xh4?** 22 ♖xh4 ♗xg5+ (not 22...♗xd5? 23 ♖g4! ±) 23 ♔c2 ♗xd5 24 ♖g4 ♗xg2 25 ♖xg2 ± Dimitrović-Klaić, corr 1979.

2) **21...bxc3** 22 ♔c2 (22 ♘xc3 ♖g4 23 ♗f3 ♗xd5 24 ♘xd5 ♖xh4 25 ♖g1 ♗d8 26 ♘d2 ♖d4 ∓ Westphal-Born, corr 1975) cxb2+ 23 ♔xb2 ♖g4 24 ♗f3 ♗xd5 25 ♗xd5 h6 26 ♗f3 ♖c4 27 ♗d5 ♖g4 28 ♗f3 ♖b4 with just a faint edge for Black, Hiller-Vokler, corr 1991.

22 ♗xd5 ♖xh4
23 ♖g1

Or 23 ♖xh4 ♗xg5+ 24 ♘d2 ♗xh4 25 cxb4 ♔e7 26 ♘c3 ♗g5 27 ♘e4 ♗f4 28 ♔c2 ♖b8 29 ♔b3 ♗xd2 30 ♘xd2 g6 31 fxg6 hxg6 and the tidal wave of passed pawns proved too much for White's minor pieces, Mokry-Ftačnik, 1983.

23 ... bxc3

23...♖h2 24 ♗c4 (or 24 ♔d1 bxc3 25 ♘xc3 ♖xb2 26 ♗c6+ ♔f8 27 ♖g4 a5 28 ♗d5 ♗d8 29 ♖c4 and by now White had good counterplay, Ferec-Cvitan, Yugoslavia 1985) h6 25 gxh6 ♖8xh6 26 ♗xa6 d5 27 ♗b5+ ♔f8 28 cxb4 ♗xb4 with an unclear position, as in Petri-Adler, corr 1989.

24 ♘xc3 ♖f4
25 ♗c6+ ♔f8
26 ♗e4 h5!

This ending favours Black. In Nunn-Browne, Gjøvik 1983, White managed to draw after long and patient defence.

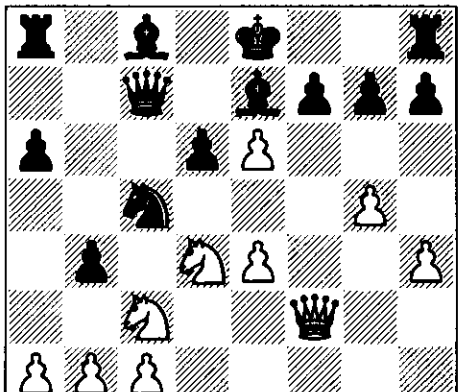
It may be that White should hold these endings, but the general verdict on 15 ♘ce2 is a firm thumbs-down.

B2212)

15 fxe6 *(D)*

This line represents an important new development in the 14 h4 variation. Accepting the piece appears very dangerous for Black, while if Black just recaptures on e6 then White can play ♘ce2-g3, but without the tactical problems associated with the immediate 15 ♘ce2. However, the defect of the early exchange on e6 is that Black can develop his kingside more easily, and this ensures him a satisfactory position.

B



15 ... fxe6

Or **15...bxc3** (15...♗xe6?! 16 ♘d5 ♗xd5 17 exd5 0-0 18 ♘c6 a5 19 ♖e1 ♗d8 20 ♗h3 ± Bertolucci-Baldocchi, corr 1987) and now:

1) **16 ♕xf7+** ♔d8 17 e5!? d5! (17...cxb2+ 18 ♔b1 ♘a4 19 ♖h3 ♗b7 20 exd6! +– d'Adamo-Foenander, corr 1990) 18 ♘f5 cxb2+ 19 ♔b1 ♗b7 20 ♗g2 ♘a4 21 ♖d4 ♖c8 22 ♖c4 ♖f8 23 ♖xc7 ♖xc7 24 ♕xg7 ♖xf5 25 ♕xh7 ♘c3+ 0-1 Nataf-Agnos, Cannes 1993.

2) **16 exf7+** with another branch:

2a) **16...♔d8** 17 ♕xc3 ♗d7 (or 17...♗g4 18 ♗h3! ♗xh3 19 ♖xh3 ♔c8 20 ♕c4 ♖b8 21 ♖c3 ± Sanchez Almeyra-Galiana, Palma de Mallorca 1992) 18 ♗h3 ♖f8 19 ♗xd7 ♕xd7 20 ♖hf1 ♕a4 21 ♖f5 ♔d7 22 ♖xc5 dxc5, Sanchez Almeyra-Suchorukow, Berlin 1990, 23 ♘f3+! ♔c8 24 ♕e5 ♖a7 25 ♕e6+ ♔b8 26 ♘e5 +–.

2b) **16...♔f8** 17 ♕xc3 and now:

2b1) **17...♔xf7** 18 ♗c4+ ♔e8 19 e5 ♘e4 20 ♗b5+ ♔d8 21 ♘c6+ ♔d7 22 e6+ ♔e8 23 ♘xe7+ +– Medvegy-Sleisz, Hungary Cht 1995.

2b2) **17...♕b6** 18 ♗h3 ♘xe4 19 ♕f3 d5 20 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 21 ♕f5 ♗xg5+ 22 hxg5 ♖b8 23 b3 ♕d6, Tseitlin-Malishauskas, Moscow 1989, and now 24 ♘e2 g6 25 ♕xd5 ♕xd5 26 ♖xd5 ♔xf7 27 c4 +–.

2b3) **17...♖a7** 18 ♘f5 (18 ♗h3 ♘xe4 {but not 18...♗xh3? 19 ♖xh3 ♔xf7 20 b4 ♘d7 21 ♕b3+ ♔e8 22 ♖c3 ♕b7 23 ♕e6 +–} 19 ♕xc7 ♖xc7 20 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 21 ♖hf1, Pavoni-Anelli, corr 1992, 21...♘xg5! 22 hxg5 ♗xg5+ 23 ♔b1 ♗f6 ∓) is also dangerous, e.g. 18...♗xf5 19 exf5 ♘d7 20 ♕d4 ♘e5 21 ♖h3! ♕c5 22 ♕e4 ♕c6 23 ♕xc6 ♘xc6 24 f6 gxf6 25 gxf6 ♗xf6 26 ♖xd6 ±.

16 ♘ce2

16 ♘d5 exd5 17 exd5 ♗d7 18 ♖e1 ♖c8 19 ♖h2 ♔d8 20 ♖he2 ♖f8 21 ♕g3 ♖f7 22 g6 hxg6 23 ♕xg6 ♖xf1? (23...♗e8 ∞) 24 ♖xf1 ♕b7 25 ♖xe7 +– Amrein-Czegledi, Zalakaros 1995.

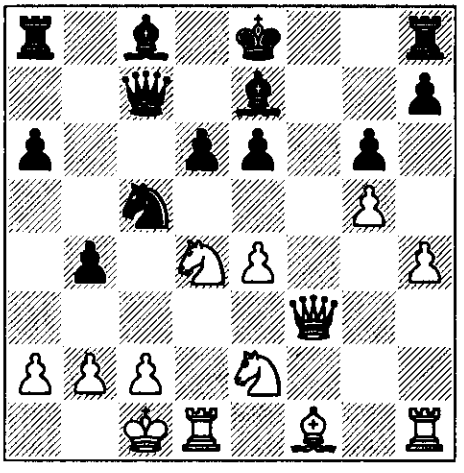
16 ... g6 *(D)*

Or:

1) **16...♗b7** (leaves e6 weak) 17 ♘g3 (17 ♗h3 ♗xe4 18 ♘xe6 seems bad after 18...♕c6! 19 ♘xg7+ ♔d8 20 ♕e3 ♗xh1 21 ♕xc5 ♕xc5 22 ♘e6+ ♔e8 23 ♘xc5 ♗f3! ∓) g6 18 ♗h3 ♖f8 19 ♕e3 ♗c8 20 e5 d5 21 ♖hf1 ♗d7 22 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 23 ♔b1 ± Butze-Falke, corr 1977.

2) **16...e5** (playable) 17 ♘f5 0-0 (17...♗xf5 18 exf5 0-0 19 ♖g1 ♖fc8 20 ♘g3 ±) 18 ♘eg3 (18 g6 hxg6 19 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 20 ♕e3 ♗e6 21 h5 g5 ∓ Playa-Michelakis, Buenos Aires jr Wch 1992) ♗e6 19 ♔b1 ♔h8 20 ♕e3 ♘xe4, Galow-Zoltai, corr 1986, 21 ♕xe4 d5 22 ♖xd5 ♗xd5 23 ♕xd5 ♖ad8 24 ♕f3 g6 25 ♗d3 ∞.

3) **16...♖f8** 17 ♕h5+ ♖f7 18 ♕xh7 (18 g6 hxg6 19 ♕xg6 e5 20 ♘f5 ♗xf5 21 exf5 ♖c8 ∓ Haas-Tenev, corr 1984) ♗b7 19 ♘g3 d5 20 ♘h5 0-0-0 21 ♘xe6! ± Sanchez Almeyra-Kamber, Chiasso 1990.



17 ♗h3

The best move is far from clear, but none of the possibilities looks very tempting for White:

1) **17 ♘f4** ♖f8 18 ♗g2 ♖xf4 19 ♕xf4 e5 20 ♕e3 exd4 21 ♕xd4 ♗e6 22 ♕h8+ ♗f8 23 ♖hf1 ♕g7 24 ♕xg7 ♗xg7 25 e5 0-0-0 26 exd6 ♗e5 ∓ de Firmian-Browne, USA Ch 1983.

2) **17 h5** ♖f8!? 18 ♕e3 e5 19 ♘b3 ♗e6 is untested, but Black is at least equal.

3) **17 ♔b1** ♗b7 18 ♘g3 ♖f8 19 ♕e3 e5 20 ♘b3 ♘e6 21 ♖h2 a5 22 ♗b5+ ♗c6 23 ♗c4 ♗d7 24 ♗d5 ♖c8 25 c4!? ♘f4 26 ♖c2 ♗d8 ∓ Shabalov-de Firmian, Philadelphia 1993.

17 ... e5
18 ♘b3 ♖f8
19 ♕e3

Black has completed his development without incurring any serious weakness and has a very comfortable position. He may try:

1) **19...♘a4!?** 20 ♖hf1 ♖xf1 21 ♖xf1 ♕c4! 22 ♗g2?! (22 ♖f3 ♗xh3 {22...d5!?} 23 ♖xh3 ♖c8 24 ♕d3 ∞) a5 23 ♔b1 ♗e6 24 ♘ec1 ♕b5 25 ♖f2 ♘b6 26 ♘d2 a4 ∓ Kolmann-Ferens, corr 1991.

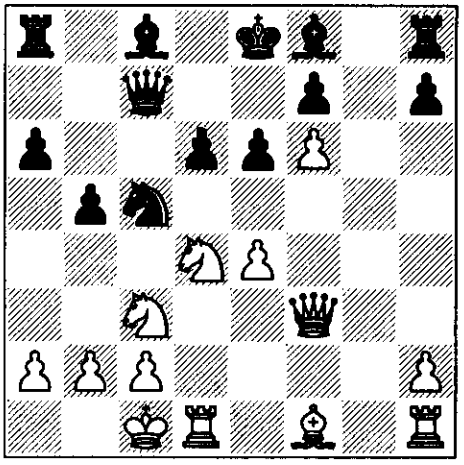
2) **19...♗xh3** 20 ♖xh3 (20 ♕xh3 ♖c8 21 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 22 ♕d3 ♖f3 23 ♕d2 ♕c4 24 ♔b1 ♖f2 25 ♖he1 ♕xe4 26 ♔a1 ♖xc2 0-1 Hechler-Born, corr 1975) ♖c8 21 ♘xc5?! (21 c3 ♘xb3+ 22 axb3 bxc3 23 bxc3 {23 ♘xc3 ♕b7 24 ♔c2 ♖f4 ∓} ♖b8 24 ♔c2 ♕b7 25 c4 a5 26 ♖a1 ♗d8 27 ♖f3 ♖f7 28 ♖af1 ♖xf3 29 ♕xf3 ∞ Rehn-Anttonen, corr 1972.

B222)

14 f6 gxf6

Not 14...♗f8? 15 ♗xb5+ ♗d7 (15...axb5 16 ♘dxb5 ♕d7 17 fxg7 ♗xg7 18 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 19 ♖hf1 +–) 16 e5 d5 17 ♘f5! g6 (17...gxf6 18 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 19 exd6 ♕xd6 20 ♘xd5 1-0 Bures-Sorsak, corr 1985; 17...♗xb5 18 fxg7 +–) 18 ♘xd5! exd5 19 ♕xd5 ♖d8 20 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 21 exd6 ♕c8 22 ♖he1+ ♔f8 23 ♗xd7 ♖xd7 24 ♕c4 ♖d8 25 d7 ♕c7 26 ♖e7 ♘e6 27 ♕b4 +–.

15 gxf6 ♗f8 *(D)*



This is one of the most important positions for the assessment of the Najdorf. White now has a major decision to make. The strategic outline of the position is clear enough: Black has all the long-term positional advantages, against which is balanced White's lead in development and short-term attacking prospects. In particular, White faces the immediate problem of what he is going to do after Black's imminent ...b4. Of course, White can simply prevent ...b4 with 16 a3, but this involves some loss of attacking momentum. Nevertheless, this is a reasonable move which is probably underestimated by theory. The second main move is the sacrificial 16 ♘f5, which gives Black no time for ...b4. Unfortunately, the sacrifice isn't really correct. The remaining three moves all aim to improve White's position to the extent that he can meet ...b4 by ♘d5. However, 16 ♗h3 doesn't really succeed in this ambition and it turns out that the ♘d5 offer is still mostly harmless. 16 ♕h5 is a better

try in this respect, in that now ...b4 may be reasonably met by ♘d5; the down side is that moving the queen again involves a certain loss of time and Black is able to complete his development in safety.

All this brings us to the most popular (and best) move, Perenyi's 16 ♖g1. This improves White's position by moving the rook to the open file, preventing Black doing likewise, and setting up tactical ideas based on ♖g7. The resulting positions are amazingly sharp and double-edged. Despite many years of investigation, the final verdict still proves elusive.

B2221: 16 a3
B2222: 16 ♘f5
B2223: 16 ♗h3
B2224: 16 ♕h5
B2225: 16 ♖g1

We may dismiss 16 ♕e3 h5 17 ♔b1 ♗b7 18 ♖g1 0-0-0 19 ♗h3 ♔b8 20 b4 ♗h6 21 ♕f3 ♘d7 ∓ Lambers-Posch, corr 1989 and 16 ♕g3 ♗d7 (16...b4!) 17 a3 h5 18 h4 0-0-0 19 ♔b1 ♔b8 20 ♗e2 is equal, Toothill-Sanakoev, corr 1992.

B2221)

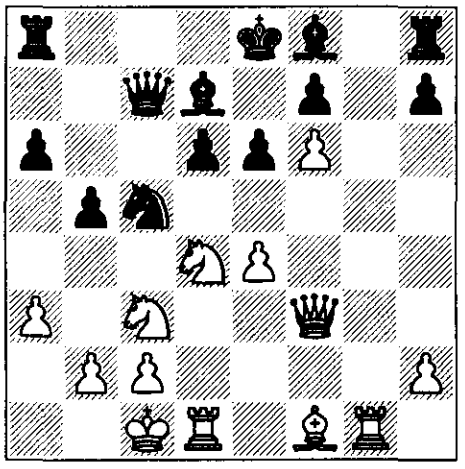
16 a3 ♗d7

Black should keep open the chance to castle, e.g. 16...♖b8 17 b4! (17 ♗h3 b4 18 axb4 ♖xb4 19 ♖he1 ♕b6 20 ♘d5 ♗h6+ 21 ♔b1 ♖xb2+ 22 ♔a1 exd5 23 exd5+ ♔f8 24 ♕e2 ♖b1+! 25 ♖xb1 ♕a5+ 26 ♔b2 ♕b4+ is a draw) ♘a4 18 ♘xa4 bxa4 19 ♖g1! (not 19 ♔b2? ♖g8 and Black seizes the important open file) a5 (19...h5 20 ♔b2 ♖h6 21 ♖g8 ♖g6 22 ♖h8 ±; 19...e5 20 ♘f5 ♗xf5 21 ♕xf5 a5 22 b5 ♗h6+ 23 ♔b2 ♗e3 24 ♖g3 ± Corkett-May, corr 1985) 20 ♕h5 ♗d7 21 ♖g7! ♗xg7 22 fxg7 ♖g8 23 ♘b5 ♖xb5 24 ♕xh7 ♖xg7 25 ♕xg7 ♖e5 26 ♖d3 ± Berg-Zinman, corr 1982.

17 ♕h5

Or **17 ♖g1** *(D)* (17 b4 ♘a4 18 ♘xa4 bxa4 19 ♖g1 a5 20 b5 ♕c5 21 ♗e2 ♖c8 22 ♕d3 ♗h6+ 23 ♔b2 ♗f4 24 ♔b1? {24 ♘f3 is equal} ♗e5 ∓ Fahys-Robeson, corr 1987; note that the position after 17 ♖g1 can also arise via the move-order 16 ♖g1 ♗d7 17 a3) and now:

B



1) **17...♕b6** 18 ♕h5 0-0-0 19 ♖g3 ♗e8 20 ♗h3 ♔b8 21 b4 ♘a4 22 ♘xa4 bxa4 23 ♘e2 ♕b5 24 ♖g5 ♗h6 25 ♕xh6 ♕xe2 26 ♗f1 ♕xe4 27 ♗xa6 ± Brodsky-Ginsburg, Nikolaev Z 1993.

2) **17...0-0-0** 18 ♔b1 (for 18 ♕h5 see the note to White's 18th below) ♔b8 19 ♗g2 e5 20 ♘d5 ♕b7 21 ♘f5 ♗c6, Gaida-Surowiak, corr 1992, 22 ♕e3 ±.

3) **17...h5!** and now:

3a) **18 ♖g7** ♖c8 (18...♕b7 19 b4 ♘a4 20 ♘xa4 bxa4 21 ♗c4 ♗xg7 22 fxg7 ♖g8 23 ♖f1! 0-0-0 {23...♖xg7

24 ♕f6 ♖h7 25 ♖g1 ♔f8 26 ♘f5 +−} 24 ♕c3 ♔b8 25 ♖xf7 ♕xe4 26 ♘xe6 ♖c8 27 ♘c5 dxc5 28 ♖xd7 ±) 19 ♘d5 (19 b4 ♘b3+ is equal; 19 ♗h3?! ♕d8! 20 ♖dg1 ♖h6 21 b4 ♕xf6! 22 ♕xf6 ♖xf6 23 bxc5 ♗xg7 24 ♖xg7 ♖xc5 25 ♔b2 ♖f2 ∓ G.Andersson-Sanakoev, corr 1988) exd5 (19...♕b7 is a complete mess; the tempting line 20 ♖e1 exd5 21 exd5+ ♔d8 22 ♖xf7 fails to 22...♗g4 −+, but 20 ♘e7!?, for example, is totally unclear) 20 exd5 and now:

3a1) **20...♗g4** 21 ♕e3+ ♘e6 (or 21...♔d8 22 ♘c6+ +−) 22 dxe6 ♗xe6 (22...♗xg7 23 fxg7 ♖g8 24 exf7+ ♔xf7 25 ♕f4+ ♔xg7 26 h3 ±) 23 ♗h3 ♕c4 24 ♖xf7 ♗h6 25 ♖e7+ ♔f8 26 ♘xe6+ 1-0 Zontakh-Jedlicka, Litomysl 1994.

3a2) **20...♕b6** 21 ♖e1+ ♔d8 22 ♖xf7 b4 23 ♘e6+ ♗xe6 24 dxe6 +− Manduch-Namark, corr 1991.

3a3) **20...♕b7!?** 21 ♖e1+ ♔d8 22 ♖xf7 ♗g4! is good for Black, as mentioned above under 19...♕b7, but of course White has many other possibilities.

3b) **18 ♔b1** ♖b8 19 ♖g5 b4 20 axb4 ♖xb4 21 ♖xh5 ♖xh5 22 ♕xh5 ♕b6 23 b3 ♘xb3 24 cxb3 ♖xd4 ∓ Efimov-Zilbershtein, Kiev 1989.

3c) **18 ♗h3** and now:

3c1) **18...♕a5?** 19 e5 d5 20 ♘xd5 exd5 21 ♗xd7+ ♘xd7 22 ♕xd5 0-0-0 23 ♕a8+ ♘b8 24 ♕xb8+ +−.

3c2) **18...♕b6?** 19 e5 d5 20 ♘xd5 exd5 21 ♗xd7+ ♘xd7 22 ♕xd5 ♖c8 23 e6 fxe6 24 ♖ge1 +−.

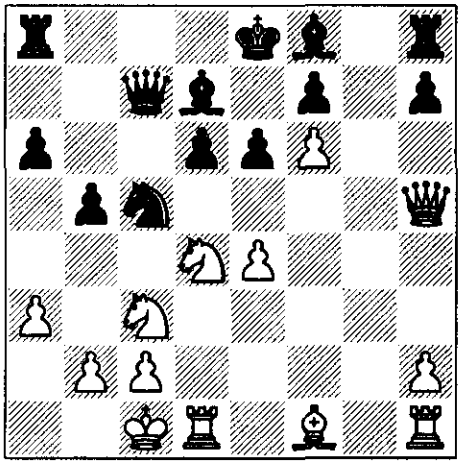
3c3) **18...♕b7!?** 19 ♗g2 ∞.

3c4) **18...♖c8** 19 ♖g2 ♕b7 20 b4!? ♘a4 21 ♘xa4 bxa4 22 ♔b2 a5 23 c3 axb4 24 cxb4 d5? (24...♕b6!? ±) 25 exd5 ♗xb4 26 axb4 ♕xb4+ 27 ♔a1 ♖c3 28 ♕f4! ♖xh3 29 ♖b2 +− Strautinš-Camilleri, corr 1993.

3c5) **18...♖b8** 19 ♖de1 b4 20 ♘d5 exd5 21 exd5+ ♔d8 22 ♗xd7 ♘xd7 23 ♘c6+ ♔c8 24 ♘xb8 ♔xb8 25 axb4 = Turlej-Gaida, corr 1992.

3c6) **18...♘a4** 19 ♘xa4 (19 ♘d5 exd5 20 exd5 0-0-0 21 ♘e6 appears inadequate after 21...fxe6 22 dxe6 ♘b6) bxa4 20 e5 ♖b8 (20...♖c8 21 exd6 ♗xd6 22 ♔b1 ♗e5 23 c3 ♖b8 24 ♖g2 ♕c5 25 ♔a1 ± Zapata-Grünfeld, Palma 1989) 21 ♗xe6 ♗xe6 22 ♘xe6 fxe6 23 exd6 ♕b6! 24 f7+ (24 d7+ ♔d8 25 ♕c3 ♗h6+ 26 ♔b1 ♗d2 27 ♕e5 ♗f4 28 ♕c3 ♗d2 = is an amusing line, although Black could play for a win by 28...♕c7) ♔d7 25 ♕c3 ♖h7 26 ♖df1 h4 27 ♖g6 ♖h5 28 ♖e1 ♖f5 29 ♖gxe6 ♖xf7 30 ♖f6 ♖xf6 31 ♕xf6 ♗xd6 32 ♕f7+ ♔c6 33 ♕f3+ ♔c7 ½-½ Van Willigen-Jordan, corr 1991.

We return to the main line after 17 ♕h5 *(D)*:



B

17 ... 0-0-0

This has been most frequently played, but there are other reasonable moves (this is particularly relevant in view of the note to White's 20th move below):

1) **17...♖g8** 18 ♕xh7 ♖g6 19 ♕h4 0-0-0 20 ♔b1 ♗h6 21 ♘f3 ♗c6 22 ♗h3 ♔b7 23 ♖hg1 ♖dg8 24 ♖xg6 (24 b4 ♘a4 25 ♘xa4 bxa4 26 ♖xg6 ♖xg6 27 ♗f1 ♗e3 ½-½ Matulović-Bukić, Uljma 1976) ♖xg6 25 ♖g1 ♖xg1+ 26 ♘xg1 ♗d2 27 ♘ge2 a5 28 ♗g2 b4 29 axb4 axb4 30 ♘d1 ± Bassoli-Gatto, corr 1977.

2) **17...♕a5** (threatening 18...b4 followed by 19...♘b3+) and now:

2a) **18 ♘b3** ♘xb3+ 19 cxb3 ♖c8 20 b4 ♖xc3+ (20...♕b6 21 ♔b1 ♖g8 22 ♕xh7 ♖g6 23 ♕h4 ♖h6 24 ♕f4 ♕d8 25 ♗e2 ♕xf6 ∓ Matulović-de Firmian, Niš 1981) 21 bxc3 ♕xa3+ 22 ♔d2 ♖g8 23 ♕f3 ♗c6 24 ♔e1 ♖g5 25 h4 ♗xe4 26 ♕xe4 ♕xc3+ 0-1 H.Sørensen-Maeder, corr 1978.

2b) **18 ♗e2** b4 (18...♖b8 may be possible, but ...b4 is the most natural) 19 axb4 ♕xb4 20 ♖hf1 ♖b8 (ignoring the threat is best) 21 ♕xf7+! ♔d8! 22 ♘b3 a5 (22...♗e8 23 ♕a7 ♖b7 24 ♕a8+ ♖b8 25 ♕xb8+! ♕xb8 26 ♘xc5 ±; 22...♘xb3+ 23 cxb3 ♕xb3 24 ♖d2 a5 ∞) 23 ♕h5 (23 e5? a4 ∓ Olim-Browne, Las Vegas 1986) ♘xb3+ (23...a4 24 ♘xc5 dxc5 25 ♖xd7+ ♔xd7 26 ♕f7+ +–) 24 cxb3 a4 25 ♔d2! ♕xb3 26 ♕a5+ ♕b6 27 ♕xb6+ ♖xb6 28 ♔c2 ♗h6, Ernst-de Firmian, New York, 1990, 29 e5! with a clear advantage for White.

3) **17...♖b8** 18 ♖g1 b4 19 axb4 ♖xb4 20 ♖g7 ♗c8 21 ♘f5 (this position looks very unpleasant for Black, but play soon becomes confused; it really doesn't have much relevance for the opening, but I can't resist giving the continuation of this crazy game!) d5 (21...♘a4 22 ♘h6 ♖xb2 23 ♘xf7 ♖xc2+ 24 ♔b1 ♘xc3+ 25 ♔xc2 ♘d5+! is a draw) 22 e5 ♕xe5 23 ♕xf7+ ♔d8 24 ♖xh7 ♕f4+ 25 ♔b1 ♖xb2+ 26 ♔a1 (26 ♔xb2 ♕b4+ 27 ♔c1 ♘b3+ is a draw) ♖b7 27 ♘e7 ♕c7 28 ♗b5 (exclamation marks may be distributed by the reader) ♖xb5 29 ♘xb5 ♕a5+ 30 ♔b1 ♕xb5+ 31 ♔c1 ♗h6+ 32 ♖xh6 ♖xh6, de Firmian-Youngworth, Lone Pine 1980, and now 33 ♘c6+ ♕xc6 34 ♕e7# is quickest.

18 ♕xf7

White has tried quite a wide range of alternatives:

1) **18 ♔b1** ♗e8 19 ♖g1 and now:

1a) **19...♕b6** 20 ♗h3 ♔b8 21 ♗xe6 fxe6 22 f7 ♗xf7 23 ♕xf7 ♕c7 24 ♕xc7+ ♔xc7 25 b4 e5 26 ♘dxb5+ axb5 27 bxc5 ± Ripoll-Rodriguez, corr 1987.

1b) **19...♕b7** 20 ♗d3 b4 21 axb4 ♕xb4 22 ♘b3 ♔c7 23 ♘xc5 dxc5 24 ♗xa6 ♖a8 25 ♗e2 ♕a5 26 ♔c1 ♕a1+ 27 ♘b1 ♖a2 28 ♕e5+ ♔b7 29 ♖g7! ♗xg7 30 fxg7 ♖g8 31 ♗c4 ± De Reu-Ostling, corr 1983.

1c) **19...♔b8** (this is the most natural line) 20 ♗h3 (20 ♖g3 ♖c8 21 b4 ♘d7 22 ♘xe6 fxe6 23 f7 ♗e7 24 fxe8♕ ♖hxe8 25 ♗xb5 axb5 26 ♕xb5+ ∓ ½-½ Matanović-Hohler, Bath Echt 1973) ♖c8 21 ♕f3 ♗d7 22 ♖g3 h5 23 ♗g2 ♘a4 24 ♘xa4 bxa4 25 e5 d5 26 ♗f1 ♔a7 27 ♕e2 ♕b6 28 ♔a1 ± Garcia-Capdevila, corr 1988.

2) **18 ♖g1** ♗e8 19 ♖g3 ♕b7 20 ♗g2 ♘d7 21 e5 d5 22 ♘xe6 fxe6 23 f7 ♗xf7 24 ♕xf7 ♗h6+? (24...♘c5 ±) 25 ♔b1 ♘c5 26 ♕f6 +– Schäfer-Derlich, Dortmund 1989.

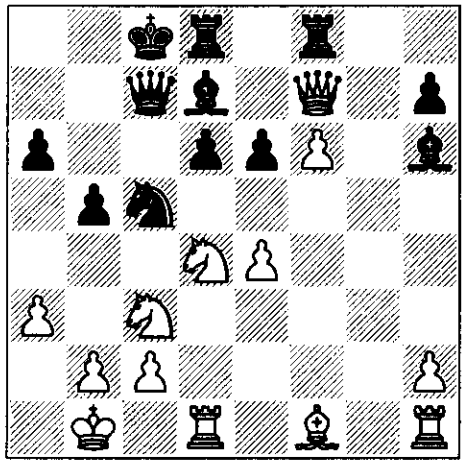
3) **18 ♘f3** ♗c6 19 ♘g5 h6 20 ♗h3 hxg5 21 ♕xh8 ♘xe4 22 ♘d5 ♗xd5 23 ♖xd5 ♔b7 24 ♖d4 d5 ∓ De Haan-Houthuijzen, corr 1984.

4) **18 b4?!** ♘b3+ (18...♘b7 19 ♔b2 ♗e8 20 ♗h3 ♔b8 21 ♖hf1 ♕b6 22 ♖f3 a5 23 ♗f1 axb4 24 axb4 d5 25 exd5 ♗xb4 26 dxe6, Matulović-Bogdanović, Sarajevo 1971, 26...♖xd4 27 ♕e5+ ♖d6 28 ♘e4 ♕c7 ∓) 19 cxb3 (19 ♔b2 ♘xd4 20 ♖xd4 ♔b8 21 ♗h3 ♖c8 22 ♖d3 ♗c6 23 ♖c1 ♖g8 24 ♘d5 exd5 25 ♗xc8 dxe4 26 ♖c3 ♕xc8 ∓ Matulović-Zuckerman, Vrnjačka Banja 1971) ♕xc3+ 20 ♔b1 ♔b8 21 ♖d3 ♕e1+ 22 ♕d1 (22 ♔b2 ♕xe4 23 ♕f3 ♕xf3 ∓) ♕xe4 23 ♖g1 ♕h4 24 ♕f3 d5 25 h3 ♖c8 26 ♔b2 e5 27 ♕xd5 cxd4 28 ♖gg3 ♕f4 0-1 Arnhold-Stolle, corr 1982.

18 ... ♗h6+

19 ♔b1 ♖hf8 *(D)*

Black must keep the d6-pawn covered: after 19...♖df8 20 ♕h5 ♖xf6 21 ♗xb5 axb5 22 ♘dxb5 ♗xb5 23 ♘xb5 White has a decisive advantage, Meizer-Krabbé, corr 1985.



20 ♕h5

Rather surprisingly, nobody has tried the critical line 20 ♕xh7 ♖xf6 21 ♕e7 ♖ff8 (21...♖f2 22 ♗h3! and White has the advantage) 22 b4! ♖de8 (22...♘b7 23 ♘cxb5!) 23 ♕h4 ♗g7 24 bxc5 ♕xc5 25 ♘ce2 ♕xa3 26 ♕g3 with inadequate compensation for Black.

20 ... ♖xf6

and now:

1) **21 ♗h3** ♔b8 (21...♖df8 22 ♖hf1 ♖xf1 23 ♖xf1 ♖xf1+ 24 ♗xf1 ♗g7 25 ♘de2 ♕d8 26 ♕xh7 ♕f8 = Ribli-Bukić, Debrecen 1970) 22 e5 dxe5 23 ♘b3 ♘xb3 24 cxb3 ♗c6 25 ♖xd8+ ♕xd8 26 ♕xe5+ ♔b7 27 ♖d1 ♗f4 28 ♕e2 ♕g8 = Grottke-Reinke, corr 1985.

2) **21 ♕h4!?** ♖g6 (it is not so easy to suggest a good move, e.g. 21...♗g7 22 ♘f5! or 21...♖df8 22 ♗xb5 axb5 23 ♘dxb5 ♗xb5 24 ♘xb5 ♕b6 25 ♘xd6+ ♔b8 26 e5 ♖g6 27 ♖d4 ±) 22 ♘f5! ♗g5 (22...exf5 23 ♘d5 ♕b7 24 ♘e7+ ♔c7 25 ♘xg6 ♕xe4 26 ♕xh6 {26 ♗h3 is also good} ♕xh1 27 ♘f4 ±) 23 ♕xh7 ♗e8 24 ♕xc7+ ♔xc7 25 ♘d4 ± Delaune-Potter, USA 1982.

B2222)

16 ♘f5!?

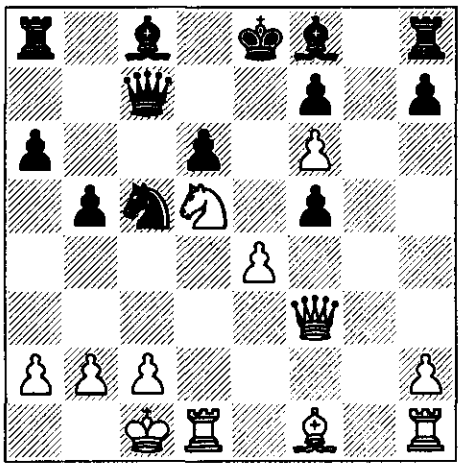
This move has been played infrequently. Although White has not done badly in practice, his position after 17...♕a5! in the main line does not inspire confidence.

16 ... exf5

Black can also play 16...b4 (after 16...♗b7 17 ♘g7+ ♔d8 18 a3 Black loses the right to castle and has his kingside pieces blocked in) 17 ♘g7+ (17 ♗b5+ ♘d7 18 e5 ♗b7 19 ♗xd7+ ♔xd7 20 ♘e4 ♖c8, Oosterhoff-Thierry, corr 1993, 21 ♘d4! ∞) ♗xg7 18 fxg7 ♖g8 19 ♗b5+ ♗d7 20 ♗xd7+ (20 e5 d5 21 ♗xd7+ ♘xd7 22 ♖xd5 bxc3 {22...♕c6!} 23 ♖f1 cxb2+ {23...0-0-0 24 ♖d6 cxb2+ 25 ♔b1 ♘xe5 26 ♕a8+ ♕b8 27

♕xa6+ ♕b7 28 ♖xd8+ ♖xd8 29 ♕a5! =} 24 ♔b1 ♘b6? 25 ♖d6 ♖c8 26 ♖c6 ♕a7 27 ♖xe6+ 1-0 Cheveresan-Craciunoiu, corr 1984) ♘xd7 21 ♘e2 ♖c8 22 ♕d3 ♘e5 23 ♕b3 ♖xg7 ∓ Baer-Koneke, corr 1986.

17 ♘d5 *(D)*



17 ... ♕a5!

Or:

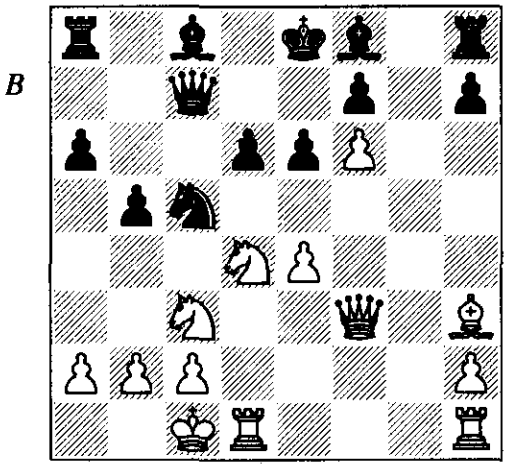
1) **17...♕b7** 18 exf5 ♔d8 19 ♗g2 ♗d7 20 ♖he1 ♗c6 21 ♕e3 h5 (or 21...♔d7 22 b4! ♘a4 23 ♘e7 ♗xg2 24 ♖xd6+ ♔xd6 25 ♕e5+ ♔d7 26 ♖d1+ ♔e8 27 ♘c8+ ♗e7 28 ♘d6+ ♔f8 29 fxe7+ ♔g8 30 ♕g3# Klosterman-Popescu, corr 1973) 22 ♔b1 ♖c8 23 b4 ♘a4 24 ♘e7 ♕d7 25 ♘xc6+ ♖xc6 26 ♗xc6 ♕xc6 27 ♖d3 was unclear in Pedro-Barcona, corr 1988.

2) **17...♕c6** 18 exf5 ♗b7 (better than 18...♘d7 19 ♗g2 and now 19...♘e5 20 ♖he1 ♖a7 21 ♕g3! ± or 19...♗b7 20 ♖he1+ ♔d8 21 ♕e3 ♘e5 22 ♘e7! ♕xg2 23 ♖xd6+ ♔e8 24 ♕xe5 ♗h6+ 25 ♔b1 ♔f8 26 ♖ed1 ♖e8 27 ♖d8 1-0 Wolff-Gunawan, Kiljava jr Wch 1984) and White is struggling to obtain enough for the piece, for example 19 ♕e3+ ♔d7 20 ♗g2 ♖e8 ∓, 19 ♗g2 0-0-0 ∓ or 19 ♕e2+ ♔d7 20 ♗g2 ♖e8 21 ♕h5 ♔d8! ∓ (22 ♕xf7? ♖e2).

After 17...♕a5! White's attack is also unconvincing, for example 18 exf5 (18 ♔b1 fxe4 19 ♕e3 b4! and White has little to show for the piece) ♕xa2 19 ♗g2 (19 ♕e3+ ♔d8 20 ♗g2 ♗xf5 21 ♖he1 ♗h6! 22 ♕xh6 ♘b3+ mates, Vlach-Borik, 1967) ♗h6+ 20 ♘f4 ♗b7 21 ♕e3+ ♔f8 22 ♘e6+ ♔e8 23 ♕xh6, Bluemers-Roelofs, corr 1989, 23...♘b3+! 24 cxb3 ♖c8+ 25 ♔d2 ♕xb2+ 26 ♔e3 (26 ♔e1 ♕xg2) ♗xg2 –+.

B2223)

16 ♗h3 *(D)*



16 ... b4

The most consistent move, because the ♘d5 sacrifice is good enough for a draw at best. However, if Black is worried about White's attack then he has playable alternatives:

1) **16...♗b7** (it is very risky to weaken the h3-c8 diagonal) 17 ♖he1 (or 17 ♕h5 b4 18 ♘d5! exd5 19 exd5 ♔d8 20 ♖he1 ♖a7 21 ♔b1 ♗a8 22 ♖e2 b3 23 cxb3 ♕a5 24 ♕g4! ♘d7 25 ♖de1 ± Wittmann-Aymard, corr 1992) b4 18 ♘d5 exd5 (18...♕a5

19 ♕h5! exd5 20 exd5+ ♔d8 21 ♕xf7 +–) 19 exd5+ ♔d8 20 ♘c6+ ♗xc6 21 dxc6 ♗h6+ 22 ♔b1 a5? 23 ♖e7 1-0 Cottone-Bottari, corr 1989.

2) **16...♗d7** 17 ♕h5 transposes to line B2224.

3) **16...♖g8** 17 ♕h5 (17 ♖he1 ♗d7 18 ♘d5 {18 ♕h5 ♖g6 is the main line of this note} ♕b7 19 ♘e7 ♖g5 20 b4 ♘a4 21 ♘df5 exf5 22 ♕f4 ♗h6 23 ♘xf5, Schwibbe-Siegl, corr 1990, 23...♗xf5 24 exf5+ ♔f8 25 ♕xd6+ ♔g8 –+) ♖g6 and now:

3a) **18 ♖he1** (this is promising for White) ♗d7 and now:

3a1) **19 ♗f5!?** ♖h6 20 ♕f3 b4 21 ♘d5 ♕a5? (21...exd5 22 exd5+ ♔d8 ∞) 22 ♔b1 0-0-0 23 ♘e7+ ♔b7 24 c5+ d5 25 ♘xd5 exf5 26 ♘e7+ ♘e4 27 ♘dxf5 ± Remont-Joseph, corr 1988.

3a2) **19 ♘f5** 0-0-0 (19...b4 ∞) 20 ♘e7+ ♗xe7 21 fxe7 ♖e8 22 ♕xh7 ♖f6, Bensiek-Schulz, corr 1986, 23 ♕g7 ±.

3a3) **19 ♘d5** ♕b7 (19...exd5 20 exd5+ ♔d8 21 ♕xh7 ∞) 20 ♔b1 (20 ♘f5 exd5 21 exd5+ ♔d8 22 ♕xh7 ♗xf5 23 ♗xf5 ♖g2! 24 ♖e3 b4 25 ♖g3 ♖f2! 26 ♖g7 ♗xg7 27 fxg7 ♔c7 28 g8♕ ♖xg8 29 ♕xf7+ ♔b6 30 ♕xg8 ♖xf5 ∓ Timman-Ljubojević, Tilburg 1983) 0-0-0 (20...♖h6 21 ♕g4 ♖g6 poses the problem of how White can avoid a draw, since if the queen moves to another square Black may be able to take the knight) 21 ♘e7+ ♗xe7 22 fxe7 ♖e8 23 ♕h4 ♕c7 24 ♖f1 ± da Costa-Consolino, corr 1985.

3b) **18 ♖hg1** (given an ! in the *Correspondence Chess Yearbook*, but as we shall see, this is not justified) b4 (18...♗d7 19 ♖xg6 hxg6 20 ♕h7 b4 21 ♘ce2 is given in the *Correspondence Chess Yearbook* as leading to equality, but now 21...♖c8!, threatening 22...e5 and 22...b3, wins straight away for Black; 18...♖xg1 19 ♖xg1 b4 20 ♘d5 exd5 21 exd5 ♗xh3 22 ♕xh3 ♕d7 23 ♖e1+ ♔d8 24 ♘c6+ ♔c7 25 ♕xh7 ♖e8 26 ♘e7 ♗xe7 27 ♕xf7 ♔d8 28 fxe7+ ♖xe7 29 ♖xe7 ♕xe7 30 ♕xe7+ ♔xe7 31 ♔d2 ♔f6 32 c3 is a variation given in the *Correspondence Chess Yearbook* as leading to a draw, even though 32...bxc3+ 33 ♔xc3 ♘a4+ wins quite easily) 19 ♘d5 exd5 20 exd5 ♗xh3 21 ♖de1+ ♔d8 22 ♘c6+ ♔c8 23 ♕xh3+ ♕d7 24 ♕xh7, Foerster-Da Costa, corr 1992, and now 24...♖h6 25 ♕g8 ♔b7 is ∓. Of course this improvement was not mentioned in the *Correspondence Chess Yearbook*.

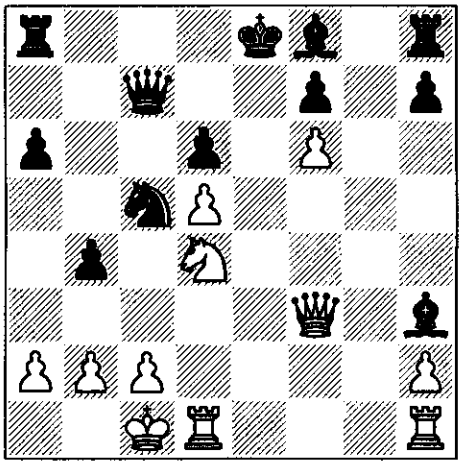
4) **16...h5** 17 ♖he1 (17 ♔b1 ♗d7 18 ♖he1 0-0-0 19 a3 ♖e8 20 b4 ♘b7 21 ♖d3 ♔b8 22 ♗g2 ♖c8 23 ♖e2 ♘d8 24 ♘d1 ♕b6 = R.Wittmann-Rademacher, Germany 1994) ♗d7 18 e5! (18 ♘d5 ♕b7 19 ♘e7 a5 20 ♕g3 ♘xe4 21 ♕g2 d5 22 ♗xe6 fxe6 23 ♕g6+ ♔d8 24 ♖xe4 ♕b6 25 ♕f7 ♗h6+ 26 ♔b1 +– Schäffer-Striebich, Germany 1992) d5 19 ♘xd5! exd5 20 e6 ♘xe6 21 ♗xe6 1-0 Rochel-Holek, corr 1976.

17 ♘d5

White is more or less committed, because 17 ♘ce2 is not dangerous: 17...♗b7 (17...♗d7 18 ♔b1 0-0-0 19 ♖hg1 ♔b8 20 c3 ♕b7 21 ♗g2 ♖c8 22 ♕e3 ♖g8 23 ♗f3 ♖xg1 24 ♖xg1 e5 25 ♘c2 b3 is equal, Lavieri Martins-Fraga Portilho, corr 1987) 18 ♘g3 0-0-0 (18...d5? 19 exd5 ♗xd5 20 ♘xe6! +– Alvarenga-Portilho, corr 1984) 19 ♖he1 ♔b8 (19...d5

20 e5 ♗h6+ 21 ♔b1 ♖dg8 22 a3 bxa3 23 ♕xa3 ♗f4 24 ♘h5 ♗h6 25 b4, Chouinard-Woldmo, corr 1990, 25...♕b6! 26 ♔a2 ♘e4 ∓) 20 ♕h5 ♖c8 21 ♔b1 d5 22 e5 ♘a4 (or 22...♘e4!? 23 ♘xe4 dxe4 24 ♗g2 ♗c5 25 ♘b3 ♗f2 26 ♖e2 e3 ∓) 23 ♘ge2 ♗c5 24 ♘xe6!? fxe6 25 ♗xe6 ∞ Quixada Neto-Tavares Neto, corr 1991.

17 ... exd5
18 exd5 ♗xh3 *(D)*



19 ♖he1+

Or **19 ♕xh3 ♕d7 20 ♖he1+** (20 ♕h5 ♔d8 21 ♘c6+ ♔c7 22 ♘xb4 ♖g8 23 ♘c6 a5 24 ♖de1 ♖g6 25 ♖hf1 ♕g4 26 ♕xh7 ♖xf6 ∓ Grguri-Osterman, corr 1979) **♔d8** and now:

1) **21 ♘e6+** (this variation offers White fair drawing chances) fxe6 22 dxe6 ♘xe6 (22...♕c6 is also possible, but 23 e7+ ♔c7 24 f7! gives reasonable compensation) 23 ♖xe6 ♖c8 (23...♔c7 24 ♕f5 ♕b5 25 ♕e4 ♖c8 26 ♔b1 ♔b6 27 f7 ♕c4 28 ♖exd6+ ½-½ Van der Kooij-Snijders, corr 1987) 24 ♖de1 ♖c5 25 ♕h4 ♖e5 26 ♖6xe5 (26 ♖1xe5 dxe5 27 ♖xa6 {27 ♖xe5 ♕d6 28 ♖e1 =} ♕d5 28 c4 ♗h6+ 29 ♔c2 ♕d2+ 30 ♔b3 ♔c7 31 ♔a4 ♕xb2 32 ♕xh6 ♕xa2+ 0-1 Van der Kooij-Frank, corr 1987) dxe5 27 f7+ ♗e7 28 ♕h6! ♔c7 29 ♕xa6 ♖d8 30 ♕a7+ ½-½ Meštrović-Bukić, Yugoslavia 1974.

2) **21 ♘c6+** ♔c7 22 ♕h4 a5 23 ♔b1 was Poulsson-George, Ybbs 1968. The continuation of this game was quite instructive: 23...h5 24 ♕c4 ♔b6 25 a3 bxa3 26 bxa3 ♕g4 27 ♖d4 ♕c8 28 ♔a2 ♕a6 29 ♕c3 ♖h6 30 ♖dd1 ♖g6 31 ♖b1+ ♔c7 32 ♘d4 ♖b8 33 ♖xb8 ♔xb8 34 ♖e8+ ♔b7 35 ♕b2+ 1-0. Black must take care in defending such positions as the c6-knight and f6-pawn constrict his position and if White does manage to penetrate with his queen the results can be devastating. In this game 23...♖g8 was better. If White ignores the pawn then Black gains a tempo to activate his rook (at g4, for example), while after 24 ♕xh7 ♖g6 25 ♕h4 ♕g4 Black has likewise brought his pieces into play.

19 ... ♔d8
20 ♘c6+ ♔c8
21 ♕xh3+ ♔b7

The most logical move. **21...♕d7** has also been played, but it has the defect that if Black plays ...♔c7 (as he usually does), then Black is a tempo down over the note to White's 19th move. However, Black's position may still be fine despite the loss of a tempo, for example:

1) **22 ♖e8+** ♔c7! is the key point, relying on a ...♗h6+ trick to regain the rook.

2) **22 ♕h5** ♔c7 (22...a5 23 ♖e3 ♔b7 24 ♖de1 ♔b6 25 ♔b1 h6? {a waste of time} 26 a3 bxa3 27 ♖xa3 a4 28 b4 ♘b7 29 ♕e2 ± Frumkin-Heap, corr USA 1987) 23 ♘xb4?! (another waste of time) ♖g8 24 ♘c6

♖g6 25 ♕f3 ♕g4 –+ Aasum-Settis, corr 1974.

3) **22 ♕h4** a5 23 ♖e2 (23 ♔b1 h5 24 ♕c4 ♕b7 25 ♖e8+ ♔c7 26 ♖xa8 ♕xa8 27 ♖e1 ♔b6 ∓) ♔c7 24 ♖de1 ♔b6 25 ♔b1 ♖g8 26 h3 ♖g6 27 ♕c4 ♕c8 28 a4 ♕a6 29 ♕d4 ♖g3 30 ♕f4 ♖g1 ∓ Voizec-Selinski, corr 1971.

After 21...♔b7 White is scraping around for compensation:

1) **22 ♘xb4** ♕d7 23 ♕h4 (23 ♕h5 ♖g8 24 ♘c6 a5 {or 24...♖g6 25 ♔b1 ♖e8 26 ♕h4 ♖g4 27 ♕f2 ♖ge4 28 ♖xe4 ♖xe4 ∓ Zhuravlev-Petkevich, corr 1967} 25 ♕xh7 ♖g6 26 ♔b1 ♖h6 27 ♕g8 ♖xf6 28 ♕g2 ♔b6 29 ♖d4 ♕f5 30 b4 axb4 31 ♖xb4+ ♔c7 0-1 Ciocaltea-Fischer, Netanya 1968) ♖g8 24 h3 (24 ♘c6 ♕g4 25 ♕xh7 ♕g6 26 ♕h3 ♕h6+ 27 ♕xh6 ♗xh6+ 28 ♔b1 Averby-Kletsel, corr 1975, 28...♔b6 ∓) ♖g6 25 ♘c6 a5 26 ♔b1 ♖h6 27 ♕c4 ♖xf6 28 ♖e3 ♖g6 29 ♕b5+ ♔c7 30 ♖a3 ♕c8 31 ♖xa5 ♕b7 ∞ Zhuravlev-Saklauskis, corr 1971.

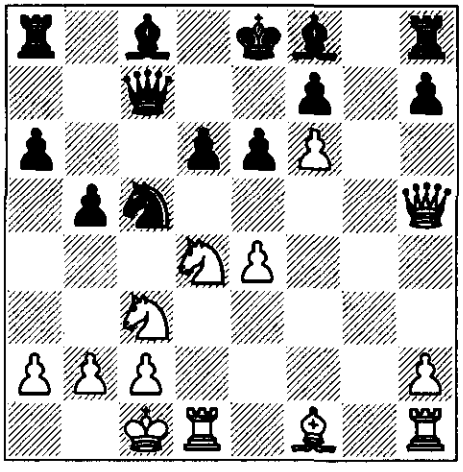
2) **22 ♖e2** h5 (22...♕d7 23 ♕h4 a5 24 ♖de1 ♕f5 25 ♕c4! ♕xf6 26 ♕b5+ ♔c7 27 ♘xb4! ± Zhuravlev-Prieditis, corr; 22...♖g8 is a sensible alternative) 23 ♖de1 ♔b6 24 ♕h4 a5 25 ♔b1 (25 ♕c4 ♖g8 ∓) ♖g8 26 a3 ♖g4 27 ♕xh5 ♕d7 28 ♖e3 ♖f4 29 ♕e2 ♕f5 ∓ Boersma-Maeder, Netherlands 1968.

3) **22 ♖e3** h5 23 ♔b1 ♕d7? (23...♖h6 is a more consistent follow-up to ...h5; 23...♕c8 24 ♕f1 ♘d7? 25 ♕c4 a5 26 ♖de1 ♘xf6 27 ♖f3 ♖h6 28 a3 ♖g6 29 ♖b3 ♖g4 30 ♘xa5+ ♔a7 31 ♕b5 1-0 Boer-Heinrich, corr 1972) 24 ♕f1 ♖g8 25 ♖de1 ♔b6 26 a3 a5 (26...bxa3 27 b4 ∞) 27 axb4 axb4 28 h3 b3 29 cxb3 ♖g5 30 b4 ♖xd5 31 ♘e7 ♗xe7 32 bxc5+ ♖xc5 33 ♖b3+ 1-0 Dobsa-Zhuravlev, corr 1970.

4) **22 ♖d4** a5 23 ♘xb4 ♕d7! (23...axb4? 24 ♖xb4+ ♔a6 25 ♖e3 +– Malitz-Meyer, corr 1978) 24 ♕c3 axb4 25 ♖xb4+ ♔c7 26 ♖be4 ♖g8 27 ♖e7 ♗xe7 28 ♖xe7 ♖g1+ 29 ♔d2 ♔b6! is winning for Black, Kopylov-Danov, corr 1966.

B2224)

16 ♕h5 *(D)*



16 ... ♗d7

Or:

1) **16...b4** 17 ♘d5 (17 ♘ce2 ♗b7 18 ♘g3 e5 19 ♘df5 ♖c8 20 ♖d2 ♘xe4 21 ♘g7+ ♔d8 22 ♕xe5 ♕xc2+ ∓ El Taher-Yang Xian, Dubai OL 1986) and now:

1a) **17...♕b7** (risky) 18 ♖e1 (18 ♗c4 ♗d7 19 ♖he1 0-0-0 20 ♘e7+ ♔b8 21 ♔b1 ♗e8 22 ♘b3 ♘xb3 23 axb3 with a slight plus for White, Lobron-Schrüfer, Bundesliga 1985) ♗d7 (18...exd5 19 exd5+ ♔d8 20 ♗g2!, threatening 21 ♘e6+, gives White a dangerous attack) 19 ♗h3 0-0-0 (19...exd5 20 exd5+ ♔d8 21 ♕xf7 ♗h6+ 22 ♔b1 ♗xh3 23 ♘c6+ ♔c8 24 ♕h5 is also dangerous) 20

♘e7+ ♔b8 (a typical position; White has lurched in, but despite appearances Black has some counterchances) 21 e5! (21 ♘b3?! ♕b5! 22 ♕f3 {22 e5; 22 ♕h4} ♘xb3+ 23 ♕xb3 ♗h6+ 24 ♔b1 ♗f4 ∓ Peters-Shirazi, USA 1983; 21 ♔b1!? ♗e8 22 e5 d5 23 ♕h4 ♔a8 24 ♗g2 ♗xe7? 25 fxe7 ♖d7 26 ♕g5 1-0 Martinović-Buljovčić, Vukovar 1966) ♗e8?! (Black must try something else, but White should be better in any case) 22 exd6 ♕b6 23 ♕e5 ♗d7 (23...♖xd6 24 ♘ef5!) 24 ♗g2 +– da Costa-de Almeida, corr 1985.

1b) **17...♕a5** 18 ♔b1 (18 ♗c4 ♗b7 19 ♘f4 0-0-0 20 ♕xf7 e5 21 ♘fe6 ∞; 18 ♘c6! ♕xa2 19 ♘c7+ ♔d7 20 ♘xb4 ♕a1+ 21 ♔d2 ♕a5 22 ♕xf7+ ♔d8 23 ♘xa8 ♕xb4+ 24 ♔c1 ♕b8 25 ♖g1 ♕xa8 26 ♖g8 ♖xg8 27 ♕xg8 ♔e8 28 ♗e2 +–) ♗d7 19 ♗h3 0-0-0 20 ♘e7+ ♔b7 21 e5 d5 22 ♕xf7 ♗e8 23 ♘ec6+ +– McCambridge-Sigurjonsson, Lone Pine 1981.

1c) **17...exd5** 18 exd5 and now:

1c1) **18...♕d7** 19 ♘c6 ♘e4 20 ♖e1 ♕f5 21 ♕xf5 ♗xf5 22 ♗d3 ± Thielen-Lorenz, corr 1982.

1c2) **18...♘d7!?** (this may represent Black's best chance) 19 ♗h3 (19 ♘e6 ♕a5 20 ♘g5 ♘e5 21 ♘xf7 ♗g4! ∓) ♘xf6? (19...♘e5 20 ♘e6 ♕a5 ∞) 20 ♕g5 ♗e7 (20...♗xh3 21 ♕xf6 ♖g8 22 ♖he1+ transposes) 21 ♖he1 ♗xh3 22 ♕xf6 ♖g8 23 ♕h4! ♕d7 24 ♘c6 ♗e6 25 ♕xh7 ± Poselnikov-Kondakov, corr 1973.

1c3) **18...♗d7** 19 ♖e1+ (this is probably stronger than 19 ♗h3, for which see the note to White's 18th move in the main line) ♔d8 20 ♔b1 (20 ♕xf7?! ♗h6+ 21 ♔b1 ♗e8 22 ♕xc7+ {22 ♘e6+ ♘xe6 23 ♕xe6 ♗f7 24 ♕h3 ♗f4 25 ♗d3 ♗e5 –+ Vijendran-Zouaoui, Thessaloniki OL 1984} ♔xc7 23 ♘e6+ ♔b6 24 ♗h3 ♗g6 ∓ Hartmann-Vokler, corr 1984) and now:

1c31) **20...♕c8** 21 ♕xf7 ♔c7 (this tends to lead to positions similar to line B2223, but with Black having lost his f-pawn) 22 ♗h3 (22 ♕h5 ♔b6 23 ♖g1 a5 24 ♘e6 ♕e8 25 f7 ♕e7 26 ♗h3 ♗xe6 27 dxe6 ± Grozescu-Cojocaru, corr 1991) ♔b6 23 ♗xd7 ♕xd7 24 ♕h5 ♖a7 (24...♖g8 25 f7 ♖g6 26 ♖hf1 ♗h6 27 ♕h4 ♖f8 28 ♘e6! ♖xf7 29 ♕xb4+ ♔a7 30 ♘xc5 dxc5 31 ♕xc5+ ± Luus-Puppendahl, Germany 1989) 25 ♘c6 ♖b7, Hobusch-Klein, corr 1985, 26 ♖hf1 ±.

1c32) **20...♔c8** 21 ♕xf7 ♔b7 (or 21...♗a4 22 ♗h3+ ♔b7 23 ♕h5 ♘d7 24 b3 ±) 22 ♘e6 ♘xe6?! 23 dxe6 ♗c6 24 ♕xc7+ ♔xc7 25 ♖g1 ♗h6 26 e7 ± Krnić-Vujović, Yugoslavia 1971.

1c33) **20...♗a4** 21 ♗h3 ♕b7 22 ♖hg1 ♕a7 23 ♖g7! ♗xg7 24 fxg7 ♖g8 25 b3! ♗d7 26 ♕xf7 ♔c7 27 ♗xd7 ♘xd7 28 ♖e7! +– Bucciardini-Naundorf, corr 1993.

2) **16...♖g8** (the idea is to abandon the relatively useless h-pawn to seize the open file and attack the crucial f6-pawn as quickly as possible) and now:

2a) **17 ♗h3** ♖g6 transposes to line B2223, note to Black's 16th move, line 3.

2b) **17 ♕xh7** ♖g6 18 a3 (18 ♕h8 ♖h6 is a draw; 18 ♕h4 ♗d7 19 a3 0-0-0 20 ♔b1 ♗h6 21 ♘f3 ♗e3 22 ♖e1 ½-½ Schneider-Krabbé, corr 1975) ♗b7 19 ♕h4 0-0-0 20 ♗d3

♗h6+ 21 ♔b1 ♗g5 22 ♕h3 ♗xf6 23 ♘d5 ♗xd5 24 exd5 ♖h8 25 ♕e3 ♖gh6 26 dxe6 ♗xd4 27 ♕xd4 fxe6= Heijnens-Goedkoop, corr 1985.

2c) **17 ♗d3** h6 18 a3 ♖g6 19 ♕h4 ♘xd3+ 20 ♖xd3 ♗b7 21 ♖hd1 is slightly better for Black, Winckelmann-Ihlenfeld, corr 1987.

2d) **17 e5** and now:

2d1) **17...d5** 18 ♕xh7 ♖g6 19 ♕h5 ±.

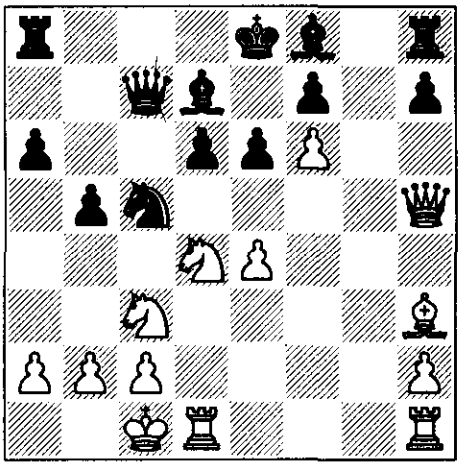
2d2) **17...b4** 18 ♕xh7 ♖g6 (not 18...bxc3 19 ♕xg8 cxb2+ 20 ♔b1 dxe5 21 ♗b5+! +–) 19 ♗b5+! (19 exd6? ♕xd6! 20 ♘ce2 ♗b7 ∓) axb5 20 ♘dxb5 ♕b8 (20...♕a5 21 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 22 ♖xd6 ♘d7 23 ♖hd1 +–) 21 ♘xd6+ ♕xd6 22 ♖xd6 bxc3 23 ♖hd1 +– Hector-Marinelli, Haifa Echt 1989. Looks convincing, but actually I don't see how White wins after 20...♕c6 21 ♕h8 ♖h6. If this is correct, then 17 e5 may not be as strong as is generally supposed.

2d3) **17...dxe5** 18 ♗xb5+! (18 ♘cxb5 axb5 19 ♗xb5+ ♘d7 20 ♘xe6 is unclear after both 20...♕b8!? and 20...♕b6 21 ♘xf8 ♕xb5 22 ♘xd7 ♗xd7) axb5 19 ♘cxb5! ♕b6 20 ♕xe5 ♘a6 21 ♘f5 ♗b7 22 ♖hf1! +– Tsaturian-Bangiev, USSR 1988.

2d4) **17...♗d7** 18 ♕xh7 ♖g6!? (not 18...dxe5?! 19 ♘dxb5 axb5 20 ♕xg8 +–; 18...0-0-0 19 ♔b1 dxe5 20 ♘dxb5 +–) 19 exd6 (19 ♗xb5 ♖h6 =) ♕b7! (19...♕xd6 20 ♕h4 ♕e5?! {20...♗h6+ 21 ♔b1 ♕f4 22 ♕xf4 ♗xf4 23 b4 ±; 20...♕c7!? 21 ♔b1 ±} 21 ♖e1! ± Pared Estrada-Virginia Estrada, Cuba 1989) and no convincing line is visible for White, for example 20 ♕h5 ♕xh1 21 ♕xc5 ♖g1!.

17 ♗h3 *(D)*

17 ♔b1 (17 a3 transposes to line B2221 above, while 17 ♖e1 0-0-0! is fine for Black) b4 18 ♘ce2 0-0-0 (18...♘xe4?! 19 ♗g2 ♘xf6 20 ♕g5 ♘d5 21 ♗xd5 exd5 22 ♘f4 ±; 18...♖g8 19 ♘g3 ♖g6 20 ♕xh7 ♖h6 21 ♕g8 ♖g6 22 ♕h8 ♖h6 =) 19 ♕xf7 e5 20 ♘b3 ♘xe4 21 ♖g1, Gelmerov-Khokhlov, corr 1989, and now 21...♗e8 22 ♕d5 ♗c6 23 ♕c4 ♗b7 24 ♕xb4 d5 or 21...♗b5 22 ♕xc7+ ♔xc7 23 f7 ♘f6 is roughly equal.



B

17 ... b4

17...0-0-0? 18 ♕xf7 ♗h6+ 19 ♔b1 ♖df8 (19...b4 20 ♘xe6! ♘xe6 21 ♘d5) 20 ♕h5 ♖xf6 21 e5! dxe5 22 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 23 ♘d5 ♕f7 24 ♕xe5 and wins, Parma-Bogdanović, Titovo Užice 1966.

18 ♘ce2

18 ♘d5 exd5 19 exd5 0-0-0 (alternatively 19...♗xh3 20 ♖he1+ ♔d8 21 ♘c6+ ♔c8 22 ♕xh3+ transposes to B2223) 20 ♘c6 ♖e8 21 ♖he1 ♔b7 22 ♗xd7 (22 ♕xf7?! ♖xe1 23 ♖xe1 ♗h6+ 24 ♔b1 ♗xh3 –+; 22 ♘e7 ♗xh3 23 ♕xh3 ♗xe7 24 fxe7 ♖xe7! –+; 22 ♖xe8 ♗xe8 23 ♖d4 a5 24 ♕g5 h5 25 ♕g3 ♗xc6 26 dxc6+ ♔a7 0-1 Dziuba-Franczak, corr 1974) ♖xe1 (22...♕xd7? 23 ♕h4 ♔c7 24

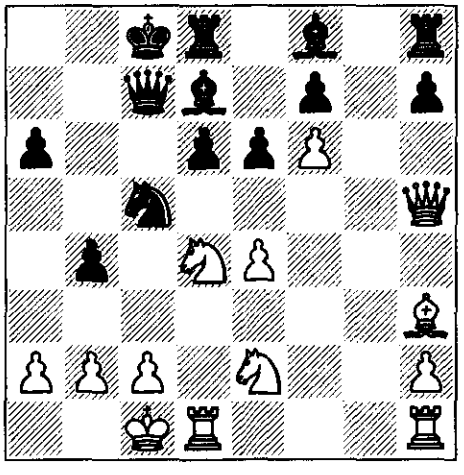
♕xb4 ♗h6+ 25 ♔b1 ♖xe1 26 ♖xe1 ♖e8? 27 ♖e7 1-0 Zhuravlev-Gutman, corr) 23 ♖xe1 ♘xd7 24 ♕xf7 ♘e5 and White can hope for a draw at best.

18 ... 0-0-0 *(D)*

Or:

1) **18...♕a5** 19 ♔b1 b3 20 cxb3 ♘xb3 21 e5 (21 ♕xa5 ♘xa5 22 ♖hg1 ♘c4 23 ♘f3 ♖b8 24 b3 h5 25 ♔a1 ♘e3 26 ♖d2 d5?! 27 ♘e5 ♗b5 28 exd5 ♘xd5 29 ♗xe6 fxe6 30 f7+ ♔d8 31 ♖g8 +– Da Costa-Al.Rodriguez, corr 1986) ♘xd4 22 ♘xd4 ♕xe5?! 23 ♕f3 ♖c8 24 ♖he1 ♕c5 25 ♖c1 ♕b6 26 ♖xc8+ ♗xc8 27 ♘xe6! ♗xe6 28 ♕d5 ♔d8 29 ♗xe6 fxe6 30 ♕xe6 ♕b5 31 f7 ♕d3+ 32 ♔a1 +– Napoli Costa-Pantaleoni, corr 1986.

2) **18...♗a4** is a suggestion of Liangov, who gives the further analysis 19 ♔b1 (19 b3 ♗b5, while most other white moves are answered by ...0-0-0) 0-0-0 20 ♘g3 ♔b8 21 ♗g2 ♖c8 22 ♖c1 ♖g8 =.



19 ♕xf7

Or **19 ♘g3 ♔b8** (19...a5 20 ♔b1 ♗a4 21 ♘b3 ♗c6 22 ♖d4 ♕a7 23 ♖hd1 ♘xb3 24 cxb3 ♖d7 25 ♖c4 ♖c7 26 ♖dc1 ♕b6 27 ♘e2 ♔d8 28 ♘f4 ± Mierzynski-Jaloszynski, corr 1992) and now:

1) **20 ♔b1** ♗c8 21 ♘b3 (21 ♗g2 ♗b7 22 ♖hf1 ♖c8 23 ♖f2 h6 24 ♕e2 ♖g8 25 ♕d2 ♕b6 26 ♘b3 ♘d7 ∓ S.Horvath-Schuetze, corr 1987) ♖d7 22 ♖d4 ♕b6 23 ♖hd1 ♘xb3 24 cxb3 h6 25 ♘f1 ♖g8 26 ♘e3 ♖g5 27 ♕e2 a5 28 ♕d2 ♗b7 29 ♗g4 ♕d8 ∓ Frontanin-Meler Molet, corr 1986.

2) **20 ♕xf7** ♗h6+ 21 ♔b1 ♖df8 22 ♕h5 (22 ♕e7 ♖e8 is a draw) ♖xf6 (the position is similar to the main line, except that the moves ♘g3 and ...♔b8 have been added) 23 ♖hf1 ♖xf1 24 ♗xf1 ♗g7 25 ♕f7 ♗e5 = Karmov-Bangiev, corr 1993.

19 ... ♗h6+
20 ♔b1 ♖df8
21 ♕h5

21 ♕e7 ♖e8 22 ♕f7 ♖ef8 is a draw. The risky winning attempt 22...♘xe4 was successful in Peyronnet-Poulenard, Uzes 1989, but only because White missed the refutation 23 ♘xe6 ♕c4 24 ♘2d4 ♖ef8 25 ♕e7 ♖e8 26 ♗f1! ♕xe6 27 ♘xe6 ♖xe7 28 ♗xa6+ ♔b8 29 fxe7 ♗xe6 30 ♖he1 +–.

21 ... ♖xf6
22 ♖hf1 ♖hf8
23 ♖xf6 ♖xf6

and now:

1) **24 ♘g3** ♔b8 (24...♗f4 25 ♕xh7 {25 ♕f3 ♗e5 26 ♕h5 h6 ∓} ♖h6 26 ♕f7 e5 27 ♕e8+ ♔b7 28 ♗xd7 exd4 29 ♗c6+ ♕xc6 30 ♕f7+ ♘d7 31 ♕xf4 ± Hobusch-Pielert, corr 1985) 25 ♕e2 ♗a4 26 b3 ♗d7 27 ♕c4 ♕a5 28 ♕e2 ♖g6 29 ♕f3 ♗g7 ∓ Sardella-Ruggieri, corr 1990.

2) **24 ♕h4** ♖g6 and now:

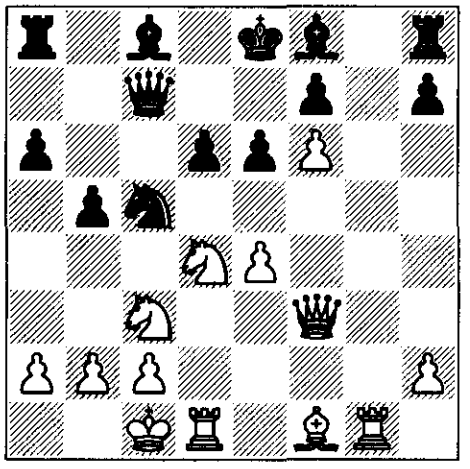
2a) **25 ♘f3** a5 (this move is met by a strong reply, so Black needs an

improvement here, e.g. 25...♗c6) 26 ♘f4! (26 ♘g3 ♕d8 27 ♕h5 ♗f4 28 ♘e2 ♕f8! ∓ Browne-Mecking, San Antonio 1972) ♗xf4 27 ♕xf4 ♗c6 28 e5 ♗xf3 (28...dxe5 29 ♘xe5 ♖g8 30 ♕e3 ±) 29 ♕xf3 ♘b7, Carmona-Montejo, corr, 30 exd6 ♘xd6 31 ♕d5! +–.

2b) **25 ♘b3** ♕d8 (25...♗g5 26 ♕xh7 ♖h6 27 ♕g7, Tringov-Browne, Sarajevo 1970, 27...♖xh3 28 ♕xg5 ♘xe4 =) 26 ♕xd8+ ♔xd8 27 ♖xd6 ♘xe4 28 ♖d4 ♘f2 29 ♘c5 ♘xh3 30 ♖xd7+ ♔e8 31 ♖xh7 ± Fernandez-Marti Cruz, corr 1989.

B2225)

16 ♖g1 *(D)*



This very logical move, originally introduced by Perenyi, may be regarded as the main line. It prevents ...♖g8, which was such a common theme in the analysis of 16 ♕h5. It also introduces many tactical possibilities based on the move ♖g7. Although White initially scored very well with ♖g1, the current situation is confused.

16 ... ♗d7

This is the most popular move, but there are various alternatives, of which one may single out 16...h5 as being worthy of close attention:

1) **16...♖b8** 17 ♕h5 ♕b7 18 ♖g7 e5 19 ♘f5 ♗xf5 20 exf5 ♖d8 21 ♗g2 ♕a7 22 ♗c6+ 1-0 Perenyi-Effertz, Porz 1985.

2) **16...♗b7** 17 ♗h3 0-0-0 (or 17...b4 18 ♘d5 exd5 19 exd5 ♘d7 20 ♘c6 ♘e5 21 ♖ge1 h5 22 ♔b1 a5 23 ♕g3 h4 24 ♕f4 ♗xc6 25 dxc6 ♖h6 26 ♖xd6 +– Willberg-Antonen, corr) 18 ♘d5 ♕a5 (18...♕b8 19 b4 ♘a4 20 ♕h5 1-0 Denaro-Materne, corr 1987) 19 ♔b1 ♔b8 20 b4 ♕a4 21 bxc5 dxc5 (21...exd5 22 c6 dxe4 23 ♕c3 +–) 22 ♗xe6 cxd4 23 ♗xf7 ± Herschel-Peli, corr 1991.

3) **16...b4** 17 ♘d5 and now:

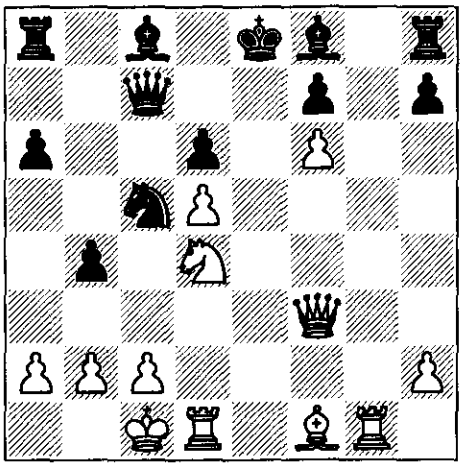
3a) **17...♕b7** 18 ♖g7 exd5 19 exd5 ♗xg7 (19...♗d7 20 ♘c6 ♗xc6 21 dxc6 ♕c7 22 ♕e3+ ♗e7 23 ♗h3 ♔f8 24 ♕h6 1-0 Perenyi-Haragos, Kecskemet 1985) 20 ♕e3+ (20 fxg7 ♖g8 21 ♘c6 ♗e6 {21...f5!? ∞} 22 dxe6 fxe6 23 ♖xd6 ♖xg7 24 ♕f6, Jozwiak-Burchardt Hofman, Warsaw 1988, 24...♖g1 =) ♔d8 21 fxg7 ♖g8 22 ♕f4 ♕d7 23 ♗h3 ♕xh3, Müller-Ott, German Cup 1991, 24 ♕xf7! +–.

3b) **17...♕a5** 18 ♔b1! ♗d7 19 ♗c4 ♖b8 20 ♘f4 ♘a4, Cumming-Bix, corr 1990, 21 ♘b3! ±.

3c) **17...exd5** 18 exd5 *(D)* and now:

3c1) **18...♘d7** 19 ♘c6! ♘e5 (19...♗h6+ {19...♗b7 20 ♗h3 transposes to line 2 above} 20 ♔b1 ♘e5 21 ♘xe5 dxe5 22 d6 ♕a7 {22...♕b8 23 d7+ ♗xd7 24 ♖xd7 ♔xd7 25 ♕d5+ ♕d6 26 ♕b7+ +–; 22...♗b7 23 dxc7 ♗xf3 24 ♗xa6 +–} 23 ♗g2 ♖b8 24 ♕h5 ♗f4 25 ♗c6+ ♗d7 26 ♗d5 ♗b5 27 ♗e6! ♔d8! 28 ♖g7 h6

B



29 ♕g4! ♗g5 30 h4 ♕f2 31 hxg5 ♗e2 32 ♕g1 +– Napoli Costa-Montagnino, corr 1991) 20 ♘xe5 dxe5 21 d6 ♕a7 22 ♗c4 (22 ♕d5 ♗h6+ 23 ♔b1 ♗f4 24 ♗c4 ♗e6 25 d7+ ♔d8 26 ♕d6 +– Georges-Giertz, Switzerland 1988) ♖b8 23 ♖ge1 ♕c5 24 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 25 ♕h5+ ♔e6 26 ♕g4+ ♔f7 27 ♕h5+ ♔e6 28 ♕g4+ ♔f7 29 d7 ♗h6+ 30 ♔b1 ♔xf6 31 ♖f1+ ♗f4 32 ♖xf4+ exf4 33 ♕xf4+ ♔e7 34 ♕xb8 +– Billeter-Thibault, corr 1991.

3c2) **18...♗d7** and now:

3c21) **19 ♖e1+** ♔d8 20 ♖g7 (20 ♗h3 ♗xh3 21 ♘c6+ ♕xc6!? {the line 21...♔c8 22 ♕xh3+ transposes to B2223, except that White's rook stands on g1 and not d1 – this difference probably favours White since the rook wasn't very effective on d1} 22 dxc6 ♗e6 23 ♔b1 ♔c7 24 ♖g3 a5 25 ♖eg1 h5 26 h3 ♗h6 27 ♖g7 ∞ Kurzynsky-Jugelt, corr 1991) ♕a5 (or 20...♔c8 21 ♖xf7 ♔b7 22 ♘e6 ♕c8 23 ♘xc5+ dxc5 24 ♗h3 +– P.Schlosser-Mull, Dortmund 1987) 21 ♘c6+ ♗xc6 22 dxc6 b3 23 c7+ ♔xc7 24 ♖xf7+ ♔b6 –+ Jerie-Kapischka, 2nd Bundesliga 1992.

3c22) **19 ♖g7** 0-0-0 (19...♗xg7 20 fxg7 ♖g8 21 ♖e1+ ♔d8 22 ♕xf7 +–; 19...♕a5 20 ♕e3+ ♔d8 21 ♖xf7 ♕xa2 22 ♘e6+ {22 ♗h3 ♕a1+ 23 ♔d2 ♕xb2 24 ♘e6+ ♔c8 25 ♘xc5 ♕c3+ 26 ♕xc3 bxc3+ 27 ♔e1 ♗xh3 28 ♘e6 ♗xe6 29 dxe6 ♖b8 30 ♖d3 ♖b5 31 ♖xc3+ ♔b8 32 e7 ♖e5+ 33 ♔d1 ♗xe7 34 fxe7 ♖e8 35 ♖xh7 ♖8xe7 ½-½ Doghri-G.Hernandez, Dubai OL 1986} ♘xe6 23 dxe6 ♕xe6 24 ♕b6+ ♔e8 25 ♖xd7! ♕xd7 26 ♗g2! ♗h6+ 27 ♔b1 ♖c8 28 ♖xd6 ♕c7 {28...♕f5 29 ♖e6+ ♔f8 30 ♕d6+ ♔g8 31 ♖e2 +–} 29 ♗c6+ ♔f8 30 ♕xb4 +–) 20 ♖xf7 (this position often arises via the move-order 16...♗d7 17 ♖g7 b4 18 ♘d5 exd5 19 exd5 0-0-0 20 ♖xf7, but the analysis given in the note to Black's 17th suggests that this move-order is a mistake, since 16...♗d7 17 ♖g7 b4 may be met by 18 e5!; 20 ♘e6? fxe6 21 dxe6 ♗xg7 22 fxg7 ♖hg8 23 ♕a8+ ♕b8 24 exd7+ ♔c7 is winning for Black, Djurić-Tadić, Yugoslavia Cht 1993) ♗h6+ 21 ♔b1 ♖df8 (21...♖de8? 22 ♘e6 ♕b6 23 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 24 ♗h3 +–) and now:

3c221) **22 ♖xd7** ♘xd7 23 ♗xa6+ ♔b8 24 ♕b3 ♕b6! ∓.

3c222) **22 ♖xf8** ♖xf8 23 ♘e6 ♘xe6 24 dxe6 (24 ♗xa6+ ♔b8 25 dxe6 ♗xe6 26 ♖xd6 ♖e8! ∞) ♗xe6 25 ♗h3! (the latest twist, which appears to tip the balance clearly in White's favour) ♕d7 (25...♕c4?! 26 b3 ♕c5 27 ♗xe6+ ♔c7 28 ♗d5! +– Shmuter-Kaspi, Tel-Aviv 1996) 26 ♕a8+ ♔c7 27 ♕a7+ ♔c8 (27...♔c6 28 ♕xa6+ ♔c5 29 a3 +–) 28 ♕xa6+ ♔c7 29 ♕a5+ ♔c8 (29...♔c6 30 ♖d4! ♖xf6 31 ♖c4+! ♗xc4 32 ♕a4+ +–) 30 ♖d4! ♗xh3 (30...♖xf6 31 ♖c4+! ♗xc4 32 ♕a8+ ♔c7 33 ♕a7+ +–) 31 ♖c4+ ♔b7 32 ♖xb4+ ♔c8 33

♕a6+! ♔d8 34 ♖b8+ ♕c8 35 ♕xd6+ ♗d7 36 ♕b6+! ♔e8 37 ♕c5 ♔f7 38 ♖xc8 ♗xc8 39 ♕h5+ with a decisive advantage for White.

3c223) **22 ♖e7** and now:

3c2231) **22...♕d8?** (this loses by force) 23 ♖xd7 ♔xd7 (23...♕xd7 24 ♗h3 +–; 23...♘xd7 24 ♗xa6+ +–) 24 ♕f5+ ♔c7 (24...♔e8 25 ♗b5+! axb5 26 ♖e1+ ♔f7 27 ♕h5+ ♔xf6 28 ♕xh6+ ♔f7 29 ♕h5+ ♔f6 30 ♕f5+ mating) 25 ♘e6+ ♘xe6 26 dxe6 and Black is without a defence against the advanced pawns and threats to his king, e.g. **26...♕xf6** 27 ♕a5+ ♔b8 28 ♕b6+ +–, **26...♖xf6** 27 ♕a5+ ♔b8 28 ♕xb4+ ♔a7 29 ♕d4+! ♔b8 30 ♗g2! ♖f4 31 ♕d5 ♖b4 32 ♕a8+ ♔c7 33 ♕c6+ ♔b8 34 ♖xd6 +–, **26...♔b6** 27 ♕f2+ ♔b7 28 ♗g2+ ♔b8 29 e7, **26...♔b8** 27 ♕e4! ♕b6 (27...♖xf6 28 ♗g2 ♕b6 29 ♕a8+ ♔c7 30 ♕xh8 +– J.Schulz-Strube, Germany 1988) 28 e7 ♗g5 29 exf8♕+ ♖xf8 30 ♗g2 +–, **26...♕b8** 27 e7 +–, **26...♗e3** 27 ♕d5! ♗c5 28 e7 ♕a8 29 exf8♕ ♖xf8 30 ♕f5 +– ♔b6 31 ♗c4 ♕d8 32 ♖f1 h5 33 ♗d5 ♕e8 34 ♗e6 a5 35 h3 a4 36 ♖f3 ♕b5 37 ♕e4 ♕e8 38 ♕f5 is winning for White, Chinchilla-G.Hernandez, Managua 1987.

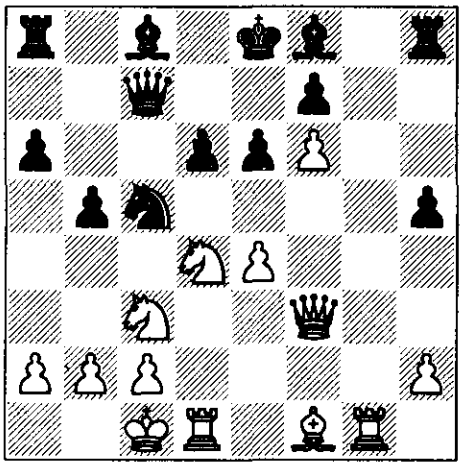
3c2232) **22...♗g5** 23 ♖xd7 ♘xd7 24 ♘e6 with a final branch:

3c22321) **24...♕a7** 25 ♘xg5 ♖xf6 26 ♕g4 ♖g8 (26...♔b8 27 ♘e6 ♖c8 28 ♗h3 ♖g6 29 ♕xb4+ ♕b6 30 ♕xb6+ ♘xb6 31 ♘f4 +– Hector-Zinić, Belfort 1988) 27 ♗d3 (27 ♕c4+ ♔b8 28 ♘e4 ∞) h5 28 ♕xh5 ♘c5 29 ♗e2 ♖f2 30 ♖e1 ♕g7 31 h4 ♔b8 32 ♕g4 ♔a8 33 ♕g3 ♖gf8 34 ♕e3 ♕e5 35 ♕xe5 dxe5 = Barten-Neumann, corr 1990.

3c22322) **24...♕b7** 25 ♘xg5 ♖xf6 26 ♕d3 ♔b8 (26...♖g8 27 h4 ♘c5 28 ♕d4 ♖fg6 29 ♗h3+ ♔b8 30 ♗f5 ♖6g7 31 ♘e6 ♘a4 32 ♔c1 ♖g3 33 ♕f4 ♕b6 34 ♘d4 ♖g1 ∞ Berta-Zabala, corr) 27 ♕xa6 ♕xa6 28 ♗xa6 ♘c5 29 ♗c4 ♖f2 and Black is at least equal, Schmidt-Scuderi, corr 1987.

If the analysis in 3c222 holds up, then Black is in trouble after 16...b4.

4) **16...h5** *(D)* and now:



4a) **17 ♖g7** and now:

4a1) **17...♘d7!?** 18 e5 (not 18 ♘xe6? fxe6 19 ♕h3 ♕c5 20 ♕xe6+ ♔d8 21 ♖d5 {21 ♖f7 ♕e5!}, Kok-Stolzenbach, corr 1990, 21...♕f2! ∓) ♕b7 19 ♕e2 dxe5 20 ♘xe6 fxe6 21 ♗g2 ♕b8 22 ♗xa8 ♕xa8 23 ♕d3 ♕c6 24 ♕g6+ ♔d8 25 ♖g8 ♖xg8 26 ♕xg8 ♔c7 27 ♖xd7+ ♗xd7 28 ♕xf8 with a clear advantage for White in the game Gershon-Halkias, Cala Galdana 1996.

4a2) **17...b4** 18 ♘d5 exd5 19 exd5 ♗g4 (19...♘d7 20 ♘c6 ♘e5 21 ♘xe5 dxe5 22 d6 ♗b7 23 ♕b3 ♗xd6 24 ♖xd6 ♕xd6 25 ♕xf7+ ♔d8 26 ♕xb7 ♖b8 27 ♕f7 +– G.Mohr-Orel, Slovenian Ch 1993) with the possibilities:

4a21) **20 ♕e3+** (unconvincing) ♔d8 21 ♘c6+ ♔c8 22 ♖d4 ♗xg7 (after 22...a5! it is doubtful if White has enough for the piece) 23 fxg7 ♖g8 24 h3 ♗e6 (24...♗d7 25 ♘e7+ ♔b7 26 ♖xb4+ ♔a7 27 ♘xg8 ♖xg8 28 ♖f4! ♖xg7 29 b4 ♗c8 30 bxc5 ♕xc5 31 ♕xc5+ dxc5 32 ♖f6! ±) 25 ♕g5! f6! 26 ♕xf6 ♕xg7 27 ♘e7+ ♔c7 28 ♘xg8 ♖xg8 29 ♕xg7+ ♖xg7 30 dxe6 ♖g1 ± Statek-Jaworski, corr 1989.

4a22) **20 ♖e1+** ♔d8 and now:

4a221) **21 ♕f2** ♕d7 22 h3 ♗xg7 (22...♗xh3 23 ♗xh3 ♕xh3 24 ♖xf7 ♗h6+ 25 ♔b1 ♖f8 26 ♘e6+ ♘xe6 27 ♕b6+ mates; 22...♔c7 23 hxg4 ♗xg7 24 fxg7 ♖he8 25 gxh5 +–) 23 fxg7 ♖e8 24 ♖xe8+ ♕xe8 25 hxg4 hxg4 26 ♘f5 ♔c7 27 ♕h4 f6 28 ♕xg4 ♕e1+ 29 ♕d1 ♕e5 ∞ Schuett-Trisić, Bargteheide 1989.

4a222) **21 ♕e3** ♔c8 22 ♘e6 ♘xe6 23 dxe6 ♗xe6 24 ♕f3 ♕b7 25 ♕xb7+ ♔xb7 26 ♖xe6 ♗xg7 27 ♗g2+ ♔b6 28 ♖xd6+ ♔c7 29 ♖c6+ ♔d7 30 fxg7 ♖hg8 31 ♖b6 ♖ab8 32 ♖xa6 ♖xg7 ∓ McDonald-Coleman, British Ch 1991.

4a223) **21 ♕f4** (best) ♔c8 (or 21...♕d7 22 h3 ♔c7 23 hxg4 ♗xg7 24 ♖e7 ±) 22 ♘c6 (22 h3? ♗d7; 22 ♔b1 ♕d7 23 h3 ♔c7 24 hxg4 ♗xg7 25 fxg7 ♖he8 26 ♖xe8 ♖xe8 27 ♗e2 hxg4 ∓ Valses-Diaz Perez, Pinol del Rio 1988) ♕d7 23 h3 ♗e6 (or 23...♗xh3 24 ♗xh3 ♕xh3 25 ♖xf7 ♘d7 26 ♘e7+ ♔c7 27 ♕c4+ 1-0 Spitz-Ballester Sanz, corr 1989) 24 dxe6 ♘xe6 25 ♘e7+ ♔d8 26 ♕f3! d5 27 ♖e5 +–.

4a3) **17...♗d7** transposes to the main line, note to Black's 17th move, line 2.

4a4) **17...♕d8** and now:

4a41) **18 b4!** (this appears very dangerous for Black) ♘d7 (18...♘b7 19 e5 ♗xg7 20 fxg7 ♕g5+ 21 ♔b1 ♕xg7 22 ♕c6+ ♔f8 23 exd6 f5 24 ♘xf5! ±) 19 e5 ♘b6 (19...♖b8 20 ♘xe6! ♘xe5 21 ♘xd8 ♘xf3 22 ♘xf7 ±) 20 exd6! ♗xg7 21 fxg7 ♖g8 22 ♘e4 ♘d5 23 ♘c6 +–.

4a42) **18 ♔b1** ♗b7 19 ♖g5 ♘d7 20 ♘xe6 (20 ♖xh5 ♖xh5 21 ♕xh5 ♕xf6 22 ♗g2 is unclear) fxe6 21 ♖xh5 ♗h6 22 ♕g3 ♕xf6 23 ♕xd6 ♖h7? (23...♕e7! ∓) 24 ♘xb5 axb5 25 ♗xb5 ♖d8 26 ♖f1! ± Wedemeyer-Maliangkay, corr 1990.

4a43) **18 ♘c6** ♕b6 19 ♘e7 ♗b7 20 ♕g3 ♘xe4 (20...♖d8!? 21 ♖xf7 ♗h6+ 22 ♔b1 ♔xf7 23 ♕g6+ ♔f8 24 ♕xh5 ♖h7 25 ♕g6 ♖h8 26 ♕h5 draws by repetition) 21 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 22 ♗g2 (22 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 23 ♖xd6 ♖h6! ∓) h4 23 ♕g4 ♗xg2 24 ♕xg2 ♖d8 25 ♖xf7! (25 ♔b1? h3! 26 ♕g5 ♕c5 27 ♕g4 ♗xg7 28 fxg7 ♔xe7 –+ Rennemo-De Ruiter, corr 1991) ♗h6+ 26 ♔b1 ♔xf7 27 ♕g6+ ♔f8 28 ♕h5 with a draw.

4b) **17 a3** and now:

4b1) **17...♖b8** 18 ♖g7 (18 e5 d5 19 ♗h3 b4 20 axb4 ♖xb4 21 ♘xd5 exd5 22 ♗xc8 ♘e4 23 ♘b3 ♕xc8 24 ♖xd5 ♖c4 25 ♖gd1 ♖g8 26 ♔b1 1-0 Wolff-McKenna, Philadelphia 1990) b4 19 axb4 ♖xb4 20 ♕e3 ♕b6 21 ♘d5 exd5 22 exd5+ ♔d8 23 ♘c6+ ♔c7 24 ♘xb4 ♕xb4 25 ♖d4 ♕a5 26 ♖xf7+ ♗d7 27 ♔b1 1-0 Keglević-Joković, corr 1989.

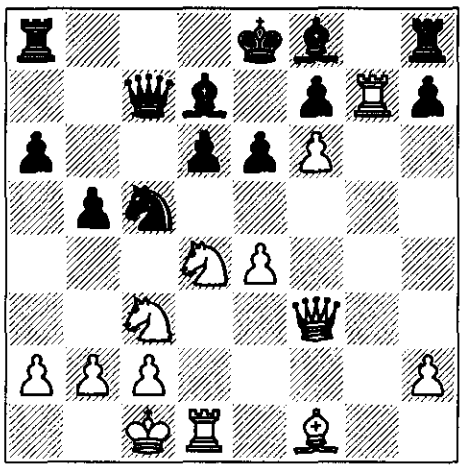
4b2) **17...♗b7!?** 18 ♗h3 ♘d7 19 ♗xe6! ♘e5 20 ♕f5 fxe6 21 ♘xe6 ♕d7 22 ♖g7! ♘f7 23 ♘d5! ♗xd5 24 exd5 ♗xg7 25 fxg7 ♖g8 26 ♖e1! +– Gueth-Schelp, corr 1990.

4b3) **17...♗d7** transposes to line B2221, note to White's 17th move, line 3.

17 ♖g7 *(D)*

The most consistent move. After 17 b4 ♘a4 18 ♘xa4 bxa4 19 a3 (19 ♔b1 e5 20 ♘e2 a5 ∓) a5 20 ♘b5 ♕b6 21 ♕d3 ♕xg1 22 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 23 ♕xd6 ♕g5+ 24 ♔b1 ♕xf6 25 ♕xd7+ ♔f8 26 b5 the position is unclear, Billeter-Salles, corr 1991.

B



17 ... ♗xg7

Alternatively:

1) **17...b4** (this appears too risky) 18 e5 (18 ♘d5 exd5 19 exd5 0-0-0 20 ♖xf7 transposes to line 3c22 in the note to Black's 16th) and now:

1a) **18...d5** 19 ♘xd5 exd5 20 ♕xd5 0-0-0 21 ♖xf7 ±.

1b) **18...♖c8** 19 ♕h5 ♗xg7 (or 19...♗a4 20 ♘xa4 ♘xa4 21 ♗xa6 +–; 19...bxc3 20 ♕xf7+ ♔d8 21 ♕e7+!! ♗xe7 22 fxe7+ ♔e8 23 ♗e2 cxb2+ 24 ♔b1 h5 25 ♖f1! ♗a4 26 ♗xh5+ ♖xh5 27 ♖f8+ ♔d7 28 e8♖#) 20 fxg7 ♖g8 21 ♕xh7 ♖xg7 (21...♔e7 22 ♘f5+ exf5 23 ♘d5+ ♔e6 24 ♕h6+ mates) 22 ♕h8+! ♔e7 23 ♘f5+ exf5 24 ♘d5+ ♔e6 25 ♘xc7+ ♖xc7 26 ♕xg7 +–.

1c) **18...♖a7** and now:

1c1) **19 ♖xf7?!** bxc3 (19...dxe5 20 ♕h5 +–) 20 ♕h5 ♔d8 (20...♕b6 21 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 22 ♕h6+ ♔e8 23 f7+ ♔xf7 24 ♕f6+ ♔g8 25 ♗b5 ♗e8 26 ♘f5 ♘b3+ 27 axb3 exf5 28 ♗xe8 +–) 21 ♖xf8+ ♖xf8 22 ♕xh7 cxb2+ 23 ♔b1, Remise-Sonnet, corr 1988, and after 23...♗c8! White seems to have insufficient compensation for the rook.

1c2) **19 ♕h5** is obviously the most dangerous move, for example 19...bxc3 20 ♕xf7+ ♔d8 21 ♖g8 +– or 19...♗c6 20 ♗b5! axb5 21 ♘cxb5 ♗xb5 22 ♘xb5 ♕b6 23 ♘xa7 ♕xa7 24 exd6 +–.

2) **17...h5** 18 ♗h3 (18 a3 transposes to line 3a in the note to White's 17th move in B2221; 18 e5 ♕b7! {other moves give White a dangerous attack} 19 ♕xb7 ♘xb7 20 ♗g2 d5 21 ♖g3 {21 ♘xd5 exd5 22 ♗xd5 ♗xg7 23 fxg7 ♖g8 24 ♗xb7 ♖a7 is at least equal for Black} ♘c5 22 ♔b1 b4 23 ♘ce2 0-0-0 with equality, Schwarz-Feher, corr 1989) b4 19 ♘d5!? (19 e5 ♕b7 20 ♕xb7 ♘xb7 21 ♘e4 d5 22 ♘g3 ♘c5 23 ♖g1 a5 24 ♘ge2 ± Olthof-Feher, corr 1987) exd5 (19...♕b7 20 ♖e1 exd5 21 exd5+ ♔d8 22 ♖xf7 ♗h6+ 23 ♔b1 ♖f8 24 ♗xd7 +–) 20 exd5 ♔d8?! (20...♗xh3!? ∞; 20...♗g4 21 ♗xg4 hxg4 22 ♕xg4 ±) 21 ♘e6+! ♘xe6 (21...fxe6 22 dxe6 ♗c6 23 e7+ +–) 22 dxe6 ♖c8 23 e7+ ♔e8 24 ♗xd7+ ♔xd7 25 ♕f5+ and White wins, Rogalewicz-Surowiak, corr 1994.

18 fxg7 ♖g8

19 e5

Not 19 ♕f6? ♕d8! 20 ♕h6 b4 21 ♘f5 (21 ♘ce2 ♕e7 22 ♘g3 0-0-0 23 ♗g2 f6 24 ♘h5 ♗e8 25 ♘xf6 ♖xg7 –+) exf5 22 ♘d5 ♘xe4 23 ♖e1 ♗e6

24 ♖xe4 fxe4 25 ♘f6+ ♔e7 26 ♕g5 ♖xg7 27 ♕xg7 ♕h8 –+.

19 ... 0-0-0

Other moves appear very bad for Black:

1) **19...d5** 20 ♕f6! b4 (20...♕d8 21 b4 ♘b7 {21...♘a4 22 ♘xa4 bxa4 23 ♗d3 +–; 21...♘e4 22 ♘xe4 dxe4 23 ♗g2 +–} 22 ♗d3 ♕xf6 23 exf6 0-0-0 24 ♗xh7 ♖ge8 25 ♖g1 +– Jackowski-Wilk, corr 1993) 21 ♘f5! exf5 (21...♗a4 22 ♘d6+ ♔d7 23 ♘xd5 +–) 22 ♘xd5 ♕d8 23 ♕d6 f6 24 ♗c4 ♗e6 25 ♘c7+ ♔f7 26 ♗xe6+ 1-0 Lobron-Chandler, Bundesliga 1986.

2) **19...♖c8** 20 exd6 ♕d8 21 b4 ♕g5+ (21...♘a4 22 ♘e4 ♖xg7 23 ♘f6+ ♔f8 24 ♗d3 ♘c3 25 ♖f1 ♘xa2+ 26 ♔b2 ♘xb4 27 ♕b7 ♘xd3+ 28 cxd3 ♗e8 29 ♘xe6+ fxe6 30 ♘d7+ ♔g8 31 ♖f8#) 22 ♔b1 ♘a4 23 ♘e4 ♕xg7 24 ♘f6+ ♔d8 25 ♖d3 ♖c4 (25...♖f8 26 ♘xd7 ♔xd7 27 ♕b7+ +–; 25...♘c3+ 26 ♖xc3 ♖xc3 27 ♕xc3 ♕xf6 28 ♘c6+ +–) 26 a3 ♖h8 27 ♘xd7 ♖xd4 28 ♘e5 +–.

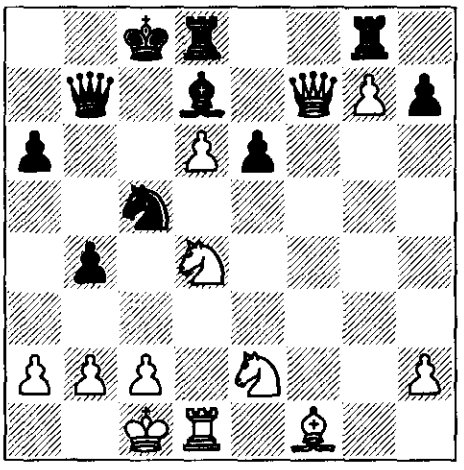
3) **19...♕b7** 20 ♕g3! ♖c8 (other moves are no better: 20...dxe5? 21 ♗g2 e4 22 b4 +–; 20...b4? 21 ♗g2 d5 22 ♘f5 exf5 23 ♘xd5 ♗c6 24 ♘f6+ ♔e7 25 ♘xg8+ ♖xg8 26 ♕g5+ mating) 21 ♗g2 ♕b6 22 ♘f5! exf5 23 ♘d5 ♕a5 24 ♘f6+ ♔e7 25 ♘xg8+ ♖xg8 26 ♕h4+ +–.

4) **19...♕d8** 20 b4! dxe5 (White wins after 20...♘a4 21 ♘e4 ♖xg7 22 ♘f6+ ♔e7 23 exd6+) 21 bxc5! exd4 22 ♘e4 ♖xg7 23 ♘f6+ ♔e7 24 ♘xd7! ♕xd7 25 ♕xa8 with a decisive advantage for White, Am.Rodriguez-Rajna, Pančevo 1987.

20 exd6 ♕b6

Or **20...♕b7 21 ♕xf7 b4 22 ♘ce2** *(D)* and now:

B



1) **22...♗c6** 23 ♕h5 ♘e4 (or 23...♗d5 24 ♗g2 ±) 24 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 25 ♕xh7 ♘xd6, Kereszturi-Derlich, Budapest 1991, 26 ♘d4! ♕b6 27 ♗h3 +–.

2) **22...♕e4** 23 ♘g3 ±, for example 23...♕e5 24 ♕f3 or 23...♕g4 24 ♘h5.

3) **22...♕d5** and now:

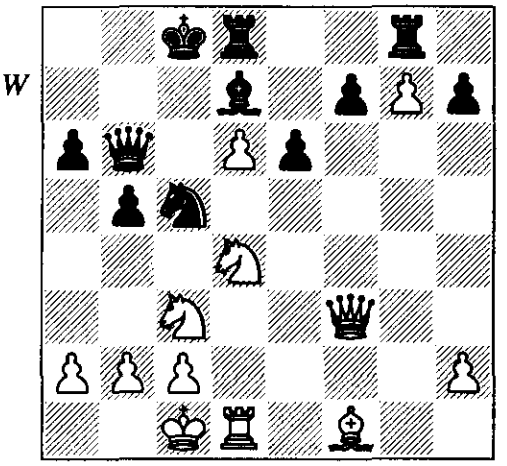
3a) **23 ♘b3** ♘xb3+ 24 axb3 ♕g5+ (24...♕f5 25 ♕e7 h6 26 ♘g3 ♕g5+ 27 ♔b1 ♖xg7 28 ♗xa6+ ♔b8 29 ♕xg5 hxg5 30 ♖d4 ±) 25 ♔b1 ♖xg7 26 ♕f2 ♗b5 (26...♔b7 27 ♘f4 ♖f8 28 ♕e2! ±) 27 ♘f4 (27 ♗h3!? ♕e5 28 ♘f4 ♖xd6 29 ♖e1 ♕f6 30 ♕c5+ ♖c6 31 ♕xb4 ♖b7, Miclot-Marcinkiewicz, corr 1987, 32 ♖xe6 ♖xe6 33 ♘xe6 ♔b8 34 ♕e4 ±) ♖f7 (27...♕e5 28 ♖e1! ♕xd6 29 ♘xe6 ±) 28 ♖d4 (28 ♗xb5 axb5 29 ♕b6 ♕xf4 30 ♕c6+ ♔b8 31 ♕b6+ ♔c8 32 ♕c6+ ½-½ Perenyi-Browne, New York 1986) e5 (28...♖xd6 29 ♗xb5 ♖xd4 30 ♗xa6+ ♔b8 31 ♕xd4 ♕xf4 32 ♕b6+ ♔a8 33 ♗b5 ♖b7 34 ♗c6 ♕f7 35 ♕xb4 +–; 28...♗xf1 29 ♕xf1 ±) 29 ♗h3+ and we have reached a key position. The game

Estevez Morales-Perez Hernandez, corr 1987 concluded 29...♔b8 30 ♖d5! ♖xf4 31 ♕b6+ ♔a8 32 ♖xe5! +– ♕xe5 33 ♗g2+ ♖e4 34 ♕xd8+ ♔b7 35 ♕c7+ ♔a8 36 ♕e7! 1-0, but there are a number of obscure points in this conclusion. First of all, it is quite unclear how White continues after 29...♔b7 30 ♗g2+ ♔b8!, for example 31 ♖d5 ♖dd7! or 31 ♖d1 e4!. Even more convincingly, after 29...♔b8 30 ♖d5 Black could have played the obvious move 30...♖g8!, threatening to swap queens with 31...♕g1+. Then White is in serious difficulties.

3b) **23 ♕f2!** (in view of the evident strength of this move, the discussion about 23 ♘b3 is somewhat irrelevant) ♕xa2 (23...♘e4 24 ♕e3 ♘xd6 25 ♘xe6 +–; 23...♕g5+ 24 ♔b1 ♖xg7 25 ♘g3! ♕d5 26 ♕e1 ♖g5 {26...♕xd6 27 ♘df5 +–} 27 ♘b3 ♕c6 28 ♘xc5 ♖xc5 29 ♕xb4 ±) 24 ♘b3 ♘xb3+ 25 cxb3 and now Black is dead lost, for example 25...♕a5 26 ♕a7 ♗c6 27 ♘f4 +– or 25...♗c6 26 ♕c5 ♔b8 27 ♕xb4+ ♗b7 28 ♘c3 ♖c8 29 ♗c4 +–.

4) **22...♗b5** 23 ♕h5 (this appears strongest) ♕b6 (23...♕a7 24 ♘xb5 axb5 25 ♕e5 ♖xg7 26 ♘d4! +–) 24 ♘xb5 axb5 (24...♕xb5 25 ♘f4 ♕b6 26 ♕xh7 ♕a7 27 d7+ ♘xd7 28 ♕d3! ♖de8 29 ♘xe6! ♖xe6 30 ♕c4+ ♘c5 31 ♗h3 +–) 25 ♕f7 (or 25 ♕xh7 ♕a7 26 ♕h5 ♖xg7 27 ♘d4 ♕b6, Tseitlin-Grünfeld, Tel Aviv 1990, 28 ♘xb5 ♖dg8 29 ♕f3 ♕b7 30 ♕e3 +–) ♕b7 26 d7+! ♘xd7 27 ♗h3 ♕e4 28 ♗xe6 (28 ♖xd7 ♖xd7 29 ♕xg8+ ♔c7 30 ♕c8+! ♔xc8 31 g8♕+ ♔c7 32 ♕g3+ followed by 33 ♕f2 should also win) ♖xg7 29 ♕xg7 ♕xe6 30 ♕g2 winning, Forsberg-Marcinkiewicz, corr 1988.

Returning to the main line after 20...♕b6 *(D)*:



21 ♘e4

The main alternative is **21 ♕xf7** (21 ♘f5? exf5 22 ♘d5 ♕xd6 23 ♕c3 ♗e6 –+; 21 b4 ♘b7 ∓) **b4 22 ♘ce2** and now:

1) **22...♘b7!?** 23 ♗h3 ♘xd6 24 ♕f3 ♖xg7 25 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 26 ♗xe6+ ♔b8 27 ♘d4 ♖c7 28 ♗d5! ♖dc8 29 ♗e6 ♖d8 30 ♗d5 is a draw.

2) **22...♕xd6** 23 ♗h3 e5 24 ♘f5 ♕xd1+ 25 ♔xd1 ♗xf5+ 26 ♔c1 ♗xh3 27 ♕c4 ♖xg7 28 ♕xc5+ ♖c7 29 ♕xb4 ♗f5 30 ♘c3 ± Sevecek-Nilsson, corr 1990.

3) **22...♘e4!** (Black just scrapes a draw in this variation) 23 ♘xe6 ♘xd6 24 ♖xd6 ♕xd6 25 ♘xd8 ♕h6+ 26 ♘f4! ♕xg7 27 ♕d5! ♕g5 28 ♘de6 ♕xd5 29 ♘xd5 ♖g1 30 ♘b6+ ♔b7 31 ♘xd7 ♖xf1+ 32 ♔d2 ♔c6 33 ♘b8+ ♔b7 34 ♘d7 ♔c6 35 ♘b8+ ½-½ Castellanos-Herrera, Cuba 1989.

21 ... ♗c6

Or **21...♘xe4 22 ♕xe4** and now:

1) 22...♕b7 23 ♕e5 ♔b8 24 ♗e2 ♕d5 (24...f6 25 ♕xf6 ♕g2 26 ♕e5

♕xg7 27 ♕e4 ♕g5+ 28 ♔b1 ♕d5 29 ♕xh7 ♕xd6 30 ♗f3 ♕f4 31 ♕e7 ♖ge8 32 ♕a3 +– K.Kristensen-Brackzo, corr 1992) 25 ♕xd5 exd5 26 ♖g1 ♔b7 27 ♗h5 ♗e6 28 ♘xe6 fxe6 29 ♗f7 ♔c6 30 ♗xe6 1-0 Chomicki-Jaloszynski, corr 1992.

2) **22...♖xg7** 23 ♕a8+ ♕b8 24 ♕xa6+ ♕b7 25 ♕a5 ♖g1 26 a4 ♖xf1 27 ♖xf1 bxa4 28 ♖f3 ♖g8, Thielen-Siegl, corr 1990, 29 b3! +–.

3) **22...♔b8** 23 ♗g2 ♔a7 24 ♕e5! ±.

4) **22...♕xd6** 23 ♕a8+ ♕b8 24 ♕xa6+ ♕b7 25 ♕a5 ♕c7 (25...♖xg7 26 ♘xb5 +–) 26 ♕a8+ ♕b8 27 ♕f3! ♕b7 (27...♗e8 28 ♖d3 b4 29 ♕f6 ±) 28 ♕xf7 ♕d5 29 h4! ♕xa2 30 ♘b3! ♕a7 31 ♗xb5 +– Wolff-Browne, Philadelphia 1987.

22 ♘xc6 ♕xc6
23 ♕c3

23 ♕xf7 ♘xe4 24 ♕xe6+ ♔b8 25 ♗g2 and now Black has more than one satisfactory continuation:

1) **25...♕e8** 26 ♕xe8 ♖gxe8 27 d7 ♖g8 28 ♗xe4 ♖xg7 29 ♗f5 ∞ Leyva-Herrera, Holguin 1988.

2) **25...♖xg7** 26 ♗xe4 ♕c5 27 ♗f3?! ♖g1 28 d7 ♔c7 29 ♕xa6 ♖xd1+ 30 ♗xd1 ♖xd7 31 ♕a5+ ♔b8 32 ♕e1 ♕g5+ 33 ♔b1 ♕d2 34 ♕e5+ ♔a7 and Black wins, Varlamov-Kirillov, corr 1989.

3) **25...♖de8** 26 ♕f7 ♖c8 27 c3 ♖cd8 28 ♖d4 ♕d7 29 ♕d5 ♕xg7 30 ♗xe4 ♕g5+ 31 ♕xg5 ♖xg5 32 ♗xh7 ♖h5 33 ♗d3 ♖xh2 = ½-½ Gouma-Hotting, corr 1988.

23 ... ♕xe4
24 ♕xc5+ ♔b8
25 ♕c7+ ♔a8

There seems little doubt that this position favours White, although the extent of his advantage is not entirely clear:

1) **26 ♕xf7!** (this may well be White's best) ♕b7 (26...♕e3+ 27 ♔b1 ♕a7 28 d7 +–; 26...♕g4 27 ♕c7! ♕f4+! 28 ♔b1 ♕f3! 29 ♖c1 ♖c8 30 ♕a5! ♕c6 31 d7 ♖cd8 32 a4 ♕d6 33 axb5 ♖xd7 34 ♗g2+ ♔a7 35 ♗c6 +–) 27 d7 ♕b6 28 ♗d3! ♕e3+ 29 ♔b1 ♕e5 30 ♕xg8! ♖xg8 31 ♗xh7 ♕h5 32 d8♕+ ♖xd8 33 ♖xd8+ ♔a7 34 g8♕ 1-0 Hamarat-Peli, corr 1991.

2) **26 d7** ♕b7? (26...♕e3+ 27 ♔b1 ♕f3) 27 ♕g3 ♖xd7 28 ♗g2 ♖d5 29 ♖xd5 exd5 30 ♕d6 ♔a7 31 ♗xd5 ♕b6 32 ♕e7+ ♔b8 33 ♕f8+ ♔c7 34 ♕xf7+ ♔d6 35 ♕f6+ 1-0 Pandavos-Kir.Georgiev, Khania 1991.

3) **26 ♗d3** with a final branch:

3a) **26...♕e3+** 27 ♔b1 f5 28 a4! ♕a7 29 axb5 axb5 (29...♕xc7 30 dxc7 ♖c8 31 b6 ♔b7 32 ♗c4 ♔xb6 33 ♗xe6 +–) 30 ♕c6+ ♕b7 31 ♕c5 ♕d5 32 ♕a3+ ♔b8 33 ♗e2 ♕b7 34 ♗f3 ♕a7 35 ♕b4 ♕b6 36 c4! ♖xg7 37 c5 1-0 Marcinkiewicz-Nimtz, corr 1988.

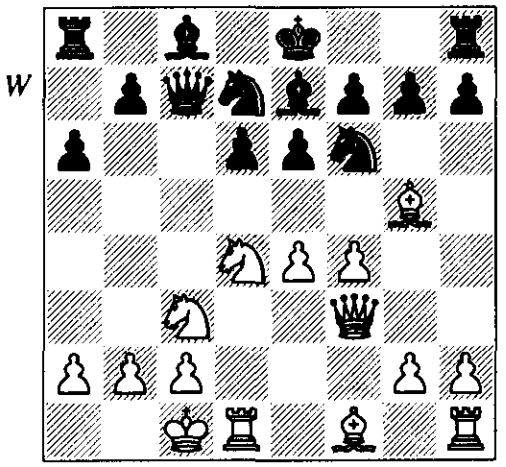
3b) **26...♕f4+** 27 ♖d2 f5 (or 27...♖xd6 28 ♗e4+ ♕xe4 29 ♕xd6) 28 ♗e2 ♕e4 29 ♕c3 b4 30 ♕c7 ♕h1+ 31 ♖d1 ♕g2 32 ♗xa6 ♕g5+ 33 ♔b1 ♕xg7 34 ♕c6+ ♔a7 35 ♕a4 +– Laskarzewski-Peczkowski, corr 1994.

The great diversity of material in this chapter makes a summary virtually impossible. Perhaps the clearest point is that after 16 ♖g1 (line B2225), the main line given above is very dubious for Black, so he has to choose one of the sidelines at move 16 or 17.

2 Main line: Other 10th Moves

In this chapter we examine White's less common 10th move options. Relatively the most important of these is 10 ♗d3, but readers should note that many opponents will meet this by 10...h6, which we consider in chapter 10. Here we look at replies other than 10...h6. Of White's alternatives only 10 ♕g3 is significant; it is played occasionally even though Black should have no problems meeting it.

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♗e7 8 ♕f3 ♕c7 9 0-0-0 ♘bd7 *(D)*



A: 10 ♗d3
B: 10 ♕g3
C: 10 ♗e2

A few rare options:

1) **10 f5** e5 11 ♘de2 (11 ♘b3 b5 12 a3 ♗b7 13 h4 ♖c8 14 ♗d3 h5 15 ♔b1 ♘b6 16 ♘d2 ♘g4 17 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 18 ♘f1 ♖xc3! 19 bxc3 d5 ∓ Ader-Fischer, Santiago 1959) b5 12 ♘g3 b4 13 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 14 ♘d5 ♘xd5 15 exd5 0-0 16 ♘e4 f6 17 h4 ♗d7 18 g4 a5 19 ♔b1 a4 20 ♗d3 ♖a5 21 g5 ∞ Benko-Olafsson, Bled Ct 1959.

2) **10 ♖d2** (an odd-looking move, the only purpose of which is to set a kind of trap) and now:

2a) **10...b5** (falling into the 'trap') 11 e5 ♗b7 12 exf6 ♗xf3 13 fxe7 (the point is that the d1-rook is no longer hanging) ♗d5 (13...♗c6 14 ♗xb5 ♗d5 15 ♗a4 f6 16 f5 ♔xe7 17 fxe6 ♗xe6 18 ♘xe6 ♔xe6 19 ♗b3+ with a dangerous attack, Schlenker-Zrinscak, Heidelberg 1979) 14 ♗xb5 f6 15 ♘xd5 exd5 16 ♘e6 ♕b7 17 ♘xg7+ ♔f7 18 ♘f5 ♕c7 19 ♗xd7 ♕xd7 20 ♖xd5 gives White an attack which should be sufficient for a draw.

2b) **10...h6** (after other moves, ♖d2 is a waste of time) 11 ♗h4 g5 12 fxg5 ♘e5 13 ♕f2 ♘fg4 14 ♕e2 hxg5 15 ♗g3 ♗d7 16 h3 ♘f6 17 ♘f3 ♘h5 18 ♗h2 b5 19 ♕e3 b4 20 ♘d1 ♖g8 ∓ Jakovljević-Narandzić, Serbia 1994.

3) **10 ♖e1** (aiming for e5, but once again if Black crosses this plan White is left having wasted a tempo) h6 11 ♗h4 g5 12 fxg5 ♘e5 13 ♕d1 ♘h7 (13...♘fg4 14 h3 hxg5 15 ♗g3 ♘f6 16 ♗e2 ♗d7 17 ♘f3 0-0-0?! 18 ♘xg5 ♘h5 19 ♗h4? {19 ♘xe6! ±} ♘f4 ∓ Semionova-Ioseliani, Sochi Ct (4) 1983) 14 ♗d3 hxg5 15 ♗g3

♗d7 16 ♖hf1 0-0-0 17 ♘f3 f6 18 ♘xe5 dxe5 ½-½ Sandler-Seglinsh, USSR 1985.

4) **10 ♗xf6** ♗xf6 (or 10...gxf6?! 11 ♕h5 ♘c5 12 f5 e5? 13 ♗c4 +– Matousek-Majzlan, Pardubice 1992; 10...♘xf6 11 g4 b5 is chapter 1) 11 g4 ♘c5 (11...b5 transposes to chapter 1; 11...g5!?) 12 g5 ♗e7 tends to lead to positions similar to chapter 1, for example 13 ♖g1 (13 h4 b5 14 a3 ♖b8 15 b4 ♘a4 16 ♘xa4 bxa4 17 f5 exf5 18 ♘xf5 0-0 19 ♖h3 ♗xf5 20 exf5 ♖fc8 21 ♖d2 a5 22 f6 ♗f8 23 b5 ∞ Unzicker-Donner, Hamburg Echt 1965) b5 14 a3 ♖b8 15 f5 b4 16 axb4 ♖xb4 17 ♗h3 ♕b6 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♘xe6 ♘xe6 20 ♘d5 ♕c5 21 ♘xb4 ♘xg5 22 ♖xg5 ♗xg5+ 23 ♔b1 ± Serper-Gelfand, USSR 1984.

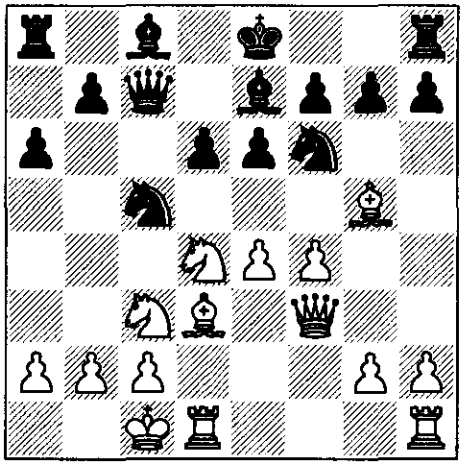
A)

10 ♗d3 b5

Or:

1) **10...0-0** (this risky move has been played surprisingly often) 11 ♖he1 (11 g4!?; 11 ♕g3 transposes to line B) ♘c5 (11...b5? 12 e5 ♗b7 13 ♕h3 +–) transposes to line 2d.

2) **10...♘c5** *(D)* (10...h6 will be dealt with in chapter 10) and now:



2a) **11 ♕g3** transposes to line B.

2b) **11 ♔b1** h6! 12 ♗h4 ♘fxe4! is good for Black.

2c) **11 f5** 0-0 12 h4 (12 ♔b1 b5 13 fxe6 fxe6 14 ♕h3 h6 15 ♗h4 b4 16 ♘ce2 e5 17 ♘f5 ♗xf5 18 exf5 d5 ∓ Oll-Ehlvest, Tallinn 1985) b5 13 g4 b4 14 ♘ce2 e5 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 g5 ♗d8 17 ♘b3 ∞ Hesse-Schoneberg, corr 1988.

2d) **11 ♖he1** and now:

2d1) **11...0-0** 12 e5 dxe5 13 fxe5 ♘d5 (or 13...♘xd3+ 14 ♖xd3 ♘d5, Koch-Groszpeter, Haifa Echt 1989, 15 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 16 ♕h5 b5 17 ♘e4 ♗b7 18 ♖c3! ♕a5 19 ♘f6+ +–) 14 ♘e4 (14 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 15 ♗xh7+ ♔xh7 16 ♕h5+ ♔g8 17 ♖e3 f5! is unconvincing) ♘b4!? (14...♘xd3+ 15 ♕xd3 h6 {15...♘b4!?} 16 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 17 ♘f3 ± Alb.Garcia-Ant.Rodriguez, Dos Hermanas 1991) 15 ♘f6+! ♗xf6 (15...gxf6 16 ♗xh7+ ♔xh7 17 exf6! +–) 16 ♗xh7+ ♔xh7 17 exf6 ♘cd3+ 18 ♖xd3 ♘xd3+ 19 ♕xd3+ ♔g8 20 fxg7 ♔xg7 21 ♕h3 +– Helsloot-Strand, corr 1988.

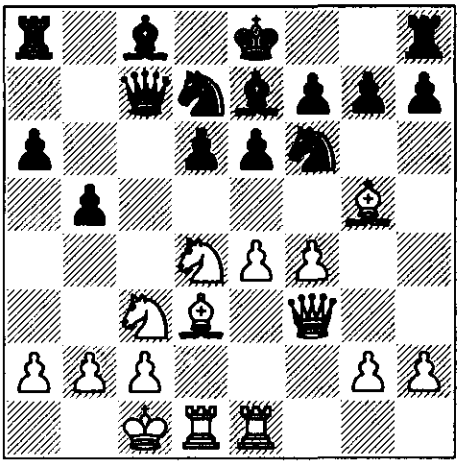
2d2) **11...h6** 12 ♗h4 ♘fxe4 13 ♘xe4 ♗xh4 14 ♕g4! ♘xe4 (not 14...♗xe1? 15 ♕xg7 ♖f8 16 ♘f6+ ♔e7 17 ♘f5+! exf5 18 ♘d5+) 15 ♕xh4 ♘f6 16 g4 ♗d7 17 g5 ♘d5 18 gxh6 ♖xh6 19 ♕g5 ± Kalish-Woolsey, corr 1983.

2d3) **11...b5** 12 ♗xf6 (12 ♗xb5+ axb5 13 ♘dxb5 ♕b8 14 e5 ♗b7 15 ♕h3 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♘d5 17 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 18 ♕h4+ ♔f8 19 ♕f2 ♘d7 20 ♘d6 with an unclear position, Joliez-Lagouche, Paris 1993) gxf6 (not 12...♗xf6? 13 ♗xb5+! ♔f8 {13...axb5 14 ♘dxb5 ♕b8 15 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 16 e5 ♗e7 17 ♕c6! ±} 14 e5 ♗b7 15 ♗c6 ± Suder-Orzechowski,

corr 1991; 12...♘xd3+? 13 ♖xd3 ♗xf6 14 e5! ♗b7 15 ♕g3 +–) 13 a3 (13 ♕h5! ♗b7 14 f5 b4 15 ♘b1 is also good) ♖b8 14 ♘f5 exf5 15 ♘d5 ♘xd3+ 16 ♕xd3 ♕c4 17 exf5 ♕xd3? (17...♖b7 ∞) 18 ♖xe7+ ♔f8 19 ♖xd3 ♗xf5 20 ♖d2 ± Rodriguez-Fernandez, corr 1990.

11 ♖he1 *(D)*

This is a position in which only rapid development can offset Black's queenside initiative based on ...♗b7 and ...b4. Once White starts to go backwards he will find himself hamstrung by the pressure on e4 and unable to take any aggressive action himself. It follows that we do not need to consider moves such as a3 and ♔b1 (although both these have been played). 11 g4 transposes to chapter 1, and otherwise the only real alternative to the text is 11 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 (11...♗xf6? 12 ♗xb5! ♗xd4 {12...axb5 13 ♘dxb5 +–} 13 ♗xd7+ ♗xd7 14 ♖xd4 ♕b6 15 ♖hd1 ♖b8 16 b3 +–; 11...gxf6 12 ♕h5 ±) 12 e5 (12 ♖he1, Walther-Fischer, Zurich 1959, and Fischer pointed out that 12...b4! followed by ...♗b7 is fine for Black; if Black can play ...b4 without triggering a crushing ♘d5 sacrifice, then he should almost always do so because the knight will be less active on e2 or a4) ♗b7 13 ♕g3 (13 ♕e2 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘d7 15 ♗e4 ♗xe4 16 ♕xe4 ♖c8 17 ♘f3 ♘c5 18 ♕e2 0-0 ∓ Carlsson-Jansson, corr 1962) dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘d7 (14...♘h5 15 ♘xe6 fxe6 16 ♗g6+ hxg6 17 ♕xg6+ ♔f8 18 ♖hf1+ ♘f6 19 exf6 ♗xf6 20 ♖xf6+ is a draw, Gusev-Labutin, USSR 1967) 15 ♖he1 0-0-0! ∓ Paoli-Tolush, Balatonfüred 1958.



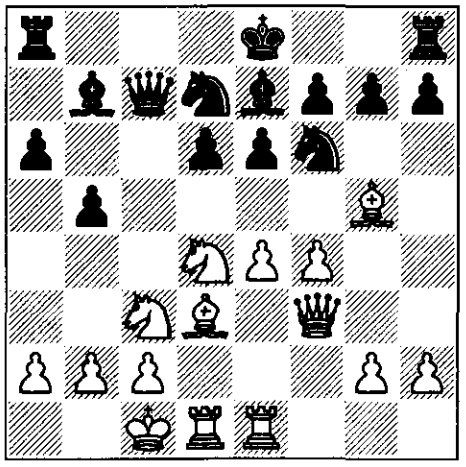
11 ... ♗b7

Rather surprisingly, **11...b4** has been played quite often even though it virtually forces White to make a very strong sacrifice: **12 ♘d5! exd5** (12...♘xd5 13 exd5 ♘e5 {13...♗xg5 14 dxe6 ♗xf4+ 15 ♔b1 +– Patelli-Venturi, corr 1974} 14 ♖xe5 dxe5 15 d6 ♗xd6 16 ♗b5+! with a decisive advantage for White, Hillenbrand-Ludwig, Ladenburg 1992) and now White has a pleasant choice:

1) **13 exd5** ♘c5 (13...♔f8 14 ♘f5 ♗d8 15 ♕g3 g6 16 ♗h6+ ♔g8 17 ♕e3 ♘f8 18 ♕e8! ♘xe8 19 ♖xe8 +– Bryson-Diallo, Thessaloniki OL 1984) 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 ♘c6 ♗e6 16 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 17 f5 1-0 Badenes-Da Silva, corr 1973.

2) **13 ♘f5** ♗f8 (13...h6 14 ♗h4 g5 15 e5 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♘xe5 17 ♖xe5 ♗xf5 {17...♕xe5 18 ♗g3 +–} 18 ♕xf5 +– Kostetsky-Garmachov, corr 1974; 13...♘c5 14 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 15 e5 ♗e6 16 exf6+ gxf6 17 ♗h4 ♖ac8 18 ♔b1 ♘xd3 19 ♕xd3 ± Lewandowski-Rosinski, corr 1992) 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘xe5 16 ♘xg7+ ♗xg7 17 ♗xf6 ♔f8 18 ♖xe5 +– Pereira-Vasconcelos, corr 1976.

After 11...♗b7 *(D)* there are two lines:



A1: 12 ♘d5
A2: 12 ♕g3

The complications arising from 12 ♘d5 are amazing, but its soundness is in serious doubt. 12 ♕g3 is also complex, but with the major difference that the main line peters out to a draw. In view of White's lack of success in these two main lines, a variety of other continuations have been tried. Here is a summary:

1) **12 ♕e2** b4! (12...0-0 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘d5 15 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 16 ♕h5 g6 17 ♕g5 ± Csaszar-Koloszvari, corr 1985) 13 ♘d5 exd5 14 exd5 0-0 15 ♕xe7 ♖fe8 16 ♗xf6 ♖xe7 17 ♗xe7 ♗xd5 ∓.

2) **12 ♕h3** 0-0-0 13 ♗xf6 (13 e5?! dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘xe5 15 ♘xe6 ♘xd3+ 16 ♖xd3 ♖xd3 17 cxd3? {17 ♘xc7+ ♖xh3 18 gxh3 ♔d7 ∓} fxe6 18 ♖xe6 ♔b8 19 ♕h4 ♖d8 20 ♗f4 ♗d6 0-1 Pipitone-Copal, corr 1983) ♘xf6 14 ♔b1 ♔b8 15 ♕e3 ♕b6 16 f5 e5 17 ♘f3 ♕xe3 18 ♖xe3 ♖c8 ∓ Fejzulahu-Kuczynski, Biel 1990.

3) **12 a3** and now:

3a) **12...♕b6** 13 ♘b3 ♖c8 14 ♕e2 h6 15 ♗h4 ♘xe4 16 ♗xe4 ♗xh4 17 ♗xb7 ♖xc3 18 g3 ♕xb7 (18...♖c7! ∓) 19 bxc3 ♗e7 20 ♘d4 ♘c5 21 f5 ∞ Solomon-Kofidis, Thessaloniki OL 1984.

3b) **12...0-0-0** 13 ♕h3 h6 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 (14...♘xf6 15 ♘d5! ♘xd5 16 exd5 ♗xd5 17 f5 ♗a2!? 18 c3! ♗g5+ 19 ♔c2 appears good for White) 15 ♗xb5! ± Mateu-Quiroga, Buenos Aires 1995.

4) **12 ♔b1** b4 (12...h6 appears promising) 13 ♘d5 (13 ♘ce2 ♘c5 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 15 g4 0-0 16 g5 ♗e7 is slightly better for Black, Dückstein-Donner, Zurich 1959) exd5 (after 13...♘xd5, the extra move ♔b1 is quite helpful compared to variation A1 below, for example following 14 exd5 ♗xg5 15 ♖xe6+ fxe6 16 ♘xe6 ♕b6 17 ♕h5+ g6 18 ♕xg5 Black doesn't have the defence 18...♕e3+, although he may still be able to defend by 18...♘f8!?) and the question is whether the extra move ♔b1 alters the assessment of the analysis given in line A1 below. However, I can't see any concrete reason why it helps.

A1)

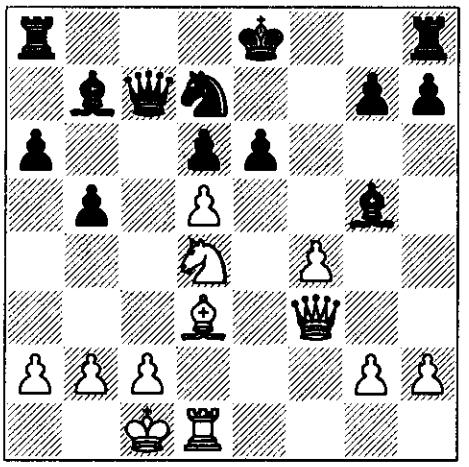
12 ♘d5 exd5

This is probably the best choice if Black is playing for a win, but there is a possible alternative: **12...♘xd5 13 exd5 ♗xg5** (not 13...♗xd5? 14 ♕xd5! exd5 15 ♖xe7+ ♔f8 16 ♗f5 ♖d8 17 ♗e6! +–; 13...♘f6 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 15 ♗e4 e5 16 fxe5 ♗xe5, Manna-Russo, corr 1983, 17 ♘c6 0-0 18 ♘xe5 dxe5 19 ♕h3 g6 20 d6 +–) **14 ♖xe6+** (14 ♘xe6? fxe6 15 ♕h5+ ♔f8 16 fxg5 ♘e5 17 ♗xh7 ♕c4! 18 b3 ♕f4+ 19 ♔b1 ♔e7 –+ Miscević-Masić, Vršac 1973; 14 fxg5? ♘e5 15 ♕h3 ♗xd5 16 g6 0-0-0 ∓) and now:

1) **14...♗e7** has never been properly analysed. Theory gives **15 ♖e2** ♘f6 16 ♖de1 0-0 17 ♖xe7 ♕c5 18 ♘f5 as dangerous for Black (indeed, it is winning for White). However, there is no reason why Black should return the piece; after 15...♔f8 16 ♖de1 ♗f6 White has no obvious way to continue the attack – all the more so as Black threatens to disentangle his kingside by ...g6 and ...♔g7. A more dangerous continuation is **15 ♖de1** ♘e5 16 fxe5 fxe6 17 ♘xe6 ♕a5 18 ♖f1, for example 18...♕xa2 19 ♕f7+ ♔d7 20 exd6 ♕a1+ 21 ♔d2 ♕a5+ 22 ♔e2 ♔xd6 23 ♕f4+ ♔d7 24 ♗f5 ♗xd5 25 ♖d1 ♔c6 26 ♖xd5 +–.

2) **14...♔d8** 15 fxg5 ♘e5 16 ♖xe5 dxe5 17 ♘c6+ ♔e8 18 ♗f5 a5 19 ♖e1 ♗xc6 20 dxc6 f6 21 ♗d7+ ♔f7 22 gxf6 gxf6 23 ♕h5+ ♔e7 24 ♕f5 ♔d6 25 ♖d1+ 1-0 Behnk-Kapischka, 2nd Bundesliga, 1994.

3) **14...fxe6** *(D)* and now:



3a) **15 ♕h5+?** g6! (15...♔d8 16 ♘xe6+ ♔c8 17 ♕xg5 ♕b6 18 ♕xg7 ♖e8 19 ♕f7 ♖h8 20 ♕g7 is a draw) 16 ♗xg6+ hxg6 (not 16...♔e7? 17 ♕xg5+ ♘f6 18 ♘f5+! ♔d7 19 ♕xf6 +–) 17 ♕xh8+ (17 ♕xg6+ ♔d8 18 ♘xe6+ ♔c8 19 ♘xc7 ♗xf4+ 20 ♔b1 ♔xc7 –+) ♘f8 18 ♘xe6 ♗xf4+ 19 ♘xf4 (19 ♔b1 ♕f7 20 ♖f1 ♗xd5 21 ♖xf4 ♕xe6 22 ♕xf8+ ♔d7 –+) 0-0-0 ∓.

3b) **15 ♘xe6** with the branch:

3b1) **15...♕a5?** 16 ♕h5+ g6 17 ♕xg5 ♖g8 (17...♘f8 18 ♕f6! ♗xd5 19 ♗e4! ♗xe4 20 ♕xh8 ♔e7 21 ♘g5 +–; 17...♖f8 18 f5! ♗xd5 19 ♘xf8 ♘xf8 20 fxg6 +– Dolonets-Balandin, USSR 1973; 17...♔f7 18 f5! +–) 18 ♖d2! ♘f8 19 ♘xf8 ♕d8 20 ♘xh7 +– Velimirović-Ljubojević, Yugoslav Ch 1972.

3b2) **15...♗xf4+?** 16 ♕xf4 ♕b6 17 ♕g5 ♘e5 18 ♕xg7 ♘xd3+ 19 ♖xd3 ♕g1+ 20 ♖d1 ♕e3+ 21 ♔b1 +– Dena-Graeser, St Ingbert 1989.

3b3) **15...♕b6!** 16 ♕h5+ (16 fxg5 g6 17 ♖f1 ♘e5 18 ♕f6 ♖g8 –+) g6 17 ♕xg5 (17 ♗xg6+ ♔e7 18 ♕xg5+ ♘f6 19 ♗h5! {19 ♗f5 ♖ag8 –+ Pioch-Pytel, Poland 1973; 19 ♖e1 ♕f2 20 ♔d1 hxg6 21 ♕xg6 ♖ag8 22 ♘g7+ ♔d7 23 ♕xf6 ♔c8 24 ♘f5 ♔b8 –+; 19 ♘d4 hxg6 20 ♕xg6 ♖ae8 –+} ♕e3+ 20 ♔b1 ♖ag8 21 ♘g7 ♗c8 22 ♕h4 ♖xg7 23 ♖e1 ♕xe1+ 24 ♕xe1+ ♔d8 is probably slightly better for Black) ♕e3+ 18 ♔b1 ♔f7 (18...♘e5 19 ♕f6 ♘f7 20 ♘c7+ ♔f8 22 ♘e6+ is a draw) and now:

3b31) **19 ♕h4** ♖ae8 (19...♗xd5?! 20 ♘c7 ♕c5 21 ♘xa8 ♗xa8 22 f5 ♕e5 23 ♖e1 ± Soos-Hartmann, Nice 1973) 20 ♖e1 ♕d2 21 ♘d8+ ♖xd8 22 ♕e7+ ♔g8 23 ♕e6+ is a draw.

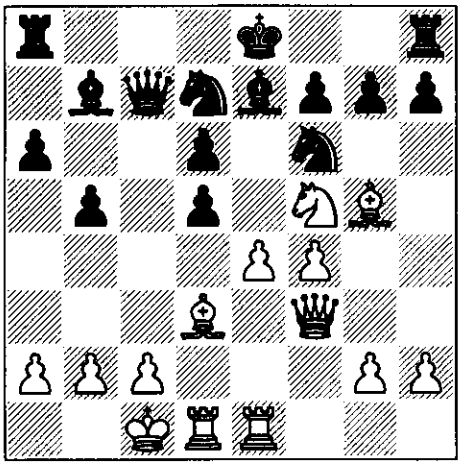
3b32) **19 ♕h6** ♖ag8! (and not 19...♗xd5?! 20 ♕g7+ ♔xe6 21 f5+ gxf5 22 ♗xf5+ ♔xf5 23 ♖f1+ ♕f4? {23...♔e4 might still draw, e.g. 24 ♕g4+ ♔e5 25 ♖f5+ ♔e6 26 ♖f3+

♔e7 27 ♕h4+ ♔e6} 24 ♕xd7+ ♔g5 25 h4+ 1-0 Kr.Georgiev-Inkiov, Varna 1977) 20 ♘g5+ ♔e8 21 ♕h4! ♔d8 22 ♖e1 ♕b6 23 ♘f7+ ♔c8 24 ♘xh8 ♖xh8 25 ♗xg6 ♕d8! ∓ Maliszewski-Surowiak, corr 1992.

13 ♘f5 *(D)*

Better than 13 exd5 ♔f8 (but not 13...♗xd5? 14 ♖xe7+ ♔xe7 15 ♕xd5 ±) 14 ♘f5 ♖e8 15 ♕h3 ♘g8 16 ♗xe7+ ♘xe7 17 ♕e3 ♘f6 18 ♕g3 ♘xf5 19 ♖xe8+ ♘xe8 20 ♗xf5 g6 −+ Lorinczi-Abdul Satar, Thessaloniki OL 1984.

B



13 ... ♔f8

Or:

1) **13...dxe4?** 14 ♗xe4 and now:

1a) **14...♗xe4** 15 ♖xe4 ♘xe4 16 ♕xe4 0-0 is fascinating. 17 ♗xe7 ♖fe8 18 ♕d4 f6 19 ♘xd6 wins simply, but in Mendoza-Royo, Tenerife 1989, White preferred 17 ♘xe7+ ♔h8 18 ♕xh7+!? ♔xh7 19 ♖d3 and won after **19...g6** 20 ♖h3+ ♔g7 21 ♗h6+ ♔f6 22 ♘d5+ ♔f5 23 ♘xc7 ♖a7 24 ♗xf8 ♖xc7? (24...♘xf8 25 ♘d5 should also be a win in the end) 25 ♗xd6 1-0. Black could have put up more resistance by **19...♕xc2+!** 20 ♔xc2 g6, although 21 ♖h3+ ♔g7 22 ♗h6+ ♔f6 23 ♖e3! is ±.

1b) **14...♘xe4** 15 ♖xe4 ♘e5 (or 15...♘c5 16 ♖xe7+ ♕xe7 17 ♘xg7+ and White wins) 16 ♘xe7 ♕xe7 17 ♕e3 f6 18 fxe5 dxe5 −+ Jitiaux-Ribaud Chevrey, Torcy 1991. Improvements for White are not hard to find. White could play for the attack by 16 ♘xg7+ ♔f8 17 ♘e6+ fxe6 18 fxe5+ ♔e8 19 ♕h5+ ♔d7 20 ♖f4 ∞ or, one move later, reach a favourable ending by 17 ♗xe7 ♘xf3 18 ♖e3 d5 (18...♘xh2 19 ♗xd6+ ♔d7 20 f5! ♔c6 21 ♗xh2 ±) 19 ♗b4+ ♔d7 20 ♖e7+ ♔c6 21 gxf3 with a clear advantage.

2) **13...♗f8** 14 e5! (14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 exd5+ ♔d8 16 ♕e4 ♕c5 17 ♗f1 ♖c8 ∓ Jimenez-Fischer, Palma de Mallorca IZ 1970) dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘e4 (15...♘xe5 16 ♘xg7+ ♗xg7 17 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 18 ♕xf6 +− Enevoldsen-Hamann, Denmark 1972) 16 ♗xe4 dxe4 17 ♖xe4 ♕c4 (17...♘c5 18 ♘d6+! +−; 17...♕c6 18 e6 ♘f6 {18...fxe6 19 ♘d6+} 19 e7 +−) 18 e6 ♘f6 (18...fxe6 19 ♘xg7+ ♗xg7 20 ♕h5+) 19 exf7+ ♔xf7 20 ♘h6+ 1-0 Vitolinš-Zilber, USSR 1973.

3) **13...♔d8** is another variation that has been analysed poorly. After 14 ♘xe7 dxe4 15 ♖xe4 (15 ♗xe4 ♘xe4 16 ♖xe4 f6 17 ♘d5 ♗xd5 18 ♖xd5 fxg5 19 ♖e6 ♖c8 20 c3 is slightly better for Black, Boey-Zagorovsky, corr 1972) h6 16 ♗h4 ♘c5 (16...g5 17 fxg5 ♘xe4 18 ♗xe4 +−, and not 18 g6? ♘g5!) 17 ♗xf6 gxf6 18 ♘f5 we arrive at a critical position. 18...♘xe4 19 ♗xe4 loses, but 18...♖c8! is better, threatening 19...♘xd3+ 20 ♕xd3 ♕xc2+, etc. White can reply 19 ♔b1, but then 19...♕d7 20 g4 ♔c7 is unclear.

4) **13...h6** and now:

4a) **14 e5?** dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘xe5 16 ♖xe5 ♕xe5 17 ♗f4 d4! ∓ Boey-Hamann, Skopje OL 1972.

4b) **14 ♗h4** g5 15 e5! dxe5 (or 15...d4 16 exd6 ♗xf3 17 dxc7 ♗xd1 18 ♘xe7 ♘c5 19 fxg5 hxg5 20 ♗xg5 ♘xd3+ 21 cxd3 ♘h7 22 c8♕+ ±) 16 fxe5 d4 (16...♘xe5 17 ♖xe5 ♕xe5 18 ♗g3 +–; 16...♘e4 17 ♘g7+ ♔d8 18 ♗xe4 dxe4 19 ♕xf7 ♕xe5 20 ♘e6+ ♔c8 21 ♕xe7 ♗d5 22 ♖xd5 ♕xd5 23 ♖d1 ♕c6 24 ♖d6! ♕b7 25 ♕g7 +–) 17 ♕xb7! (17 exf6 ♗xf3 18 ♗g3 ♕xg3 19 hxg3 ♗xd1 is unclear) ♕xb7 18 exf6 with a very strong attack, for example 18...♕b6 19 fxe7 ♖g8 20 ♗f2 ±.

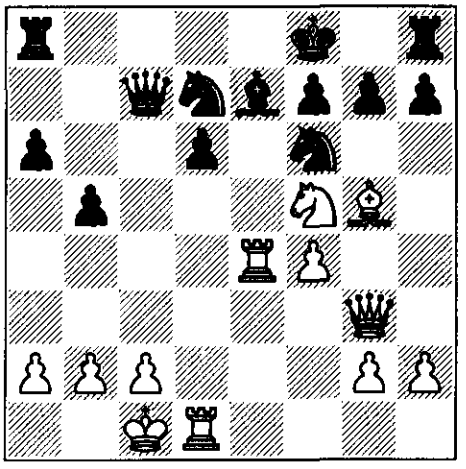
4c) **14 exd5** hxg5 15 ♖xe7+ is unconvincing after both 15...♔d8 16 fxg5 ♘xd5 (16...♗xd5 17 ♕e3 ♘h7 18 ♕d4 with a decisive advantage for White) 17 ♖xd7+ ♔xd7 18 ♗e4 ♖c8 19 ♘xg7 (19 ♘d4 ♔d8) ♘e7 ∓ and 15...♔f8 16 fxg5 ♘xd5 17 ♖xf7+ (17 ♖xd7 ♕xd7 18 ♗e4 may be best, but this is clearly at most a draw for White) ♔xf7 18 ♗e4 ♘7b6 and the discovered checks are surprisingly useless.

14 ♕g3

Or 14 exd5 ♗d8 (14...♖e8) 15 ♕g3 ♖g8 (15...♘h5 16 ♕f3 ♘hf6 17 ♕g3 ♘h5 18 ♕f3 ♘hf6 ½-½ Schulz-Schuh, West Germany 1987) 16 ♘xg7 ♖xg7 17 ♗h6 ♘h5 18 ♕e3 ♗f6 (18...♔g8! looks much better) 19 ♕e4 ♘xf4 20 ♕xf4 ♗xd5 21 ♗f5 ∞ Timman-Jacobsen, Helsinki 1972.

14	**...**	**dxe4**
15	**♗xe4**	**♗xe4**
16	**♖xe4** *(D)*	
16	**...**	**♕c5!**

Better than:



1) **16...h6** 17 ♗h4 g6 18 ♖xe7 ♕c5 (18...gxf5 19 ♗xf6; 18...♘g8 19 ♖xd6) 19 ♘xd6! ♔xe7 20 ♘e4 ♕b6 (20...♕c6 21 ♕a3+ ♔e8 22 ♘xf6+ ♘xf6 23 ♖e1+ ♔d7 24 ♕e7+ ♔c8 25 ♗xf6 ♖g8 26 ♕xf7 +–; 20...♕b4 21 ♕e3! +–; 20...♕c4 21 ♕e3 ♕e6 22 ♖xd7+ +–) 21 ♕c3! (intending 22 ♖xd7+ or 22 ♕b4+) g5 22 ♘xf6 ♘xf6 (22...♕xf6 23 ♖xd7+) 23 fxg5 hxg5 (23...♘d7 24 ♖e1+) 24 ♗xg5 +– .

2) **16...♘xe4** 17 ♗xe7+ ♔e8 18 ♕xg7 ♖f8 19 ♕d4! ♖c8 (19...♕c4 20 ♗xf8 ♘xf8 21 ♕xe4+ ♕e6 22 ♘xd6+ 1-0 Beliavsky-Trifunović, Sombor 1972) 20 ♕xe4 ♘c5 21 ♕e2 ♘e6 22 ♗f6 ♔d7 23 ♖xd6+ 1-0 Thompson-Saarinen, corr 1974.

3) **16...♖c8** 17 ♖e2 ♕c4 18 ♘xe7 ♕xe2 19 ♘xc8 +– Garcia-Boudy, Cienfuegos 1973.

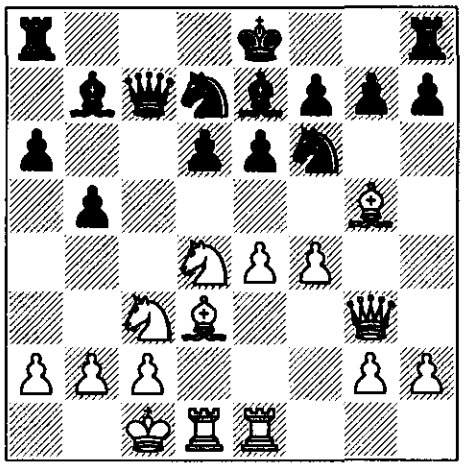
After 16...♕c5!, White has some attacking chances for the piece, but objectively his compensation is insufficient, for example 17 ♗h6 (17 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 18 ♘xd6 ♘b6 19 ♕b3 ♕c7 20 ♕e3 ♕c6 ∓) ♘xe4 18 ♕xg7+ ♔e8 19 ♕xh8+ ♘f8 20 ♗xf8 (20 ♕e5 is witty, but not very good) ♗xf8 21 ♕xh7 ♖c8 ∓.

The conclusion is that the immediate sacrifice 12 ♘d5 is unsound.

A2)

12 ♕g3 *(D)*

B



It turns out that this is an improvement over the immediate ♘d5. If Black castles queenside, then White has a dangerous sacrifice on b5; therefore Black is almost forced to play 12...b4, when White plays his ♘d5 sacrifice with an extra tempo. Unfortunately for White, even this improved version appears inadequate for more than a draw.

12 ... b4

The alternatives are:

1) **12...h6** (dubious) 13 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 (13...gxf6 14 ♕g7 ♖f8 15 ♘d5! ♕a5 16 ♘b3 ♕xa2 17 ♘c3 1-0 Leisebein-Wesely, corr 1984; 13...♘xf6 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ±) 14 ♗xb5 axb5 (14...0-0 15 ♗xd7 ♕xd7 16 e5 dxe5 17 ♘f5 +–) 15 ♘dxb5 ♕c6 16 ♖xd6 ♕c5, Geisel-Horch, corr 1987, 17 e5 ♗e7 18 ♕xg7 ♖f8 19 ♖d2 ±.

2) **12...♘c5** 13 e5 (13 ♗xf6!? intending 13...gxf6 14 ♕g7 or 13...♗xf6 14 e5 {14 ♗xb5+!?}) ♘xd3+ 14 ♖xd3 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘h5 16 ♕g4 g6 (16...♗xg5+ 17 ♕xg5 g6 18 ♘dxb5 axb5 19 ♘xb5 ♕a5 20 ♘d6+ ♔f8 21 ♖f1 winning, Chiesa-Simoni, corr 1978) 17 ♗h6 ♕c4 18 ♕h3 ♗f8 19 ♗d2 ∞ Lewandowski-Kawelczyk, corr 1992.

3) **12...♖c8** 13 ♗xb5 (13 e5!? appears promising) axb5 (13...0-0 14 ♗xd7 ♕xd7 15 e5 ±) 14 ♘dxb5 ♕c5 15 e5 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♘e4 17 ♖xe4 ♗xe4 18 ♗xe7 ♔xe7? (18...♕xb5! ∞) 19 ♕g5+ ♔f8 20 ♖xd7 g6, Poulenard-Lahaye, Uzes 1989, 21 ♘d4 and White wins.

4) **12...♘b6** 13 ♗xf6 gxf6 14 ♕g7 ♖f8 15 ♕xh7 b4, Neumann-Galow, corr 1986, 16 ♘ce2 d5 17 exd5 ♘xd5 (17...♗xd5 18 ♗e4) 18 g3 ± (18...♘e3? 19 ♘xe6 +–).

5) **12...0-0-0** and now:

5a) **13 ♗xf6** (this wins a pawn; Black obtains some compensation but not really enough) ♘xf6 (or 13...♗xf6 14 ♗xb5) 14 ♕xg7 ♖df8 15 ♕g3 b4 16 ♘a4 ♖hg8 (16...♕a5 17 b3 ♘h5 18 ♕f2 ♘xf4 19 ♗xa6 ♕xa6 {19...♗xa6 20 ♘c6 ♗g5 21 ♕a7 +–} 20 ♕xf4 ♖hg8 21 ♕f2 ♖g4?! 22 ♘f5 ♖e8 23 ♘xe7+ ♖xe7 24 ♖d4 +– Murakhveri-Quednau, corr 1982) 17 ♕f2 ♘d7 (17...♕a5 18 b3 ♔b8 19 ♔b1 ♖c8 20 g3 ♘d7 21 e5 {21 ♘f3 ♖c7 22 ♘b2 ♘b6 23 ♘c4 ♘xc4 24 ♗xc4 ♖gc8 25 e5 d5 26 ♗d3 ± Messing-Čabrilo, Yugoslavia 1973} dxe5 22 fxe5 ♘xe5 23 ♗xh7 ♖gd8 24 ♗e4 ± Martinović-Messing, Yugoslavia 1974) 18 b3 (18 c3?! ♘c5 19 ♗c2 ♘xa4 20 ♗xa4 bxc3 21 ♖d3 cxb2+ 22 ♔xb2 ∞ Minić-Novoselski, Yugoslav Ch 1973; 18 ♔b1 ♔b8 19 c3 ♘c5 20 ♗c2 bxc3 21 ♘xc3 ♗f6 22 g3 ± Spassky-Fischer, Reykjavik Wch

(15) 1972) ♘c5 19 ♘b2 ♔b8 20 ♔b1 ♗f6 21 g3 ♖d8 22 ♘c4 ± ♗xe4? 23 ♗xe4 ♘xe4 24 ♖xe4 d5 25 ♘c6+ ♕xc6 26 ♘e5 +– Messing-Vujačić, Sutomore 1973.

5b) **13 ♗xb5!** axb5 14 ♘dxb5 and now:

5b1) **14...♕c5** with two continuations:

5b11) **15 e5** dxe5 (or 15...♘h5 16 ♕g4 f6 17 exd6 ♗f8 18 ♕xh5 fxg5 19 fxg5 with a clear advantage for White) 16 fxe5 ♘h5 (16...♘e8 17 ♗e3 ♕xe5 {17...♕b4 18 ♖d4 +–} 18 ♘a7+ ♔b8 19 ♗f4 +–; 16...♘d5 17 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 18 ♘d6+ ♔b8 19 ♘xd5 exd5 {19...♗xd5 20 ♖xd5 exd5 21 ♕b3+} 20 e6 +–) 17 ♕h4 f6 (17...♗xg5+ 18 ♕xg5 g6 19 ♘d6+ and 20 ♘xf7 +–) 18 ♗e3! ♕xe5 19 ♖d4 ±.

5b12) **15 b4** ♕xb4 16 ♖d4 ♕a5 17 e5 d5 18 f5 ♘h5 19 ♕h4 ♗xg5+ (19...♗a3+ 20 ♔b1 ♗c5 21 ♖a4 ♕b6 22 ♕xh5 ♗c6 23 ♕e2 d4 24 ♖a6! ♕b7 25 ♕c4 +– Burduja-Copal, corr 1978) 20 ♕xg5 ♘c5 21 ♕e7 ♕b6 22 ♕xf7 g6 23 fxe6 ♘xe6 24 ♘d6+ ♔b8 25 ♘a4! +– Burduja-Bochis, corr 1978.

5b2) **14...♕b6** 15 e5 and now:

5b21) **15...dxe5** 16 fxe5 ♘h5 17 ♕h4 ♗xg5+ 18 ♕xg5 g6 19 ♘d6+ ♔b8 20 ♘xf7 +–.

5b22) **15...♘c5** leading to a final branch:

5b221) **16 exf6** gxf6 17 ♗h4 ♖hg8 18 ♕e3 ♖xg2 19 ♕d4 ♗f3?! (19...♘d7 20 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 21 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 22 ♖xd6 ♖xh2 23 ♗g3 ♖g2 24 ♖e3 ♖g8 25 ♗e1 f5 26 ♘b5 ±; 19...e5 20 ♕c4! ±) 20 ♖d2 ♖xd2 21 ♕xd2 d5 22 ♗f2 ♕a6 23 ♗d4 ♗e4 24 ♕e3 ♘a4, B.Hartman-West, Philadelphia 1990, 25 ♘xe4 dxe4 26 c4 +–.

5b222) **16 ♕h3!?** ♘d5 (West gives 16...♗a6!? 17 exf6 gxf6 18 ♘d5 ♕b7 '∞', but 19 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 20 ♕c3! fxg5 21 ♘xd6+ wins) 17 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 18 ♗xe7 ♕xb5 19 ♗xd8 ♔xd8 20 exd6 +– Burduja-Serghei, corr 1978.

5b23) **15...d5** 16 f5! ♘h5 (alternatives are also bad: 16...♘c5 17 ♗e3 ♗c6 19 b4 wins for White; 16...♗c5 17 exf6 gxf6 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♖xe6 +–; 16...♘e4 17 ♘xe4 ♕xb5 18 ♗xe7 dxe4 19 ♗xd8 ♖xd8 20 fxe6 fxe6 21 ♕xg7 +–; 16...♘g8 17 ♗e3 ♗c5 18 ♘d6+ ♔b8 19 ♗xc5 ♘xc5 20 fxe6 +–) 17 ♕h4 ♗xg5+ 18 ♕xg5 f6 (18...♘xe5 19 ♕xh5 d4 20 ♖xe5! dxc3 21 ♘xc3 +– Velimirović-Al Kazzaz, Nice OL 1974) 19 ♕xh5 fxe5 20 fxe6 ♕xe6, Maumey-Brzezinski, corr 1989, 21 ♕f7! +–.

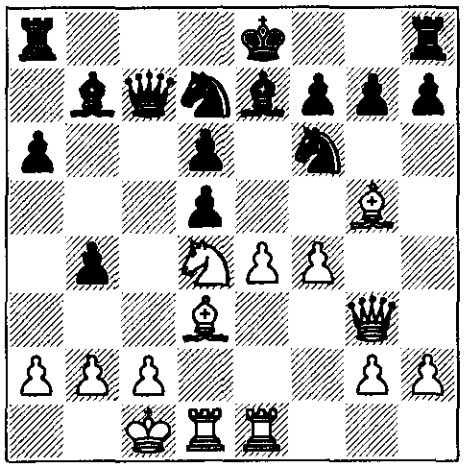
13 ♘d5

This is the obvious move based on general principles, but it is interesting to note the example 13 ♘a4 ♖c8 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘h5 16 ♕g4 ♗xg5+ 17 ♕xg5 g6 18 ♖d2 h6 19 ♕e3 ♕a5 20 b3 ♘c5? (20...♘g7!, but ± since Black still has trouble castling) 21 ♘xc5 ♖xc5 22 ♘xe6! +– Mos-Stachanczyk, corr 1993.

13 ... exd5 *(D)*

Here this reply is forced, for example 13...♘xd5 (13...♗xd5 14 exd5 ♘xd5 15 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 16 ♕xg7 ♖g8 17 ♕xh7 ♖xg2 18 ♗e4 +– Kobryn-Grzegorzewsky, corr 1993) 14 exd5 ♗xd5 15 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 16 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 17 f5 g6 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♕g4 ♘e5 20 ♖xe5 dxe5 21 ♕h4+ ♔f7 22 ♖f1+ ♔g8 23 ♕f6 +–.

14 e5



Here there is a major alternative: **14 exd5 ♔d8** (14...♘b6 15 ♘f5 ♘bxd5 16 ♗xf6 gxf6 17 ♗e4 +–; 14...♔f8 15 ♘f5 ♖e8 16 ♗h6 +–) and now:

1) **15 ♘f5?!** (inadequate) ♗f8 16 ♗xf6+ (16 ♗h4 ♕c5 17 ♘xg7 ♔c7 18 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 19 ♕g5 ♘xd5 20 ♗e4 ♘e3! –+; 16 ♕e3 ♕c5 17 ♕e2 ♔c7 18 ♗c4 ♘b6 –+ Semionova-Ruck, Balatonbereny 1994; 16 ♖e4 ♕b6 17 ♖c4 ♗xd5 –+) gxf6 17 ♘g7 ♕a5 18 ♗f5 ♖g8 19 ♕e3 ♖xg7 20 ♕e8+ ♔c7 21 ♕xd7+ ♔b6 –+ Höpfl-Scholz, Dortmund 1992.

2) **15 ♖xe7** ♔xe7 16 ♘f5+ (16 ♘e6!? ♕b6 17 ♖e1 ♖ag8 18 ♘xg7+ ♔d8 19 ♗xf6+ ♘xf6 20 ♕h4 ♔c8 21 ♕xf6 ♔b8 ± Yuuki-Abdennabi, Lucerne OL 1982; 16...fxe6 17 ♗xf6+ ♔xf6 looks better, as 18 ♕g5+ ♔f7 19 dxe6+ ♔f8 is good for Black, but White can retain some attacking chances by 18 dxe6!?) ♔d8 17 ♗h4 and now:

2a) **17...♕a5** 18 ♘xd6 ♔c7 19 ♘xf7 ♘h5 20 d6+ ♔b6 21 ♕g4 ♗c6 22 ♘xh8 ♖xh8 23 ♗e4 +– Maliszewski-Bieganowski, corr 1994.

2b) **17...g6** 18 ♗xf6+ ♘xf6 19 ♕g5 ♕d7 20 ♖e1 ♖e8 21 ♕xf6+ ♔c7 22 ♘e7 ±.

2c) **17...♕c5** 18 ♕xg7 ♔c7 19 ♗xf6 ♖hg8 20 ♗d4 ♖xg7 21 ♗xc5 ♘xc5 22 ♘xg7 ♖g8 23 ♘h5 ♘xd3+ 24 ♖xd3 ♖xg2 25 h3 and Black is not worse, although a draw is the most likely result.

2d) **17...♖g8** 18 ♘h6 ♔e7 19 ♘xg8+ ♖xg8 20 ♗xh7 ♔f8 21 ♗xg8 ♔xg8 22 ♕b3 ♕c5 23 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 24 a3 a5 ∓ Hyldkrog-Nielsen, corr 1984.

3) **15 ♕e3** and now:

3a) **15...♖e8** 16 ♘f5 ♘xd5 17 ♕e2 ♘7b6 (17...♘7f6 18 ♗c4 ♕d7 19 ♗xd5 ♘xd5 20 ♖xd5 ♗xd5 21 ♗xe7+ ♖xe7 22 ♘xe7 ♗e6 23 f5 ♕xe7 24 fxe6 fxe6 25 ♕c4 ♔d7 26 ♕xb4 ± Dybal-Mroz, corr Bielsko 1993) 18 ♕h5 ♗xg5 19 ♕xg5+ and now:

3a1) **19...f6?!** 20 ♖xe8+ ♔xe8 21 ♘xg7+ ♔f7 22 ♕h6 ♖g8 23 ♖e1 ♘xf4 24 ♘f5 ♘xd3+ 25 ♔b1 ♘xe1 26 ♕xh7+ ♔e6 27 ♕xc7 (27 ♘d4+ ♔e5 28 ♕xc7 ♗e4 29 ♕xb6 ♖xg2 ± Geller-Grigorian, USSR Ch 1973) ♗xg2 (27...♗e4 28 ♘xd6 ♘d5 29 ♕f7+ ♔xd6 30 ♕xg8 ±) 28 ♘d4+ ♔e5 29 ♕xb6 ♗e4 30 ♘c6+ ♗xc6 31 ♕xc6 and White wins, Engel-Sevecek, corr 1978.

3a2) **19...♔d7** 20 ♕xg7 ♖xe1 21 ♖xe1 ♖d8 22 ♕xf7+ (22 ♕g4 ♕c5!) ♔c8 23 ♘e7+ ♔b8 24 f5 ♘f4 ∓ Eklind-Cedersund, corr 1978.

3b) **15...♘b6** 16 ♘f5 ♘bxd5 and now:

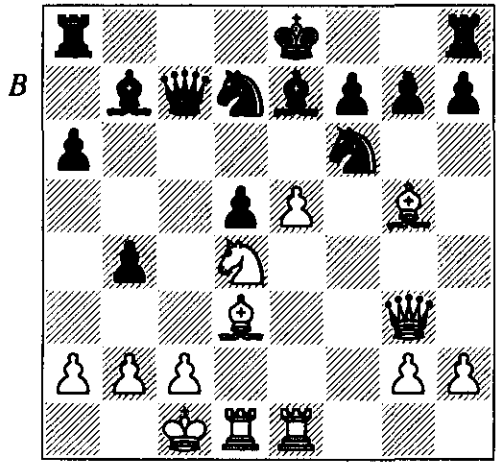
3b1) **17 ♕e2** ♖c8 (17...♗c8 18 ♘xe7 ♘xe7 19 ♗xf6 gxf6 20 ♗c4 ♘c6 21 ♕h5 ♖e8 22 ♗xf7 ♖e7 23 ♕xh7 ♕d7 ∓ Tabernero-A.Timoshenko, corr 1990; 17...h6 18 ♘xe7 hxg5 19 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 20 ♕g4 gxf4 21 ♕xg7 ♖xh2? {21...♖e8 ±} 22

♗f5 wins for White, Vrbka-Koneke, corr 1988) 18 ♘xe7 ♘xe7 19 ♗xf6 gxf6 20 ♕h5 ♗xg2 ∓ Koskivirta-Larsen, corr 1989.

3b2) **17 ♕d4** ♗f8 18 ♗e4 (18 ♘e3 ♕b6 19 ♗e4 ♕xd4 20 ♖xd4 ♘xe3 21 ♗xb7 ♖b8 22 ♗xa6 ♘f5 ∓ Schutz-Theil, corr 1970) ♔c8 19 ♘xg7 (19 ♗f3 ♕c5 20 ♕d3 ♔c7 21 ♕b3 ♔b6 ∓ Lerner-Zhuravlev, Daugavpils 1974) ♘xe4 20 ♘e8 ♕c5 21 ♕xh8 ♘e3 22 ♖e2 ♘c3 23 ♕xf8 ♘xe2+ 24 ♔d2 ♕d4+ 25 ♔xe2 ♕xd1+ 26 ♔xe3 ♕e1+ 27 ♔d3 ♕d1+ ½-½ Kohlweyer-Tomczak, Baden-Baden 1987.

14 ... dxe5

15 fxe5 *(D)*



15 ... ♘h5

Other moves have been played, but there is only one genuine alternative:

1) **15...♘e4** (this appears inferior) 16 ♗xe4 ♗xg5+ (16...dxe4 17 ♗xe7 ♕xe5 {17...♔xe7 18 ♘f5+ ♔d8 19 ♕xg7 +– Weigel-Hauernherm, corr 1978} 18 ♕xe5 ♘xe5 19 ♗xb4! g6 20 ♘b3 ♘d7 21 ♘a5 1-0 Klompus-Chaleyrat, corr 1980) 17 ♕xg5 dxe4 and now White has two possible moves:

1a) **18 e6** with the lines:

1a1) **18...♘c5** 19 exf7+ ♔xf7 20 ♖f1+ ♔e8 21 ♘f5 ♘e6 22 ♕g4 ♖d8 (22...♖f8 is possibly better, e.g. 23 ♘d6+ ♕xd6 24 ♖xd6 ♖xf1+ 25 ♔d2 ♘f8 or 23 ♖d6 ♘c5) 23 ♖xd8+ ♔xd8 24 ♖d1+ ♔e8 25 ♘d6+ ♔e7 26 ♕h4+, Schott-Frech, Eppingen 1988, 26...g5! 27 ♕h5 ♕xd6 28 ♖xd6 ♔xd6 with a distinct advantage for Black.

1a2) **18...♘e5** 19 ♘f5 f6 20 ♘xg7+ ♔e7 21 ♘f5+ ♔xe6 22 ♘d4+ ♔f7 23 ♖f1! ♕e7 24 ♕h5+ ♘g6 25 ♘f5 ♕c7 26 ♕h6! ♔g8 27 ♕e3 ♖c8? (27...h5! ∞) 28 ♕b3+ ♕c4 29 ♖d8+ ♘f8 30 ♕g3+ ♔f7 31 ♕g7+ ♔e6 32 ♕e7# Livshits-Kochetkov, USSR 1976.

1b) **18 ♘f5!** (more convincing) ♕xe5 19 ♖f1! (19 ♘d6+ ♔f8 20 ♕xe5 ♘xe5 21 ♘xb7 ♘g4 22 ♘d6 g6 23 h3 ♘f6 24 ♘xe4 ± Petrushin-Chudinovskikh, USSR 1973) ♗c6 (19...f6 20 ♕xg7 0-0-0 21 ♘d6+ ♔c7 22 ♘xb7 ♖hg8 23 ♕xh7 ♖h8 24 ♕f7 ± ♖hf8? 25 ♖xd7+; 19...h6 20 ♘xg7+ ♔f8 21 ♖xf7+! ♔g8 22 ♕g6 ♕g5+ {22...♘f8 23 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 24 ♖f1+ forces mate} 23 ♕xg5 hxg5 24 ♖fxd7 ±) 20 ♘xg7+ ♔f8 21 ♕h6! ♗b5 (21...♕xg7 22 ♕xc6 ±; 21...♗d5 22 ♖f5 ♕xg7 23 ♕d6+ ♔g8 24 ♕xd5 +–) 22 ♘f5+ ♔g8 23 ♖f4 ♘f8 24 ♕g7+! ♕xg7 25 ♘e7# Lassen-Karlsson, corr 1982.

2) **15...0-0-0** (not as bad as its reputation, but White should be able to preserve an edge) 16 ♘f5! (16 exf6 ♕xg3 17 hxg3 ♗xf6 18 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 19 ♖e7 ♖hf8 and White doesn't have enough for the pawn, Bieri-Olivier, Geneva 1996) ♗c5! (not 16...♘xe5 17 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 18

♖xe5 ♕c7 19 ♗f4 +– Petryk-Gadalinski, Poland 1977) and now:

2a) **17 exf6** ♕xg3 18 hxg3 gxf6 19 ♗f4 ♘e5 20 ♗xe5 fxe5 21 ♖xe5 ♖de8 22 ♖xe8+ ♖xe8 23 ♖h1 ± Adams-Levitt, London 1984.

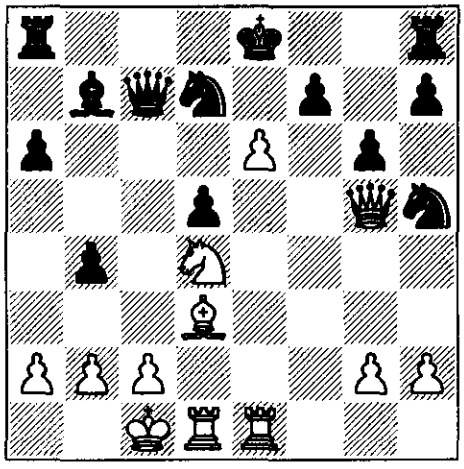
2b) **17 ♘xg7** ♘e4 18 ♗xe4 dxe4 19 ♗xd8 ♖xd8 20 e6 was Nunn-Kuczynski, Bundesliga 1994, and now 20...♘f8! 21 ♖xd8+ ♕xd8 22 exf7 e3 should enable Black to hold the balance, for example 23 ♖xe3 ♗xe3+ 24 ♕xe3 ♕f6 25 ♕c5+ ♔d7 26 ♕xf8 ♕f1+ with perpetual check.

16 e6

According to theory this queen sacrifice leads to a forced draw (but see the note to Black's 16th move). The alternative is also very complicated, but the result is probably the same: **16 ♕h4 ♗xg5+ 17 ♕xg5 g6** and now:

1) **18 g4** h6 (the move played in practice, but after 18...♘g7!? 19 e6 ♘c5 20 exf7+ ♔xf7 21 ♖f1+ ♔g8 it is hard to believe that White has enough for the piece) 19 ♕d2 ♘g7 (19...0-0-0 20 gxh5 ♘xe5 21 hxg6 ♘xd3+ 22 ♕xd3 ♕f4+ 23 ♔b1 ♕f6 24 gxf7 ♕xf7 ± Sauermann-Ertl, corr 1981) 20 e6 ♘f8 21 exf7+ ♔xf7 22 ♖e3 ♕b6 23 ♕f2+ ♔g8 24 ♖e7 ♖h7 25 ♖f1 ♘ge6 26 ♖xh7 ♔xh7 27 ♕f7+ ♔h8? (27...♘g7 ∞) 28 ♕f6+ ♔g8 29 ♕f7+ ♔h8 30 ♘xe6 1-0 Walther-Krabbé, corr 1980.

2) **18 e6** *(D)* and now:



2a) **18...♕f4+** 19 ♕xf4 ♘xf4 20 exd7+ ♔xd7 21 ♖f1 ♘xd3+ 22 ♖xd3 (despite Black's extra pawn, his appalling bishop means that White has the edge) and now:

2a1) **22...♖hf8** 23 ♖df3 (23 ♖f6?! a5 24 ♘b3 d4 25 g4 ♔e7 26 g5 h6 27 ♖b6 ♗a6 28 ♖xd4 hxg5 29 ♘xa5 ♖h8 ∓ Fiorito-Goedkoop, corr 1988) ♔e7 24 ♖e3+ ♔d7 25 ♖f6 ± Sakharov-Zhuravlev, corr. 1977.

2a2) **22...f5** 23 g4 ♖af8 (23...a5 24 ♖h3 ♗a6 25 ♖f4 fxg4 26 ♖f7+ ♔d6 27 ♖e3 ♖hf8 28 ♖e6+ ♔c5 29 c3 bxc3 30 bxc3 ♔c4 31 ♔c2 ♖fc8 32 ♖f4 g5 33 ♖xg4 1-0 Kusturin-Comini, corr 1989) 24 gxf5 gxf5 25 ♖h3 ♖f7 26 ♖xf5 ♖xf5 27 ♘xf5 ♔e6 28 ♘d4+ ♔e5 29 ♖h4 ♖f8 30 ♘e2 ♖f7 31 ♖xb4 +– Bauer-Ertl, corr 1981.

2b) **18...0-0** 19 exd7 ♖ad8 20 g4 ♘g7 (20...♕f4+ 21 ♕xf4 ♘xf4 22 ♖e7 ±) 21 h4 (21 ♗f5? ♗c6 22 ♖d3 ♗xd7 23 ♕h6 ♖fe8 24 ♖f1 b3 ∓ Sanakoev-Maeder, corr 1978) ♖xd7 22 h5 ♕d6 23 ♕h6 ♗c8 24 ♖h1 ♘e8 25 ♖df1 ♖c7 26 g5 ♕e7 27 ♘c6! ± Estrin-Maeder, corr 1983.

2c) **18...♘df6** 19 exf7+ ♔xf7 and now:

2c1) **20 ♖f1** ♖ae8 (20...♖he8 21 g4 ♕e5 22 ♕h6 ♘g7 23 g5 ♕e3+ 24 ♔b1 ♔g8 25 ♗xg6 hxg6 26 ♕xg6 ♕e4 27 ♘f5 ♘h5 28 ♘h6+ ♔h8 29 ♘f7+ ♔g8 with equality, Rodriguez Talavera-Nedobora, Seville 1992) 21 g4 ♕e5 22 ♘f3 (22 ♕h6 is ineffective here because h7 is defended)

Hendriks-Goedkoop, corr 1985, and now 22...♕xg5+ 23 ♘xg5+ ♔g7 24 gxh5 h6 ∓.

2c2) **20 ♘e6** ♕d7 (20...♕d6 21 ♕h6 ♖he8 22 ♗xg6+ hxg6 23 ♘g5+ ♔g8 24 ♕xg6+ ♘g7 25 ♖f1 ♖f8 26 ♖xf6 ♖xf6 27 ♕h7+ ♔f8 28 ♕h8+ ♔e7 29 ♕xg7+ ♔e8 30 ♕xb7 +– Rallo-Voltolini, corr 1986) and now **21 ♘c5** ♕c8 22 ♖f1 ♕xc5 22 g4 ♖ae8 24 ♖f3 ♔g7 25 gxh5 ♘xh5 –+ was Zukerfeld-Darcyl, Mendoza 1985. However, White can improve by **21 g4!** ♘g7 (21...♖he8 22 gxh5 ♘xh5 23 ♖f1+ ♔xe6 24 ♗xg6 +–) 22 ♘c5 ♕c6 23 ♖f1 ♘e8 24 ♘xb7 ♕xb7 25 ♕e5 with sufficient compensation for the piece.

2d) **18...♘c5** (after this move the draw seems to be almost inevitable) 19 exf7+ ♔xf7 20 ♖f1+ (20 ♗xg6+ hxg6 21 ♖f1+ ♔g8 22 ♘f5 ♖h7 23 g4 ♔h8 0-1 Barotek-Pospišil, corr 1993) ♔g8 21 ♘f5 ♘e6 (21...♘xd3+ 22 ♖xd3 ♖f8 23 ♖e3 1-0 Thon-Pantaleoni, corr 1986 – a rather early resignation as 23...♕g7! ∞ is possible) 22 ♘h6+ ♔g7 23 ♘f5+ ♔g8 24 ♘h6+ ♔g7 25 ♘f5+ ½-½ Ernst-Kamber, Lugano 1989.

16 ... ♘xg3

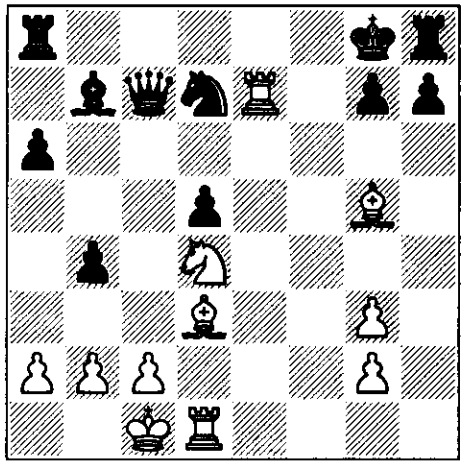
16...♗xg5+ 17 ♕xg5 ♘df6 (or 17...♕f4+ 18 ♕xf4 ♘xf4 19 exd7+ ♔xd7 20 ♗f5+ ♔d6 21 g3 ♘g6 22 ♗h3 ♘e7 23 ♖e3 ±) is an interesting and untested alternative. Tal gave **18 exf7+** ♔xf7 19 ♘e6 ♕d6 20 ♗e2 g6 21 ♗xh5 **♖ae8** 22 ♗g4 ♗c8 23 ♖f1 ♖xe6 24 ♗xe6+ ♕xe6 25 ♖xd5 +–, but there are many possible improvements for Black, for example after **21...♘xh5** 22 g4 (22 ♖f1+ ♔xe6) ♖he8 23 gxh5 ♖xe6 24 ♖xe6 ♕xe6 White appears to have little for the piece. **18 ♘f5!?** is another idea, for example **18...fxe6** 19 ♖xe6+ ♔d8 20 ♖e7 ♕c6 21 ♖de1 gives White a dangerous attack, but after **18...0-0-0** 19 exf7 ♕f4+ 20 ♕xf4 ♘xf4 21 ♘xg7 ♖hf8 22 ♖e7 d4! Black seems to be at least equal. If Black wants to play for a win after 16 e6, then this is his best bet.

17 exf7+ ♔xf7

17...♔d8 18 ♖xe7 ♕f4+ 19 ♖e3+ ♕xg5 20 ♘e6+ ♔c8 21 ♘xg5 ♘e4 22 ♘xe4 dxe4 23 ♗xe4 looks fairly drawish. White might do better to play 19 ♗xf4 ♔xe7 20 ♗xg3 ♔xf7 21 ♘f5, for example 21...♘c5 22 ♘d6+ ♔e7 23 ♖e1+ ♔d7 24 ♘xb7 ♘xb7 25 ♗f5+ ♔c6 26 ♖e6+ ♔b5 27 ♗d3+ with a decisive attack.

18 ♖xe7+ ♔g8

19 hxg3 *(D)*



19 ... ♕xg3

There are several reasonable alternatives:

1) **19...♕c5?** 20 ♖xd7 ±.

2) **19...♕e5** 20 ♗f5 h6 (20...♕xe7 21 ♗xe7 ♔f7 22 ♗xb4 favours White) 21 ♗e6+ ♔h7 22 ♗f5+ (22 ♗f4 ♕f6 23 ♗f5+ ♔g8 doesn't alter the situation as 24 ♖xd7 ♗c8! favours Black) is a draw.

3) **19...♖c8** 20 ♗f5 ♘f8 21 ♖xc7 ♖xc7 22 ♖e1 gives White good compensation for the exchange.

4) **19...♕d6** 20 ♗f5 ♘c5 (after 20...♕xe7 21 ♗xe7 we are in line 2) 21 ♘e6 ♕e5 22 ♗f4 ♕f6 23 ♗g5 is another draw.

5) **19...h6!?** is untested. 20 ♗f4 ♕d8 21 ♖de1 is a possible continuation.

20 ♘e6 ♕e5
21 ♖f1 ♘f8!

The safest move. Other ideas:

1) **21...♘c5?** 22 ♗f5 ♘e4? (even 22...♘xe6 23 ♗xe6+ ♕xe6 24 ♖xe6 gives White a distinct advantage) 23 ♗xe4 dxe4 24 ♖f6! ♕xg5+ 25 ♘xg5 ♗d5 26 ♖xa6! 1-0 Baluyev-Vadikan, corr 1976.

2) **21...♖f8** 22 ♗f6 ♕e3+ 23 ♔d1 ♖f7 24 ♖xf7 ♔xf7 25 ♗d4+ ♔xe6 26 ♗xe3 may be slightly better for White, but a draw is the most likely result.

22 ♗f5 ♗c8
23 ♖e8

It is not a good idea to play 23 ♗xh7+ ♔xh7 24 ♘xf8+ ♖xf8 25 ♖h1+ ♔g6 26 ♖xe5, because after 26...♖f5 27 ♖xf5 ♗xf5, followed by ...♖c8, White loses a pawn.

23 ... ♔f7
24 ♖e7+ ♔g8

Neither side can reasonably deviate from the repetition of moves.

As is so often the case with very sharp lines, all the main variations sprouting from 12 ♕g3 seem to lead to a draw.

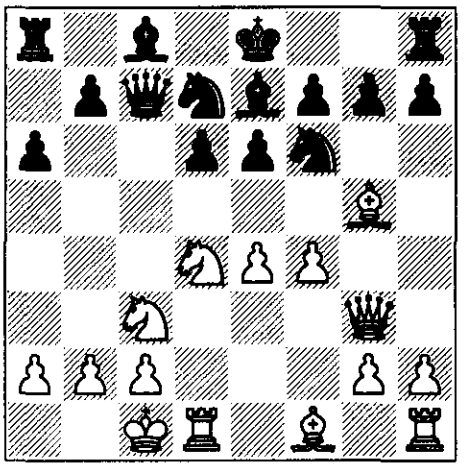
B)

10 ♕g3 *(D)*

10 ... b5

The alternatives are:

B



1) **10...0-0** 11 ♗d3 (11 ♗e2 b5 12 ♗f3 ♗b7 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘d5 15 ♗xd5 ♗xg5+ 16 ♕xg5 ♗xd5 17 ♘xd5 exd5, Nedev-Benderac, Yugoslavia Cht 1989, 18 ♘f5! g6 {18...♕xe5 19 ♖xd5} 19 ♖xd5 ±) b5 (11...♖e8 12 ♖he1 b5 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘h5 15 ♕h4 ♗xg5+ 16 ♕xg5 g6, Angioni-de Angelis, corr 1981, 17 g4 ♘g7 18 ♘e4 ±) 12 ♖he1 (threatening e5) b4 13 ♘d5 exd5 14 ♘f5 ♗d8 15 ♘xg7 ♔h8 looks very dangerous, but Wittmann-Leow, Thessaloniki OL 1984 continued 16 e5?! (16 ♘f5) dxe5 17 fxe5 ♘e4 18 ♗xe4 dxe4 19 ♗f4 ♕a5 20 ♘h5 ♖g8 ∓.

2) **10...h6** (a sound choice) 11 ♗xf6? (for 11 ♗h4 see chapter 10) ♗xf6 12 ♗e2 0-0 13 ♕e3 b5 14 a3 ♖b8 ∓ Podzielny-Tobor, corr 1980.

3) **10...♘c5** 11 ♗d3 (11 ♖e1!? h6 12 ♗h4 0-0 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘e8 ± Keres-Aronin, USSR 1957, but 12...♘h5 is an improvement) h6 (11...b5? 12 e5! dxe5 13 fxe5 b4 14 ♘cb5! ♘xd3+ 15 ♖xd3 axb5 16 ♘xb5 ♕b8 17 exf6 ♕xb5 18 fxe7 wins, Kengis-Malishauskas, USSR 1979) 12 ♗h4 0-0 (12...♘h5 13 ♕g4 ♘xf4 14 ♕xg7 ♘cxd3+ 15 cxd3 ♘g6 16 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 17 ♖hf1 ♕g5+

18 ♔b1 ♖f8 19 ♘f3! ♕xg2 20 ♕d4 ± Cuijpers-Kovac, Caorle 1980) and now:

3a) **13 e5?** dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘h5 15 ♕g4 ♗xh4 16 ♕xh4 ♕xe5 ∓.

3b) **13 ♖he1** ♘h5 14 ♕g4 ♗xh4 (14...♘xf4 15 ♕xf4 e5, Sgri-Rallo, corr 1988, 16 ♘d5! ♘xd3+ 17 ♖xd3 exf4 18 ♘xc7 ♗xh4 19 g3 fxg3 20 ♘xa8 ±) 15 ♕xh4 ♘xf4 16 ♕xf4 e5 17 ♕h4 (17 ♕e3 exd4 18 ♕xd4 ♗e6 = Petersen-Andersen, corr 1986) exd4 18 ♘d5 ♕d8 19 ♘e7+ ♔h8 20 ♖f1 ∞ Tal-Portisch, Nikšić 1983.

3c) **13 ♘f3** b5 (13...♘h5 14 ♕g4 ♘f6 is sound, since if White avoids the repetition by 15 ♕h3, then 15...b5 16 e5 dxe5 17 fxe5 ♘d5 ∞ and after an exchange on d5 his queen will be attacked) 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘e8 16 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 17 ♘e4 ♘xd3+ (17...♗b7 18 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 19 ♖he1 ♘c7 20 ♕h4 ♖a7 21 ♘d2 ♘d5 22 ♘e4 ± Lanka-Pulkis, corr 1985) 18 ♖xd3 ♗b7 is unclear, Olthof-Deneuville, corr 1985.

11 ♗xb5

There are various other possibilities, and White should certainly look at these since the main line appears to be good for Black:

1) **11 ♗xf6** and now:

1a) **11...gxf6** 12 f5 (12 ♘f5 exf5 13 ♘d5 ♕a5 14 ♕g7 ♖f8 15 ♗d3 ♗b7 16 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 ∓ Martinčević-Düster, Würzburg 1987) ♘e5 13 fxe6 fxe6 14 ♕h3 ♔f7 15 ♗e2 ♗d7 16 ♗h5+ ♘g6 17 ♖hf1 b4 18 ♘ce2 ± Martinčević-Holzschuh, Würzburg 1987.

1b) **11...♗xf6** 12 ♗xb5 0-0 (or 12...axb5 13 ♘dxb5 ♕b8 {13...♕c6 14 ♖xd6! ♕c5 15 e5 ♗e7 16 ♕xg7 ±} 14 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 15 e5 ♗e7 16 f5 exf5 17 ♘xf5 ♕xe5 18 ♕xe5 ♘xe5 19 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 20 ♘d5+ ♔d6 21 ♘b6+ ♔c6 22 ♘xa8 ± Bjerring-Van Wely, Munich 1993) 13 ♗xd7 ♗xd7 14 e5 (14 ♖d3 ♖ab8 15 ♖hd1 ♖fc8 16 ♘b3 ♗c6 17 ♖xd6 ♗xe4 18 ♖d7 ♕c6 19 ♖7d6 ♕a8! ∓ Kell-de Firmian, USA 1987) dxe5 15 ♘e4 exd4 16 ♘xf6+ ♔h8 17 ♘h5 ♖g8 18 ♖xd4 ♖ac8, Ivanović-de Firmian, Vršac 1983, 19 c3 ±.

1c) **11...♘xf6** 12 e5 (12 ♕xg7 ♖g8 13 ♘dxb5 axb5 14 ♘xb5 ♕c5 ∓) dxe5 13 fxe5 ♘d7 14 ♗xb5 0-0 15 ♗xd7 (15 ♗c6?! ♖b8 16 ♖he1 ♘b6 17 ♖d3 ♘c4 18 ♘a4 ♖d8 19 ♕f4 ♗f6 20 ♘f3 ♖xd3 21 ♕xc4 ♖xf3 22 gxf3 ♗xe5 ∓ Meiers-Petkevich, USSR 1985) ♗xd7 16 ♘e4 ♖ab8 17 ♖d3 ♕b7? (17...♖b4 ±) 18 ♘f6+ ♗xf6 19 exf6 ♕xb2+ 20 ♔d1! g6 21 ♕g5 ♕b1+ 22 ♔d2 1-0 Belluire-Pulkis, corr 1991.

2) **11 ♖e1** h6 (11...b4 12 ♘d5! exd5 13 exd5 ♘b8 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 ♕g7 ♖f8 16 ♗d3 ♔d8 17 ♖e3 ± Stasano-Sukhanovsky, USSR 1983) 12 ♗h4 g5 ∞ is untested in practice.

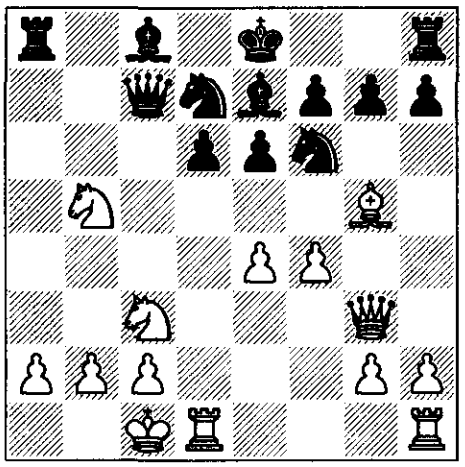
3) **11 ♗d3** b4 (11...♗b7 transposes to line A2) 12 ♘b1 ♗b7 13 ♖he1 g6?! 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘h5 16 ♕e3 ♘c5 17 g4 ♘g7 18 ♗f6 ± Pinter-Ungureanu, Bucharest 1976.

11 ... axb5

12 ♘dxb5 *(D)*

12 ... ♕b8

Other moves are bad, for example 12...♕c5 (12...♕b6 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘xe5 15 ♕xe5 0-0 16 ♗e3 ♕b7 17 ♗d4 ♘e8 18 ♖he1 f6 19 ♕e4 ♕a6 20 a4 ± Popescu-Cimpeanu, corr 1986) 13 e5 dxe5 (13...♘h5 14 ♕f3 dxe5 15 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 16 ♕xa8 +– Heinola-Anttila, corr 1983) 14



fxe5 ♘e4 (14...♘xe5 15 ♗e3 ♘h5 16 ♗xc5 ♘xg3 17 ♘c7+ ♔f8 18 ♖d8#) 15 ♘xe4 ♕xb5 16 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 17 ♕g5+ 1-0 Herbrechtsmeier-Mermagen, corr 1982.

13 e5 dxe5

This is the most natural move, but 13...♖a5 14 exf6 gxf6 may also be playable. After **15 ♘d4** fxg5 16 ♘c6 ♕a8 17 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 18 f5 ♖xf5 19 ♕xd6+ ♔e8 20 ♖he1 ♕a6 21 ♕d4 ♖g8 22 ♘e4 ♖f4 23 g3 ♖xe4 24 ♖xe4 ♕xa2 Black was clearly better in the game Strenzwilk-Renet, St Martin 1992. **15 ♗h6** ♖xb5 16 ♘xb5 ♕xb5 17 ♕g7 ♖f8 18 ♕xh7 ♕h5 is more critical, with an unclear position.

14 fxe5 ♘xe5

15 ♖he1 ♘g6!

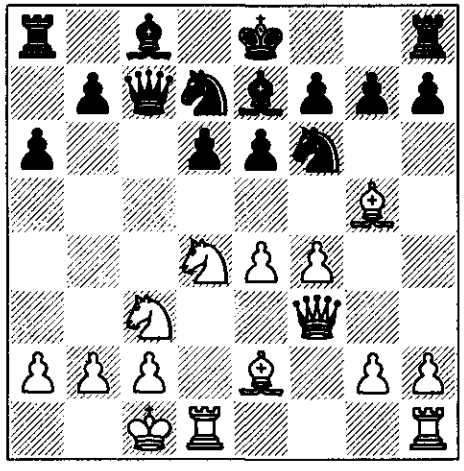
The only good move. 15...♘ed7?! (15...♘c4? 16 ♕c7 ♘d5 {16...♗b7 17 ♕xc4 0-0 18 ♗f4 ±} 17 ♖xd5 0-0 18 ♗xe7 1-0 Vitolinš-Anetbaev, Riga 1975) 16 ♗f4 ♕b7 (16...e5 17 ♖xe5 ♘xe5 18 ♗xe5 ♕b7 19 ♗xf6 gxf6 20 ♕g7 ♖f8 21 ♘d5 ♔d7 22 ♕g4+ ♔c6 23 ♕c4+ ♗c5 24 ♘d4+ ♔d6 25 ♘c7! ♔xc7 26 ♕xc5+ ♔b8 27 ♘c6+ winning) 17 ♗d6 ♖a6?! (17...♘h5 18 ♕h3 ♘hf6 19 ♘c7+ ♔d8 20 ♗xe7+ ♔xe7 21 ♘xa8 ♕xa8 22 ♕g3 ∞) 18 ♘c7+ ♔f8 19 ♗xe7+ ♔xe7 20 ♘xe6! gave White a very strong attack in Gusev-Zhuravlev, USSR 1976. Detailed analysis of this spectacular game may be found in *The King-Hunt* by Nunn and Cozens.

16 ♘c7+ ♔f8

17 ♘xa8 ♕xa8 18 ♕c7 h6 19 ♗e3 ♘e8 and Black has the advantage, Shirazi-Browne, USA Ch 1983. Various improvements over this game have been suggested (e.g. 18 h4), but these do not seem likely to alter the basic assessment that Black has an edge.

C)

10 ♗e2 *(D)*



This move was introduced in the famous game Keres-Fischer, Bled Ct 1959. Keres had prepared an intriguing queen sacrifice against the most obvious reply 10...b5, but Fischer found the best defence, which leads to an ending in which White can only hope to draw (however, see line 3b in the note to White's 13th), and gradually outplayed Keres. These days 10 ♗e2 is only played occasionally, and when it does appear the

modern treatment is not based on Keres's queen sacrifice.

10 ... b5

For 10...h6 11 ♗h4 see chapter 10. Other moves are less accurate:

1) **10...♖b8** 11 ♕g3 (11 g4 b5 12 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 13 g5 ♘d7 has been played a couple of times, but ♗e2 is not very useful – indeed, it blocks an important retreat for the c3-knight) h6 (11...b5 12 e5 dxe5 13 fxe5 ♘xe5 14 ♗f4 ♘fd7 15 ♘f3 +–) 12 ♗h4 transposes to line B of chapter 10.

2) **10...0-0** 11 g4 (11 ♕g3) b5 12 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 13 g5 ♘d7 (13...♘e8 14 ♗d3 b4 15 ♘ce2 ♗b7 16 h4 e5 17 ♘f5 g6 18 ♘h6+ ♔h8 19 f5 ± Bottyan-Mihalik, Slovakia Cht 1995) 14 h4 b4 15 ♘b1 ♗b7 16 ♘d2 ♖fc8 17 ♗d3 ♘f8 18 f5 exf5 19 ♕xf5 ♕c5 20 ♘2b3! ♕e5 21 ♖hf1 ± d'Adamo-Telbis, corr 1992.

11 ♗xf6

As usual in the main line Najdorf, White has to act quickly. Alternatives:

1) **11 e5** ♗b7 12 ♕g3 (the queen sacrifice is hopeless without a preliminary exchange on f6 – 12 exf6? ♗xf3 13 ♗xf3 gxf6 –+) dxe5 and now:

1a) **13 fxe5** ♕xe5 14 ♗f4 ♕c5 15 ♗e3 (15 ♘b3 ♕c8 16 ♘a5 ♘e4 17 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 18 ♗d3 ♘c5 19 ♕xg7 ♘xd3+ 20 ♖xd3 ♗xd3 21 ♕xh8+ ♗f8 22 c3 ♕c5 ∓ Salomon-Hermanek, corr 1968) ♕e5 16 ♗f4 ♕c5 17 ♗e3 ♕c8! 18 ♖hf1 0-0 19 ♗d3 ♘c5 20 ♗g5 ♘fe4! ∓ G.Kuzmin-Gheorghiu, Riga IZ 1979.

1b) **13 f5!?** ♘c5 (13...♘e4 14 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 15 ♗xe7 exf5, Bisco-Belan, Slovakia Cht 1995, 16 ♗d3! ♖c8 17 ♗d6! ♕xd6 18 ♘xf5 is winning for White; 13...b4 14 fxe6 bxc3 15 exd7+ ♕xd7 16 ♗xf6 cxb2+ 17 ♔b1 gxf6 18 ♕g7 ♖f8 19 ♗g4 ♕a4 20 ♘e6 ♖c8 21 ♖d8+ 1-0 Mishnaevsky-Beutel, corr 1993) 14 fxe6 fxe6 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 ♗h5+ g6 17 ♗g4 Bisco-Pasko, Slovakia Cht 1995, 17...♗g5+ 18 ♔b1 ♗f4 and Black wins.

2) **11 f5?!** e5! 12 ♘b3 b4! 13 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 14 ♘d5 ♘xd5 15 ♖xd5 ♗b7 16 ♖dd1 0-0 ∓ Roccetti-Ruggieri, corr 1991 is a typical bad Najdorf position for White. He has no real control over d5, his dark squares are weak and Black has an automatic attack with ...a5-a4.

3) **11 a3** ♗b7 12 h4 0-0-0 (or 12...♘c5 13 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 14 b4 ♘d7? {14...0-0! ∓} 15 ♘dxb5 axb5 16 ♘xb5 ♕c6 17 ♘xd6+ ♔e7 18 ♗b5 1-0 Prast-de Korte, corr 1991) 13 ♗xf6 ♗xf6? (13...♘xf6 is unclear) 14 ♘dxb5 axb5 15 ♘xb5 ♗xb2+ 16 ♔xb2 ♕b6 17 ♖xd6 ♗c6 18 ♖xc6+ 1-0 Malinen-Jauhiainen, corr 1978.

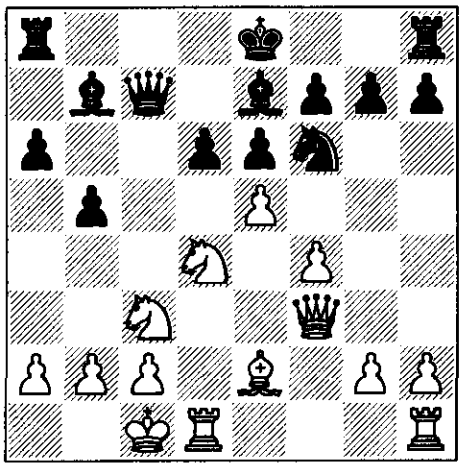
11 ... ♘xf6

Better than **11...gxf6** (but not 11...♗xf6? 12 ♗xb5!) and now:

1) **12 e5** ♗b7 (12...d5 13 ♕h5! ±) 13 ♕h5 fxe5 14 ♘xe6 ♕b6 15 ♘g7+ ♔f8 16 ♘f5 ± Doplmayr-Knoll, corr 1994.

2) **12 ♕h5** ♘b6 (12...♘c5 13 a3 ♖b8 14 f5 e5 {14...b4 15 axb4 ♖xb4 16 fxe6 +–} 15 ♘d5 ♕b7 16 ♘e6 ♘xe6 17 fxe6 ♗xe6 18 ♖hf1 ♗xd5 19 ♖xd5 ± Sarapu-Ibrahimoglu, Siegen OL 1970) 13 ♗f3 b4 14 ♘ce2 e5 15 ♘f5 ♗xf5 16 exf5 ♖c8 17 c3 bxc3 18 ♘xc3 ♘a4 19 ♗d5 ♖f8 20 ♖d3 ♕b6 21 ♕e2 ♔d7 22 fxe5 fxe5 23 f6! ± Berecz-Orso, Hungary Cht 1993.

12 e5 **♗b7** *(D)*



13 ♕g3

This move is White's current preference. Keres's queen sacrifice line runs **13 exf6 ♗xf3 14 ♗xf3 ♗xf6** (14...♖c8 15 fxe7 b4 {15...♕b6 16 ♖he1 h5 17 f5 e5 18 f6 g6 19 ♖xe5 dxe5 20 ♗c6+ 1-0 Rantanen-Denman, Skopje OL 1972}, Bierwisch-Tobor, corr 1984, 16 ♘ce2 d5 17 ♖he1 ±; 14...d5 15 fxe7 ♕xf4+ 16 ♔b1 ♔xe7 17 ♗xd5 ♖ac8 18 ♗b7 b4, Leveille-Lesiège, Montreal 1995, 19 ♘e4! ±) **15 ♗xa8** and now:

1) **15...♗xd4** 16 ♖xd4 d5 17 ♗xd5 (17 ♘xd5 ♕c5 18 ♖d2 0-0 19 ♗b7 exd5 20 ♗xd5 ♕e3 ∓ Buczinski-Jedrezejowski, corr 1993) transposes to the main line.

2) **15...♕c4!?** 16 ♘e4 ♕xa2 17 ♘xf6+ gxf6 18 c3! d5 19 ♗c6+ ♔e7 20 ♖he1 ♔d6 21 f5 b4! 22 c4! ± Mokrishchev-Makarov, corr 1983.

3) **15...d5** with a further branch:

3a) **16 ♘ce2** 0-0 17 ♗c6 ♗xd4 18 ♘xd4 ♕xf4+ 19 ♔b1 ♕c7 is good for Black.

3b) **16 ♗c6+** (this line deserves more attention) and now:

3b1) **16...♔e7** 17 ♖he1 ♕xf4+ 18 ♔b1 ♔d6?! (18...♖d8! 19 ♘xe6! fxe6 20 ♘xd5+ ♖xd5 21 ♗xd5 e5 22 h3 ±) 19 ♗xd5! exd5 20 ♘xd5 ± ♕g5 21 ♘xf6 ♕xf6 22 ♘xb5+ ♔c5 23 ♖d6! ♕f5 24 g4! ♕f4 25 ♖ed1 ♕e4? 26 ♘c3 ♕f4 27 ♖1d5+ ♔c4 28 ♖c6+ 1-0 Gild.Garcia-Browne, Las Vegas 1990.

3b2) **16...♔f8** was Browne's proposed improvement. His analysis continued '17 ♘ce2 ♗xd4 18 ♘xd4 ♕xf4+ 19 ♔b1 ♕d6 20 ♖hf1 g6! ∓ (20...e5? 21 ♘e6+! ♕xe6 22 ♗xd5 =)'. However, 20...g6 runs into 21 ♘xe6+! ♕xe6 22 ♗xd5, just as Browne gives after 20...e5 only in an even more unfavourable form since Black has lost his e-pawn! Conversely, 20...e5 21 ♘e6+ may be met by 21...♔e7! and I do not see a good continuation for White. There is scope for further analysis here.

3c) **16 ♗xd5** ♗xd4 (16...♕f4+? 17 ♔b1 exd5 {17...♗xd4 18 ♗c6+ and 19 ♘e2 ±} 18 ♘xd5 ♕g5 19 ♖he1+ ♔f8 20 ♘c7 +–; 16...b4 17 ♗c6+ ♔e7 18 ♘ce2 ♖d8 19 ♖d2! ±) 17 ♖xd4 exd5 18 ♖e1+ ♔f8 and although White has a temporary initiative, he cannot prevent Black from freeing his h8-rook, and then White has slightly the worse of a draw. Play may continue:

3c1) **19 ♘xd5** ♕c5 20 c3 h5 (20...g6 is also satisfactory, for example 21 f5 gxf5 22 ♖e5 ♔g7 23 ♖xf5 ♖c8 24 ♖g4+ ♔h8 = McKay-Zuckerman, Dresden 1969, or 21 g4 ♔g7 22 g5 h6 23 h4 hxg5 24 fxg5 ♖d8 25 ♘f6 ♖xd4 26 ♖e8 ♖d8 27 ♖xd8 ♕e3+ drawing) 21 ♖e5 (21 f5?! ♖h6 22 f6 {22 ♖de4 ♔g8 is at least equal for Black} gxf6 23 ♘f4 h4 ∓ Keres-Fischer, Bled Ct 1959; 21 ♘b4 g6! =) g6 22 f5 ♔g7 23 f6+

♔h6 = (if 24 g4 then 24...b4!) is given by Fischer.

3c2) **19 ♖e5** g6 20 ♘xd5 ♕d6 (20...♕a7 21 c3 ♔g7 22 f5 gxf5 23 ♘e3 ♕c7 = Meštrović-Bukić, Yugoslavia 1975, and 20...♕b8 21 ♖de4 ♔g7 22 f5 gxf5 23 ♖xf5 ♖d8 = Andersson-Donner, Berlin 1971, are also reasonable for Black, while 20...♕c5 21 c3 h5 transposes to the last note) 21 c3 ♔g7 (21...h5 22 ♘e3 ♕f6 23 ♖de4 ♔g7 24 g3 ♖d8 ∓ Adams-de Keyser, corr 1977) 22 g4 ♖c8 23 g5 ♕d7! 24 f5 gxf5 25 ♖f4 ♕a7! 26 ♖exf5 ♖c4 27 ♖f1 ♖h4 28 ♖e5 ♕c5 29 ♖ef5 ♕f8 30 ♖e1? (30 ♖1f2 =) ♖xh2 31 ♖e7 a5 32 ♖fe5 ♕c8 33 ♘e3 ♖f2 34 ♖d5 b4 35 c4 a4 36 ♖ee5 ♔f8 37 c5 b3! 0-1 Richardson-Zagorovsky, corr 1972.

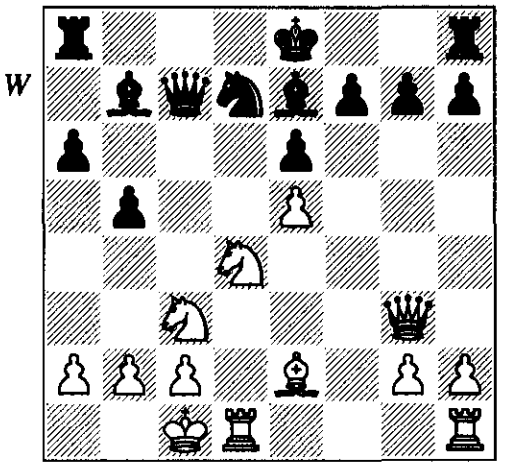
13 ... dxe5

14 fxe5

Not 14 ♕xg7? ♖g8 15 ♘cxb5 (15 ♘xe6 ♕b6! −+ Wirschell-De Boer, Amsterdam Donner op 1995) ♕b6! (15...♕c5 16 ♘xe6! ♖xg7 17 ♘bc7+ ♕xc7 18 ♘xc7+ ♔f8 19 ♘xa8 ♗xa8 20 fxe5 ± Garofalo-Simoni, corr 1978) 16 ♘xe6 axb5 17 ♗xb5+ ♗c6 18 ♗xc6+ ♕xc6 19 ♕h6 ♕xe6 20 a3 ♖xa3 21 b3 ♖xb3 0-1 Sardella-Vaccari, corr 1988.

14 ... ♘d7 *(D)*

Better than 14...♘e4 15 ♘xe6 fxe6 (15...♕xc3 16 ♘xg7+ {not 16 ♕xg7? ♗a3! ∓} ♔f8 17 ♘e6+ ♔e8 18 ♕xc3 ♘xc3 19 ♘c7+ ♔f8 20 bxc3 ♖c8 21 ♘d5 ♗g5+ 22 ♔b2 ♖e8 23 ♗f3 ♖xe5 24 ♘b4 ±) 16 ♗h5+ ♔f8 17 ♖hf1+ ♗f6 18 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 19 c3! (19 ♖d2? ♕c4! 20 ♖df2 ♗xc2 21 ♕c3 {21 ♖xf6+ gxf6 22 ♖xf6+ ♔e7 23 ♕g7+ ♔d8 24 ♕xh8+ ♔c7 −+} ♗d3 22 ♖d1 ♕xc3+ 23 bxc3 ♗g6 ∓ Lange-De Rosa, Hamburg 1993) and after taking on f6 White will have an extra pawn.



15 ♗xb5

This piece sacrifice has led to a slight resurgence of interest in 10 ♗e2, but the latest analysis indicates that it is also inadequate for White. Other moves:

1) **15 ♘cxb5** axb5 16 ♗xb5 0-0 (16...♖xa2 17 ♔b1 ♗d5 18 ♕xg7 ♖f8 also favours Black, for example 19 c4 ♗xc4 20 b3 ♗xb3 21 ♗xd7+ ♕xd7 22 ♘xb3 ♕a4 23 ♕g3 ♖e2 24 ♖d2 ♕e4+ 25 ♕d3 ♕xd3+ 26 ♖xd3 ♖xg2 27 ♖c1 f5 ∓) 17 ♘xe6 fxe6 18 ♖xd7 ♕c5 19 ♗d3, Artana-Soares, corr 1974, and now 19...♖xa2 20 ♗xh7+ ♔h8 wins for Black.

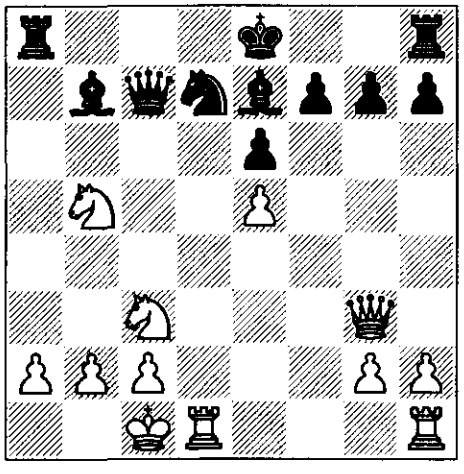
2) **15 ♕xg7** ♕xe5 16 ♕xe5 ♘xe5 17 ♘f3 ♘xf3 18 ♗xf3 ♗xf3 19 gxf3 with an edge for Black.

3) **15 ♗f3** ♗xf3 (15...0-0!? 16 ♗xb7 {16 ♖he1!?} ♕xb7 17 ♖he1 {17 ♘d5 ♕xd5 18 ♘f5 ♗g5+! 19 ♕xg5 ♕xe5 ∓} ♘c5 ∓ Morgado-Ricardi, Mar del Plata 1988) 16 gxf3 (16 ♘xf3 0-0 17 ♖d4 ♖fc8 18 ♖hd1 ♘b6 19 ♘e1 b4 20 ♘e4 ♘d5 21 ♖1d3 a5 ∓ Andreev-Kriukov, corr 1962) g6 17 f4 ♕b7 18 ♖he1 (18 h4

0-0-0 19 ♘f3 b4 20 ♘e2 ♘c5 21 ♘g5 ♖df8 22 ♕e3 h6 23 ♘f3 ♖d8 ∓ Larsen-Portisch, Manila 1974) ♘c5 (18...0-0-0 19 ♘e4 ♔b8 20 ♘b3 ♘b6 21 ♘d6!? ♗xd6 22 ♖xd6 ♖xd6 23 exd6 ♘d5 24 f5 gxf5 25 ♘c5 ♕c6 26 d7+ ♔a7 27 ♕h4 ∞ Morgado-Sanakoev, corr 1978) 19 ♕f3 0-0-0 20 ♕xb7+ ♔xb7 21 ♘f3 h6 22 ♖g1 ♖xd1+ 23 ♖xd1 ♔c7 24 h4!? ♘d7 25 a4 b4 26 ♘e2 ♘b6 27 b3 ♘d5 ∓ Kling-Tenev Teno, corr 1992.

15 ... axb5

16 ♘dxb5 *(D)*



B

16 ... ♕c5

The best square for the queen, e.g. **16...♕b6** (16...♕xe5 17 ♘c7+ ♔f8 18 ♘xa8 ♕xg3 19 hxg3 ♗g5+ 20 ♔b1 ♔e7 21 ♘c7 ♗xg2 22 ♖he1 +– Morgado-Carvalho, corr 1971) **17 ♕xg7 0-0-0 18 ♕xf7 ♗g5+ 19 ♔b1 ♘xe5 20 ♕g7 ♘g6** and now:

1) **21 a4** ♗d2! 22 ♖hf1 ♗f4? (22...♖dg8 ∞) 23 ♖xd8+ ♕xd8 24 ♖xf4! ♘xf4 25 ♕e5 ♖f8 26 ♘d6+ ♔b8 27 ♘cb5 ♔a8? (27...♘g6) 28 ♕c5 ♕b8 29 ♕b6 1-0 Morgado-Beretta, corr 1973.

2) **21 ♖xd8+** ♕xd8 22 ♖d1 ♕e7 23 ♕d4 ♗f4? (23...♖d8 24 ♘d6+ ♖xd6 25 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 26 ♖xd6 ±) 24 g3 ♗e5 25 ♕b6 ♗b8 26 ♘a4 ♘e5 27 ♕a5! ♗c6 28 ♕a6+ 1-0 Rinaldi-Paredes Prats, corr 1991.

17 ♕xg7 ♕xe5!

The simplest solution to Black's problems. The alternatives are risky:

1) **17...♖f8** 18 ♖he1 0-0-0 (or 18...♖c8 19 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 20 exd6 ♕f5 21 ♖d2 ♔d8 22 b3 ♕f6 23 ♕xf6+ ♘xf6 = Morgado-Celis, corr 1973) 19 ♖d4 (19 g3 ♗f3 20 ♖d4 ♗c6 21 a4 ♔b8 22 b4 ♕b6 23 ♖ed1 ♕a6 24 ♘d6 ♗xd6 25 exd6 ♗xa4 26 b5 ♗xb5 27 ♖b4 ♕a3+ 28 ♖b2 ± Pyda-Zolnierowicz, Polish Ch 1990) ♗c6 20 a4 ♖g8 21 ♕xf7 ♖xg2 22 ♖ed1 ♔b7 23 ♕xe6 (23 b4 ♗g5+ 24 ♔b2 ♕e7 ∞) ♘f8 24 ♘d6+ ± Cella-Zabala, corr 1986.

2) **17...0-0-0** 18 ♕xf7 ♗g5+ (or 18...♗xg2 19 ♖hg1 ♗c6 20 ♕xe6 ♗xb5 21 ♘xb5 ♕xb5 22 ♕xe7 ♕xe5 23 ♕a3 ± Borgognoni-Cassibba, corr 1988) 19 ♔b1 ♘xe5 20 ♕xe6+ ♔b8 21 ♘d6 h5 (21...♗f4 22 ♘xb7 ♔xb7 23 g3 ♗e3 24 ♘e4 +– Salvadori-Maffel, corr 1987) 22 ♘ce4 ♗xe4 23 ♘xe4 ♕e7 24 ♕b6+ ♔a8 25 ♘d6 +– Fernandez-Saez Vinas, corr 1986.

18 ♘c7+

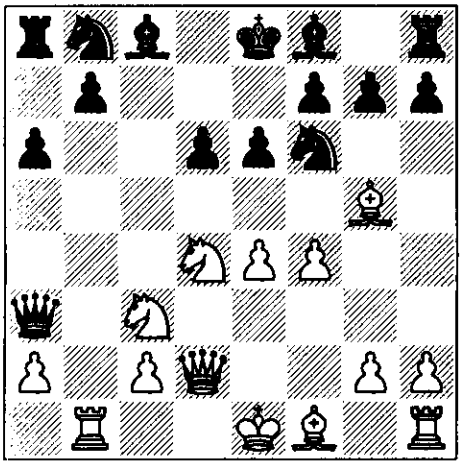
After 18 ♕xe5 ♘xe5 19 ♘c7+ ♔f8 20 ♘xa8 ♗xa8 21 ♖he1 ♘g4 Black is at least equal.

18 ... ♕xc7

Now 19 ♕xh8+ ♘f8 20 ♕g8 ♖a5 leads to a position in which Black's active pieces more than compensate for White's nominal material advantage. Mischke-Braczko, corr 1991 continued 21 ♖hf1 ♗g5+ 22 ♔b1 ♗xg2 23 ♖g1 ♕xh2 24 b4?? ♕f4 0-1.

3 Poisoned Pawn: 9 ♖b1 ♕a3 10 ♗xf6

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♕b6 8 ♕d2 ♕xb2 9 ♖b1 ♕a3 *(D)*



This position is the starting point for the 'main lines' of the Poisoned Pawn. It is possible for White to deviate on move 8 or 9, but apart from 9 ♘b3 these lines are not thought critical. While the Poisoned Pawn enjoyed decades of popularity from the 1950s to the 1980s, it has suffered a sharp decline in the closing years of the century. Partly this is due to fear of the vast amount of theory to be learnt, and partly it is due to lack of a really promising line for White. However, the Poisoned Pawn remains popular in correspondence chess. My own (very personal) opinion is that if there is a good line against it, then such a line will be based on 9 ♘b3 rather than 9 ♖b1. This view is based on the fact that the older 9 ♖b1 lines have been analysed to enormous depth without any really convincing possibility emerging for White. One line after another has appeared promising for White, only for Black to devise a more accurate response and put White players back on the defensive.

For this reason the lines with 9 ♖b1 are currently of less importance than hitherto, although it must be stressed that Black should be thoroughly familiar with them, if only because the slightest misstep spells instant disaster.

After 9...♕a3 White can continue the attack in a variety of ways. 10 ♗xf6, the topic of this chapter, is comparatively quiet; White breaks up Black's pawns and then simply develops. The assumption is that Black's continuing problems with his king will persist and allow White to gradually build up his attack. However, there is little convincing evidence to support this theory.

10 ♗e2, a line which was almost unknown before 1980, took centre stage during the 1980s. This line again aims for an e5 breakthrough, but only after White has completed his development by castling. It is considered in chapter 4, but currently it is not thought critical.

White's most direct method is 10 e5, which will be analysed in chapter

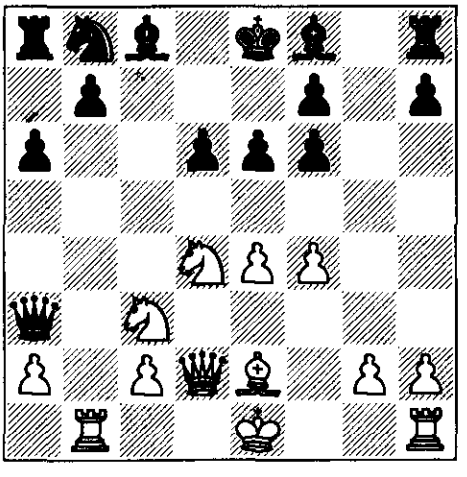
5. Although there are still many unanswered questions after 10 e5, the tides of fashion have turned against it and important developments have been few and far between in the 1980s and 1990s.

Finally we come to the main line 10 f5. Eventually a supercomputer will probably tell us what the result should be, but until then readers will have to make do with chapters 6 and 7.

10 ♗xf6 gxf6
11 ♗e2 *(D)*

Not 11 f5? (11 ♗d3? and 11 ♗c4? are both met by 11...♕c5) ♗h6! and Black has a clear advantage after 12 ♕xh6 ♕xc3+ 13 ♕d2 ♕xd2+ 14 ♔xd2 ♔e7, Bannik-Tolush, USSR Ch 1957, or 12 ♕d3 ♘c6 13 fxe6 fxe6 14 ♘xc6 bxc6 15 e5 dxe5 16 ♕h3 0-0, Stanković-Bangiev, Pula 1990.

B



Now there are two main lines:
A: 11...♘c6
B: 11...♗g7

Or 11...h5 (it is unnecessarily committal to play ...h5 so soon) 12 0-0 ♘d7 (Black could try to reach line A by 12...♘c6, but if ...♘c6 is the plan, it is better to play it at move 11) 13 ♔h1 (13 ♗f3 ♘c5? 14 e5! fxe5 15 fxe5 dxe5 16 ♘b3 ♕b4 17 ♔h1 ♘a4 18 ♘xa4 ♕xa4 19 ♕g5! ± Spasov-Tukmakov, Ybbs 1968, but 13...♕a5, 13...♕c5 and 13...♗e7 have all been suggested as improvements) ♘c5 (13...♕c5 14 ♖f3 ♗e7 15 ♖h3 h4 16 f5 ♘b6 17 ♘d1! Simagin-Stein, USSR Ch 1961 appears promising for White) 14 ♖f3 (14 e5!? is a better chance, by analogy with Spasov-Tukmakov above) ♕a5 15 ♘b3 (15 f5 ♗d7 16 ♘b3 ♘xb3 17 ♖xb3 ♗c6 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♖xf6 ♕e5 = Jimenez-Tringov, Leningrad 1967) ♕c7 16 ♘xc5 dxc5 17 f5 ♗d7 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 e5!? ♕xe5 20 ♖e3 (20 ♖xb7 ♗d6 21 ♖h3 h4 ∞) ♗h6 21 ♕xd7+ ♔xd7 22 ♖xe5 fxe5 was better for Black in Velimirović-Tringov, Osijek 1978, although White held the draw. Playing ...♘d7 appears illogical to me. Black has to move the knight again in order to develop his c8-bishop, and Black does not challenge the centralised knight on d4.

A)
11 ... ♘c6

Current theory considers this best; Black is assured of a satisfactory game with little risk.

12 ♘xc6

Or **12 ♘b3** (12 ♖b3 ♕a5 13 ♘xc6 bxc6 14 f5 exf5 15 0-0 ♗e6 16 ♖b7 fxe4 17 ♖xf6 0-0-0 ∓, Novopashin-Korchnoi, USSR Ch 1962) with the alternatives:

1) **12...h5** 13 0-0 ♗d7 14 ♖f3 and now **14...0-0-0?!** 15 ♔h1 h4 16 ♕e1 gave White attacking chances in Kupreichik-Mukhin, Kiev 1970, but **14...♖c8!** 15 ♔h1 b5 was fine for

Black after 16 ♖e1 ♗e7 17 ♖h3 h4, as in Tukmakov-Platonov, USSR Ch 1970, or 16 ♖h3 h4 17 ♕e1 ♗g7 18 ♖d1 ♘e7, Tal-Sakharov, USSR Ch 1969.

2) **12...♕b4** (threatening to extract the queen by ...♕b6) 13 ♕e3 ♘a5 14 ♘d4 ♕a3 (this looks rather odd, but it isn't clear who has lost more time) 15 0-0 ♗d7 16 f5 ♕c5 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♔h1 ♖c8 19 ♕f2 ♗g7 20 e5 0-0 −+ Rohde-Schroer, New York 1986.

3) **12...♗g7** 13 f5 (13 0-0 f5! 14 exf5 ♕b4 is at least equal for Black, Rossetto-Panno, Mar del Plata 1962) 0-0 14 0-0 transposes to line B.

Playing 12 ♘b3 is inconsistent, in that 9 ♘b3 often induces Black to continue ...♕a3 without any necessity for ♖b1. Here White has played both ♖b1 and ♘b3, a combination which amounts to the loss of nearly a whole tempo.

12 ... bxc6
13 0-0 ♕a5

Or:

1) **13...♗g7** 14 ♔h1 0-0 (14...d5 15 exd5 f5 16 ♖b3 ♕d6 17 ♕e3 cxd5 18 ♘xd5 0-0 19 ♘b6 ♖b8 was level in Lhagvasuren-Pigusov, Ulan Bator 1984, but not 14...♕c5+ 15 ♔h1 f5 16 exf5 exf5 17 ♘a4 ♕d4 18 ♕xd4 ♗xd4 19 ♖d1 ± Bronstein-Suetin, USSR Ch 1966) 15 ♖b3 (15 f5 ♕a5 16 ♖f3 exf5 17 ♕xd6 ♗e6 18 ♖bf1 fxe4 19 ♘xe4 ♕e5 20 ♗d3, Zinser-Buljovčić, Reggio Emilia 1966, and now 20...♕xd6 21 ♘xd6 ♗xa2 22 ♖h3 h6 23 ♘f5 ♗e6 is equal according to Marić) ♕a5 16 ♕xd6 ♖a7 17 ♖a3 ♖d8 18 ♖xa5 ♖xd6 is ±, but Black held the draw in Matanović-Minić, Vrnjačka Banja 1962, and Matanović-Tringov, Kecskemet Z 1964.

2) **13...h5** 14 ♔h1 (14 f5?! ♕c5+ 15 ♔h1 ♕e5 16 ♕d3 d5! 17 exd5 ♗d6 18 ♕h3 exd5 19 ♘a4 ♖b8 20 ♖be1 ♔f8 21 c3 ♕e4 ∓ Grosar-Ftačnik, Vienna 1986) ♕a5 15 ♖b3 ♗e7 (15...h4 16 h3 ♗e7 17 ♗f3 ♔f8 18 ♕f2 d5 19 exd5 cxd5 20 f5 ♕c5 21 ♕d2 ♖a7 22 ♘xd5! ± Chekhov-Dementiev, Riga 1976) 16 ♕e3 (16 ♕d4 d5 17 exd5 cxd5 18 ♘a4 ♖h6! ∓ Olthof-Barlov, Liège 1981) h4 17 ♗g4 d5 (17...♔f8!?) 18 exd5 cxd5 19 f5 ♕c5 20 ♕e2 ♕c4 21 fxe6 ♕xe2 22 exf7+ = Yoffe-Lubin, Leningrad 1972.

3) **13...d5?!** is much more risky, for example:

3a) **14 ♔h1** ♕a5 15 f5 ♗b4 (the move 15...♗g7 has been suggested, but 16 exd5 cxd5 transposes to 3b) 16 ♖b3 dxe4 17 ♕d4 ♗xc3 18 ♖xc3 e5 19 ♕e3 ♗d7 20 ♖c5 ♕d8 21 ♕xe4 0-0 22 ♖xe5! ♗e6 23 fxe6 fxe5 24 exf7+ 1-0 Minić-Korchnoi, Yugoslavia v USSR match 1963

3b) **14 exd5** cxd5 15 f5 ♕a5 16 ♔h1 ♗d6 (16...♗g7 17 ♖f3 0-0 18 ♖bf1 ♗d7 19 ♖g3 ♔h8 20 ♗h5 ♖ac8 21 ♖ff3 h6 22 ♖xg7 ♔xg7 23 ♖g3+ ♔h7 24 ♗g6+ ♔g7 25 ♗h7+ 1-0 Parma-Ramirez, Torremolinos 1963) 17 fxe6 ♗xe6 18 ♖xf6! ♗e5 19 ♕h6! with a very dangerous attack, Shmuter-Timoshenko, Nikolaev Z 1993.

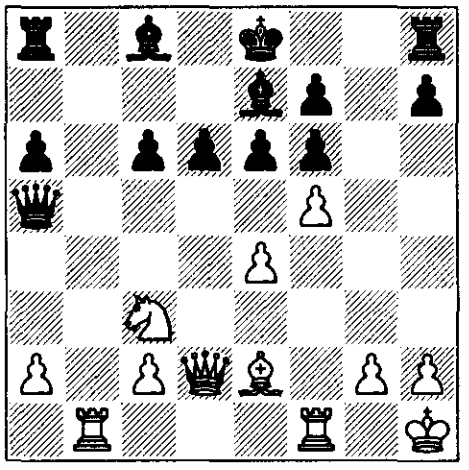
14 ♔h1 ♗e7

14...d5?! transposes to line 3a of the previous note.

15 f5 *(D)*

Or 15 ♕e1 (15 ♖f3 ♖a7! 16 f5 ♖b7 17 ♖bf1 h5 18 ♗c4 d5 is at least equal for Black, Parma-Bertok,

Vrnjačka Banja 1962) and now both **15...h5** 16 ♕g3 ♔f8 17 ♖b3 h4 18 ♕f3 d5 19 exd5 (19 ♗d3! f5 20 exf5 exf5 21 ♘d1 ∞) exd5 20 h3 f5! Brodsky-Zagorskis, Berlin 1993 and **15...♖a7** 16 ♖b8 ♕c7 17 ♖b3 ♖b7 18 ♕g3 ♖xb3 19 axb3 ♕a5 20 ♘d1 ♔f8, Brodsky-Zilbershtein, St Petersburg 1993 were fine for Black.



B

15 ... h5!

Better than the old line 15...exf5 16 exf5 ♗xf5 17 ♗xa6! (not 17 ♗f3? 0-0 18 ♗xc6 ♖ac8 and now 19 ♗b7? ♖xc3 20 ♖xf5 ♖b3! 0-1 Marić-Gligorić, Belgrade 1962 or 19 ♕d4 ♕e5! 20 ♕xe5 fxe5 21 ♘d5 ♗h4! ∓, Gunsberger-Stanciu, Romanian Ch 1964) ♕xa6 (17...♖xa6? 18 ♖b8+ ♗d8 19 ♕xd6) 18 ♖xf5 d5 19 ♖e1 ♕b7 20 ♕h6! (20 ♖xf6 0-0 21 ♕g5+ ♔h8 22 ♕e5 ♗xf6 23 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 24 ♖e3 ♖fe8 25 ♕g5+ ♔h8 26 ♕f6+ ½-½ Matanović-Bertok, Yugoslav Ch 1962) 0-0-0 21 ♕h3 ♕d7 22 ♘a4 and Black's king is still very exposed, Molli-Gonzales, corr 1964.

The move 15...h5! may seem slow, but both sides suffer from a shortage of constructive moves. In particular Black doesn't want to play ...♗d7 or ...♖a7 for fear of the white rook penetrating to b7 or b8. Moreover, Black's king is going to have to stay in the centre. The move ...h5 not only prepares a possible safe spot for the king at f8, but also creates threats of its own. The idea is to play ...h4 and attack h2 by ...♕e5, ...d5 and ...♗d6. White must generate threats quickly, but the solid wall of black pawns across the centre makes this tricky.

16 ♕d3

16 ♗f3 **e5** 17 ♕d3 ♕c7 (17...h4 18 ♕c4 ♕c5 19 ♕xc5 dxc5 20 ♘a4 is also ±) 18 ♖b3 ♖b8 19 ♖xb8 ♕xb8 20 ♕c4 ♕c7 21 ♖b1 and White has more than enough compensation for the pawn, Velimirović-Gavrikov, Vršac 1985. However the move 16...e5 is dubious because it cuts out Black's main plan; instead he should meet the threat of e5 by the simple **16...♔f8!**, for example 17 ♖b3 ♖a7 (17...♕e5 and 17...h4 are also promising) 18 ♕f2 ♖b7 19 ♘e2 ♖xb3 20 axb3 exf5 21 exf5 d5 ∓ Ziegler-Magnusson, Rilton Cup 1988.

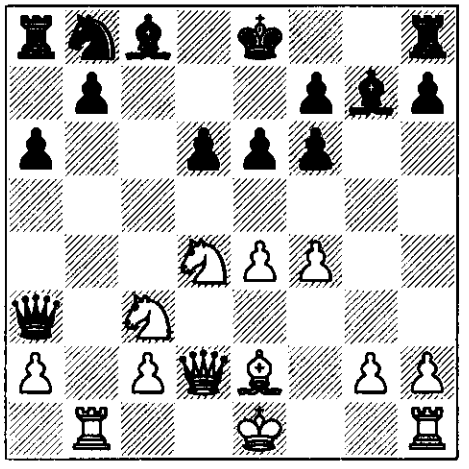
16 ... h4

Black is slightly better, for example: 17 ♕h3 (defending h2 in advance; 17 ♗g4 is met by 17...♖g8 18 ♗h3 ♕e5 19 ♘d1 d5 followed by ...♗d6) exf5! 18 exf5 d5 (this manoeuvre is Portisch's imaginative idea; once Black has transferred his bishop to e5 he will have an extra pawn and a positional advantage) 19 ♖b3 (despite the open black king White cannot prevent the bishop transfer) ♗d6! (more accurate than 19...♔f8 20 ♖f4 ♗d6 21 ♖xh4 ♖xh4 22 ♕xh4 ♔e7, although this was also very good for Black in Wedberg-Portisch, Amsterdam 1984) 20

♕g4 (White cannot even take the h-pawn) ♔f8 21 ♘a4 ♖b8 22 ♕d4 ♗e5 (not 22...♖xb3? 23 ♕xf6) 23 ♕c5+ ♕xc5 24 ♘xc5 a5 25 ♖xb8 ♗xb8 26 ♖b1 ♗c7 (not 26...♗d6 27 ♖b6!) 27 ♗d3 ♔e7 28 ♘a6 ♔d6 29 ♘xc7 ♔xc7 and Black has a won ending, Grosar-Nunn, Lugano 1987.

B)

11 ... ♗g7 *(D)*



W

At one time this was thought better than 11...♘c6, but the endings arising in line B2 below are now considered to be slightly better for White. While these endings are by no means forced, it has cast a shadow over 11...♗g7, with the result that 11...♘c6 is now thought safest.

After 11...♗g7 there are two important lines:

B1: 12 f5
B2: 12 0-0

Or **12 ♖b3 ♕a5** (not 12...♕c5? 13 ♘a4) **13 f5** (13 0-0?! f5) **0-0 14 0-0 ♘c6 15 ♘xc6 bxc6 16 ♕xd6** and now:

1) **16...♖a7!?** 17 ♖a3 (17 ♕xc6 ♖c7 18 ♕a4 ♕xa4 19 ♘xa4 ♖xc2 = or 17 ♕f4 ♖e8 18 ♗g4 ♕c5+ 19 ♕f2 ♗f8 20 fxe6 fxe6 21 ♘a4 ♕xf2+ 22 ♖xf2 f5 = Pietzsch-Kavalek, Leipzig 1965) ♕b6+!? (17...♖d8 18 ♖xa5 ♖xd6 19 e5 ♖d4 20 exf6 ♗xf6 21 fxe6 ♗g7 and Black should have no trouble defending the ending, Balashov-Christoph, Hastings 1965) 18 ♔h1 ♖d8 19 ♖b3 ♕a5 could be a draw by repetition after 20 ♖a3.

2) **16...exf5** 17 ♗c4 (17 ♕xc6 ♗e6 18 ♘d5 fxe4 19 c4 **♕d2** 20 ♘e7+ ♔h8 21 ♕xe4 f5, I.Zaitsev-Krogius, USSR Ch 1962 and now the bulletin and other sources give 22 ♕e3 losing White's queen, but the move actually played must surely have been 22 ♕d3 ∓; **19...f5!** looks even better for Black) f4 (17...♖a7!?) 18 ♕xc6 ♖a7 19 ♘d5 ♗e6 20 ♔h1 with some advantage for White, Stein-Bronstein, Leningrad 1962.

B1)

12 f5 0-0

Or:

1) **12...♗h6?!** 13 ♕d3 ♕c5 14 fxe6 (14 ♖d1 ♘c6 15 ♘xc6 bxc6 16 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 17 ♖xd6 ♔e7 18 ♖d3 ♖b8 = Flores-Geller, Santiago 1965) fxe6 15 ♗g4! ♖g8! (15...♘c6?! 16 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 17 ♗xe6 ♘b4 18 ♖xb4 ♕xb4 19 0-0 ±) 16 ♗xe6 ♖xg2 17 ♗xc8 ♖d2! (17...♕xc8? 18 ♘d5 ♘d7 19 ♕h3 ± Pandavos-Bogda, Thessaloniki OL 1984) and now:

1a) **18 ♕g3!** ♕xd4 19 ♗xb7 ♗g5 20 ♘e2! ♕c4 21 ♕g4 ♕xc2 22 0-0 +– (O'Kelly).

1b) **18 ♕f3** ♕xd4 19 ♘e2 ♕e3 20 ♕xe3 ♗xe3 21 ♗xb7 ♖a7 22 ♖b3 ♗g5 23 h4 ♗h6 24 ♗d5 ♘d7 25 ♖g1 ± Arnaudov-Tringov, Plovdiv 1967.

2) Black should certainly avoid **12...♘c6** 13 ♘xc6 bxc6, hoping to transpose to line A, because of 14 ♖b3! ♕c5 (14...♕a5 15 ♕xd6 ♖a7 16 ♖b8 ♖c7 17 fxe6 fxe6 1-0 Wedberg-Hünerkopf, Stockholm 1986) 15 ♘a4 ♕e5 16 ♘b6 ♖b8 17 ♘c4 ♕a1+ 18 ♔f2 ♕xh1 19 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 20 ♖xb8 ♕xh2 21 ♖xc8+ 1-0 Olthof-Ihlebaek, corr 1985.

13 0-0

13 ♖b3 ♕a5, transposing to 12 ♖b3 above, is also possible.

13 ... ♘c6

14 ♘b3

14 ♘xc6 bxc6 15 ♔h1 transposes to the analysis of 13...♗g7 in line A.

14 ... ♘e5

This position is fine for Black, for example 15 ♗d3 (15 ♘d4 b5 16 ♔h1 ♗d7 17 ♗h5 ♖ac8 ∞ Parma-Fischer, Bled 1961) ♗d7! (15...♕b4 16 a3 ♕b6+ 17 ♔h1 ♖d8 18 ♘e2 d5 19 fxe6 fxe6 20 exd5 ± Matulović-Minić, Yugoslav Ch 1965) 16 ♘e2 ♖ac8! ∓ (16...♔h8?! 17 ♘g3 ♖ac8 18 ♘h5 ♕xa2 19 ♘xg7 ♔xg7 20 ♘d4 ∞ Nunn-Portisch, Tilburg 1982) since 17 ♘g3 is met by 17...♕xa2 threatening ...♘xd3.

B2)

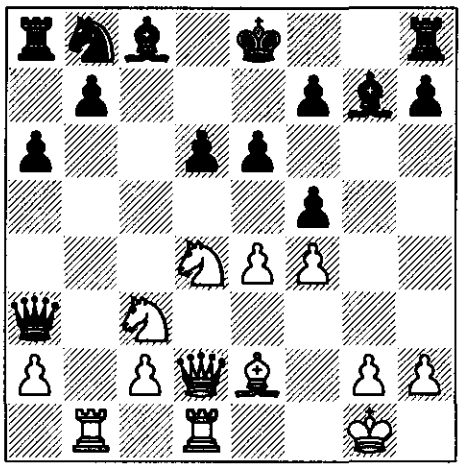
12 0-0

The best move.

12 ... f5

Black is well advised to play this move if White permits it, as 12...0-0 allows 13 ♖f3! with good attacking chances (13 f5 leads to B1 above).

13 ♖fd1 *(D)*


B

13 ... ♘c6

Black should consider deviating from the main line either here or on the next move, or else he will end up in a depressing ending. The alternative is 13...0-0 (13...fxe4? 14 ♘xe4 d5 15 f5! or 13...♕c5? 14 ♘a4) 14 exf5 (14 ♔h1 fxe4 15 f5 exf5 16 ♘d5 e3 17 ♕e1 ♘c6 18 ♕g3 ♔h8 19 ♕h4 ♘xd4 20 ♖xd4 ♕c5 ∓ Ivanović-Portisch, Nikšić 1983) exf5 (14...♘c6 15 ♘xc6 bxc6 16 f6! ♗xf6 17 ♘e4 ♗g7 18 ♖b3 ♕a4 19 ♘xd6 is better for White, Parma-Bogdanović, Yugoslav Ch 1965) 15 ♘d5 ♘c6 16 ♘xc6 (16 c3 ♕a5 17 ♘b6 ♖b8 18 ♗f3 ♘xd4 19 cxd4 ♕xd2 20 ♖xd2 ♖d8 21 d5 ♗c3 22 ♖d3 ♗a5 23 ♖a3 ♗d2 24 g3 ½-½ Ljubojević-Ribli, Bugojno 1984) bxc6 17 ♘e7+ ♔h8 18 ♘xc8 ♖fxc8 19 ♕xd6 (19 ♕d3?! ♕c5+ 20 ♔h1 ♖e8 21 ♕c4 ♕xc4 22 ♗xc4 ♖e4 23 ♗xf7 ♖f8 ∓ Parma-Fischer, Rovinj-Zagreb 1970) ♕xa2 (19...♕e3+ 20 ♔f1 ♖e8 21 ♕d2 is minutely better for White) 20 ♕c5 with a very slight plus for White.

14 ♘xc6 ♗xc3

14...bxc6 15 ♖b3 ♕c5+ 16 ♔h1 (it is natural to hide on h1, but 16 ♔f1 d5 17 ♘a4 ♕a7 18 ♖g3 ♗f6 19 exf5 exf5 20 c4! ♗e6 21 ♕c2 was unclear in Ziatdinov-Kaiumov, Tashkent 1984) 0-0 17 ♘a4 (17 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 18 ♖xd6 e5, Matanović-Bronstein, Wijk aan Zee 1963, may be

very slightly better for White) ♕f2 18 ♖f3 ♕a7!? (18...♕h4 19 exf5 exf5 20 ♘b6 ♖b8 21 ♘xc8 ♖fxc8 22 ♗xa6 ♖e8 23 ♖e3 ♖xe3 24 ♕xe3 ± Parma-Barczay, Sarajevo 1969) 19 ♕xd6 fxe4 20 ♖g3 ♕f2 21 f5 ♔h8 22 ♖xg7 (22 ♘b6 ♕xb6 23 ♖xg7 ♔xg7 24 f6+ ♔xf6 25 ♕xf8 ± has been proposed, but 22...exf5! 23 ♘xa8 ♕xe2 is very good for Black) ♔xg7 23 ♖f1 ♕xe2 24 f6+ ♔g6 25 ♕g3+ ♔h5 26 ♕e5+ ♔g6 27 ♕g3+ ½-½ Ankerst-Bogdanović, Vukovar 1966.

15 ♕e3 bxc6

15...♗b2 16 ♕b6 bxc6 was tested in the correspondence game Sauermann-Lorincz, 1991 which eventually proved better for Black after **17 exf5** ♗f6 18 ♕xc6+ ♔e7 19 ♕xa8 ♕e3+ 20 ♔h1 ♕xe2 21 ♕c6 ♖d8 22 fxe6 ♗xe6. However, improvements are not hard to find, for example **17 ♕xc6+** ♔e7 18 ♕xa8 ♕e3+ 19 ♔h1 ♕xe2 20 ♕c6 ♖d8 (20...♗a3 21 e5! is crushing as 21...dxe5 loses to 22 ♕c7+ ♔f6 23 ♖e1) 21 e5! d5 22 ♕c7+ (22 ♕c5+ is also good) ♗d7 23 ♖d3! ♖g8 24 ♖g1! and Black has no defence to the threat of 25 ♕d6+ followed by 26 ♕b8+ and 27 ♕xb2 or 26 ♖b3.

16 ♖b3 ♕c5

The critical position, which can lead to various endings. However, all these endings give White an annoying edge and in my view they are best avoided by Black:

1) **17 ♖xc3** ♕xe3+ 18 ♖xe3 and now:

1a) **18...♔e7** (18...d5 19 exf5! 0-0 20 f6 is good for White, as is 18...fxe4 19 ♖xd6 f5 20 ♖xc6 ♔e7 21 ♖b3) 19 exf5 ♖d8 (19...♖g8 20 f6+ ♔d7 21 ♗h5 ♖f8 22 ♖g3 followed by ♖g7 is strong) 20 fxe6 fxe6 21 ♗g4 ♖f8 22 ♗xe6 ♗xe6 23 ♖de1 ♖f6 24 f5 with a clear plus for White.

1b) **18...♔d7** 19 exf5 exf5 (after 19...♔c7 20 ♗h5 ♖f8 21 f6 ♗d7 22 ♖g3 ♖g8 23 ♖dd3 ♖af8 24 ♖xg8 ♖xg8 25 ♖g3 ♖xg3 26 hxg3 ♗e8 27 g4 a march by the white king up the h-file will be very awkward) 20 ♖ed3 (20 c4 ♖b8 21 ♖ed3 ♖e8 ±) d5 (20...♔c7 21 ♖xd6 ♖e8 ±) 21 c4 ♔e7 22 cxd5 cxd5 23 ♖xd5 ♗e6 24 ♖a5 ♖hb8 25 ♖d2 and Black has a difficult defensive task ahead, Velimirović-Ftačnik, Banja Luka 1983.

2) **17 ♕xc5** dxc5 18 ♖xc3 fxe4 19 ♖xc5 ♗d7 (Stean recommends 19...♔e7, but this also fails to equalise completely, for example 20 ♖xc6 ♖d8 21 ♖xd8 ♔xd8 22 ♔f2 ±) 20 ♖e5 f5 21 g4 (*The Najdorf for the Tournament Player's* suggestion of 21 ♗c4 ♔e7 22 g4 ♖hg8 23 ♖xd7+ ♔xd7 24 ♗xe6+ fails after 24...♔d6 25 ♗xg8 ♖xg8 26 g5 ♖xg5+) ♖g8 22 ♔f2 fxg4 and now:

2a) **23 ♖xe4** h5 24 ♔g3 ♔e7 25 ♖e5 (25 ♔h4! retains an edge for White) h4+ 26 ♔xh4 ♖h8+ 27 ♖h5 ♖xh5+ 28 ♔xh5 ♖h8+ 29 ♔xg4 ♖xh2 30 ♖d2 a5 31 ♔g3 ♖h1 32 ♗c4 ♖e1 33 ♖e2 ♖xe2 34 ♗xe2 ½-½ Parma-Fischer, Havana 1965.

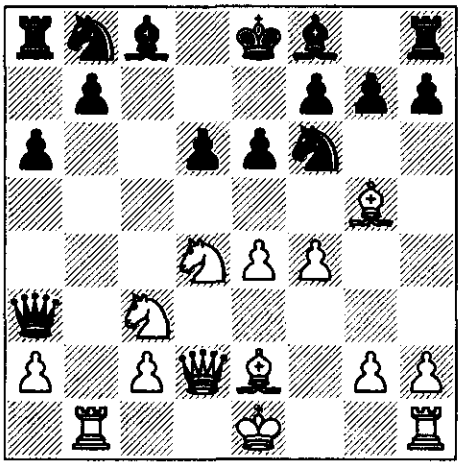
2b) **23 f5** ♔e7 is nothing, e.g. 24 ♗c4 ♔f6, 24 fxe6 ♗xe6 25 ♗c4 ♖g6 or finally 24 ♖xe4 ♖af8 25 ♗xg4 ♔d8.

2c) **23 ♔g3** ♔e7 24 ♗c4 ♖gf8 (24...♖g7? ½-½ Lehmann-O'Kelly, Solingen 1968, but 25 f5 ♔f6 26 ♔f4 would have been good for White) 25 ♖xe4 and White retains a nagging edge.

4 Poisoned Pawn: 9 ♖b1 ♕a3 10 ♗e2

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♕b6 8 ♕d2 ♕xb2 9 ♖b1 ♕a3 10 ♗e2 *(D)*

B



In the mid-1980s this was one of White's main lines against the Poisoned Pawn. White's plan is to complete his development by ♗e2 and 0-0, then try to break through by f5 or, more frequently, by e5. Play is very complex and the assessment of the main lines depends on long and complex tactical variations. However, it soon became clear that Black has at least one satisfactory defence, and this caused the variation to suffer a steep decline.

10 ... ♗e7

There are three alternative moves:

1) **10...♘c6** (a dubious move) 11 ♘xc6 bxc6 and now:

1a) **12 0-0** d5 (12...♗e7 transposes to line 2 in the note to Black's 11th move below) 13 ♔h1! ♗c5? (13...♗b4 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 ♖b3 ♕a5 16 f5 is given as unclear by Lobron, with the idea 16...dxe4 17 ♕d4 ♗xc3 18 ♖xc3 ♕e5 19 ♕xe5 fxe5 20 f6 and here Lobron claims ±) 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 exd5 f5 (15...cxd5 16 ♘xd5 exd5 17 ♖b3 ♕a4 18 ♕xd5 +−) 16 ♗h5 cxd5 17 ♘xd5 ♖a7 (17...exd5 18 ♕xd5 ♖a7 19 ♕e5+ wins) 18 ♖b8 0-0 19 ♖b3 ♕a4 20 ♘f6+ ♔g7 21 ♕e1! ♖h8 22 ♕h4 h6 23 ♖d1 ♕a5 24 ♖g3+ ♔f8 25 ♘h7+ ♔e8 26 ♕f6 1-0 Lobron-Hulak, Indonesia 1983.

1b) **12 e5** ♘d5 13 ♘xd5 cxd5 (13...exd5 14 0-0 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♗e7 16 ♖b3 ♗xg5 17 ♕xg5 ♕c5+ 18 ♔h1 0-0 19 ♖g3 g6 20 ♗d3 ± Tsaturian-Perfanov, corr 1985) 14 0-0 with three branches:

1b1) **14...♗e7** 15 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 16 f5 h6 17 fxe6 fxe6 (17...♗xe6 is better, but still very good for White) 18 ♕f4 dxe5 19 ♕xe5 ♖g8 20 ♕c7+ ♗d7 21 ♖b3 1-0 Krivić-Hallier, corr 1984.

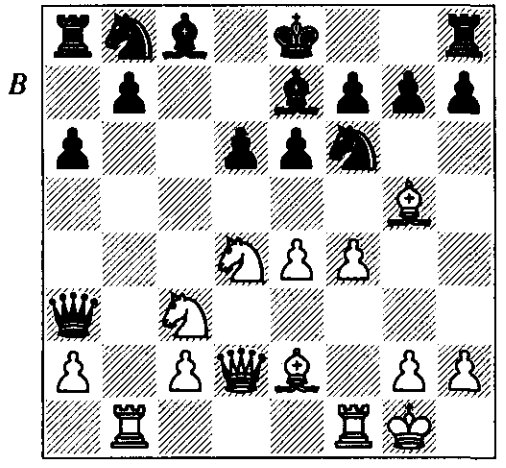
1b2) **14...h6** 15 ♗h4 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♕c5+ 17 ♔h1 ♗e7 18 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 19 ♖b3 ♖a7 (19...0-0 20 ♖g3 ♔h7 21 ♖f6 with a deadly attack) 20 ♖g3 g6 21 ♗d3 and White's initiative is worth more than a pawn, Weinzettl-Opl, Eggenburg 1981.

1b3) **14...dxe5** 15 fxe5 ♗e7 (the line 15...♖a7 16 ♖b3 ♕a4 17 ♕c3 ♕d7 18 ♗h5 g6 19 ♗f6 also gives

White good compensation) 16 ♖b3 ♕c5+ 17 ♔h1 0-0 18 ♗f6 ♗xf6 19 exf6 ♖e8 20 ♖c3 with more than enough for the pawn.

2) **10...♘bd7** 11 0-0 ♕a5?! (both 11...♗e7 and 11...♕c5 12 ♔h1 ♗e7 transpose to lines considered later in the chapter; 11...b5 12 e5 dxe5 13 fxe5 ♘xe5 14 ♖xf6! gxf6 15 ♗xf6 ♘g6 16 ♘cxb5! +–) 12 f5! e5 13 ♘e6 fxe6 14 fxe6 ♗e7 (14...♘c5 15 ♖xf6 gxf6 16 ♗h5+ ♔d8 17 ♘d5! +–) 15 exd7+ ♗xd7, Wedberg-Jakobsen, Copenhagen 1983, and now 16 ♗xf6 gxf6 17 ♗h5+ ♔d8 18 ♖xb7 was a simple way to get the advantage, e.g. 18...♖c8 19 ♖xd7+ ♔xd7 20 ♗g4+ ♔d8 21 ♗xc8 ♔xc8 22 ♖b1 ±.

11 0-0 *(D)*



B

Now Black has three main replies:

A: 11...h6
B: 11...♕c5
C: 11...♘bd7

Of the other lines, only 11...♕a5 should be taken seriously (indeed, it appears rather promising for Black):

1) **11...0-0?!** is bad because of 12 e5! dxe5 13 fxe5 ♘fd7 14 ♘e4!? ♘xe5! (14...♗xg5 15 ♕xg5 ♕a5 16 ♘f6+ ♘xf6 17 ♘f5!) 15 ♖b3 ♗xg5 16 ♕xg5 f6! 17 ♘xf6+ ♖xf6 18 ♖xf6 ♕c5 19 ♖f4!.

2) **11...♘c6** 12 ♘xc6 (12 e5? ♕c5 13 exf6 gxf6) bxc6 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♕c5+ 15 ♔h1 ♕xe5 16 ♗f4! and now:

2a) **16...♘e4?** 17 ♘xe4 ♕xe4 18 ♗f3 ♕c4 19 ♗d6! f5 (19...♖a7 20 ♗xe7 ♖xe7 21 ♕d6 f6 22 ♗h5+ g6 23 ♖xf6 wins after 23...gxh5 24 ♖b8 or 23...♖f8 24 ♗e2 ♕d5 25 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 26 ♖f1+ ♔e8 27 ♕f4) 20 ♖fd1 ♖a7? (20...♗xd6 21 ♕xd6 ♔f7 22 ♕c7+ ♔f6 23 ♖b6! ±) 21 ♖b4 ♕xa2 22 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 23 ♕d4 1-0 Van der Wiel-Ftačnik, Århus 1983.

2b) **16...♕a5** 17 ♗f3 ♗d7 (or 17...0-0 18 ♘d5 ♕d8 19 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 20 ♗xc6 ♖d8 21 ♕a5 ♖a7 22 ♗b8 ±) 18 ♖b7! ♕d8 (18...♖c8 19 ♗g5 ♕d8 20 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 21 ♘e4 ♖c7 22 ♘xf6+ gxf6 23 ♖b3 h5 24 ♖d3 ♔e7 25 ♕a5 ♔f8 26 ♗xc6 ♔g7 27 ♖g3+ 1-0 Selke-Thieme, corr) with the branch:

2b1) **19 ♘a4** 0-0 20 ♘b6 e5, Van der Wiel-Fedder, Plovdiv Echt 1983, and now 21 ♗e3 e4 22 ♗e2 wins a piece.

2b2) **19 ♘e4** ♘d5 20 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 21 ♗xd6 ♗c8 (21...♕c8 22 ♖c7!) 22 ♖xf7 ♕xd6 23 ♖xg7 wins for White according to Christiansen, for example 23...♕e5 24 ♕h6 ♗d7 25 ♕h4 +–.

2b3) **19 ♖d1** ♘d5 20 ♗xd5! cxd5 21 ♘xd5 exd5 22 ♕xd5 0-0 (22...♗b5 23 ♖xe7+ forces mate in a further six moves) 23 ♖xd7 ♕e8, McCambridge-Ftačnik, New York 1983, gives White some advantage, for example 24 ♗c7! (preventing

...♖d8) ♗f6 25 c4 and the c-pawn is very dangerous.

3) **11...♕a5** 12 f5 (12 e5 dxe5 13 fxe5 ♕xe5 14 ♗f4 ♕a5! 15 ♗f3 ♘bd7 16 ♔h1 ♕d8 17 ♖xb7? ♗xb7 18 ♗xb7 ♘c5! 19 ♗c6+ ♘fd7 20 ♘e4 0-0 21 ♗xa8 ♕xa8 22 ♗d6? ♘xe4 0-1 Cigan-Ribli, Portorož-Ljubljana 1985; even the relatively better 17 ♗xb7 ♗xb7 18 ♖xb7 ♖c8 is ∓) and now:

3a) **12...0-0** 13 ♘d5 ♕d8 14 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 15 ♗xf6 gxf6 16 ♖b3 is good for White.

3b) After **12...e5** 13 ♘b3 the continuation **13...♕b6+** 14 ♗e3 ♕c7 15 g4 h6 16 h4 d5 17 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 18 exd5 ♘d7 19 c4 was ± in Wu-Groszpeter, Lucerne Wcht 1985. However, **13...♕d8** 14 ♗e3 ♘bd7 15 g4 h6 16 ♘c1 ♘c5 17 ♗f3 was played in Hava-Rubi Pajares, corr 1989, and after 17...b6 followed by ...♗b7 we reach a position which resembles an ordinary Sicilian, except that White has no b-pawn!

3c) **12...♘c6!** 13 fxe6 (13 ♗e3 ♘e5 14 fxe6 fxe6 15 ♘f3 b5 16 ♖b3 ♘eg4 17 e5 dxe5 18 ♘g5 ♘xe3 ½-½ McDonald-Szekely, Budapest 1995; Black is better in the final position) ♘xd4 (13...fxe6 14 ♘xc6 bxc6 15 ♗f3 transposes to a variation of Timman's line in chapter 6 thought good for White) 14 ♕xd4 ♕xg5 15 exf7+ ♔f8 16 ♘d5 ♘xd5 17 exd5 and White eventually won in the game Iodice-Schettini, corr 1990, but after 17...♗f6 Black is clearly better.

A)

11 ... h6

12 ♗h4

Compared to line C below, some tactical possibilities for White are eliminated (for example, White cannot play ♕h6+ if the black king flees to f8). On the other hand the bishop can often drop back to f2 to make life awkward for Black's queen.

12 ... ♘bd7 *(D)*

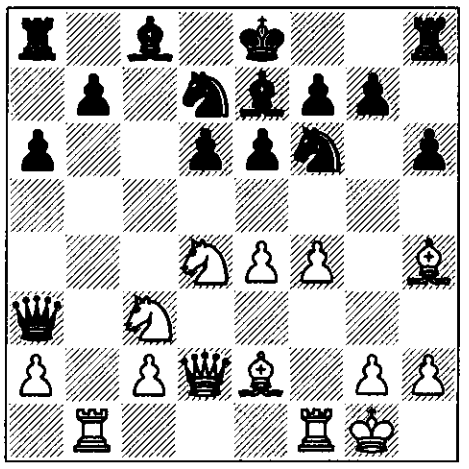
12...♘c6 (12...♘xe4? 13 ♘xe4 ♗xh4 14 ♖b3 ±) is also playable, the point being that the line 13 ♘xc6 bxc6 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♕c5+ 16 ♔h1 ♕xe5 17 ♗g3 (see 11...♘c6 above) offers Black much better chances now that White's queen is undefended, for example 17...♕a5 18 ♗f3 ♘d5 is possible. The only practical test was Salov-Glusenko, Alma Ata 1982, which continued 13 ♗f2 ♘d7 14 f5 ♗g5 15 ♕e1 ♘xd4 16 ♗xd4 ♗f6 17 e5 ♗xe5 (*The Najdorf for the Tournament Player* naïvely commented that 17...♘xe5 18 ♖b3 ♕a5 19 ♗b6 wins, even though 18...♘d3! gives Black the advantage; however, 18 ♘e4! is genuinely dangerous for Black) 18 ♗xe5 ♘xe5 19 ♕g3 exf5 20 ♕xg7 ♖f8 21 ♕xh6 ♕xc3 22 ♕xd6 and now 22...♘c6! offers Black good defensive chances, because White has to take time out to meet the threat of ...♕d4+.

13 e5

There are various other moves:

1) **13 ♔h1** ♕a5 14 f5 and now:

1a) **14...e5** (14...♘xe4 15 fxe6! ♘xd2 16 exf7+ ♔d8 17 ♘e6#) 15 ♘e6! fxe6 16 fxe6 ♘f8 (16...0-0 17 exd7 ♗xd7 18 ♖xb7 ±; 16...g5 17 exd7+ ♗xd7 18 ♗e1 ♕c7 19 ♘d5 ♘xd5 20 ♗h5+ ♔d8 21 ♕xd5 gives White excellent compensation for the pawn; 16...♘c5 17 ♖xf6 gxf6 18



♗xf6 and 16...♘b6 17 ♖xf6 certainly give White some dangerous threats, but whether these are enough to give him the advantage is not so clear), Incelli-Svendsen, corr 1984, and now 17 ♖xf6 gxf6! 18 ♗h5+ ♔d8 19 ♗f2! wins Black's queen for insufficient compensation.

1b) **14...♘e5** 15 fxe6 fxe6 16 ♗h5+ ♘f7 (16...♘xh5? 17 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 18 ♘d5+) and now:

1b1) **17 ♗xf7+** ♔xf7 18 ♕d3! (18 e5 dxe5 19 ♘f3 e4 20 ♘xe4 ♕xd2 21 ♘e5+ ♔g8 22 ♘xd2 ♔h7, Lobron-Portisch, Indonesia 1983, and now 23 a4! would have given White good drawing chances, but this is hardly a recommendation) ♖f8?! 19 e5 dxe5 (19...♕xe5 20 ♖be1 ♕h5 21 ♘f5!? exf5 22 ♕c4+ ♔g6 23 ♖xe7 ∞) 20 ♕h7! exd4 21 ♘e4 ♔e8 22 ♕xg7 ♘d5 23 c4!! (a fantastic move) dxc3 24 ♗xe7 ♖xf1+ 25 ♖xf1 ♘xe7 26 ♖f7 (the point: there is no mate on e1) ♕b4 27 ♘f6+ ♔d8 28 ♕f8+ ♔c7 29 ♖xe7+ ♔b8 30 ♘d7+ ♔c7 31 ♘b6+! ♔xb6 32 ♖xb7+ and wins, Erlandsson-Stypka, corr 1988.

1b2) **17 e5** dxe5 (17...♘xh5 18 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 19 ♘f5+ ♔e8 20 ♘xd6+ ♘xd6 21 ♕xd6 ♕xc3 22 ♖bd1 ♕a5 23 ♖f3 g5 and now White can force a draw by 24 ♕d3 ♘f4 25 ♖xf4 gxf4 26 ♕g6+; in Goldberg-Butze, corr 1985 White played for a win by 24 ♖a3 ♕xa3 25 ♕xa3 and succeeded after 25...♘g7 26 ♕d3 ♔f7 27 ♖f1+ ±, but 25...♘f4 ∞ is better) 18 ♗xf6 gxf6 (18...♗xf6? 19 ♘xe6! ♗xe6 20 ♕d6 ♗xa2 21 ♘xa2 ♕xa2 22 ♖b3 1-0 David-Müller, corr 1984) and Black has good defensive chances.

2) **13 ♗g3** ♘c5 14 ♗f3 ♕a5 15 e5 dxe5 (15...♘fd7 16 exd6 ♗xd6 17 ♘c6 ±) 16 ♘c6 ♕c7 17 ♘xe7 ♕xe7 18 fxe5 ♘fd7 19 ♖b4 ♘d3 20 ♖g4 with a dangerous attack, Nicht-Heinel, corr 1987.

3) **13 f5** e5 14 ♘e6 (unsound) fxe6 15 fxe6 ♘f8 (15...♘c5 16 ♗h5+ ♔d8 17 ♖xf6 gxf6 18 ♗xf6 ♘xe6 19 ♗xh8 ♗g5 20 ♕e1 ♘f4 21 ♗f3 ♗e6 22 h4 ♗e7 23 ♗g7 ♖c8 24 ♘d5 ♗xd5 25 exd5 ♖xc2 26 ♗xh6 ♘h3+ 27 ♔h1 ♘f2+ 28 ♔g1 ♗xh4 ∓ G.Hartmann-Hünerkopf, Bundesliga 1984/5) 16 ♗xf6 gxf6 17 ♘d5 ♘xe6 18 ♖b3 ♕c5+ 19 ♔h1 ♘g5 20 ♗h5+ ♔d8 −+ Fischer-Leuner, corr 1988.

4) **13 ♖f3** and now:

4a) **13...♕c5** 14 ♗f2 ♕c7 15 ♖g3 ♖g8 (15...♘c5 16 ♗f3 g6 17 ♘b3 ♘cd7 18 ♖d1 h5 19 ♖h3 ♖g8 20 ♗e2 b5 21 e5 dxe5 22 fxe5 ♘g4 23 ♗xg4 hxg4 24 ♖d3 with strong pressure for White, Mi.Tseitlin-Kremenietsky, USSR 1962) 16 ♗f3 ♖b8 17 a4 ♔f8 18 ♗e3 b6 19 e5 dxe5 20 ♘c6 exf4 21 ♗xf4 e5 22 ♗xh6 gxh6 23 ♕xh6+ ♔e8 24 ♘d5 ♗c5+ 25 ♔h1 ♕d6 26 ♘xf6+ ♘xf6 27 ♖d1 1-0 Iodice-Agazzi, corr 1991.

4b) **13...♕a5** 14 ♗f2 and now:

4b1) **14...♕c7** 15 ♖g3 ♖g8 is untested.

4b2) **14...g5!?** 15 f5 ♘e5 16 fxe6 fxe6 17 ♖xf6! ♗xf6 18 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 19 ♕xd6 ♘f3+! 20 ♗xf3 ♕e5 21 ♗h5+ ♗f7 22 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 23 ♖xb7+ ♔g6 was unclear in Kengis-Veingold, Tallinn 1983.

4b3) **14...b5** 15 ♘c6 ♕c7 16 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 17 a4 bxa4 18 ♖g3 ♖g8 19 ♕d4 a3 (19...e5!?) 20 e5 dxe5 21 fxe5 ♕xe5 22 ♕a4 ♕d6 23 ♖d1 ♘d5 24 ♘xd5+ exd5 25 ♖e3+ ♔f8 26 ♕a5 and Black is in trouble despite his three extra pawns, Roose-Sprinkhuizen, corr 1991.

13 ... dxe5
14 fxe5 ♘xe5
15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6

This is the same position as in line C below, except that Black's pawn is on h6 instead of h7, a change which favours Black for two reasons, both of which are relevant after 16 ♖xf6 gxf6 17 ♘e4. Firstly, 17...♕e7 18 ♕f4 may be met by 18...♘d7 19 ♘d6+ ♔f8 and there is no check on h6, and secondly after 17...f5 18 ♘xf5 exf5 19 ♘f6+ ♔e7 White cannot play ♕g5. Indeed, these factors are so important that Black is probably already better, so White should adopt one of the alternative 13th moves.

16 ♘e4

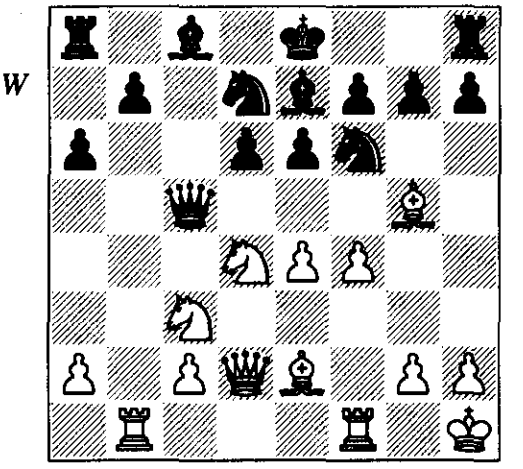
There is little else as ♖xf6 is bad as explained above, but now Black gains the advantage: 16...♗d8 17 ♗b5+ (17 ♕f4 ♗c7, 17 ♘b5 ♗b6+ 18 ♔h1 axb5 19 ♗xb5+ ♔f8 20 ♖b3 ♕e7 and 17 ♖b3 ♕e7 18 ♖g3 ♘g6 19 ♗h5 0-0 20 ♗xg6 fxg6 21 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 22 ♖xg6 ♗b6 are all good for Black) axb5 18 ♘xb5 ♕a5 19 ♘bd6+ ♔f8 20 ♕f2 (20 ♕f4 f6!) ♕a7! 21 ♕xa7 ♖xa7 22 ♘xc8 ♖a8 23 ♘cd6 b6 24 ♖b5 ♖a5 and Black has the better endgame, Van der Wiel-Portisch, Tilburg 1983.

B)

11 ... ♕c5
12 ♔h1

This position after 11...♕c5 has been reached numerous times, and on every occasion bar one White has played 12 ♔h1. In Petrushin-Magerramov, Moscow 1991, however, White came close to refuting the whole variation: 12 ♘a4!? ♕a7 (12...♘xe4 13 ♕e3 ♕a5 14 ♘b6 ±; 12...♕c7 13 ♘b6 ♖a7 14 ♕e3 ±) 13 ♘b6 ♘c6 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 (14...♗xf6 15 ♘xc6 bxc6 16 ♕xd6 +–) 15 ♔h1 ♖b8 16 f5 e5 17 ♘f3 h5 18 ♗c4 ♖h7 19 ♖fd1 with enormous pressure for the sacrificed pawn. Black won this game in the end, but at this stage his position looks awful. In view of this Black should probably adopt the move-order 10...♘bd7 11 0-0 ♕c5 12 ♔h1 ♗e7 if he wants to reach this line.

12 ... ♘bd7 *(D)*



13 f5

Or:

1) **13 ♖f3** and now Black has a choice between three moves:

1a) **13...h6** 14 ♖h3 ♕c7 15 f5 (15 ♖f1 ♖g8 16 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 17 ♖g3 ♗d7 18 ♕e3 e5 19 ♘f5 ♗xf5 20 exf5 ♖c8 21 ♖b1 b5 with advantage to Black, Lanka-Gavrikov, USSR 1983) e5 16 ♘e6 fxe6 17 fxe6 ♘f8 18 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 19 ♘d5 ♕d8 20 ♗h5+ g6 21 ♕f2 1-0 Kivi-Tapani, corr 1989 (21...♘xe6 22 ♗xg6+ ♔f8 23 ♘xf6 ♘f4 24 ♘h5! wins).

1b) **13...0-0** 14 ♖h3 (14 ♖g3 ♔h8 15 ♗f3 ♕c7 16 ♖h3 ♖e8 17 g4 ♘f8 18 f5 ♗d7 19 ♗h4 ♖ac8 20 ♖b3 ♗d8 ∓, Kengis-Kaiumov, USSR 1983) ♖e8 15 ♖f1 ♘f8 (15...♗f8 16 f5 is unclear) 16 f5 exf5 17 exf5 ♗d7 18 ♗f3 d5 (18...♗c6 19 ♘xc6 bxc6 20 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 21 ♘e4 ♖xe4! 22 ♗xe4 d5 ±) 19 ♖g3 ♔h8 (19...♖ac8 20 ♘ce2 ♔h8 21 ♗h6 ∓ Kengis-Novikov, USSR 1984) 20 ♗h6 g6 21 ♘ce2 ♖ad8 22 fxg6 hxg6 23 h4 ♘8h7 ∓ Pedersen-Poulsen, corr 1984.

1c) **13...b5** (Black delays committing his king to the dangerous kingside until he has made more progress on the queenside) and now:

1c1) **14 ♘b3** ♕c7 15 a3 ♗b7 16 ♖e3 ♖c8 17 ♘d4 0-0 18 a4 b4 19 ♖xb4 d5! −+ Cigan-De Wit, Schilde 1982.

1c2) **14 f5** ♘e5 15 ♖g3 b4 16 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 17 ♘a4 ♘c4! 18 ♕xb4 (18 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 19 ♘b6 ♕xa2 20 ♕xb4 ♗xd4 21 ♘xa8 0-0 is good for Black) ♕xd4 19 ♕xc4 0-0 20 ♕xd4 (20 ♖f3 exf5 21 exf5 ♗d7 22 ♘b6 ♖ab8 23 ♕xa6 ♗c6 24 ♖ff1 ♗e5 25 ♖b3 ♕h4 26 h3 ♕g5 27 ♗g4 h5 ∓ Kreimer-Fichaud corr 1990) ♗xd4 21 ♖d3 ♗e5 22 ♘b6 ♖b8 23 ♖db3 ∓ Hellers-De Wit, Groningen 1984/5.

1c3) **14 ♖e3** ♗b7 15 ♗f3 ♘b6 16 ♘b3 ♕b4 (16...♕c7 17 ♘a5 ♖c8 18 ♕e1 ♘c4 19 ♘xc4 ♕xc4 20 e5 ♗xf3 21 ♖xf3 b4? 22 ♖b3 ♕c7 23 exf6 gxf6 24 ♘d5! +− Kuntermann-Butze, corr 1989) 17 ♕e1 ♘c4 18 ♘d2 ♕c5 19 ♘xc4 ♕xc4 20 e5 ♗xf3 21 ♖xf3 b4 22 exf6 gxf6 23 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 24 ♘e4 ♗e7 25 ♖xb4 ♕xc2 26 ♖c3 ♕xa2 27 ♖c7 ∞ Klovans-Gasseholm, corr 1986.

2) **13 ♘b3** ♕c7 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘xe5 (15...♕xe5 16 ♗f4 ♕f5 17 ♗d6 ♕g6 18 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 19 ♖bd1 and White should win) 16 ♗xf6 and now:

2a) **16...♗xf6** 17 ♖xf6! gxf6 18 ♘e4 ♕e7 (18...♘d7 19 ♕b4) 19 ♕f4 ♘d7 20 ♘d6+ ♔f8 (20...♔d8 21 ♘a5 with the threat of 22 ♖xb7 is decisive) 21 ♕h6+ ♔g8 22 ♖d1 ♘e5 23 ♘e4 ♘g6 24 ♘g3!, Stashans-Zaklauskis, corr 1983 and White has a winning attack because 24...♕f8 loses to 25 ♖d8 ♕xd8 26 ♘h5 forcing mate.

2b) **16...gxf6!** 17 ♘e4 f5 18 ♘g3 ♗d7 19 ♘d4 ♖d8? 20 ♕h6 ♖c8 21 ♘h5 ♘g6 22 ♘g7+ ♔d8 23 ♖fd1 ♕e5 24 ♖xb7 ♗d6 25 ♘f3 ± Snijders-Daamen, corr 1990, but the obvious continuation 19...0-0-0! is a large improvement.

3) **13 ♗f3** 0-0 14 ♖fd1 ♕c7 15 ♕e1 ♖e8 looks like a normal Sicilian except that White is missing a pawn, G.Andersson-Ekebjærg, corr 1989.

13 ... e5

13...♘e5 14 fxe6 fxe6 15 ♗h5+ (15 ♖xb7!? ♗xb7 16 ♘xe6 ♕c6 17 ♘xg7+ ♔f7 18 ♘h5 favours White, but 15...♘f7! is harder to refute) ♘f7? (15...♘xh5 16 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 17 ♕g5+ is +− according to Lukacs and Hazai, but after 17...♔e8 18 ♕xh5+ g6 there is no clear-cut win for

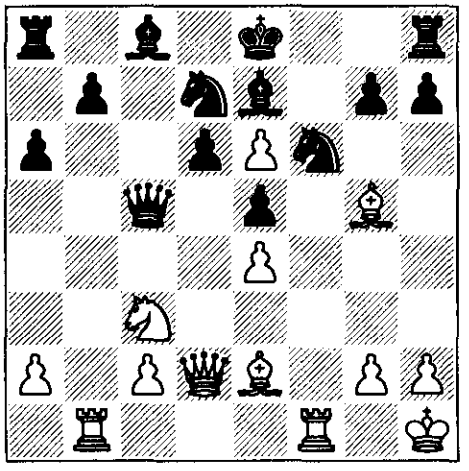
White) 16 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 17 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 18 e5 dxe5 19 ♘b3 ♕e7 20 ♘e4 ♖f8? 21 g4 b5 22 ♘bc5 ♗b7 23 ♘xb7 ♕xb7 24 ♕g2 ♔g6 25 g5 ♗e7 26 ♖f6+! gxf6 27 gxf6+ ♔f7 28 ♘g5+ 1-0 Ivan-Spasov, Budapest 1987.

14 ♘e6

The only consistent move. 14 ♘b3 has been played a few times, but without any real success.

14 ... fxe6

15 fxe6 *(D)*



15 ... ♘b6

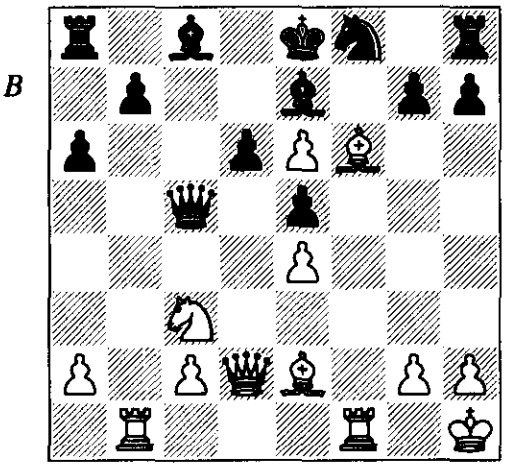
Or:

1) **15...♘f8** (not recommended; Black may be able to scrape a draw with very accurate play) and now:

1a) **16 ♗e3** ♕c6 (not 16...♕a5? 17 ♖xf6 and White won in Agapov-Barkovsky, Leningrad 1983, since 17...gxf6 18 ♗b6 ♕a3 19 ♖b3 traps the queen; although Black gets two rooks in return White keeps his attack) 17 ♖xf6 gxf6 transposes to line 1b.

1b) **16 ♖xf6** (this should lead to a draw) gxf6 17 ♗e3 ♕c6 (17...♕c7 18 ♘d5 ♕b8 looks dubious, but 19 ♗h5+ ♘g6 20 ♗b6 ♗xe6 21 ♘c7+ ♔f7 22 ♘xe6 ♔xe6 is not so clear since the obvious 23 ♕d5+ ♔d7 24 ♕f7 fails to 24...f5! 25 exf5 ♕g8 and Black wins) 18 ♖b6 ♕c7 19 ♘d5 ♕d8 (19...♕b8 20 ♗h5+ ♘g6 21 ♕b4! is very dangerous) 20 ♕c3 (20 ♖b3 ♗xe6 21 ♗h5+ ♘g6 22 ♗b6 ♕d7 23 ♕h6 ♔f7 –+ Wedberg-Sigurjonsson, Reykjavik 1984) ♗xe6! (20...♘xe6? 21 ♗h5+ ♔f8 22 ♗h6+ ♘g7 23 ♘c7! +– Wedberg-Jakobsen, Malmö 1984) 21 ♗h5+ ♘g6 (not 21...♗f7 22 ♘c7+) 22 ♘c7+ ♔f7 23 ♘xe6 ♔xe6 24 ♕b3+ ♔d7 25 ♗g4+! (the tempting 25 ♖xb7+ ♔e8 26 ♗b6 ♕c8 27 ♖c7 ♕b8 28 ♕e6 ♕d8 29 ♖b7 fails because of White's weak back rank: 29...♖b8! 30 ♗xd8 ♖xb7 and Black wins) ♔e8 26 ♗h6! ♖b8 27 ♕a4+ ♔f7 28 ♕b3+ with a draw by perpetual check (analysis by Wedberg).

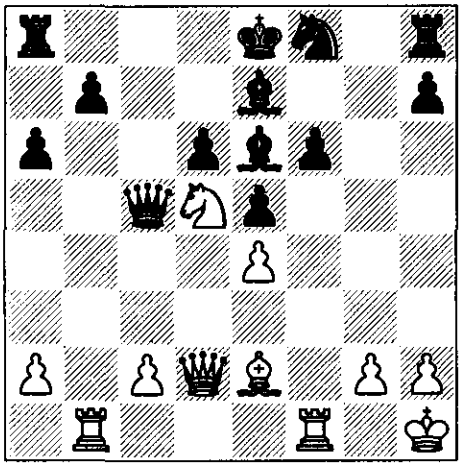
1c) **16 ♗xf6** *(D)* (the bishop capture is White's best chance to play for a win) and now:



1c1) **16...♗xf6** (apparently this move loses by force) 17 ♖xf6 gxf6 18 ♗h5+ ♘g6 (18...♔d8 19 e7+ ♔xe7 20 ♘d5+ ♔d8 21 ♕h6 ♘d7 22 ♕g7, or 18...♔e7 19 ♘d5+ ♔xe6 20 ♕h6 ♘d7 21 ♕g7 and White wins in either case) 19 ♕h6 ♕xc3

(19...♖g8 20 ♕xh7!, or 19...♗xe6 20 ♗xg6+ ♔d8 21 ♕g7 ♖g8 22 ♕xf6+ ♔d7 23 ♗f5 and wins) 20 ♗xg6+ hxg6 (20...♔d8 21 ♗f5 ♖e8 22 ♕xf6+ ♔c7 23 ♕f7+ ♔d8 24 c7+ ♖xe7 25 ♕f8+ wins) 21 ♕xh8+ ♔e7 22 ♕g8! d5 23 ♕f7+ ♔d6 24 c7 ♗d7 25 ♕xf6+ ♔c5 (25...♗e6 26 exd5 ♔xd5 27 ♖d1+) 26 ♕b6+ ♔c4 27 ♕xb7 +–.

1c2) **16...gxf6!** 17 ♘d5 ♗xe6 *(D)* (after 17...♘xe6 18 ♗h5+ ♔d8 19 ♕h6 White has a dangerous attack, or 17...h5 18 ♖xf6! ♗xe6 19 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 20 ♕g5 1-0 Medeiros-Lima, corr 1987) and now:



1c21) **18 ♗h5+** ♘g6 (18...♔d8 19 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 20 ♕h6 ♖g8 21 ♕xf6+ ♔d7 22 ♗f7 ♔c6 23 ♕e7 ± Markov-Zuk, Toronto Ch 1972) 19 ♕h6 0-0-0! (or 19...♗xd5 20 ♗xg6+ and now 20...♗f7 21 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 22 ♖xb7 wins for White, while 20...♔d7 21 ♗f5+ ♔c7 22 exd5 gives White good compensation) 20 ♗xg6 hxg6 (20...♗xd5 21 ♗f5+) 21 ♘xe7+ ♔b8 22 ♕xg6 ♗xa2 is unclear.

1c22) **18 ♘xe7** ♔xe7 19 ♕h6 ♘g6 (19...♘d7 20 ♕g7+ ♗f7 21 ♖xb7 ♖hf8 22 ♗g4 1-0 Beth-Heina corr 1988; 19...♖g8 20 ♖xb7+ ♔d8 21 ♕xf6+ ♔c8 22 ♖e7 +– Wessman-Johansson, Malmö 1986) 20 ♕g7+ ♔d8 21 ♕xf6+ ♔d7 22 ♕g7+ ♔d8 23 ♖xb7 ♖e8! (23...♕c6 24 ♗h5 ♖e8 25 ♕xh7 ♗d7 26 ♗xg6 ♕xb7 27 ♗xe8 +–) 24 ♕f6+ ♔c8 25 ♖xh7 ♘f4! 26 g3! (26 ♗h5 ♕xc2 27 ♕g7 ♖a7! –+) ♕xc2! (26...♘xe2? 27 ♕xe6+ mates; 26...♗h3 27 gxf4 ♗xf1 28 ♗xf1 +–; 26...♕c6 27 gxf4 ♕xe4+ 28 ♗f3 ♕xh7 29 ♗xa8 ±) 27 ♕g7 ♘xe2 28 ♕b7+ ♔d8 29 ♕b6+ ½-½ Sanakoev-Kauranen, corr 1987.

2) **15...0-0** (the safest move, leading to a more or less a forced draw) 16 exd7 ♗xd7 17 ♖xb7 ♘g4! 18 ♕d5+! (18 h3 ♖xf1+ 19 ♗xf1 ♖f8 20 ♗e2 ♗xg5 21 ♕xg5 ♕c6 22 ♗xg4 ♕xb7 23 ♕e7 ♕b6! ∓ Selke-Tiemann, corr) ♕xd5 19 ♘xd5 (19 ♖xf8+ ♖xf8 20 ♘xd5 ♗xg5 21 ♖xd7 ♘f2+ 22 ♔g1 ♘xe4 23 ♗xa6 ♖f7 =) ♖xf1+ 20 ♗xf1 ♗xg5 21 ♖xd7 ♘f2+ 22 ♔g1 ♘xe4 23 ♗c4 (23 ♗d3 ♘c5 24 ♖xd6 ♖d8! is the same) ♔h8 24 ♗d3 ♘c5 25 ♖xd6 ♖d8 and Black holds the draw without difficulty.

After 15...♘b6 Black is dicing with death, but in this case the gamble appears to pay off since White has equality at best.

16 ♗xf6! *(D)*

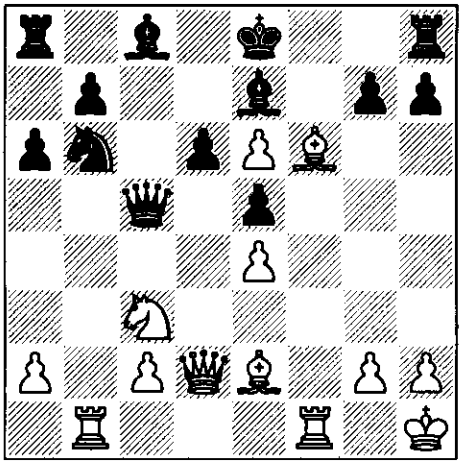
Or:

1) **16 ♖xf6** (not 16 ♗e3? ♘c4, nor 16 ♗h5+? ♘xh5 17 ♗xe7 ♗xe6 18 ♕g5 ♕c7 19 ♗xd6 ♕xd6 20 ♕xh5+ g6 21 ♕g5 ♖f8 and Black wins, Peelen-Cserna, Amsterdam 1984) ♗xf6! 17 ♗h5+ (17 ♗xf6 ♗xe6! 18 ♗h5+ ♔d7 19 ♗xg7 ♖hg8 ∓) ♔d8 18 e7+ (18 ♗e3 ♘c4 and 18 ♖xb6 ♕xb6 19 e7+ ♗xe7 20 ♗xe7+

♔d7! win for Black) ♔d7 19 ♗xf6 gxf6 transposes to line 1 of the next note (which is good for Black).

2) **16 ♕d3** ♗xe6 17 ♗e3 ♗c4 (17...♕c4 18 ♖xb6 ♕xd3 19 ♗xd3 ♖c8 followed by ...♖c7 is at least equal for Black) 18 ♗xc5 ♗xd3 19 ♗xd3 ♘bd7 20 ♗e3 ♖c8 ∓ Dobsa-Dormoy corr 1987.

B



16 ... gxf6

The alternative is **16...♗xf6** and now:

1) **17 ♖xf6** gxf6 18 ♕h6 (18 ♗h5+? ♔d8 19 e7+ ♔d7! 20 ♕h6 ♔c7! 21 ♕xf6 ♗d7 22 ♖d1 ♗c6 23 ♘d5+ ♘xd5 24 exd5 ♗xd5 0-1 Buzbuchi-Szekely, Hamburg 1984) ♗xe6! 19 ♕xf6 (19 ♗h5+ ♔d8! 20 ♕xf6+ ♔c7 21 ♕xe6 ♕xc3 −+) ♔d7 20 ♕g7+ (20 ♘a4 ♕xc2 21 ♕xg7+ ♔d8 22 ♕g5+ ♔d7 is also a draw) ♔c6 21 ♘a4 ♖ag8! 22 ♕e7 ♖e8 with a perpetual attack against White's queen.

2) **17 ♗h5+** ♔d8 18 ♖xb6 ♕xb6 19 ♘d5 ♕d4 (for 19...♕c5, see line 3) 20 ♕a5+ b6 21 ♘xb6 ♕c5 22 ♕xc5 dxc5 23 ♘xa8 ♗xe6 24 ♖d1+ ♔e7 25 ♘c7 ♗c4 26 ♘d5+ ♗xd5 27 ♖xd5 ♖b8 is equal, Filippelli-Travaglini, corr 1990.

3) **17 ♖xb6** ♕xb6 18 ♘d5 ♕c5 19 ♗h5+ ♔d8 20 ♖xf6 gxf6 21 e7+ ♔d7 22 ♕h6 ♕a5! (the only move) 23 e8♕+ ♖xe8 24 ♕g7+ ♔c6 25 ♗xe8+ ♔c5 26 ♕g3 ♕d2 ½-½ De Jong-Langeveld, corr 1992 (27 ♕a3+ ♔d4 28 ♕a4+ is perpetual check, or 27 h3 ♗xh3 =).

17 ♖xb6

17 ♗h5+ ♔d8 18 ♗f7 **h5** (not 18...♔c7? 19 ♖xb6 +−; 18...♘c4 19 ♕d3 ♕d4 20 ♕g3 ♘d2 21 ♘d5 ∞) 19 ♕d3 h4?! 20 ♖xb6! ♕xb6 21 ♘d5 ♕d4 22 ♕f3 b5? (22...♖f8!? 23 ♘xe7 ♗xe6! 24 ♗xe6 ♔xe7 25 ♕g4 ∞) 23 ♘xe7 +− Stachanczyk-Turlej, corr 1991. However, the simplest reply to White's idea is **18...d5!?** 19 ♖xb6 ♕xb6 20 ♘xd5 ♕c5 21 ♘xe7+ ♔xe7 22 ♕h6 ♗xe6 23 ♕xf6+ ♔d6 and Black is slightly better.

17 ... ♕xb6

18 ♘d5

and now:

1) **18...♕d4?** (there are no small errors in such a position) 19 ♕h6 ♗xe6 (19...♕xe4 20 ♘xf6+ +−; 19...♔d8 20 ♘xe7 ♗xe6 21 ♕xf6 ♔d7 22 ♕g7 ♕xe4 23 ♘d5+ ♔c6 24 ♕c7+ ♔xd5 25 ♕xb7+ +−) 20 ♕g7 0-0-0? (20...♗xd5 21 ♕xh8+ ♗f8 22 ♗h5+ ♔d7 23 exd5 ±) 21 ♘xe7+ ♔b8 22 ♘c6+! (this is why d4 is an inferior square for the queen) bxc6 23 ♖b1+ and mates.

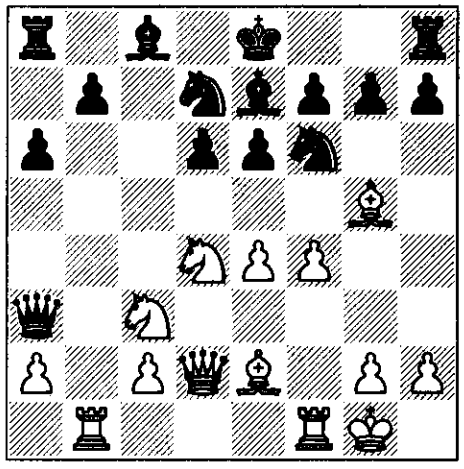
2) **18...♕c5** (White still has a dangerous attack, but Black can defend) 19 ♗h5+ (19 ♕h6? ♗xe6 20 ♕g7 0-0-0 21 ♘xe7+ ♔b8 −+ is good for Black) ♔d8 20 ♕h6!? (20 ♗f7? h5! 21 ♖f3 b6 22 ♕e1 ♗b7 23 ♖c3 ♕d4 and Black won in Brodt-Szilagyi, corr 1984) ♗xe6 (20...♕b5? 21 c4! ♕xc4 22 ♖c1 ♕xe4 23 ♕g7

and wins) 21 ♕g7 ♗xd5! (21...♖e8 22 ♗xe8 ♗xd5 23 exd5 ♔xe8 24 ♕g8+ ♔d7 25 ♕xa8 ♕xd5 26 ♖b1 ♔c7 is unclear; if Black can consolidate without losing a pawn he will be doing well, but at the moment his king is exposed and his b- and h-pawns are weak) 22 ♕xh8+ ♔c7 23 ♕xa8 ♗xe4 (the retention of the light-squared bishops favours Black, because his e4-bishop is very active) 24 ♕e8 d5 25 ♕f7 ♔b8 26 ♗f3! ♕b5! ∓ Peli-Delabie, corr 1990.

The conclusion on 11...♕c5 has changed substantially since publication of *The Najdorf for the Tournament Player*, so a summary of the current opinion is in order: 12 ♘a4 is very interesting, but can probably be circumvented by a different move-order. The main line is slightly better for Black after 15...♘b6; of the alternatives, 15...0-0 is drawish but 15...♘f8 is dubious.

C)

11 ... ♘bd7 *(D)*



At one time the most popular move, it rather unfairly suffered a decline before the whole variation was more or less abandoned by White. It leads to a roughly equal position.

12 e5

The most direct continuation. Quieter methods should not cause Black any sleepless nights:

1) **12 ♔h1** h6 (12...0-0 13 ♖f3 ♕c5 14 ♖h3 b5 15 ♗f3 ♖a7 16 e5 dxe5 17 ♘c6 ♖c7 18 ♘e4 ♘xe4 19 ♗xe4 f6 20 ♗xh7+ ♔f7 21 ♕d3 ♔e8 is unclear, Doldberg-Tiemann, corr 1984) 13 ♗h4 ♕a5 14 ♕e3 ♕c5 15 ♘a4 ♕c7 16 f5 e5 17 ♘e6 fxe6 18 fxe6 0-0 19 exd7 ♗xd7 20 ♘b6 ♖ab8 21 ♖xf6 ♗xf6 22 ♘d5 ♕xc2 23 ♖c1 ♕xc1+ 24 ♕xc1 ♗xh4 and Black is slightly better, Pinter-Szekely, Budapest 1971.

2) **12 f5** and now:

2a) **12...e5** with another branch:

2a1) **13 ♘e6!?** fxe6 14 fxe6 ♘f8 15 ♗xf6 (15 ♖b3 ♕c5+ 16 ♗e3 ♕c6 17 ♖b6 ♘xe4 favours Black) gxf6 16 ♘d5 ♕c5+ 17 ♔h1 ♗xe6 is line 1c2 in the note to Black's 15th move in line B. This is an interesting idea, because if Black ends up playing ...♕c5+ then we transpose into line B, but with Black having adopted the inferior continuation ...♘f8.

2a2) **13 ♘b3** ♕b4 14 ♗e3 ♘xe4 15 ♘xe4 ♕xe4 16 ♘a5 (16 ♗f3 ♕a4 17 ♗d5 0-0 18 ♘a5 ♘c5 19 ♘xb7 ♗xb7 20 ♗xb7 ♘xb7 21 ♖xb7 ♗f6 and Black is clearly better, Schnellingerhout-Timmermans, corr 1984) d5 17 ♗f3 ♕xe3+ 18 ♕xe3 ♗c5 19 ♕xc5 ♘xc5 20 ♗xd5 ♔e7 21 ♖b6 ♖d8 22 c4 f6 23 ♗xb7 = Sax-Browne, Wijk aan Zee 1981.

2b) **12...♘e5** (solid and good) 13 fxe6 fxe6 14 ♔h1 0-0 15 ♖b3 ♕a5 16 ♘d5 ♕xd2 17 ♘xe7+ ♔f7 18 ♗xd2 ♔xe7 19 ♖g3 ♖f7 ∓ Wedberg-H.Olafsson, Denmark 1982.

12 ... dxe5
13 fxe5 ♘xe5
14 ♗xf6

and now Black has a choice:

E1: 14...♗xf6
E2: 14...gxf6

E1)

14 ... ♗xf6

There is a good deal of practical and analytical evidence available on this move; it all points to the conclusion that Black cannot equalise. Perhaps his best chance is a possible improvement at move 17.

15 ♖xf6 gxf6
16 ♘e4 ♕e7

16...♘d7? (16...f5? 17 ♘f6+ ♔e7 18 ♕g5 ♔d6 19 ♖d1 ♕c5 20 ♕e3 +−) 17 ♖b3 ♕xa2 (17...♕e7 18 ♘c6 bxc6 19 ♘d6+ ♔d8 20 ♕a5+ ♘b6 21 ♕xb6+ ♔d7 22 ♖d3 wins) 18 ♘d6+ ♔f8 19 ♕c3! ♔g7 20 ♘6f5+ exf5 21 ♘xf5+ ♔g6 22 ♕h3 1-0 Timman-Ljubojević, Linares 1985.

17 ♕f4

17 ♖b6!? is less convincing:

1) **17...♘d7** 18 ♘d6+ ♔d8 19 ♖c6!! (19 ♕a5 ♘xb6 20 ♕xb6+ ♔d7 21 ♘xb7 ♔e8 22 ♘c6 ♕d7 23 ♘c5 ♕d5! 24 ♗f3 ♕d2 25 ♘d3 ♔f8 isn't completely clear) ♕f8 20 ♕a5+ ♔e7 21 ♘4f5+ exf5 22 ♘xf5+ ♔e8 23 ♖e6+ fxe6 24 ♗h5+ ♕f7 25 ♘d6+ ♔f8 26 ♘xf7 ♖g8 27 ♕b4+ ♔g7 28 ♕g4+ ♔f8 29 ♕xe6 +−.

2) **17...0-0** 18 ♕h6 ♘g6 19 ♘f5 exf5 20 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 21 ♖xf6 ♗e6 22 h4 ±.

3) **17...h5!** (the best move, taking h6 away from White's queen) 18 ♕c3 ♔f8 19 ♘d6 ♘c6 20 ♘xc8 ♖xc8 21 ♗xa6 ♕d8 22 ♖xc6 ♖xc6 23 ♘xc6 ♕b6+ 24 ♘d4 bxa6 25 ♕a3+ ♔e8 26 ♕a4+ ♔e7 27 ♔f1 ♖c8 28 ♕a3+ ♕c5 0-1 Gromotka-Kaniuth, corr 1984.

17 ... ♔d8

Or:

1) **17...♘d7!?** 18 ♘d6+ ♔d8 (not 18...♔f8 19 ♕h6+ ♔g8 20 ♖b3 and now 20...♘e5 21 ♘e4 ♘g6 22 ♖b6! ♗d7 23 ♘f5 exf5 24 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 25 ♖xf6 or 20...♕xd6 21 ♖g3+ ♕xg3 22 hxg3 with a clear plus for White in both cases) and now almost all annotators gave the line 19 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 20 ♘xb7+ ♔c8 (20...♔e8 21 ♘d6+ ♔f8 22 ♘c6) 21 ♘d6+ ♔c7 22 ♘6b5+ winning. Only Christiansen noticed 19 ♖xb7 ♕xd6! 20 ♕xd6 ♗xb7 and matters are not entirely clear, e.g. 21 ♗h5 ♖f8 22 ♗xf7 (22 c4 ♖c8 or 22 ♗f3 ♗xf3 23 gxf3 ♖g8+ 24 ♔f2 ♖g5) ♖xf7 23 ♘xe6+ ♔e8 24 ♘c7+ ♔d8 25 ♘xa8 ♗xa8 26 ♕xa6 ±.

2) **17...♘g6?** 18 ♘xf6+ ♔d8 19 ♘c6+ bxc6 20 ♕d4+ ♔c7 (20...♗d7 21 ♕b6+ ♔c8 22 ♕b7+) 21 ♕b6+ ♔d6 22 ♖d1+ ♔e5 23 ♕d4+ ♔f5 24 ♖f1+ ♔g5 25 ♕e3+ and White is winning.

18 ♘xf6 ♘d7

Not 18...♘g6? 19 ♘c6+ bxc6 20 ♕d2+! ♗d7 21 ♕a5+ ♔c8 22 ♗xa6+ winning.

19 ♘xd7 ♗xd7

Or 19...♔xd7 20 ♘xe6 fxe6 21 ♖d1+ ♔c6 22 ♗f3+ ♔b6 23 ♕d4+ ♔c7 24 ♕e5+ ♔b6 25 ♖b1+ ♔a7 26 ♕d4+ ♔b8 27 ♕xh8 (the material balance is restored, but White has a decisive advantage) ♖a7 28 ♕d4 a5 29 ♗e4 ♖a6 30 ♕e5+ ♔a7 31 ♗d3 ♖c6 32 ♕xa5+ ♔b8 33 ♕e5+ ♔a7 34 ♖b3 h6 35 h3 ♖c5 36 ♖a3+ ♔b6

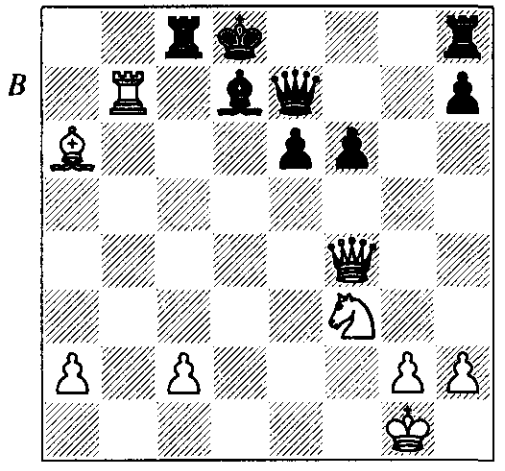
37 ♕b8 1-0 Oll-Zagrebelny, USSR 1983.

20 ♖xb7 ♖c8

20...e5 21 ♘c6+ ♗xc6 22 ♕d2+ ♗d7 23 ♗g4 wins.

21 ♘f3! f6

22 ♗xa6 *(D)*



B

22 ... e5

The other lines are also good for White:

1) **22...♖xc2?** 23 ♖b8+ ♗c8 24 ♘d4! e5 25 ♕f5 ♖c1+ 26 ♔f2 +–.

2) **22...♖f8** 23 ♕d4! ♔e8 (23...e5 24 ♕b6+ ♔e8 25 ♖xd7! ♔xd7 26 ♗b5+ or 23...♕g7 24 ♕b6+ ♔e8 25 ♖xd7! ♔xd7 26 ♗b5+ ♔e7 27 ♕b7+, winning in both cases) 24 ♗b5 ♖d8 25 ♕b6 e5 26 ♘d2 f5 27 ♘c4 ♖f6 28 ♗xd7+ ♖xd7 29 ♕b5 ♖e6 30 a4 e4 31 ♔f1! ♕g7? (31...e3 32 ♔e2 f4 33 ♘b6 +– or 31...f4 32 ♘b6 +– would have put up a better fight but not changed the result) 32 ♖b8+ 1-0 Tal-Ftačnik, Sochi 1982 (32...♔e7 33 ♕xd7+).

3) **22...♖g8** 23 ♗b5 (23 ♕d4 ♕g7!) ♕c5+ 24 ♔h1 (24 ♘d4 ♖c7 25 ♖xc7 ♕xc7 26 ♕xf6+ ♔c8 27 ♕e7! h6 28 ♗a6+ ♔b8 29 ♕b4+ is promising for White after 29...♔a8 30 ♗f3 ± or 29...♔a7 30 ♗b5 ♕b7 31 ♕c5+ ♔b8 32 ♗c6 ±) ♖c7 25 ♖b8+ ♖c8 26 ♖b7 ♖c7 27 ♖b8+ ♖c8 28 ♗xd7 (28 ♕xf6+! ♔c7 29 ♕f4+ e5! 30 ♘xe5! ♖xb8 31 ♘xd7+ ♕d6 32 ♕xd6+ ♔xd6 33 ♘xb8 ♖xb8 34 a4 gives White winning chances) ♔xd7 29 ♖b7+ ♖c7 30 ♖xc7+ ♕xc7 31 ♕xf6 ♖b8 32 ♕f7+ ♔d6 33 ♕f4+ ♔d7 34 ♕f7+ ♔d6 ½-½ Kengis-Azmaiparashvili, USSR 1982.

23 ♕d2

White keeps some advantage after any black reply:

1) **23...♕c5+** 24 ♔h1 ♕c6 25 ♘xe5! fxe5 26 ♕g5+ ♔e8 27 ♕xe5+ ♔f7 28 ♗c4+ ♔g6 29 ♗d5 +–.

2) **23...♔e8** 24 ♕d5! ♖d8 25 ♗b5 ♖f8 (25...e4 26 ♘d4 e3 27 ♗xd7+ ♖xd7 28 ♖b8+ ♖d8 29 ♕h5+ ♔f8 30 ♖xd8+ ♕xd8 31 ♘e6+ wins) 26 ♘h4 f5 (26...♕f7 27 ♗xd7+ ♖xd7 28 ♖b8+ ♔e7 29 ♘f5#) 27 ♘f3 Manduch-Wittmann, corr 1983.

3) **23...♖f8!** 24 ♗b5 ♕c5+ 25 ♔h1 ♖c7 26 ♖b8+ ♔e7 27 ♖xf8 ♕xb5 28 ♖h8 ♕f1+ 29 ♘g1 ♕f5 (29...♖b7 30 ♕d5! ±) 30 ♕b4+ ♔e6 31 c3 ±.

In line E1 Black, by extremely precise play, can reach a position where he only has a modest disadvantage. Only masochists need consider playing this variation with Black.

E2)

14 ... gxf6

It is better to retain the important dark-squared bishop, and in this line Black can equalise by means of accurate play.

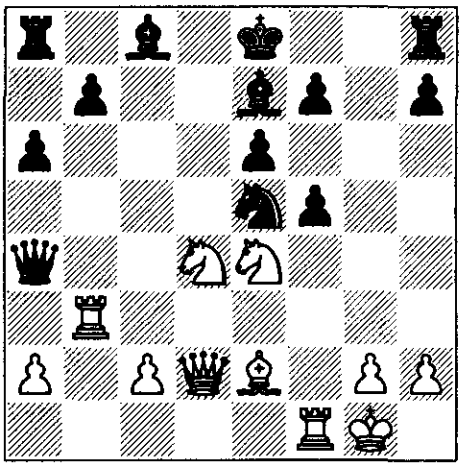
15 ♘e4 f5

Not 15...♗d7 16 ♖xb7 ♖d8 17 ♕f4 ♖f8 18 ♗h5 f5 19 ♖xd7 ♖xd7

20 ♘xe6 fxe4 21 ♕xe5 ♕e3+ 22 ♔h1 ♗d6 23 ♕f5 +– Lukovnikov-Zilbershtein, Podolsk Cht 1993.

16 ♖b3 ♕a4 *(D)*

W



17 ♘xf5!

The alternative **17 ♕c3?** has given rise to an immense amount of analysis, but the move is simply bad. The refutation runs **17...♖g8!** (we need not consider the complex alternatives 17...♗d7 and 17...fxe4; curious readers may refer to *The Najdorf for the Tournament Player* for detailed coverage) **18 ♘c5 ♗xc5 19 ♕xc5 ♘c6 20 ♗b5** (Black has excellent winning chances after 20 c4 ♕a5 21 ♕d6 ♕d8 or 20 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 21 ♕xc6+ bxc6 22 ♗f3 ♖a7 23 ♗xc6+ ♔e7, while 20 ♘xf5 exf5 21 ♖e3+ ♗e6 22 ♕xf5 loses to 22...0-0-0) **axb5 21 ♘xb5** and now:

1) **21...♖a5** (this leads to a forced draw) 22 ♘c7+ ♔d8 23 ♖d1+ ♗d7 24 ♕d6 ♘e5 25 ♖xb7! (25 ♘xe6+ fxe6 26 ♕b8+ ♔e7 27 ♕xg8 ♕g4! ∓ Hort-Miles, London 1983) ♖xg2+ 26 ♔xg2 ♕e4+ 27 ♔g1 ♕xb7 (perpetual check will also arise after 27...♕g4+) 28 ♕f8+ ♔xc7 29 ♕d6+ ♔d8 ½-½ Miles-Hort, London 1983.

2) **21...♕a5!** and now:

2a) **22 ♖a3** ♕xb5 23 ♕xb5 ♖xa3 is good for Black.

2b) **22 ♘d6+** ♔f8 23 ♖b5 ♕a7 24 ♖b6 ♔g7 25 ♖f3 h6 –+.

2c) **22 ♕d6** f6 23 ♘c7+ (23 ♖xf5 exf5 24 ♖e3+ ♔f7 25 ♕d5+ ♔f8 26 ♕d6+ ♔g7 0-1 Pontecorvo-Van der Heijden, corr 1985) ♔f8 24 ♘xa8 ♕xa8 25 ♖h3 ♕a7+ 26 ♔h1 ♖g7 –+ Eriksen-Parades Prats, corr 1992.

2d) **22 ♖h3!?** is White's last possibility to scrape a draw, but it looks fairly desperate. The idea is that 22...♖g7 23 ♖a3 ♕xb5 (23...♕d2 24 ♖f2 ♕e1+ is a draw) 24 ♕xb5 ♖xa3 allows 25 ♕b2. However, simply 22...h6! seems to be very strong. White cannot reply 23 ♖xh6 due to 23...♕d2, and 23 ♖d1 f6 24 ♖xh6 ♔f7 offers White inadequate compensation for the piece.

17 ... exf5

It isn't clear whether this is better than 17...♕xe4, when play continues 18 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 19 ♖e3! (not 19 ♕g5+ ♔e8 20 ♖e3 ♕d4 21 ♖d1 h6! ∓) ♕d5 20 ♕b4+ ♕d6 (20...♔e8 21 ♖d1 ♕c6 22 ♖c3! a5 23 ♕d4 ♕d5 24 ♕e3 +–) 21 ♕h4+ ♔e8 22 ♕f6 ♖f8 23 ♖xe5 (White is a pawn down, but his pressure against Black's exposed king more than compensates) ♗d7 (or 23...♕e7 24 ♕h6 ♗d7, but after 25 ♕xh7 White retains some advantage) 24 ♗h5 ♕e7 25 ♕g7 ♔d8 26 ♖xf7! ♖xf7 27 ♗xf7 ♔c7! (not 27...♗e8? 28 ♖xe6! ♕xf7 29 ♕g5+ ♔c8 30 ♕e5 ♔d8 31 ♕g5+ ♔c8 32 ♕e5 ♔d8 33 ♕d6+ ♕d7 34 ♕b6+ ♔c8 35 ♕c5+ ♔d8 36 ♖d6 +– Lobron-Ribli, Zagreb 1985) 28 ♕g3 (28 ♕xh7?? ♖f8 29 ♗g6 ♕f6 –+) ♕d6. Now Van der Tempel-Wagenaar, corr 1991 continued 29 ♖c5+

♗c6 30 ♕xd6+ ♔xd6 31 ♖h5 ♖h8 32 c4 h6 and Black even won the ending, but White shouldn't have acquiesced so easily to the exchange of queens. He could have retained a slight advantage by 29 ♕c3+ ♔b8 (or 29...♔d8 30 ♖e1 and Black's king remains exposed) 30 ♖e3 ♔a7 31 ♖d3 ♕b6+ 32 ♕d4, only offering to swap queens once Black's king has been driven away from the centre.

18 ♘d6+ ♗xd6

18...♔f8 19 ♕h6+ ♔g8 20 ♗c4! is winning for White after 20...♗xd6 21 ♖g3+ ♘g4 22 ♖xg4+ or 20...♗e6 21 ♗xe6 ♕d4+ 22 ♔h1 ♗xd6 23 ♕f6! ♕g4 24 ♗xf5.

19 ♕xd6 ♕e4

19...♘c6 20 ♖e3+ ♗e6 21 ♖xe6+ fxe6 22 ♗h5#.

20 ♖e1 ♘c6

20...♗d7 (not 20...♘c4 21 ♕b4 ♕d4+ 22 ♔h1 ♗e6 23 ♗xc4 +– Janczyszyn-Zgodka, corr 1993) is less accurate after **21 ♖b4!** and now:

1) **21...♘f3+** 22 ♔f2 ♕xb4 23 ♕xb4 ♘xe1 24 ♕xb7 ♔e7 25 ♕b4+ ♔f6 26 ♕d4+ ± as Black's king remains exposed.

2) **21...♕e3+** 22 ♔f1 0-0-0 (not 22...♗c6 23 ♗f3 ♗b5+ 24 c4! ♗xc4+ 25 ♖xc4 ♕xe1+ 26 ♔xe1 ♘xc4 27 ♕c5 +–) 23 ♗d3 ±.

21 ♔f1 ♗e6

22 ♗h5

The only move, since 22 ♗f3 (22 ♗d1 ♖d8! is also good for Black) ♖d8! 23 ♕c5 ♕h4 24 g3 (24 ♖xb7 ♘e7 threatens ...♕c4+) ♕g5 25 ♖xb7 ♘e7 leaves White struggling for compensation.

22 ... ♕c4+! *(D)*

After 22...♖d8 23 ♕xe6+ ♕xe6 24 ♖xe6+ ♔f8 25 ♖f6 ♖d7 26 ♖xf5 ♖g8 27 ♖d3 ♖e7 28 ♔f2 White retains an edge, although there was no need for Black to lose as quickly as he did in Pisarev-Malykh, corr 1991, which concluded 28...h6 29 ♖df3 ♘e5 30 ♖xe5 1-0.

After 22...♕c4+, play may continue **23 ♖d3** (23 ♖e2? ♘d8! 24 ♖e3 ♖c8 wins as the e2-rook is pinned) **♘d8** and now:

1) **24 ♕d7+** ♔f8 25 ♕d6+ and in Pogrebniak-Guk, USSR 1986 the game ended in a draw after 25...♔e8 26 ♕d7+ ½-½. The other king moves give White at least a draw, for example 25...♔g8 26 ♗e2 f4 27 ♖g3+ fxg3 28 ♕xg3+ ♔f8 29 ♕a3+ or 25...♔g7 26 ♕g3+ (26 ♕e5+ f6 27 ♕g3+ ♔f8 28 ♕d6+ ♔g7 29 ♕e7+ ♗f7 30 ♗xf7 ♘xf7 31 ♔g1 f4 32 ♖e6 is met by 32...♖he8! 33 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 –+) ♔h6?! (26...♔f8! 27 ♕d6+ =) 27 ♗e2! ♕e4 28 ♗d1 ±.

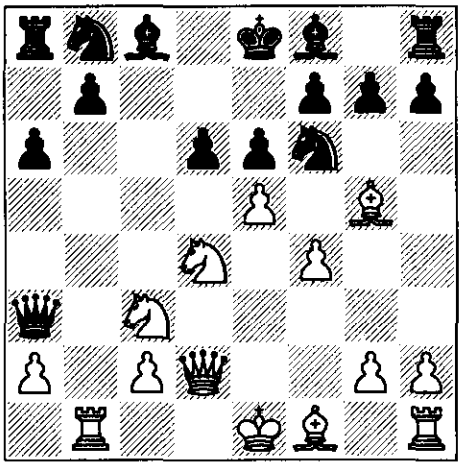
2) **24 ♖xe6+!?** ♕xe6 25 ♕d4 ♖g8 (25...♔e7 26 ♕xh8 ♕h6 ∞) 26 ♖e3 ♖c8 (26...♔e7 27 ♖xe6+ fxe6 28 ♕h4+ ♔d6 29 ♗f3 =) 27 ♖xe6+ ♘xe6 28 ♕b6 (28 ♕d5 ♖c6 29 ♕xf5 ♖g7 30 ♗f3 ♖c7 =; 28 ♕f6 ♖g6 29 ♗xg6 hxg6 =) ♔e7! 29 ♕xb7+ ♖c7 with an equal position, Sidorenko-Guk, USSR 1987.

The conclusion is that 11...♕a5 is interesting and promising for Black, 11...h6 is relatively untested but apparently satisfactory, 11...♕c5 is at least equal for Black (but see the note about move-order) and 11...♘bd7 is roughly level. White's problem in this line is the number of viable black continuations; simply finding one improvement would not be enough to revive the variation.

5 Poisoned Pawn: 9 ♖b1 ♕a3 10 e5

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♕b6 8 ♕d2 ♕xb2 9 ♖b1 ♕a3 10 e5 *(D)*

B



When the Poisoned Pawn was first played, White invariably continued 10 e5, for what could be more natural than to gain time by kicking away the knight? Moreover, if Black exchanges pawns the f-file is opened for White's attack. Today, however, the view is that the weakness of the e5-pawn and the open diagonal for the f8-bishop provide enough compensation for the loss of time.

The 10 e5 variation has slumped from being the main line of the Poisoned Pawn to a theoretical backwater. A revival is not imminent.

There are two reasonable moves for Black:

A: 10...h6
B: 10...dxe5

Others are inferior:

1) **10...♘d5** 11 ♘xd5 exd5 12 ♖b3 ♕xa2 (12...♕a4 13 ♘b5) 13 ♕c3 or 13 ♖e3 with a decisive attack.

2) **10...♘fd7** 11 f5! ♘xe5 (or 11...dxe5 12 fxe6 exd4 13 exf7+ ♔xf7 14 ♗c4+ ♔e8 15 ♕e2+ ♗e7 16 ♘d5 ♕a5+ 17 ♔d1 ♘c6 18 ♘xe7 ♘ce5 19 ♘f5 +–) 12 fxe6 fxe6 13 ♗e2 ♘bc6 14 ♘xc6 bxc6 15 ♘e4 d5 16 0-0 ♕a4 17 ♗h5+ ♔d7 18 ♖xf8! 1-0 Keres-Fuderer, Gothenburg IZ 1955.

A)

10 ... h6

This rare continuation is a bit risky, since White can chase Black's king out into the open. However, the theoretical verdict is rather favourable for Black, because many lines end in perpetual check and Black is the one who can play to avoid the draw. Doubtless this variation would have been more carefully investigated had 10...dxe5 proved less successful.

11 ♗xf6

Or 11 ♗h4 (11 exf6 hxg5 12 f5 gxf6 13 fxe6 fxe6 14 ♗d3 ♘c6 15 ♘xc6 bxc6 16 ♗g6+ ♔d8 ∓) dxe5 12 fxe5 13 ♗e2 (13 ♗c4 is also answered by 13...♗e7, while 13 ♘e4 transposes into a line of variation B1 regarded as good for Black) ♗e7 (now Black threatens to take on h4

with check, so there is no time for ♖b3) 14 ♗g3 ♗g5 ∓ Pichler-Yuferov, Moscow 1990.

11 ... gxf6

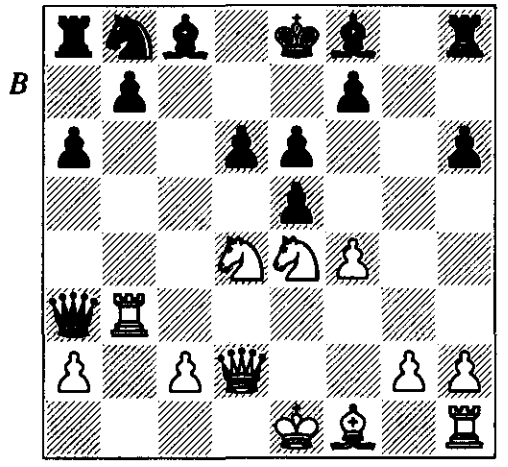
12 ♘e4

12 ♖b3 (12 exd6?! ♕xd6 13 ♘e4 ♕d8 14 ♕c3 ♗e7 15 g4 ♖g8 16 ♗e2 h5 ∓ Kots-Bykov, USSR 1962) ♕a5 13 exd6 ♗xd6 14 ♘db5 ♗e7 15 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 16 ♕xd6 ♕d8 17 ♕a3 ♕e7 ∓.

12 ... fxe5

13 ♖b3 *(D)*

13 fxe5 dxe5 14 ♘f5 (14 ♘f6+ ♔e7 15 ♘f5+ ♔xf6 wins for Black after 16 ♖b3 ♕xb3! 17 axb3 exf5 18 ♕d8+ ♔g7 or 16 ♕d8+ ♔g6 17 ♘h4+ ♔g7) exf5 15 ♘f6+ ♔e7 16 ♘d5+ ♔e8 (16...♔d8!? is a reasonable winning attempt, for example 17 ♖b3 ♕c5 18 ♘b6+ ♘d7 19 ♘xa8 ♗d6 ∓) 17 ♘c7+ ♔e7 and White should take the draw, as in Vooremaa-Smit, USSR 1961, as 18 ♘xa8 ♘d7 19 ♘c7 ♘f6 led to a win for Black in Kapengut-Kalinsky, USSR 1965.



13 ... ♕a4

Another possibility for Black is 13...♕xa2, for example 14 ♘f6+ ♔e7 15 fxe5 dxe5 16 ♘f5+ ♔xf6 (16...exf5 17 ♘d5+ ♔e6 18 ♘c7+ ♔f6 is a draw as 19 ♘xa8 ♕a1+ is just lost for White) 17 ♕d8+ ♔g6 18 ♘e7+! (18 ♖g3+? ♔h7 19 ♕f6 exf5) ♗xe7 19 ♕xe7 ♕a5+?! (19...♕a1+ was better, when 20 ♔e2 ♘c6 is similar to the game but with an important difference which will be revealed later) 20 ♔e2 ♘c6 21 ♖g3+ ♔f5 22 ♖f3+ ♔e4 23 ♖e3+ ♔d5 24 c4+ ♔xc4 25 ♕d6! ♔b5 (if the black queen had been on a1 instead of a5, then 25...♖d8! would have won here) 26 ♖b3+ ♔c4 27 ♖b1! ♖d8 28 ♔e3+ ♔c3 29 ♗d3! 1-0 Sporish-Sorokin, USSR 1968. See *The King-Hunt* by John Nunn and William Cozens for detailed annotations to this spectacular game.

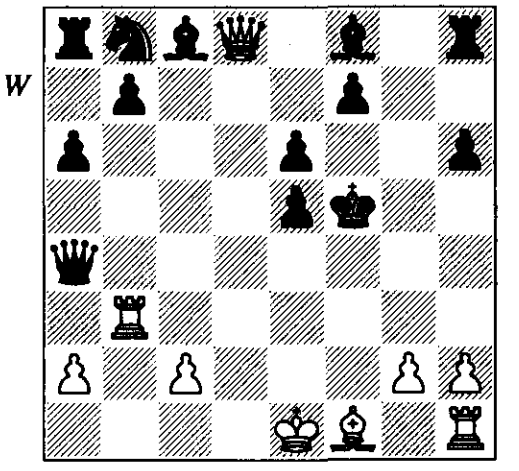
14 fxe5 dxe5

15 ♘f6+ ♔e7

16 ♘f5+ ♔xf6

16...exf5 17 ♘d5+ ♔e6 18 ♘c7+ ♔f6 19 ♘d5+ (19 ♕d8+? ♔g6 20 ♖g3+ ♔h7 21 ♕f6 ♕a5+ followed by 21...♕xc7 −+; 19 ♘xa8? ♕e4+ 20 ♔d1 ♗c5 −+) ♔e6 (19...♔g6?? 20 ♖g3+ mates) ½-½ Bradarević-Buljovčić, Yugoslav Ch 1965.

17 ♕d8+ ♔xf5 *(D)*



18 ♗d3+ e4 19 0-0+ and now:

1) **19...♔g6** 20 ♕f6+ (but not 20 ♗xe4+? f5 21 ♖g3+ ♔f7 22 ♕c7+ ♘d7 23 ♗xf5 ♕d4+ 24 ♔h1 exf5 25 ♖xf5+ ♔e6 26 ♖f1 ♘e5 –+ Ungr-Prieditis, corr 1962) ♔h7 21 ♖f4! ♗g7 22 ♖xe4! ♔g8 23 ♕d8+ 1-0 Gudat-Prieditis, corr 1967. However, 21...exd3 22 ♖xa4 dxc2 23 ♕xf7+ ♗g7 24 ♖c4 ♖f8 25 ♕c7 ♘c6 26 ♖g3 ♖g8 is a large improvement, when Black is at least equal.

2) **19...♔e5** 20 ♕f6+ ♔d6 21 ♕xh8 ♘d7 22 ♖xf7! (22 ♗e2 f5 ∓) exd3 23 ♖xd3+ ♔c6 24 ♖xf8 ♘xf8 25 ♕xf8 ♔b6 26 ♕f2+ ♔c7 27 ♕g3+ with perpetual check.

B)

10	**...**	**dxe5**
11	**fxe5**	**♘fd7** *(D)*

Or:

1) **11...h6** 12 ♗xf6 (12 ♗f4! ♘fd7 13 ♗c4 is more dangerous) gxf6 13 exf6 ♘d7 14 ♘e4 ♕xa2 (14...♘c5!? 15 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 ∞) 15 ♖b3 ♕a4 16 ♖e3 ♘c5 17 ♘c3 ♕d7 18 ♗c4 b5 19 ♘cxb5 with enormous complications in the game Brodsky-Savon, USSR Ch 1991.

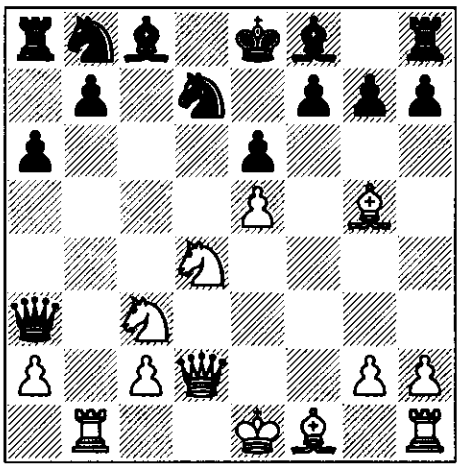
2) **11...♘d5?** 12 ♘xd5 exd5 13 ♖b3 ♕a4 (13...♕xa2 14 ♕c3) 14 ♘b5! axb5 15 ♗xb5+ ♘c6 16 ♗xa4 ♖xa4 17 0-0 ♗c5+ 18 ♔h1 ♗d4 19 ♕f4 1-0 Svennerstedt-Foglar, corr.

Now White has two main lines:

B1: 12 ♘e4
B2: 12 ♗c4

The only real alternative is **12 ♗e2** and now:

1) **12...♕c5** 13 ♘a4 (13 0-0 ♘c6 14 ♗e3 ♘xd4 15 ♗xd4 ♕xd4+ –+; 13 ♘e4 ♕xe5 14 ♗f3 ♘f6 15 ♘e2



♘bd7 16 ♘xf6+ ♘xf6 ∓ Vasiukov-Sherbakov, USSR 1956) ♕xe5 (or 13...♕c7 14 0-0 ♘c6 15 ♖xf7 ♘xd4 16 ♕xd4 ♔xf7 17 ♖f1+ ♔e8 18 ♕e4 g6 wins for Black, Havlicek-Bachler, Vienna 1990) 14 ♘xe6 ♕xe6 (14...fxe6 15 ♘b6 ♗c5 16 ♘xa8 0-0 ∓) 15 ♘b6 ♗c5! 16 ♘xa8 0-0 and Black can be happy.

2) **12...♗b4** (not 12...♘xe5? 13 ♘xe6) 13 ♖b3 ♕a5 14 0-0 (this is similar to the main line, but the bishop is not so active on e2 and, in particular, sacrifices on e6 are not possible) 0-0 15 ♗f6 ♘xf6 16 exf6 ♖d8 17 ♖xb4 (17 fxg7 ♗c5! –+, but not 17...♖xd4? 18 ♕h6! with a strong attack, as in Mahia-Quinteros, Buenos Aires 1960) ♕xb4 18 ♕g5 g6 19 ♖f4 (19 ♕h6 ♕f8 20 ♕h4 h6 21 ♖f3 e5 22 ♘b3 ♘c6 –+ Krolikowski-Gruszczynski, corr 1991; unlike line B2, where the bishop is on c4 instead of e2, White has no time for ♘e4 as his d4-knight is attacked by the queen) ♖xd4 20 ♕h6 ♕f8 and Black will be a pawn up in the forthcoming ending.

3) **12...♕a5** 13 0-0 (13 ♘b3 is met by 13...♕c7 14 0-0 ♘xe5 15 ♘e4 f5 16 ♗h5+ g6 17 ♗f6 ♖g8 18 ♕f4 ♗g7 and Black is better) and now:

3a) **13...♗b4?** 14 ♘e4! ♗xd2 15 ♘d6+ ♔f8 16 ♘xe6+ ♔g8 17 ♖xf7 ♕xe5 18 ♖e7 ♘f8 (18...h6 19 ♖e8+ ♔h7 20 ♗d3+ g6 21 ♖e7+ ♔g8 22 ♗c4! hxg5 23 ♘f4+) 19 ♖f1! ♕xe6 20 ♗c4! ♗d7 (20...h6 21 ♖xf8+ ♔h7 22 ♗d3+ ♕g6 23 ♖xh8+ ♔xh8 24 ♗xg6 ♗d7 25 ♗xd2) Heitmann-Bucholz, corr 1975, and unfortunately White won rather prosaically by 21 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 22 ♗xe6 g6 23 ♖f7+ ♔g8 24 ♖xd7+ ♔f8 25 ♖f7+ ♔g8 26 ♗f6 1-0, instead of forcing mate in five by 21 ♘f5!!. Nevertheless, an exceptional game.

3b) **13...♗c5** 14 ♔h1 ♗xd4 15 ♕xd4 ♘c6 16 ♕f2 0-0 17 ♘e4 ♕xe5 ∓ Dworzynski-Walther, Moscow OL 1956.

B1)

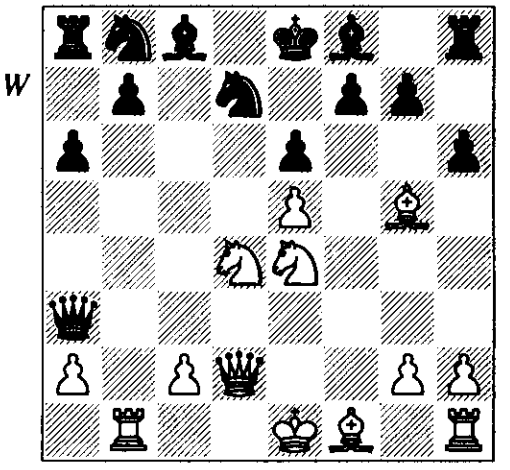
12 ♘e4 h6! *(D)*

Or **12...♕xa2** (12...♕a4? 13 ♗b5! axb5 14 0-0 ♗c5 15 ♘xc5 ♘xc5 16 ♘f5! 0-0 17 ♘e7+ ♔h8 18 ♖xf7 ♘bd7 19 ♕f2 with a winning attack, Alexander-Walther, Dublin 1957) **13 ♖b3 ♘c6** (13...♗c5? 14 ♕c3 wins after 14...h6 15 ♘xc5 hxg5 16 ♘cxe6 or 14...b6 15 ♘d6+, while 13...♕a1+? 14 ♔f2 ♕a4, Tolush-Tal, USSR Ch 1956, should have been met by 15 ♘xe6! fxe6 16 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 17 ♕xd6 ♖f8+ 18 ♔g3 ♘f6 19 exf6 gxf6 20 ♗e2 ±, for example 20...fxg5 21 ♗h5+ ♖f7 22 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 23 ♖f3+ ♔g6 24 ♕d3+ ♔h6 25 h4 +−) **14 ♘xc6 bxc6** and now White has been successful with two moves:

1) **15 ♕c3** ♕a4 16 ♗c4! ♘c5 (16...♘xe5 17 0-0! ♘xc4 18 ♘f6+ gxf6 19 ♕xf6, or 17...♕xc4 18 ♕xe5 ♕d5 19 ♖d3!) 17 ♕d2 f6 18 exf6! ♘xe4 19 f7+ ♔xf7 20 ♕f4+ ♔e8 21 ♕xe4 ♗c5 22 ♖d3 ♗b6 23 ♖a3 ♕xa3 24 ♕xc6+ 1-0 Ostrovjerhov-Koshelj, corr 1971.

2) **15 ♗c4** ♕a1+ 16 ♔f2 ♕xe5 17 ♖e1 ♗c5+ 18 ♔f1! ♕c7!? 19 ♖d3 0-0! 20 ♗f6!? ♘e5! 21 ♖h3! ♘g6 22 ♘xc5 gxf6 23 ♖e4 e5 24 ♖g3 f5 25 ♕h6! fxe4! 26 ♖xg6+ hxg6 27 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 28 ♕h6+ ♔g8 29 ♘xe4 ♕d8 30 ♘f6+ ♕xf6+ 31 ♕xf6 ♗e6 32 ♗d3 +− Keresztes-Blaho, corr 1957.

I am not sure that either of these games is completely convincing, but certainly Black comes under a fierce attack after 12...♕xa2 and it cannot be recommended.



13 ♗b5!?

This astonishing move is the only decent continuation for White. The alternative **13 ♗h4** (13 ♖b3 ♕a4 is good for Black) **♕xa2 14 ♖b3** is inferior:

1) **14...♘c6** 15 ♘xc6 bxc6 16 ♕c3 is dangerous for Black (compare with the note to Black's 12th move).

2) **14...♕a4** 15 ♗e2 ♘c6 (here 15...♘c5 fails to 16 ♘b5! ♕a1+ 17 ♗d1 f6 18 ♘xf6+! gxf6 19 0-0) 16

♘xe6 ♕a1+ 17 ♔f2 ♕xe5 18 ♘xf8 ♔xf8 19 ♘d6 ♕d4 20 ♕xd4 ♘xd4 21 ♖c3 with strong pressure to compensate for the pawns, Schudro-Gebuhr, corr.

3) **14...♕a1+** 15 ♔f2 ♕a4 (the preliminary check on a1 has forced White's king to an inferior square) and now White has no good move: the bishop on h4 hangs after **16 ♘xe6** fxe6 17 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6; **16 ♗e2** and **16 ♗c4** are both answered by 16...♘c5; **16 ♖e3** ♘c6 17 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 18 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 19 exd6 ♕c5! 20 ♗e7 ♘e5 21 ♗e2 ♘g6 22 ♖d1 ♗d7 23 ♗f3 ♗c6 –+ was Mazzoni-Tringov, The Hague Z 1966; finally, **16 ♗b5** axb5 17 ♘xb5 ♗c5+! 18 ♘xc5 ♕xh4+ 19 g3 ♕d8! 20 ♕d6 (20 ♘d6+ ♔f8 21 ♕f4 ♕e7) ♘xc5! 21 ♘c7+ ♕xc7 22 ♕xc7 ♘8a6 23 ♕b6 ♘xb3 –+ was Korchnoi-Tolush, USSR Ch 1958.

13 ... hxg5

The soundest reply is **13...axb5! 14 ♘xb5 hxg5** (14...♕xa2 15 0-0 hxg5 16 ♘ed6+ ♗xd6 17 ♘xd6+ ♔d8 18 ♘xf7+ +– Baudu-Guiral, corr 1979) **15 ♘xa3 ♖xa3 16 0-0 ♘c6 17 ♖b5** and now:

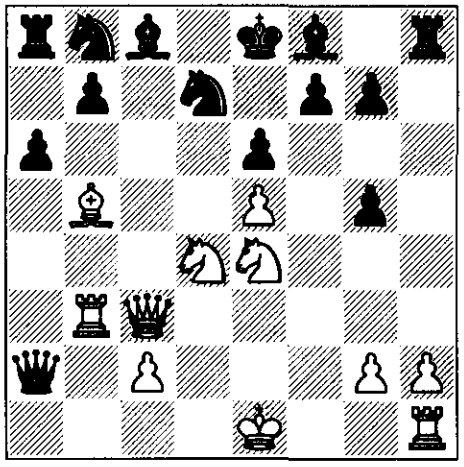
1) **17...♖a4** 18 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 19 exd6 f6 20 c3 ♖ah4 21 h3 ♘ce5 22 ♖b4 ♘c4 23 ♕e2 ♘de5 24 ♖d1 ♔d7 25 ♖d4 ♘xd6 26 ♕d1 ♖xd4 27 ♖xd4 ♘ef7 ∓ Vogelmann-W.Löffler, corr 1987.

2) **17...♗e7** 18 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 19 exd6 (19 ♕xd6 ♖xa2) f6 20 ♖e1 ♘ce5 (20...♘de5 21 d7+!) 21 ♕b4 (21 ♖bxe5!? fxe5 22 ♕xg5 ♔f7 23 ♕e7+ ♔g6 24 ♖f1 is unclear) ♖a6 ½-½ Platonov-Minić, Sochi 1968, even though 22 ♖xb7 ♖h4 is good for Black.

14 ♖b3 ♕xa2?!

Or 14...axb5 (14...♕e7? 15 ♘d6+ ♔d8 16 ♗xd7 and ♕a5+ wins) 15 ♖xa3 ♗xa3 16 ♕xg5 (16 ♘xb5 0-0 17 ♕xg5 f6 is better for Black) ♖a4! 17 c3 ♘c6 18 ♕xg7 ♖f8 19 0-0 (Quinteros-Browne, London 1981/2) ♘cxe5 (better than 19...♗e7?! 20 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 21 exd6 ±) 20 ♘g5 b4! 21 ♘dxe6!? (21 ♘h7 bxc3 ∓; 21 c4 ♗b2!) bxc3! (21...fxe6 22 ♖xf8+ ♘xf8 23 ♕xe5 is also murky) 22 ♘xf8 ♗xf8 ∞.

15 ♕c3 *(D)*



White has a dangerous but not necessarily decisive attack, as the following variations prove:

1) **15...axb5** 16 ♕xc8+ ♔e7 17 0-0! (17 ♘d6 ♘c6 18 0-0! ♘cxe5! and now 19 ♘4f5+ exf5 20 ♘xf5+ ♔f6 21 ♕c7 ♔g6 0-1 Martinez-Vera, Cuba 1984, or 19 ♕c7 ♕a7 20 ♖d3 ♕c5 and the attack collapses) and now:

1a) **17...♘c6** 18 ♖xf7+ ♔xf7 19 ♕xd7+ ♗e7 20 ♕xe6+ ♔e8 21 ♘d6+ ♔d8 22 ♘xb7+ ♔c7 23 ♕xc6+ ♔b8 24 ♕d7 ♕a1+ 25 ♔f2 ♖f8+ 26 ♖f3 ♖xf3+ 27 gxf3 ♖a6, Maliszewski-Wisniewski, corr 1993, and now 28 ♘d8! ♗xd8 29 ♕xd8+ ♔b7 30 e6

would have been very good for White.

1b) **17...♕a7!** 18 ♖d3 f5!? (after 18...♘xe5 19 ♖xf7+ ♘xf7 20 ♕xe6+ ♔d8 21 ♔f1 White has a dangerous attack, but a forced win is not easy to find after 21...♕a2!) 19 exf6+ gxf6 20 ♖xf6 ♖h6 21 ♖xh6 ♗xh6 22 ♔f1! ∞ Vlasov-Shalnev, Sokobanja 1989.

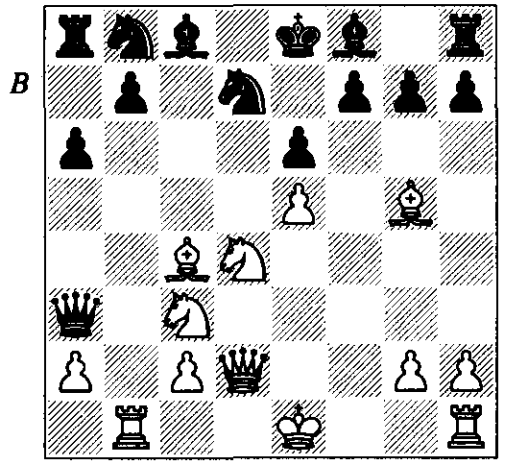
2) **15...♘c6** 16 ♗xc6 bxc6 17 0-0 ♘xe5 (17...c5 18 ♘c6! ♕a4 19 ♕f3 ♘xe5 20 ♘xe5 ♕d4+ 21 ♖e3! f6 22 ♘c6 followed by ♘xf6+ wins) 18 ♘e2 ♕a4 19 ♕xe5 ♕c4 20 ♖d3 f5? 21 ♖xf5 ♖a7? 22 ♖xf8+ 1-0 Quinteros-Sunye, San Pedro de Jujuy 1981.

3) **15...♔d8** 16 ♘d6 ♗xd6 17 exd6 ♘c6 18 ♗xc6 bxc6 19 0-0 with a winning attack for White, Velasquez-Lopez, Chile Ch 1984.

The imaginative 13 ♗b5 poses questions which have not been completely resolved, but it is hard to believe that it can give White the advantage since Black has several reasonable possibilities.

B2)

12 ♗c4 *(D)*



This is a critical position, in which at least five moves have been tried in practice. Of these 12...♕c5 is considered dubious (however, see the note to Black's 15th in line 4 below), 12...♘xe5 may not be as bad as its reputation and 12...♗e7 is unclear. The two remaining lines, 12...♕a5 and 12...♗b4, are entirely satisfactory for Black.

B21: 12...♗e7
B22: 12...♕a5
B23: 12...♗b4

The lesser alternatives are:

1) **12...♘c6** 13 ♘xc6 bxc6 14 ♘e4 ♕a4 15 ♕c3 ±.

2) **12...h6** 13 ♗f4 ♘c6 14 ♘xc6 bxc6 15 ♘e4 ±.

3) **12...♘xe5** (very risky, but it does not lose outright) 13 ♘xe6! ♕a5 (13...fxe6 14 ♕d8+ ♔f7 15 0-0+ ♔g6 16 ♖f6+ wins) and now:

3a) **14 ♗b5+** leading to a further branch:

3a1) **14...♘bd7** (not 14...axb5? 15 ♖xb5 +−, nor 14...♘bc6? 15 ♗d8! +−) 15 ♘xf8 ♔xf8 (after 15...♖xf8, White has the choice between 16 ♘d5 ♕xd2+ 17 ♔xd2 f6 18 ♘xa8 fxg5 19 ♘xa8 ± and 16 ♗e2, playing for the attack) 16 ♗e2 h6 17 ♗e3 ♔g8 18 0-0 b5 19 ♖b3 ♘f6 20 ♖xf6 gxf6 21 ♕d6 ♘c4 22 ♕g3+ ♔h7 23 ♘e4! 1-0 Richter-Ulfig, corr.

3a2) **14...♗d7** leaves White with no clear route to an advantage, for example 15 ♗xd7+ ♘bxd7 16 ♘xf8 ♖xf8 17 ♖xb7 f6, followed by ...♖c8, or 15 ♗d8 ♕a3!.

3b) **14 ♗d8** ♘f3+ 15 gxf3 ♕e5+ 16 ♔d1 fxe6 17 ♘d5 ♗d6 (17...♔xd8 18 ♕a5+ b6 19 ♕xb6+ ♔d7 20 ♖e1

♕d6 21 ♕xd6+ ♔xd6 22 ♘b6+ ♗b7 23 ♘xa8 ♗xf3+ 24 ♗e2 ±) 18 ♗g5 ♘c6? (18...♕f5! is certainly better) 19 ♗f4 ♕f5 20 ♗xd6 ♕xf3+ 21 ♔c1 1-0 Djordjević-Usunov, corr.

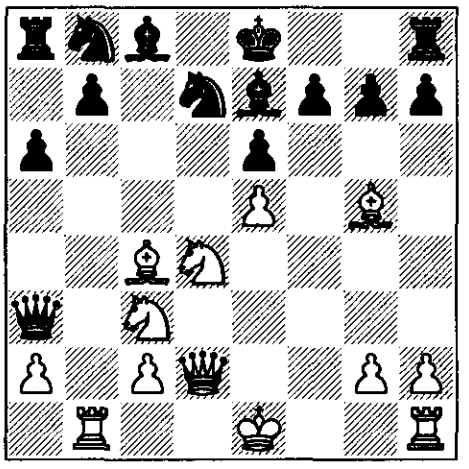
4) **12...♕c5** 13 ♗xe6 fxe6 (not 13...♕xe5+? 14 ♔d1, nor 13...♗e7 14 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 15 0-0+ ♔g8 16 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 17 ♘d5 with a white win in both cases) 14 ♘xe6 ♕xe5+ 15 ♕e3 ♕xe3+ (not 15...♔xf7? 16 0-0+ ♔e6 17 ♕h3+ ♔d6 18 ♗f4 ±, but 15...♗d6!? may be better) 16 ♗xe3 ♗d6 and now White has a choice of favourable continuations:

4a) **17 0-0** b6 (17...♘e5 18 ♘xg7+ ♔d7 19 ♖bd1 ♘c4 20 ♗f4 ♔c7 21 ♘d5+ ♔c6 22 ♗xd6 ♘xd6 23 ♖f6 ♗g4, Matanović-Darga, Vienna Echt 1957, and now 24 ♖d2! wins the piece back with a solid extra pawn) 18 ♘d5 ♗b7 19 ♗g5! ♘c5 20 ♘xg7+ ♔d7 21 ♖f7+ ♔c6 22 ♘b4+ ♔b5 23 ♘f5 ♘e4 24 ♘xd6+ ♘xd6 25 ♖c7 ♔a4 26 ♘d3 ♖g8 27 ♗e3 ♖xg2+ 28 ♔f1 ♖g4 29 ♖b3 ♗g2+ 30 ♔f2 b5, Petrović-Lipiniks, corr 1968, and now 31 ♘b2+ ♔a5 32 ♖a3+ ♖a4 33 ♘xa4 bxa4 34 ♔xg2 wins for White.

4b) **17 ♘d5** ♔f7 (17...♘f6? 18 ♘xg7+ ♔f7 19 0-0 ♔xg7 {19...♘bd7 20 ♘h5 +–} 20 ♖xf6 ♖d8 21 ♖bf1! ♔g8 22 ♘b6 +– Matanović-Barcza, Vienna Echt 1957) 18 ♘ec7 (18 ♘dc7? ♘e5) ♘f6 19 0-0 ♔g6 20 ♘f4+ ♗xf4 21 ♖xf4 ♘c6 22 ♘xa8 ♘d5 23 ♖f3 ♗g4 24 ♖g3 ♘xe3 25 ♘b6 and Black will be the exchange down for insufficient compensation (25...♖e8 26 ♖e1).

B21)

12 ... ♗e7 *(D)*



13 ♗xe6

White has a major alternative in **13 ♖b3 ♗xg5** (13...♕c5 14 ♘d5! exd5 {14...♗xg5 15 ♕xg5 transposes} 15 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 16 ♘f5 and White has an immense attack) **14 ♕xg5 ♕c5** (14...♕e7? 15 ♕xg7 ♕f8 16 ♕g5 ♖g8 17 ♕f4 ♘c5 18 0-0 ♕g7 19 ♖f2 ♘bd7 20 ♘d5! ± Keres-Tolush, Moscow 1957) **15 ♘d5!** and now:

1) **15...0-0?** 16 ♘e7+ ♔h8 17 ♘xe6 fxe6 18 ♘g6+! hxg6 19 ♖h3+ ♔g8 20 ♗xe6+ ♖f7 21 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 22 ♖f1+ wins.

2) **15...exd5** 16 ♘f5 ♘xe5 17 ♘xg7+ ♔f8 18 ♕xe5 ♕xc4 19 ♘e6+ ♗xe6 20 ♕xh8+ ♔e7 21 ♖xb7+ ♔**d6** 22 ♖xb8 leaves Black without a perpetual, e.g. 22...♕e4+ 23 ♔d1 ♗g4+ 24 ♔c1 ♕f4+ 25 ♔b1.

3) **15...g6** 16 ♖e3 h6 (16...exd5? 17 e6 is crushing) 17 ♕f4 (17 ♕h4 is also possible, but 17 ♘f6+? ♘xf6 18 ♕xf6 ♖f8 leaves White with no follow-up) exd5 (17...g5 18 ♕e4 exd5 19 ♗xd5 is good for White according to Spassky and Tolush) 18 e6 0-0 19 e7 **♖e8** (19...dxc4 20 0-0! or 19...♕xc4 20 exf8♕+ ♘xf8 21 ♖f1) 20 0-0 ♖xe7 21 ♗xd5 and Black's position crumbles.

Such is the state of theory after 13 ♖b3 (as reported in *The Najdorf for the Tournament Player*). However, as is so often the case with theoretical analysis unsupported by practical tests, most of it is simply wishful thinking. In line 2 Black has a clear advantage after **21...♘d7!** 22 ♕xa8 ♕c3+ 23 ♔f2 (or else White loses the rook on h1) ♕xc2+ 24 ♔g3 ♕d3+ 25 ♔f2 ♕d4+ 26 ♔f3 ♕e4+ 27 ♔f2 ♕f4+ 28 ♔e2 ♗g4+ 29 ♔d3 ♕c4+ 30 ♔d2 ♕xa2+. In line 3, **19...g5!** is a large improvement, for example 20 exf8♕+ ♘xf8 21 ♕f6 ♘bd7 22 ♕xh6 dxc4 or 20 ♕f5 ♕xd4 21 e8♕ ♘f6! 22 ♕xf8+ ♔xf8 23 ♕xc8+ ♔g7 and Black wins. In view of this, 13 ♗xe6 seems more reliable than 13 ♖b3.

13 ... 0-0

Or:

1) After **13...♗xg5** White should play 14 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 15 0-0+ ♔e8 (15...♘f6 16 ♕xg5 ♕xc3 17 ♖xf6+ gxf6 18 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 19 ♘e6! +–) 16 ♕xg5 with a very strong attack. The alternative 14 0-0, aiming to transpose to the column after 14...0-0, is unclear after 14...fxe6 (14...♗xd2 15 ♗xf7+ leads to mate) 15 ♕xg5 ♕e7, for example 16 ♘e4 ♕g5 17 ♘d6+ ♔d8 18 ♘xe6+ ♔e7 19 ♘xg5 ♘xe5 ∓ Ekblom-Rompotti, corr 1961.

2) **13...fxe6** 14 ♘xe6 ♗xg5 15 ♘c7+! ♔d8 16 ♘e6+ ♔e8 17 ♘xg5 is very awkward for Black, for example 17...♕a5 18 0-0 ♘xe5, Mavlikeev-Glumov, USSR 1966, and now 19 ♘ge4! ♘bc6 20 ♘d6+ ♔e7 21 ♘xb7 ♗xb7 22 ♖xb7+ ♔e8 23 ♕d6 ♕xc3 24 ♕e6+ ♔d8 25 ♖d1+ ♘d4 26 ♕xe5 ♔c8 27 ♖c7 ±.

14 0-0 ♗xg5

Or:

1) **14...fxe6** 15 ♘xe6 ♘c6 16 ♘d5! ♗c5+ 17 ♔h1 and now the capture 17...♘dxe5 fails to 18 ♘xf8 ♗xf8 19 ♘b6 ♖b8 20 ♕d5+ ♔h8 21 ♗f4, while 17...♘cxe5 18 ♘xf8 ♗xf8 19 ♘c7 ♖b8 20 ♕d5+ ♔h8 21 ♘e6 ♘g6 22 ♕d4 +– is Dückstein-Euwe, Chaumont 1958.

2) **14...♘xe5** is largely untested, but it looks like a possible improvement. In the only practical example Black lost quickly after **15 ♘d5** ♘bc6 16 ♘xc6 **♘xc6** 17 ♘xe7+ ♘xe7 18 ♗xf7+ ♔h8 19 ♖be1 ♘c6 20 ♕d5 ♕a5 21 ♕xa5 ♘xa5 22 ♗e7 1-0 Borassi-Solaroli, corr 1976, but he should have played **16...♗c5+!** 17 ♗e3 bxc6 18 ♖b3 ♗xe3+ 19 ♕xe3 (19 ♖xe3 ♕c5) ♕d6! and White has nothing. Nor do other 15th moves look very promising, for example **15 ♗xe7** ♕xe7 16 ♘d5 ♕c5 17 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 or **15 ♖b3** ♗xg5 16 ♕xg5 ♕c5 17 ♗xf7+ ♔h8. Taking on e5 is logical because Black's main weak spot is f7 and if he can prevent a sacrifice on this square it is hard for White to break through.

15 ♕xg5 h6

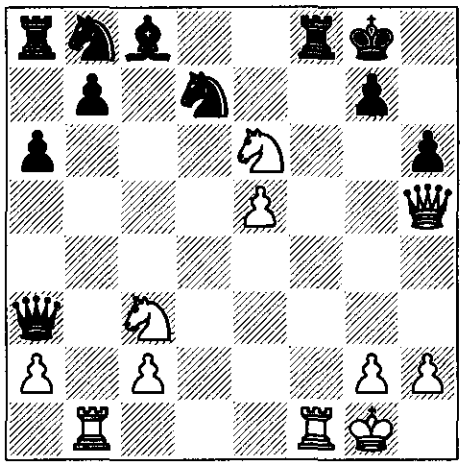
Or 15...♕c5 (15...♕xc3? 16 ♘f5 ♕xe5 17 ♘h6+ ♔h8 18 ♘xf7+ ♖xf7 19 ♕d8+ mates; 15...fxe6? 16 ♘xe6 +–) 16 ♖xf7 ♖xf7 17 ♔h1 ♘f6 (17...♘xe5 18 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 19 ♖f1+ ♔e8 20 ♕xg7 +–) 18 ♗xf7+ ♔h8 19 ♘f5 1-0 Joao-Salete Aguiar, corr 1990.

16 ♕h5! fxe6

16...♘xe5? (16...♕xc3? 17 ♖xf7! ♕xd4+ 18 ♔h1 ♔h8 19 ♖bf1 ♕c5 20 ♕g6 ♖xf7 21 ♕xf7 +–) 17 ♕xe5 wins for White, e.g. 17...♕xc3 18 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 19 ♖xf7 or 17...♗xe6 18

♘xe6 fxe6 19 ♖xb7! ♖xf1+ 20 ♔xf1 ♕c1+ 21 ♔f2 ♕xc2+ 22 ♔e1 ♕c1+ 23 ♘d1.

17 ♘xe6 *(D)*



Now:

1) **17...♕e7** 18 ♘xf8 ♘xf8 19 ♘d5 ♕c5+ 20 ♔h1 ♕xd5 (20...♗e6 21 ♘b6 ♖a7 22 ♕e8 ♘d7 23 ♘xd7 ♗xd7 24 ♕f7+ ♔h7 25 ♕xf8 ♕xe5 26 ♖be1 ♕b5 27 ♖f7 1-0 Kolpakov-Nikitin, USSR 1963) 21 ♖bd1 ♕b5 (21...♕e6 22 ♖xf8+, 21...♕xd1 22 ♕f7+ ♔h7 23 ♖xd1 and 21...♗e6 22 ♖xd5 ♗xd5 23 ♕e8 are all +–) 22 c4! and White wins, e.g. 22...♕d7 23 ♖xd7 ♘bxd7 24 ♕f7+ and 25 e6.

2) **17...♕xc3** 18 ♘xf8 ♕c5+ 19 ♔h1 ♘xf8 (19...♘f6 20 ♖xf6 gxf6 21 ♘h7! and now 21...♕xc2 22 ♘xf6+ ♔g7 23 ♘e8+ ♔g8 24 ♖f1 +– or 21...♔xh7 22 ♕f7+ ♔h8 23 exf6 ♕g5 24 ♕e8+ ♔h7 25 ♕xc8 +–) 20 ♕f7+ ♔h7 21 ♕xf8 ♘d7 (21...♕xf8 22 ♖xf8 ♘d7 23 ♖e8 h5 24 ♖d1 ♘b6 25 e6 +–) 22 ♕f5+ ♔h8 23 ♖bd1 ♕e7 (23...♕xe5 24 ♖xd7) 24 ♖d6! (threatening ♖e6) ♘xe5 25 ♕f8+ ♕xf8 26 ♖xf8+ ♔h7 27 ♖dd8 +–.

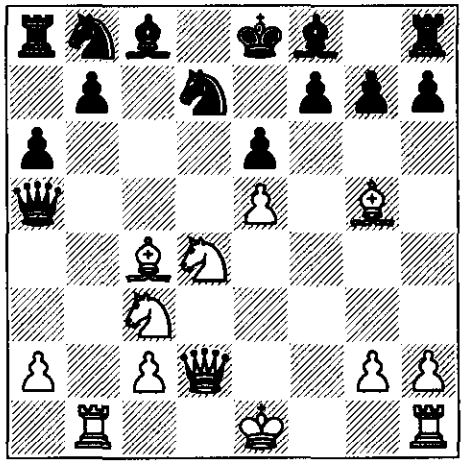
3) **17...♘f6** 18 exf6 ♗xe6 19 fxg7 ♖xf1+ 20 ♖xf1 ♕xc3 21 ♕xh6 ♕xg7 22 ♕xe6+ ♔h8 23 ♕e8+ ♔h7 24 ♖f7 +–.

4) **17...♖xf1+** 18 ♖xf1 ♕e7 19 ♕f5! ♘b6 (19...♘xe5 20 ♕f8+ and 19...♘c6 20 ♘d5 ♕e8 21 ♘dc7 are +–) 20 ♕f8+ ♕xf8 21 ♖xf8+ ♔h7 22 ♘c7 ♖a7 23 e6 is the critical line, but it favours White. Black cannot avoid giving back the piece, when his oddly-placed rook gives White the advantage. Some sample lines: 23...♘c6 (23...♗xe6 24 ♘xe6 ♘c6 25 ♖f7 ♔g6 26 ♖f3 ♖a8 27 ♘f8+ ♔h5 28 ♘e4 with a decisive attack against Black's king) 24 ♘e4 ♔g6 (24...♗xe6 25 ♘xe6 ♘e5 26 ♖e8! ♘g6 27 ♘d6 followed by ♘f5 should win for White) 25 ♘d6 ♗xe6 (25...♘e7 26 ♖f7 ♘c6 27 ♘ce8 is winning for White) 26 ♘xe6 ♖a8 27 ♖f3! ♔h7 (or else White continues ♘f8+) 28 ♖b3 and White wins a pawn while retaining a substantial positional plus.

The conclusion is that 13 ♗xe6 is very promising against 12...♗e7, except for the possible black improvement at move 14.

B22)

12 ... ♕a5 *(D)*



13 0-0

1) **13 ♘xe6?** fxe6 14 ♗xe6 ♕xe5+ 15 ♕e3 (15 ♔d1 ♕xe6 −+) ♕xe3+ 16 ♗xe3 ♘c6 17 ♘d5 ♗d6 18 0-0 ♘f6! 19 ♘xf6+ gxf6 20 ♖xf6 ♔e7 21 ♗xc8 ♔xf6 22 ♗xb7 ♘e5 23 ♗xa8 ♖xa8 −+ Mazzoni-Fischer, Monaco 1967.

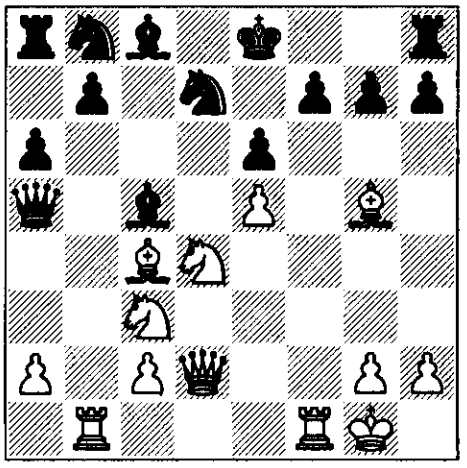
2) **13 ♗xe6** fxe6 (not 13...♕xe5+? 14 ♔d1 nor 13...♗b4? 14 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 15 0-0+ ♔e8 16 ♖xb4 ♕xb4 17 ♘d5! and White wins) 14 ♘xe6 (14 0-0 ♘xe5 and Black defends after 15 ♔h1 ♘bc6 16 ♘xc6 ♘xc6 17 ♕f4 ♕f5 18 ♕c7 ♗d6! 19 ♕xd6 ♕xg5 or 15 ♕e3 ♘bc6 16 ♘xc6 ♘xc6 17 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 18 ♕xe6+ ♗e7) ♘xe5 (14...♕xe5+ transposes to line 4 in the note to Black's 12th move) 15 ♗d8 (after 15 ♘d5 ♕xd2+ 16 ♔xd2 ♔d7 17 ♘ec7 ♖a7 18 ♖he1 ♘c4+ and 19...b5 White's attack dies and he is left a piece down; 15 ♘xf8 ♖xf8 16 ♗e7 fails to 16...♘c4!) ♘f3+! 16 gxf3 ♕e5+ 17 ♔d1 (17 ♔f2 ♗xe6 18 ♖be1 ♗c5+ 19 ♔g2 ♕f5 20 ♖xe6+ ♕xe6 21 ♖e1 ♕xe1 22 ♕xe1+ ♔xd8 is good for Black) ♗xe6 18 ♖e1 (18 ♖xb7 ♕f5 19 ♖f1 ♘d7 wins) ♕f5 19 ♘d5 (19 ♗h4 ♕xf3+ −+) ♗d6 and now:

2a) **20 ♖xb7** (20 ♘f6+ ♔xd8 21 ♕xd6+ ♔c8 −+) ♕xf3+ 21 ♔c1 ♗a3+ 22 ♔b1 0-0 −+ Johansson-Eszik, corr 1980.

2b) **20 ♘b6** when Black has the happy choice between **20...♕xf3+** 21 ♕e2 (21 ♖e2 0-0 22 ♕xd6 ♕f1+ 23 ♔d2 ♕xb1 24 ♕xe6+ ♔h8 25 ♕e8 ♘d7! 26 ♘xd7 ♖axd8 −+) ♕xe2+ 22 ♖xe2 ♔f7 23 ♖f2+ ♔g6 24 ♖g2+ ♔h5 25 ♘xa8 ♖xd8 0-1 Lewin-Engel, corr 1977 and **20...♘c6** 21 ♗h4 0-0 22 ♘xa8 ♕xf3+ 23 ♕e2 ♕d5+ 24 ♕d3 ♕h5+ 25 ♔c1 ♗f4+ −+ Bortkun-Kaak, corr 1994.

13 ... ♘xe5

13...♗c5 *(D)* (13...♗b4? 14 ♘e4! ♗xd2 15 ♘d6+ ♔f8 16 ♖xf7+ ♔g8 17 ♗xe6 +−) is more risky:



1) **14 ♖xf7?** ♘xe5! (Black has a pleasant choice; it is quite unclear how White can justify his sacrifice if Black just captures the rook, e.g. 14...♔xf7 15 ♗xe6+ ♔e8 or 15 ♖f1+ ♔e8 16 ♘d5 ♗xd4+ 17 ♕xd4 exd5) 15 ♖xg7 (15 ♗xe6 ♘bc6 16 ♔h1 ♗xd4 17 ♕xd4 should be met by 17...♗xe6! 18 ♕d6 ♗xf7 19 ♖xb7 ♖d8 20 ♖e7+ ♔f8 21 ♖d7+ ♔g8 −+ and not 17...♘xd4 18 ♖e7+ ♔f8 19 ♖f1+ ♘ef3 20 ♖xf3+ ♘xf3 21 ♖f7+ ♔e8 22 ♖e7+ ♔f8 23 ♖f7+ ½-½ Lilloni-Martinez Acosta, corr 1971) ♘bc6! 16 ♗e3 ♘xd4! 17 ♗xd4 ♘xc4 18 ♕f4 ♖f8! 19 ♕h4 ♗xd4+ 20 ♕xd4 ♕e5! and Black wins, Deidun-Timmermans, corr 1980.

2) **14 ♔h1** ♗xd4 (14...♘xe5 15 ♗b5+ ♗d7 {15...axb5 16 ♘b3} 16 ♗xd7+ ♘bxd7 17 ♘xe6 fxe6 18 ♘d5 ♗b6 19 ♖xb6 1-0 Vittoni-Cillo, corr 1972) 15 ♕xd4 (15 ♘d5 ♕xd2 16 ♘c7+ ♔f8 17 ♗xd2 ♘xe5 −+ Atanasov-Hamarat, corr) ♘c6 16 ♕f4!

♘dxe5? (16...0-0 17 ♘e4 ♕xe5 looks good for Black; perhaps 16...♘cxe5 is also possible) 17 ♘e4 0-0 18 ♘f6+ ♔h8 19 ♕h4 1-0 Prokopowicz-Mochocki, corr Poland 1993.

3) **14 ♗xe6!** fxe6 (14...0-0 15 ♖xf7 ♖xf7 16 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 17 e6+ is clearly better for White) 15 ♔h1 ♗xd4 (15...♘xe5 16 ♘b3!) 16 ♕xd4 and now:

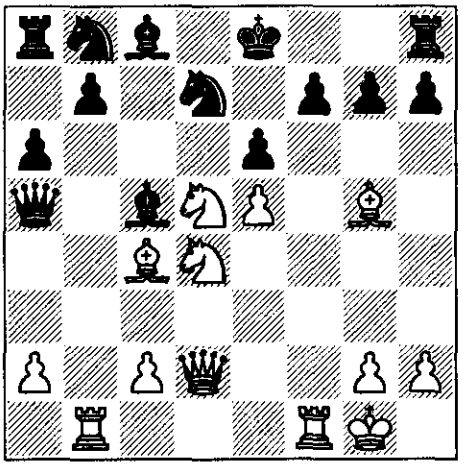
3a) **16...♘c6** 17 ♘e4! ♘dxe5 18 ♕d6! (18...♘f7 19 ♖xb7! 1-0 Gaida-Groiss, corr 1982) ♖b8 19 ♗f6 ♘f7 (19...♕d5 20 ♗xg7 ♕xe4 21 ♗xh8 ♘g6 ±) 20 ♖xb7 ♖xb7 21 ♕xc6+ ♖d7 22 ♕xe6+ ♔f8 23 ♘d6 gxf6 24 ♕xf6 ♗b7 25 ♕xh8+ ♔e7 26 ♕f6+ ♔f8 27 ♘xf7 1-0 Polivalov-Bechalov, corr 1988.

3b) **16...♕xe5** 17 ♖be1! ♕xg5 (17...♘c6 18 ♕d2 +—) 18 ♖xe6+ ♔d8 19 ♖d1! (threat 20 ♕b6#) ♕a5 20 ♕xg7 +– Czada-Weber, corr 1974.

3c) **16...♕c5** 17 ♕d2 (intending ♘e4) ♕c6 18 ♘e4! ♕xe4 19 ♕d6 winning.

4) **14 ♘d5** *(D)* and now:

B



4a) **14...♕xd2?** 15 ♘c7+ ♔f8 16 ♘xe6+ ♔g8 17 ♗xd2 ♘xe5 18 ♘xc5 ♘xc4 19 ♖be1 h6 20 ♗c3 with a distinct plus for White.

4b) **14...♗xd4+** 15 ♕xd4 ♘c6 16 ♕f4 (16 ♕f2 ♘dxe5 17 ♘b6 0-0 18 ♗d2 ♕a3 19 ♖b3 ♕e7 20 ♘xa8 ♘xc4 21 ♘b6 ♘xd2 22 ♕xd2 was unclear in the game Kuntschke-Viskov, corr 1993) ♘dxe5 17 ♖be1 ♕c5+ (17...0-0? 18 ♘f6+) 18 ♔h1 ♕xc4 19 ♘c7+ ♔f8 20 ♘xa8 h6! 21 ♘b6 (21 ♗h4 ♕xf4 22 ♖xf4 ♘g6) hxg5 22 ♘xc4 gxf4 23 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 24 ♖xe5 ♗d7 25 ♖xf4 ♔e7 ± Norton-Freeman, New Zealand Junior Ch 1978.

4c) **14...♘c6!** 15 ♕xa5 ♗xd4+ 16 ♔h1 ♘xa5 17 ♘c7+ ♔f8 18 ♗xe6 ♘xe5 19 ♗xf7 ♘xf7 20 ♖be1 ♗d7 21 ♘xa8 ♘c6 ∓.

14 ♖be1!

The alternatives are less dangerous:

1) **14 ♗xe6?** ♗xe6 15 ♘xe6 fxe6 16 ♖xf8+ ♖xf8 17 ♕d6 ♘f3+! is winning for Black, Nieuwenlink-Stempin, Eeklo 1978.

2) **14 ♘xe6?** ♘xc4! with the idea 15 ♕e2 ♗xe6 16 ♖xf7 ♕e5 –+.

3) **14 ♕f4** ♗c5! (14...♗d6? 15 ♘e4!) 15 ♕xe5 ♘c6! (15...♗xd4+ 16 ♕xd4 ♕xg5 17 ♘e4 and White wins) and Black wins since 16 ♗b5 is refuted by 16...♕xc3, Winkler-Olthof, corr 1984.

14 ... ♘xc4

Or **14...♘bc6** (not 14...♗b4? 15 ♖xe5 ♕xe5 16 ♘xe6 ♘c6 17 ♘xg7+ ♕xg7 18 ♗f6 ±, Merfogel-Masaross, corr 1977) **15 ♘xc6 ♘xc6 16 ♕f4** (16 ♔h1 ♗b4 17 ♖f3 0-0 18 ♗f6 ♗e7 19 ♗xg7 ♔xg7 20 ♖g3+ ♔h8 21 ♕h6 ♖g8 22 ♖xg8+ ♔xg8 23 ♖e3 ♘e5 24 ♖h3, Maciejewski-Masternak, Poland Cht 1991, and now 24...♗d6! is good for Black) **♗c5+ 17 ♔h1 0-0** and now:

1) **18 ♘e4** ♗e7 19 ♖e3 (19 ♗d3 f5 20 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 21 ♘g5 ♘g6 22 ♕d6 ♕d5 23 ♕c7 f4 ∓ Klemp-Montag, corr 1987; 19 ♕g3 ♗xg5 20 ♘xg5 h6 21 ♘e4 ♘e7 22 ♘d6 ♕c5 23 ♕f4 ♘g6 ∓ Sokoler-Hoffer, corr 1991) ♕d8 20 ♖g3 f5 21 ♘c5 ♕d6 (21...♗xg5! 22 ♖xg5 ♘d4 23 ♖d1 ♕e7! ∓) 22 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 23 ♕xd6 ♗xd6 24 ♗xe6+ ♔h8 25 ♖d3 ♗e5 26 ♖d7 ½-½ Andani Lorente-Garcia Beltran, corr 1982.

2) **18 ♕g3** (much more dangerous) ♗d4 19 ♘e4 ♗e5? 20 ♘f6+ ♗xf6 21 ♗xf6 g6 22 ♕f4 g5 23 ♕e4 ♕b4 24 ♕g4 h6 25 ♕h5 1-0 Gaida-Grigoriew, corr 1992.

15 ♕f4 ♘d6

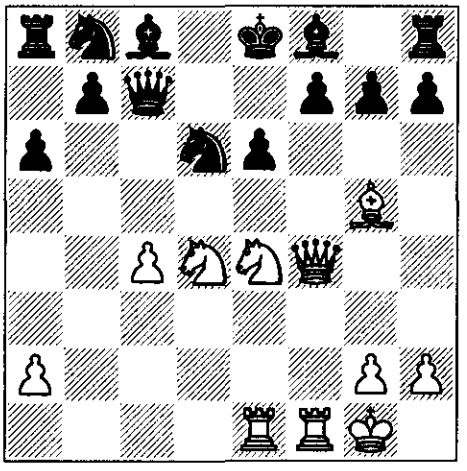
16 ♘e4

16 ♖e3 h6 17 ♗h4 ♘c6 18 ♘e4 ♘e5! 19 ♗e1 ♕d5 20 ♘c3 g5! 21 ♘xd5 gxf4 22 ♖xe5 ♗g7 and Black is winning, Manduch-Shephard, corr 1989.

16 ... ♕c7

17 c4! *(D)*

17 ♘f5? ♕b6+! 18 ♔h1 ♘xf5 19 ♕xf5 exf5 20 ♘f6+ ♔d8 21 ♘d5+ and now Black wins after either 21...♕f6 or 21...f6.



B

17 ... h6

17...♘b5!? 18 cxb5 ♕xf4 19 ♗xf4 is a crucial variation. Black is two pawns up in an ending but White has an immense lead in development. Hellers evaluated it as ∓.

After 17...h6 White cannot reply 18 ♗h4 because then 18...♘b5 is strong.

18 ♘f5! ♘b5

The safest line is 18...hxg5 19 ♘fxd6+ ♗xd6 (19...♔d7 20 ♕d2 ♔c6 21 ♖xf7 looks awful for Black) 20 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 (not 20...♔d7 21 ♕e5!) 21 ♕xf7+ ♕xf7 22 ♘xf7 ♖h4! 23 ♘d6+ (23 g3 ♖d4 24 ♘d6+ ♔g8 25 ♘xc8 ♘c6 is very good for Black as the knight has to retreat to the bad square b6) ♖f4! 24 ♘xc8 ♘c6 25 g3 (25 ♘d6 ♔e7) ♖xf1+ 26 ♖xf1+ and Black is slightly better, although a draw is very likely.

19 ♕xc7 ♘xc7

20 ♘fd6+ ♔d7? (now Black runs into trouble; he should have played 20...♗xd6 21 ♘xd6+ ♔d7 22 ♘xf7 hxg5! 23 ♘xh8 ♔c6 ∓) 21 ♘xf7 hxg5 22 ♘xh8 ♔e8 23 ♖f7 ♘d7 24 ♖ef1 e5 25 ♘xg5 ♗e7 26 ♖xg7 ♘f8, Hellers-Oll, Groningen 1984/5, and now 27 ♖xe7+! ♔xe7 28 ♖f7+ ♔d6 29 ♖xf8 ♗e6 30 ♘hf7+ ♗xf7 31 ♘xf7+ ♔e6 32 ♖xa8 ♘xa8 33 ♘d8+ would have given White excellent winning chances.

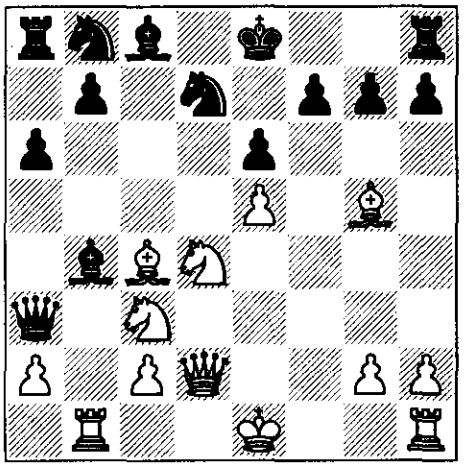
B23)

12 ... ♗b4 *(D)*

Now:

B231: 13 ♘xe6
B232: 13 ♖b3

The creative 13 ♗xe6 occurred in the game Opl-Stohl, Austria Cht



1991. The idea is probably 13...♗xc3 14 0-0, but after 14...♗xd4+ 15 ♕xd4 fxe6 Black seems to win.

B231)

13 ♘xe6 fxe6

13...♗xc3? 14 ♘c7+ ♔f8 15 0-0 ♕c5+ 16 ♕e3! ♕xc4 (16...♕xe3+ 17 ♗xe3 ♘xe5 18 ♗d5 ±) 17 e6 ♕xc7 18 exd7 ♕xd7 19 ♖bd1 ♗f6 (19...♗b4 20 ♕f4 ♗c5+ 21 ♔h1 f5 22 ♖xd7 ♗xd7 23 ♕c7 +–) 20 ♗xf6 gxf6 21 ♕h6+ ♔e8 22 ♖fe1+ 1-0 Winterhalter-Brinkmann, corr 1980.

14 ♖xb4 ♕xb4

15 ♗xe6

Despite Black's extra rook he has a surprising number of defensive problems, but with accurate play he can refute White's attack.

15 ... h6!

This is the key move. Alternatives give White unnecessary chances, for example:

1) **15...♖f8** 16 ♘d5 ♕xd2+ 17 ♔xd2 ♖f2+ 18 ♔c1 ♘f6 (18...♘b6 19 ♘c7+ ♔f8 20 ♗e3! +–) 19 ♘c7+ ♔d8 20 ♘xa8 ♗xe6 21 exf6 gxf6 22 ♗h4, with a likely draw.

2) **15...♘c6** 16 0-0 ♖f8 (16...♘f6 17 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 18 exf6 0-0 19 ♕d5+ ♔h8 20 fxg7+ ♔xg7 21 ♕d7+ ♔g8 22 ♕e6+ wins for White) 17 ♖d1 ♕d4+ 18 ♕xd4 ♘xd4 19 ♖xd4 h6 20 ♗h4 and White has fair compensation for the exchange. It is possible that Black can gain the edge (see *The Najdorf for the Tournament Player* for details) but this analysis is redundant in view of the strength of 15...h6!.

16 ♗f7+

16 0-0? ♕b6+.

16 ... ♔xf7

17 ♕d5+

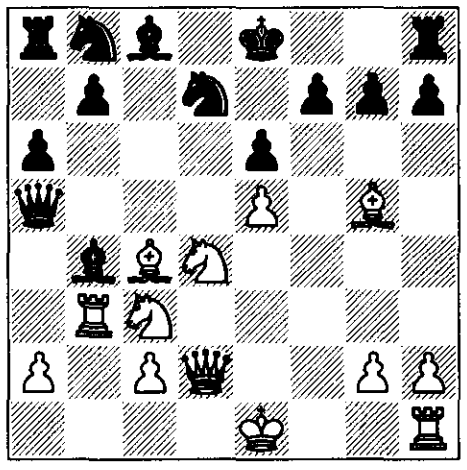
Or 17 e6+ ♔g8 18 e7 (18 exd7 ♗xd7 19 0-0 ♕b6+ 20 ♗e3 ♕g6 21 ♘d5 ♘c6! 22 ♘b6 ♖d8 23 ♘xd7 ♕e6 –+ Lizan-Dobsa, corr 1993) ♔h7! 19 ♕d3+ g6 20 0-0 hxg5 21 ♖f7+ ♔h6 –+.

17 ... ♔g6

After 18 ♕d3+ ♔h5! (Geller only gave 18...♔xg5? 19 h4+ ♔h5 20 ♕f5+ mating and 18...♔f7 19 e6+ ♔g8 20 e7 ♔f7 21 0-0+ ♘f6 22 ♗xf6 +–) it is impossible to see how White can justify his sacrifices, for example 19 ♗e7!? is answered by 19...♘xe5 20 ♕e2+ ♕g4 21 ♕xe5+ ♔g6 –+.

B232)

13 ♖b3 ♕a5 *(D)*



14 0-0

Other moves:

1) **14 ♗xe6?!** 0-0 15 ♗xf7+ ♖xf7 16 e6 ♖f8 17 ♖xb4 ♕xb4 18 e7 ♖e8 19 ♘f5 ♘f6 20 ♗xf6 ♗xf5 21 ♕d5+ ♔h8 22 ♕f7 ♖xe7+ 23 ♕xe7 ♕xe7+ 24 ♗xe7 ♘c6 ∓ Kurajica-Tukmakov, Vrnjačka Banja 1989.

2) **14 ♘xe6!?** fxe6 15 bxe6 ♕xe5+ 16 ♔d1 ♕xe6 17 ♖e1 ♘e5 18 ♕d8+ ♔f7 19 ♖f1+ ♔g6 20 ♕xh8 was played in Blanck-Gerold, corr 1984. At first sight Black should win easily, but there are unexpected problems, e.g. 20...♗xc3 21 ♖xc3 ♘bc6 22 ♖g3 ♘g4 23 ♗d2, 20...♘bc6 21 ♘e2, or 20...♘f7 21 ♕g8 ♘c6 22 ♗f6 ♕d7+ 23 ♔c1 ♘h6 24 ♕h8, in all cases with an unclear position. The game continued 20...♕g4+ 21 ♔e1 ♕g4+ 22 ♔d1 ♕d4+ (turning down the draw) 23 ♔c1 ♗f5 24 ♗d2 ♘f7 25 ♕e8 ±. This is an interesting idea, but Black has at least a draw so its theoretical importance is fairly limited.

3) **14 a3** and now:

3a) **14...♕xe5+** 15 ♔d1 looks too dangerous.

3b) **14...♗f8** 15 ♘xe6 fxe6 16 ♗xc6 ♘c6 17 ♘d5 with a very strong attack.

3c) **14...♗xa3** (probably best) 15 ♖xa3 (15 0-0 ♗c5 16 ♔h1 ♗xd4 17 ♕xd4 ♘c6 and White will be three pawns down) ♕xa3 16 0-0 0-0 (on other moves White will generally play ♘e4) 17 ♗f6 (Black threatened ...♘xe5) ♘xf6 (17...gxf6 18 exf6 is very dangerous for Black) 18 exf6 ♖d8 and Black threatens ...♕c5, while after 19 ♕g5 g6 or 19 ♘e4 g6 it is hard to see how White can successfully continue his attack.

3d) **14...♗c5** 15 ♘xe6 (15 ♗xe6 0-0 16 ♗xf7+ ♖xf7 17 e6 ♖f8 18 exd7 ♗xd7 ∓) fxe6 16 ♗xe6 h6 (17 ♖xb7 was a threat) 17 ♗f7+ (17 ♖f1 hxg5 18 ♗f7+ ♔d8 19 e6 ♗e7 20 exd7 ♘xd7 −+ Bartes-Potss, corr 1968) ♔xf7 (17...♔f8 18 ♖f1 hxg5 19 ♗g6+ ♘f6 20 ♕d5 ♗f2+ 21 ♖xf2 ♕xd5 22 ♘xd5 ♗e6 23 c4 ± Giuliano-Pasqua, corr 1973) 18 ♕d5+ ♔g6 19 ♕e4+ ♔f7 20 ♕d5+ ½-½ Martinov-Murei, USSR 1968.

3e) **14...♗xc3** 15 ♖xc3 0-0 16 ♗e7 ♖e8 17 ♗b4 ♕xe5+ 18 ♖e3 ∞.

It can be seen that although 14 a3 is less explored than 14 0-0, it does not solve White's problems.

14 ... 0-0

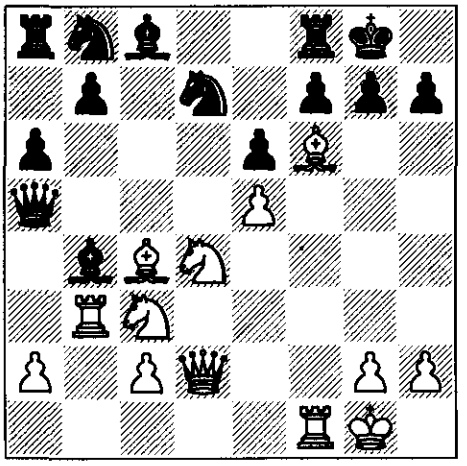
The alternative **14...♘xe5** is inferior, but White must play precisely: 15 ♖xb4! (15 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 16 ♗xe6 0-0 ∓) ♕xb4 16 ♘xe6 ♕b6+ (not 16...♘bc6? 17 ♘xg7+! ♔f8 18 ♗h6 ♕c5+ 19 ♔h1 ♘c4 20 ♕f4 +−) 17 ♗e3 ♘xc4 (17...♕a5? 18 ♘xg7+ ♔f8 19 ♕d6+ +− Gatto-Strick, corr 1980) 18 ♘xg7+ ♔f8 19 ♖xf7+ ♔g8 (positions such as 19...♔xf7 20 ♕d5+ ♗e6 21 ♕h5+ ♔xg7 22 ♗xb6 ♘xb6 23 ♕e5+ ♔f7 24 ♕xh8 favour White; 24...♗f5 is strongly met by 25 ♕e5, while otherwise White takes on h7 and acquires two connected passed pawns) 20 ♖f8+ ♔xg7 21 ♗d4+ ♔xf8 22 ♕f4+ ♔g8 23 ♗xb6 ♘xb6 24 ♘e4 ♘8d7 25 ♘d6 ♔g7 26 ♕f7+ ♔h6 27 h4 1-0 Pasqua-Scalisi, corr.

Nobody has tried **14...♗c5**, when 15 ♔h1 ♗xd4 16 ♕xd4 ♘c6 17 ♕f4 ♘cxe5 18 ♘e4 0-0 19 ♖h3! gives White a powerful attack, for example 19...♘xc4? 20 ♕h4 h6 21 ♗xh6 ♕d8 22 ♘g5! +−.

15 ♗f6 *(D)*

15 ♘xe6 fxe6 16 ♗xe6+ ♔h8 17 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 18 ♕f4 ♘c6 19 ♕f7 ♕c5+ 20 ♔h1 ♘f6! 21 ♗xc8 ♘xe5 22 ♕e6 ♘eg4 0-1 Tringov-Fischer, Havana 1965.

B



15 ... ♘xf6

Other moves seem catastrophic, with the possible exception of line 4:

1) **15...gxf6** 16 ♕h6! ♕xe5 (there is no defence, for example 16...♗xc3 17 ♗d3 f5 18 ♘xf5 +– or 16...♕c5 17 ♘cb5! ♘xe5 18 ♖g3+ ♘g6 19 ♖h3 ♖e8 20 ♖xf6! +–) 17 ♘f5! exf5 18 ♘e4! ♗d2 (18...♖e8 19 ♖h3 ♘f8 20 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 21 ♕xf6 ♗e6 22 ♗xe6 fxe6, Mazzoni-Bobotsov, Le Havre 1966, and now 23 ♖g3+ ♘g6 24 ♖xg6+ hxg6 25 ♕xg6+ ♔f8 26 ♕f6+ ♔g8 27 ♖f3 would have led to mate) 19 ♘xd2 ♕d4+ 20 ♔h1 ♘e5 21 ♖g3+ ♘g4 22 h3 ♕e5 23 ♖f4 ♕e1+ 24 ♘f1 ♕xg3 25 ♖xg4+ ♕xg4 26 hxg4 regaining all the material and retaining a decisive attack, R.Byrne-Evans, US Ch 1965.

2) **15...♘xe5?** 16 ♖xb4 ♕xb4 17 ♗xe5 ♕xc4 18 ♗xg7 and White is winning.

3) **15...♘c6** 16 ♘xc6 bxc6 17 ♖xb4 ♕xb4 ½-½ Radulov-Bobekov, Bulgaria 1968, but 16 ♘f5! (not 16 ♕g5?? ♘xf6) looks strong to me, for example 16...♕c5+ 17 ♖f2! gxf6 (17...exf5 18 ♕g5) 18 ♕h6 exf5 19 exf6 +–.

4) **15...♗c5!?** is untested.

16 exf6 ♖d8
17 ♖xb4

Slower ideas fail, e.g. 17 ♖f4 g6 18 ♔h1 ♗f8, 17 ♔h1 ♘c6 18 ♘xc6 ♖xd2 19 ♘xa5 ♗xa5 ∓ or 17 fxg7 ♗c5.

17 ... ♕xb4
18 ♕g5 g6
19 ♖f4

19 ♘e4 (19 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 20 ♗xe6 ♕xc3 21 ♕h6 ♕c5+ and ...♕f8 –+) **♕f8** (19...♖xd4? 20 c3) **20 ♘f3** (20 c3 ♘c6 21 ♘xc6 bxc6 22 h4 ♖d5! 23 ♗xd5 exd5 24 ♘g3 h6 25 ♕e3 ♗e6 26 h5 g5 ∓ Ortega-Bobotsov, Sochi 1966) and now:

1) **20...♘c6** 21 ♕h4 h5 (21...♘d4 22 ♘e5 ♘f5 23 ♖xf5 gxf5 24 ♕g3+ ♔h8 25 ♘g5 ♖d1+ 26 ♔f2 ♖d2+ 27 ♗e2 ♖d7 28 ♕h4 h6 29 ♘gxf7+ ♖xf7 30 ♘g6+ ♔h7 31 ♘xf8+ ♖xf8 32 ♗h5 1-0 Randolfi-Verwoert, corr 1991) 22 ♕g5 ♔h7 23 ♕h4 ♕h6 24 ♘eg5+ ♔g8 25 ♕f4 ♕f8 26 ♘xf7 ♕xf7 27 ♘g5 ♕f8 28 ♕c7 ♕h6 29 ♕f7+ ♔h8 30 ♕c7 ♔g8 ½-½ Heikkinen-Tanninen, corr 1979.

2) **20...b5! 21 ♗b3 ♗b7 22 ♗xe6** ♗xe4 23 ♗xf7+ ♕xf7 24 ♘e5 ♕a7+ 25 ♔h1 ♕f2! 26 f7+ ♔g7 27 f8♕+ ♕xf8 28 ♘f7 ♘d7 29 ♕h6+ ♔g8 30 ♕e3 ♘f6 0-1 Svager-Prieditis, corr 1968. Various improvements have been proposed for White, but none appears to justify White's play fully. For example, Geller gave **22 ♕h4**, but 22...♗xe4 23 ♘g5 ♕c5+ 24 ♔h1 ♗xg2+ 25 ♔xg2 ♖d2+

26 ♔h3 h5 27 ♗xe6 ♖a7 is −+, while *The Najdorf for the Tournament Player's* **21 ♕g4** bxc4 22 ♘eg5 is met by 22...♕c5+ 23 ♔h1 h5 24 ♕h4 ♖d5!.

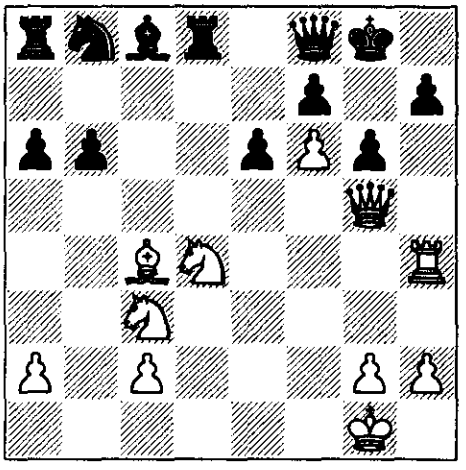
19 ... b6

There are two other reasonable moves:

1) **19...♖xd4** 20 ♕h6 (20 ♖xd4 ♕b6 21 ♘e2 ♘d7 22 h4 e5 23 h5 ♕xf6 24 ♕xf6 ♘xf6 25 ♖d8+ ♔g7 26 h6+ ♔xh6 27 ♖f8 b5 −+ Greiner-Ziewitz, corr 1971) ♖d1+ 21 ♘xd1 ♕f8 22 ♕g5 (22 ♕xf8+ ♔xf8 23 ♖d4 ♘d7 24 ♖f4 b5 25 ♗e2 e5 26 ♖f1 ♖b8 −+ Roose-Geradon, corr 1992) ♘d7 23 ♖d4 h6 and Black is better according to Boleslavsky.

2) **19...♕f8** 20 ♖h4 b5 21 ♗d3 (21 ♗b3 b4 22 ♘a4 h6 23 ♖xh6 ♖xd4 24 ♖xg6+ ½-½ Harding-Blackstock, Hastings II 1966/7; not, however, 21 ♘f3? ♘d7 threatening 22...♕c5+) b4 22 ♗xg6 hxg6 23 ♖h6 ♖xd4 24 ♖xg6+ ½-½ Hartston-Mecking, Hastings 1966/7. However, instead of provoking the drawing sacrifice on g6, Black could have played ...♖a7 at some stage, leaving White struggling to gain compensation.

20 ♖h4 ♕f8 *(D)*



and now:

1) **21 ♘ce2** ♗b7? (21...♖a7! is better) 22 ♘xe6 ♖d1+ 23 ♔f2 fxe6 24 ♗xe6+ ♔h8 25 ♕xg6 ♕c5+ 26 ♘d4! 1-0 Szekely-Toth, Budapest 1967.

2) **21 ♔f1** ♖d6 (21...♖a7? 22 ♘f3 ♘d7 23 ♘e4 ♗b7 24 ♖xh7! with a dangerous attack, Mazzoni-Lee, Havana OL 1966) 22 ♘f3 ♘d7 23 ♘e4 ♗b7! and according to O'Kelly both 24 ♘xd6 ♕xd6 and 24 ♖xh7 ♔xh7 25 ♕h4+ ♔g8 26 ♘fg5 ♘xf6 27 ♘xf6+ ♔g7 are good for Black.

3) **21 ♕e3** ♗b7 (not 21...♖a7? 22 ♘e4 ♖ad7? 23 ♖xh7 1-0 Tringov-Palmasson, Havana OL 1966) and now:

3a) **22 ♗xe6** ♘c6 doesn't work.

3b) **22 ♘e4** ♗xe4 takes most of the sting out of White's attack.

3c) **22 ♘xe6** fxe6 23 ♗xe6+ ♔h8 24 ♕h3 ♕c5+ 25 ♔h1 h5 26 ♕g3 ♖d2 27 ♗h3 ♖f2 28 ♖f4 ♖xf4 29 ♕xf4 ♕f8 30 f7 ♘c6 31 ♘e4 ♖d8 32 ♔g1 ♕g7 33 ♘d6 g5 0-1 Greiner-May, corr 1972.

3d) **22 ♕h3** ♕c5 23 ♘e2 ♖xd4 24 ♘xd4 (24 ♖xd4 ♘d7 25 ♗xe6 ♘xf6 and Black is a pawn up with the better position) ♘d7 25 ♗xe6 ♘xf6 26 ♖f4 ♖f8 ∓.

The conclusion is that the position after 12...♗b4 is at least equal for Black, with the proviso that he must play very accurately. This line has been analysed and tested so extensively it seems unlikely that a major improvement will be found for White.

6 Poisoned Pawn: 9 ♖b1 ♕a3 10 f5 ♘c6 11 fxe6 fxe6 12 ♘xc6 bxc6 13 e5 dxe5

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♕b6 8 ♕d2 ♕xb2 9 ♖b1 ♕a3 10 f5 ♘c6 11 fxe6 fxe6 12 ♘xc6 bxc6 13 e5 dxe5 14 ♗xf6 gxf6

15 ♘e4 *(D)*

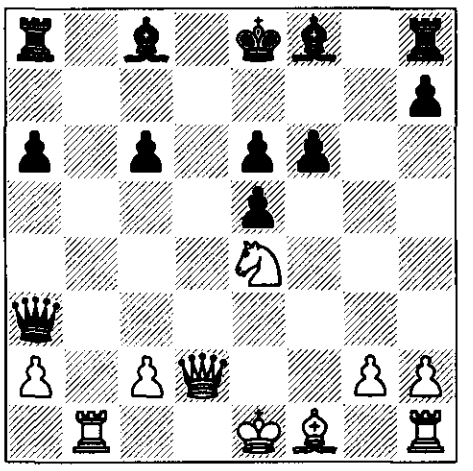
Not **15 ♗e2?** (the whole point of White's play is to prevent Black's queen returning to the centre and this is much more important than forcing Black's king to move) **♕d6** and now:

1) **16 ♕e3**, Hübner-Portisch, Rio de Janeiro IZ 1979, and now 16...♕c5! 17 ♗h5+ (17 ♕g3 f5 18 ♗h5+ ♔d8 ∓) ♔d8 18 ♕d3+ ♔c7 19 ♘e4 ♕d4 20 ♕xd4 exd4 21 ♘xf6 ♗e7 ∓ is best.

2) **16 ♗h5+** ♔e7 17 ♕c1 (a new attempt to revive this system; the older 17 ♕e2 ♕d4 is good for Black after 18 ♘e4 ♗h6 19 ♖b3 ♕a1+ 20 ♔f2 ♕d4+ 21 ♔e1 f5 0-1 A.Martin-Nunn, London 1979, or 18 ♘d1 ♗h6 19 c3 ♕c5 20 ♕e4 ♖a7 21 ♗f3 ♖d7 22 ♖b2 ♗g5 23 ♖e2 a5 24 ♕xc6 ♕xc6 25 ♗xc6 ♖d6 0-1 Grünfeld-Quinteros, Lone Pine 1979) ♖b8 (17...♗d7 18 ♔e2 is less clear) 18 ♖xb8 ♕xb8 19 0-0 ♕b4 20 ♘e4, Boiky-Shashin, USSR 1990, and now Boiky gave the line '20...♕xe4 21 ♕a3+ ♔d7 22 ♖d1+ ♔c7? 23 ♕a5+ ♔b8 24 ♖b1+ ♔a8 25 ♕c7 +–'. However, after 25...♗b4 it is Black and not White who wins, for example 26 a3 ♖g8 or 26 ♗f3 ♕d4+ 27 ♔h1 e4 28 c3 ♕d3 29 ♗xe4 ♗b7.

After 15 ♘e4 Black has a major choice. The first variation is dubious; the second is greedy but is apparently sufficient for a draw; the third is the traditional main line:

B



A: 15...♕e7
B: 15...♕xa2
C: 15...♗e7

The alternatives are not recommended:

1) **15...f5?** 16 ♗e2 fxe4 17 ♗h5+ ♔e7 18 0-0 ♕d6 19 ♖f7+ ♔d8 20 ♖xf8+ wins.

2) **15...♕a4** 16 ♘xf6+ ♔e7 17 ♗d3 ♕h4+ (17...♔xf6 18 0-0+ ♔e7 19 ♕g5+ ♔e8 20 ♗xh7 +–) 18 g3 ♕h6 (18...♗h6 19 ♕a5 ♕xf6 20 ♖f1

♗f4 21 ♕c7+ ♕e7 22 ♕xe5 +–) 19 ♕xh6 ♗xh6 20 ♖f1 ♔e7 21 ♖b6 gives White the better ending.

A)

15	**...**	**♕e7**
16	**♗e2**	**h5**

This idea has recently been played several times in correspondence chess, but it seems to be unsound.

17 ♕d1!

The critical move. Alternatives:

1) **17 ♘xf6+?** ♕xf6 18 ♖f1 ♕h4+ 19 g3 ♕d4 –+.

2) **17 0-0** f5 18 ♕c3 (18 ♕d1 ♕d8! 19 ♗xh5+ ♔e7 20 ♘f2 ♕xd1 21 ♗xd1 e4 –+; 18 ♘g3 ♕c5+ 19 ♔h1 ♗h6 20 ♗xh5+ ♔e7 ∓ Minazzi-Roselli, corr 1985) ♗d7 19 ♕xe5 ♗g7 20 ♘d6+ ♔f8 21 ♕c5 ♖h6? (21...♔g8 22 ♖b7 ♗f8 23 ♖d1 ♖h7 24 ♗c4 ♕f6 ∞) 22 ♖b7 ♖d8 23 ♖d1 e5 24 ♕b6 ± c5 25 ♕c7 ♕g5 26 ♘xf5 ♖c6 27 ♕xd8+ ♕xd8 28 ♖dxd7 1-0 Haag-Raudenbusch, corr 1985.

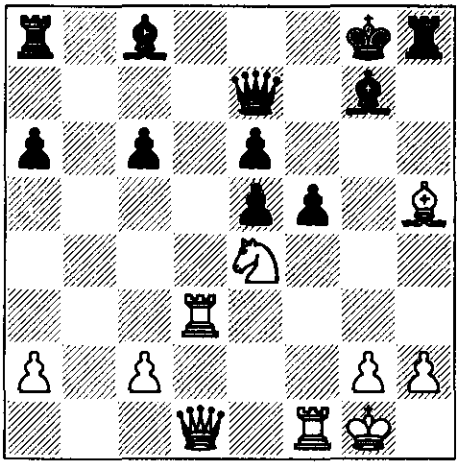
3) **17 ♕c3** ♗d7 (17...♔f7 18 ♕xc6 ♕a7 19 ♖f1 f5 20 ♖xf5+ 1-0 Molarius-Nagel, corr 1993) 18 ♖b7 f5 19 ♕xe5 (19 ♘g3 ♕c5! 20 ♗xh5+ ♔d8 with good chances for Black) ♗g7 20 ♘d6+ ♔f8 and now the natural continuation 21 ♕c5 ♔g8 22 0-0 transposes to the bracket after Black's 21st move in line 2.

4) **17 ♖d1** f5 18 ♘g3 h4 19 ♗h5+ ♖xh5 20 ♘xh5 ♔f7 21 h3 ♔g6 22 g4 ♕b4 23 ♕xb4 ♗xb4+ 24 ♔f2 ♗c5+ 25 ♔g2 ♗d4 ∓ Rusafov-Mladenov, corr 1992.

17	**...**	**♗g7**
18	**♗xh5+**	**♔f8**
19	**0-0**	**f5**
20	**♖b3**	**♔g8**
21	**♖d3** *(D)*	

More dangerous than 21 ♘g3 ♖a7 22 ♖b8 ♔h7 23 ♗g6+!? ♔xg6 24 ♖xc8! ♖d7! (24...♖xc8? 25 ♕h5+ ♔f6 26 ♘e4#) 25 ♕e2 ♕c5+ 26 ♔h1 ♖h4 ∓ Giazzi-Nagel, corr 1988.

B



21	**...**	**a5**

The alternative is 21...♖a7 (not 21...fxe4? 22 ♗f7+ ♕xf7 23 ♖d8+! ♕f8 24 ♖dxf8+ ♗xf8 25 ♕d8 +–) 22 ♖d8+ (22 ♘d6 is possible because 22...e4 23 ♘xe4 ♕h4 24 ♖h3 ♕xe4 25 ♕d8+ ♗f8 26 ♖g3+ wins for White; however, after 24...♕e7! White may not have any more than a draw) ♔h7, Ralbjerg-Nagel, corr 1991, and now 23 ♗e8!! ♕h4 24 g3! ♕h6 25 ♖xc8 fxe4 26 ♕g4 is winning for White.

22 ♖d8+!

22 ♗g6 ♗a6 23 ♖d7 ♕h4 24 ♖f3 ♖h6 is unclear.

22	**...**	**♔h7**
23	**♗f7**	**♕h4**
24	**♖d3**	**♗h6**

and now:

1) **25 ♘d6** ♖f8 26 ♕e2!? ♗a6 27 ♕xe5 ♗xd3 28 cxd3 ♖ad8! 29 ♗xe6 ♗g7! 30 ♗xf5+ ♔h8 (Black is distinctly better) 31 ♖f4? ♕xh2+! 32 ♔xh2 ♗xe5 0-1 Van Houten-Nagel, corr 1988.

2) **25 ♖g3** ♖d8 26 ♗g6+ ♔h8 (26...♔g7 27 ♕a1 ♗f4 28 ♗xf5+ ♗xg3 29 hxg3 +–) 27 ♘d6 ♖a7 28 ♕a1, Grozescu-Popescu, corr 1991, and now 28...♕d4+ 29 ♕xd4 exd4 30 ♘f7+ ♖xf7 31 ♗xf7 ♖f8 gives Black good compensation.

3) **25 ♖h3!** (this is the refutation of 15...♕e7) ♕xe4 26 ♕h5 ♔g7 27 ♕g6+ ♔f8 28 ♗xe6! ♗xe6 (28...♔e7 29 ♕f7+ ♔d6 30 ♖d1+ ♔c5 31 ♕e7+) 29 ♕f6+ ♔e8 30 ♕xe6+ 1-0 Boto-Mijatović, Yugoslavia 1991.

B)

15 ... ♕xa2

No refutation of this move is known. The main line appears to lead to a more or less forced draw, but there are some interesting deviations.

16 ♖d1

16 ♘xf6+ ♔f7 17 ♖d1 (17 ♖b3 ♕a1+ 18 ♔e2 ♕d4 19 ♕g5, Matulović-Nunn, Helsinki 1981, 19...e4! 20 ♘g4 ♗g7 ∓) ♕b2! (not 17...♔xf6? 18 ♗d3, nor 17...a5?! 18 ♗b5! followed by 19 0-0, with a very dangerous attack in both cases) 18 ♘e4 ♗b4 19 c3 ♕xd2+ 20 ♖xd2 ♗e7, Hjartarson-Van der Heijden, Groningen 1979/80, and White does not have enough compensation for the two pawns.

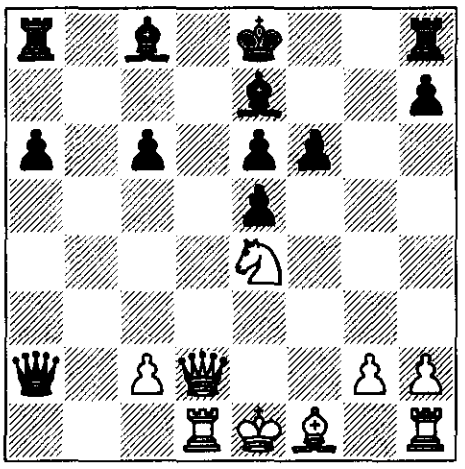
16 ... ♗e7 *(D)*

16...♔f7 is best met by 17 ♗d3 since 17 ♗e2 ♕d5 18 ♗h5+ ♔g7 19 ♕e3 ♕a5+ 20 c3 ♗e7 favoured Black in Rodriguez-Guimerans, corr 1989.

17 ♗e2

Or:

1) **17 ♗d3** f5 18 0-0 and now Black can try:



1a) **18...0-0** 19 ♕h6 ♖f7 20 ♖f3 ♔h8 (20...♕a5 21 ♗c4! ♖a7 22 ♘g5! is dangerous, but 20...♗d7 21 ♗f1 ♖d8 22 ♖g3+ ♔h8 23 ♕h5 ♗e8 24 ♘d6 ♖xd6 25 ♖xd6 e4 26 ♖xc6 ♕a1 was ∓ in Ernst-Fedder, Copenhagen 1982) 21 ♖h3 (21 ♕h5 ♖a7 22 ♔h1 ♗f8 23 ♘g5 ♖fe7 24 ♘xh7 ♖xh7 25 ♕e8 ♖hf7 26 ♖h3+ ♔g8 ∓ Bij-Feukkink, corr 1993) ♗d7 22 ♔h1 ♖g8 23 ♘c3 ♕a5 24 ♗xf5 exf5 25 ♖xd7 ♕c5 ∓, Velimirović-Polajzer, Maribor 1980.

1b) **18...♖a7** 19 ♕h6 ♖d7 (once the rook arrives on d7 Black threatens to tuck his king away by ...♔d8 and ...♔c7) 20 ♘f6+ ♗xf6 21 ♕xf6 ♖f8 22 ♕xe5 ♕d5 23 ♕b8 ♔f7 ∓ Bouaziz-Nunn, Hamburg 1982.

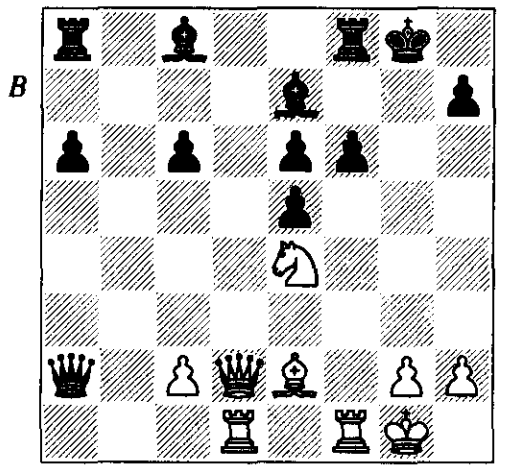
2) **17 ♘d6+** ♗xd6 18 ♕xd6 ♕a5+ 19 c3 (19 ♖d2 ♖a7 20 ♔f2 ♕b6+ 21 ♔f3 ♔f7 22 ♗c4 ♖e8 23 ♕d3 ♔f8 ∓ Sandklef-Butze, corr 1982) ♖a7 20 ♗e2 h5 (other moves are also good) 21 ♕xc6+ ♗d7 22 ♕f3 f5 23 0-0 ♕c5+ 24 ♔h1 h4 ∓ Sonntag-Koskinen, corr 1985.

17 ... 0-0

18 0-0 *(D)*

18 ... f5

Black has an interesting alternative in **18...♖a7!?** and now:



1) **19 ♘xf6+** ♗xf6 20 ♖xf6 ♖xf6 21 ♕g5+ ♖g6 22 ♖d8+ ♔f7 is simply incorrect.

2) **19 ♕h6** ♕xc2 20 ♗d3 ♕b3 (the attack on the d1-rook prevents White bringing his reserves up) 21 ♔h1 f5 22 ♕e3 ♖d7 23 ♖d2 ♗b4 0-1 Morris-Paulsen, Copenhagen 1980.

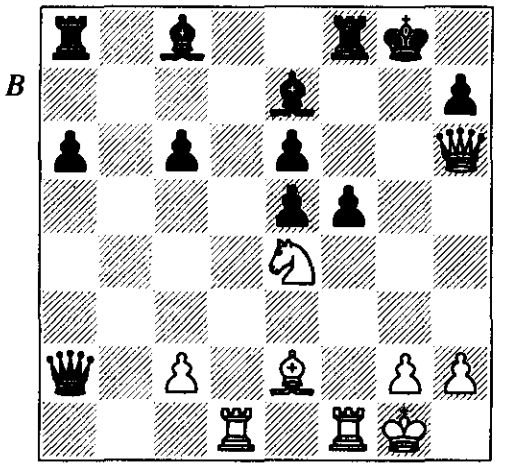
3) **19 ♖f3** (the critical move) and now:

3a) **19...♖f7** 20 ♕h6 (20 ♕d8+ ♗xd8 21 ♖xd8+ ♔g7! 22 ♖g3+ ♔h6 23 ♖h3+ ♔g6 24 ♖g3+ ♔h6 is a draw – note that 21...♖f8 22 ♘xf6+ ♔g7 23 ♘h5+ ♔h6 24 ♖dxf8 is good for White) ♕xc2? (20...♖d7 transposes to line 3b) 21 ♖g3+ ♔h8 22 ♗h5 ♖b7 23 h3 ± ♖b3? 24 ♖d8+ 1-0 Van Kempen-Groeger, corr 1991.

3b) **19...♔h8** 20 ♖g3 ♖d7 (better than 20...♖g8 21 ♕h6 ♖xg3 22 hxg3 ♖d7 23 ♘xf6 ♕xc2, Hakki-Iskov, Eksjö 1982 and now 24 ♘xd7 ♕xe2 25 ♖f1 ♕xf1+ 26 ♔xf1 ♗d7 27 ♕d2 +−) 21 ♕h6 ♖f7 22 ♕h5 ♖xd1+ (22...♗f8 23 h3 ♕a5? 24 ♖xd7 ♖xd7 25 ♘xf6 ♖g7 26 ♕xh7+ 1-0 Servi-Liskevitch, corr 1970, but even 23...♖c7 24 ♖d8 ♕b1+ 25 ♔h2 ♕b4 26 ♘xf6! ♖xf6 27 ♕g5 ♖g6 28 ♕xe5+ ♖gg7 29 ♖xg7 ♖xg7 30 ♖xc8 is ±) 23 ♗xd1 ♕a5! 24 ♔f1 ♕d8 (24...♕b5+? 25 ♗e2 ♕b1+ 26 ♔f2 ♕b7 27 ♗xa6 ♕a7+ 28 ♔f3 ♕xa6 29 ♕xf7 ♕f1+ 30 ♘f2 e4+ 31 ♔g4 e5+ 32 ♔h4 1-0 Poliakov-Khenkin, USSR 1988) 25 ♕xf7 ♕xd1+ 26 ♔f2 ♕xc2+ 27 ♔e3 ♗c5+ 28 ♘xc5 ♕xc5+ 29 ♔f3 e4+! 30 ♔xe4 ♕c4+ ½-½ G.Andersson-Poulsen, corr 1991.

19 ♕h6 *(D)*

The sacrifice **19 ♖f3** fxe4 20 ♖g3+ ♔h8 21 ♕c3 is refuted by 21...♗b7, as in Hjelm-Khenkin, Gausdal 1991, while **19 ♕c3** ♕a3 20 ♕xc6 ♕e3+ 21 ♘f2 ♖a7 was ∓ in Rittiphunya-wong-Bogda, Lucerne OL 1982.



19 ... ♖f7?!

Or:

1) **19...fxe4?** 20 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 21 ♕g5+ ♔h8 22 ♕f6+ ♔g8 23 ♗h5 ♖a7 24 ♖f1 ♗c5+ 25 ♔h1 ♕d5 26 ♗f7+ ♖xf7 27 ♕xf7+ ♔h8 28 ♕f6+ ♔g8 29 ♕g5+ ♔h8 30 h4 ♕d6 31 h5 ♕e7 32 ♕xe5+ ♔g8 33 ♖f4 h6 34 ♖f6 ♗d6 35 ♖g6+ ♔h7 (35...♔f7 36 ♕g7+ ♔e8 37 ♕h8+ wins) 36 ♕xe4 1-0 Grünfeld-Helmers, Lucerne 1979.

2) **19...♕xc2** (best) and now:

2a) **20 ♖d3** (this leads to a forced draw) ♕xe2 21 ♖g3+ ♔f7 22 ♖xf5+

exf5 23 ♖g7+ ♔e8 24 ♕xc6+ ♔d8 25 ♕b6+ ½-½ Velimirović-Ftačnik, Vršac 1981.

2b) **20 ♘g5?** ♗c5+ 21 ♔h1 ♖a7 22 ♗xa6 ♗xa6 23 ♕xe6+ ♖ff7 24 ♖c1 (24 ♘xf7 ♖xf7 25 ♖c1 ♕e4 26 ♖fe1 ♗e3 27 ♖cd1 ♗c4 –+ Soler-Engel, corr 1977) ♕d2 25 ♘xf7 ♖xf7 26 ♖fd1 ♕e3 27 ♖e1 ♕f2 28 ♖xe5 ♗f1 0-1 Liberzon-Grünfeld, Biel 1980.

2c) **20 ♖f3** and now:

2c1) **20...♕xe2?** 21 ♖g3+ ♔f7 22 ♖g7+ ♔e8 23 ♖xe7+ ♔xe7 24 ♕g5+ and mate in two more moves.

2c2) **20...♗c5+** 21 ♔h1 ♖a7 22 ♖g3+ ♔h8 23 ♘f6 threatening 24 ♕xf8+.

2c3) **20...f4** 21 ♖h3 ♖f7 22 ♖hd3! ♗d7 (22...♕xe2 forces a draw after 23 ♖d8+ ♖f8 24 ♘f6+ ♔f7 25 ♘h5 ♗xd8) 23 ♗f3! and now Wittman-Groiss, Lienz 1979, went 23...♗c5+ 24 ♔h1 ♗d4 25 ♘f6+ ♖xf6 26 ♕xf6 ±. The critical move is 23...♖a7 with a highly unclear position. 24 ♖xd7 ♖xd7 25 ♖xd7 ♗c5+ is probably winning for Black, so White should continue more quietly.

2c4) **20...♖f7** transposes to line 1 of the following note (which favours Black).

The point of 19...♖f7 is to avoid the forced draw after 19...♕xc2 20 ♖d3, but this is probably one risk too many and now White can gain the advantage.

20 ♖d3!

Or:

1) **20 ♖f3** ♕xc2 21 ♖g3+ ♔h8 22 ♗h5 fxe4 (22...♕xd1+ 23 ♗xd1 fxe4 24 h3 ♗d7 25 ♗h5 ½-½ De Vleeschauwer-Leca, corr 1990) 23 h3 ♕f2+ 24 ♔h2, Dravnieks-Beals, corr 1985, and now the best line is 24...♕xg3+! 25 ♔xg3 ♖g7+ 26 ♗g4 (26 ♔h2 ♗g5 27 ♗f7 ♖a7 28 ♗xe6 ♖ad7 29 ♗xd7 ♗xh6 should win for Black) ♗g5 27 ♕h5 ♗d7 and, in view of the threats of ...♗e8 and ...♗f4+, Black has a near-decisive advantage.

2) **20 ♘d6** ♖g7 21 ♘xf5 (21 ♗c4 ♕xc2 22 ♗xe6+ ♗xe6 23 ♕xe6+ ♔h8 24 g3 ♗xd6 25 ♕xd6 f4! 26 ♖de1 ♕c3! 27 ♖xe5 ♖ag8 28 ♕f6 fxg3 29 h4 g2 30 ♖d1 ♕h3 0-1 Tischbierek-H.Grünberg, Fürstenwalde 1981) exf5 22 ♕xc6 ♗b7 23 ♗c4+ ♔h8 24 ♕xb7 ♗c5+ 25 ♔h1 ♖xb7 26 ♗xa2 (Black is a pawn up but the result should be a draw) ♖f8 27 ♗c4 ♖b6 28 ♖d5 ♗d4 29 g3 ♗b2 30 ♗d3 ♖bf6 ½-½ Zundel-Elwert, corr 1991.

20 ... ♖g7

Or:

1) **20...♗f8** 21 ♘f6+ ♔h8 22 ♖g3! leads to mate.

2) **20...f4** 21 ♗h5 ♖g7 (21...♖f5 22 ♗g6! hxg6 23 ♕xg6+ ♔f8 24 ♖h3 +–) 22 ♖fd1 ♕a5 23 ♘f6+ ♔h8 (23...♗xf6 24 ♕xf6 ♗d7 25 ♖xd7 ♖xd7 26 ♕xe6+ wins) 24 ♘xh7! ♖xh7 25 ♖d8+ mates.

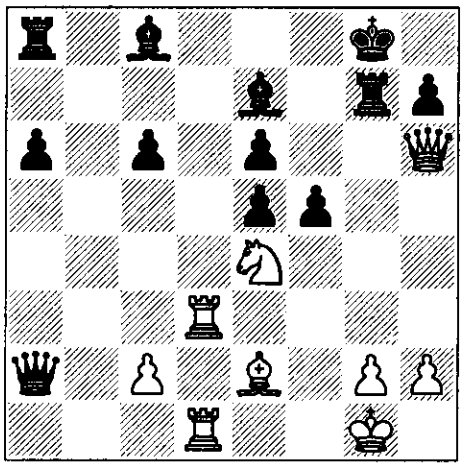
3) **20...♗b7** 21 ♖g3+ ♔h8 22 ♗h5 ♗f8 (22...♖af8 23 ♗xf7 ♖xf7 24 ♕h5 +–) 23 ♘g5! ♖g7 24 ♕f6 with a very dangerous attack.

21 ♖fd1 *(D)*

21 ♘f6+ ♗xf6 22 ♕xf6 ♗d7 23 ♖fd1 ♖f8 ∓.

After 21 ♖fd1 Black has no good continuation:

1) **21...♗b7** 22 ♘f6+ ♗xf6 (or 22...♔h8 23 ♘xh7! ♖xh7 24 ♖d8+ +–) 23 ♕xf6 ♖f8 24 ♖d8 ♖gf7 25 ♖xf8+ ♖xf8 26 ♕g5+ ♔h8 27 ♖d7 and wins.


B

2) **21...fxe4** 22 ♖d8+ ♗xd8 23 ♖xd8+ ♔f7 24 ♕h5+ ♔f6? (24...♖g6 25 ♕xh7+ ♖g7 26 ♗h5+ ♔e7 27 ♖e8+ ♔d6 28 ♕xg7 ♕b1+ 29 ♔f2 ♕xc2+ 30 ♔g3 ♕c3+ 31 ♔h4 ±) 25 ♕h4+ ♖g5 26 ♕h6+ ♖g6 27 ♕f8+ ♔g5 28 g3 1-0 Brunner-Stohl, Dortmund 1990.

3) **21...♗d7** 22 ♘f6+! (22 ♖xd7 fxe4 23 ♖xe7 ♖xe7 24 ♕g5+ ♖g7 25 ♖d8+ ♖xd8 26 ♕xd8+ ♔f7 27 ♗h5+ ♖g6 28 ♗xg6+ leads to perpetual check) ♗xf6 23 ♕xf6 ♕xc2 24 ♕xe5! (24 ♖xd7 ♖xg2+ =) ♖d8 25 ♔f1! ± ♖f7 26 ♕g3+! ♖g7 27 ♕h4 ♖b8 28 ♖xd7 ♖xd7 29 ♖xd7 ♖b1+ 30 ♔f2 ♕c5+ 31 ♔f3! ♕c3+ 32 ♗d3 ♖f1+ 33 ♔e2! 1-0 Krempel-Svendsen, corr 1990.

C)

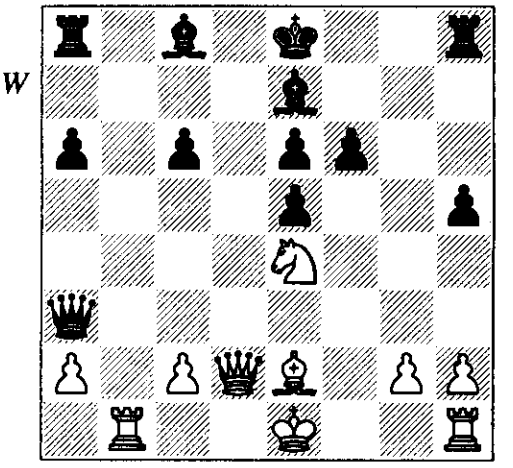
15 ... ♗e7
16 ♗e2 h5 *(D)*

Better than **16...0-0 17 ♖b3 ♕a4 18 c4** and now:

1) **18...♖f7** 19 0-0 f5 20 ♖g3+ ♔h8 21 ♕c3 ♗f8 22 ♕xe5+ ♗g7 23 ♘d6! ♖e7 24 ♖xf5 1-0 Vitolinš-Gutman, Riga 1967.

2) **18...f5** 19 0-0! c5 (or 19...fxe4 20 ♖g3+ ♔h8 21 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 22 ♕g5 and wins), Hartston-Gligorić, Hastings 1965/6, and now 20 ♖g3+ ♔h8 21 ♕c3! would have been the quickest win.

3) **18...♔h8** 19 0-0 ♖a7 20 ♕h6 ♕a5 (20...f5? 21 ♖g3 ♗b4 22 ♘f6 1-0 Gipslis-Korchnoi, USSR Ch 1963) 21 ♘xf6 (21 ♖g3 ♗c5+ 22 ♔h1 f5 23 ♘f6 ♕d8! defends) ♕c5+ 22 ♔h1 ♗xf6 23 ♖xf6 ♖g7, Giazzi-Alagna, corr 1985, and now 24 ♕e3! ♕e7 25 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 26 ♖b8 leaves Black with a miserable position.


W

17 ♖b3

Or **17 ♗f3** (17 c4 f5 18 ♖b3 ♕a4 is line C1; 17 0-0 f5 18 ♗d3?! {18 ♗f3 transposes to later in the current note} ♗d7 19 ♖b3 ♕a4 20 c4 fxe4 21 ♗xe4 ♕xc4 ∓ Bronstein-Gufeld, Tbilisi 1980) and now:

1) **17...♖a7** 18 ♖b8 ♖c7 (18...♔f7 19 0-0 f5 20 ♖xc8 ♖xc8 21 ♕h6 ♔e8 22 ♖d1 ♗c5+ 23 ♔h1 ♗d4 24 ♕xe6+ ♔d8 25 ♘d6 ♖d7 26 ♘xc8 1-0 Ernst-Hjartarson, Gausdal 1985) 19 0-0 f5 20 ♘g3 ♕d6 and now:

1a) **21 ♗xh5+** ♔d8 22 ♕e2 ♖d7 23 ♖a8 ♕c5+ 24 ♔h1 ♕b5 25 c4 ♕c5 26 ♗f7 ♖d4 27 ♖xc8+ (the variation 27 ♗e6!? ♖xh2+ 28 ♔g1 ♖h1+ 29 ♘xh1 ♖d6+ 30 ♔h2 ♖xe6 31 ♖xf5 ♔c7 is roughly equal) ♔xc8

28 ♗xe6+ ♔c7 29 ♘xf5 ♖f4 ∓ Ernst-Hünerkopf, Gausdal 1986.

1b) **21 ♕e2** ♕c5+ 22 ♔h1 h4 23 ♗h5+ ♔d7 24 ♖d1+ ♗d6 25 ♕d2 e4 26 ♕g5 ♕e5 27 ♖b4 ± Oechslein-Manuelyan, corr 1986.

2) **17...f5** and now:

2a) **18 ♖b3** ♕a4 19 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 20 ♕xd6 ♕a5+ 21 ♔f2 (21 c3?! ♖a7 22 0-0 ♔f7 23 c4 ♖d7! 24 ♕xc6 ♖c7 25 ♕a8 ♔g7 26 ♖b5 ♕c3 ∓ Kotkov-Mukhin, Moscow 1970) ♔f7 22 ♖d1 ♖a7 23 ♗xc6 ♔f6! 24 ♖e3 ♖g7 25 ♖d5 ♕c7 26 ♕xe5+ ♕xe5 27 ♖dxe5 = Kaufman-Quinteros, Washington 1979.

2b) **18 ♘d6+** ♗xd6 19 ♗xc6+ ♔f7 20 ♗xa8 e4 and now the lines **21 ♗c6** ♕c5, **21 ♗b7** ♗d7 22 ♖b3 ♕c5 23 ♗xa6 h4 and **21 ♗xe4** fxe4 22 0-0+ ♔e8 are all very good for Black.

2c) **18 0-0** and now:

2c1) **18...fxe4** (the most promising move) 19 ♗xe4 ♗d7 with a further branch:

2c11) **20 ♗g6+** ♔d8 21 ♖b7 ♕d6! 22 ♕e2, Barlov-Sindik, Yugoslavia 1973, and now 22...♔c8 defends.

2c12) **20 ♖b3** ♕a4 21 ♗g6+ ♔d8 22 ♖d3 c5 23 ♖d1 ♖a7 and again Black defends.

2c13) **20 ♖f3** ♕c5+! 21 ♔h1 ♖g8 22 ♖d3 ♖g4! 23 ♖xd7 (23 ♗f3? e4 and 23 ♕e2 ♕c4 24 ♗f3 e4 win for Black) ♖xe4 24 ♖bb7 ♖f4 25 ♕d1 (25 ♖xe7+ ∓) ♖f5 26 h3 was Böhmfeldt-Nunn, Dortmund 1979, and now 26...♗f8!, threatening ...e4 followed by ...♖d5, wins for Black, e.g. 27 ♖dc7 ♕d5 −+.

2c14) **20 ♖b7** 0-0-0 21 ♖fb1 ♗d6 22 ♔h1 ♖df8 23 ♗d3 ♖f4 ∓ Ribli-Barczay, Budapest 1968.

2c2) **18...♔f7** and now:

2c21) **19 ♔h1** ♖a7 20 ♖b8 (Tal proposed 20 ♕f2!?) ♖d7 21 ♕e2?! (21 ♕f2 ∞) h4 22 ♗g4 ♔g7 23 ♗xf5 exf5 24 ♕f2! ♖d1! 25 ♖xd1 fxe4 26 ♕e2 ♔h6! 27 ♕xe4 ♕c5 ∓ Tolnai-Kir.Georgiev, St John Open 1988.

2c22) **19 c4!** h4 20 ♖b3 ♕a4 21 ♕c3 ♖h6 22 ♕xe5 ♕xa2 23 ♗d1 (or 23 ♖b6 ♕xc4 24 ♖xc6 ♕xc6 25 ♘g5+ ♗xg5 26 ♗xc6 ♖a7 27 ♕b8 ♗e3+ 28 ♔h1 ♗d7 29 ♕b3! ±) ♖a7 24 ♖b8 h3, Tisdall-H.Olafsson, Husavik 1985, and now 25 ♖b2! ♕a3 26 ♖b3! ♕a2 27 ♖g3 would have been very good for White.

2c3) **18...♖a7** 19 ♖b8 (19 ♔h1 ♖d7 20 ♘f6+ ♗xf6 21 ♗xc6 ♕c5 ∓ Lanka-Novikov, USSR 1983) ♔f7 (19...0-0 20 ♕h6 fxe4 21 ♖xc8 ♗c5+ 22 ♔h1 ♖xc8 23 ♕xe6+ ♔g7 24 ♕xe5+ ♔g8 25 ♗e2 ♖f8 26 ♗c4+ ♔h7 27 ♕xh5+ ♔g7 28 ♕g4+ ♔h6 29 ♕h4+ ½-½ Tolnai-Spiriev, Zalakaros 1988) 20 ♕f2 ♖b7 21 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 22 ♕g3 ♕a5 23 ♘g5+ ♗xg5 24 ♕xg5 ♕c5+ 25 ♔h1 ♕e7 26 ♗xh5+ ♔f8 27 ♕g6 ♖h7 28 ♖b1 e4 29 h3 e3 30 ♖xb7 ½-½ Lukov-Spasov, Pamporovo 1981.

17 ... ♕a4 *(D)*

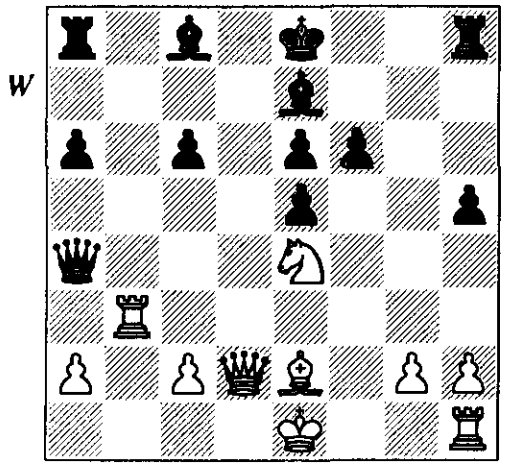
Now there are two lines; the first is the older method, now thought harmless, and the second is the current main line:

C1: 18 c4
C2: 18 ♘xf6+

C1)

18 c4 f5

Not 18...♖a7?! 19 ♖b8! (19 0-0 ♖d7 20 ♕b2 ♕a5 21 ♖xf6 ♖d4 22 ♖b8, Estrin-Zilbershtein, USSR 1969,



22...♗xf6 23 ♖xc8+ ♗d8 ∓) ♔f7 20 0-0 f5 21 ♖xc8! ♖xc8 22 ♕h6! ♔e8 23 ♕xe6 ♔d8 24 ♖xf5 ♖d7 25 ♕xe5 ± Smejkal-Trapl, Czechoslovak Ch 1964.

19 0-0

Other moves are less important:

1) **19 ♘g3** (interesting, but equal at best) h4 20 ♘h5 and now:

1a) **20...♗d8** 21 0-0 ♕a5 with a further branch:

1a1) **22 ♕e3** ♗e7 23 ♔h1 ♕c5 24 ♕h3 (now that Black has got his queen out of the box White has to work hard to prove that he has enough for two pawns; in the example he just manages to draw) ♖g8 25 g4 ♕d4 26 ♕f3 ♗d7 27 h3 e4 28 ♕f4 ♗d6 29 ♕h6 ♕e5 30 ♖f2 ♕a1+ (30...♗e7!? is a winning attempt) 31 ♖f1 ♕e5 32 ♖f2 ♕a1+ 33 ♖f1 ♕e5 ½-½ Veličković-Buljovčić, Novi Sad 1980.

1a2) **22 ♕d6** ♕c7 23 ♕d2 ♕d7 (avoiding the draw) 24 ♖d3 ♕e7 25 ♘g7+ ♔f7 26 ♘h5 ♕g5 and Black wins, Rasmussen-Mazzeo, corr.

1a3) **22 ♘g7+** ♔f7 23 ♖b7+ ♔g6 (23...♗xb7 24 ♕d7+ is just a draw) 24 ♕d6, Groszpeter-Karolyi, Budapest 1979, and now 24...♗f6! favours Black.

1b) **20...♖a7** 21 ♕c3 (21 ♖b8 ♔f7 22 0-0 ♖d7 23 ♕e3 ♕a5 24 ♔h1 ♕c5 25 ♕h3 ♖d2 26 ♖xf5+ exf5 27 ♖xc8 ♕f2 0-1 Kordonowski-Schwarze, corr 1988) and now:

1b1) **21...♕xa2** 22 ♕xe5 (22 ♖b8 0-0 23 ♕xe5 ♗d8 24 0-0 ♕a5 and now either 25 ♘f6+ ♖xf6 26 ♕xa5 ♗xa5 ∓ or 25 ♕e3 ♖h7 26 ♘f6+ ♗xf6 27 ♖xc8 ♖e7 28 ♖xc6 ♖d8 ∓) ♕xb3 23 ♕xh8+ ♗f8 24 ♘f6+ ♔e7, Fedorowicz-Nunn, Hastings 1977/8, and now 25 ♘h7! ♕b4+ 26 ♔f1 ♕b1+ 27 ♔f2 ♕b6+ 28 ♔e1 would have been a draw.

1b2) **21...♗d6** may be better, for example 22 0-0 ♖b7 23 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 24 ♕e3 ♕xa2 ∓ or 23 ♖fb1 ♕xa2 24 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 25 ♖xb7 ♕xe2.

2) **19 ♘d6+** (Black has a safe advantage after this move) ♗xd6 20 ♕xd6 ♕a5+ 21 ♔f2 and now:

2a) **21...♗d7?** 22 ♖d1 ♖d8 23 ♖b7 ♖h7 24 ♖xd7! ♖dxd7 25 ♗xh5+ ♖xh5 26 ♕xd7+ forces mate.

2b) **21...♔f7** 22 c5 ♔f6 23 ♖e3 e4 24 ♖xe4 (24 ♕xc6 ♖a7 25 ♕b6 ♕xb6 26 axb6 ♖d7 ∓) fxe4 25 ♕f4+ ♔g6 (it is doubtful if White can even draw) 26 ♕xe4+ ♔f7 27 ♕e5 ♖h7 28 ♖d1 ♖a7 29 ♗xh5+ ♔g8 30 ♕g5+ ♖hg7 31 ♗g6 ♖ad7 32 ♕h5 ♕xa2+ 0-1 Scherbakov-Zaid, Baku 1978.

2c) **21...♖a7** and now:

2c1) **22 ♖b8** ♔f7 23 ♖d1 ♔f6 24 c5 (24 ♕xc6 ♖c7 25 ♖d5 ♖xc6 26 ♖xa5 ♖h7 ∓ Ivanov-Ziewitz, corr 1977) ♖d7! 25 ♕xd7 ♕xc5+ 26 ♔f1 ♗xd7 27 ♖xh8 ♕e7 28 ♖h6+ ♔g7 29 ♖xh5 c5 with a distinct advantage for Black, Matulović-Stean, Vršac 1979.

2c2) **22 ♕xc6+** ♗d7 (22...♔f7 23 ♖d1 is unclear) 23 ♕d6 ♔f7 24

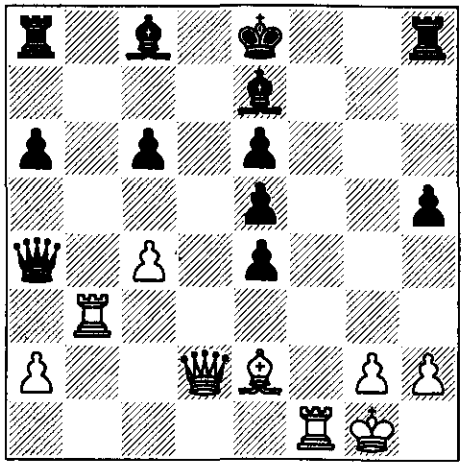
c5 (24 ♖hb1 ♕c7 25 c5 ♔f6 26 ♕xc7 ♖xc7 and Black won the ending, Kramer-Acosta, corr 1977) ♕c7 25 ♖c1 ♔f6 26 ♖b6 ♗c8 27 ♖c6 ♕g7 28 ♗xa6 ♖g8 29 g3 ♖xa6 30 ♖xa6 ♗xa6 31 ♕xa6 h4 32 ♖c3 f4 ∓ Schwibbe-Leisebein, corr 1989.

2c3) **22 ♖d1** ♔f7 23 ♖a3 ♕c7 24 ♕c5 e4 25 ♖d6 ♕e7 26 ♕d4 e5 27 ♕d1 ♕h4+ 28 ♔g1 f4 ∓ Ruppe-Blank, corr 1977.

2c4) **22 ♖e3** ♕c7 23 ♕c5 e4 is very promising for Black, Hartston-Kavalek, Prague 1968.

2c5) **22 ♖g3** ♔f7 23 ♖g5 ♖d7 24 ♕xc6 ♕d2 25 h4 ♕d4+ 26 ♔g3 ♗b7 −+ Bjornsson-Palatnik, Philadelphia 1994.

19 ... fxe4 *(D)*



20 ♔h1

Or:

1) **20 ♕d1** ♗c5+ (20...♗d7? 21 ♖b8+ +−; 20...♕a5 21 ♗xh5+ ♖xh5 22 ♕xh5+ ♔d8 23 ♖d1+ ♔c7 24 ♕e8 ♕c5+ 25 ♔h1 e3 26 ♖xe3 ♖b8 27 ♖ed3 ♗d6 28 h3 ∞ Djurić-Benderac, Yugoslavia Cht 1993) 21 ♔h1 ♗d4 22 ♗xh5+ ♔d8 23 ♖f7 (23 ♕g4? ♖a7 24 ♕g5+ ♖e7 25 ♖d1 ♕xc4! 26 ♖c1 ♖f8 0-1 Tratatovici-Uržica, Romanian Ch 1977) ♕xc4 and now, in view of the back-rank threats, White has no satisfactory continuation of the attack.

2) **20 ♕c3** and now:

2a) **20...♗c5+** 21 ♔h1 ♖f8 (not 21...♗d4? 22 ♕g3) 22 ♗xh5+ ♔d8 23 ♖d1+ ♗d4 (23...♗d7? 24 ♕xe5 +−) 24 ♖xd4+ exd4 25 ♕xd4+ ♗d7 26 ♕b6+ ♔e7 27 ♕c5+ ♔f6, and now 28 ♕f2+ (or 28 ♖g3 ♖g8 29 ♕f2+) draws.

2b) **20...♕xa2** 21 ♗d1 (21 ♕xe5? ♕xb3 22 ♕xh8+ ♔d7 −+; 21 ♖b2? ♗c5+ 22 ♔h1 ♗d4 −+) ♗c5+ (or 21...♖f8 22 ♗xh5+ ♔d8 23 ♖d1+ ♗d7 24 ♕e3 ♕a5 25 ♖b7 ♗c5 26 ♖dxd7+ ♔c8 27 ♖dc7+ ♔d8 28 ♖d7+ ½-½ Kavalek-Fischer, Sousse IZ 1967) 22 ♔h1 ♖f8 23 ♗xh5+ ♔d8 (23...♔e7? 24 ♖xf8 ♔xf8 25 ♕xe5 +− Benkovich-Mukhin, USSR 1976) 24 ♖d1+ ♗d7! (24...♗d4 25 ♖xd4+ exd4 26 ♕xd4+ ♗d7 27 ♕b6+ ♔e7 28 ♕c5+ ♔f6 29 ♕d4+ e5 30 ♕xd7 ♕xb3 31 ♕d6+ ♔g7 32 ♕g6+ ½-½ Gorki-Spassky, USSR 1968) 25 ♖b7 ♗d4 26 ♕b4 ♕f2 27 h3 ♖c8 28 ♕d6 ♖f7 −+ Priepke-Marten, corr 1988.

3) **20 ♕c2** (it looks wrong to let the black queen out to a5) ♕a5 21 ♕xe4 ♔d8 (or 21...♕c5+ 22 ♔h1 ♖a7 23 ♗f3 ♔d8 24 ♖fb1 ♖f8 25 g3 ♖d7 26 ♖b8 ♖d4 −+ Chevaldonnet-W.Schmidt, Bagneux 1982) 22 ♔h1 (22 ♖f7 ♖a7 ∓) ♔c7, Nikolov-Armas, Pernik 1983 and with the queen coming to c5 Black can defend.

After **20 ♔h1** the only real question is whether White can salvage a draw. I suspect that he cannot, although it is not clear which black move is the most promising. The alternatives are:

1) **20...c5** (safe, but now White can probably draw) and now:

1a) **21 ♕c3** ♕c6 22 ♕xe5 ♖f8 23 ♖fb1 (23 ♗xh5+ ♔d8 24 ♖d1+ ♗d7 25 ♗g6 ♗d6 26 ♕b2 ♔c7 27 ♖b1 e3 28 ♖b7+ ♔c8 29 ♖b6 ♕c7 30 ♗e4 ♖b8 31 ♖xb8+ ♕xb8 32 ♕e2 ♕xb1+! 33 ♗xb1 ♖f2 –+ Espig-Helmers, Lodz 1978) ♖a7 24 ♖b6?! ♖b7! 25 ♖xb7 (25 ♕xh5+ ♔d8 26 ♖d1+ ♖d7 or 25 ♗xh5+ ♔d8 26 ♖xb7 ♕xb7!) ♗xb7 26 ♖d1 ♗f6 27 ♕xh5+ ♔e7 28 ♕h7+ ♖f7 29 ♕g8 ♗d4 30 ♗h5 ♖g7 0-1 Nunn-Szekely, Groningen jr Ech 1974/5.

1b) **21 ♕c2!** ♕c6 22 ♖fb1 ♗d8 23 ♗f3 exf3 (23...♖a7 24 ♗xe4 ♕d6 25 ♖d1 ♕f8 26 ♖f3 +–) 24 ♕g6+ ♔d7 25 ♕f7+ ♗e7 26 ♖d1+ ♔c7 27 ♕xe7+ ♗d7 28 ♖xd7+ ♕xd7 29 ♖b7+ ♔xb7 30 ♕xd7+ ♔b6 31 ♕d6+ ♔b7 32 ♕d7+ ½-½ Taborov-Peresypkin, USSR 1977.

2) **20...♖a7** (simple and strong) 21 ♕c2 (21 ♖b8 ♖c7 22 ♕c3 ♖f8! 23 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 24 ♕xe5 ♕a3 25 ♗xh5+ ♔d8 26 ♕f6+ ♔d7 27 ♖b1 ♖b7 28 ♖d1+ ♔c7 29 ♕e5+ ♗d6 and Black has been able to consolidate his extra piece, Kengis-Shashin, Riga 1976) ♕a5 22 ♕xe4 ♕c5 23 ♗xh5+ ♔d8 24 ♗g4 ♖f8 25 ♖d1+ ♔c7 26 h3 ♖b7 27 ♖xb7+ ♔xb7 28 ♖b1+ ♔a8 29 ♕c2 ♗d6 0-1 Harandi-Portisch, Rio IZ 1979.

3) **20...♗d7** with three possible variations:

3a) **21 ♕c2** ♕a5! 22 ♕xe4 ♔d8! 23 ♖d1 ♔c8 24 ♗f3 ♕c7 25 ♖bd3 ♖d8 26 ♕h7 ♗e8 27 ♕g8 ♖xd3 28 ♖xd3 ♔b7 29 ♕xe6 ♗c5 30 ♗xh5 ♕e7! ∓ Olthof-Van Raay, corr 1978.

3b) **21 ♕c3** ♖f8 22 ♗xh5+ (22 ♖d1 ♖f5 –+) ♔d8 23 ♖d1 (23 ♖fb1 ♗d6! 24 ♖d1 ♗c7 –+) ♔c8 24 h3 ♕xa2 25 c5 (25 ♖xd7 ♔xd7 26 ♖b7+ ♔c8 27 ♖xe7 ♕f2 28 ♕a5 ♖a7 –+) a5 (preventing ♕a5 in many lines, but 25...♕a4 was also good) 26 ♖db1, Hübner-Hort, Hamburg m (5) 1979, and now 26...♖f2! 27 ♕c4 (27 ♕xe5 ♖f1+) ♔d8 28 ♕xe4 ♖f1+ 29 ♖xf1 ♕xb3 30 ♕xe5 ♔c8 31 ♖f7 ♗d8 would have repulsed the attack as the sacrifice on d7 fails to draw.

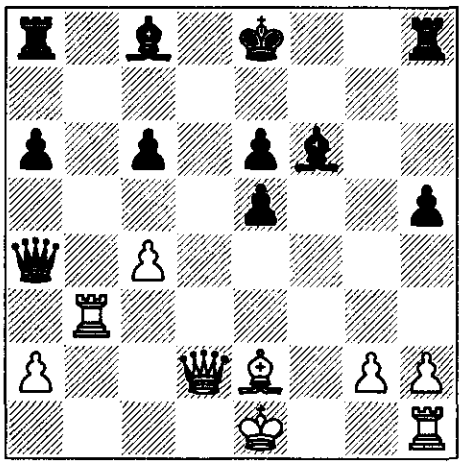
3c) **21 ♖b7** c5 (even 21...♖d8 22 ♕e3 ♗c8 23 ♖xe7+ ♔xe7 is promising for Black after 24 ♕c5+? ♖d6 –+ or 24 ♕g5+ ♔d6 25 ♖d1+ ♕xd1+ 26 ♗xd1 ♖hf8 ∓) 22 ♕b2 and now the available examples have rather favoured White. However, so far as I can see, 22...♗d6! is a complete answer to White's attack, for example 23 ♖d1 ♕a5! 24 ♗xh5+ (24 h3 ♗c7) ♖xh5 25 ♖xd7 (25 ♕e2 ♖f5 26 ♖xd6 ♕xa2 –+) ♕xd7 26 ♕b7+ ♕c7 27 ♕xa8 ♕c6 28 ♕g8 ♖f5 and Black wins.

C2)

18	**♘xf6+**	**♗xf6**
19	**c4** *(D)*	

Amazingly, the weak move 19 0-0 has been played a number of times, even though 19...♕d4+ 20 ♕xd4 exd4 21 ♖xf6 ♔e7 gives Black a favourable ending, for example 22 ♖g6 ♗d7 23 c3 (23 ♖b7 ♔d6 24 ♖g7 ♖ad8 25 ♖a7 ♗c8 26 ♖h7 e5 27 ♖xh8 ♖xh8 28 ♖a8 a5 29 ♗a6 ♔c7 30 ♔f2 ♖f8+ 31 ♔e1 ♖d8 32 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 33 ♖xa5 ♔d6 ∓ Licina-Novikov, Bern 1994; 23 ♖g5 ♔d6 ∓) c5 24 ♖g7+ ♔d6 25 cxd4 cxd4 26 ♖b4 e5 27 ♖b7 ♗f5 28 ♖b6+ ♔c5 29 ♖f6 ♖hf8 with good winning chances for Black, Kengis-Machulsky, Riga 1980.

B



After 19 c4 it seems unbelievable that White has sufficient compensation for a piece and a pawn, but apart from the exposure of his king, Black suffers from problems which will persist for several moves. His queen is locked out of play and his c8-bishop displays no activity at all; only his dark-squared bishop is doing a good job, and it is this piece which holds Black's entire position together.

Black has two main moves, but the rarely played 19...c5 is also possible:

C21: 19...♗h4+
C22: 19...♖a7

The two lines 19...♗h4+ 20 g3 ♗e7 21 0-0 ♖a7 and 19...♖a7 20 0-0 ♗e7 differ only in the position of White's g-pawn, but we consider them separately as the availability of ♕g3 is an important difference. Nevertheless they are closely related and should be compared.

Other ideas:

1) **19...c5** (Black returns the piece in order to exchange queens, but the resulting ending is slightly worse for him) 20 0-0 ♕d7 and now:

1a) **21 ♖d3** ♕g7 22 ♖g3 ♕e7 23 ♕d3 (23 ♖g8+ ♖xg8 24 ♗xh5+ ♔f8 25 ♕h6+ ♕g7 26 ♖xf6+ ♔e7 27 ♖f7+ ♕xf7 28 ♗xf7 ♔xf7 29 ♕h7+ is at best a draw for White) ♕f7 24 ♕f3 ♖b8 25 ♕xf6 ♕xf6 26 ♖xf6 ♔e7 is comfortable for Black.

1b) **21 ♕xd7+** ♗xd7 22 ♖xf6 and now:

1b1) **22...♔e7** 23 ♖g6 ♖ad8 (alternatively, 23...♔f7 24 ♖g5 ± or 23...♖h7 24 ♖g5 h4 25 ♖xe5 ♖c8 26 ♗g4 ± Aldrete-Rittiphunyawong, Lucerne OL 1982) 24 ♖e3 ♗e8 25 ♖g5 ♖d2 26 ♖gxe5 ♖h6 27 ♖a3 ♗c6 28 ♖xa6 ♔d7 29 ♔f2 ♖g6 30 g3 ♖g4 31 ♔e3 ♖gd4 32 ♖xc5 1-0 Beliavsky-Mikhalchishin, USSR 1980.

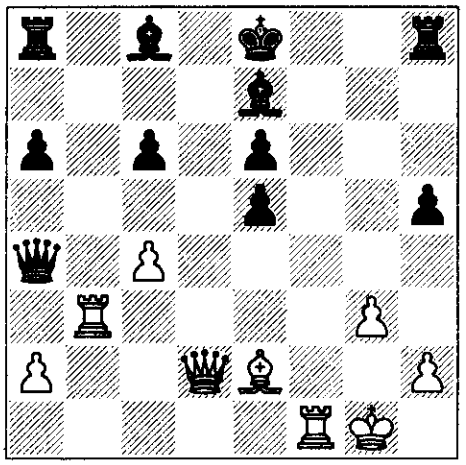
1b2) **22...h4!** 23 ♖e3 (23 ♖g6 ♔f7 24 ♖g5 ♔f6 or 23 ♗f3 ♔e7) ♔e7 24 ♖f2 ♖ab8 25 ♖xe5 ♖b1+ 26 ♖f1 ♖b2 27 ♗g4 ♖xa2 28 ♖xc5 ½-½ Rogulj-Stean, Smederevska Palanka 1980.

2) **19...♗e7** 20 0-0 e4? (20...♖a7 transposes to line C22; 20...♗d7? 21 ♖b7 0-0-0 22 ♖fb1 ♗c5+ 23 ♔h1 ♗d4 24 ♖7b4 ♕a3 25 c5 1-0 Recio-Romero, corr 1991) 21 ♕c3 ♖f8 22 ♗xh5+ ♔d8 23 ♕d4+ ♔c7 24 ♕b6+ ♔d6 25 ♖d1+ ♔e5 26 ♕d4+ ♔f4 27 ♖f1+ 1-0 Nuutilainen-Surakka, corr 1981.

C21)

19	**...**	**♗h4+**
20	**g3**	**♗e7**
21	**0-0** *(D)*	

Here there are two main choices for Black, of which the first is the safest and best, leading to at least a draw for Black. The second leads to an unclear position after Beliavsky's 25 ♕e4!.



C211: 21...h4
C212: 21...♖a7

Or **21...♗d7** (a rather dubious move) **22 ♖b7 ♖d8** (after 22...c5 not 23 ♕d3 0-0-0! but 23 ♗d1! ♕c6 24 ♗f3 ♕d6 25 ♕c2 and now 25...♕d4+ 26 ♔h1 0-0-0 27 ♕b3 ♗d6 28 ♖b8+ mates, so Nunn-Macaulay, British Ch 1979, went 25...e4 26 ♖d1! ♗c6 27 ♖xd6 ♗xd6 28 ♖b6 with a winning position for White) **23 ♗d3 ♗c5+** and now:

1) **24 ♔h1** ♖g8 25 ♗e2!? ♔e7 26 ♗xh5 ♖g7 27 ♕h6 ♕xc4 28 ♕xg7+ ♔d6 29 ♕f6 ♗d4 30 ♖fb1 ± ♕d3? 31 ♖7b3 ♕f5 32 ♕xd8 and White won in Timman-Ribli, Nikšić 1978, but a point to note is that if Black plays 27...♖dg8 White wins by 28 ♕f6+ ♔d6 29 ♖d1+ ♕xd1 30 ♗xd1, but if the pawn is on g2 instead of g3 (see the note on the previous page), then 30...♖xg2 turns the tables.

2) **24 ♔g2** ♖g8 25 ♕e2! (this method seems to work wherever the white pawn is) ♗d4 26 ♕xh5+ ♔e7 27 ♕h4+ ♔d6 28 c5+! ♔xc5 29 ♕e7+ ♔d5 30 ♖xd7+ ♖xd7 31 ♕xd7+ ♔c5 32 ♖c1+ ♔b6 33 ♗e4 ♗c3 34 ♕d3 +– Beliavsky-Szekely, Frunze 1979.

C211)

21 ... h4

It is astonishing that Black can get away with such a move, but he reasons that just at the moment White has no instant threats, so pushing the h-pawn is the best way to generate some counterplay. So far White has not found more than a draw; perhaps the last unexplored territory is 22 ♗d3!?.

22 ♕d3

Other moves may be better, since some offer good prospects of a draw:

1) **22 ♕c2** ♕a5 23 ♗h5+ ♖xh5 24 ♕g6+ transposes to the main line.

2) **22 ♗d3!?** ♗c5+ 23 ♔h1 ♖g8 24 ♗e2 (24 ♗h7 ♖g4 25 ♕d3 ♖d4 26 ♕g6+ ♔d8 27 ♖f7 ♖d1+ 28 ♔g2 ♕xa2+ 29 ♔h3 ♖d7 –+ Dewar-Budlevskis, corr 1992) ♗d7 (24...♗d4 25 ♕h6! ±) 25 ♗h5+ ♔d8 26 ♖f7 ♗d4? (26...♗e7 is better, for example 27 ♖d3 c5 28 ♗d1 ♕c6+ 29 ♗f3 e4 30 ♕a5+ ♔c8 –+) 27 ♖b4 ♕a3 28 ♖b7 ♗e8 29 ♖f3 (now White has a dangerous attack) hxg3 30 hxg3 ♕a4 31 ♗xe8 ♔xe8 32 ♖ff7 c5 33 ♖h7 ♕c6+ 34 ♔h2 ♕d6 35 ♕c2 ♔d8 36 ♕a4 ♔c8 37 ♖hd7 ♖d8 38 ♖xd6 ♖xd6 39 ♖e7 e4 40 ♕e8+ 1-0 Boto-Komljenović, Zagreb 1982.

3) **22 ♕d1** and now:

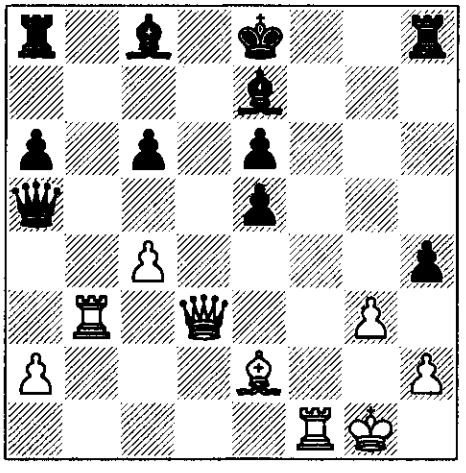
3a) **22...♕a5** 23 ♗h5+ ♖xh5 24 ♕xh5+ ♔d8 25 ♔h1 ♕c5 26 ♖d3+ ♔c7 27 ♕e8 e4 28 ♖dd1 ♔b6 29 ♖f7 ♗g5 30 gxh4 ♗xh4 31 ♖b1+ ♔a5 32 ♕h8! +– I.Popov-Tenev, corr 1991.

3b) **22...♗c5+** 23 ♔h1 ♗d4 24 ♕c2! (24 ♕d3 ♔e7 25 ♕g6 ♔d6 26 ♕g7 ♖d8 27 ♖d1 ♕a5 28 gxh4 ♖d7 29 ♕g3 ♔e7 –+ Rogulj-Szekely, Virovitica 1980) ♔d8 (now 24...♔e7?

is dubious because of 25 ♖f7+! ♔d6 26 c5+ ♗xc5 27 ♖d3+ ♕d4 28 g4 ±, but not 25 ♖b7+? ♗xb7 26 ♕xa4 c5+ 27 ♗f3 hxg3 28 h3 e4! ∓) 25 ♕g6 ♖e8 (25...♗d7 26 ♕g7 ♖e8!? is an interesting winning attempt, but not 26...♔c7? 27 ♖b7+! +–) 26 ♖f7 ♖a7 27 ♖xa7 ♗xa7 28 ♕f6+ ♖e7 29 ♕h8+ ♖e8 30 ♕f6+ ½-½ Berecz-Rumiancevas, corr 1992.

22 ... ♕a5! *(D)*

The only move (but a strong one!), as 22...♗c5+ (or 22...♖h6 23 ♗h5+ ♖xh5 24 ♕g6+ ♔d8 25 ♖d1+ ♗d7 26 ♕g8+ ♔c7 27 ♕xa8 ♗c5+ 28 ♔h1 +– Jonasson-Pigusov, Reykjavik 1994) 23 ♔g2 h3+ 24 ♔h1 ♔e7 25 ♕g6 ♕d6 26 ♕g7 is winning for White after **26...♖d8** 27 ♖d1+ ♗d4 28 ♖xd4+ exd4 29 ♕xd4+ ♔e7 30 ♕h4+ +– or **26...♗d7** 27 ♖d1+ ♗d4 28 c5+! ♔c7 29 ♖b7+ ♔xb7 30 ♕xd7+ ♔b8 31 ♖b1+ ♕b5 32 ♗xb5 cxb5 33 a4 +– Henczi-Tolnai, Hungary 1981.



23 ♗h5+

Other moves are no better:

1) **23 ♕g6+** ♔d8 24 ♕g7 ♖e8 25 ♗h5 ♖a7! 26 ♔h1 (26 ♕g6 ♖f8 is also good for Black) h3! 27 ♗xe8 (27 ♖d3+ ♖d7 28 ♕g6 ♖f8 –+) ♕xa2! 28 ♗xc6 ♕xb3 29 ♕xe5 ♕b6 30 ♗e4 ♖d7 31 ♕h8+ ♔c7 32 ♕xh3 ♗b7 33 ♕g4 ♖d4 0-1 Maninang-Ribli, Indonesia 1982.

2) **23 ♖d1** ♕c5+ 24 ♔h1 e4! 25 ♕xe4 ♖h6 26 gxh4 (the point of the preliminary ...e4 is to meet 26 ♗h5+ by ...♕xh5; 26 ♕f4 ♖f6 27 ♕e4 ♗d7 –+ Kovacs-Karolyi, Hungary 1984) ♗d7 27 ♕f4 ♖xh4 (Black has a choice of good moves; the move played aims to set up an attack on h2, but 27...♖f6 was also promising) 28 ♕g3 ♗g5 29 ♖g1 ♗f6 30 ♖f3 ♕e5 31 ♕f2 0-0-0! 32 ♖xf6 ♖xh2+ 33 ♕xh2 ♕xf6 ∓ Misius-Palević, corr 1983.

3) **23 ♗g4** ♖h6 24 ♗h5+ ♖xh5 25 ♕g6+ transposes to the main line.

23 ... ♖xh5

Now the only question is whether White can draw. Play continues 24 ♕g6+ ♔d8 25 ♕xh5 ♕c5+ 26 ♔h1 (26 ♔g2 ♔c7 27 ♕e8 h3+! 28 ♔xh3 e4 29 ♔g2 e5 30 ♔h1 ♕d6 0-1 Parr-S.Szilagyi, corr 1983) and now:

1) **26...♖a7** 27 ♕h8+ ♔c7 28 ♕e8 ♕d6 29 ♖f7 ♕d1+ 30 ♔g2 h3+ with perpetual check (Bottlik).

2) **26...♔c7** 27 ♕e8 ♕d6 (not 27...♗b7? 28 ♖xb7+) 28 ♖f7 ♕d1+ 29 ♔g2 h3+ 30 ♔xh3 ♕h5+ 31 ♔g2 ♕e2+ 32 ♔h3 ♕h5+ ½-½ Olthof-Gochev, Eger 1987.

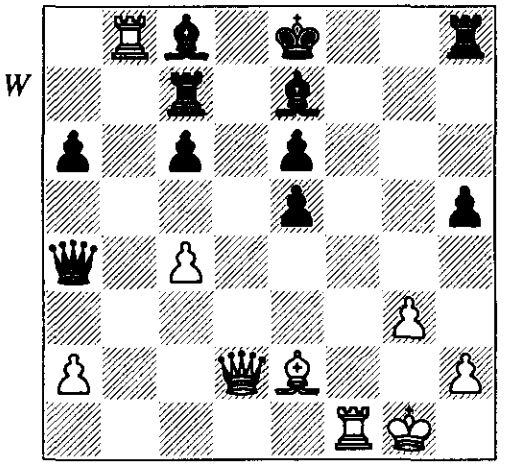
3) **26...hxg3** 27 ♖xg3? (27 hxg3) ♔c7 28 ♖g7 ♗d7 29 ♖ff7 ♖e8 30 ♕e2 ♕d6 –+ Rimpineva-Wikman, corr 1992. The exchange on g3 rules out the trick Black uses to win in line 4, so black players should be wary of exchanging on g3 prematurely.

4) **26...e4!** 27 ♕h8+ ♔c7 28 ♕e8 ♕d6 29 ♖f7 ♕d1+ 30 ♔g2 ♕e2+! (30...h3+ 31 ♔f2 ♕d2+ 32 ♔f1 ♗d7

33 ♕xe7 ♕d1+ 34 ♔f2 ♕d2+ 35 ♔f1 ♕d1+ ½-½ C.Martinez-Novikov, Mendoza 1985) 31 ♔g1 (31 ♖f2 h3+ 32 ♔xh3 ♕xf2 33 ♕xe7+ ♗d7 −+) ♕e1+ 32 ♔g2 h3+ 33 ♔xh3 e5+ 34 ♔g2 ♗h3+ and Black wins.

C212)

21 ... ♖a7
22 ♖b8 ♖c7 *(D)*



23 ♕d3

Or:

1) **23 ♗d3** and now:

1a) **23...♗c5+?** 24 ♔h1 ♖f8 25 ♗g6+ ♔e7 26 ♖xf8 ♔xf8 27 ♕d8+ ♔g7 28 ♗xh5 ♕c2 (28...♕a5 29 ♕g5+ ♔h7 30 ♕g6+ ♔h8 31 ♖xc8+ ♖xc8 32 ♕f6+ mates) 29 ♕xc7+ ♔h6 30 ♕f7 +−.

1b) **23...♖g8** 24 ♗h7 (24 ♕h6? ♔d7 25 ♕h7 ♖g4 26 ♖f7 ♕a3 −+ Kovačević-Marinović, Yugoslav Ch 1979) with a further branch:

1b1) **24...♗c5+** 25 ♔g2 and now Szilagyi-Fodor, corr 1981 continued **25...♖gg7** 26 ♕h6! ♕xa2+ 27 ♔h3 ♖ge7 (27...♖xh7 28 ♕g6+ ♖hf7 29 ♖xc8+ ♖xc8 30 ♖xf7 wins) 28 ♗d3 ♔d7 29 ♕h8 with a slight advantage for White. However, **25...♖g4!** looks like a major improvement. After **26 h3** ♖gg7 White can no longer hide his king on h3, while **26 ♕h6** ♕xa2+ 27 ♔h3 ♕xc4 28 ♖xc8+ (28 ♗g6+ ♔d7 29 ♖f7+ ♔d6 30 ♕f8+ ♔d5 wins for Black because of the looming threat of mate by ...♖h4+) ♖xc8 29 ♕xh5+ ♔d8 30 ♖f7 ♖c7 31 ♖xc7 ♖xg3+ leaves Black three pawns ahead.

1b2) **24...♖g7** 25 ♕h6 ♖xh7 26 ♕g6+ ♔d8 27 ♕g8+ ♔d7 28 ♕xh7 ♖b7 29 ♖xb7+ ♗xb7 30 ♖b1 ♔d6 (in my opinion, Black is still clearly better after 30...♗c8 31 ♕xh5 ♗c5+ 32 ♔h1 ♕xc4) 31 ♖xb7 ♕d1+ 32 ♔g2 ♕e2+ 33 ♔g1 ♕e1+ ½-½ S.Salov-Krasnov, Riga 1981.

2) **23 ♔h1** and now:

2a) **23...♗c5?** 24 ♕g5 +−.

2b) **23...c5** 24 ♕e3 (24 ♕d3 e4 is the same) e4 25 ♕c3 ♖g8 26 ♖d1! gives White a very strong attack.

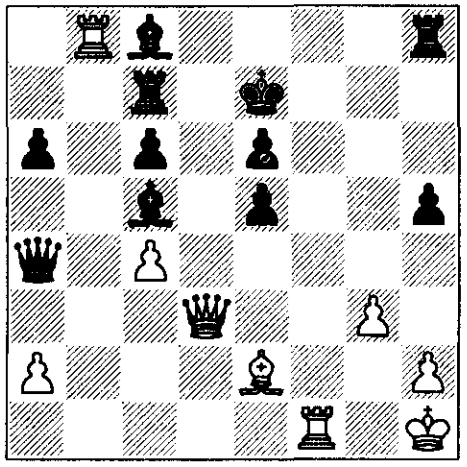
2c) **23...h4** 24 ♕d3 (24 ♗d3 ♖g8 25 ♗e2 ♖h8 only repeats, although ultra-cautious players could interpose this to stop possible castling) c5 (24...hxg3 25 ♕xg3 ♖f8 26 ♗h5+ ♔d8 27 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 28 ♕g6 ♖e7 29 ♕f6! ± Pirisi-Szymczak, Hungary 1981) 25 ♕g6+ ♔d8 26 ♕g7 ♖e8 (26...♕e8 is promising, for example 27 ♕xe5 hxg3 28 ♖d1+ ♖d7 29 ♕xe6 ♗d6! −+) 27 ♕xe5 ♖f8 28 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 29 ♕xe6! ♕c6+ 30 ♕xc6 ♖xc6 31 ♗g4 with an incredible study-like draw, Wojtkiewicz-Staniszewski, Polanica Zdroj 1988.

2d) **23...♕a3!?** 24 ♖d1 ♔f7 25 ♖f1+ ♔g7 26 ♖b3 ♖d7 27 ♕c2 ♕c5 28 ♖bf3, Leveille-Popescu, corr 1989, and now 28...♗g5! 29 h4 ♗d8 would have given Black a distinct advantage.

23 ... ♗c5+

Or 23...♕a3 24 ♗xh5+ ♖xh5 25 ♕g6+ ♔d8 26 ♕g8+ (26 ♖d1+ ♖d7 27 ♖xc8+ ♔xc8 28 ♕e8+ ♖d8 29 ♕xc6+ and 26 ♕xh5 ♕e3+ 27 ♖f2 ♗c5 also lead to a draw) ♔d7 27 ♖d1+ ♗d6 28 ♕f7+ ♔d8 29 ♕f8+ ♔d7 30 ♕f7+ ♔d8 31 ♕f8+ ½-½ Hartmann-Hünerkopf, Bundesliga 1982/3.

24 ♔h1 ♔e7 *(D)*



25 ♕e4

Or **25 ♕f3** (25 ♕g6 ♔d6 26 ♕f6 ♖e8 transposes to line 3b in this note) and now:

1) **25...♕xa2?!** 26 ♕f6+ ♔d6 27 ♕xh8 ♕xe2 28 ♕f8+ ♖e7 29 ♖xc8 ♕e4+ 30 ♖f3 a5 and now not **31 ♖d8+** ♔c7 32 ♖a8 ♖e8! = but **31 ♔g2!** a4 32 h4 a3 33 ♔h3 a2 34 ♖d3+ ♕xd3 35 ♖d8+ ♔c7 36 ♖xd3 a1♕ 37 ♕d8+ ♔b7 38 ♖b3+ ♔a6 39 ♕a8+ and mates.

2) **25...♔d6?** 26 ♖d1+ and now:

2a) **26...♗d4** 27 ♖xd4+ exd4 28 ♕f4+ e5 29 ♕f6+ ♗e6 30 ♖xh8 and now the lines **30...♕xa2** 31 ♕d8+ ♖d7 32 ♕b8+, **30...♕c2** 31 ♖d8+ ♖d7 32 ♕f8+ ♔c7 33 ♖c8+ ♔b7 34 ♖b8+ ♔c7 35 ♖b3 ♕e4+ 36 ♔g1 ♖d8 37 ♕e7+ ♗d7 38 c5! ♕d5 39 ♗xa6 and **30...♕a5** 31 ♖d8+ ♖d7 32 ♕f8+ ♔c7 33 ♖c8+ ♔b7 34 ♖b8+ ♔c7 35 ♖b1 are all winning for White.

2b) **26...♔e7** 27 ♕e4 ♗d4 28 ♕h4+ ♔d6 (28...♔e8 29 ♕f6 +–) 29 ♖xd4+ exd4 30 ♕xd4+ ♔e7 31 ♕g7+ ♔d8 32 ♕xh8+ ♔d7 33 ♕g7+ ♔d8 34 ♕f8+ ♔d7 35 ♗xh5 1-0 Perović-Marinović, Yugoslavia 1979.

3) **25...♖e8**, leading to a forced draw, is the best move:

3a) **26 ♕f7+?!** ♔d8 27 ♕f6+ ♖ce7 (not 27...♗e7? 28 ♕xe5 with a very strong attack, e.g. 28...♖d7 29 ♗xh5 ♖g8 30 ♖a8 ♕b4 31 ♕xe6 ♖g7 32 ♕e5 ♖g8 33 ♗g4 ±) 28 ♗xh5 (28 ♕xe5 ♕a3 29 ♖b3 ♗d6! 30 ♖d1 ♖d7 31 ♕f6+ ♗e7 and 28 ♖d1+ ♗d4 29 ♕xe5? ♕xd1+ are also bad for White) ♗d6! 29 ♖b3 (29 ♖a8 c5) ♕xc4 30 ♖d1 ♔c7 31 ♖bd3 ♖d8 32 ♖xd6 ♖xd6 33 ♕xe7+ ♖d7 ∓.

3b) **26 ♕f6+!** ♔d6 27 ♗xh5 (27 ♖f5 ♗d4 28 c5+ ♔d7 29 ♗xh5 ♖e7 –+) ♖ce7 28 ♖d1+ (28 ♖f5 ♔c7! –+) ♗d4 29 ♖xd4+ exd4 30 ♕xd4+ ♔c7 31 ♕b6+ ½-½ Vitolinš-Gavrikov, Kalinin 1977, and Beliavsky-Platonov, USSR 1st League 1980.

25 ♕e4 was Beliavsky's idea, so that after the obvious 25...♗d4, defending the e5-pawn, simply 26 c5! cuts off the Black king's escape route and gives White a winning attack.

25 ... ♖d7

The stem game Beliavsky-Hübner, Tilburg 1981, went on 25...♔d6 26 ♖d1+ ♕xd1+ 27 ♗xd1 (Black's position is poor compared to similar lines where he gives up his queen) h4 28 ♕d3+ ♗d4 29 c5+! ♔xc5 30 ♕a3+ ♔d5 31 ♗b3+ ♔e4 32 ♗c4 ♔f5 33 ♕f3+ ♔g5 34 gxh4+ ♖xh4 35 ♕g3+ 1-0.

Since this game, few Black players have cared to meet 25 ♕e4 – indeed, there has been no reason for them to do so as the other lines are much safer for Black. However, it isn't clear that Beliavsky's move really does finish Black off.

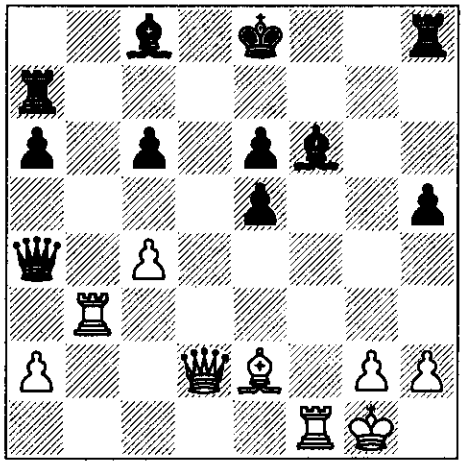
26 ♕xe5 ♗d4

The game Cuoghi-Cimmino, corr 1991 continued 27 ♕f4 (27 ♕g5+ ♔d6 28 ♖d1 ♔c7 29 ♖xd4 ♖xd4 30 ♕e5+ ♖d6 31 ♖b2 c5 32 ♗f3 ♕xc4 33 ♕g7+ ♖d7 34 ♕e5+ ♖d6 is a draw) c5 (27...♔d8 28 ♖fb1 ♔e7 is also playable, with a likely draw after 29 ♖f1 ♔d8) 28 ♕g5+ (28 ♕f7+ ♔d8 29 ♕xe6 ♕a5 is not better for White, for example 30 ♖f7 ♕e1+ 31 ♔g2? ♕xe2+! 32 ♕xe2 ♖xf7 ∓ or 30 ♖fb1 ♕c7 31 ♕xa6 h4 32 g4 ♖e8 33 ♗d3 ♖de7 ∓) ♔d6 29 ♕f4+ ♔e7 30 ♖b6? (30 ♕g5+ is a draw) ♔d8 31 ♗f3 ♕xc4 32 ♖e1 ♖e8 and Black won.

C22)

19 ... ♖a7

20 0-0 *(D)*



B

20 ... ♖f7

With this move Black attempts to avoid the loss of time inherent in playing ...♗e7. There are two other possible moves:

1) **20...♗e7** (the same as C212, but with the white pawn on g2 instead of g3; this gives White the g3-square for his queen or rook and prevents counterplay by ...h4 as in C211; the only negative point is that White is more vulnerable to back-rank mates, but on balance this position is probably a little better for White than C212) 21 ♖b8 ♖c7 and now:

1a) **22 ♗d3** is dubious, since in addition to the lines given in C212 Black has the additional defence 22...♖g8 23 ♗h7 (23 ♖d1 ♗c5+ 24 ♔h1 ♗d4 25 ♕e2 ♔d8 26 c5 ♖d7 27 ♗xa6 ♔c7 −+ Marklund-Eszik, corr 1980; 23 ♕e2 ♕a3 24 ♔h1 ♔d8 25 c5 ♖f8 26 ♖fb1 ♗xc5 27 ♗xa6 ♗d4 and Black wins, Chiburdanidze-Psakhis, Riga 1980) ♕xc4 and now **24 ♖d1** ♖g7 25 ♖xc8+ ♖xc8 26 ♕d7+ ♔f7 27 ♖f1+ ♕xf1+! 28 ♔xf1 ♖d8 −+ or **24 ♗xg8** ♗c5+ 25 ♖f2 ♕g4 26 ♗h7 e4! ∓; this fails in line C212 as ...♗c5+ can be met by ♔g2.

1b) **22 ♔h1** (this appears to lead to a draw) ♕a3 (22...h4 23 ♕d3 c5 24 ♕g6+ ♔d8 25 ♕xe6 ♖f8, Müller-Minte, corr 1984, and now 26 ♖xc8+ ♖xc8 27 ♕b6+ ♖c7 28 ♕b8+ forces a draw) 23 c5 h4 (23...♗xc5 24 ♕g5 ♖f8! 25 ♕xh5+ ♔d8 26 ♕g5+ ♔e8 27 ♕g6+ ♔d8 28 ♕g5+ ♔e8 ½-½ Wojtkiewicz-Shlekis, Vilnius 1980) 24 ♗d3 ♖g8 25 ♗e2 ♖g5 26 ♕d1 ♕xc5 27 ♗h5+ ♖xh5 28 ♕xh5+ ♔d8 29 ♕h8+ ♔d7 30 ♖d1+ ♗d6 31 ♕h7+ ♔e8 32 ♕g8+ ♔d7 33 ♕f7+ with a draw, Munoz-Labarca, corr 1985.

1c) **22 ♕d3** ♗c5+ 23 ♔h1 ♔e7 and now:

1c1) **24 ♕g6** ♔d6 25 ♖d1+ (25 ♕f6 leads to a draw as in C212) ♗d4 26 ♖xd4+ exd4 27 ♕g3+ (this is why the same line could not be played in C212) e5 (27...♔d7? 28 ♕g7+ wins) 28 c5+ ♔d5 29 ♗f3+ e4 30 ♕g5+ ♔c4 31 ♕c1+ ♔d5 32 ♗d1 (a final winning attempt) ♕xa2! 33 ♕g5+ (33 ♗b3+? ♕xb3 and Black wins) ♔c4 34 ♕c1+ ½-½ Kasparov-Rashkovsky, USSR Ch 1979.

1c2) **24 ♕f3** is an attempt to emulate the analogous line of C212, but Black has an interesting extra possibility in 24...♔d6 25 ♖d1+ ♗d4 26 ♖xd4+ exd4 27 ♕f4+ e5 28 ♕f6+ ♗e6 29 ♖xh8 ♖f7! when the lines **30 c5+** ♔xc5 31 ♕xe5+ ♗d5, **30 ♖d8+** ♔c7 and **30 ♕d8+** ♔c5 all favour Black, since White is threatened by ...♕d1+. Of course Black can play as in C212 if he wishes, with a draw.

1c3) **24 ♕e4**. This appears to be similar to the corresponding line in C212.

1c4) **24 ♕g3!** (the direct method is the best way to exploit the availability of g3) ♔d6 (24...♖e8 25 ♕xe5 ♗d6 26 ♕g5+ ♔d7 27 c5 wins) 25 ♖d1+ ♕xd1+ 26 ♗xd1 ♖f7 27 ♗f3 h4 28 ♕e1! ♖f4 29 ♗e4! ♖hf8 30 ♖b1 ♗d7 (30...♔d7 31 h3 ♗f2 32 ♖d1+ ♗d4 33 ♗f3 ± Preussner-S.Wittmann, corr) 31 h3 with some advantage for White, Levchenkov-Roze, Riga 1981.

2) **20...♖d7** and now:

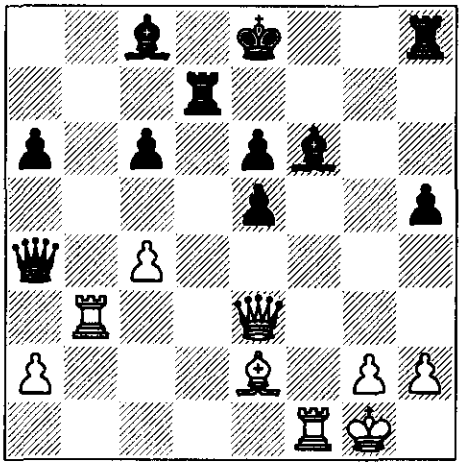
2a) **21 ♕b2** ♖f8! (not 21...♗g7 22 ♖a3 ♖d2? 23 ♕xd2 ♕xa3 24 ♕g5! ±, although 22...e4 transposes to line 2b) 22 ♖a3 e4 23 ♗xh5+ (23 ♖xf6? ♖d1+! 24 ♗xd1 ♕xd1+ 25 ♔f2 ♖xf6+ 26 ♕xf6 ♕d2+ wins for Black, Z.Ivanov-Palevich, USSR 1982) ♔e7 24 ♕xf6+ ♖xf6 25 ♖xa4 is roughly equal.

2b) **21 ♕c3** ♗g7 22 ♖a3 e4 23 ♕xg7 ♖xg7 24 ♖xa4 ♖g5 (24...c5 25 ♖f4 ♔e7 26 ♖h4 ♔d6 27 g3 ♔e5 28 ♖a3 ♖f7 29 ♖b3 ♖b7 30 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 31 ♖xh5+ ♖xh5 32 ♗xh5 ♔d4 ∓ Hakki-Hölzl, Lucerne OL 1982) 25 ♖f4 ♖e5 26 ♖a3 ♔e7 27 ♖h4!? (fixing the h-pawn on a light square; 27 ♔f2 h4 28 ♔e3 ♖g5 29 ♖g4 ♖xg4 30 ♗xg4 e5 31 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 32 ♔xe4 ♖g8 33 g3 ♔e6 34 ♔f3 ½-½ Timman-Ljubojević, London 1980) ♔f6 28 ♔f2 ♔g5 29 g3 ♖f8+ 30 ♔e3 ♔g6 31 ♖b3 ± Goldberg-Steffan, corr 1981.

The evidence of these games is rather conflicting. In all probability the ending is microscopically better for White.

2c) **21 ♕e3** *(D)* and now:

B



2c1) **21...♖f7** 22 ♖xf6 (22 ♕c5 ♗e7 23 ♕xe5 transposes into the main line) ♖xf6 23 ♕xe5 with a final branch:

2c11) **23...♖fh6** (risky) 24 ♖b8 ♔f7 (24...♔e7 25 ♕g7+ ♔d6 26 c5+

♔d5 27 ♗f3+ ♔c4 28 ♕e5! +–; 24...0-0 25 ♕g5+ ♔h7 26 ♖xc8 ♖xc8 27 ♗d3+ wins, Boto-Sose, Yugoslavia 1990) 25 ♕c7+ ♔f6 26 ♖b1 e5! and although White can easily force a draw, there is no straightforward win.

2c12) **23...♔e7** 24 ♖d3! ♖f5 25 ♕c7+ ♔f6 26 ♖g3 surprisingly gives White a decisive attack.

2c13) **23...♕xa2** 24 ♕xf6 ♕xb3 25 ♕xh8+ ♔d7 26 ♕d4+ ♔c7 27 ♗xh5 a5 28 h4 a4 29 ♗d1 ♕b4! 30 ♕e5+ ♔b7 31 h5 a3! 32 h6 a2 33 h7 a1♕! 34 ♕xa1 ♕e1+ with a draw (analysis by Krnić and Veličković).

2c2) **21...♕xa2** 22 ♖xf6 ♕a1+ 23 ♗f1 (23 ♔f2 ♕d4 24 ♖xe6+ ♔d8 25 ♕xd4 ♖f8+ 26 ♖f3 ♖xf3+ 27 ♗xf3 exd4 28 ♖xc6 ± Prié-Touzane, Nice 1994) and now:

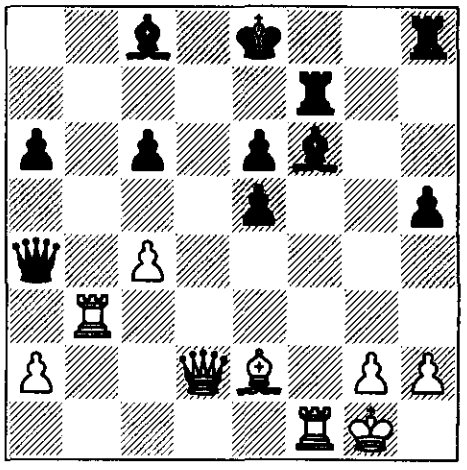
2c21) **23...♕d4** 24 ♖xe6+ ♔d8 25 ♖xc6 ♖f8 26 ♕xd4 ♖xd4 27 ♗e2 ± h4? (27...♔d7) 28 ♖b8 ♔d7 29 ♖c5! ± Timman-Hjartarson, Linares 1989.

2c22) **23...♖d1** 24 ♖c3 ♖e1? 25 ♕g3! +– ♕b1 26 ♖d3 ♗d7 27 ♕g7 1-0 Walker-Schuller, corr 1985.

2c23) **23...♖g7** 24 ♖b8 (24 ♖f2 ♕d4 25 ♖d3 ♕xe3 26 ♖xe3 ♖g5 27 h4 ♖g4 28 g3 ♔e7 = Velimirović-Marjanović, Yugoslav Ch 1982) ♔e7 25 ♖f2 ♕d4 26 ♕f3 e4 27 ♕f4 ♖g4 (27...♖hg8 28 ♔h1 e5 29 ♕f6+ ♔d7 30 ♖fb2! ± Vasto-Jasaitis, corr 1984; 27...♖gg8 28 ♖bb2 ♖f8 29 ♕g5+ ♔e8 and now White has an immediate draw, but I would not surprised if he had something stronger) 28 ♕c7+ ♕d7 29 ♖xc8 ♕xc7 30 ♖xc7+ ♔d6 31 ♖a7 e3 32 ♖e2 ♖e4 33 ♖xa6 ♔c5 34 ♖a3 1-0 Beliavsky-Timman, Tilburg 1981.

2c3) **21...♗g7** 22 ♕g5 (22 ♖b8 ♔d8 23 ♕b6+ ♔e7 24 ♕c5+ ♔d8 =) ♕a5 23 ♖b8 ♕c7 24 ♗xh5+ ♖xh5 25 ♕xh5+ ♔d8 26 ♕g5+ ♔e8 27 ♖b3! (White correctly avoids the repetition) ♕a7+ 28 ♔h1 a5?! 29 ♖h3 ♗a6 30 ♖h8+ 1-0 Van der Kooij-Magnusson, corr 1987.

We return to the main line after 20...♖f7 *(D)*:



21 ♕d6

Or:

1) **21 ♗xh5?!** ♖xh5 22 ♖b8 ♔f8 23 ♖xf6 ♖xf6 24 ♖xc8+ ♔g7 25 ♕d8 ♖f1+! 26 ♔xf1 ♕xc4+ 27 ♔e1 ♕e4+ 28 ♔d1 ♕b1+ with excellent winning chances for Black, Pyhälä-Välkesalmi, Finnish Ch 1980.

2) **21 ♖b8** 0-0 (21...♔e7 22 ♖d1! ±) 22 ♗xh5 ♖d7! (22...♖g7? 23 ♖xf6 ♖xf6 24 ♖xc8+ ♔h7 25 ♕d3+ ♖f5 26 ♕h3! +–) and now:

2a) **23 ♕e3** ♕xa2 24 ♖xc8 ♖xc8 25 ♕h3 ♕xc4 26 ♖xf6 ♖f8 27 ♖g6+ ♖g7 28 ♖xg7+ ♔xg7 29 ♕g3+ ♔h8 30 ♕xe5+ ♔h7 –+ Nicholson-Nunn, London 1979.

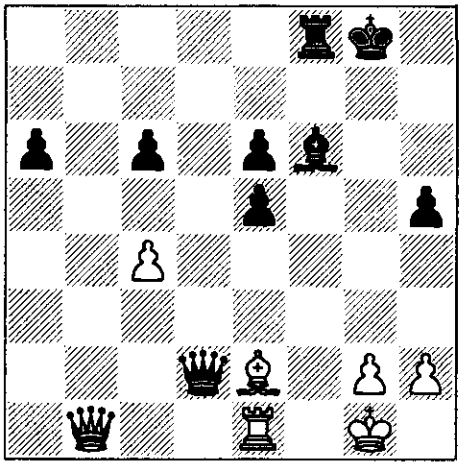
2b) **23 ♕c1** ♕xa2! 24 ♖xf6 (24 ♖b2 ♕a3 25 ♖f3 ♕c5+ 0-1 Colias-Nunn, London 1985) ♖xf6 25 ♕g5+ ♖g7 26 ♖xc8+ ♔h7 27 ♗g6+ ♖fxg6

28 ♕h5+ ♖h6 29 ♖h8+ ♔xh8 30 ♕xh6+ ♔g8 31 ♕xe6+ ♖f7 and White does not have perpetual check, Gofshtein-Scherbakov, Beltsy 1979.

2c) **23 ♕e2** ♕a3 24 ♖xc8 ♖xc8 25 ♖xf6 ♕c1+ 26 ♖f1 ♕g5 27 ♕f3 ♕f4 28 ♕h3 ♕xc4 (28...♕d4+ 29 ♖f2 ♕xc4 30 ♕g3+ ♖g7 31 ♗f7+ ♔h8 32 ♕xe5 ♕c1+ 33 ♖f1 ♕g5 ∓) 29 ♗g4 ♔g7? (29...♖e7 ∞) 30 ♗xe6 ♕d4+ 31 ♔h1 ♕f4 32 ♗c4 ♕d4, Strand-Szilagyi, corr 1983, and now 33 ♖f3 wins for White.

2d) **23 ♕f2** ♖c7 (23...♖dd8 24 ♖b3! with a dangerous attack) 24 ♕b6 ♖g7 25 ♖xf6 ♖xf6 26 ♖xc8+ ♔h7 27 ♕d8 ♖xg2+! leads to a draw.

3) **21 ♖bf3** ♖d7! 22 ♕b2 ♖b7 23 ♖b3 (after 23 ♕d2 Black need not repeat moves but can play 23...♗e7 with the idea 24 ♗d3 ♗d7 and the king escapes to the queenside) 0-0! 24 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 25 ♕xb7 ♕xa2 26 ♖e1 (26 ♗xh5 e4 27 ♔h1 ♕xc4 28 ♕b1 ♕d3 and Black wins, Velimirović-Nunn, Skara Echt 1980) ♕d2 27 ♕b1 *(D)* and now:



3a) **27...h4** 28 ♗f3 ♕d4+ (a safer line is 28...♗g7 29 h3 ♖xf3 30 gxf3 ♕g5+ 31 ♔h1 ♕g3 32 ♕b8+ ♔h7 33 ♕b1+ ♔g8 34 ♕e4 c5 35 ♖e2 ♕xh3+ 36 ♔g1 ♕f5 leading to a balanced position, Kandyba-Bangiev, corr 1988) 29 ♔h1 ♕xc4 30 ♖c1 ♕b5 31 ♕g6+ ♗g7 32 ♕xe6+ ♔h8 33 h3 (despite the two-pawn deficit White has a dangerous attack) c5 34 ♕g4 ♖f4 35 ♕h5+ ♔g8 36 ♖d1 ♖d4 37 ♗d5+ ♖xd5 38 ♖xd5 ♕f1+ 39 ♔h2 ♕f4+ 40 ♔g1 ♕e3+ 41 ♔f1 ♕f4+ 42 ♕f3 ♕c1+ 43 ♖d1 1-0 Bastianelli-Prada, corr 1989.

3b) **27...e4!** 28 ♗xh5 ♗c3 gives Black at least a slight advantage, for example **29 ♖d1** ♕g5 ∓, **29 ♖e2** ♕g5 ∓ or **29 ♖f1** ♕d3 30 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 31 ♕f1+ ♔e7 ∓.

4) **21 ♕c3** c5 22 ♖xf6 (what else?) ♖xf6 23 ♕xe5 ♖fh6! (23...0-0 24 ♖g3+ ♔f7 25 ♕xc5 +–; 23...♖hh6 24 ♗xh5+ ♖xh5 25 ♕xh5+ ♖f7 26 ♕h8+ draws) 24 ♕xc5 ♔f7 (24...♕d7 25 ♖d3 ♕b7 26 ♖b3 is a draw) 25 ♕e5 ♕d7 26 ♖f3+ (26 ♖g3 ♖8h7 27 h4 is murky, but Black probably retains some advantage by 27...♕e7 28 ♗d3 ♔f8 29 ♗xh7 ♖xh7 30 ♕f4+ ♖f7 31 ♕h6+ ♔e8 32 ♕xh5 ♕f6) ♔e8 27 ♖g3 ♕a7+! 28 c5 (28 ♔h1 h4 29 ♖g7 ♕f2 30 h3 ♖6h7 –+) ♕b7 29 ♗d3 ♖f8 30 ♖g7 ♕d5 31 ♕c7 ♕d4+ 0-1 Müller-Szilagyi, corr 1982.

It seems that Black has at least a draw in all the above lines, so 21 ♕d6 is the critical move.

21 ... ♗e7

21...c5 22 ♖b8 ♕d7 23 ♕xc5 ♕d4+ 24 ♕xd4 exd4 leaves Black with a bad ending after 25 ♖xf6, while the ingenious 21...♖d7 22 ♕xe6+ ♗e7 is strongly met by 23 ♕xe5 ♖h6 24 ♖g3 ±.

22 ♕xe5

22 ♕b8 is untested. One possible line is **22...♖xf1+ 23 ♗xf1 0-0 24 ♖g3+ ♔f7** and now:

1) **25 ♕xe5** ♔e8! 26 ♕xh5+ ♔d8 27 ♖d3+ ♗d7 –+.

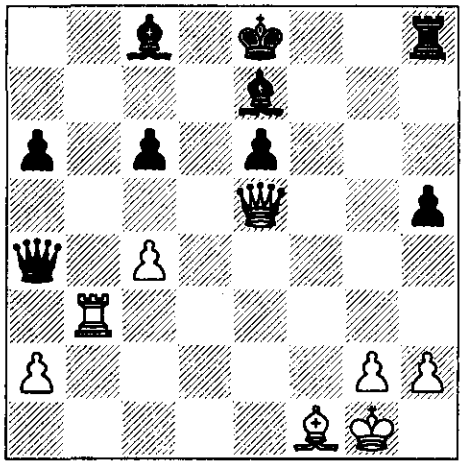
2) **25 ♗e2** ♕b4! 26 ♗xh5+ (26 ♖f3+ ♔g6 27 ♗d3+ ♔h6 28 ♕xe5 ♕c5+ wins) ♔f6 27 ♖g6+ ♔f5 and the exchange of queens is forced.

3) **25 ♖f3+** ♗f6! 26 ♕c7+ ♔g8 27 ♖xf6 ♖xf6 28 ♕xc8+ ♔g7 29 ♕c7+ ♔h6 30 ♕xe5 ♖xf1+ 31 ♔xf1 ♕xc4+ with an extra pawn for Black, although a draw is very likely.

22 ... ♖xf1+

23 ♗xf1 *(D)*

White can force an immediate draw by 23 ♔xf1 0-0+ (23...♖f8+? 24 ♔g1 transposes to the next note) 24 ♔g1 h4 25 ♕h5 (there is nothing Black can do to avoid the coming perpetual) ♕xa2 26 ♕g6+ ♔h8 ½-½ Bouaziz-Tukmakov, Las Palmas IZ 1982 (and various other games!). The main line also appears to be a draw, so there is little to choose between these moves.



B

23 ... ♖h7

The only move, for example:

1) **23...♖f8** 24 ♗e2 ♖f5 25 ♗xh5+ ♖xh5 26 ♕xh5+ ♔d8 27 ♕h8+! (27 ♖d3+? ♗d7 28 ♕h8+ ♔c7 29 ♕d4 c5 30 ♕f4+ ♔c6 31 ♕e4+ ♔c7 allowed Black to escape in Velimirović-Musil, Maribor 1980; indeed White even lost after spurning the perpetual) ♔c7 (27...♔d7 loses to 28 ♖d3+) 28 ♕g7 ♔d8 29 ♕d4+ and now the three lines **29...♔c7** 30 ♕b6+ ♔d7 31 ♖d3+ ♔e8 32 ♕c7, **29...♔e8** 30 ♖b8 ♗c5 31 ♖xc8+ ♔f7 32 ♖c7+ ♔e8 33 ♕xc5 ♕d1+ 34 ♔f2 ♕c2+ 35 ♔g3 ♕g6+ 36 ♔h4 and **29...♗d7** 30 ♕h8+ ♗e8 31 ♖d3+ all win for White.

2) **23...♖h6** 24 ♖b8 ♔d7 25 ♕d4+ ♗d6 (25...♔c7 26 ♕a7+ ♔d6 27 c5+ and wins) 26 ♕g7+ ♗e7 (or 26...♔d8 27 ♖b3!) 27 ♕xh6 +– Van der Kooij-Steger, corr 1985.

24 ♗d3

24 ♖b8?! ♔d7 25 ♕d4+ ♗d6 26 ♕a7+ ♔d8! (26...♗c7 is an immediate draw) 27 ♖xc8+ ♔xc8 28 ♕xh7 ♗c5+ 29 ♔h1 ♕xa2 ∓ Chiburdanidze-Alexandria, Borzhomi wom Wch (5) 1981. White's bishop is passively placed and the black a-pawn can advance quickly.

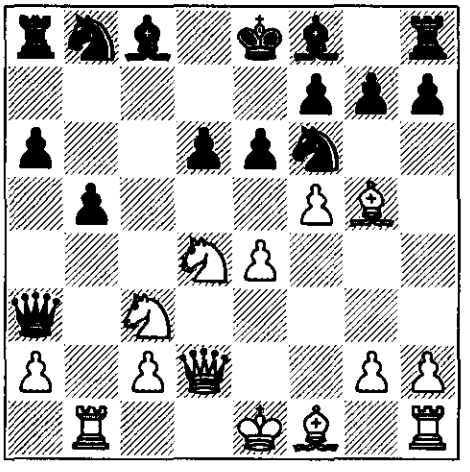
24 ... ♖h6

The result should be a draw after 25 ♗e2 (25 ♕c7 ♗d7! 26 ♖b8+ ♔f7 defends because 27 ♕xd7 ♕d1+ 28 ♔f2 ♖f6+ leads to mate) c5 26 ♗xh5+ ♖xh5 27 ♕xh5+ ♔d8 28 ♖d3+ ♗d7 29 ♕h8+ ♔c7 30 ♕e5+ ♔c6 31 ♕b8 ♕xc4 32 ♕a8+ ♔b6 33 ♖xd7 ♕c1+ 34 ♔f2 ♕b2+ 35 ♔f3 ½-½ Kelstrup-Ingerslev, corr 1981.

7 Poisoned Pawn: 9 ♖b1 ♕a3 10 f5: Other Lines

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♕b6 8 ♕d2 ♕xb2 9 ♖b1 ♕a3 10 f5 ♘c6

10...b5 is the only realistic alternative, but it looks suspicious to play another non-developing move. In reply, White may delay fxe6 for a couple of moves, but for convenience all variations with fxe6 are gathered together in line 3 below. After **10...b5** *(D)*, White may play:



1) **11 ♖b3** ♕a5 (11...♕c5 and now not 12 ♗xf6 gxf6 13 ♘cxb5 axb5 14 ♖c3 ♗h6! 15 ♕d3 ♕b4! but simply 12 fxe6 fxe6 transposing to line 3) 12 ♗xf6 gxf6 13 ♗e2 b4 14 fxe6 fxe6 (14...bxc3 15 ♖xc3 ♕d8 16 ♗h5! +–) is line 3.

2) **11 ♘cxb5** (incorrect) axb5 12 ♗xb5+ ♗d7 13 fxe6 fxe6 14 ♘xe6 ♕xa2 15 ♗xf6 gxf6! 16 ♖b3 ♕a5 17 c3 ♕a1+ 18 ♔f2 ♕a2 –+ Kosanović-Marjanović, Yugoslav Ch 1986.

3) **11 fxe6** fxe6 and now:

3a) **12 ♗xf6** gxf6 13 ♗e2 ♗h6 ∓.

3b) **12 ♖b3** and now:

3b1) **12...♕c5?** 13 ♘cxb5! (13 ♗xf6 gxf6 14 ♗e2 ♗d7 ∞) ♘xe4 (13...axb5 14 ♖c3 ♘xe4 15 ♖xc5 ♘xd2 16 ♖xc8+ ♔d7 17 ♖d8+ wins for White) 14 ♕a5! ♔f7 (taking on g5 leaves Black the exchange down for inadequate compensation) 15 ♗e3 ♗d7 16 ♗e2 ♘c6 17 0-0+ ♘f6 18 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 19 ♘d4 ± with an enormous initiative for the pawn, Velimirović-Marjanović, Yugoslav Ch 1979.

3b2) **12...♕a5** 13 ♗xf6 gxf6 14 ♗e2 b4 (14...h5 15 0-0 ♗e7 16 ♔h1 ♗d7 17 ♕d1 b4, Bogdanov-Glushenko, corr 1970 and now 18 ♕b1! ±) 15 0-0 ♗g7 (15...bxc3 16 ♖xc3 ♕d8 17 ♗h5+ is very dangerous after 17...♔d7 18 ♘xe6 or 17...♔e7 18 ♖xf6) 16 ♘d1 0-0, Hartston-Lee, Marlow 1967, and now 17 ♗c4 ± is best according to Hartston.

3c) **12 ♗e2** ♗e7 (12...b4 13 ♗xf6 ♕xc3 14 ♗h5+ ♔d7 15 ♗g5 ♗e7 16 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 17 ♖xb4 ♕xd2+ 18 ♔xd2 ± Tischbierek-Mikhalchishin, Leipzig 1979) 13 ♗f3 (13 0-0 b4) and now:

3c1) **13...♖a7** 14 ♗e3 e5 15 ♘f5 ♖d7 16 ♗b6 b4 17 ♖b3 bxc3 18 ♖xc3 ♕xa2 19 ♖xc8+ is clearly better for White, Bagrowski-Kalwak, corr 1992.

3c2) **13...0-0** 14 0-0 (14 e5 dxe5 15 ♗xa8 exd4 offers Black reasonable prospects) ♖a7 15 ♗e3 ♖b7 16 g4 e5 17 ♘f5 ♗e6 18 g5 ♘e8 19 ♘d5 with a dangerous initiative for White, Tall-Holst, corr 1976.

3c3) **13...e5** 14 ♘b3 (14 ♘f5! was critical) ♘bd7 15 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 16 ♘d5 ♖a7 17 0-0 0-0 and White has inadequate compensation, Palacios-Bernabe Pajares, corr 1983.

Line 3b seems to be promising for White and it is hard to believe that 10...b5 is really a satisfactory continuation.

Moves other than 10...b5 and 10...♘c6 are definitely inferior:

a) **10...♗e7** 11 fxe6 fxe6 12 ♗c4 d5 (12...e5 13 ♘e6 ♗xe6 14 ♗xe6 b5 15 0-0 ♘c6 16 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 17 ♘d5 ♕c5+ 18 ♔h1 ♘d4 19 ♖xf6! gxf6 20 ♘xf6+ ♔e7 21 ♘d5+ ♔e8 22 ♕g5, Melnick-Burrows, corr 1971, and now even after the best defence 22...♕a7, 23 ♗g4! is winning for White) 13 exd5 ♗b4 (13...♕c5 14 ♗b3 ♘xd5 15 ♘xd5 exd5 16 0-0! ♗xg5 17 ♕xg5 ♕xd4+ 18 ♔h1 ♘c6 19 ♖bd1 ♕xd1 20 ♕e3+ 1-0 Fridh-Steiner, Vesely 1967) 14 ♖b3 ♘e4 15 ♖xa3 ♘xd2 16 ♔xd2 ♗xa3 17 dxe6 with a distinct white advantage, Schwertel-Szilagyi, corr 1984.

b) **10...♕c5** 11 fxe6 fxe6 12 ♗xf6 gxf6 13 ♘a4 ♗h6 14 ♕xh6 ♕xd4 15 ♘b6 ♖a7 (15...♕c3+ 16 ♕d2 +–) 16 ♕g7 ♖f8 17 ♗e2 +–.

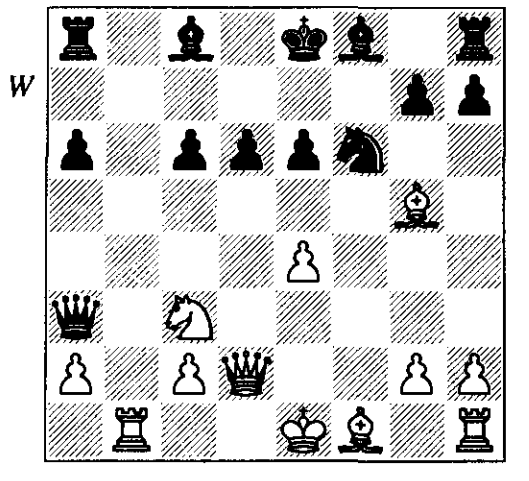
c) **10...♕a5** 11 fxe6 fxe6 12 ♗c4 d5 13 e5 ♗b4 (13...dxc4 14 0-0! is winning for White after 14...♘d5 15 ♕f2 ♕c7 16 ♘e4 followed by ♘d6+ or 14...♘g4 15 ♕f4 ♘xe5 16 ♖be1 ♘bd7 17 ♕f7+! ♘xf7 18 ♖xe6+ ♗e7 19 ♖xe7+ ♔f8 20 ♘e6+ ♔g8 21 ♖e8+) 14 ♖xb4 ♕xb4 15 ♗e2 ♘g8 16 0-0 ♘c6? (White was better anyway) 17 ♘xc6 bxc6 18 ♘b5! c5 19 ♕xb4 cxb4 20 ♘c7+ and wins, Maeder-Kondratiev, corr 1973.

d) **10...e5** 11 ♗xf6 gxf6 12 ♘d5! exd4 (12...♔d8 13 ♘b3 ♘d7 14 h4 ♘c5 15 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 16 ♖h3 ♗e7 17 ♖c3 ♕d4 18 ♕xd4 exd4 19 ♖c7 +– Nevostruev-V.N.Kozlov, Vladivostok 1990) 13 ♘c7+ ♔d8 14 ♘xa8 ♕xa2 15 ♖b3 (15 ♕b4 was an earlier theoretical suggestion, but the rook move appears better) ♕a1+ 16 ♔f2 ♘d7 17 ♗b5! ♕xh1 18 ♕a5+ ♔e7 19 ♘c7 ♗h6 20 ♘d5+ ♔e8 21 ♘xf6+ ♔e7 22 ♘d5+ ♔e8 23 ♕c7 ♗e3+ 24 ♖xe3 dxe3+ 25 ♘xe3 ♔f8 26 ♗xd7 ♕a1 27 ♕d8+ 1-0 Levchenkov-Zilbershtein, Nikolaev 1981.

11 fxe6

11 ♘xc6 bxc6 12 fxe6 (12 ♖b3 ♕a5 13 ♗d3 ♗e7 14 0-0 h6 15 ♗e3 ♘g4 16 ♗f4 ♘e5 ∓ was too slow, Barczay-Marjanović, Ruma 1978) is a mistake due to 12...♗xe6!, as is 11 ♗xf6 gxf6 12 ♗e2, this time on account of 12...♗h6.

11	**...**	**fxe6**
12	**♘xc6**	**bxc6** *(D)*



Now there is a branch:

A: 13 ♗e2
B: 13 e5

Or 13 ♗xf6 gxf6 14 ♗e2 (14 e5? ♗h6! 15 ♕d3 dxe5 16 ♗e2 0-0 17 0-0 ♖a7 18 ♕c4 ♖g7 –+ Brito-Ftačnik, Hastings 1980/1) ♖g8 (not the only decent move; 14...♕c5 15 ♘a4 ♕e5 16 0-0 d5 was good for Black, Hennings-Kavalek, Leipzig 1965, as was 14...♗e7 15 ♗h5+ ♔d8 16 ♗f3 ♖a7 17 ♖b3 ♕a5 18 0-0 ♖g8 19 ♖fb1 ♖g5 20 ♔h1 ♔c7 21 ♕e3 ♕c5, Brooks-Ftačnik) 15 0-0 (15 ♗h5+ ♔e7 and now 16 0-0 ♕c5+ simply drops a piece) ♕c5+ 16 ♔h1 ♕g5 17 ♕xg5 ♖xg5 18 ♖xf6 ♗g7 19 ♖f3 ♖c5 20 ♖bf1!?, Bertin-Constantin, corr 1981, 20...♖a7! ∓.

Timman's 13 ♗e2 is one of the few truly original ideas to have been developed in the Poisoned Pawn over the past 15 years. It became very popular in the 1980s, but gradually antidotes were found and it appears that the main line gives White no more than a draw by repetition. 13 ♗e2 has now joined the long list of failed white attempts to refute the Poisoned Pawn.

A)

13 ♗e2 ♗e7

Or **13...♕a5** (this is a poor square for the queen, setting Black up for a ♘d5 trick if he castles; 13...d5 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 ♗h5+ ♔e7, Goldberg-Mowsziszian, Dresden 1993, and now 16 exd5 cxd5 17 ♘xd5+ exd5 18 ♕xd5 ♖a7 19 ♔f2 +–) **14 0-0 ♗e7 15 ♗f3!** (15 ♔h1 ♕d8 16 e5! dxe5 17 ♕e3 ♕d4 18 ♕h3 is good for White after 18...e4 19 ♗h5+ ♘xh5 20 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 21 ♕xh5, or 18...0-0 19 ♗d3 g6 20 ♗xg6! hxg6 21 ♕h6 ♖f7 22 ♗xf6 ♖xf6 23 ♖xf6 ♗xf6 24 ♕xg6+ ♗g7 25 ♘e4! ♗d7 26 c3 +– Oll-Smirin, Nikolaev 1983; however 15...♖a7 and 17...0-0 are possible improvements) and now:

1) **15...0-0** 16 ♘d5 ♕xd2 (the lines 16...♕d8 17 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 18 ♖fd1 and 16...♗d8 17 ♘e7+ ♔h8 18 ♕xd6 are ±) 17 ♘xe7+ ♔f7 18 ♗xd2 ♔xe7 19 e5 is virtually winning for White.

2) **15...♗d7** 16 ♖b7 h6 17 ♗e3 0-0 18 ♘d5 ♕d8, Timman-Sunye, Thessaloniki OL 1984, and now 19 ♘b6 ♖b8 20 ♖xb8 ♕xb8 21 e5 ♗d8 22 ♘xd7 ♘xd7 23 exd6 ±.

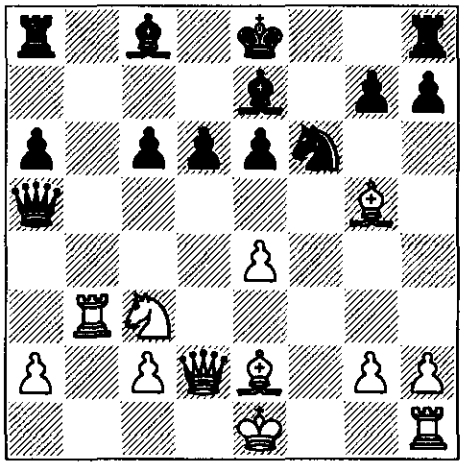
3) **15...♖a7** 16 e5 dxe5 17 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 18 ♗xc6+ ♔f8 (18...♔f7 19 ♕f2! ♖c7 20 ♘e4 ♖xc6 21 ♘xf6 ♕c5 22 ♕xc5 ♖xc5 23 ♘e4+ wins) 19 ♖b8! ♕c5+ (19...♕c7 20 ♘e4 +–) 20 ♔h1 ♔f7 21 ♘e4! ♕xc6 22 ♘xf6 gxf6 23 ♕f2 ± Timman-Ljubojević, Tilburg 1986.

4) **15...e5** 16 ♗h5+! ♘xh5 17 ♗xe7 ♘f4 (17...♕c5+ 18 ♔h1 ♔xe7 19 ♕g5+ ♔e8 20 ♕xh5+ g6 21 ♕h4! ♕c4 22 ♘d5! +–) 18 ♕xd6 (18 ♖xf4! exf4 19 ♗xd6 gives White a very dangerous attack) ♕xc3 19 ♖xf4 (19 ♕d8+ ♔f7 20 ♕xh8 ♕d4+! is a draw after 21 ♔h1 ♗h3 22 ♖xf4+ exf4 23 ♕xa8 ♗xg2+ 24 ♔xg2 ♕xe4+ or unclear after 21 ♖f2 ♔xe7 22 ♕xg7+ ♔d6) exf4 20 ♗h4 ♔f7 21 ♕e7+ ♔g6 22 ♕g5+ ♔f7 ½-½ C.Hartman-Dževlan, Stockholm 1995.

14 0-0

Or **14 ♖b3** (the advantage of playing this before 0-0 is that Black has

to retreat to the inferior square a5, owing to 14...♕c5 15 ♗e3 ♕e5 16 ♗d4 ♕a5 17 e5! and now 17...♘d5 18 exd6 ± Namyslo-Astengo, Biel Open 1994 or 17...♘d7 18 exd6 ±) **♕a5** *(D)* and now:



1) **15 0-0** with another branch:

1a) **15...0-0** is bad, transposing to the note to Black's 15th in the main line.

1b) **15...♕d8!** 16 ♗xf6 (16 ♕e3 0-0 17 e5 ♘d5 18 ♗xe7 ♖xf1+ 19 ♗xf1 ♕xe7 20 exd6 ♕xd6 21 ♘e4 ♕e5 22 ♕d3 ♗d7 23 c4 ♘f4 24 ♕xd7 ♕xe4 25 ♖b7 ♕e3+ 26 ♔h1 ♕e5 = Yudasin-Stempin, Leipzig 1986) ♗xf6 17 ♗h5+ g6 18 ♕h6 ♗d4+ 19 ♔h1 ♕e7 (19...♕h4 20 ♘e2 ♕xh5 21 ♕xh5 gxh5 22 ♘xd4 c5 ∓ Laber-Kornasiewicz, corr 1988) 20 ♘e2 ♕g7 21 ♕d2 ♗e5 22 ♗g4 ♖f8 ∓ Bartek-Cimra, Slovakian Ch 1994.

1c) **15...♖a7!** 16 ♗xf6 (16 e5 dxe5 17 ♗xf6 ♕c5+ 18 ♔h1 ♗xf6 19 ♘e4 ± Ratajczyk-Grigoriew, corr 1992, is an interesting idea, but 16...♕xe5 appears better, for example 17 ♗f4 ♕a5 18 ♗xd6 ♖d7 19 ♖b8 0-0 −+) gxf6 17 ♖b8 (17 ♕h6 ♕g5 18 ♕xg5 fxg5 19 ♖b8 ♔d8 ∓ De Jong-Daamen, corr 1986) 0-0 (17...♔d7 18 ♖fb1 ♖g8 19 ♕d3 ♔c7 20 ♔h1 ♕g5 21 ♗f3 ♗b7 22 ♖xg8 ♕xg8 23 ♘a4 with a double-edged position, Oll-Neverov, Tallinn 1986) 18 ♖f3 d5! (18...♕e5? 19 ♕h6 f5 20 ♖h3 ♗f6 21 ♗xa6! ± Timman-Ljubojević, Tilburg 1985) 19 exd5 cxd5 20 ♕h6 ♗c5+ 21 ♔h1 ♕c7 ∓ Modena-Poli, corr 1989.

2) **15 ♗h5+** g6 16 0-0 and now:

2a) **16...♘xh5** 17 ♗xe7 ♕c5+ 18 ♔h1 ♔xe7 19 ♘a4 ♕e5 20 ♖bf3 (20 ♕f2 is met by 20...♘f6! based on the point 21 ♘b6 ♗d7 22 ♘c4 ♕xh2+!) ♖b8 21 ♕f2! ♔d8! 22 ♖f7 c5 23 ♕h4+ g5 24 ♕xh5 ♗d7 25 ♕e2 ♗b5 26 ♕d2 ♗xf1 27 ♕a5+ ♔e8 28 ♕c7 ♗xg2+ 29 ♔xg2 ♕xe4+ 30 ♔g3 ♕e3+ 31 ♔g2 ♕e2+ 32 ♔g3 ½-½ Timman-Portisch, Hilversum m (1) 1984.

2b) **16...♕c5+** 17 ♔h1 gxh5 (or 17...0-0 18 ♗e2 ♕a7 19 ♗xf6 ♖xf6 20 ♖xf6 ♗xf6 21 ♕xd6 ♕e3 = Betko-Cimra, Slovakian Ch 1994) 18 ♗xf6 ♖f8 19 ♕h6 ♕c4 20 ♖bb1 (not 20 ♔g1? ♕xf1+) ♖b8 21 ♖bd1 ♖xf6 (21...e5 22 ♕xh5+ ♕f7 23 ♕e2 ♗xf6 24 ♖xd6 ∞ – Morgado) 22 ♖xf6 ♕xc3 23 ♕xh5+ ♔d8 24 ♖f7 ♖b7! (trying to win; 24...♕xc2 25 ♖xe7 is a draw, as is 24...♖b5 25 ♕xh7 ♕xc2 26 ♖xd6+! ♗d7 27 ♖xd7+ ♔xd7 28 ♖xe7+ ♔d8 29 ♖d7+ ♔c8 30 h4 ♕c1+ Erofeev-Wohl, corr 1989-90) 25 ♖df1, Morgado-Engel, corr 1986 and now 25...♖d7 26 ♖1f3 (26 ♖xh7 ♗f6 ∓) ♕e5 ∓.

2c) **16...♘xe4** 17 ♘xe4 ♕xd2 18 ♗xd2 gxh5 19 ♘f6+ ♗xf6 20 ♖xf6 ♖f8 21 ♖h6 ♖f7 ∓ Pugachev-Nevostruev, USSR 1988.

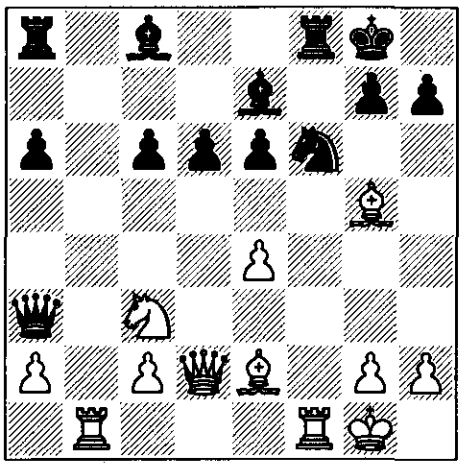
14 ... 0-0 *(D)*

Or:

1) **14...♖a7?** 15 e5 dxe5 16 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 17 ♗h5+ ♔e7 18 ♕e3! +– Hünerkopf-Ryan, Gausdal 1988.

2) **14...d5** is interesting. One line is **15 ♖bd1** h6?! 16 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 17 ♗h5+ ♔e7 (17...♔d8) 18 exd5 ♕c5+ 19 ♔h1 ♗xc3? (19...cxd5! 20 ♘a4 ♕d6 is better) 20 ♖f7+ ♔d8 21 ♕xc3! ♕xc3 22 dxe6+ ♗d7 23 ♖dxd7+ 1-0 Traczewski-Sluzalski, corr Poland 1990-1, but 15...♗b4 16 ♗xf6 gxf6 17 ♗h5+ ♔d8 18 ♖f3 ♕a5 is fine for Black. Thus White should prefer **15 exd5**, e.g. 15...exd5 16 ♗xf6 gxf6 (16...♗xf6 17 ♗h5+ ♔f8 18 ♘e4 ±) 17 ♗h5+ ♔d8 18 ♘xd5 cxd5 19 ♕xd5+ ♗d6 20 ♖fd1! +–.

3) **14...♖f8!?** (an interesting attempt to develop without allowing ♘d5) 15 ♔h1 (15 ♗f3 ♖a7 16 ♗e3 c5 17 e5 dxe5 18 g4 ♕a5 19 ♗c6+ ♘d7 20 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 ∓ Enders-Lingnau, Bundesliga 1992/3) ♕a5 16 ♗e3 c5 17 e5 dxe5 18 ♗f3 ♖a7 19 ♗c6+ ♔f7 20 ♘e4 ♕xd2 21 ♗xd2 ♗d7 ∓ *Mephisto*-Novikov, Berlin Summer 1992.



W

15 ♖b3

Or 15 ♔h1 ♖a7 (15...d5 16 e5 ♘d7 17 ♖xf8+ ♘xf8 18 ♖f1 ♖a7 19 ♕e3 ♕c5 20 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 21 ♗h5 g6 ∓ Seltmann-Petzold, corr 1987) 16 ♕e3 ♖d7 (16...♖b7 17 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 18 ♘d5 ♕xe3 19 ♘xe7+ ♔f7 20 ♗xe3 ♔xe7 21 e5 ♘e4 ∞ Vitolinš-Veingold, USSR 1983) 17 e5 dxe5 18 ♗d3 (18 ♕xe5 ♕d6 19 ♕a5 ♗d8! 20 ♕a4 ♕e5 ∓ Oll-Gavrikov, USSR 1st League 1983, or 18 ♕h3 ♖d4 19 ♗d3 e4 20 ♗xf6 exd3! 21 ♗xd4 dxc2 22 ♕g3 ♗f6 23 ♖bc1 ♗xd4 24 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 25 ♕d3 c5, given as ∓ by Oll and Veingold) ♕xc3 (18...h6!? 19 ♗xh6 gxh6 20 ♕xh6 ♗d8 and no convincing continuation is visible, for example 21 ♘e4 ♕e7 22 ♖f3 ♘xe4) 19 ♗xh7+ ♘xh7 20 ♕xc3 ♗xg5 21 ♕xe5 ♖e8!? (21...♖xf1+ 22 ♖xf1 ♖d8 23 ♕c7 ♗d7 24 ♖d1 ♘f8 25 ♕a5 ± Oll-Ubilava, USSR 1983) 22 ♖b8 ♖dd8 23 ♕c5 ♗f6 24 ♕c4 ♔h8 25 ♖e1 ♘f8 ∞ Eisen-Noble, corr 1990.

15 ... ♕c5+

Better than 15...♕a5 16 ♘d5 ♕d8 (16...♕xd2 17 ♘xe7+ ♔f7 18 ♗xd2 ♔xe7 19 e5 ♘d7 20 ♗g5+, 16...♗d8 17 ♕xa5 ♗xa5 18 ♘xf6+ gxf6 19 ♗h6 ♖f7 20 ♗h5 ♖e7 21 ♖g3+ ♔h8 22 ♖xf6 and 16...♕c5+ 17 ♗e3 cxd5 18 ♗xc5 ♘xe4 19 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 20 ♕a5 ♘xc5 21 ♖f3 +– Brustman-Wiese Jozwiak, Veliko Trnovo 1985, are no better) 17 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 18 ♖d3 (18 ♖bf3 ♗b7 19 ♗d3 e5 20 ♕f2 ♖ad8 21 ♕h4 ♖d7 22 ♗xf6 ♖xf6 23 ♖xf6 gxf6 24 ♖xf6 ± Schumi-Gochev, Eger 1989) ♕a7+ 19 ♔h1 (19 ♗e3 ♕e7 20 ♗g5 repeats) d5 20 ♗xf6 (20 ♖g3 ♘xe4 21 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 22 ♖f3+ ♔e8 23 ♕f4 ♘xg5 24 ♕f8+ ♔d7 25 ♕xg7+ ♔d6 26 ♕xg5 ∞ Dworakowska-Litinskaya, Polish Cht 1995) ♖xf6 21 ♖xf6 gxf6 22

♕h6 ♕e7 23 ♖g3+ ♔h8 24 e5 f5 25 ♕f6+ ♕xf6 26 exf6 ± Herbrechtsmeier-Hünerkopf, Bundesliga 1985.

16 ♗e3 ♕e5

17 ♗f4

17 ♗d4 ♕a5 18 ♗b6 is a draw by repetition.

17 ... ♕c5+

This appears safer than **17...♘xe4 18 ♘xe4** (18 ♕e3 ♖xf4! 19 ♕xf4 ♕xf4 20 ♖xf4 ♘c5 21 ♖b6 d5! ∓ Nielsen-Elwert, corr 1991, since 22 ♖xc6 is met by 22...♗b7 23 ♖b6 ♘d3!) **♕xe4 19 ♗xd6 ♖xf1+ 20 ♔xf1 ♗f6 21 ♗a3** (21 ♗f3 ♕a4 22 ♖b4 ♕xa2 23 ♗e5 a5! ∓ Herbrechtsmeier-Mudelsee, corr 1986) and now:

1) **21...♕e5** 22 ♗b2 ♕xh2 23 ♗xf6 gxf6 24 ♖h3 ♕c7 25 ♗d3 f5 26 ♕g5+ ♕g7 27 ♕d8+ ♕f8 28 ♖g3+ ♔f7 29 ♕c7+ ♔f6 30 ♕xh7 ♖b8 31 ♖g8 1-0 Billeter-Godebert, corr 1989.

2) **21...a5** 22 ♕d6 c5 23 ♗d3 ♕d5 24 ♗xc5 ♕xd6 25 ♗xd6 ♗a6 26 c4 ♔f7 27 ♔e2 ♗e7 28 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 29 ♖b6 ♖a7 30 ♔e3 ± Timman-Ribli, Amsterdam 1986.

3) **21...c5!** 22 ♗f3 (22 ♗xc5 ♗b7! ∓) ♕c4+ and now:

3a) **23 ♕e2** ♕xe2+ 24 ♔xe2 ♖a7 25 ♖b8 (25 ♔d3!? intending ♔c4 is untested) ♖c7 26 ♗b7 ♖xb7 27 ♖xc8+ ♔f7 28 ♖xc5 was equal after both 28...♗b2 29 ♖a5 ♖c7 30 ♖c5 ♖b7 31 ♖a5 ♖c7 ½-½ Sax-Kir.Georgiev, Wijk aan Zee 1989 and 28...♗e7 29 ♖a5 ♗xa3 30 ♖xa3 ♖b6 Grasis-Karklins, USSR 1988.

3b) **23 ♕d3** ♕xd3+ 24 cxd3 ♖a7 25 ♗xc5 ♖c7 26 d4 ♔f7 27 ♔e2 ♗d7 (27...e5 28 ♗d6 ♖c2+ 29 ♔d1 ♗f5 30 ♗d5+ ± Morgado-Sutkus, corr 1992) 28 ♖b6 ♗e7 29 ♖b7 ♖xb7 30 ♗xb7 ♗b5+ 31 ♔e3 ♗c4 32 a4?! (32 a3! was better according to Hertel) ♗d8 33 ♔e4 ♗b3 34 ♗c6 ♔f6 ½-½ Morgado-Hertel, corr 1988.

Although the endings arising in line 3 are probably drawn with accurate play, there seems little reason for Black to enter them when he has safe equality with the text move.

18 ♔h1

This appears to give Black the edge. Since the alternative 18 ♖f2 d5 19 ♗f3 ♕a7 20 e5 ♘d7 21 ♗e3 ♗c5 ∓ Petzold-Leisebein, corr 1987 is clearly bad for White, the best line is undoubtedly 18 ♗e3 with a draw by repetition.

18 ... ♘g4

Once again Black has a double-edged alternative: **18...d5 19 e5 ♘d7** (19...♘e4 20 ♘xe4 dxe4 21 ♖c3 ♕d5 22 ♕e3 c5 23 ♖d1 ½-½ Luther-Stratil, Uzhgorod 1988) **20 ♘a4 ♕a7 21 ♕c3 ♘c5 22 ♘xc5 ♗xc5 23 ♕h3** and now:

1) **23...g6** 24 ♖g3? (Ernst gives 24 ♖bf3 as ±, although I cannot see that it rates more than a ∞) ♕g7 25 ♗d3, Am.Rodriguez-Ernst, Subotica IZ 1987, and now 25...♖a7 ∓.

2) **23...♕e7** 24 ♖g3 g6 25 ♗d3 ♕g7 26 ♖gf3 ♖b8 27 c3 ♖b2 28 ♗h6 ♖xf3 29 ♕xf3 ♕e7 ∞ Fletcher-Micklethwaite, corr 1992.

19 h3

Not 19 ♗xg4 (19 ♘a4? ♘f2+) e5 20 ♘a4 (20 ♗xc8 ♖axc8 21 ♖b7 ♗g5 ∓) ♕c4 21 ♗e2 ♕xa4 22 ♗g5 ♖xf1+ 23 ♗xf1 ♗f8 ∓.

19 ... e5

19...♘e5 20 ♘a4 ♕a7 21 ♘b6 ♖b8 22 ♖fb1 ♔h8 23 ♗xe5 dxe5 24 ♘xc8 ♖fxc8 25 ♖xb8 ♖xb8 26

♖xb8+ ♕xb8 27 ♕d7 ♗c5 28 ♕d1 a5 29 ♗c4 ♕d6 ½-½ Kosanović-Buljovčić, Yugoslavia 1988.

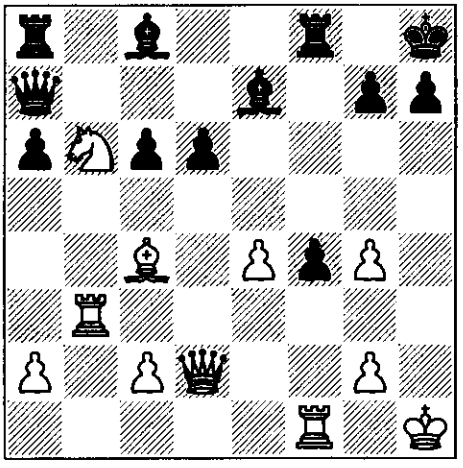
20 ♘a4 ♕a7

Not 20...♘f2+?? 21 ♖xf2 ♕xf2 22 ♗c4+ and White wins.

21 ♗c4+ ♔h8
22 hxg4 exf4
23 ♘b6 *(D)*

The safest line is probably 23 ♖xf4 ♗d7! 24 ♘b6 ♖xf4 25 ♕xf4 ♖f8 26 ♕g3 a5 27 ♘xd7 ♕xd7 28 ♖f3 ♕d8 29 ♕f2 ♖xf3 30 ♕xf3 ½-½ Balashov-Pigusov, Sverdlovsk 1987.

B



23 ... d5

We take Kasparov's choice as the main line. The alternative is **23...♖b8 24 ♖xf4 ♗d7** (24...♖xb6? 25 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 26 ♕f2 +–; 24...♖xf4? 25 ♕xf4 ♖xb6 26 ♕f7 +–) **25 ♘xd7** (25 g5 ♖xf4 26 ♕xf4 ♖f8 27 ♕g3, Vlasak-Pecenka, corr 1991, is best met by 27...a5 =) **♕xd7 26 ♖f5** (26 ♗xa6 ♕e6 27 g3 ♖a8 28 ♖xf8+, Enders-Stohl, Kecskemet 1989, and now Stohl gives 28...♖xf8 29 ♕e2 d5 30 ♗d3 ♕e5 31 exd5 ♕xg3 32 ♕xe7 ♕h3+ = – note that 32 ♗xh7 in this line is met by 32...♕h4+ 33 ♔g2 ♕xh7 34 ♕xe7 ♕xc2+ 35 ♔h3 ♖f6 ∓) and now:

1) **26...♖bd8?!** 27 ♖h5 d5 28 exd5 c5?? (28...♕xg4 ∞) 29 ♖bh3 ♕d6 30 ♖xh7+ ♔g8 31 ♖h8+ ♔f7 32 ♕f2+ ♔e8 33 ♖xf8+ 1-0 Angelov-S.Popov, corr 1992.

2) **26...♖xb3?!** 27 cxb3 ♕d8?! (27...♖xf5 28 gxf5 ♗f6 29 ♗xa6 ♕e7 ±) 28 ♗xa6 g6 29 ♖f3 ♗f6 30 ♕f2 ♔g7 31 ♗c4 ♕e7 32 ♕e3 c5? 33 ♕f4 +– Spraggett-A.Sokolov, St John Ct 1988.

3) **26...♕d8** 27 ♗xa6 ♗f6 28 g5 ♗e5 29 ♖xb8 ♕xb8 30 ♕b4 ♕e8 31 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 32 ♕b7 ♗f4 33 ♕xc6 ♗xg5 34 a4 ± Sutkus-Jovaisa, corr 1988.

4) **26...♕a7** and now:

4a) **27 ♖xb8** ♕xb8 28 ♕f2 (28 ♗xa6 ♕b1+ 29 ♔h2 ♕xa2 30 ♕e2 ♗f6 31 ♗c4 ♕b2 ∓) a5 29 g5 ♕d8 30 g6 (30 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 31 ♕b6 ♕d8 32 ♕xc6 ♗xg5 =) hxg6 31 ♖f3 ♖xf3 32 ♕xf3 ♗g5 33 ♕h3+ ♗h6 34 ♗f7 d5! 35 exd5 ♔h7! 36 dxc6 ♕d1+ 37 ♔h2 ♕d6+ 38 g3 ♕xc6 = Konovalov-Zablotsky, corr 1989.

4b) **27 g5** ♖xf5 28 exf5 ♖xb3 (not 28...d5? 29 ♕e3!) 29 axb3 (29 ♗xb3!? d5 30 ♕f4 ♕d7 31 g6 ♕d6 32 ♕xd6 ♗xd6 33 ♗a4 hxg6 34 fxg6 ♔g8 35 ♗xc6 ½-½ Morgado-Engel, corr 1988) d5 30 ♗f1 ♕b8 31 ♕e3 ♕d8 32 g6 ♗d6 33 g3 hxg6 34 fxg6 ♕e7 ½-½ Khlusevich-V.Neverov, corr 1988.

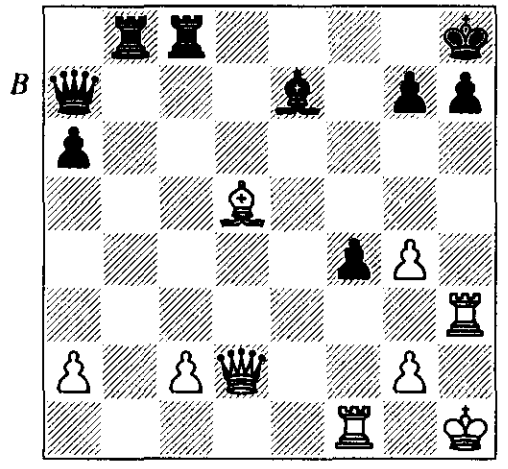
24 exd5 cxd5
25 ♗xd5

25 ♕xd5 ♗b7 26 ♕h5 is best met by 26...g6 27 ♕h6 f3! 28 gxf3 ♗xf3+ 29 ♖fxf3 ♖xf3 30 ♖xf3 ♕xb6 since after 31 ♖f7 ♕b7+ White cannot avoid the checks.

25 ... ♖b8
26 ♘xc8 ♖bxc8

27 ♖h3! *(D)*

27 ♖xf4 (27 ♗e4 ♗g5 28 ♖b7 ♕c5 29 ♕d7 ♕e5 30 ♗d3 ♖cd8 31 ♕c6 ♖d6 32 ♕f3 ♖h6+ 33 ♔g1 ♗e7 −+ Gillam-Noble, corr 1992) ♖xf4 28 ♕xf4 ♖f8 29 ♕c1 ♗d6 gives Black enough play for the pawn.



27 ... ♕b6

Black can force an immediate draw by 27...h6!? 28 ♖xf4 ♗g5 29 ♖f8+ ♖xf8 30 ♕xg5 ♖f1+ 31 ♔h2 ♕g1+ 32 ♔g3 ♕f2+.

28 ♖e1

Or 28 ♕d3 h6 29 c4 ♖ce8 30 ♖b1 (30 ♖h5!? ∞) ♕f6 31 ♖h5 ♗c5 32 ♗e4 ♖e5 33 ♖xe5 ♕xe5 34 ♗f5 f3! 35 gxf3 ♕g3 36 ♕f1 ♖e8 ∓ Oorebeek-Noomen, corr 1992.

28 ... ♗g5

29 ♖e6 ♕d8

and now:

1) **30 ♖d6** ♕xd6 31 ♖xh7+ ♔xh7 32 ♗e4+ ♕g6 33 ♗xg6+ ♔xg6 34 ♕d3+ ♔h6 35 ♕h3+ ♔g6 36 ♕d3+ is a draw.

2) **30 ♕d3** ♗h4 31 ♗e4 ♕xd3 32 ♗xd3 g5 33 ♖e7 ♖fe8 34 ♖xh7+ ♔g8 35 ♖3xh4 gxh4 36 ♖xh4 should also be equal.

3) **30 c4?!** ♖b8! 31 ♕d3 ♗h4 ∓ 32 ♗e4 ♕g5! 33 ♗xh7?! ♖fd8 34 ♕c2 f3 35 ♖xf3 ♖d2 ∓ Ivanchuk-Kasparov, Linares 1990.

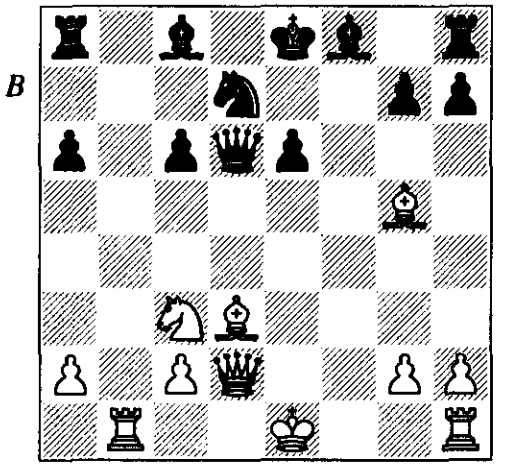
B)

13 e5 ♘d5

After 13 e5 Black has three possible moves, of which 13...dxe5 was analysed in chapter 6. The third possibility is inferior: **13...♘d7?!** and now:

1) **14 ♗e2** d5 (14...♘xe5 15 ♘e4 ±) 15 ♖b3 (15 0-0 ♗e7 16 ♗e3 ♗c5 17 ♔h1 ♖b8 ∞ Lazić-Marek, corr 1972) ♕a5 16 0-0 ♕c7 (16...♗c5+ 17 ♔h1 ♖f8 18 ♘xd5! ♖xf1+ 19 ♗xf1 ♕xd2 20 ♘c7+ ♔f7 21 ♗xd2 ♖b8 22 ♗c4 ±) 17 ♘a4 ♘xe5 (17...♘c5 18 ♖xf8+ ♖xf8 19 ♘xc5 ♕xe5 20 ♖e3 ±) 18 c4! ♘f7?! 19 cxd5 cxd5 20 ♖c1 ♕d6 21 ♘b6 +− Tatai-Lederman, Beersheba 1978.

2) **14 exd6** ♕xd6 (14...♗xd6? 15 ♖b3 ♕c5 16 ♘e4 ♕e5 17 ♕xd6 ♕xe4+ 18 ♖e3 +−) 15 ♗d3 *(D)* and now:



2a) **15...♖b8** 16 ♖d1 ♕e5+ 17 ♘e4 ♗c5 (17...♗d6 and now 18 g3 transposes to 2c2 below, while 18 ♗f4! ♗b4 {18...♕xf4 19 ♘xd6+ ♕xd6 20 ♗g6+ wins the queen} leads to the main line of this note) 18 ♗f4

♗b4 19 c3 ♗xc3 20 ♕xc3 ♕xf4 21 ♘d6+ ♔d8 22 ♗e4 ♖f8 23 ♖d2 ± Vitolinš-Peresypkin, Kiev 1974.

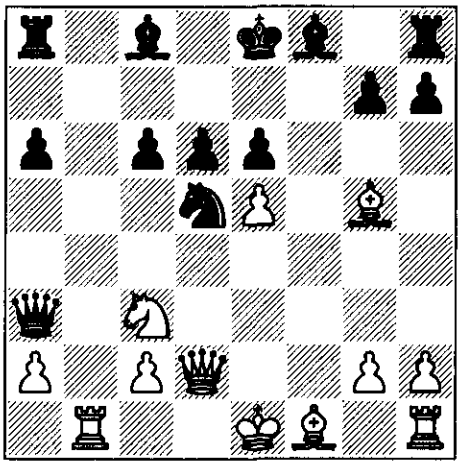
2b) **15...♘c5** 16 0-0 ♗e7 17 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 18 ♘e4 ♘xe4 19 ♗xe4 ♕c5+ 20 ♔h1 ♖a7, Stuart-Hanssen, corr 1990, and now 21 ♖b8 ♖c7 22 ♕d3! would have been very good for White since 22...♕a7 loses to 23 ♗g6+!.

2c) **15...♕e5+** leads to a further branch:

2c1) **16 ♔d1** ♗e7 17 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 18 ♖e1 ♕xh2? (18...♕h5+ 19 ♔c1 ♘c5 20 ♗e2 ±) 19 ♕g5+ ♔f7 20 ♖xe6! ♖e8 (20...♔xe6 21 ♗c4+ ♔d6 22 ♘e4+ ♔c7 23 ♕a5+ +– or 20...♘f6 21 ♖xf6+ gxf6 22 ♗c4+ ♔e8 23 ♕xf6 +–) 21 ♖xe8 ♔xe8 22 ♖b4 ♘f6 23 ♕xg7 ♕h5+ 24 ♔c1 ♕f7 25 ♕g5 ♘d5 26 ♖e4+ ♔d7 27 ♘xd5 cxd5 28 ♖f4 ♕e7 29 ♕xd5+ ♔e8 30 ♖e4 ♖a7 31 ♕g8+ 1-0 Vekshenkov-Shalnev, Lvov 1977.

2c2) **16 ♘e4** ♗d6 (16...♘c5 17 0-0 ♕d4+ 18 ♔h1 ♘xe4 19 ♗xe4 ♕xd2 20 ♗xd2 ♗d7 21 ♗c3 ♖c8 22 ♗e5 c5 23 ♗b7 ♖d8 24 c4 ♗e7 25 ♗c7 +– Välkesalmi-Arnold, Groningen 1978/9) 17 g3 ♘f6 (17...♖b8 18 ♖d1 ♖b4 19 0-0! ♗c5+ 20 ♘xc5 ♕xc5+ 21 ♖f2 ♖f8 22 ♗e3 ♖xf2 23 ♗xf2 and White's initiative is worth far more than a pawn, Strautinš-Kalivoda, corr 1971) 18 0-0 ♕d4+ (18...♘xe4 19 ♗xe4 ♗c5+ 20 ♗e3 ±) 19 ♕f2! ♕xf2+ (19...♘xe4 20 ♗xe4 ♕xf2+ 21 ♖xf2 ♗d7 22 ♖d2 ± Vitolinš-Amakov, USSR 1971, or 19...♗e5 20 ♗e3 ♕a4 21 ♗c5 ♗d7 22 ♖b4 ♕xa2 23 ♗c4 ± Ritum-Amakov, corr 1971) 20 ♖xf2 ♗e5 21 ♘xf6+ gxf6 22 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 23 ♖xf6 with a very promising ending for White.

Now we return to the main line after 13...♘d5 *(D)*:



14 ♘xd5

Or:

1) **14 ♖b3** is dubious, for example 14...♕a5 15 ♘e4 (15 exd6 ♗xd6 16 ♘e4 ♕xd2+ 17 ♔xd2 ♗c7 18 c4 h6 ∓ Barash-Kotenko, USSR 1986) ♕xd2+ 16 ♔xd2 dxe5 17 c4 a5! (knight moves are bad, but 17...h6 18 ♗h4 ♗e7 is probably ∓) 18 cxd5 exd5 19 ♘c3 ♗b4 20 a3 ♗d6 and Black is clearly better, McCurdy-Tukmakov, Harrachov 1967.

2) **14 ♘e4** dxe5 (14...♕xa2?! 15 ♖d1 dxe5 16 ♗e2 ♕a4 17 ♗h5+ ♔d7 18 ♕e2 ♔c7 19 0-0 ± Reinhardt-Panno, Buenos Aires 1965) with four possibilities:

2a) **15 c4** ♗b4 16 ♖xb4 ♕xb4 17 cxd5 ♕xd2+ 18 ♔xd2 exd5 ∓.

2b) **15 ♖d1** ♕b4 (15...h6 16 ♗h4 ♗b4 17 c3 ♘xc3 18 ♘d6+ ♔f8 19 ♕f2+ ♔g8 20 ♕f7+ ♔h7 21 ♗d3+ e4 22 ♘xe4 ♘xe4+ 23 ♔e2 ♕b2+ ∓ Milovanović-Loh, corr) 16 c4 ♕a3 and now White has nothing better than 17 ♖b1 transposing to line 2a.

2c) **15 ♗e2** ♗b4 16 ♖xb4 (16 c3? ♕xc3 –+) ♕xb4 17 ♕xb4 ♘xb4 18 0-0 leaves Black with plenty of

extra material, but the game Yurkov-Antoshin, USSR 1964 concluded 18...♘d5 19 ♘d6+ ♔d7 20 ♘c4 ♔e8 21 ♘d6+ ½-½. Black appears to have no clear way to gain the advantage in this ending, while on the other hand the winning attempt 20 ♘f7 seems misguided after 20...♖f8 21 ♘xe5+ ♔e8.

2d) **15 ♗d3** ♗b4 16 ♖xb4 ♕xb4 17 c3 ♕b6?! (17...♕a3 18 0-0 ♖f8 19 c4 ♘f4! and 17...♕b8 18 0-0 ♖f8 19 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 20 c4 ♘f4 are unclear) 18 ♘d6+ (18 ♖f1 ♖a7 19 ♘d6+ ♔d7 20 ♘c4 ♕c5 21 ♖f7+ ♔e8 22 ♘d6+ ♕xd6 23 ♖xa7 e4! is unclear according to Van der Tak) ♔d7 19 ♘f7 ♖f8 20 ♖f1, Schultz-Sills, corr 1985, and now instead of 20...♔c7? 21 ♕e2 ♗d7 22 ♕xe5+ ♔b7 23 c4 1-0, Black should have tried 20...♕c5 21 c4 ♘f6, which would have offered some defensive chances.

14 ... cxd5

Not 14...exd5 15 ♖b3! ♕xa2 16 ♕c3 c5 17 exd6 ♔d7 18 ♕xc5 ♗xd6 19 ♗b5+! ± Nikitin-Khaikin, Leningrad 1967.

15 ♗e2

Or:

1) **15 c4!?** (largely untested) dxc4 (15...dxe5 16 cxd5 ♗e7 is a better reply, when 17 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 18 d6 is well met by 18...♕h4+) 16 ♗xc4 ♕c5 (16...d5 17 0-0! ♕c5+ 18 ♗e3 ♕xc4 19 ♕f2 ♕c7 20 ♖bc1 followed by ♗b6 with a very dangerous attack) 17 ♗e2 ♕xe5 18 0-0 ♗e7 19 ♗f4 ♕c5+ 20 ♗e3 ♕c7 21 ♗b6 ♕d7 22 ♕d4 ♖g8 23 ♕e4 favoured White in Vogt-Espig, E.Germany 1967.

2) **15 ♗d3** ♕c5 16 ♗e3 ♕c7 17 0-0 dxe5 18 ♕f2 ♗d6 19 ♕h4 e4 20 ♗e2 ♗e5 21 ♗b6 ♕d6 22 c4 g6 23 ♔h1 ♗d7 24 ♗a5 ♖b8 25 ♕f2 ∞ Bezgodov-Savon, Alushta 1993.

15 ... dxe5

15...♕c5 16 ♗e3 ♕c7 17 exd6 ♗xd6 18 0-0 ♖b8 19 ♖xb8 ♕xb8 was good for Black in Sillger-Cao, Budapest 1995, but it looks completely wrong to help Black develop the f8-bishop with gain of tempo. 17 0-0 dxe5 18 c4 is far more dangerous.

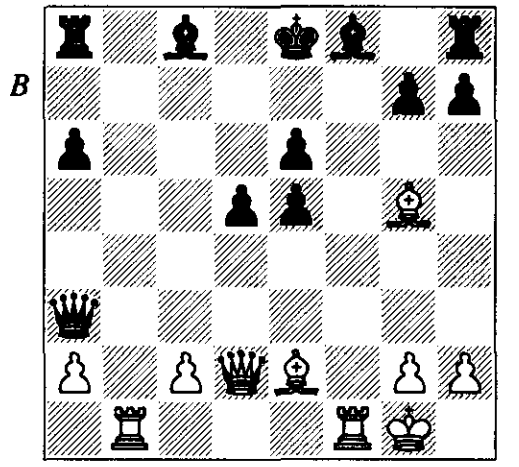
16 0-0 *(D)*

Or **16 ♖f1!?** (the idea is to deprive Black of the tempo he gains by checking on c5) and now:

1) **16...♕xa2** 17 ♖b3 (17 ♔f2 ♗c5+ 18 ♔g3 h6 19 ♕d3 e4 20 ♗h5+ ♔d7 21 ♕c3 ♗d6+ 22 ♗f4 ♗xf4+ 23 ♖xf4 ♕xb1 24 ♖f7+ 1-0 Lindroos-Virtanen, corr 1979, but this idea appears dubious) ♗c5 18 ♕c3! ±.

2) **16...♗e7** 17 ♖b3 ♗xg5 18 ♕xg5 ♕e7 19 ♕h5+ g6 20 ♕xe5 is good for White.

3) **16...♖a7** 17 ♖b3 ♕d6 18 ♗h5+ g6 19 ♕f2 d4 (19...♖c7 20 ♕f6 ♖g8 21 ♖b6) 20 ♕f6 ♖g8 21 ♖b8 1-0 Leisebein-Neubauer, corr 1983.



B

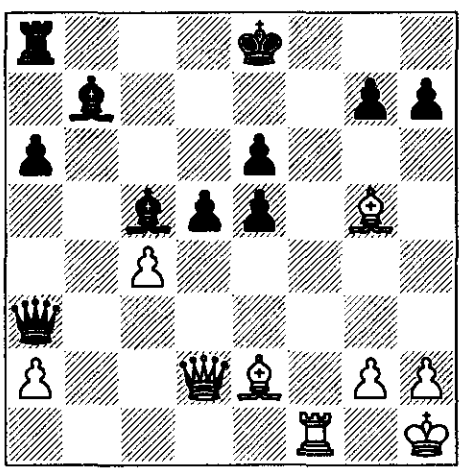
16 ... ♖a7

This move led to a slight revival of interest in 13...♘d5 during the 1970s. The older lines are:

1) **16...♗d6?!** 17 c4 ♖b8 (White wins after 17...♕c5+ 18 ♔h1 d4 19 ♕d3 g6 20 ♕f3 +– threatening ♕f6 and ♕xa8, Hartston-Moe, Harrachov 1967) 18 ♖xb8 ♗xb8 19 cxd5 ♕c5+ 20 ♔h1 ♕xd5 (20...exd5 21 ♖c1) 21 ♕c2 ♗b7 22 ♗h5+ g6 23 ♗xg6+ hxg6 24 ♕xg6+ ♔d7 25 ♕g7+ ♔d6 (25...♔c6 26 ♕xh8) 26 ♕e7+ ♔c6 27 ♖c1+ +–.

2) **16...♗e7** 17 c4 ♕c5+ 18 ♔h1 d4 19 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 20 ♗h5+ g6 21 ♗f3 ♖a7 22 ♗c6+ ♔d8 23 ♕a5+ ♕c7 24 ♕c5 ♖e8 25 ♖f8 ♗d7 26 ♖xe8+ ♗xe8 (26...♔xe8 27 ♖f1) 27 ♕f8 ♕xc6 28 ♖b8+ ♔c7 29 ♖xe8 and Black is losing his queen.

3) **16...♗c5+** 17 ♔h1 ♖f8 18 c4 ♖xf1+ 19 ♖xf1 ♗b7 *(D)* (19...♗d4? 20 ♕c2 ♕b2 21 ♕xh7 ♕xe2 22 ♕g8+ ♔d7 23 ♕d8+ ♔c6 24 cxd5+ ♔b5 25 ♕e8+ +– Sirotkin-Sorolin, USSR 1967 and 19...♖a7 20 cxd5 ♖d7 21 ♕c2, Dukić-Marjanović, Yugoslavia 1971, are terrible for Black and even 19...h6 20 ♗h5+ ♔d7 21 ♖f7+ ♔c6 22 ♗f3 e4 23 ♗xe4 dxe4 24 ♕f4 poses tremendous defensive problems for Black) and now:



3a) **20 ♕c2** e4 (20...♗e7 21 ♗h5+ g6 22 ♗xg6+ hxg6 23 ♕xg6+ ♔d7 24 ♗xe7 regains all the sacrificed material and retains a strong attack, or 20...g6 21 ♗g4 ♗e7 22 ♕f2! +–) 21 ♗g4 ♗e7 (21...♗c8 offered better defensive chances) 22 ♕f2 0-0-0 23 ♗f4 ♗d6 24 ♗xe6+ ♔b8 25 ♕b6 ♗xf4 26 ♕xd8+ ♔a7 27 ♖b1 ♕d6 28 ♗xd5 ♗xd5 29 ♕xd6 ♗xd6 30 cxd5 1-0 Tal-Bogdanović, Budva 1967.

3b) **20 ♗d1** (probably best) ♗e7 (the only move, e.g. 20...dxc4 21 ♕c2 intending ♕xh7 or ♕a4+, 20...e4 21 ♕c3!, 20...d4 21 ♕f2 ♗e7 22 ♗a4+ ♕xa4 23 ♕f7+, 20...♔d7 21 ♖f7+ ♔c6 22 cxd5+ exd5 23 ♗b3 ♗d4 24 ♕c2+ ♕c5 25 ♗xd5+ ♔xd5 26 ♕b3+ or 20...♖c8 21 ♕e2 ♗e7 22 ♕h5+ g6 23 ♕xh7 ♗xg5, Zhuravlev-Gutman, Riga 1967, and now 24 ♕xb7 ±) 21 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 (Black cannot defend after 21...♕xe7 22 ♗a4+ ♔d8 23 ♕a5+ ♔c8 24 c5!) 22 ♕g5+ ♔d6 23 ♖f7 ♖e8 24 c5+! ♕xc5 (24...♔xc5 25 ♖xb7 ♕d3 26 ♕c1+ or 24...♔c6 25 ♕xe5 wins for White) 25 ♖xb7 ♕f2 26 h3 ♕f1+ 27 ♔h2 ♕f4+ (27...♕xd1 28 ♕xg7 wins) 28 ♕xf4 exf4 29 ♖xg7 e5 30 ♖xh7 ±.

17 c4

Better than 17 ♖b3 (17 ♔h1 is likely to transpose to the main line after 17...♕c5 18 c4, since 18 ♖b3 ♖c7 19 c4 d4 is not good for White) ♕d6 18 ♔h1 ♗e7 (18...♖c7 gives Black a clear advantage according to Hulak) 19 ♕c3 ♖c7 20 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 21 ♕g3 g6 22 ♖bf3 ♗b7 23 ♖f6, Soylu-Hulak, Budva 1981, and now Hulak recommends 23...♔d8! as good for Black.

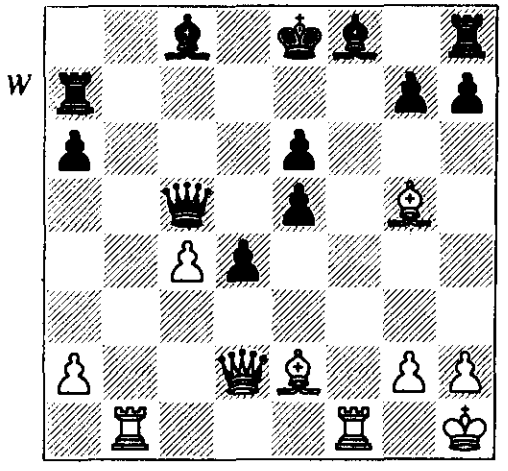
17 ... ♕c5+

Or:

1) **17...d4** 18 ♗h5+ g6 19 ♗d1 ♗c7 20 ♖f3 ♕c5 21 ♗a4+ ♔d8 22 ♖f7 transposes into the main line with the difference that the white king is on g1 rather than on h1. Who benefits from this is hard to say, for example 22...e4 23 ♖xe7 (23 ♗e3 ♖d7 24 ♗xd7 dxe3 25 ♕b2 ♖f8 26 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 27 ♗xc8 e2+ 28 ♔h1 ♕f2 29 ♕d2+ ♔xc8 30 ♕e1 e3 31 h3 ♗d6 0-1 Melzer-Wendt, corr 1981 was a case in which Black gained from the king being on g1) ♖xe7 24 ♖f1 e3 25 ♗xe3 e5 26 ♗g5 ♗e6 27 ♗f6 ♖g8 28 ♕g5 ♗d7 29 ♖e1 d3+ 30 ♔h1 ♕b4 31 ♕xe5 ± Leisebein-Idler, corr 1985.

2) **17...♖d7!?** 18 ♗h5+ g6 19 ♗d1 ♗g7 20 ♖f3 ♕c5+ 21 ♔h1 e4 22 ♖f1 h6 23 ♗a4 hxg5 24 ♗xd7+ ♗xd7 25 ♖b8+ ♔e7 26 ♕xg5+ ♔d6 −+ Alingh Prins-Sonderberg, corr 1991.

18 ♔h1 d4 *(D)*



19 ♗h5+

Or:

1) **19 ♗d1** ♗e7 20 ♗a4+ ♔d8 21 ♖f7 h6 is less favourable for White as the h6-pawn is not *en prise*.

2) **19 ♕c2** (dangerous) ♗e7 20 ♕a4+ ♖d7 21 ♗d2 ♖f8 22 ♗h5+ g6 23 ♗f3 ♖xf3 24 ♖xf3 e4 25 ♖ff1 e3 26 ♗b4 ♕c7 27 ♗a5 ♕e5 (27...♕c5 28 ♗b6 ±) 28 c5!? (28 ♕c6 ♕xa5 29 ♖b8, Bednarski-Sakharov, Varna 1968, and now 29...e2 30 ♖xc8+ ♗d8 31 ♕xe6+ ♖e7 32 ♕c6+ is a draw) e2 29 ♖fc1 ♗d8 30 ♗e1 ♗g5 31 ♕c6 ♗xc1 32 ♕xc8+ ♔e7 33 c6! +− Jablonski-Tiemann, corr 1983.

3) **19 ♕d3** ♗e7 20 ♕f3 ♗xg5 (20...♖f8?! 21 ♕h5+ g6 22 ♕xh7 is dangerous for Black) 21 ♕h5+ g6 22 ♕xg5 ♖f8 (22...♖g8 23 ♗d1 ♖e7 24 ♗a4+ ♔d8 25 ♖f7 h6 26 ♕f6 +− Koppe-Strausz, corr 1983) 23 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 24 ♕d8+ ♔g7 25 ♖f1 ♖f7 26 ♖xf7+ ♔xf7 27 ♕h8 and White has at the very best a draw.

19 ... g6

20 ♗d1 ♗e7

20...♗d6? 21 ♕f2 (21 ♗a4+ ♗d7 22 ♕f2 is also effective) ♖f8 22 ♗a4+ ♖d7 (22...♗d7 23 ♕xf8+!) 23 ♕h4 h5 24 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 25 ♗h6+ 1-0 Petrushin-Dementiev, USSR 1972.

21 ♗a4+ ♔d8

22 ♖f7

Or **22 ♗xe7+** (22 ♗h6 ♖g8 23 ♖f7 is worth investigating, for example 23...e4 24 ♕f4 e5 25 ♕xe4 ± was Rogulj-Sindik, Yugoslav Ch 1980, while 23...g5? 24 ♕d3! ♖g6 25 ♖xh7 ♖g8 26 ♕f1! is +−) and now:

1) **22...♕xe7** 23 ♕a5+ ♕c7 24 ♖b6 ♖b7 25 c5 ♔e7 26 ♖xb7 ♕xb7 27 c6 1-0 Nordby-Engel, corr 1984.

2) **22...♔xe7** (this also loses) 23 ♕f2 ♔d6 24 ♕f6 ♖g8 25 ♖fe1! (threatening 26 ♖xe5 ♕xe5 27 ♖b6+) with the branch:

2a) **25...♖ag7** 26 ♖xe5 ♕xc4 27 ♗b3 ♖b7 28 ♖e4 +−.

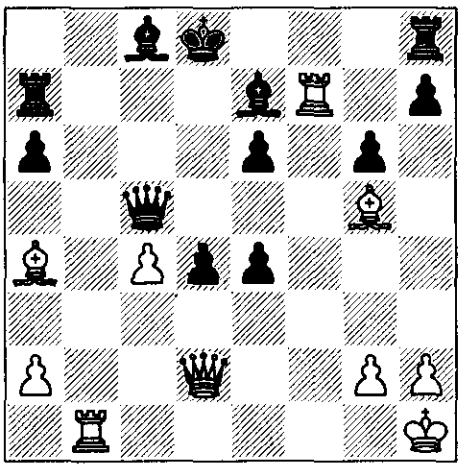
2b) **25...d3** 26 ♖bd1 ♖ag7 (White wins after 26...♕xc4 27 ♕xe5+ ♔e7 28 ♖e4 +– or 26...♕d4 27 ♖xe5 +–) 27 ♖xd3+ ♔c7 28 ♗e8! ±.

2c) **25...♖b7** 26 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 27 ♕f7 wins a piece.

3) **22...♖xe7!** (the only move) 23 ♕g5 ♔c7 24 ♖fe1 ♖f8! 25 ♖xe5 (25 ♗c2 ♖f5! ∓) ♕b4!! Benes-Vozka, Czechoslovakia 1988, and now 26 ♖c5+ ♔d8 27 ♖d1! ♕xa4 28 ♖xc8+ ♔xc8 29 ♕c5+ ♔d8! 30 ♖xd4+ ♕d7 31 ♖xd7+ ♔xd7 32 ♕a7+ ♔e8 33 ♕a8+ ♔f7 34 ♕xa6 ♔g7! favours Black.

22 ... h6

Or **22...e4** *(D)* (risky, but perhaps just playable) and now:



1) **23 ♖b8** with a whole range of possible moves:

1a) **23...♖c7** 24 ♗xe7+ ♖xe7 25 ♕f4 ♖xf7 26 ♕xf7 ♕d6 27 ♕b7! ♕c7 28 ♖xc8+ ♕xc8 29 ♕g7 ♖e8 30 c5! d3 31 ♕f7 ♖h8 32 ♕f6+ ♔c7 33 ♕e5+ ♔b7 34 ♕b2+ ♔a8 35 ♕b6 1-0 Lorincz-Sakharov, corr 1981. A very fine game.

1b) **23...h6!** 24 ♗xe7+ ♖xe7 25 ♕f4 is an ingenious attempt to improve, as we have the same position as in line 1a with the difference that Black's pawn is on h6 instead of h7. This becomes important if play follows the same course, since with the pawn on h6 Black need not resign, but can instead play 35...♖h7!. However, White can ensure an advantage in any case by (moves 25-29 as before) 30 ♕f6+ ♔c7 31 ♕e5+ ♔b7 (31...♔b6 32 ♕xd4+ ♔c7 33 ♕e5+ ♔b6 34 ♕d6+ ♔a7 35 c5 +–) 32 ♕xe4+ ♔b8 33 ♕b1+ ♔c7 34 c5! ♕b8 35 ♕b6+ reaching a favourable bishop v two pawns ending.

1c) **23...e3** 24 ♗xe3 e5 is an untested suggestion.

2) **23 ♖xe7** ♖xe7 24 ♗f6 with two lines:

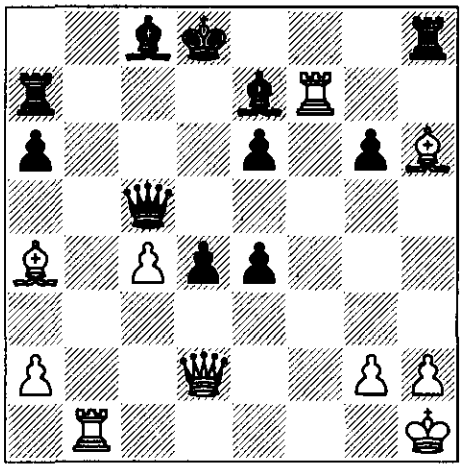
2a) **24...e5?** 25 ♗xh8 e3 26 ♕c2! (26 ♕e1 ♖b7! and 26 ♕e2 ♖f7 are unclear) ♖f7 27 ♕e4 (a good square for the queen, since Black has problems covering e5) ♗b7 (27...♗f5 28 ♖b8+ ♗c8 29 h3 and White's attack continues) 28 ♗f6+! ♖xf6 29 ♕xb7 ♕c7 30 ♕e4 ♖b6 (30...♖f4 31 ♕d5+ ♔e7 32 g3 and 33 ♖b7 wins) 31 ♕a8+ ♔e7 32 ♕e8+ and wins, Milovanović-Stern, corr 1984.

2b) **24...e3!** 25 ♕d3 (25 ♕xd4+ ♕xd4 26 ♗xd4 is met by 26...♖7e8! 27 ♗f6+ ♔c7 28 ♗e5+ with a draw, but not 26...♖f8? 27 ♗b6+ ♖c7 28 ♖d1+ ♔e7 29 ♗xc7 e2 30 ♗d6+ ♔d8 31 ♗xf8+ and wins; the alternative 25 ♕e1 ♖f8 26 ♗xd4 ♕xd4 27 ♖d1 ♕xd1 28 ♕xd1+ ♗d7 favours Black) e5 26 ♗xh8 ♗f5 27 ♕b3 ♖f7 (not 27...♗xb1? 28 ♕b8+ ♕c8 29 ♕d6+ ♖d7 30 ♗f6+ ♔e8 31 ♕e7#) 28 ♕b8+ ♗c8 29 ♕xe5 ♕xe5 30 ♗xe5 e2 31 ♔g1 ♗f5 32 ♖b8+ (or else ...♗d3 wins) ♗c8 33 ♖b1 ♗f5 with a draw (analysis by Bodnar).

23 ♗xh6 e4 *(D)*

23...♖b7 24 ♖e1 gives White good chances (24 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 25 ♗g5 ♗xg5 26 ♕xg5+ ♔c8 27 ♗d7+ ♔b8 28 ♗xe6 ± is not quite so good).

After 23...e4 we arrive at a critical position for the assessment of 13...♘d5. This position has been the subject of much analysis, mostly by correspondence players, but as yet definite conclusions are far away.



24 h3

White relieves his back rank and cuts out sacrifices on h2. However, other moves are playable:

1) **24 ♗g7?!** (dubious) ♖xh2+! 25 ♔xh2 ♗d6+ 26 g3 ♖xf7 27 ♗xd4 ♕h5+ 28 ♔g1 ♔e7! with advantage for Black.

2) **24 ♖e1** is an untested suggestion of Tiemann.

3) **24 ♖bf1** e5 (24...♗d7? 25 ♗g7 ♗xa4 26 ♗xh8 ♖d7 27 ♕f4! ±) 25 ♗g5 e3 26 ♖xe7 ♖xe7 27 ♕b2 e2 28 ♕xe2 ♔c7 29 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 30 ♕d2 ♗b7 31 ♕a5+ ♔c8 32 ♕b6 ♕c7 33 ♕e6+ ♔b8 34 ♖f7, Oechslein-Weber, corr 1973, 34...♕a5 35 h3 ♕e1+ 36 ♔h2 ♕e4 ∞.

4) **24 ♖d1** ♗d7?! (supporting d4 by 24...e5 poses the question of what the rook is doing on d1) 25 ♗g7 ♗xa4 26 ♗xd4! ♖xh2+ (there is nothing better) 27 ♔xh2 ♕h5+ 28 ♔g1 ♖d7 29 ♖df1! ♕e5 (29...♗d6 30 ♖xd7+ ♗xd7 31 ♗b6+ ♔e7 32 ♗d8+! ♔xd8 33 ♕xd6 winning) 30 ♖f8+ 1-0 Ihlebaek-Olthof, corr 1985.

5) **24 ♗e3** e5! (not 24...♖xh2+ when White wins by 25 ♔g1! ♕h5 26 ♕xd4+ ♖d7 27 ♕b6+ ♔e8 28 ♗xd7+ ♗xd7 29 ♖xe7+ ♔xe7 30 ♕b4+ ♔e8 31 ♕b8+, nor 24...♖d7 25 ♗xd7 dxe3 26 ♕b2! +–) 25 ♗g5 e3 (25...♗xg5 26 ♕xg5+ ♖e7 27 ♕f6! +–; 25...♖h5 26 ♖f8+ ♔c7 27 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 28 ♕a5+ +–; 25...♖e8 may be playable, for example 26 ♗xe8 ♔xe8 27 ♖xe7+ ♖xe7 28 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 29 ♕h6 ♕f6! ∞) 26 ♗xe3 ♖h5 (26...♖b7, Velimirović-Cvitan, Yugoslav Ch 1982, 27 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 28 ♗g5 ♗xg5 29 ♕xg5+ ♔c8 30 ♕f6 ♖d8 31 ♖xb7 ♔xb7 32 ♕xd8 ♕xc4 and now either 33 ♕d7+ ♔b6 34 h4 or 33 ♕e7+ ♔b6 34 ♕f6+ and 35 ♗d1, with excellent winning chances for White in both cases) 27 ♖g7 (27 ♕d3 ♖f5 28 ♖h7 ♖b7 29 ♖d1 ♗d7 30 ♗xd7 ♖xd7 ∓ Nieuwenhuis-Van Antwerpen, corr 1991; 27 ♗c2!? ♖d7 28 ♗h6 g5 29 ♗g7 d3 30 ♗a4 ♖d4 31 ♖e1 g4 32 ♕f2 d2 33 ♖f1 g3! 34 ♕xg3 ♗e6 35 ♖xe7 ♕xe7 36 ♗xe5 ♖xc4? {36...♕f7! ∞}, Selke-Kunzelmann, corr 1981, and now 37 ♗f6 ♕xf6 38 ♕d6+ ♔c8 39 ♕xa6+ ♔d8 40 ♖xf6 ♖c1+ 41 ♖f1 wins for White) and now:

5a) **27...♗d7** 28 ♖b8+ ♔c7 29 ♕b2! ♗b5 (29...♗xa4! 30 ♖xe7+ ♗d7 ∞) 30 ♖gg8! ♕b4 31 ♖gc8+ ♔d7 32 ♕xb4 ♗xb4 33 cxb5 +–.

5b) **27...♖d7** 28 ♖g8+ ♔c7 29 ♕b2 ♕b4 30 ♕xb4 ♗xb4 31 ♗xd7

♗xd7 32 ♗xd4 exd4 33 ♖xb4 ♖e5 34 ♔g1 +–.

5c) **27...♗f5** 28 ♗xd4! exd4 (or 28...♕xd4 29 ♖b8+) 29 ♖b8+ ♗c8 30 ♖g8+ ♗f8 31 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 32 ♕xd4+ +–.

5d) **27...♖b7** and now:

5d1) **28 ♖e1** ♗f5 (28...♗d7?! is inferior, for example 29 ♗xd4 exd4 30 ♖gxe7! ♕d6 31 ♖xd7+ ♖xd7 32 g4! ±; 28...♕b4!?) 29 ♖g8+ ♔c7 30 ♗f2 ♖b1 31 ♖g7 ♖xe1+ 32 ♕xe1 ♔d8, Tiihonen-Lagland, corr 1982 and now White should force a draw by 33 ♖g8+ ♔c7 34 ♖g7.

5d2) **28 ♖xb7!** ♗xb7 29 ♖xg6 ♕xc4 (29...♖f5! 30 ♖g8+ ♔c7 31 ♗f2 ±) 30 ♕a5+ ♔c8 31 ♗b3 ♕f1+ 32 ♗g1 ♔b8 33 ♗d5! ♕d1 (33...♕e2 34 h3 ♕b2 35 ♖g8+ ♔a7 36 ♕c7 wins) 34 ♖g8+ ♔a7 35 ♖a8+! 1-0 Heemsoth-Weber, corr 1973-6.

24 ... e5

This move leads to the same position as in line 5 of the previous note, but with White having the extra move h3. This relieves the back rank and prevents tactical ideas on h2, but on the other hand it allows ...♗xh3 in several variations, so it is not clear how much of an advantage the extra move really is. In view of doubts about this, Black should consider the alternative line **24...♖b7 25 ♖xb7** (25 ♖bf1 e5 26 ♗g7 ♖h7 27 ♖xe7 ♖xe7 28 ♗f6 ♔c7 29 ♗xe7 ♖xe7 ∓ Teuvo-Strausz, corr 1984; 25 ♖e1 e5 26 ♖xe4 ♗e6 27 ♖xe7 ♖xe7 28 ♗g5 ♖h5 29 ♗xe7+ ♔xe7 30 ♗d1 ♖f5 = Bauer-Müller, corr 1981) **♗xb7 26 ♕b2 ♔c8 27 ♗f4** (27 ♗g7? ♖xh3+ 28 gxh3 e3+ 29 ♔g1, Szilagyi-Müller, corr 1982, 29...d3! 30 ♕d4 e2! –+) and now:

1) **27...e5** 28 ♗g5 ♕b4 and a draw was agreed in Schuller-Prins, corr 1984 in view of the line 29 ♕xb4 ♗xb4 30 ♗f6 ♖f8 31 ♗d7+ ♔c7 32 ♗xe5+ ♔d8 33 ♗f6+ with perpetual check.

2) **27...e3** 28 ♗d7+! (28 ♔g1? e5 29 ♗g3 d3 30 ♕xe5 ♕xe5! 31 ♗xe5 e2! 32 ♗c3 ♗c5+ 33 ♔h2 ♖d8 –+) ½-½ Prins-Strand, corr 1984, since 28...♔xd7 29 ♕xb7+ ♔e8 30 ♖xe7+ ♕xe7 31 ♕c8+ ♕d8 32 ♕xe6+ ♕e7 is a perpetual.

3) **27...♖d8!** (a winning attempt) 28 ♗e5 (28 ♗c6 ♗xc6 29 ♖xe7 ♕xe7 30 ♕b8+ ♔d7 31 ♕c7+ ♔e8 32 ♕xc6+ ♔f7 33 ♕xe4 d3 –+; 28 ♖h7 e3 29 ♗c6 ♕xc6 30 ♖xe7 d3 –+) e3 29 ♗f6 ♕b4! –+ Odeev-Kotenko, corr 1987.

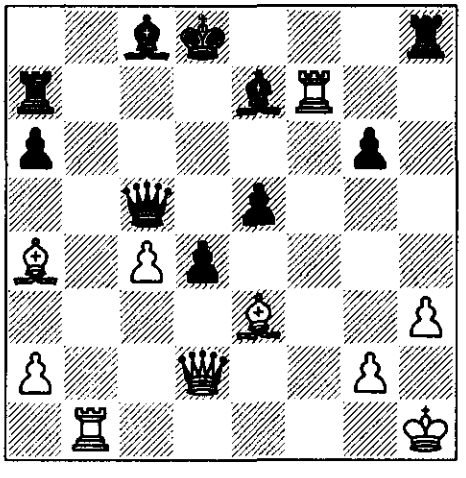
25 ♗g5

After 25 ♖g7!? ♖b7 26 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 27 ♕b2 ♔c8 28 ♗g5 ♕b4 29 ♕xb4 ♗xb4 30 ♗f6 the ending turned out to be unexpectedly bad for Black in Kopp-Palm, corr 1979, which continued 30...e3 31 ♗xe5 ♖f8 32 ♗g3 g5 33 c5 +–. It is curious that this line was never repeated.

25 ... e3

26 ♗xe3 *(D)*

B



26 ... ♖b7

Or:

1) **26...♗xh3** 27 gxh3 (27 ♔g1 ♗c8 ∞) ♖xh3+ 28 ♔g2 ♖xe3 29 ♕b2 ♕xc4? (29...♕d6 30 ♖h1 ♖g3+ 31 ♔xg3 ♗h4+ 32 ♖xh4 ♖xf7 33 ♖h8+ ♔c7 34 ♔g2 ±) 30 ♕b8+ ♕c8 31 ♕b6+ ♖c7 32 ♖f8+ 1-0 Walker-Hacker, corr 1985.

2) **26...♖h5** 27 ♖g7 ♖b7 28 ♖f1 (28 ♖e1 transposes to the main line) and now 28...♗f5 29 ♔g1 ♔c8 30 ♗f2 ♖h8 31 g4 ♗e4 32 ♕e2 ♗f6 33 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 was good for Black in Oechslein-Hamilton, corr 1987, but 28...♗xh3 29 gxh3 ♖xh3+ 30 ♔g2 ♖xe3 may be even better.

27 ♖e1

Not 27 ♖d1? ♗g4 28 ♖e1 ♔c8 29 ♗g1 ♗f5 30 ♗h2 e4 31 ♖xe7 ♖xe7 32 ♕f4 ♕b4 −+ Bouaziz-Hulak, Reggio Emilia 1983/4.

27 ... ♖h5

Or:

1) **27...♗f5** 28 ♗g5 (28 ♗xd4 exd4 29 ♕f4 d3! and now 30 ♖e5 loses to 30...♖b1+ forcing mate, so White probably cannot justify his sacrifice) ♗xg5 29 ♕xg5+ ♔c8 30 ♕f6 ♖xf7 31 ♕xh8+ ♖f8 32 ♖xe5 with an extra pawn for White in the ending.

2) **27...♕b4!?** 28 ♗c6 ♗xh3! 29 ♔g1 ♗e6 ∞.

28 ♖g7 ♕b4

White is slightly better, for example 29 ♕d1 ♕d6 30 ♗d2 ♔c7 31 ♗c2 d3 (31...♗f5 32 ♗xf5 ♖xf5 33 ♕g4 ±) 32 ♗a5+ ♔b8 33 ♕xd3 (33 ♗xd3? ♗xh3) ♕xd3 34 ♗xd3 ♗b4! 35 ♗xb4! (35 ♖xb7+ ♗xb7 36 ♗xb4 ♖xh3+ =) ♖xg7 36 ♗d6+ ♔a8 37 c5 ± and the pawn on e5 is falling, but in Timman-Sunye, Wijk aan Zee 1980, Black held the draw.

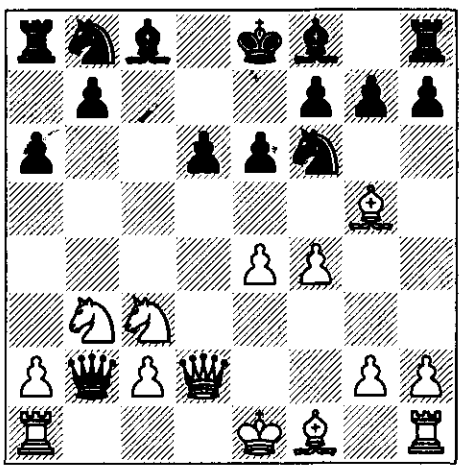
Although the theoretical verdict on 13...♘d5 is unclear, there has been almost no practical experience in recent years. The reason seems to be that Black has to defend extremely accurately for a long time, but even then he is not sure to escape from his difficulties. At least in the main line of chapter 6 Black has an extra piece, so if he survives the immediate crisis then his future looks rosy, whereas here material is often equal. Having said this, no route to an advantage is visible for White.

8 Poisoned Pawn: 8 ♕d2 ♕xb2 9 ♘b3

9 ♘b3 is a more restrained continuation than 9 ♖b1. White makes it very hard for Black's queen to return to the centre and plans to complete his development with an enduring initiative for the pawn. This line has retained a certain level of popularity without ever really becoming fashionable. However, in view of White's lack of success in the 9 ♖b1 lines, it may be due for a revival.

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♕b6 8 ♕d2 ♕xb2 9 ♘b3 *(D)*

B



The threat is 10 a3 and 11 ♖a2 trapping the queen, so Black's options are limited. Of the three lines, the first two are most important.

A: 9...♕a3
B: 9...♘c6
C: 9...♘bd7

A)

9 ... ♕a3
10 ♗xf6

Other moves:

1) **10 ♗d3** ♗e7 (10...♘c6 leads to line B) 11 0-0 and now:

1a) **11...♘bd7** 12 ♖ae1 (12 ♕e1 h6 13 ♗h4 e5 14 f5 b6 15 ♘b1 ♕a4 16 c4 ♘c5 17 ♘xc5 bxc5 18 ♘c3 ♕d7 19 ♗c2 0-0 20 ♗a4 ♕d8 ∞ Grünfeld-Hölzl, Lucerne OL 1982) and now:

1a1) **12...e5** 13 ♕f2 ♕b4 14 fxe5 ♕xc3 15 exf6 ♗xf6 (15...♘xf6 16 e5! dxe5 17 ♕g3 ♕b4 18 ♖xe5 ♗e6 19 c3, Korsunsky-Zilberman, USSR 1981, and now instead of 19...♕g4? 20 ♕e1! ♕a4 21 ♗f5 +–, Black should have played 19...♕b6+ or 19...♕d6, which would have been ±) 16 e5 dxe5 17 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 18 ♕g3 ♔f8 19 ♖xe5 ♗e6 20 ♖c5 ♕b2 21 ♕d6+ ♔g8 was unclear in Kapengut-Zilbershtein, USSR Ch 1972.

1a2) **12...h6** 13 ♗h4 (13 ♗xf6 gxf6! 14 f5 ♘e5 15 fxe6 fxe6 16 ♘e2 ♗d7 17 ♘f4 ♗d8 18 ♔h1 ♗b6 19 ♘h5 0-0-0 20 ♘xf6 ♔b8 ∓ Beliavsky-Bronstein, Yaroslavl 1982) ♘c5! (better than 13...♕b4? 14 ♗f2 ♘c5 15 a3! ♕b6 16 ♕e2! ± Shmulenson-Sorokin, corr 1973, or 13...g5 14 fxg5 ♘g4 15 e5! ♘dxe5 16 h3! ♘xd3 17 cxd3, Kupreichik-Szekely, Frunze 1985, and now Black had to give up a piece since 17...♘e5 18

♖e4 followed by ♖a4 or ♘b1 costs Black his queen) 14 e5 ♘fe4 (or 14...♘xb3 15 cxb3 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♘d7 17 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 18 ♗c2 0-0 19 ♕d3 f5 20 exf6 ♘xf6 21 ♖e3 ♕c5 ∓ Lutikov-Yuferov, Minsk 1982) 15 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 16 ♗xe4 ♗xh4 17 exd6! ♗xe1 18 ♖xe1 ♗d7 19 f5 (19 ♕d4 0-0 20 ♗xb7 ♖ab8 21 ♘c5 ♖xb7 22 ♘xb7 ♖c8 ∓ Scheffer-Korn, corr) 0-0 20 f6 ♕b2 ∞ Korsunsky-Timoshchenko, Lvov 1977.

1b) **11...h6** 12 ♗xf6 (12 ♗h4 ♘xe4! 13 ♘xe4 ♗xh4 14 f5 exf5! 15 ♗b5+ axb5 16 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 17 ♘xc8 ♘c6! 18 ♘d6 ♖d8 19 ♘xb5 ♕e7 ∓ Spassky-Fischer, Reykjavik Wch (7) 1972) ♗xf6 13 e5 dxe5 (13...♗e7 may be met by 14 ♖ae1 ∞ or 14 ♗b5+!? ∞) 14 ♘e4 ♘d7 15 f5 exf5 (15...♕e7!? 16 fxe6 ♕xe6 17 ♗c4! ♕b6+ 18 ♔h1 0-0 19 ♖f3 ♕c7! 20 ♗d5 ♗e7 21 ♖af1 ♘b6! ∓ Mukhin-Sorokin, USSR 1973) 16 ♖xf5 ♗e7 17 ♗c4 (17 ♕f2 ♘f6 18 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 19 ♖xf6 gxf6 20 ♕xf6 ♖f8 ½-½ Wittmann-Butze, corr 1984) ♘f6 18 ♖xe5 ♘xe4 19 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 20 ♕d5+ ♔g6 21 ♕xe4+ ♔f7 22 ♖f1+ ♗f6 23 ♘c5 ♖e8? (23...♖d8) 24 ♕d5+ ♔f8 25 ♕d6+ ♔f7 26 ♘xb7 ♕a4 27 ♕d5+ ♔f8 28 ♘d6 ♗e6 29 ♖xe6 ♖xe6 30 ♕xe6 ♕d4+ 31 ♔h1 ♕a7 32 ♘f5 ♕f7 33 ♕d6+ ♗e7 34 ♕c6 ♖d8 35 ♕xa6 1-0 Tal-Zaid, Moscow tt 1973.

2) **10 ♗e2** ♗e7 11 0-0 ♘bd7 12 ♗f3 (12 ♔h1 ♕b4 13 ♕e3 h6 14 ♗h4 ♘g4 15 ♗xg4 ♗xh4 16 f5 ♘e5 17 ♗e2 ♗g5 ∓ Gild.Garcia-Pigusov, Reykjavik 1994; 12 ♖ad1 0-0 13 ♕e3 h6 14 ♗h4 ♘g4 15 ♕g3 ♗xh4 16 ♕xg4 ♗f6 ∓ Gagarinov-Sotnikov, St Petersburg jr 1993) 0-0 13 ♖ae1 ♘c5 14 e5 (14 ♔h1 ♘xb3 15 cxb3 h6 16 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 17 ♖c1 ♖b8 ∓ Postema-Wagermans, corr 1991) ♘xb3 15 cxb3 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♘d7 17 ♔h1 ♗xg5 18 ♕xg5 ♕a5! 19 b4! ♕xb4 20 ♘e4 ∞ Sakharov-Geller, USSR Ch 1976.

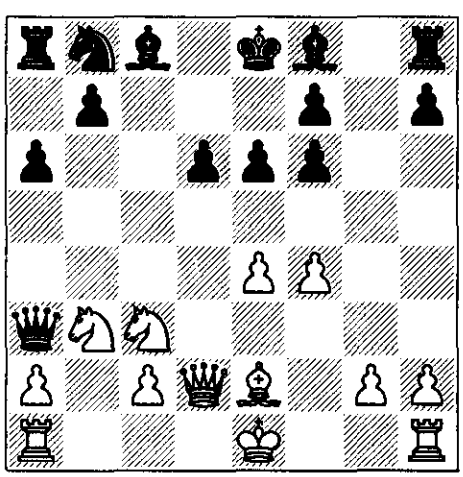
3) **10 e5** dxe5 11 fxe5 ♘fd7 12 ♘e4 ♕b4 13 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 14 exd6 ♕xd2+ 15 ♗xd2 b6 16 a4 ♗b7 17 c4 a5 18 ♘d4 ♘a6 19 ♗e2 ♘ac5 ∓ Timmerman-Engholm, corr 1984.

10 ... gxf6

11 ♗e2 *(D)*

Or 11 ♗d3 (11 f5 ♘d7 12 ♗e2 h5 13 0-0 ♘c5 14 ♔h1 ♗d7 15 ♖ab1 ♖c8 was good for Black in Merdinian-Tringov, Plovdiv 1977) ♘d7 (11...♘c6 12 0-0 ♗d7 transposes to line B) 12 0-0 ♘c5 13 ♔h1 ♗d7 14 f5 0-0-0?! (14...♖c8 ∞) 15 ♖ab1 ♘xd3 16 cxd3 ♗e7 17 ♘e2! (17 ♖bc1 ♔b8 18 ♘b1 ♕a4 19 ♖c4 ♕b5 20 ♘c3 ♕b6 21 ♖b1 ♔a8 ∓ Hulak-Tringov, Bor 1977) d5 18 ♘a5 ♗b5 19 ♖b3 ♕a4 20 exd5 ♖xd5 (20...e5 21 ♖c1+ ♔b8 22 ♘c4! +–) 21 ♖f4 1-0 Geenen-Delabie, corr 1992. This line deserves more tests. It has been traditional to develop the bishop on e2 in the 9 ♘b3 variation, but there are many circumstances in which d3 is more appropriate.

B



11 ... ♘c6

There are basically two plans for Black; he can either play ...h5 or omit it. Unfortunately, there are various possible move-orders, which makes the organisation of material a little tricky. In the main line we consider only those possibilities not involving an early ...h5. Lines with ...h5 are all found in this note. The analysis runs **11...h5 12 0-0** and now:

1) **12...♘d7** reaches a position distinguished by the fact that almost every legal move has been tried (note that most lines involving ♔h1 are analysed in variation 1f):

1a) **13 f5** and now:

1a1) **13...♕b4?!** 14 fxe6 fxe6 15 ♔h1 ♗e7 (15...♘c5 16 ♖xf6 ♗d7? 17 ♖xf8+! wins) 16 ♖ab1 ♘e5 (or 16...♘c5 17 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 18 ♘a4 ♕c7 19 ♘b6 ±) 17 ♘d4 ♕a5 18 ♖b3 ♗d7? (18...♕c7 19 ♕d1 ±) 19 ♖xb7 ♖c8 20 ♖b3 d5 21 ♕e3! ± Sarink-Engel, corr 1991.

1a2) **13...♗e7** 14 ♘b1 ♕a4 15 c4 ♕c6 16 ♘c3 ♘e5 17 ♘d4 ♕c7 18 ♕d1 b5 19 fxe6 fxe6 20 ♗xh5+ ♔d8 21 ♘ce2 ♘xc4 22 ♘f4 ♕b6 23 ♖f2 ± Kaunonen-Rompatti, corr 1975.

1a3) **13...♘c5!?** 14 ♕d4 ♘xb3 15 axb3 ♕c5 16 ♕xc5 dxc5 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♖xf6 ♗g7 19 ♖f3 =.

1b) **13 ♕d4** b5 (13...♘c5 14 ♕xf6 ♘xb3 15 ♕xh8 ♘xa1 16 ♖xa1 ♗d7 17 ♗xh5 ♖c8 18 ♘e2 ♕e3+ 19 ♔h1 ♕xe4 20 c3 ♗c6 21 ♕g8 ♖c7 ∞ Szewczyk-Ziewitz, corr 1984) 14 ♘b1 ♕a4 15 c4 b4 16 f5 ♗e7 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♘1d2 ♕c6 19 a3 bxa3 20 ♔h1 ♖b8 21 ♖xa3 ♖b6 22 ♕a1 ± Kasparov-Zaid, USSR 1977.

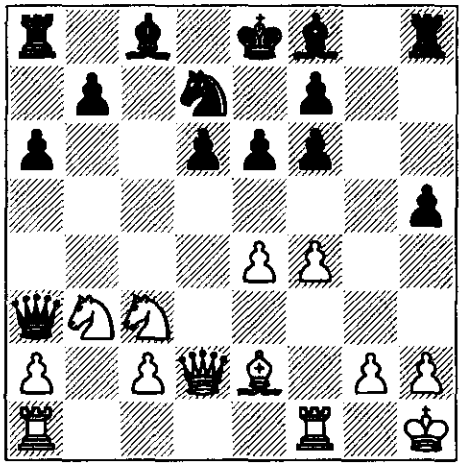
1c) **13 ♖f3** ♘c5 (13...♗e7 14 ♔h1 is line 1f32) 14 ♖d1 ♘xb3 15 axb3 ♗d7 16 ♔h1 ♕a5 17 ♖d3 ♗c6 18 ♗f3 0-0-0 19 ♕e3 ♗e7 20 ♘e2 ♔b8 21 c4 ♕c5 ∞ Liska-Schonherr, corr 1984.

1d) **13 ♘b1** ♕a4 14 c4 ♘c5 15 ♘c3 ♕c6 16 ♘d4 ♕c7 17 ♕e3 b6 18 f5 ♗h6 19 ♕f3 ♗g5 ∓ Ollek-Engel, corr 1983.

1e) **13 ♕e3** ♘c5 14 ♖fd1 b5 15 ♗xb5+ ♗d7 16 ♘xc5 axb5 17 ♘xd7 ♔xd7 18 ♕d4 b4 19 ♘b5 ♕a6 20 a4 ♗e7 21 ♕xb4 +– Gazdos-Brunclik, corr 1982.

1f) **13 ♔h1** *(D)* and now:

B



1f1) **13...♘c5** 14 f5 ♗d7 15 fxe6 fxe6 16 ♖xf6 ♘xb3 17 cxb3 ♕a5 18 ♖c1 ♖c8 19 ♖g6 ♕e5 20 ♖c2 ♗g7 21 ♖g3 h4 22 ♖h3 ♔e7 ∓ Gisel-brecht-Cording, corr 1983.

1f2) **13...h4** 14 h3 ♗e7 15 ♖ad1 b6 (15...b5 16 ♗xb5 axb5 17 ♘xb5 ♕a4 18 ♘c7+ ♔f8 19 ♘xa8 ♕xa8 ∞) 16 ♕e3 ♗b7 17 f5 ♖c8 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♗g4, Short-Kasparov, Riga 1995, 19...♘c5! 20 ♕d4 ♘xb3 21 cxb3 ♕c5 22 ♘a4 ♕xd4 23 ♖xd4 ♔f7 24 ♘xb6 ♖c2 ∓.

1f3) **13...♗e7** with a final branch:

1f31) **14 ♕d4** ♘c5 15 ♖fd1 ♗d7 16 e5 fxe5 17 fxe5 ♘xb3 18 cxb3 ♕c5 19 exd6 ♕xd4 20 ♖xd4 ♗f6 21

♖d3 ♖c8 22 ♖c1 ♗b5 23 ♖f3 ♗e5 ∓ Enders-Szekely, Budapest 1995.

1f32) **14 ♖f3** ♘c5 15 ♕e1 (15 ♖b1 ♘a4 16 ♗b5+ axb5 17 ♘xb5 ♕xa2 18 ♖a1 ♘c5 19 ♖xa2 ♖xa2 ∞ Lamm-Auerswald, corr 1983) ♗d7 16 ♖h3 h4 17 ♖xh4 0-0-0 18 ♖xh8 ♖xh8 19 ♖d1 ♕b4 20 ♖d4 ♕b6 ∓ Kopecky-Cmiel, corr 1982.

1f33) **14 ♖ab1** ♘c5?! (14...b6!?) 15 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 16 ♘a4 ♕c6?! 17 ♘b6 ♖b8 18 ♖f3 ♔f8 19 ♖c3 ♕e8 20 ♖c7 ± Mariasin-Sorokin, corr 1979.

1f34) **14 ♖ad1** ♘c5 15 ♗f3 (for 15 f5! see line 1f35 below) ♕b4 (or 15...♗d7 16 e5 d5 17 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 18 ♘e4 ♕c7 19 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 20 exf6 0-0-0 21 ♕d4 ♗b5 22 ♖fe1 ♔b8 ½-½ Neukirkh-Kaniuth corr) 16 f5 ♘d7 17 ♕e3 ♕b6 18 ♕e2 ♕c7 19 fxe6 fxe6 20 ♗xh5+ ♔d8 21 ♘a4 ♘e5 ∞ Markland-Palmo, corr 1982.

1f35) **14 f5!** ♘c5 15 ♖ad1 (15 fxe6 ♗xe6? 16 ♘d4 0-0-0 17 ♘f5 ♗f8 18 ♕d4 ♗xf5 19 exf5 with a clear advantage for White, Morgado-Rolle, corr 1976) ♗d7 (15...♕b4 16 ♕e3 {16 ♖f4! ±} ♗d7 17 ♗f3 ♖c8 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♖d4 ♕b6 20 ♖e1 ♘xb3 21 cxb3 e5 ∓ Baumann-Greiner, corr 1973) 16 fxe6 fxe6 17 e5! ♘xb3 (17...fxe5 18 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 19 ♘e4 ♕d4 20 ♕e1 ♕b6 21 ♕g3 0-0-0 22 ♖f7 ♖de8? 23 ♖xe7 ♖xe7 24 ♘xd6+ ♔d8 25 ♕xe5 ♖f8 26 ♘f5 1-0 Alomaki-Schlupek, corr 1980) 18 axb3 fxe5 19 ♘e4 d5 20 ♕c3 ♕b4! 21 ♘f6+ ♔d8 22 ♕xe5 ♕d6 23 ♕xd6 ♗xd6 24 c4 ♖f8 25 cxd5 ♔e7 26 ♘xd7 ♔xd7 27 dxe6+ ♔xe6 28 ♖fe1 ♔d7 29 ♗xh5 ± G.Kuzmin-Platonov, USSR 1967.

2) **12...♕b4** 13 ♔h1 ♕b6 (White has a clear advantage after 13...♘d7 14 ♖ab1 ♘c5 15 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 16 ♘a4 ♕c7 17 ♘b6 ♖b8 18 f5 ♔e7 19 ♕a5 ± Noria-Thannhauser, corr 1973) 14 a4 ♗d7 15 a5 ♕c7 16 ♘a4 ♗xa4 17 ♖xa4 ♘c6 18 ♕c3 ± Voitsekh-Gofbinder, corr 1976.

3) **12...♘c6** and now (note that all lines involving an early ♔h1 are considered under 3a):

3a) **13 ♔h1** ♗d7 with a further divergence:

3a1) **14 ♖f3** ♖c8 15 ♖h3 (15 ♖d1, transposing to line 3c below, is better) h4 16 ♕e1 ♘b4 17 ♘d4 e5! 18 f5 (18 ♘cb5 ♕a5 19 ♖a3 ♕b6 20 ♕xb4 d5 21 ♕a5 ♕xa5 22 ♖xa5 exd4 23 ♘xd4 dxe4 0-1 Hayes-Riemer, corr 1980) exd4 19 ♘d5 ♘xc2 ∓ 20 ♖xa3? ♘xe1 0-1 Beitinjaneh-Olthof, corr 1985.

3a2) **14 ♘b1** and now:

3a21) **14...♕b2** 15 ♘c3 (15 a3 ♖c8; 15 a4 d5! 16 exd5 ♘b4 17 ♘a3 ♖c8 ∓ Timman; 15 ♕e3 ♘b4 16 c3 ♘c2 17 ♕d2 ♗a4! ∓) ♘b4?! (it is risky to play for a win) 16 ♕d4 ♖c8 (16...♘xc2 17 ♕d2! ♖c8 18 ♖f3 ±) 17 ♕xb4 ♕xc3 18 ♕xb7 h4!? 19 ♕xa6 ± Van der Hooven-Olthof, corr 1979.

3a22) **14...♕a4?!** 15 a3! ♘e7 16 ♘c3 ♕c6 17 ♖f3 favours White, according to Timman.

3a23) **14...♕b4** 15 ♕e3 ♘e7 (not 15...d5?! 16 exd5 ♘e7 17 c4! ♘f5 18 ♕d3 h4? {18...♖c8 ±} 19 ♗g4 ♘d6 20 ♘1d2 f5 21 a3 ♕b6 22 c5 +– Spassky-Fischer, Reykjavik Wch (11) 1972) 16 a3 (16 c4 f5 17 a3 ♕a4 18 ♘c3 ♕c6 19 ♘d4 ♕c5 20 exf5 ♗g7 21 fxe6 fxe6 22 ♖ad1 ♗xd4 23 ♕xd4 ♕xd4 24 ♖xd4 ♘f5 25 ♖d2 ♖c8 26 ♖f3 ♔e7 ∓ Qi Jingxuan-Karpov, Hannover 1983) ♕a4 17 ♘c3

♕c6 18 ♖ad1 ♖d8?! (18...♖c8) 19 ♖d3 ♘g6 20 ♘d5 ♗e7 ± ½-½ Bau-Noble, corr 1991.

3a3) **14 ♕e3** and now:

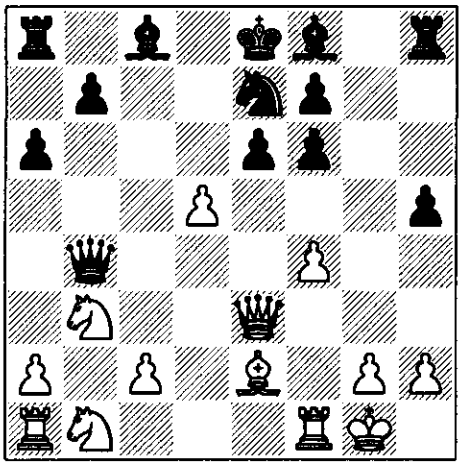
3a31) **14...♘a5?!** 15 ♕b6 ±.

3a32) **14...♘b4!** 15 ♕d2 (15 ♕b6 ♖c8 16 ♘b1 ♕a4 17 ♕xb7 ♘xc2 18 ♖c1 ♖c6 −+ Watson-Barnsley, corr 1991) ♖c8 (avoiding the repetition) 16 ♗d3, Braune-Kurbel, corr 1984, 16...♗g7 ∓.

3a33) **14...♖c8** 15 ♘b1 ♕a4 (or 15...♕b2 16 ♘1d2 d5 17 exd5 ♘b4 18 dxe6 fxe6 19 ♘c4 ♘d5 20 ♕e4 f5 21 ♕xd5 exd5 22 ♘xb2 ♖xc2, Mordue-Collinson, British Ch 1991, 23 ♖f2 ±) 16 c4 (16 ♘c3 repeats; 16 a3 ♘a5 17 ♘c3 ♘c4! 18 ♕d4 ♕c6 19 ♘d5 exd5 20 exd5 ♕c7 21 ♕xf6 ♖h6 ∓ Cavender-Trahan, corr 1989) ♘a5 17 ♕c3 (17 ♘1d2 ♘xb3 18 axb3 ♕b4 19 ♖ad1 ♕c5 20 ♕c3 e5 21 fxe5 fxe5 22 b4 ♕c7 23 ♕g3 ♗e6 = Heimo-Sonntag, corr) ♘xc4 18 ♕xf6 ♖h6 19 ♕d4 ♖h7 20 f5 exf5 21 ♘c3 ♗g7 22 ♘xa4 ♗xd4 23 ♘xd4 ♗xa4 24 ♖ac1 = Tal-R.Byrne, Leningrad IZ 1973.

3a4) **14 ♘d1** ♖c8 (14...♕b4 15 ♕e3 ♘e7 16 a3 ♕a4 17 f5 e5 18 ♘b2 ♕c6 19 c4 h4 20 ♖f3 ♗h6 21 ♕d3 ♘c8 22 a4 ∞ Platonov-Bukhover, Kiev 1963) 15 ♘e3 ♕b4 16 c3 ♕xe4 17 ♗d3 ♕a4 18 ♘c4 ♖c7 19 ♘b6 ♕a3 20 ♘c4 (20 ♖ae1? ♘e7 21 ♘c4 ♖xc4 22 ♗xc4 h4 ∓ Short-Kasparov, PCA Ch (4), London 1993) ♕a4 21 ♘b6 ♕a3 22 ♘c4 ½-½ Gulko-Psakhis, Beersheba 1993.

3b) **13 ♘b1** ♕b4 (13...♕b2? 14 a3 +− or 13...♕a4 14 c4 ♕b4?! 15 ♕e3 ♗g7 16 a3 ♕a4 17 ♕g3! ± Tal-Zilbershtein, Riga 1973) 14 ♕e3 d5 (14...f5 15 exf5 d5 16 fxe6 fxe6 17 c3 ♕e7 18 ♘1d2 ♗d7 19 ♘f3 ± Robatsch-Korchnoi, Palma de Mallorca 1972) 15 exd5 ♘e7 *(D)* and now:



3b1) **16 c4** ♘f5 17 ♕d3 ♕b6+ 18 ♔h1 (18 ♖f2 ∞) h4 19 ♖f3 ♘g3+ 20 ♖xg3 hxg3 21 ♕xg3 ♗d6, Zuzek-Paulucci, corr 1986, 22 ♘c3!, intending 23 c5 ♗xc5 24 ♘a4, with good compensation.

3b2) **16 ♘c3** ♘f5 (16...♗d7 is probably better) 17 ♕d3 ♕b6+ 18 ♖f2! (18 ♔h1 h4 19 ♗g4 ♘e3 20 ♘a4 ♕a7 loses the exchange) ♗d6 (18...♕e3 19 ♘e4 ♕xd3 20 ♗xd3 ♗e7 21 ♖e1 with the better ending for White, Mecking-Tal, Las Palmas 1975) with a last branch:

3b21) **19 ♘e4** ♗xf4 20 ♘xf6+ ♔f8! (20...♔e7, Wittmann-Van der Heijden, corr 1986, 21 dxe6! and now 21...♔xf6 22 ♕f3 ♕e3 23 ♕xf4 ♕xf4 24 ♖xf4 ±, 21...fxe6 22 ♕xf5 ♕xf2+ 23 ♔xf2 exf5 24 ♘d5+ ± or 21...♗xe6 22 ♘d5+ ♗xd5 23 ♕xd5 ♗xh2+ 24 ♔xh2 ♕xf2 25 ♕e5+ +−) 21 ♕c3 ♗xh2+ 22 ♔xh2 (22 ♔f1? ♘e3+ 23 ♔e1 ♗g3 24 ♘d7+ ♗xd7 25 ♕xh8+ ♔e7 −+) ♕xf2 23 ♘d7+ ♔g8 24 ♘f6+ with a draw by perpetual check, Peleshev-Odeev, corr 1988.

3b22) **19 ♘a4** ♕c7 20 ♕e4 b5! 21 ♘b2 ♗b7 22 ♖d1 ♗a3! 23 c4 ♗xb2 24 c5 ♗a3! 25 c6 –+ Groffen-Van Raay, corr. 1979.

3b23) **19 dxe6** fxe6 (19...♗xe6 20 ♘d5 ♕d8 21 ♗f3 ±) 20 ♕e4! ♔f7 (20...♕e3 21 ♘d5 +–) 21 ♗c4 ♕e3, Mularczyk-Siniarski, corr 1990, 22 ♕xf5! ♕xc3 23 ♕e4 ♗c5 24 ♘xc5 ♕xa1+ 25 ♖f1 ±.

3c) **13 ♖f3** ♗d7 14 ♖d1 (14 ♖h3 h4 15 ♕e1 ♖c8 16 ♖xh4 ♖xh4 17 ♕xh4 ♘a5 0-1 Schenning-Hanssen, corr 1991) ♖c8 (14...0-0-0) 15 ♔h1 ♕b4 16 ♕e3 ♘e7 17 ♖a1 ♕a3 18 ♕b6 ♗c6 19 ♘b1 ♕b2 20 ♘c3 d5? (20...♕a3 =; 20...f5!?) 21 ♖b1 ♕a3 22 ♘c5 ♘g6 23 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 1-0 Maksimović-Bogić, corr 1991.

It is worth mentioning that various 11th moves other than 11...♘c6 and 11...h5 are possible, although much less important:

a) **11...f5** 12 ♕d4 (12 ♘d5 exd5 13 ♕c3 ♘c6! 14 ♕xh8 dxe4 ∞) e5 13 fxe5 ♘c6 14 ♕d2 ♗g7? (Black should try 14...dxe5 ∞) 15 ♘d5 0-0 16 0-0 ♗xe5 17 exf5 ♕a4 18 c4 ♕a3 19 f6 ♔h8 20 ♕h6 1-0 Bryson-Mo.Sharif, Thessaloniki OL 1984.

b) **11...♕b4** 12 0-0 ♗e7 (12...h5 transposes to line 2 above) 13 ♗h5! (13 ♔h1 ♕b6?! 14 f5 h5 15 fxe6 fxe6 16 ♕d1 h4 17 ♗h5+ ♔d8 18 ♗g4 ♘c6 19 ♘a4 ♕b4 20 ♘ac5! e5 21 ♗xc8 ♔xc8 22 ♕g4+ ♔b8 23 ♘d7+ ♔a7 = Minić-Quinteros, Yugoslavia 1973) ♖g8 14 ♔h1 ♕b6 15 ♖ae1 ♔f8 16 ♖e3 ♖g7 17 ♖ff3 ♔g8 18 ♖g3 ♗f8 19 ♖xg7+ ♗xg7 20 ♖d3! ± Timman-Quinteros, Amsterdam 1973.

c) **11...♗g7** (the bishop is usually not well placed on g7 unless Black can force through a quick ...f5) 12 0-0 ♘c6 13 ♖f3 (13 ♔h1 0-0 14 ♖f3 f5! 15 exf5 exf5 16 ♖af1 ♘e7! 17 ♘d5 ♘xd5 18 ♕xd5 ♗e6 ∓ Gheorghiu-Quinteros, Teesside 1975; White delayed f5 too long) and now:

c1) **13...♗d7** 14 f5 (14 ♖g3 ♗h6 15 ♖h3 ♗g7 16 ♗h5 0-0 17 ♖d1 d5 18 exd5 exd5 19 ♖g3 ♔h8 20 ♕f2 ♗f5 21 ♘xd5 ♕xa2 22 ♘e3 ∞ Strode-Hünerfauth, corr 1984; 14 ♔h1 0-0 15 ♖d1 ♖ac8 16 ♖g3 ♔h8 17 ♖h3 ♕b4 18 ♕e3! ♘e7 19 a3! ♕xa3 20 ♕b6 ∞ Mariasin-Rashkovsky, Beltsy 1979) and now:

c11) **14...♖c8** 15 ♖g3 ♖g8 16 ♖f1 ♔e7 17 ♔h1 ♕b4 18 ♗h5 ♖cf8 19 ♖d3 ♖d8 20 fxe6 fxe6 21 ♖g3 ♖df8 22 ♖d1 f5 23 a3 ♗xc3 24 ♖xc3 ♕xe4 25 ♖e3 +– Minić-Buljovčić, Yugoslavia 1966.

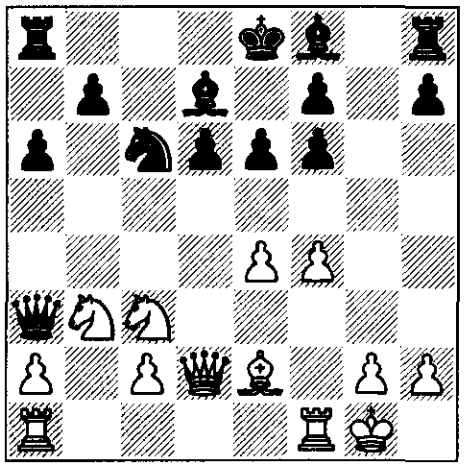
c12) **14...♘e5** 15 ♖g3 ♗f8 16 fxe6 fxe6 17 ♗h5+ ♘g6 18 ♖b1 ♖c8 19 ♕d4 ♗e7 20 ♖f1 ♖f8 21 h4 a5 22 ♕b6 a4 23 ♖xg6 hxg6 24 ♗xg6+ ♖f7 25 ♘b5 ♗xb5 26 ♕xb5+ ♔f8 27 ♕h5 +– Slobodan-Nakić, corr 1980.

c13) **14...h5** 15 fxe6 ♗xe6?! 16 ♘d5 ♗xd5 17 ♕xd5 h4 18 ♖d1 ♘e5, Kuusava-Haavisto, corr 1990, 19 ♖f2 ±.

c2) **13...0-0** 14 f5 ♘e7 (14...h6 15 ♖af1 ♔h7 16 ♖h3 ♘e7 17 ♗d3 exf5 18 ♘d5 ± Balashov-Schaufelberger, Riga 1967, or 14...♘e5 15 ♖g3 ♔h8 16 ♖f1 ♖g8 17 ♖h3 ♗f8 18 ♖f4 and h7 comes under heavy pressure) 15 ♖af1 ♔h8 16 ♖h3 ♘g8 17 ♗d3 h6 18 ♖f4 ♖d8 19 ♖g4 d5 20 ♖hg3 +– Matulović-Gavrilaikis, Štip 1976.

12 0-0 ♗d7 *(D)*

12...♗g7 transposes to line c just above.



13 ♔h1

Various other moves have been tried:

1) **13 f5** and now:

1a) **13...h5** (although this line involves the move ...h5, it does not normally arise from the move-order with 11...h5, so we did not consider it in the note to Black's 11th move) 14 fxe6 fxe6 15 ♖xf6 (15 ♖f3 0-0-0 16 ♖b1 ♗h6 17 ♕e1 ♖dg8 18 ♕f2 ♖g5 ∓ Suradiradja-Palatnik, Plovdiv 1977) 0-0-0 16 ♖d1 ♗g7 17 ♖f3 ♗e5 18 ♔h1 h4 19 ♕e3 ♖df8 ∓ J.L.Roos-Ribli, Baden-Baden 1981.

1b) **13...♘e5** 14 fxe6 (14 ♕d4 can be met by 14...♗g7 or 14...♗e7) fxe6 15 ♗h5+ (15 ♖xf6 0-0-0) ♔d8 16 ♖ab1 (16 ♘e2 preparing to attack the weak spot at e6 is more dangerous, e.g. 16...♖c8 17 ♘f4 ♖c4 18 ♕f2 ♗e7 19 ♘d4 ♔c8 20 ♗e2 ± Suradiradja-Minić, Plovdiv 1977) ♖c8 17 ♘e2 ♗e7 18 ♘f4 ♔c7 19 ♗e2 (19 ♘d4 ♔b8 20 ♘dxe6 ♕c3 and the tempo Black has gained over Suradiradja-Minić enables him to equalise) ♔b8 20 ♘d4 (20 ♘a5 b5 21 ♘b3 ♗d8 22 ♔h1 ♗b6 23 ♘h5 ♖c7 24 ♘xf6 ♗c8 25 ♘g4 ♘c4 26 ♗xc4 ♖xc4 27 ♘f6 ♕b4 ∓ Tal-Portisch, Varese Ct (2) 1976) ♘c4 21 ♗xc4 ♖xc4 22 ♘fxe6 ♖hc8 23 ♖b3 ♕a4 24 ♖fb1 b5 ∓ Hohm-Schubert, corr 1987.

2) **13 ♘b1** ♕b4 (13...♕a4!? 14 c4 ♗e7 15 ♔h1 ♖c8 16 ♘c3 ♕a3 17 ♖ad1 ♘a5! 18 e5?! ♘xc4 19 ♗xc4 ♖xc4 20 ♘b1 ♕b4 21 exd6 ♗d8 is slightly better for Black, Kupreichik-Palatnik, Daugavpils 1974) 14 ♕e3 (14 ♘c3 ♕b6+ extracts the queen) ♘e7 15 a3 (15 c4?! f5! 16 a3 ♕a4 17 ♘c3 ♕c6 18 ♖ad1 ♗g7 19 c5 fxe4! ∓ Matulović-Marjanović, Yugoslavia 1978) ♕a4 16 f5 ♖c8 17 ♗d3 e5?! (Minić gives 17...♕c6 18 ♘1d2 ♖g8, while 17...d5 is suggested by Shamkovich) 18 ♘1d2 d5 19 exd5 ♘xd5 20 ♕g3, Matulović-Lederman, Le Havre 1977, and now 20...♗h6 is unclear.

3) **13 ♗h5** ♗g7 (note that if the moves ♔h1 and ...♖c8 occur, then there will be a transposition into the main line) and now:

3a) **14 f5** 0-0 15 ♖f3 (15 ♘e2 ♕b4 16 ♖ad1 ♕xe4 17 ♘g3 ♕b4 18 ♕xd6 ♖fd8 19 ♕xb4 ♘xb4 20 ♘c5 ♗c6 21 fxe6 fxe6 22 ♘xe6 ♖xd1 23 ♖xd1 ♘xa2 24 ♘f5 ♗f8 ∞ Tringov-Ribli, Malta OL 1980) ♘e7 (the safest line may be 15...♘a5 16 ♘xa5 ♕xa5 17 ♕xd6 ♗c6 18 ♖g3 ♔h8 19 ♖f1 ♕e5 20 ♕xe5 with an equal position, Matulović-Tringov, Kragujevac 1974) and now:

3a1) **16 ♖af1** ♖ac8 17 ♘b1 (17 ♔h1 exf5 18 exf5 d5 19 ♖e1 ♔h8 20 h3 ♕b4 21 ♘d4 ♖c4 22 ♖d3 ♘xf5 23 ♖b1 ♕c5 24 ♖xb7? ♖xd4! 25 ♖xd4 ♘g3+ 26 ♔g1 f5! 0-1 Kir.Georgiev-Ribli, Baile Herculane 1982) ♕xa2 18 ♕xd6 ♘c6? (18...♗b5!) 19 ♘c5 ♘e5 20 ♘xd7 ♘xf3+ 21 ♗xf3 ± Bernal Caamano-Gibney, corr 1990.

3a2) **16 ♖d1** ♖ad8 17 ♘b1! (17 ♖d3 ♗c8! 18 ♖xd6 {18 ♖d4 d5! 19 exd5 e5 20 ♖c4 ♕d6 ∓ Beliavsky-Mukhim, USSR 1975} ♖xd6 19 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 20 ♖xd6 exf5 21 ♘d5 = Schuler-Dahl, corr 1980) ♕xa2 18 ♕xd6 ♘c6 19 ♘c3 ♕xc2 20 ♘a1! ♕b2 21 ♖b1! 1-0 Fiorito-Groiss, corr 1983.

3b) **14 ♖f3** 0-0 (if White plays ♔h1 during the next few moves, a transposition to the main line is likely) and now:

3b1) **15 ♖d1** ♖ad8 (15...♘a5 16 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 17 ♖xd6 ♘xb3 18 ♖xd7 ♘c5 19 ♖c7 ♖ac8 20 ♗xf7+ ♔h8 21 ♖e7 ± Smith-Kunzelmann, corr) 16 ♖g3 ♗c8 (16...♔h8 17 ♕e2 ♗e8 18 ♕g4 ♖g8 19 ♕h4 ♘e7 20 ♖h3 h6 21 g4 ♘g6 22 ♗xg6 fxg6 23 e5 ♖f8 24 exf6 ♖xf6 25 ♘e4 ± Pauly-Hauptmann, corr 1982) 17 ♕e2 f5 18 exf5 exf5 19 ♘d5 ♔h8 20 ♕f2 ♕b2 21 ♖d2 ♕b1+ 22 ♖d1 ∞ Markland-Kauranen, corr 1982.

3b2) **15 ♖af1** ♘a5 16 ♖h3 (16 ♖g3? ♘xb3 and 17...♕c5+; 16 ♔h1 is line 3b3 below) ♘xb3 17 axb3 ♖ac8 18 ♔h1 f5! 19 exf5 ♕b4 20 f6 ♗xf6 21 f5 exf5! (21...♖xc3? 22 ♖g3+ ♔h8?? {22...♗g7 23 ♖xg7+ =} 23 ♕h6! 1-0 {23...♖xg3 24 ♗g6!! leads to mate} Tal-Platonov, Dubna 1973) 22 ♖f4 ♗xc3 23 ♕e3 ♕a5 24 ♕g3+ ♗g7 0-1 Schwieger-Kunselmann, East Germany 1978.

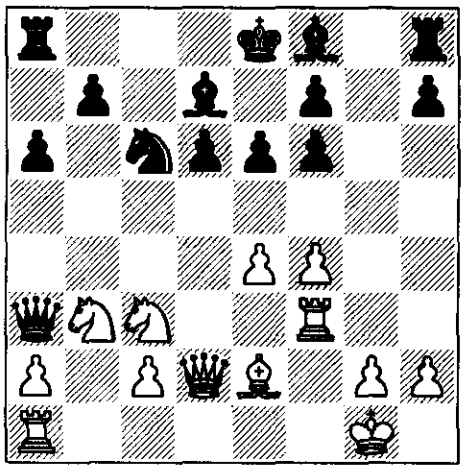
3b3) **15 ♔h1** ♘a5 (15...♖c8 is the main line) and now:

3b31) **16 ♖d1** ♘xb3 17 cxb3 ♕a5 18 ♖h3 ♗c6 19 ♗g4 ♖fd8 20 f5 e5 21 ♖d3 = Sanmarti-Vercauteren, corr 1985.

3b32) **16 f5** ♘xb3 17 cxb3 ♖ad8 18 ♖af1 ♗c6 19 ♖g3 ♔h8 20 fxe6 fxe6 21 ♗g4 ♗d7 22 ♘e2 f5 23 exf5 exf5 24 ♗f3 b5 = 25 ♘f4 ♗e5?? 26 ♘g6+ 1-0 Weber-Hallier, corr 1977.

3b33) **16 ♖af1** ♘xb3 17 axb3 ♕c5 18 f5 ♗c6 19 ♖g3 ♔h8 20 ♖h3 ♕e5 21 fxe6 fxe6 22 ♗g6 ♕g5 23 ♖xh7+ ♔g8 −+ Lodge-Kwiatkowski, corr 1979.

4) **13 ♖f3** *(D)* (one of White's more promising ideas in this line; the rook is ready to participate in a possible kingside attack, but is also lined up with Black's queen) and now:



4a) **13...♗e7** 14 ♔h1 h5 (the combination of ...h5 and ...♗e7 looks odd, but works well in this game) 15 ♘b1 (15 ♖d1!?) ♕b4 16 ♕e3 ♗d8! (the lack of pressure on d6 permits Black to extract his queen) 17 c3 ♕b6 18 ♕d2 ♗e7 19 c4 h4 20 ♘c3 h3 21 g3 ♘a5 22 ♘d1 ♘xb3 23 ♖xb3 ♕c5 ∓ Kasparov-Magerramov, USSR 1982.

4b) **13...♗g7** transposes to line c1 in the note to Black's 11th move.

4c) **13...♘a5** 14 ♘d5! exd5 (not 14...♘xb3 15 ♘xf6+ ♔e7 16 ♖xb3 +−) 15 ♘xa5 ♕c5+ 16 ♔h1 dxe4 17 ♘xb7 ♕c7 18 ♖b3 ♗e6 19 c4 f5 20 ♖ab1 ♗e7 21 ♕d4 ± Mariasin-Savon, Minsk 1980.

4d) **13...♖c8** 14 ♔h1 and now:

4d1) **14...♗g7** 15 ♖g3 (this line is very similar to c1 in the note to Black's 11th move) 0-0 16 ♖d1 ♖fd8 (16...♔h8 17 ♖h3 f5 18 exf5 exf5 19 ♘d5 ♕xa2 20 ♘b6 ♗e6 21 ♘xc8 ♖xc8 22 ♗h5 a5 23 ♕d3 a4 24 ♗xf7 ♗xf7 25 ♕xf5 ∞ Gaida-Wisniewski, corr 1992) 17 ♗h5! ♘e7 18 f5 (compare this with line 3b above) ♔f8 (18...exf5 19 ♘d5 ♘g6 20 exf5 ♗xf5 21 ♘d4 ♕xa2 22 ♘xf5 ♖xc2 23 ♕e3 +– Zyrianov-Shvidun, corr 1990) 19 ♘d4 ♕c5 20 ♗xf7! exf5 21 ♗b3 fxe4 22 ♘xe4 ♕e5 23 ♖e1! h6 24 ♘c3 1-0, Barczay-Cserna, Balatonbereny 1980.

4d2) **14...♘e7** 15 ♖d1 ♕b4 16 e5! d5 17 a3! ♕b6 18 ♘e4 ♘g8 19 ♖g3 (19 ♘xf6+ ♘xf6 20 exf6 ♗xa3 21 f5 ±) ♗e7, Sakharov-Zilberman, USSR 1979, and now 20 c4 was ±.

4d3) **14...h5** 15 ♖d1 h4 16 e5! fxe5 17 ♘e4 ♕b4 18 ♘f6+ ♔d8 19 c3 ♕b6 20 ♖d3 ♗e7 21 ♖xd6 ♗xf6 22 ♖xe6 ♖c7 23 ♖xf6 +– Kasparov-Magerramov, USSR 1982.

4e) **13...h5**. This is perhaps the critical test of 13 ♖f3. It transposes to line 3c in the note to Black's 11th move.

5) **13 ♕e3** (White prepares ♘b1 by cutting out Black's retreat to b6 in advance) ♖c8 14 ♘b1 ♕a4 15 ♘c3 (15 c4 ♘a5 16 ♕c3 ♘xc4 17 ♕xf6 ♖g8 18 ♗h5 ♖g7 19 ♘c3 ♕c6 20 f5 ♕b6+ 21 ♔h1 exf5 22 exf5 ♘e5 ∞ Gazivoda-Bogić, corr 1992) ♕a3 16 ♖fd1 ♘a5?! (White still had no threat, so 16...h5 was possible) 17 ♘b1 ♕b2? (Black might have survived by 17...♕a4 or 17...♕b4, the latter move being based on the tactical point 18 a3 ♘c4! 19 ♕d4 ♕b6 20 ♗xc4 ♕xd4+ 21 ♖xd4 e5) 18 ♘xa5! ♕xa1 19 ♕b3 b5 20 c3 b4 21 cxb4 ♗b5 22 ♗h5 ♔e7 23 e5! fxe5 24 f5! d5 25 fxe6 ♗h6 26 ♕xd5 ♖cd8 27 ♕b7+ ♔f6 28 ♕xf7+ ♔g5 29 ♘d2 ♕d4+ (too late to do any good) 30 ♔h1 e4 31 g3! 1-0 Sampouw-Ribli, Indonesia 1982.

13 ... ♖c8

13...♗e7 14 ♘b1 ♕b4 15 ♕e3 ♗d8 16 ♘1d2 ♕b6 17 ♕g3 ♗e7 18 ♕g7 ♖f8 19 ♕xh7 0-0-0 and Black was at least equal in Maninang-Li, Philippines 1977. However, the manoeuvre ...♗d8 and ...♕b6 works only if there is insufficient pressure against d6, so 14 ♖d1 was better.

14 ♗h5

Or:

1) **14 f5** ♘e5 15 fxe6 fxe6 16 ♗h5+ ♔d8 (compared to Tal-Portisch in the note to White's 13th, the move ♔h1 is not very useful) 17 ♘e2 (17 ♖xf6 ♕b4! 18 ♕g5 ♔c7 ∓) ♔c7! 18 ♘f4 (18 ♖ab1 ♔b8 19 ♘a5 b5 20 ♖b3 ♕a4 21 ♖xf6 ♗e7 ∓ Geller) ♔b8 ∓ Ligterink-Geller, Wijk aan Zee 1977.

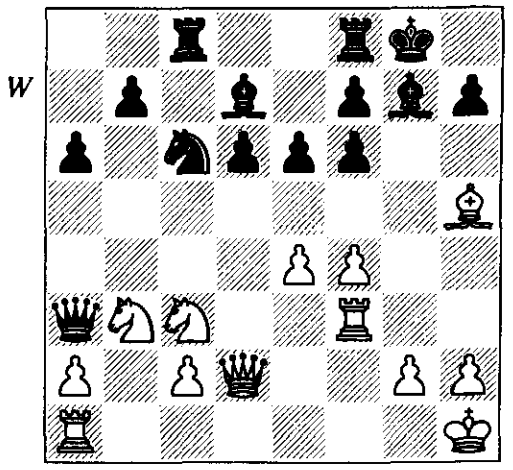
2) **14 ♘d1** ♗g7 (14...♕a4 15 ♗d3 ♘d4 16 ♘e3 ♘xb3 17 axb3 ♕d4 18 c4 ♗e7 19 ♖ad1 h5 20 b4 h4 ∞ Lengyel-Horvath, Hungary 1982, but 14...h5 may be the simplest, transposing to line 3a4 in the note to Black's 11th move) 15 ♘e3 ♕b4 16 c3 ♕xe4 17 ♗f3 ♕a4 18 ♕xd6 ♗f8 19 ♕d2 ♗e7 20 ♗h5 leading to an unclear position, Windheuser-Even, corr 1983.

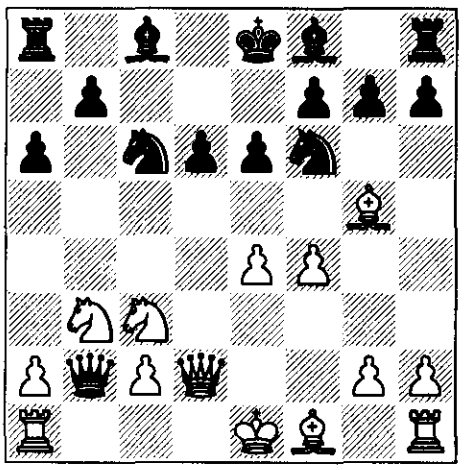
3) **14 ♖f3** transposes to line 4d in the note to White's 13th move.

14 ... ♗g7

15 ♖f3 0-0 *(D)*

and now:





1) **16 e5** fxe5 17 f5 exf5 18 ♘d5 ♖cd8 19 ♘f6+ ♔h8 20 ♕g5 h6 21 ♕h4 ♕b4 22 c4 ♗e6 23 ♖c1 d5 24 g4 ♕e7 25 g5 hxg5 26 ♕h3 ♗h6 27 ♖xf5 ♕xf6 0-1 Gutierrez-Vera, Havana 1978.

2) **16 ♖af1** ♘a5 17 ♖h3 ♘xb3 18 cxb3 ♕c5 19 ♖ff3 f5 20 ♖fg3 ♔h8 ∓ Sher-Yuferov, USSR 1981, but 17 ♖g3 looks better.

3) **16 ♖e1** ♘a5 17 f5 ♘xb3 18 axb3 ♕a5 19 ♖d3 exf5 20 ♖xd6 ♗e6 21 ♘d5 ♕xd2 22 ♘e7+ ♔h8 23 ♖xd2 = Liberzon-Ribli, Buenos Aires OL 1978.

4) **16 ♖d1** and now:

4a) **16...♘a5** 17 ♕xd6 (17 ♘d4 ♘c4? {17...♖c5!} 18 ♕e1 ♕c5 19 ♕h4 h6 20 ♖g3 1-0 Martin-Barbon, corr 1980) ♕xd6 18 ♖xd6 ♘xb3 19 ♖xd7 ♘c5 20 ♖e7 ±.

4b) **16...f5** 17 exf5 exf5 18 ♘d5 ♗e6? (18...♕xa2! ∞ – Am.Rodriguez) 19 ♘d4 ♕xa2 20 ♘xc6 bxc6 21 ♘e7+ ♔h8 22 ♘xc8 ♖xc8 23 ♕xd6 ♕xc2 24 ♖fd3 ± Am.Rodriguez-Vera, Havana 1978.

B)

9 ... ♘c6 *(D)*

This perfectly natural move attempts to delay ...♕a3 and thereby retain the possibility of saving a tempo by missing it out altogether. Failing this, Black at least hopes to restrict White's options. However, the defect is that White has a continuation that leads almost by force to a slightly better ending. While this ending might very well be a draw, it is probably not what Black was aiming for when he adopted the Poisoned Pawn.

10 ♗xf6

The alternative is **10 ♗d3** (10 ♖b1 ♕a3 cannot be critical since one would hardly contemplate 10 ♖b1 in line A; 10 a3? loses to 10...♘a5) and now:

1) **10...d5** and now:

1a) **11 ♖b1?** ♕xc3 ∓ is not hard to see, although it has been played several times.

1b) **11 ♗xf6** gxf6 12 ♘a4 (12 ♘d1 ♕a3 13 exd5 ♘b4 14 ♗e4 {14 ♘e3 ∞; 14 dxe6? ♘xd3+ 15 ♕xd3 ♕b4+ 16 c3 ♕xf4 17 exf7+ ♔xf7 ∓ Kotkov-Ruchkin, Sochi 1958} ♘xd5 15 0-0 ♗c5+ 16 ♔h1 ♕b4 17 ♕e2 ♘c3 18 ♘xc3 ♕xc3 19 ♖f3 ♕b4 20 ♖d1 ± Haatanen-Gunter, corr 1983) ♕a3 13 ♘b6 and now:

1b1) **13...♘d4?** 14 ♖b1 ♕xa2 15 c3 wins a piece.

1b2) **13...♖b8** 14 exd5 ♘a5 (or 14...♘d4 15 ♖b1 ♕b4 16 ♘xc8! ♖xc8 17 c3 ♘xb3 18 ♖xb3 ♕e7 19 dxe6 fxe6 20 ♕e2 ♖c6 21 ♕h5+ ♔d8 22 ♔e2 ± Cella-Rinaldi, corr 1983) 15 ♔e2!? (15 ♖b1 ♕b4 16 ♘xc8 ♖xc8 17 c3 ♖xc3 18 ♘xa5 ♕xa5 19 ♔e2 ♗b4? {19...♖a3} 20 ♖xb4! ♕xb4 21 ♖c1 +– Renet-Mrdja, Geneva 1988) ♘xb3 16 cxb3 exd5, Blaszczyk-Turlej, corr 1992, 17 ♘xd5 ♕d6 18 ♕e3+ ♔d8 19 ♕f3 ♗e6 20 ♖hd1 ±.

1b3) **13...d4** 14 0-0 ♖b8 with a final branch:

1b31) **15 e5** f5!? (15...♕b4) 16 ♕e2 ♕e7 17 c3 dxc3 18 ♗xf5! ♕c7 19 ♘xc8 ♖xc8 20 ♗e4 ♗c5+ 21 ♔h1 ♘d4 22 ♘xd4 ♗xd4 ∞ Kelečević-Barczay, Sarajevo 1968.

1b32) **15 f5** ♕b4 and none of the available liquidations offers White any chance of an advantage, for example **16 ♘xc8** ♕xd2 17 ♘xd2 ♖xc8 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♖xf6 ♗g7 20 ♖ff1 ♘e5 21 ♖fb1 ♗h6 ∓ Winterstein-Novikov, Bern 1993, **16 ♕xb4** ♗xb4 17 ♘xc8 ♖xc8 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♖xf6 ♔e7 20 ♖af1 ♘e5 21 ♔h1 ♗c3 = Venni-Alagna, corr 1990 or **16 fxe6?!** fxe6 17 ♕xb4 ♗xb4 18 ♖xf6 ♗e7 19 ♖h6 ♗g5 20 ♖h5 h6 with an equal position, Class-Mudelsee, corr 1983.

1b33) **15 ♕f2** ♕b4 16 ♘xc8 ♖xc8 17 a3 ♕b6 18 ♕h4 ♕d8 19 ♕h5 ♖c7 20 ♘d2 h6 21 e5 f5 22 h3 ♖g8 23 ♔h2 ♘e7 ∓ Kuczynski-Schutt, corr 1990.

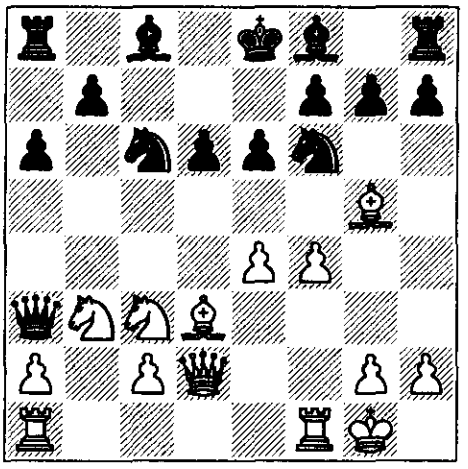
1b34) **15 ♕e2** ♕b4 16 ♘xc8 ♖xc8 17 ♘d2 ♗h6? 18 ♖ab1 ♕e7 19 ♕h5 ♗g7 20 ♖f3 h6 21 ♖g3 ♗f8 22 e5 f5 23 ♘c4 ± Pereira-Gerold, corr 1984.

1b35) **15 ♘c4** ♕b4 16 ♕e2 b5 17 a3 (preventing the queen retreating to d6; after 17 ♘cd2 h5, there is 18 ♖f3 h4 19 ♖h3 e5 20 f5 ♗h6 21 ♘f3 ♗e3+ 22 ♔h1 ♗d7 23 ♖xh4 ♔e7 ∓ Fiorito-Raymaekers, corr 1985 or 18 a3 ♕d6 19 ♕f2 ♕c7 20 ♔h1 e5 21 f5 ♗b7 22 ♕h4 ♗e7 23 g4 ♔d7 24 gxh5 ♖h6 25 ♖g1 ♖bh8 0-1 Abraham-Gerold, corr 1981) ♕e7 18 ♘cd2 h5 (18...♗g7 19 ♕h5 ∞) 19 a4 bxa4 20 ♖xa4 ♘b4 21 ♖a5 ♕c7 22 ♗c4 (22 ♖xh5 ♖xh5 23 ♕xh5 ♘xd3 24 cxd3 ♕c2 25 ♕d1 ♕xd3 ∓) h4 23 ♖h5 ♖xh5 24 ♕xh5 ♘xc2 25 ♖c1 ♕b6 ∓ Renet-Ftačnik, Lyon 1988.

1c) **11 ♘a4** (White tries to reach the same type of position as in 1b, but without exchanging on f6) ♕a3 12 ♘b6 d4 (after 12...♖b8 White would have to exchange on f6, but this is a some sort of victory, as Black can no longer play his most dangerous line) 13 0-0 ♖b8 14 ♘c4 ♕b4 15 ♕e2 b5 16 ♘e5 (this is the point; in line 1b this square was unavailable and the knight had to retreat) ♕d6?! (16...♗b7) 17 ♘xf7 ♔xf7 18 e5 ♕d5 19 exf6 gxf6 20 ♗e4 ♕d6 21 ♕h5+ ♔e7 22 ♗xc6 ♕xc6 23 ♗xf6+ ♔xf6 24 ♕e5+ ♔g6 25 ♖f3! +– Wibe-Govbinder, corr 1985.

2) **10...♕a3** 11 0-0 *(D)* and now:

2a) **11...♗e7** (lines with ...♗d7 are considered under 2b) 12 ♖ae1 (12 ♖f3 h6 13 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 14 e5 dxe5 15 f5 ♗g5 16 ♕f2 exf5 17 ♗xf5 ♗xf5 18 ♖xf5 0-0 ∓ Rizzitano-Pelts, Chicago 1989) h6 (12...0-0? 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 wins after 14...♘d7 15 ♗f6! ♗xf6 16 exf6 ♘ce5 17 ♖e3 ♘xf6 18 ♖xe5 1-0 Korsunsky-Sher, USSR


B

1979, or 14...♘d5 15 ♗f6! ♖d8 16 ♘e4 ♗xf6 17 exf6 ♕f8 18 fxg7 ♕xg7 19 ♖f3 +– Arbakov-Joffe, Moscow v Leningrad 1967; 12...♗d7 is line 2b2 below) 13 ♗h4 ♕b4 (13...0-0 is better) 14 ♗f2 (threatening 15 a3; 14 ♔h1 ♗d7 15 a3 ♕b6 16 e5 dxe5 17 fxe5 ♘d5 18 ♗xe7 ♘dxe7 19 ♕f4 0-0 20 ♘e4 ♘g6 21 ♘f6+ gxf6 22 ♗xg6 fxg6 23 ♕xh6 ♘xe5 24 ♖xe5 ½-½ Pioch-Govbinder, corr 1974) ♘a5 15 a3 ♘xb3 16 cxb3 ♕a5 17 b4 ♕d8 18 e5 dxe5 19 fxe5 ♘d5 (after 19...♘g4 20 ♗g3 the g4-knight is in trouble) 20 ♘e4 0-0 (20...b6 21 ♗b1 a5 22 ♗h4! and now 22...♗xh4 23 ♘d6+ ♔d7 24 ♖xf7+ ♗e7 25 ♖c1 threatening ♕xd5 gives White a decisive attack, so Nilsson-Lind, corr 1985 continued 22...g5 23 ♗g3 axb4 24 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 25 exd6 0-0 26 axb4 ♖a3 27 ♖e5 f6 28 ♖xd5! ±) 21 ♗b1 ♗d7 22 ♕c2 ♖c8 23 ♗c5 g6 and White certainly has enough for the pawn, but it is not clear whether he holds the advantage, Beliavsky-Pinter, Lucerne OL 1982.

2b) **11...♗d7** and now:

2b1) **12 ♗xf6** gxf6 with a final branch:

2b11) **13 ♘b1** ♕a4 (13...♕b4 14 ♕e3 ♘e7 15 ♘1d2 d5 16 c4 ♗g7 17 cxd5 exd5 18 exd5 ± Abreu-Rodas Martini, Lucerne OL 1982) 14 c4 ♕b4 15 ♘c3 ♘a5 16 ♖ab1 ♖b8?! (16...♘xb3 17 ♖xb3 ♕c5+ 18 ♔h1 ♗c6 19 ♘d5! ±) 17 ♔h1 ♗e7 18 f5 ♖g8 was Mesing-Hulak, Yugoslavia 1977, and now 19 e5! fxe5 20 fxe6 ♗xe6 21 ♘d4 gives White a slight advantage.

2b12) **13 ♖ab1** (the combination of ♘b3 and ♖b1 always appears odd) ♖c8 14 ♕e3 ♘b4 (provocative; 14...♗e7 ∞) 15 ♘d5 exd5 16 exd5+ ♔d8 17 ♕b6+ ♖c7 18 ♘a5 ♘xd5 19 ♘xb7+ ♔e8 20 ♖fe1+ ♗e7 21 ♕d4 ♗c6 22 ♘xd6+ ♔d7 23 ♘c4 ♗c5 24 ♗f5+ 1-0 E.Agdestein-Bjerke, Gausdal 1982.

2b13) **13 ♔h1** ♗e7 14 ♘d5!? exd5 15 exd5 ♘a7 16 ♖ae1 ♔f8 17 f5 h5 18 ♖e4 ♖e8 19 ♘d4 ♕xa2 20 ♘e6+ ♗xe6 21 ♗c4 ♕b2 22 fxe6 ♗d8 23 ♖f5 ♕a1+ 24 ♗f1 ♘c8 appears inadequate, although White did manage to scrape a draw in Kupreichik-Mukhin, USSR 1972.

2b2) **12 ♖ae1** ♗e7 (12...0-0-0 13 ♗h4 ♗e7 14 ♗f2 ♘g4 15 ♗b6 ♕b4 16 ♗xd8 ♗xd8 17 ♔h1 h5 = Sakharov-Dementiev, Rostock 1973) 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘d5 15 ♘xd5 exd5 16 ♕f2 ♗e6 17 ♗c1 ♕a4 18 ♕g3 ♕g4 19 ♕e3 0-0 20 ♖f3 ♕h5 ∓ Ilinčić-Machulsky, Alma Ata 1989.

3) **10...♗e7** 11 0-0 will probably transpose to line 2a above.

10 ... gxf6 *(D)*

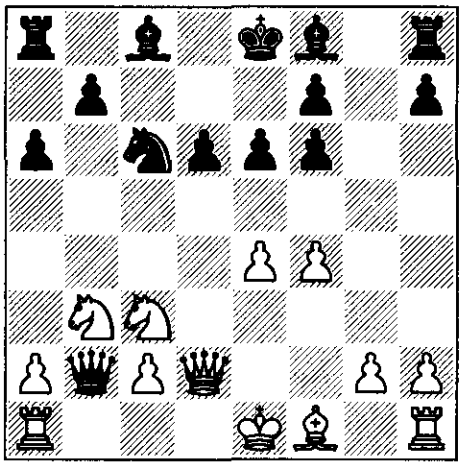
11 ♘a4!

Better than **11 ♗e2** and now:

1) **11...d5** and now:

1a) **12 ♘a4** (12 exd5? ♕xc3) ♕a3 13 ♘b6 and now:

1a1) **13...d4!** 14 0-0 ♖b8 15 ♘c4 (15 f5?! ♗c5! 16 ♘c4 d3+ 17 ♔h1



dxe2 18 ♕xe2 ♕b4 19 c3 ♕b5 is clearly better for Black, Velimirović-Ribli, Pula 1971; 15 ♖ad1 ♕b4 16 ♕xb4 ♗xb4 17 e5 fxe5 18 fxe5 ♗c3 19 ♖f4 ♘xe5 ∓ Hausius-Strauss, corr 1984) ♕b4 16 ♕d1 b5! (16...♗g7 17 ♖f3 h5, Kupreichik-Peresypkin, USSR 1973, and now 18 c3! dxc3 19 a3 ♕e7 20 ♘d6+ ♔f8 21 ♖xc3 ±) 17 ♘cd2 (17 a3 ♕e7 18 ♘b2 ♗g7 19 ♖f3 ♕c7 20 ♔h1 e5 21 c3 0-0 ∓ Bolte-Welz, corr 1973) ♗g7 18 ♖f3 e5 19 ♕e1 exf4! 20 ♖xf4 ♕d6 21 ♖h4 0-0 ∓ Nunn-Portisch, Toluca IZ 1982.

1a2) **13...♖b8** 14 exd5 (14 ♘xc8? ♖xc8 15 exd5 ♗b4 16 c3 ♘a5! –+ Henao-Marjanović, Manila 1974) ♘a5! 15 ♖b1 ♕b4 16 ♕xb4 ♗xb4+ 17 ♘d2 ♗c3 18 ♖f1 exd5 19 ♘xd5 ♗xd2+ 20 ♔xd2 ♗e6 = Westerinen-Szekely, Budapest 1976.

1b) **12 ♘d1** ♕a3 13 exd5 exd5 (13...♘a5 14 0-0 ♗b4 15 ♕d3 ♗d7 16 ♘e3 ♖c8 17 ♕e4 ± Oppici-Rolle, corr 1991; 13...♘b4 14 c4 exd5 15 0-0 dxc4 16 ♗xc4 ♗e7 17 ♖e1 ♘c6 18 ♘e3 0-0 19 ♕d5 ♕d6 20 ♕h5 ∞ Sellberg-Holst, corr 1976) 14 0-0 (14 ♕xd5?! ♗e6 is good for Black) d4 (14...f5 15 ♘c3 ♗g7 16 ♘xd5 0-0 17 ♖ad1 ♗e6 18 c4 ♖ad8 19 ♖f3, Kupreichik-Georgadze, USSR 1983, and now Georgadze suggests 19...b5 20 ♖g3 ♔h8 as unclear) and now:

1b1) **15 ♖e1?!** ♗e7 16 ♗c4 0-0 17 c3 ♖d8 18 ♘f2 b5 19 ♗d3 f5 gives Black an edge, Ljubojević-Minić, Rovinj-Zagreb 1975.

1b2) **15 ♗f3** ♗d7 (15...♕b4 16 ♕e2+ ♗e7 17 ♖e1 ♗e6 18 ♘b2 ♕b6 19 ♘d3 f5 20 ♖ab1 ♕a7 = Smal-Turlej, corr 1992) 16 ♖e1+ ♗e7 17 ♘xd4 ♕d6 18 c3 0-0 19 ♘f2 ♘xd4 20 cxd4 f5 21 ♖ab1 ♗f6 22 ♖xb7 ♖ab8 23 ♖xb8 ♖xb8 24 ♖d1 ♗a4 ∓ Torre-Browne, Manila 1976.

1b3) **15 ♗c4** ♗e7 16 f5 ♗d7 17 ♔h1 ♕d6 18 ♘b2 ♖g8 19 ♖f4 ♖g5 20 ♖af1 ♕b4 21 ♕xb4 ♗xb4 22 ♗d5 = Krebs-Hallier, corr 1983.

2) **11...f5** with the branch:

2a) **12 0-0** ♗g7 13 ♘a4 ♕a3 14 ♘b6 ♖b8 15 c3 (15 ♘c4 ♕b4 16 ♘xd6+ ♔e7 17 ♕xb4 ♘xb4 18 e5 f6! ∓) ♘a5 16 ♘xa5 ♕c5+ 17 ♔h1 ♗xc3 18 ♕c1 ♗xa5 19 ♘c4 fxe4 ∓ Planinc-Hulak, Banja Luka 1976.

2b) **12 ♘a4** ♕a3 (12...♕g7? 13 ♘b6 ♖b8 14 exf5 ♕xg2 15 0-0-0 ±) 13 ♘b6 ♖b8 14 ♘c4 ♕a4 15 exf5 (15 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 16 ♕xd6 ♕b4+ ∓) d5 16 fxe6 (16 ♘e5 exf5 17 0-0 ♗g7 18 ♕xd5 ♗e6 and 16 ♘b6 ♕b4 17 ♘xc8 ♕xd2+ 18 ♔xd2 ♖xc8 19 fxe6 fxe6 are fine for Black) ♗xe6 17 ♘e5 ♘xe5 18 fxe5 ♕h4+ 19 g3 ♕h6 is at least equal for Black.

2c) **12 ♖b1** ♕a3 13 exf5 (13 ♘d4 ♕c5 14 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 15 exf5 ♗g7 16 ♖b3 0-0 17 0-0 exf5 ∓ Sellberg-Holst, corr 1978) ♗g7 14 ♘e4 (14 fxe6 ♗xe6 15 ♗f3 ♕b4 16 ♘e4 d5! 17 c3 ♕e7 ∓ Kir.Georgiev-Vera, Groningen 1977; 14 0-0 ♕b4 15 ♖f3

♘d4 16 ♖d3 ♘xf5 ∓) d5 15 f6 ♗f8 16 ♘f2 (16 ♘g5 h6 17 ♘f3 ♗d6 18 c3 ♗d7 19 0-0 0-0-0 20 ♘fd4 h5 ∓ Gooch-Baron, corr 1991) ♗d7 17 0-0 0-0-0 18 c3 h5 19 ♘d4 ♗c5 20 ♖fc1 ♔b8 21 ♔h1 ♔a8 and Black is at least equal, Balashov-Hulak, Toluca IZ 1982.

2d) **12 exf5** ♗g7 and now:

2d1) **13 ♘a4** ♕a3 14 ♘b6 ♖b8 15 ♘c4 (15 c3 ♘a5 16 ♖b1 ♘xb3 17 ♖xb3 ♕c5 ∓) ♕b4 16 ♘xd6+ ♔e7 17 ♘xc8+ ♖bxc8 18 ♕xb4 ♘xb4 ∓.

2d2) **13 f6** ♗xf6 14 ♘e4 ♗g7 15 ♕xd6 (15 ♘xd6+ ♔e7 16 ♘xc8+ ♖axc8 17 0-0 ♘d4 18 ♗d3 ♕c3 with an edge for Black) and now Veselovsky and Pimonov continue with 15...♕xc2 16 ♗f3 ♗xa1 17 ♘xa1 ♕b1+ 18 ♔e2 ♕b2+ 19 ♔e3 ♘e7 and Black wins.

11	...	**♕a3**
12	**♘b6**	**♖b8**
13	**♘c4**	**♕a4**

13...♕b4 14 c3 ♕a4 15 0-0-0 ♔d8? 16 ♘c5! +– Rennemo-Brusila, corr 1980. However, 15...♗e7 is much better, with an unclear position, so White should probably play 15 ♗e2 or 15 ♔f2, when the extra move c3 is quite helpful for White.

14 a3

Or:

1) **14 0-0-0?!** d5! (14...♗d7 15 ♔b1 d5 16 c3! ♘e5! 17 fxe5 dxc4 ∓ Petrushin-Ubilava, USSR 1979, but 15 ♘c5 ♕xa2 16 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 17 ♕xd6 ♕a3+ 18 ♔b1 ♕b4+ {and not 18...♖d8? 19 ♘xb7!} 19 ♔c1 ♕a3+ is a draw) 15 exd5 exd5 16 ♘b6 (16 ♕xd5 ♗e6 17 ♕e4 ♕xa2 18 f5 ♗h6+ 19 ♘cd2 ♖c8!! 20 fxe6 ♘a5 21 exf7+ ♔f8 22 ♕b4+ ♔xf7 –+), Albas-Sindik, Greece 1975, and now 16...♕xa2 17 ♖e1+ (17 ♕e3+ ♗e6 18 f5 d4! ∓) ♗e6 18 ♘xd5 (18 ♕xd5 ♗a3+ 19 ♔d1 ♖d8 –+) ♗a3+ 19 ♔d1 ♖d8 –+.

2) **14 ♗e2** and now:

2a) **14...b5** 15 ♘xd6+ (15 ♘e3 ♗b7 ∓) ♗xd6 16 ♕xd6 ♕b4+ 17 ♕xb4 ♘xb4 18 ♘d4! (18 ♗d3 e5 19 0-0 ♔e7 = Hass-Martinez, corr 1979) ♗b7 19 a3 ♘c6 20 ♘b3, Allosa-D.Hernandez, corr 1993, 20...♔e7 =.

2b) **14...♗e7** 15 0-0 (15 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 16 ♕xd6 ♕xe4 ∓) 0-0 16 ♖f3 ♔h8 17 ♖h3 d5 18 f5 ♖g8 19 exd5 exd5 20 ♕xd5 ♘b4 21 ♖xh7+! ♔xh7 22 ♕xf7+ ♖g7 23 ♕h5+ ♔g8 24 ♘b6! +– Baiocchi-Palmiotto, corr 1974.

2c) **14...d5** 15 exd5 exd5 16 ♘b6 ♕b4 17 ♘xd5 ♕xd2+ 18 ♔xd2 (18 ♘xd2 ♘b4! ∓) ♗g7 19 ♔e3 0-0 20 c4 a5 21 a4 (Rodriguez suggests 21 ♗d3 a4 22 ♘d2, to which Shamkovich replies with 22...f5! =) ♖e8+ 22 ♔f2 ♗f5 = Rodriguez-Marjanović, Vrnjačka Banja 1977.

3) **14 ♔f2** and now:

3a) **14...f5?** 15 a3! (threatening 16 ♘b6 ♕xe4 17 ♗d3 or 17 ♖e1) ♗g7 16 e5 b5 17 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 18 g3! b4 19 ♗g2 +– Timman-F.Olafsson, Reykjavik 1976.

3b) **14...♗e7!?** (probably the best move) 15 a3 b5 16 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 ∓ Brat-Marcinkiewicz, corr 1981.

3c) **14...b5** 15 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 16 ♕xd6 ♗b7 17 ♗d3 ♖d8 18 ♕c5 ♘b4 19 ♖hd1 ♘xd3+ 20 cxd3 ♖c8 21 ♕d6 ♖d8 22 ♕c7 ♗a8 23 ♕c3 ± Popescu-Butze, corr 1983.

3d) **14...e5** 15 ♗d3 ♗e6 (15...exf4 16 ♕xf4 ♘e5 17 ♘b6 ♕c6 18 ♘d5 ♘g4+ 19 ♔e2 ♗h6 20 ♕f1 ♗g7 ∞ is more ambitious but also more risky,

J.Fernandez-Nunn, Budapest 1978) 16 ♘b6 ♕b4 17 ♕xb4 ♘xb4 18 f5 ♗d7 19 a3 ♘xd3 20 cxd3 ♗c6 = Ligterink-Barczay, Wijk aan Zee 1977.

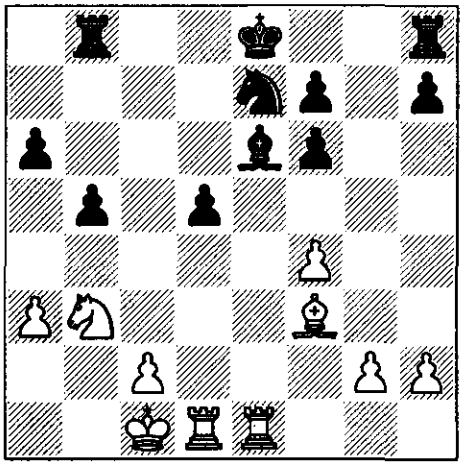
14 ... b5
15 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6
16 ♕xd6 ♕xe4+
17 ♗e2 ♕d5
18 ♕xd5 exd5
19 0-0-0 ♗e6

Or 19...♘e7 20 ♗f3 ♖b6 (20...♗e6 transposes to the main line) 21 ♗xd5 ♘xd5 22 ♖xd5 ♗e6 23 ♖d2 0-0 24 ♖hd1 ♔g7 25 ♖d6 ♖fb8 26 ♖1d4 ♔g6 27 ♔d2 a5 28 ♘xa5 ♖xd6 29 ♖xd6 ♖a8 30 ♘c6 ♖xa3 31 ♘e7+ ♔g7 32 f5 ♗c4 33 ♘d5 b4 34 ♘xf6 b3 35 ♘h5+ ♔f8 36 f6 ♖a8 37 cxb3 ♗xb3 is clearly better for White, Marletta-d'Adamo, corr 1984.

20 ♗f3 ♘e7

20...b4 21 a4 ♘e7 22 ♖he1 ♖c8 23 ♘d4 (23 ♗xd5 ±) ♔d7? (23...♖c7 ±) 24 f5! ♗xf5 25 ♘xf5 ♘xf5 26 ♗g4 +– Burridge-Campbell, corr 1989.

21 ♖he1 *(D)*



B

Perhaps the key position for the assessment of 9...♘c6. For the moment White is a pawn down, but he has no trouble regaining it. Then White hopes to exploit Black's weak kingside pawns and his more active rooks. On the other hand White's queenside pawns are also weak and White has trouble winning the pawn back without allowing a general liquidation leading to a draw. There is no doubt that White has an edge, but in my view Black should be able to reach a draw without excessive difficulties.

21 ... 0-0!

Almost certainly the best defence. Alternatives:

1) **21...♖g8** 22 ♘d4 ♖b6 23 f5 ♗c8 24 ♖d3 (24 ♗xd5 ♔f8 25 ♗f3 ♘xf5 26 ♘xb5 axb5 27 ♖d8+ ♔g7 28 ♖xg8+ ♔xg8 29 ♖e8+ ♔g7 30 ♖xc8 ±) ♔d8 25 g4 ♗b7 26 ♔d2 ♘c8 27 ♘b3 ♖d6 28 ♘a5 ♗a8 29 a4 ♔c7 30 axb5 axb5 31 ♖b1 ♔b6 32 c4 ♘a7 33 cxb5 ♖c8 34 ♘b3 ± Lanc-Novikov, Camaguey 1987.

2) **21...♖c8** 22 g4 f5 23 gxf5 ♗xf5 24 ♘d4 ♗e4 25 ♗xe4 dxe4 26 ♖xe4 ♔f8 27 ♘f3 ♘c6 28 ♖d7 h6 29 ♘h4 ♖d8 30 ♖c7 ♘d4 31 ♖ee7 ♖h7 32 c3 ♘c6 33 ♘g6+ ♔g8 34 ♖xc6 +– Romensky-Gaisyniuk, corr 1989.

22 g4!

A better chance than 22 ♘d4 (or 22 ♘c5 ♖b6 23 ♘d7 ♗xd7 24 ♖xe7 ♗e6 25 ♗xd5 ♗xd5 26 ♖xd5 ♖c8 =) ♖b6 23 g4 ♖e8 (23...f5 24 gxf5 ♘xf5 25 ♘xf5 ♗xf5 26 ♖xd5 ♗e6 =) 24 f5 ♗d7 25 ♘b3 ♖d6 26 ♘c5 ♔f8 = P.Müller-Gerold, corr 1981.

22 ... f5
23 gxf5 ♘xf5

and now:

1) **24 ♘c5** ♘e7! 25 f5 (25 ♘d7 ♗xd7 26 ♖xe7 ♗e6 27 ♗xd5 ♗xd5 28 ♖xd5 ♖fe8 =) ♘xf5 (25...♖bc8 26 ♘xe6 fxe6 27 ♖xe6 ♖xf5 28 ♗g4

♖f2 29 ♖d2 ±) 26 ♗xd5 ♗c8 (or 26...♖be8 27 ♘xe6 fxe6 28 ♖xe6 ♖xe6 29 ♗xe6+ ♔g7 30 ♖d7+ ♔h8 31 ♗d5 with just a faint edge for White) 27 ♖e5 ♖b6 28 ♖f1 ♘g7 29 ♖e7 ♘e6 (29...♘f5 ∞) 30 ♘e4 ♘d8 31 ♘g5 ♖d6? (31...♖g6 32 ♘xf7 ♗e6! =) 32 ♗e4 ♖h6 33 ♖g1 ♔h8 34 ♘xh7! ♘c6 35 ♖c7 ♖d8 36 ♘g5 ♘e5 37 ♖xf7 ♖e8 38 ♖c7 ♖xh2 39 ♖c5 ♖f2 40 ♘f3 1-0 Nunn-Stohl, Bundesliga 1995.

2) **24 ♗xd5** ♖be8 (24...♖b6? 25 ♘c5! ♗c8 26 ♗b3! ±; 24...♗c8? 25 ♖g1+ ♔h8 26 ♗xf7 ± Hauszler-Apps, corr 1984) and now:

2a) **25 ♗xe6** ♖xe6 26 ♖xe6 fxe6 27 ♘c5 ♘e3 28 ♘xe6 ♖c8 29 ♖g1+ (29 ♖d8+ ♖xd8 30 ♘xd8 ♘c4 =) ♔f7 30 ♘g5+ ♔f6 31 ♘e4+ ♔e6 = 32 ♖g5 ♖xc2+ 33 ♔b1 ♖c6 34 ♖e5+ ♔d7 35 ♘c5+ ♔d6 36 ♘b7+ ½-½ Adams-Gelfand, Wijk aan Zee Ct (3) 1994.

2b) **25 ♗b7!?** (probably White's best winning chance in this ending) ♗c8 (25...♖b8 26 ♘c5! ±; 25...♗xb3 26 ♖g1+ ♔h8 27 cxb3 ±) 26 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 27 ♖e5 ♘h4 28 ♖d6 is awkward for Black as the obvious reply 28...♘f3 is refuted by 29 ♖e3! ♘xh2 30 ♖g3+ ♔h8 31 ♖h6 ♘f1 32 ♖f3 and Black loses his knight.

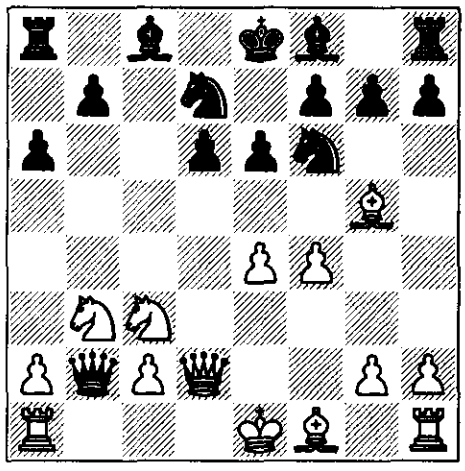
C)

9 ... ♘bd7 *(D)*

10 ♗xf6

Or **10 ♗d3** (10 a3? ♘c5 −+; 10 ♗e2 ♕a3 will probably transpose to line 2 in the note to White's 10th move in A) and now:

1) **10...b5?** 11 0-0 ♘c5 (a further error, but even 11...♕a3 12 e5 dxe5 13 fxe5 is very good for White since



13...♘xe5 is met by 14 ♖xf6) 12 ♘xc5 dxc5 13 ♗xf6 gxf6 14 ♖ab1 ♕a3 15 ♘xb5 1-0 Beliavsky-Stean, Lucerne OL 1982.

2) **10...d5** 11 ♗xf6 gxf6 12 ♘d1 ♕a3 13 exd5 ♕d6 14 dxe6 fxe6 ± Fiorito-Lilienthal, corr.

3) **10...♘c5** 11 0-0 ♗d7 with three lines:

3a) **12 ♘xc5** ♕b6 13 ♕f2 ♕xc5 14 ♕xc5 dxc5 15 e5 ♘d5 16 ♘xd5 exd5 17 c4, Petrushin-Doroshkevich, Omsk 1973, and now 17...♗c6! is equal.

3b) **12 e5!?** ♖c8! 13 exf6 (13 ♘xc5 ♕b6! ∓) ♘xb3 14 axb3 ♕xc3 15 ♕xc3 ♖xc3 16 f5! e5 17 fxg7 ♗xg7 18 f6 ♗f8 19 ♖f3 ∞ Kuznetsov-Wohl, corr 1991.

3c) **12 ♗xf6** gxf6 13 ♘xc5 (13 ♔h1 ♖c8 14 ♘xc5 ♖xc5 ∓ Fershter-Doroshkevich, USSR 1973) ♕b6 14 ♔h1 ♕xc5 15 e5 f5 16 ♖ad1 ♗c6 17 exd6 0-0-0 ∓ Coristo-Pontecorvo, corr 1985.

4) **10...♗e7** (10...♕a3 11 0-0 ♗e7 is the same) 11 0-0 ♕a3 leads to line A, variation 1a in the note to White's 10th move.

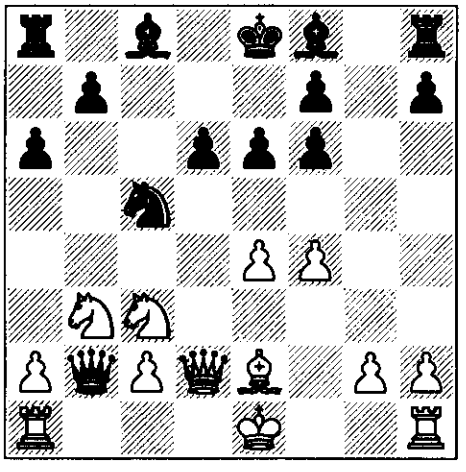
10 ... gxf6

Not 10...♘xf6? 11 a3 winning material.

11 ♗e2 ♘c5 *(D)*

11...♕a3 12 0-0 h5 transposes to line 1 in the note to Black's 11th move in A. 11...h5 will lead to the same thing.

11...b5 is an interesting alternative, e.g. 12 0-0 ♗b7 13 ♘a5 (13 a3? ♖c8 14 ♖f3 ♘c5 15 ♖a2 ♘xb3 −+ Riegsecker-Hotting, corr 1987) ♖c8 14 ♘xb7 ♕xc3 15 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 16 ♕xd6 ♖c6 17 ♕d3 ♕xc2 18 a4 ♕xd3 19 ♗xd3 bxa4 20 ♖xa4 with a draw after, for example, 20...♔e7. In Streletsky-Arnason, Reykjavik 1980, 20...♘c5? 21 ♗b5! gave White an edge.



12 0-0 ♗d7

12...♕a3 13 ♔h1 (13 f5 intending fxe6 and ♗h5+ is also feasible – then 13...h5 14 ♔h1 is line 1f in the note to White's 11th move in A) ♘xb3 (13...h5 14 f5 would transpose as in the previous bracket) 14 axb3 ♕c5 15 e5 fxe5 16 fxe5 ♕xe5 17 ♗b5+! +− Shianovsky-Peresypkin, USSR 1972.

13 ♖ab1

13 ♔h1 (13 ♘xc5 ♕b6! ∓) ♖c8 14 ♘d4 ♘b3 15 axb3 ♕xc3 16 ♕d1 ♗g7 ∓ Kupreichik-Vaulin, USSR Ch 1986.

13 ... ♕a3

and now:

1) **14 ♔h1** ♗c6 15 f5 ♘xb3 16 axb3 ♕a5 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♖xf6 ♕e5 19 ♖bf1 ♗e7 20 ♖f7 h5 21 ♕e3?! ♔d7 22 ♕d3 ♖af8 ∓ Lang-Soltau, corr 1977.

2) **14 f5** ♘xb3 15 ♖xb3 ♕c5+ 16 ♔h1 ♖c8?! 17 ♗h5 ♔e7 18 e5! ♕xe5 19 ♖e1 ♕c5 20 ♘e4 ♕e5 21 ♖xb7 ♖c4 22 ♘xf6 ♕xf6 23 ♗xf7! ♕xf7 24 fxe6 ♕f5 25 exd7+ ♖e4 26 ♖xe4+ 1-0 Milvidas-Marek, corr 1977.

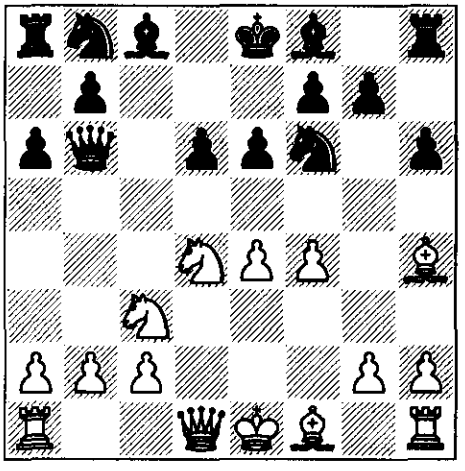
9 Poisoned Pawn: Other Lines

There are quite a few minor lines left over from the preceding chapters, and one major line, namely 8 ♘b3, which avoids offering the b2-pawn. The minor lines can be disposed of relatively rapidly, but 8 ♘b3 occurs surprisingly often in practice. Perhaps the main reason is that it is often adopted by white players lacking in confidence about their theoretical knowledge. It affords a relatively risk-free method of reaching a reasonable middlegame position without all the risks associated with the main lines of the Poisoned Pawn. Indeed, since the theoretical status of ...♕xb2 is rather comfortable for Black, this quiet line could be due for a revival.

However, there are sound positional reasons why this variation is unlikely to prove critical to the assessment of 7...♕b6. The knight retreat to b3 leaves White's minor pieces less aggressively posted than in the other lines of the 6 ♗g5 Najdorf, and Black can often simply drop his queen back to c7, confident that with the knight on b3 White's attacking potential will be significantly reduced. Indeed, if 8 ♘b3 were forced, you could be sure that all black players would send the queen out to b6 before playing it to c7.

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♕b6

Or **7...h6 8 ♗h4 ♕b6** *(D)* (very rarely seen these days) and now:



1) **9 a3** (not so sharp as 9 ♕d2 or 9 ♕d3, but it could be best because White's bishop can move to f2 with gain of tempo) and now:

1a) **9...♗d7** 10 ♗f2 ♕c7 (alternatively, 10...♘g4 11 ♗g1 ♕xb2 12 ♔d2 ♘f6 13 ♘b3 ± Chiesa-Mariotti, corr 1975 or 10...♕xb2? 11 ♘de2 ♗b5 12 ♗d4 +– Juhnke-Mayer, corr) 11 ♕f3 ♗e7 12 0-0-0 ♘c6 (12...e5?! 13 fxe5 ♗g4 14 exf6!! ♗xf3 15 ♘d5 ± Hanu-Simu, corr 1961) 13 g4 (13 ♗d3 is possible, for example 13...♘xd4 14 ♗xd4 e5 15 fxe5 dxe5 16 ♕g3!) g5 14 ♘xc6 ♗xc6 15 fxg5 hxg5 16 ♗d4 ♖h6 17 h4 ♘d7 18 h5 ± Tal-F.Olafsson, Bled Ct 1959.

1b) **9...♘c6** 10 ♗f2 ♕c7 11 ♕f3 ♗e7 12 ♗d3 (12 0-0-0 may transpose to 1a after 12...♗d7) ♗d7 13 h3 (13 0-0-0 transposes to 13 ♗d3 in line 1a) 0-0-0 14 ♘b3 ♘a5 15 0-0 (15 ♘xa5 ♕xa5 16 ♕e3 ♕c7 17 a4 ±

Timperi-Graefe, corr) ♗c6 16 ♘d4 d5 17 e5 ♘d7 18 b4 ♘c4 19 b5! gave White a clear plus, Nezhmetdinov-Topover, USSR 1959.

2) **9 ♕d2** ♕xb2 10 ♖b1 (10 ♘b3 is very similar to chapter 8) ♕a3 and now 11 e5 is bad since 11...dxe5 12 fxe5 ♘fd7 13 ♗c4 ♗e7! prevents 14 ♖b3 because the capture on h4 is check (see also line A of chapter 5). However, White's alternative 11th moves are quite playable. The result may just be a transposition to lines in which Black plays ...h5, but any differences are generally in White's favour (e.g. Black has weakened g6 and he cannot play ...♗h6).

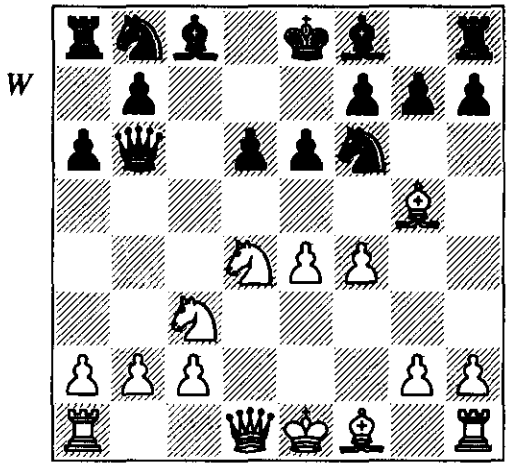
3) **9 ♘b3** ♕e3+ 10 ♗e2 and now both 10...♘xe4 11 ♘xe4 ♕xe4 12 0-0 ♘c6 and 10...♕xf4 11 ♗g3 ♕e3 12 ♗xd6 ♘c6 are fine for Black (this latter position was won twice by Tal in the 1958 Munich Olympiad, once with White and once with Black!).

4) **9 ♕d3** (this is the sharpest line) ♕xb2 (9...♘c6 10 0-0-0 is dubious, just as in line 5 of the note to White's 8th move) 10 ♖b1 (10 ♘b3!?) ♕a3 11 e5 (11 ♗e2) and now:

4a) **11...♘d5** 12 ♘xd5 ♕xd3 13 ♗xd3 exd5 14 e6! (14 ♔d2 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♗e7) fxe6 (14...♘c6 15 exf7+ ♔xf7 16 ♘xc6 bxc6 17 ♖b6 c5 18 c4! d4 19 0-0 ♖a7 20 ♖e1 ♖b7 21 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 22 f5 ± Mikenas-Tal, Riga 1952; 14...♗e7 15 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 16 ♘f5+ ±) 15 ♗g6+ ♔d7 16 ♗f7 (16 f5 e5 17 ♘e6 b5 18 a4 is also dangerous, Martynov-Bönsch, corr 1964) e5 17 ♘f5 d4 (17...♔c6 18 ♘e3 d4 19 ♘d5) 18 0-0 ♘c6 19 ♗d5 ♔c7 20 fxe5 dxe5 21 ♗g3 with a strong initiative for White, Shilin-Sherbakov, USSR 1959.

4b) **11...dxe5** 12 fxe5 ♘d5 (the move 12...♘fd7 is universally given as losing to 13 ♘xe6, but 13...♕a5 14 ♘xf8 ♘xf8 15 ♗e2 ♘g6 16 ♗g3 0-0 doesn't look bad for Black) 13 ♘xd5 exd5 (13...♕xd3? 14 ♘c7+ ♔d7 15 ♗xd3 ♔xc7 16 ♖f1 wins) 14 e6 ♕xd3 (14...♗b4+ is bad after 15 ♖xb4 ♕xb4+ 16 c3 ♕c5 17 exf7+ ♔xf7 18 ♗e2! or 15 ♔d1 ♕xd3+ 16 ♗xd3 ♗e7 17 exf7+ ♔xf7 18 ♖f1+ ♗f6 19 ♗xf6 gxf6 20 ♖b6 ♘d7 21 ♖d6 with an unpleasant ending for Black) 15 exf7+ ♔xf7 16 ♗xd3 ♘d7 17 ♗f5 (17 ♖f1+ ♘f6 18 ♗xf6 gxf6 19 ♖b6 ♗e7 is fine for Black) ♗c5 18 ♗xd7 (18 ♗e6+ ♔g6 19 ♗f5+ ½-½ Parma-Sofrevski, Yugoslavia 1960) ♗xd4 19 ♗xc8 ♖axc8 20 ♖xb7+ ♔g6 with an equal position.

We return to the main line after 7...♕b6 *(D)*:



8 ♘b3

As there are several minor variations at this point, here is a list to help readers locate the line they are looking for: 8 ♕d3 is line 1, 8 a3 is line 2, 8 ♗xf6 gxf6 9 ♗e2 is line 3, 8 f5?! is line 4 and 8 ♕d2 ♘c6 is line 5.

The detailed analysis runs:

1) **8 ♕d3** (this had a brief burst of popularity in the 1980s, but it has now been abandoned) ♕xb2 (if Black declines the pawn, the queen's ability to swing directly to the king-side at g3 or h3 becomes dangerous, for example 8...♘c6 9 0-0-0 ♗d7 10 ♗e2 ♖c8 11 ♘xc6 ♗xc6 12 ♗xf6 gxf6 13 ♗h5 ♕c5 14 ♕h3 ♗d7 15 ♖d2 b5 16 e5 f5 17 exd6 ♗xd6 18 ♔b1 ± Liss-Loginov, Budapest 1993 or 8...♘bd7 9 0-0-0 ♗e7 10 ♕h3 ♘c5?! 11 e5 dxe5 12 fxe5 ♘d5 13 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 14 ♗d3 ♗d7 15 ♕g3 ± Van der Wiel-Quinteros, Biel IZ 1985) 9 ♖b1 (9 ♘b3 is possible, but the queen would appear to be worse placed on d3 than d2, since it is subject to attack by Black's b8-knight) ♕a3 (the position of the queen at d3 is to White's advantage in some variations, e.g. where ♕g3 or ♕h3 may be played, but in other ways the queen is worse placed than at d2, e.g. the c3-knight cannot go to e4) and now:

1a) **10 ♗xf6** gxf6 11 ♗e2 ♕c5 (11...h5!?; 11...♘d7!?) 12 ♖f1 (12 ♘b3 ♕a7!?) ♘d7 13 ♗g4!? ♕a5 (13...h5!) 14 ♖f3 ♘c5 15 ♕d2 ♗d7 ∓ Pirttimäki-Magerramov, Uzhgorod 1988.

1b) **10 f5** and now:

1b1) **10...♗e7** 11 ♗e2 (11 ♕c4 0-0! 12 fxe6 fxe6 13 ♘xe6? b5 −+) ♘c6 12 fxe6 fxe6 13 ♘xc6 bxc6 14 e5 (14 0-0 ♕a5 15 ♗xf6 gxf6 ∓) dxe5 15 ♗xf6 gxf6 and we have transposed to line 1b2 below.

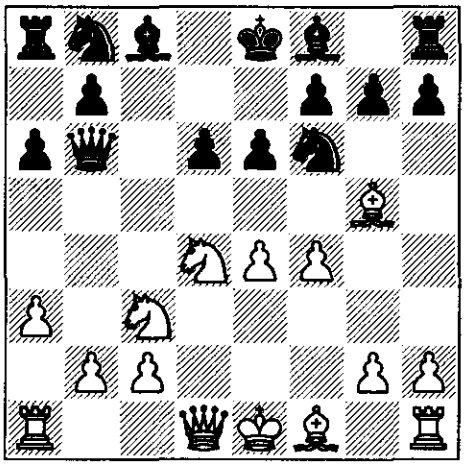
1b2) **10...♘c6** 11 fxe6 fxe6 12 ♘xc6 bxc6 13 e5 dxe5 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 ♗e2 ♗e7! (15...♗c5 16 ♗h5+ ♔e7 17 ♕g3 and now not 17...♗d7? 18 ♕g7+ ♔d6 19 ♖d1+ ♗d4 20 ♖xd4+! exd4 21 ♕g3+ ♔c5 22 ♘e4+ ♔b4 23 c3+! with a winning attack, but 17...♖g8! 18 ♕xg8 ♕xc3+ with perpetual check) 16 ♗h5+ ♔f8 17 0-0 (or 17 ♕d2 ♔g7! and now 18 ♘d5 ♖d8! 19 ♖b3 ♖xd5 20 ♖xa3 ♖xd2 21 ♖g3+ ♔h6 is good for Black, so Nunn-Kasparov, Brussels 1986 continued 18 ♖b3 ♕a5! 19 0-0 ♖g8 20 ♔h1 ♔h8, but this too gave Black the advantage) e4! 18 ♕h3 f5 19 ♔h1 (19 ♖b3 ♕c5+ 20 ♔h1 ♕e5 is good for Black) ♖g8! 20 ♖b3 ♕c5 ∓ Van der Wiel-Gavrikov, London 1985.

1c) **10 ♗e2** ♘bd7 11 0-0 ♕c5 (11...♗e7 12 ♔h1 h6 13 e5 hxg5 14 exf6 gxf6 15 fxg5 ♘e5 16 ♕e3 f5 with a clear plus for Black, Veerman-Van der Wiel, Utrecht 1986) 12 ♔h1 ♗e7 13 ♘b3 (13 a4!? ♕c7 14 ♖f3 {14 f5 ♘c5 15 ♕e3 0-0 16 ♘b3, Van Gaalen-Miles, Utrecht 1986, 16...b6! ∓} h6 15 ♖h3, Nieuwenhuis-Nunn, Utrecht 1986, 15...♖g8 16 ♗h4 g5 17 ♗g3 gxf4 18 ♗xf4 e5 19 ♘f5 exf4 20 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 21 ♖xh6 ♕c5! and Black defends) ♕c7 14 ♕g3 h6 15 ♗xf6 (15 ♗h4 g5 16 fxg5 hxg5 17 ♗xg5 ♖g8 ∓) ♗xf6 16 e5 dxe5 (16...♘xe5 17 ♘e4 ♘g6 is another idea) 17 ♘e4 0-0 18 f5 was Frank-Paust, San Bernardino 1983, and now 18...exf5 19 ♖xf5 ♗e7! 20 ♖bf1 (20 ♘d4 ♗d8! and the knight has to retreat) b6 21 ♘d4 ♘c5! enables Black to defend.

2) **8 a3** *(D)* and now:

2a) **8...♘bd7** 9 ♗e2 ♗e7 (very sensible play by Black) 10 ♘b3 h6 11 ♗xf6 (11 ♗h4 ♘xe4) ♗xf6 12 ♕d2 ♘c5 13 0-0-0 ♘xb3+ 14 cxb3 ♗e7 15 ♔b1 ♗d7 16 ♔a2 ♗c6 =

B



Vl.Georgiev-Ermenkov, Bulgarian Ch 1995.

2b) **8...♗e7** 9 ♕d2 h6 (9...♕xb2? 10 ♘b3 h6 11 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 12 e5! +–) 10 ♗xf6 (the defect of this line from White's point of view is that he normally has to meet ...h6 by ♗xf6, since ♗h4 runs into ...♘xe4) ♗xf6 11 0-0-0 0-0 (11...♗xd4 12 ♕xd4 ♕xd4 13 ♖xd4 ♔e7 14 ♗e2 ♘c6 with just an edge for White) 12 ♘b3 ♖d8 13 h4 a5 14 g4 a4 15 ♘d4 ♗xd4 16 ♕xd4 ♕xd4 17 ♖xd4 e5! 18 fxe5 ♘c6 19 ♖xd6 ♗xg4 20 ♗b5 ♘xe5 21 ♖b6! ± Timman-Van der Wiel, Amsterdam 1991.

2c) **8...♘c6** 9 ♘b3 ♗e7 (9...h6 10 ♗xf6 gxf6 11 ♕f3 ♗d7 12 0-0-0 0-0-0 13 ♘a4 ♕a7 14 c4 ♘a5 15 ♘xa5 ♗xa4 16 ♖d2 ♗e7 17 ♗e2 ♔b8 ∞ Murei-Quinteros, Lucerne OL 1982; 9...♕e3+ 10 ♕e2 ♕xe2+ 11 ♗xe2 b5 12 0-0-0 h6 13 ♗xf6 gxf6 14 ♗h5 ♖g8 15 g3 ♗b7 16 ♖hf1 ♔e7 17 ♖de1 ♗g7 18 ♘d5+ ♔f8 19 ♘b4 ♖c8 20 c3 ♔e7 21 ♖f2 ♖gd8 22 ♖d2 ± Nijboer-Van Wely, Netherlands Ch 1995) and now:

2c1) **10 ♕f3** with a final branch:

2c11) **10...♕c7** 11 0-0-0 (11 ♗h4 b5 12 0-0-0 ♗b7 13 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 14 ♗xb5 ♗xc3 15 ♗xc6+ ♕xc6 16 ♕xc3 ♕xc3 17 bxc3 ♗xe4 18 ♖xd6 ♗xg2 19 ♖g1 ♗e4 20 ♘c5 ♗f5 21 ♖xa6 ♖xa6 22 ♘xa6 ± Murei-Hjartarson, Brighton 1982; 11 ♗e2 ♖b8 12 ♕g3 h6 13 ♗h4 0-0 14 0-0 b5 15 ♔h1 ♘d7 16 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 17 ♖ad1 e5 18 fxe5 dxe5 19 ♘d4 ♘b6 = Ivanchuk-Topalov, Dos Hermanas 1996) h6 (11...♗d7 12 ♗h4 ♖c8 13 g4 h6 14 ♗g3 e5 15 g5 ♗g4 16 ♕g2 hxg5 17 fxg5 ♘h5 18 ♘d5 ♗xg5+ 19 ♔b1 ♕d8 ∞ Murei-Sigurjonsson, Randers Z 1982) 12 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 13 h4 h5 (13...♗d7 14 g4 0-0-0 15 ♗g2 ♗e7 16 g5 ♘a5 17 ♘xa5 ♕xa5 18 ♔b1 ♔b8 19 ♕g3 hxg5 20 hxg5 g6 21 ♖h6 ♖c8 22 ♖dh1 ♖hd8 23 ♖h7 ± Grünfeld-Adamson, Philadelphia 1994) 14 g3 ♗d7 15 ♖h2 0-0-0 16 ♖hd2 ♗e7 17 ♕e3 ♔b8 18 ♘a4 ♘a5 19 ♘xa5 ♗xa4 20 ♘c4 ♗c6 ± Grünfeld-Psakhis, Herzliya 1993.

2c12) **10...h6** 11 ♗h4 g5 12 ♗f2 ♕c7 13 g3 b5 14 0-0-0 ♗b7 15 ♗h3 ♖c8?! 16 ♖he1 ♖g8 17 ♕e2 g4 18 ♗g2 b4?! 19 ♘d5! exd5 20 exd5 ♘b8 21 axb4 ♔f8 22 ♔b1 ± Murei-Ftačnik, Hastings 1982.

2c13) **10...0-0** (a risky idea) 11 0-0-0 ♕c7 12 g4 b5 13 ♗g2 ♖b8? (13...♗b7 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 15 g5 ♗e7 16 ♕g3 ∞) 14 e5 ♘d5 15 ♖xd5! exd5 16 ♘xd5 ♕d7! 17 ♘a5! ♘xa5 18 ♘xe7+! ♔h8 19 f5! ♗b7 20 f6! ♗xf3 21 fxg7+ ♔xg7 22 ♗f6+ ♔h6 23 ♗xf3 ± Donchev-Nikolov, Bulgaria 1987.

2c2) **10 ♕d2** 0-0 (10...h6 11 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 12 0-0-0 ♗e7 13 h4 ♕c7 14 g4 ♗d7 15 ♕f2 b5 16 ♖h3 ♕a7 17 ♕d2 ♖b8 18 g5 b4 ∞ Vl.Georgiev-Mariano, Matinhos Wch jr 1994; 10...♗d7 11 0-0-0 0-0-0 12 ♗h4 ♕c7 13 ♗f2 ♔b8 14 ♗d3 ♗c8 15

♔b1 ± Zak-Szekely, Groningen 1994) 11 0-0-0 ♖d8 12 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 13 g4 ♗d7 (13...♘a5 14 ♘xa5 ♕xa5 15 g5 ♗e7 16 ♔b1 ♗f8 17 ♗c4 ♕c5 18 ♗b3 b5 19 ♖hf1 a5 ∞ Necesany-Stodola, corr 1988; 13...♗e7!?) 14 g5 ♗e7 15 h4 ♘a5 16 ♘xa5 ♕xa5 17 ♔b1 (17 h5 ♖ac8 18 h6 g6 19 ♔b1 ♕c5 20 ♕d4 ♕xd4 21 ♖xd4 e5 22 ♖b4 b5 23 ♘d5 ♖e8 24 fxe5 dxe5 25 ♘xe7+ ♖xe7 26 ♗e2 ♗e6 was equal in Tanis-Wagemans, corr 1991) ♕c5 (17...♕b6!? 18 ♗c4? d5 ∓ Primett-O'Connor, corr 1993) 18 h5 b5 19 g6 a5 20 h6 fxg6 21 hxg7 ± Timman-Sisniega, Taxco IZ 1985.

3) **8 ♗xf6** gxf6 (after 8...♕xb2 9 ♗b5+ {9 ♘xe6!?} the lines 9...axb5 10 ♘dxb5 ♕b4 11 ♘c7+ ♔d7 12 ♖b1 ♕c5 13 ♘xa8, 9...♘c6 10 ♘xc6 axb5 11 ♘d5! gxf6 12 ♖b1 and 9...♗d7 10 ♘xe6 fxe6 11 ♕h5+ g6 12 ♕d1 are all very good for White; however, 9...♘d7 may be playable) 9 ♗e2 and now Black can try:

3a) **9...♘c6** 10 ♘b3 ♕e3 11 ♖f1 (11 ♕d2 ♕xd2+ 12 ♘xd2 ♘d4 13 ♗d3 ♔d8 14 0-0 ♗d7 15 ♘c4 ♔c7 16 ♖ad1 ♗e7 17 ♘e3 b5 18 ♘b1 ♘c6 = Vitolinš-Petrosian, Daugavpils 1989) b5 (11...♗e7 12 ♖f3 ♕g1+ 13 ♗f1 ♕xh2 14 ♕d2 ♕h4+ 15 g3 ♕h5 16 ♕f2 f5 {16...♗e7 17 0-0-0 ♘a5 18 ♘d4 ♔c6 19 f5 ∞ Hector-Gavrikov, Palma de Mallorca GMA 1989} 17 exf5 ♕xf5 18 0-0-0 h5 19 ♗d3 ♕g4 20 ♗e2 ∞ Hector-Schandorff, Tåstrup 1990) 12 ♕d3 ♕xd3 13 cxd3 ♗b7 14 ♖c1 ♗e7 15 d4 ± ♗d8? 16 ♘xb5! axb5 17 ♗xb5 ♖xa2 18 ♖f2 ± Boudre-Gravagna, Massy 1993.

3b) **9...♖g8!** (developing a piece with gain of tempo before taking on b2) 10 ♗f3 (10 g3?! ♕xb2 11 ♘a4 ♕a3 12 c3 ♘d7! ∓) ♕xb2 11 ♘a4 ♕a3 12 c3 ♘d7! 13 0-0? (13 ♕c2 b5 14 ♘b2 ♗b7 15 0-0 ♖c8 16 ♘b3 ♗h6 ∓) b5 −+ 14 ♗h5 ♕xa4 15 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 16 ♕h5+ ♔g7 17 ♘xe6+ ♔h8 18 ♘d8 ♕c4! 19 ♔h1 ♖g7 0-1 K.Harman-Magerramov, corr 1992.

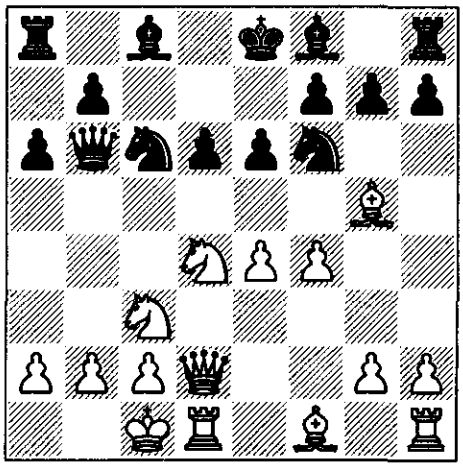
3c) **9...♕xb2** 10 ♘a4 ♕a3 (safer than 10...♕b4+ 11 c3 ♕a5 12 0-0 ♗d7 13 ♘b2 ♘c6 14 ♘c4) 11 c3 and now:

3c1) **11...♗d7** 12 ♘b6 ♕xc3+ 13 ♔f2 ♕c5 14 ♘xa8 ♘c6 15 ♖c1 ♕a7 (15...♕xd4+ 16 ♕xd4 ♘xd4 17 ♗h5 f5 18 ♖c7 fxe4 19 ♖xb7 ♗e7 20 ♘c7+ ♔f8 21 ♖b8+ ♔g7 22 ♖xh8 ♔xh8 23 ♗xf7 ± Harman-Barnsley, corr 1991) 16 ♕b3 ♘xd4 17 ♕b6 (17 ♕e3 ♗h6 18 ♖c4 e5! 19 ♘c7+ ♔d8 20 ♘d5 ♗b5 ∓) ♕xb6 18 ♘xb6 ♘xe2 19 ♖c7 ♗c6 20 ♖c8+ ♔e7 21 ♖c7+ ♔d8 22 ♖c8+ ½-½ Kengis-Magerramov, Pavlodar 1987.

3c2) **11...♘d7** 12 0-0 b5 13 ♗h5 bxa4 (13...♕xa4 14 ♗xf7+ ♔d8 15 ♘xe6+ ♔e7 16 ♕h5 ♘b6 17 ♘d4 b4 ∞ Moldovan-Bouaziz, Bucharest 1992) 14 ♗xf7+ ♔e7 15 ♘c6+ ♔xf7 16 ♕h5+ ♔g7 17 ♘d4? (White must take the draw) ♖g8 18 ♘xe6+ ♔h8 with an easy win for Black, Hector-H.Olafsson, Reykjavik Z 1995.

4) **8 f5?!** ♕xb2 9 ♘a4 ♕a3 10 c3 ♗d7 11 fxe6 fxe6 12 ♗xf6 (Pinter gives 12 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 13 ♗c1 ♗b3 14 ♗xa3 = but 12...♗xa4 looks very good for Black) gxf6 13 ♕h5+ ♔e7 14 ♗c4 ♕xa4 ∓ Murei-Pinter, Malta OL 1980.

5) **8 ♕d2** ♘c6 (this appears illogical; the queen is badly placed on b6) 9 0-0-0 *(D)* (the only critical move) and now:



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5a) **9...♗d7** 10 ♗e2 ♖c8 (Loginov has been virtually the only player to take Black's side in this position) 11 ♔b1 (11 ♗f3 ♘a5 12 ♘b3 ♘c4 13 ♕d3 h6 14 ♗h4 g5 15 fxg5 hxg5 16 ♗xg5 ♗g7 17 ♔b1 {17 ♕d4!?} ♘xb2 18 ♔xb2 ♘g4 19 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 20 ♖xd6 ♗xc3+ 21 ♔b1 ♘xh2 = Lengyel-Loginov, Budapest 1994) ♗e7 12 ♘b3 (12 ♘f3 0-0 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘d5 15 ♘xd5 exd5 16 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 17 ♗d3 ♗f5 = Bauer-Loginov, Hungary 1994) 0-0 13 ♖hf1 (13 g4 looks natural) ♖fd8 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 15 ♕xd6 ♗e7 16 ♕d3 ♗e8 17 ♕f3 and Black has only slight compensation for the pawn, Lengyel-Loginov, Budapest 1993.

5b) **9...♕xd4** 10 ♕xd4 ♘xd4 11 ♖xd4 (it was established in the late 1950s that this ending is depressing for Black) ♗d7 (11...♘d7 {11...b5!?} 12 ♗e2 h6 13 ♗h4 g5 14 fxg5 ♘e5 and now either 15 ♘a4 ♗e7 16 ♘b6 ♖b8 17 ♗g3 hxg5 18 ♖hd1 f6 19 c4 0-0 20 ♖4d2 ± Keres-Panno, Gothenburg IZ 1955 or 15 gxh6 ♗xh6+ 16 ♔b1 ♗e3 17 ♗f6! ♖xh2 18 ♖xh2 ♗xd4, Klaić-Letić, corr 1987, 19 ♘b5! +–) 12 ♗e2 ♗c6 13 ♗f3 ♘d7 14 ♖hd1 f6 15 ♗h4 e5 16 fxe5 dxe5 17 ♖4d2 ± ♗b4? 18 ♗h5+ ♔e7 19 ♖xd7+ ♗xd7 20 ♘d5+ ♔d8 21 ♘xb4 +– Domanski-Gawlikowski, Polish Ch 1955.

8 ... ♘bd7

Or:

1) **8...♕e3+** 9 ♕e2 ♕xe2+ 10 ♗xe2 (this endgame is marginally better for White) and now:

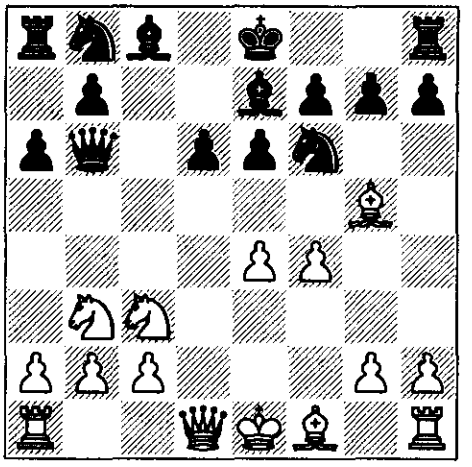
1a) **10...b5** 11 ♗xf6 gxf6 12 ♗h5 followed by 0-0-0, ♖f1 and f5 with an edge for White.

1b) **10...♘c6** 11 ♗f3 (11 0-0-0 h6 12 ♗h4 ♗e7 13 ♗f2 b5 14 ♗f3 ♘d7 15 ♖he1 ♗b7 16 a3 0-0-0 17 a4 b4 18 ♘d5 exd5 19 exd5 ♘ce5 20 fxe5 ♘xe5 21 ♗e4 ± Semionova-Wohlfahrt, Balatonbereny 1994) ♗d7 12 0-0-0 ♗e7 13 ♘a4 0-0-0 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 ♘b6+ ♔b8 16 ♘xd7+ ♖xd7 17 ♗h5 ♗d8 18 ♖hf1 ♖g8 19 g3 ♗b6 20 ♖f3 ± Stein-Gligorić, Stockholm IZ 1962.

1c) **10...♘bd7** 11 0-0-0 (11 a4 ♗e7 12 0-0-0 h6 13 ♗h4 e5 14 f5 ± Joppen-Bronstein, Belgrade 1954; 11 ♗f3 ♖a7 12 0-0-0 b5 13 ♘a5 h6 14 ♗h4 ♖c7 15 e5 dxe5 16 fxe5 b4 17 ♘a4 ♘h7 18 ♗c6 ♗e7 19 ♗f2 ½-½ was Tukmakov-Kots, Ukraine 1962) b6 (11...♗e7 12 ♘a5! ♘b6 Leidecker-Kunath, corr 1979, 13 ♗f3 ±) 12 f5 e5 13 ♗c4 ♗b7 14 ♗d5 ♘xd5 15 ♘xd5 ♖c8 16 ♖he1 ♗xd5 17 ♖xd5 ± Keres-Van den Berg, Munich OL 1958.

2) **8...♗e7** *(D)* (this section contains mostly lines without ...♘bd7, except where they cannot normally arise by transposition from the main line) and now:

2a) **9 ♕d2** h6 (alternatives will probably transpose to other lines) 10 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 11 0-0-0 ♗e7 12 ♔b1 ♕c7 13 ♗e2 ♘d7 14 ♖hf1 0-0 15 g4



b5 16 ♗f3 ♘b6 17 h4 b4 ∓ Slobodjan-Stohl, Hamburg 1993.

2b) **9 ♕d4** ♕c7 (9...♕xd4 10 ♘xd4 ♘c6 is equal) 10 0-0-0 ♘bd7 (10...♘c6 11 ♕d2 0-0 is a position that could arise from the Richter-Rauzer; after 12 ♗xf6 gxf6 13 ♗d3 ♔h8 14 g4 ♖g8, Murei-Gavrikov, Amsterdam 1987, 15 ♖hg1, followed by h4 and g5, the position is unclear) 11 ♗e2 b5 12 ♖he1 ♗b7 13 e5?! dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘xe5 15 ♗f4 ♘fd7 16 ♘xb5 axb5 17 ♗xb5 0-0-0 18 ♗xd7+ ♖xd7 19 ♕xe5 ♕xe5 20 ♗xe5 ♗g5+ 21 ♔b1 ♖xd1+ 22 ♖xd1 f6 23 ♗g3 ♗xg2 ∓ Jakovljević-Maksimenko, Yugoslavia Cht 1994.

2c) **9 ♕e2** h6 10 ♗xf6 (not 10 ♗h4? ♘xe4) ♗xf6 and now:

2c1) **11 e5** dxe5 12 fxe5 ♗e7 (12...♗g5?! 13 ♘e4 ♕e3 14 ♘d6+ ♔e7 15 g3 b5 16 ♗g2 ♖a7 17 ♖f1 ± Kuhnert-Søgaard, corr 1991) 13 0-0-0 ♘c6 14 h4 (14 g3 ♕c7 15 ♖e1 ♗d7 16 ♗g2 ♖c8 17 ♖hf1 0-0 18 ♔b1 ♗b4 19 ♖f3 ♘a5 20 a3 ♘xb3 21 cxb3 ♗e7 22 ♖d3 ♖fd8 ∓ Belkhodja-Guerra, Lucerne OL 1982) ♕c7 15 ♖e1 ♗d7 16 ♖h3 b5?! 17 ♕g4 g6 18 ♖he3 b4 19 ♘d1 a5 20 ♔b1 a4 21 ♘d2 ♘a5 22 ♗d3 h5 23 ♕g3 b3 24 ♖f1 ± Karklins-Verber, USA 1971.

2c2) **11 0-0-0** and now:

2c21) **11...♕c7** (a necessary precaution if Black intends ...♘c6) 12 h4 b5 (12...♗xc3 13 bxc3 ♗d7 14 ♖h3 ♘c6 15 ♖hd3 ♘e7 16 ♖xd6 ♗c6 17 f5 ♗d5 18 exd5 ♕xd6 19 dxe6 ♕f4+ 20 ♔b2 0-0 21 g4 ± Kupreichik-Novikov, Erevan 1984) 13 ♖h3 (13 a3 ♘c6 14 ♖h3 b4 15 axb4 ♘xb4 16 g4 ♖b8 17 ♔b1 ♗d7 18 ♕d2 ♗e7 19 g5 ♕b6 = Short-Sigurjonsson, Westmann Islands 1985) b4 (13...♘d7 transposes to line 2c221) 14 ♘b1 (14 e5 dxe5 15 ♘e4 ♗e7 16 ♕g4 0-0 17 ♖g3 g6 18 h5 exf4 19 hxg6 f5 20 ♕h5 ♔g7 21 ♖h3 ♖h8 22 ♘ed2 ♘c6 ∓ Savon-Ilinčić, Borovo 1991) ♘d7 (14...♘c6 15 ♘1d2 a5 16 ♘c4 ♗e7 17 ♕d2 a4 18 ♘d4 ♘xd4 19 ♕xd4 e5 20 fxe5 dxe5 21 ♘xe5 ♗xh3 22 ♗b5+ ♔f8 23 gxh3 ∞ Serrano-Alcala, corr 1987) 15 ♕d2 ♕b7 16 ♕xd6 ♕xe4 17 ♘1d2 ♕b7 18 ♘a5 ♕b8 19 ♘dc4 ♗e7 20 ♕d4 ± Kupreichik-Gavrikov, Lvov 1984.

2c22) **11...♘d7** 12 h4 with a final branch:

2c221) **12...♕c7** 13 ♖h3 b5 14 ♕d2 ♗e7 15 g4 (15 ♖g3 g5 16 hxg5 hxg5 17 f5 ♘e5 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♗e2 ♗d7 20 ♖xg5 0-0-0 21 ♖g7 ♗f8 22 ♖xd7 ♔xd7 ∓ Ivanović-Marjanović, Yugoslavia Ch 1985) ♗b7 16 a3 ♖c8 17 ♔b1 ♘c5 18 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 19 g5 hxg5 20 hxg5 ♖xh3 21 ♗xh3 = Delaney-Escalante, Dubai OL 1986.

2c222) **12...♘c5** 13 ♘xc5 (13 e5!?) ♕xc5 14 e5 dxe5 15 ♘e4 ♕a5 16 ♘d6+ ♔f8 17 ♘c4 (17 ♕c4 ♔e7 18 ♘b5! ♔f8 is a draw) ♕xa2 18 fxe5 ♗e7 19 ♕f3 (19 ♖h3!?) ♕a1+ 20 ♔d2 ♕a4 21 ♗d3 ♗d7 22 ♖hf1 ♗e8 23 ♕xb7 ∞ Diaz-Novikov, Manzanillo 1987.

2c223) **12...♗xc3** (this line is fine for Black) 13 bxc3 ♘f6 (13...♘c5!? 14 g4 ♗d7 15 ♗g2 0-0-0 16 ♖d2 ♘a4 17 ♖h3 ♔b8 18 ♕d1 ♗b5 19 ♗f1 ♗xf1 20 ♕xf1 ♖c8 21 ♖dd3 ♖c6 22 ♖hf3 ♖hc8 ∓ Schoneberg-Sutkus, corr 1988) 14 ♖h3 (14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘d5 16 ♖d4 ♕c7 17 c4 ♘e7 18 ♖h3 ♗d7 19 ♖hd3 ½-½ Mikhalchishin-Petrosian, USSR Ch 1985) ♗d7 15 c4 e5 16 f5 ♕c7 (or 16...♕c6 17 ♖e3 a5 {17...g5 18 c5 dxc5 19 ♖ed3 c4 20 ♖d6 ♕xe4 21 ♘c5 ♕f4+ 22 ♕d2 ♕xd2+ 23 ♖1xd2 is clearly better for White, Ljubojević-Ribli, Amsterdam 1986} 18 g4 a4 19 ♘d2 0-0-0 20 ♘b1 ♕c5 21 ♖c3 ♗c6 22 ♗g2 ♔b8 23 ♗f3 g6! ∓ Deppe-Novikov, Moscow 1990) 17 ♖g3 (17 g4 ♗c6 18 ♗g2 a5! 19 ♖hd3 with an edge for Black, V.Kozlov-Magerramov, USSR 1987) ♗c6 18 ♖e3 0-0-0 19 g4 a5 20 ♗g2 ♕b6 ∓ Battiato-Alemanni, corr 1984.

2d) **9 ♕f3** and now:

2d1) **9...h6** 10 ♗xf6 (10 ♗h4 ♘xe4 11 ♗xe7 ♘xc3 12 ♕xc3 ♔xe7 13 ♕xg7 ♕e3+ 14 ♗e2 ♖f8 15 ♕xh6 ± Malevinsky-Machulsky, USSR 1976) ♗xf6 11 0-0-0 ♕c7 12 ♘e2 (12 ♘d4 ♘c6 13 ♘xc6 bxc6 14 g3 ♖b8 15 ♗g2 d5 16 e5 ♗e7 ∓ Brdicko-Zagorskis, Pardubice 1995) ♘d7 13 ♔b1 b5 14 ♘ed4 ♗e7 15 ♗d3 ♗b7 16 f5 e5 17 ♘e2 b4 = Enders-Szekely, Budapest 1995.

2d2) **9...♕c7** giving rise to a final branch:

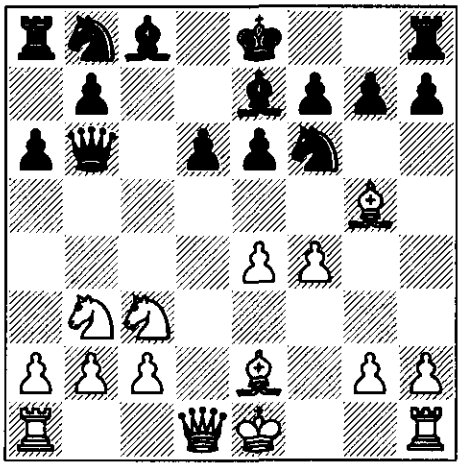
2d21) **10 ♗d3** h6 11 ♕h3 (11 ♗h4 ♘xe4 12 ♗xe7 ♘xc3 13 ♗h4 ♘d5 14 a3 ♘d7 15 0-0-0 ♘7f6 16 h3 ♗d7 17 ♖hf1 0-0-0 18 g4 ♔b8 ∓ Safianovsky-Machulsky, Moscow 1991) ♘c6 12 ♗h4 ♗d7 13 0-0-0 0-0-0 14 ♖he1 g5! ∓ Kolmann-Stachanczyk, corr 1992.

2d22) **10 a4** b6 11 ♗d3 ♗b7 12 0-0 (castling kingside is rather unusual in this line) ♘bd7 13 ♖ae1 h6 14 ♗h4 0-0 15 ♕h3 ♖fe8 16 ♗f2 e5 17 ♗e3 exf4 18 ♗xf4 ♘e5 = Ankerst-Csonkics, Yugoslavia Cht 1990 (similar positions arise in the note to White's 10th move in the main line).

2d23) **10 0-0-0** ♘c6!? (10...♘bd7 transposes to the main line) 11 g4 (11 ♗h4 0-0! 12 g4 b5 13 ♗xf6!? ♗xf6 14 g5 ♗e7 15 h4 b4! 16 ♘e2 ♗b7 17 ♔b1 ♖ac8 18 ♖d2 d5! ∓ Seirawan-Andersson, Tilburg 1992) ♗d7 12 ♗h4 h6 13 ♗g3 e5 14 f5 ♘a5 15 h4 ♘xb3+ 16 axb3 ♗c6 17 ♗f2 ± Ziatdinov-Hogenacker, Berlin Summer 1993.

2e) **9 ♗e2** *(D)* and now:

B



2e1) **9...♕e3** 10 ♕d3 (10 ♕d4!?) ♕xd3 11 cxd3 (this ending is slightly better for White) h6 12 ♗xf6 (12 ♗h4 ♘xe4 13 ♗xe7 ♘xc3 14 ♗xd6 ♘xe2 15 ♔xe2 ♘c6 16 ♖hc1 f6 17 a4 e5 ½-½ Ivanchuk-Yudasin, USSR Ch 1988) ♗xf6 13 d4 b6 (13...♘c6 14 0-0-0 0-0 15 d5 exd5 16 ♘xd5 ♗d8 17 ♗f3 ♗e6 18 g3 ♖e8 19 ♔b1 ♖c8 20 ♖d3 = Yudasin-Grünberg,

Moscow 1989) 14 ♗f3 ♗b7 15 0-0 ♘d7 (15...♗e7? 16 f5! h5 17 ♖ae1 ♘d7 18 e5! d5 19 ♗e2 ♗g5 20 ♗d3 ± Ljubojević-Portisch, Reggio Emilia 1991) 16 ♖ac1 ± ♖c8? 17 e5! ♗xf3 18 exf6 ♗a8 19 fxg7! ♖g8 20 ♘d5! ♖d8 21 ♘c7+ ♔e7 22 d5! ± Yudasin-Novikov, Pamplona 1990.

2e2) **9...h6** 10 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 11 ♕d3 and now:

2e21) **11...♘d7** 12 0-0-0 ♗e7 13 h4 ♕c7 (13...♘c5 14 ♕g3 ♘xb3+ 15 axb3 ♖g8 16 e5 ♗d7 17 f5 dxe5 18 ♗h5 0-0-0 19 ♗xf7 ♖gf8 20 ♕g6 ♗f6 21 ♖xd7 ♔xd7 22 fxe6+ ♔e7 23 ♘e4 ± Oll-Novikov, Debrecen 1990) 14 g4 (14 ♗f3 ♘b6 15 g4 ♗d7 16 g5 0-0-0 17 ♘d4 hxg5 18 hxg5 g6 19 ♔b1 ♔b8 20 f5 gxf5 21 exf5 ♗xg5 ½-½ Palkövi-A.Petrosian, Siofok 1990) b5 15 ♗f3 ♖b8 16 g5 b4 17 ♘e2 a5 18 ♔b1 (18 g6 0-0! 19 gxf7+ ♖xf7 20 ♗h5, Oll-Mrdja, Rome 1990, 20...♖f6! 21 ♖hg1 ♗f8 22 ♔b1 a4 23 ♘d2 ♘c5 24 ♕g3 e5! ∓) a4 (18...e5!?) 19 ♘bd4 ♘c5 20 ♕e3!? (20 ♘b5 ♘xd3 21 ♘xc7+ ♔d7 22 cxd3 ♔xc7 23 d4 ♗b7 24 ♖c1+ ♔d7 ∓) ♗a6 21 f5 e5 22 f6! exd4? (22...gxf6 23 ♘f5 hxg5 24 hxg5 ♖xh1 25 ♖xh1 fxg5 26 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 27 ♕xg5+ ♔d7 ∞) 23 fxg7 ♖g8 24 ♘xd4 hxg5 25 hxg5 ♘e6 26 g6 ♖xg7 27 gxf7+ ♔d7 28 ♘xe6 ♔xe6 29 e5! ♕c5 30 ♕h6+ ♔xf7 31 ♗h5+ ♔f8 32 ♕h8+ 1-0 Rogalewicz-Stachanczyk, corr 1993.

2e22) **11...♘c6!?** 12 0-0-0 (12 ♕xd6 ♗xc3+ 13 bxc3 ♕e3) 0-0 13 h4 a5! 14 a3 ♗d7?! (14...a4 15 ♘d2 ♘d4 16 ♘c4 ♕c6 17 e5 dxe5 18 fxe5 ♘xe2+ 19 ♕xe2 ♗e7 ∞) 15 ♘a4 ♕a7 16 ♕xd6 ♖ac8! 17 ♕c5 and Black does not have enough for the pawn, Brodsky-Kupreichik, Beskidy 1991.

3) **8...h6** 9 ♗xf6 gxf6 (9...♕e3+ 10 ♗e2 {10 ♕e2 ♕xe2+ 11 ♗xe2 gxf6 12 ♗h5 ♗e7 13 0-0-0 ♗d8 14 ♖d3 ♘c6 15 a3 ♗c7 16 ♔b1 ♗d7 17 ♘d1 ♔e7 18 ♘e3 ± Yudasin-Savon, St Petersburg 1996} gxf6 11 ♖f1 ♗d7 12 ♖f3 ♕g1+ 13 ♗f1 ♖g8 14 ♕d2 ♘c6 15 0-0-0 ♕a7 16 ♔b1 0-0-0 17 a4 ♕b6 18 ♖h3! ± Zaitsev-Alzate, Havana 1983; this line should favour White as he is effectively a tempo up over line 3a in the note to White's eighth move) and now:

3a) **10 f5** h5 11 ♗e2 ♕e3 12 ♕d3 ♕xd3 13 cxd3 ♘d7 14 0-0 ♔e7 15 d4 ♘b6 16 ♖ad1 ♗d7 17 ♘a5 ± Van den Berg-F.Olafsson, Beverwijk 1961.

3b) **10 ♕f3** ♘c6 11 0-0-0 ♗d7 12 ♔b1 0-0-0 13 ♕h5 ♗e8 14 g3 ♔b8 15 ♗h3 ♕c7 16 ♖he1 ♖g8 17 ♖d2 ± Matanović-Bertok, Yugoslavia 1966.

3c) **10 ♕e2** ♘c6 11 0-0-0 ♗d7 12 g3 0-0-0 13 ♗g2 ♔b8 14 ♔b1 ♘a5 15 ♕h5 ♘xb3 16 axb3 ♗e8 17 f5 ♕c5 18 ♗h3 ♕e5 19 ♖he1 ± Ptschelkin-Kupshis, corr. 1984.

3d) **10 ♕d2** ♘c6 11 0-0-0 (this is similar to the Richter-Rauzer and in some lines a direct transposition is possible) ♗d7 12 ♗e2 (12 g3 0-0-0 13 f5 ♔b8 14 ♗h3 h5 15 ♔b1 is best met by 15...♗c8!? 16 fxe6 fxe6 17 ♘e2 ♘e5 18 ♕c3 ♗g7! = Krylov-Kupshis, corr 1984, rather than 15...♗e7 16 ♘e2 ♘e5 17 ♘f4 ♘f3 18 ♕e2 ♘g5 19 ♗g2 ± Kaplan-Shamkovich, Teesside 1975) h5 13 ♖hf1 0-0-0 14 ♔b1 (14 ♖f3 ♔b8 15 a3 ♗c8 16 ♘a4 ♕a7 17 ♘a5! ♖d7 18 ♖b3 ♘xa5 19 ♕xa5 ± I.Zaitsev-Barkovsky, USSR 1983) ♗e7 (the

famous game Keres-Botvinnik, Moscow 1956 continued 14...♘a5 15 ♖f3 ♘xb3 16 axb3 ♔b8 17 ♘a4 ±) 15 ♖f3 ♔b8 16 ♖h3 (16 ♗f1 intending ♘a4 is a more conventional plan) h4 17 ♕e1 ± Lanka-Petkevich, Riga 1977.

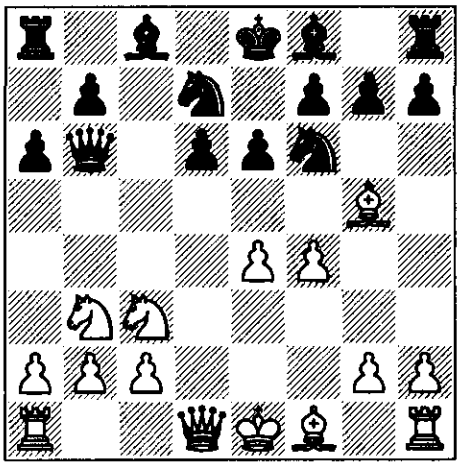
4) **8...♘c6** (some GMs believe that the knight is misplaced on this square) and now:

4a) **9 ♕f3** ♗e7 10 0-0-0 (10 ♗d3 ♗d7 11 0-0-0 ♖c8 12 ♖he1 h6 13 ♗h4 ♕c7 14 ♗g3 ♘b4 15 ♔b1 ♘xd3 16 cxd3 0-0 17 ♖c1 ♕b8 18 e5 dxe5 19 fxe5 ♘h7 ½-½ Gufeld-Kärner, Tallinn 1981) ♕c7 11 ♗d3 ♗d7 12 ♖he1 h6 13 ♗h4!? ♘xe4 14 ♖xe4 ♗xh4 15 ♕g4 ♗f6 16 ♘d5 ♕d8 17 ♗c4 ♔f8 ∞ Chiburdanidze-Martinović, Baku 1980.

4b) **9 ♗xf6** (White should not play this voluntarily) gxf6 10 ♕d2 h5 (10...♗e7 11 0-0-0 ♗d7 12 ♔b1 0-0-0 13 ♗e2 ♖hg8 14 ♗h5 ♖g7 15 g3 ♔b8 16 ♕e2 ♖c8 17 ♖d3 ♘a5 18 ♘xa5 ♕xa5 19 ♕d1 ± Brodsky-Jansen, Porz 1993) 11 0-0-0 ♗d7 12 ♔b1 ♕c7 13 f5 ♘e5 14 g3 b5 15 ♗h3 ♘c4 16 ♕d3 b4 17 ♘e2 ♗b5 ∓ Sinz-Touzane, Altensteig 1993.

4c) **9 ♕d2** (the most natural move; indeed, White is almost a tempo up over line 2c2 in the note to White's eighth move) ♘g4 (9...♗e7 10 0-0-0 ♕c7 11 ♗e2 ♗d7 12 ♔b1 ♖c8 13 ♖he1 h6 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 ♗h5 ♔f8 16 ♖e3 ± Maier-Dubeck, Donaueschingen 1985) 10 ♘d1 (10 ♗d3 ♘b4 11 ♘a4 ♘xd3+ 12 cxd3 ♕a7 13 h3 ♗d7 14 hxg4 ♗xa4 15 f5 ♖c8 16 ♗e3 ♕b8 ∞ Luther-Loginov, Balassagyarmat 1990; 10 ♕e2! looks most promising to me) h6 11 ♗h4 g5 12 ♕e2 ♘d4 13 ♘xd4 ♕xd4 14 c3 ♕a4 15 fxg5 hxg5 16 ♗xg5 ♖xh2 = Lengyel-Loginov, Budapest 1994.

Returning to the main line after 8...♘bd7 *(D)*:



9 ♕f3

Alternatively:

1) **9 ♗d3** (harmless) ♗e7 (9...h6 10 ♗xf6 ♕e3+ 11 ♕e2 ♕xe2+ 12 ♗xe2 ♘xf6 13 0-0 ½-½ Boey-Govbinder, corr 1978) 10 ♕e2 h6 11 ♗h4 (11 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 12 ♘d1 0-0 13 c3 ♘c5 ∓ Valtera-Bores, Prague 1995) ♘xe4 12 ♗xe7 ♘xc3 13 bxc3 ♔xe7 ∓ Rosinow-Nieminski, corr 1980.

2) **9 ♕d2** ♕c7 and now:

2a) **10 ♗e2** b5 11 a3 ♗b7 12 ♗f3 ♗e7 is harmless, e.g. 13 0-0 0-0 14 ♕e2 ♖ac8 15 ♖ad1 ♘b6 16 ♖d3 ♘c4 17 ♘d1 ♖fd8 ∓ Stenborg-Holst, corr 1978 or 13 0-0-0 0-0 14 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 15 g4 ♖fd8 16 g5 ♘d7 17 h4 ♖ac8 18 g6 fxg6 19 ♗g4 ♘f8 20 ♘d4 ♕c4 ∓ Sgri-Pontecorvo, corr 1988.

2b) **10 0-0-0** ♗e7 (10...b5 11 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 12 ♗d3 b4 13 ♘e2 ♖b8 14 ♘ed4 ♗e7 15 g4 h6 16 ♔b1 g6 17 ♕e2 e5 18 g5 hxg5 19 fxg5 ♘h5 20 ♘f3 ♘f4 ∓ Kovacs-Loginov, Budapest 1990) 11 ♗d3 (11 g4 b5 12 ♗xf6 gxf6 13 ♗d3 ♘c5 14 ♘d4 b4 15 ♘ce2 ♗b7 16 ♘g3 d5 17 ♕e3

0-0-0 18 ♔b1 h5! 19 ♘xh5 dxe4 20 ♗e2 ♘a4 ∓ Beliavsky-Palatnik, USSR 1974) h6 12 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 13 ♘e2 b5 14 g4 g5 15 ♔b1 ♗b7 16 ♖hf1 ♖f8 17 h4 gxh4 18 ♘a5 ♘c5 ∞ Ziatdinov-Heuer, Bern 1994.

3) **9 ♗e2** and now:

3a) **9...♗e7** 10 ♕d3 (10 ♕d2 h6 11 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 12 0-0-0 ♕c7 13 ♗f3 ♗d7 14 ♔b1 0-0-0 15 ♖he1 ♔b8 16 ♖e3 with just an edge for White, Ljubojević-Hübner, Linares 1985) ♕c7 (the position is equal after 10...h6 11 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 {11...♗xf6 12 0-0-0 ♔e7?! 13 ♖d2 ♕c7 14 ♘d4 ♘b6 15 a4 ♗d7 16 a5 ± Brodsky-Mitenkov, Katowice 1993} 12 0-0-0 ♕c7 13 ♗f3 ♖b8 14 h4 h5 15 f5 ♗d7 16 ♔b1 ♖c8 17 ♖he1 e5, Yudasin-Gavrikov, USSR Ch 1988) 11 ♗f3 (preventing ...b5; 11 0-0-0 b5 12 a3 ♖b8 13 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 14 g4 b4 15 axb4 ♖xb4 16 g5 ♘d7 17 ♕g3 d5 18 e5 ♘c5 ∓ Palkövi-Arsović, Budapest 1991) and now:

3a1) **11...h6** 12 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 (or 12...♗xf6 13 0-0-0 ♗xc3 14 ♕xc3 ♕xc3 15 bxc3 e5 16 g3 ♔e7 17 ♘a5 exf4 18 gxf4 g5 with equality, Nijboer-Van der Wiel, Netherlands Ch 1992) 13 0-0-0 e5 14 f5 b5 (14...♗d7 15 ♔b1 b5 16 ♘d2 ♖c8 17 h4 h5 18 ♘d5 ♘xd5 19 exd5 ♕b6 = Ljubojević-Kir.Georgiev, Novi Sad OL 1990) 15 ♔b1 ♗b7 16 g4 ♖c8 17 h4 ♘d7 18 ♘d5 ♗xd5 19 exd5 ♗d8 = Hraček-Ftačnik, Brno 1992.

3a2) **11...♖b8** and now:

3a21) **12 h4** b5 (12...h5!?) 13 g4 b4 14 ♘e2 a5 15 ♘bd4 a4 (15...♘c5 16 ♕e3 ♘cxe4?! 17 ♗xe4 ♘xe4 18 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 19 ♕xe4 ♗b7 20 ♕e3 ♗xh1 21 f5 e5 22 f6+! ♔d7 23 fxg7 exd4 24 gxh8♕ dxe3 25 ♕xh7 ± Nijboer-De Boer, Wijk aan Zee 1992) 16 ♕e3 ♕c5 17 a3!? h6 18 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 19 g5 ♗d8! 20 axb4 ♖xb4 21 0-0-0 ∞ Nijboer-Van Wely, Wijk aan Zee 1993.

3a22) **12 0-0-0** b5 13 ♗xf6 (13 ♔b1 b4 14 ♘e2 a5 15 g4 a4 16 ♘bd4 ♕c5 17 e5!? dxe5 18 ♘c6 e4! 19 ♗xe4 ♖b6 20 ♘xe7 ♗a6 21 ♕f3 ♔xe7 22 f5 ♖c8 23 ♗e3 ♕e5 24 ♗d3 ∞ Krakops-Novikov, Riga 1995) ♘xf6 14 g4 b4 15 ♘e2 e5 16 f5 ♘d7 17 ♔b1 a5 18 ♘g3 (18 h4 a4 19 ♘bc1 ♘c5 20 ♕d2 ♗a6 21 g5 b3 22 cxb3 axb3 23 a3 ♘a4 24 ♘c3 ♘xc3+ 25 ♕xc3 ♕xc3 26 bxc3 = Groszpeter-Kir.Georgiev, Odorheiu Z 1995) 0-0 19 h4 a4 20 ♘d2 a3 21 b3 ♗a6! 22 ♕xa6 ♕c3 23 ♘c4 ♘c5 24 ♕a7 ♕xf3 25 ♕xe7 ♕xg3 = Yudasin-Oll, Seville 1992.

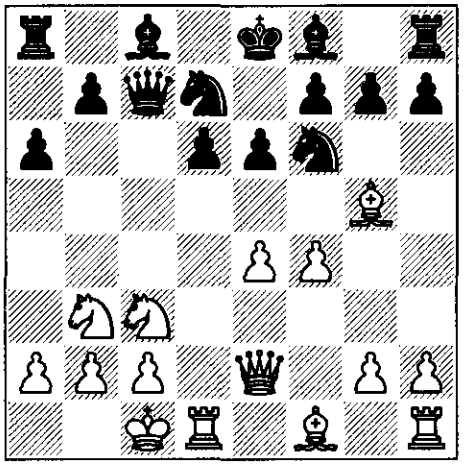
3b) **9...♕c7** 10 ♗f3 (10 ♕d2 is line 2a above) ♗e7 (10...♖b8 11 ♕d2 b5 12 0-0-0 h6 13 ♗h4 ♘b6 14 ♖he1 b4 15 ♘e2 ♘c4 16 ♕d3 ♗e7 17 ♘ed4 e5 18 ♘f5 ♗xf5 19 exf5 ± Luther-Weber, Bundesliga 1990/1) 11 ♕d3 transposes to 3a above.

3c) **9...h6** 10 ♗h4 ♕e3 11 ♕d2 ♕xd2+ 12 ♔xd2 b5 13 a3 ♗b7 14 ♗f3 ♖c8 15 ♖ae1 g5 16 fxg5 ♘h7 17 g6 fxg6 18 ♗g4 ♗e7 19 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 20 ♘d4 ± Ginsburg-Nevostruev, Smolensk 1992.

4) **9 ♕e2** ♕c7 (after 9...h6, 10 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 11 g3 ♗e7 12 ♗g2 ♕c7 13 0-0-0 e5 14 h4 0-0 15 f5 b5 ∞ is Gufeld-Palatnik, USSR 1981 while 10 ♗h4 will probably transpose to the main line of this note) 10 0-0-0 *(D)* (10 g3 b5 11 0-0-0 b4 12 ♘b1 ♘xe4? 13 ♕xe4 ♗b7 14 ♕c4! ± Luther-Touzane, Lippstadt 1994; 10 g4 b5 11 ♗g2 b4 12 ♗xf6 gxf6 13 e5

bxc3! 14 ♗xa8 cxb2 15 ♖d1 dxe5 16 f5 ♗b4+ 17 ♔f1 ♘b6 ∓ Mi.Tseitlin-Bangiev, Odessa 1971) and now:

B



4a) **10...h6** 11 ♗h4 ♗e7 12 ♗g3 (alternatives will probably transpose to 4b or 4c) e5 13 f5 b5 14 ♗f2 ♗b7 15 ♔b1?! (15 a3) b4 16 ♘d5 ♘xd5 17 exd5 ♖c8! ∓ Velimirović-Marjanović, Yugoslavia 1977.

4b) **10...b5** (this section contains mostly lines in which ...b5 and a3 are played; for other variations see line 4c) 11 a3 (11 g4 b4 {11...♗e7 transposes to line 4c3} 12 ♘b1 ♗b7 13 ♗g2 ♖c8 14 ♖d2 ♗e7 15 ♖hd1 e5 = Hage-Langeveld, corr 1991) ♗b7 (11...♗e7 may be met by 12 g4 ♖b8 13 ♗g2 b4 14 axb4 ♖xb4 15 ♗h4 ♘c5 16 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 17 ♖d3 ♕a5 18 ♔b1 ♗b7 19 g5 ♘d7 20 ♗e1 ♕b6 21 ♘d1 ♘c5 22 ♗xb4 ♘xd3 23 ♗d2 ♘c5 24 f5 ∞ Mikhailov-Sorokin, corr 1977 or 12 g3 h6 {12...♗b7 transposes to the main line} 13 ♗h4 ♗b7 14 ♗g2 ♖c8 15 ♖he1 g5 16 fxg5 hxg5 17 ♗xg5 ♖xh2 18 ♗h4 ♘e5 ∓ Kunte-Kohler, corr 1983) and now:

4b1) **12 g3** ♗e7 13 ♗g2 ♘b6 (13...h6 14 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 15 e5 dxe5 16 ♘xb5 ♕b6 17 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 18 ♖xd6 ♕xd6 19 ♗xb7 ♖a7 20 fxe5 ♕b6 21 ♗xa6 ♕xa6 22 ♕xa6 ♖xa6 23 exf6 gxf6 24 c4 ∞ Ljubojević-Browne, Buenos Aires 1980) 14 ♘a5 ♘a4 15 ♘xb7 ♘xc3 16 bxc3 e5 17 fxe5 dxe5 18 ♗xf6 gxf6 19 ♖d3 ♗xa3+ 20 ♔b1 ♕xb7 21 ♖hd1 ∞ E.Karlsson-Raymaekers, corr 1980.

4b2) **12 g4** ♖c8 13 ♗h4 (13 ♗g2 ♗e7 14 ♗h4 h6 15 ♗g3 ♘c5 16 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 17 ♖he1 ♘d7 18 e5 ♗xg2 19 ♕xg2 d5 20 f5 b4 21 axb4 ♕xb4 22 f6 gxf6 23 exf6 ♗xf6 24 ♕xd5 0-0 ∓ Barczay-Rashkovsky, Sochi 1979) ♘b6 14 g5 ♘fd7 15 f5 e5 16 ♗f2 ♘c4 17 ♖d3 ♘db6 18 ♗h3 ♘a4 19 ♘xa4 bxa4, Grabczewski-Tal, Lublin 1974, 20 f6! ±.

4b3) **12 ♗h4!** ♗e7 13 ♗e1 (13 ♔b1 ♖c8 14 g4 ♘xe4 15 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 16 ♕xe4 ♗xh4 17 ♗d3 d5 18 ♕f3 ∓ Gromotka-Scholcin, corr 1983) 0-0 14 ♔b1 ♖fd8 15 g4! ♘c5 16 ♗g2 ♘xb3 17 cxb3 ♗c6 18 g5 ♘d7?! (18...♘e8!?) 19 ♘d5! exd5 20 exd5 ♗b7 21 ♕xe7 ± Telbis-Popescu, Romanian Ch 1989.

4c) **10...♗e7** and now:

4c1) **11 ♗h4** b5 12 a3 ♗b7 transposes to line 4b3 above.

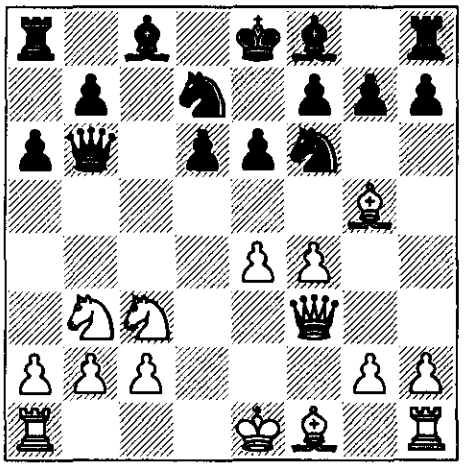
4c2) **11 g3** h6 (11...b5 12 ♗g2 ♗b7 13 e5! dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘d5 15 ♗xe7 ♘xc3 16 bxc3 ♗xg2 17 ♗d6 ♕b7 18 ♖hf1! ♗xf1 19 ♖xf1 ± L.Bronstein-Quinteros, Argentine Ch 1975) 12 ♗h4 (12 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 13 ♖d3 b5 14 ♗g2 ♖b8 15 ♖hd1 ♗e7 16 ♘d4 0-0 17 g4 b4 18 ♘a4 ♘c5 ∓ Kretek-Trichkov, Czech Cht 1993) b5 13 ♗g2 ♖b8 14 ♖he1 b4 (or 14...♗b7 15 a3 ♘b6 16 g4 g5! 17 ♗g3 gxf4 18 ♗xf4 ♘c4 ∓ Martinović-Marjanović, Vrnjačka Banja 1976) 15 ♘d5 (15 ♘b1?! e5 16 ♘3d2 0-0 17 ♘f1 a5 18 ♘e3 ♖e8 19 ♗h3?

b3! and Black is distinctly better, Martinović-Vaisman, Stara Pazova 1981) exd5 16 exd5 0-0 17 ♕xe7 ♖e8 18 ♕xe8+ ♘xe8 19 ♖xe8+ ♘f8 ∓ Loh-Soltau, corr 1975.

4c3) **11 g4** h6 (11...b5 12 ♗g2 ♖b8 13 ♗h4 h6 14 ♗g3 ♘b6 15 e5 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♘fd7 17 ♘d4 ♗b7 18 ♗xb7 ♕xb7 19 ♘e4 ± Chiburdanidze-Azmaiparashvili, USSR 1981) 12 ♗h4 (12 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 13 ♖d3 g5? 14 e5! dxe5 15 f5 ♘c5 16 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 17 ♘e4 ♕e7 18 ♕f3 exf5 19 gxf5 ♖g8 20 ♗h3 ± Riabchonok-Psakhis, Volgograd 1977) g5 13 fxg5 (13 e5 dxe5 14 fxg5 ♘h7 15 ♗g2 hxg5 16 ♗g3 ♘hf8 17 ♗e4 ♖g8 18 ♘d2 ♖b8 19 ♘c4 f6 20 h4 gxh4 21 ♗xh4 b5 ∓ Boudre-Renet, French Cht 1991) ♘h7 14 ♗g3 hxg5 15 e5 (15 h4 gxh4 16 ♗xh4 ♘g5 17 ♔b1 ♘e5 18 ♗g2 ♖g8 19 ♗g3 ♗d7 20 ♖h5 0-0-0 21 ♗f4 ♖g7 ∓ Malevinsky-Doroshkevich, USSR 1976) ♘xe5 16 ♘e4 (16 ♖d4 ♗d7 17 ♗g2 ♖c8 18 ♖e1 b5 19 ♘e4 ♘f6 20 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 21 ♖xd6 ♕xd6 22 ♗xe5 ♕e7 23 ♖f1 ♖h6 ∞ Stavenhagen-Schwibbe, corr 1989) d5 17 ♗g2 dxe4 18 ♕xe4 ♗f6 19 ♖de1 ♘f8 20 ♖hf1 ♗g7 21 ♗xe5 ♗xe5 22 ♕xe5 ♕xe5 23 ♖xe5 ♖xh2 24 ♗e4 ♘h7 25 ♘a5 ♔e7 26 ♖c5 ♘f6 27 ♖c7+ ♔d6 28 ♖xf6 ♔xc7 29 ♖xf7+ ♔d8 (29...♔d6 30 ♘c4+ ♔c5 31 ♖c7+ ♔d4 32 ♗g6 ♖h6 33 c3+ ♔d5 34 ♘b6+ ♔d6 35 ♘xa8 ♗d7 36 ♗e4 1-0 Canova-Carvalho, corr 1988) 30 ♘c4 e5 31 ♘b6 ♖b8 32 ♖f8+ ♔c7 with equality, Kupreichik-Tal, USSR Ch 1979.

Going back to the main line after 9 ♕f3 *(D)*:

9 ... ♗e7



Or **9...♕c7** and now:

1) **10 ♗d3** b5 11 0-0 (11 a3 ♗e7 12 ♗h4 h6! 13 ♗f2 g5! 14 g3 ♗b7 15 0-0-0 ♖g8 16 ♖he1 gxf4 17 gxf4 ♘c5 18 ♖g1 0-0-0 = Grinfeld-Szekely, Groningen 1975) ♗b7 12 ♖ae1 b4 13 ♘e2 ♗e7 14 ♔h1 0-0 15 ♕h3 ♖fe8 16 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 17 ♘g3 e5 18 fxe5 dxe5 19 ♘f5 ♗f8 20 ♖e3 g6 21 ♕h4 ♘h5 22 ♖h3 ♕d8 ∓ I.Almasi-Vaulin, Budapest 1991.

2) **10 f5** ♗e7 11 ♗e2 ♘e5 12 ♕h3 b5 13 a3 ♖b8 14 0-0-0 b4 15 axb4 ♖xb4 16 ♖d4 ♘c6 17 ♖xb4 ♘xb4 18 ♖d1 e5 19 ♗d3 ♗b7 20 ♗d2 h6 = Van der Wiel-Sunye Neto, Graz 1981.

3) **10 ♗xf6** ♘xf6 11 g4 b5 (or 11...g6 12 ♗g2 ♗g7 13 0-0-0 ♘d7 14 h4 h5 15 g5 ♘b6 16 f5 ♗e5 17 ♖hf1 ♘c4 18 ♗h3 b5 19 ♘d4! b4 20 ♘ce2 ± Dementiev-Peresypkin, USSR 1972) 12 a3 ♗b7 13 g5 ♘d7 14 0-0-0 g6 15 h4 ♖c8 16 ♖h2 ♘b6 17 ♘d4 d5 18 exd5 ♗d6 19 ♔b1 ♘xd5 20 ♘e4 ♗xf4 ∓ Pavlov-Kavalek, Halle Z 1963.

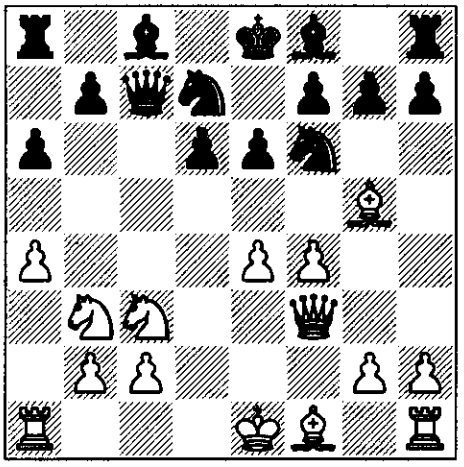
4) **10 0-0-0** b5 (10...♗e7 and 10...h6 11 ♗h4 ♗e7 transpose to the main line) and now:

4a) **11 a3** ♗b7 (11...♖b8 12 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 13 ♖d4 ♗e7 14 ♗e2 0-0 15 g4

e5 16 ♘d5 ♘xd5 17 ♖xd5 b4 18 a4 ♗b7 with a clear plus for Black, Bakalarz-Loginov, Wisla 1992) 12 ♗xf6 (12 g4 ♗e7 13 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 14 g5 ♘d7 15 ♖g1 g6 16 ♕h3 ♘c5 17 ♘d2 ♖c8 18 ♗d3 d5 19 exd5 ♘xd3+ 20 ♕xd3 exd5 ∓ Westerinen-Minev, Halle Z 1963) ♘xf6 13 f5 exf5 (13...e5 14 g4 h6 15 h4 ♕b6 16 ♗g2 ♗e7 17 g5 ♘d7 18 f6! gxf6 19 gxh6 ♖xh6 20 ♗h3 ∞ Ciocaltea-Najdorf, Havana 1962; 13...d5!? 14 fxe6 dxe4 15 exf7+ ♔xf7 16 ♕f2 ♗xa3 17 ♗xb5 ♖hd8 18 ♖hf1?? ♕xc3 0-1 Cotofan-Popescu, corr 1987) 14 ♕xf5 ♗e7 15 ♘d5 ♘xd5 16 exd5 ♗f6! 17 ♗d3 ♗e5 18 h4 ♗xd5! 19 ♗xb5+ axb5 20 ♖xd5 0-0 ∓ Ciocaltea-Tringov, Sofia 1962.

4b) **11 ♗d3** ♗b7 (11...b4 12 ♘e2 ♗b7 13 ♔b1 ♗e7 14 g4 a5 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 ♗b5 ♖d8 17 ♘g3 ♕b6 18 ♗xd7+ ♖xd7 19 ♘h5 a4 20 ♘xf6+ gxf6 21 ♘d4 = Kostadinov-Petrov, corr 1990) 12 ♖he1 ♗e7 13 a3 (13 g4 b4 14 ♘e2 a5 15 ♔b1 0-0 16 ♕h3 e5 17 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 18 g5 ♗e7 19 ♘g3 g6 20 ♘f5 gxf5 21 exf5 ♖fe8 22 f6 e4 23 ♖xe4 ♗xe4 24 ♗xe4 ♘xf6 25 gxf6 ♗xf6 26 ♖g1+ ♔f8 27 ♕h6+ 1-0 Celis-Juarez, Villa Balester 1996; 13 ♕h3 b4 14 ♘e2 ♘xe4?! {14...a5 =} 15 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 16 f5 ∞ Yudasin-Yoffe, USSR 1979) h6 (13...♖c8 14 ♕g3 h6 {14...e5 15 ♔b1 ♘h5? 16 ♕g4 ♘xf4 17 ♗xf4 exf4 18 ♘d5! ± Westerinen-O'Kelly de Galway, Havana 1967} 15 ♗h4 g5 16 fxg5 ♖g8 = 17 ♕f4?? hxg5 0-1 Pax-Puth, Kettig 1994; 13...0-0-0 14 ♕e2 h6 15 ♗h4 g5 16 ♗g3 ♖hg8 17 ♔b1 g4 18 ♗h4 ♘c5 19 ♘xc5 dxc5 20 e5 ♘d5 21 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 22 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 23 c4 ± Triebskorn-Schoppmeyer, corr 1988) 14 ♕h3 0-0-0 15 ♗h4 g5 16 ♗g3, Ivanez Rico-Popescu, corr 1991, 16...g4! 17 ♕h4 h5 ∓.

5) **10 a4** *(D)* and now:



5a) **10...b6** 11 ♗d3 ♗b7 12 0-0 ♗e7 (12...g6 13 ♖f2 ♗g7 14 ♖af1 0-0 15 ♕h3 ♘c5 16 f5 ♘fd7 17 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 Howell-Sowray, London Lloyds Bank 1994, 18 ♗e3! ♕e5 19 ♗f4 ±) 13 ♖ae1 (13 ♕h3 h6 14 ♗h4 0-0 15 ♘d4 ♕c5 16 ♗f2 ♕h5 17 ♕g3 ♕g4 18 ♕e3 ± Sax-Nunn, Hastings 1977) 0-0 (13...h6 14 ♗h4 g5 15 ♗g3 gxf4 16 ♗xf4 ♘e5 17 ♕e2 ♘fd7 18 ♘d2 ♗g5 19 ♗g3 h5 20 ♘f3 ♗f6 21 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 ± Renet-H.Olafsson, Reykjavik 1992) 14 ♕h3 e5 15 ♘d5 (15 ♔h1 ♖fe8 16 ♘d2! ♘f8 17 ♗c4 exf4?! 18 ♗xf4 ♘g6 19 ♗g5 ♗c8 20 ♕g3 ♗e6 21 ♗xf6! ♗xf6 22 ♘d5 ♗xd5 23 ♗xd5 ♖ad8 24 c3 ± Stein-Parma, Lvov 1962) ♗xd5 16 exd5 ♖fe8 17 ♘d2 g6 18 f5 ♕d8 19 fxg6 fxg6 20 ♖e3 ♘f8 21 ♖ef3 ♘6d7 22 ♗h6 ♘f6 23 ♘e4 ♘xe4 24 ♗xe4 ± Shabalov-Chachère, Geneva 1992.

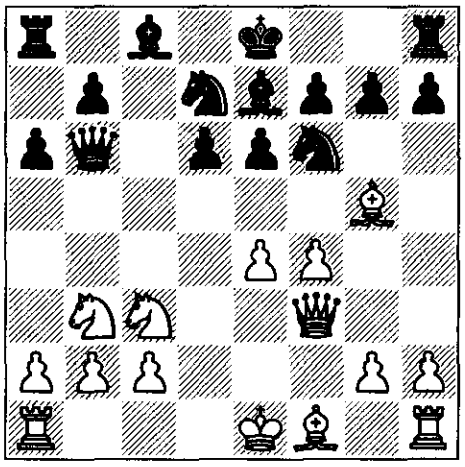
5b) **10...♗e7** 11 ♗d3 h6 12 ♕h3 (12 ♗h4 ♘xe4) ♖g8 (12...♘c5 13 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 14 ♗h4 0-0 15 ♗f2 ♕c6 16 0-0 {16 ♕f3 b6 17 0-0 ♗b7

18 ♖ae1 ♘d7 19 ♕g3 ♗f6 20 ♗e3 ♗xc3 21 bxc3 ♕xc3 ∓ Haag-Barczay, Salgotarjan 1967} e5 17 f5 d5 18 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 19 exd5 ♕xd5 20 ♖ad1 e4 21 ♗xa6 ♕e5 22 ♗c4 ♗xf5 23 ♕b3 = Kantchev-Kaliwoda, corr 1988) and now:

5b1) **13 ♗h4** g5 14 fxg5 hxg5 15 ♗f2 g4 (15...♘e5 16 0-0-0 b6 17 ♖he1 ♖b8 18 ♗g1 g4 19 ♕e3 ♘fd7 20 ♔b1 ♘c5 = G.Schmidt-Norotmy, corr 1981; 15...b6 16 0-0 ♘e5 17 ♕e3 ♖b8 18 ♕e2 ♕b7 19 ♘d2 ♘fd7 20 ♗g3 g4 21 ♖f2 ♖g7 22 ♖af1 ± Gufeld-Suetin, USSR Ch 1966) 16 ♕e3 ♘e5 17 0-0 ♖h8 18 ♗g3 ♘h5 19 a5 ♘xg3 20 hxg3 ♗d7 and Black is distinctly better, G.Schmidt-Wittman, corr 1976.

5b2) **13 ♗xf6** ♗xf6 14 0-0 ♗xc3 (14...♘c5 15 ♖ae1 ♗xc3 16 bxc3 ♗d7 17 e5 0-0-0 18 ♕e3 ♘xa4 19 c4 ♗c6 20 exd6 ♖xd6 ∓ Gipslis-Minić, Lvov 1962) 15 bxc3 ♕xc3 16 ♖ad1 (16 e5 dxe5 17 fxe5 ♕xe5 18 ♖ae1 ♕d6 is more critical) ♕c7 17 ♘d2 ♘b6 18 ♖a1 a5 19 ♕g3 ♗d7 20 e5 ♗c6! ∓ Villun-Sorokin, corr 1970.

We now continue with the main line after 9...♗e7 *(D)*:



10 0-0-0

White may also play to castle kingside by **10 ♗d3** (10 ♗e2 ♕c7 11 a4 h6 12 ♕h3 ♖g8 13 ♗h4 g5 14 fxg5 hxg5 15 ♗f2 b6 16 ♕e3 ♗b7 17 ♗g3 ♘e5 18 0-0-0 ♖c8 19 ♖d4 ♘fd7 = Ljubojević-Quinteros, Linares 1981) and now:

1) **10...h6** 11 ♕h3 (not 11 ♗h4? ♘xe4 12 ♗xe7 ♘xc3 13 ♗xd6 ♕xd6 14 bxc3 ♘f6 ∓) ♘g4 (11...♘c5? 12 0-0-0 ♘xd3+ 13 ♖xd3 ♖g8 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 f5 ♗d7 16 fxe6 fxe6 17 ♕h5+ ♔d8 18 ♘d4 ± Suetin-Sakharov, USSR 1977; 11...♖g8 12 ♗h4 g5 13 ♗f2 ♕c7 14 g3 b5 15 a3 h5 16 0-0-0 ♗b7 17 ♖he1 ♘c5 18 ♘xc5 dxc5 19 e5 ♘g4 20 ♗g1 ♗f3 21 ♗e4 ♗xe4 22 ♘xe4 ± Schmidt-Niemynski, corr 1980) 12 ♗xe7 ♕f2+ 13 ♔d1 ♘e3+ 14 ♔c1 ♔xe7 15 g3 g5 16 ♘d1 ♘xd1 17 ♔xd1 ♘f6 18 ♖f1 ♕e3 = Kubler-Grabowski, corr 1975.

2) **10...♕c7** and now:

2a) **11 a4** h6 12 ♕h3 ♘c5 (or 12...♖g8 13 ♗h4 g5 14 fxg5 hxg5 15 ♗f2 g4 16 ♕e3 ♘e5 17 ♗e2 ♗d7 18 ♘d2 ♗c6 19 ♖f1 d5 20 ♗g3 dxe4 21 ♕d4 ♘fd7 22 ♘c4 f6 23 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 24 ♕xe4 ± Drzycimski-Kwolek, corr 1991) 13 a5 ♗d7 14 f5 0-0-0 15 ♗e3 d5 16 exd5 exd5 17 0-0 ♖he8 18 ♔h1 = Joecks-Magerramov, Budapest 1989.

2b) **11 0-0** ♖b8 (11...b5 12 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 13 e5 ♗b7 14 ♗e4 d5 15 ♗xd5 exd5 16 exf6 ♘xf6 17 ♖fe1+ ♔f8 18 ♘d4 ± Pinkas-Kosek, Karvina 1992) 12 ♖ae1 b5 13 ♔h1 ♗b7 14 a3 h6 15 ♕h3 ♖g8 16 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 17 f5 e5 18 ♖d1 ♘b6 ∞ Quang-Sleisz, Aggtelek 1993.

2c) **11 ♗h4** b5 12 a3 ♗b7 13 0-0 0-0 14 ♕h3 (14 ♗f2 ♘c5 15 ♘xc5

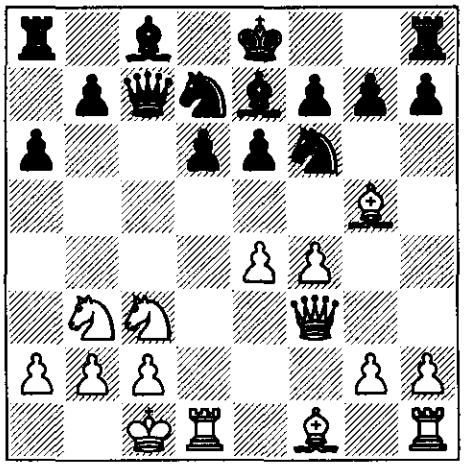
dxc5 16 ♖fd1? c4 17 ♗e2 ♘xe4 18 ♘xe4 f5 ∓ Klein-Otto, corr 1985; 14 ♕e2 ♘c5 15 ♘xc5 dxc5 16 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 17 e5 ♗e7 18 ♗e4 f5 19 exf6 ♖xf6 20 ♖ae1 ♗xe4 21 ♕xe4 ♖af8 22 g3 c4 = Selke-Gerold, corr 1982) e5 15 ♖ae1 (15 ♖f3 ♘c5 16 ♘xc5 ♕xc5+ 17 ♔h1 ♕c8 18 f5 ♕d7 19 g4 d5 20 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 21 exd5 ♗xd5 = Mehner-Adam, corr 1983) ♘c5 16 ♘xc5 ♕xc5+ 17 ♔h1 b4 18 axb4 ♕xb4 19 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 20 ♘d5 ♗xd5 21 exd5 g6 = Heinrich-Franke, corr 1973.

10 ... ♕c7 *(D)*

Or **10...h6 11 ♗h4** and now:

1) **11...♕c7** 12 ♗g3 (12 ♗d3 g5 is better for Black than the corresponding line of the Browne System, while 12 g4? g5 is absurd; 12 ♗e2 transposes into the following note) b5 13 e5 ♗b7 14 ♕e2 ♘d5 (this is better than 14...dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘h7 16 ♘e4! ♗g5+ 17 ♔b1 0-0 18 h4 ♗e7 19 ♘d6, Karpov-Quinteros, Leningrad IZ 1973, and now 19...♗c6 or 19...♖ad8 ±) 15 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 16 ♖xd5 exd5 17 e6 ♘f6 18 exf7+ ♔xf7 19 ♕f3 ∞.

2) **11...g5** 12 ♗f2 (12 fxg5 ♘e5 13 ♕e2 ♘fg4 14 ♘d4 hxg5 15 ♗g3 ♗d7 16 ♕d2 ♕c5 17 ♗e2 0-0-0 18 ♗xg4 ♘xg4 19 ♖hf1 ♗e8 20 ♕e2 ♘e5 = Krakops-Zagorskis, Berlin Summer 1993) ♕c7 13 g3 b5 14 ♗d3 (14 a3 ♗b7 15 ♗h3 ♖c8 16 ♕e2 ♕c4 17 ♕xc4 ♖xc4 18 ♘a5 ♖xc3 19 ♘xb7 ♖c7 20 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 21 ♖xd6 ♘xe4 ∓ Hausner-Ftačnik, Hradec Kralove 1981; 14 ♗g2 ♖b8 15 ♖he1! b4 16 ♘b1 e5 17 ♘1d2 a5 18 ♔b1 a4 19 ♘c1 ♘c5 20 f5 g4 21 ♕e3 ♗a6 22 ♗f1 ∞ ♘d5? 23 exd5 ♗g5 24 ♕xc5 dxc5 25 ♗xa6 ± Tukmakov-Bukhover, Ukrainian Ch 1963) ♗b7 (14...b4!? 15 ♘e2 ♗b7 16 ♗d4) 15 a3 ♘c5 (15...0-0-0!? 16 ♔b1 ♔b8 17 ♖he1 ±) 16 ♔b1 ♖c8?! (16...0-0-0!?) 17 ♖he1 ♘xd3 18 cxd3 e5 19 fxe5! dxe5 20 d4 ± Lutikov-Bannik, USSR Ch 1961.



11 ♗d3

There is a wide range of other moves:

1) **11 a4** (this has an odd appearance when White has castled queenside, but it is not so easy to exploit the weakening of White's king position) h6 12 ♗h4 g5 13 fxg5 ♘e5 14 ♕f2 ♘fg4 15 ♕g1 ♗d7 16 h3 ♘g6 17 ♗e1 ♗xg5+ 18 ♗d2 ∞ Chiburdanidze-Nunn, London Lloyds Bank 1985.

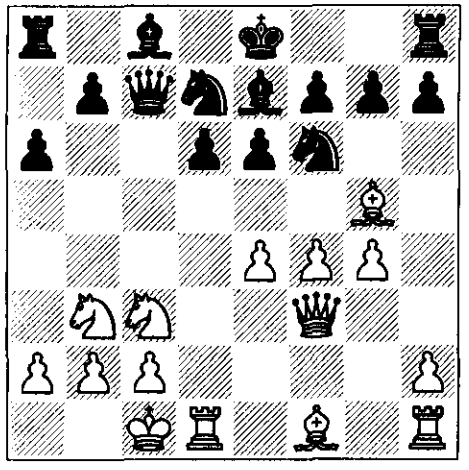
2) **11 ♔b1** ♖b8 (11...b5 12 a3 ♗b7 13 f5?! ♘e5 14 ♕f4 exf5 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 ♕xf5 0-0 17 g4 ♘c4 ∓ Prevot-Thébault, French Ch 1987) 12 ♗d3 b5 13 ♖he1 b4 14 ♘e2 ♗b7 15 ♘g3 h6 16 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 17 ♘h5 ♔f8 18 ♘xf6 ♗xf6 19 ♕h5 e5 20 ♖f1 ∞ Haag-Barczay, Hungary 1969.

3) **11 f5** b5 12 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 13 fxe6 fxe6 14 e5 ♗b7 15 ♕h3 dxe5 16 ♕xe6 ♗c8 17 ♘d5 ♘xd5 18 ♕xd5 ♗b7 19 ♕e6 ♗c8 20 ♕d5

♗b7 ½-½ Liberzon-Byrne, Geneva 1977.

4) **11 ♗h4** b5 12 a3 ♗b7 13 ♗d3 (13 ♘d4 ♘xe4? 14 ♘xe4 ♗xh4 15 ♘xd6+ ♕xd6 16 ♕xb7 ♕xf4+ 17 ♔h1 ♕b8 18 ♕e4 ± Posylek-Blain, corr 1989) h6 (13...♘c5 14 ♔b1 0-0-0 15 ♗f2 ♔b8 16 ♕e2 ♘fd7 17 ♖he1 ♗f6 18 ♘xc5 ♘xc5 19 e5 ♘xd3 20 ♖xd3 dxe5 21 fxe5 = Vetter-H.Schneider, corr 1988) 14 ♗f2 g5 15 g3 g4 16 ♕e2 ♘c5 17 ♘d4 ♘xd3+ 18 ♖xd3 d5 19 e5 ♘e4 20 ♘xe4 dxe4 21 ♖c3 ± Demitrov-Oncy, corr 1973.

5) **11 g4** *(D)* and now:



5a) **11...b5** 12 ♗xf6 (12 ♗d3 ♗b7 13 ♖he1 h6 14 ♗h4 b4 15 ♘e2 a5 16 ♘ed4 ♘c5 17 ♘xc5 dxc5 18 ♘b5 ♕b6 19 ♕e2 ♖d8 20 e5 ♘d5 21 ♗g3 ♘c7 22 ♘xc7+ ♕xc7 23 ♗c4 ± Timmerman-Houtman, corr 1983) ♘xf6 (12...gxf6 13 f5 {13 a3 ♖b8 14 ♗e2 b4 15 axb4 ♖xb4 16 ♖d4 ♖xd4 17 ♘xd4 ♗b7 = Bagirov-Van den Berg, Beverwijk 1965} ♘e5 14 ♕h3 ♗d7 15 ♘d4 b4 16 ♘ce2 ♕a5 17 ♔b1 ♘c6 18 ♘xc6 ♗xc6 19 ♘d4 ♖c8 20 fxe6 fxe6 21 g5 fxg5 22 ♕h5+ ♔d7 23 ♗h3 ± Mnatsakanian-A.Petrosian, Erevan 1982) 13 g5 ♘d7 (this is a standard position, but with the knight on b3 instead of d4, a difference that favours Black) 14 a3 (14 ♗d3 b4 15 ♘e2 ♗b7 16 ♔b1 0-0-0 17 c3 ♕b6 18 cxb4 ♕xb4 19 ♘ed4 ♘c5 20 ♘xc5 dxc5 21 ♘c2 ♕a4 = Nowak-Michalski, corr 1991; 14 f5 b4 15 ♘e2 ♗xg5+ 16 ♔b1 ♘e5 17 ♕h5 ♕e7 18 ♖g1 ♗f6 19 ♘f4 g6 20 ♕e2 ♗d7 21 ♘d4 0-0 22 fxe6 fxe6 23 ♗h3 ♔h8 24 ♘fxe6 ♖f7 ½-½ Presznyak-Szekely, Hungary Cht 1991) ♖b8 15 h4 b4 16 axb4 ♖xb4 17 ♖d4 ♖xd4 18 ♘xd4 ♕b6 19 ♘b3 ♗b7 20 h5 ♘c5 21 ♗c4 ∞ Akopian-Collinson, Oakham 1992.

5b) **11...h6** and now:

5b1) **12 ♗xf6** ♗xf6 13 ♘e2 (13 e5 dxe5 14 f5 exf5 15 gxf5 ♗g5+ 16 ♔b1 ♘f6 17 h4 ♗f4 18 ♖e1 0-0 19 ♗d3 ♗d7 ∓ Dobrovolsky-Ftačnik, Czechoslovakia Ch 1982) ♘c5 14 h4 ♗d7 15 g5 ♗e7 16 ♔b1 0-0-0 17 ♗h3 ♔b8 18 ♘c3 g6 19 ♖hg1 hxg5 20 hxg5 ♖c8 21 ♖d2 b5 ½-½ Thipsay-Spassov, New Delhi 1984.

5b2) **12 ♗h4** g5 13 fxg5 ♘e5 (13...♘h7 14 g6 fxg6 15 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 16 ♕e3 ♘g5 17 ♗e2 ♘f7 18 ♖hf1 b5 19 ♕f2 ± Foldi-Nagy, Hungary Cht 1992) 14 ♕g3 ♘fxg4 15 gxh6 ♗xh4 (15...♖xh6 16 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 17 ♗e2 ♗d7 18 ♗xg4 ♕g5+ 19 ♔b1 ♕xg4 20 ♕e3 ♖g6 21 ♕d4 with a clear White advantage, McDonald-Loskutov, Budapest 1996) 16 ♕xh4 ♖xh6 17 ♕g3 ♗d7 18 ♗e2 ♖g6 19 h4! 0-0-0 20 h5 ♖gg8 21 ♖h4! ± Nikitin-A.Petrosian, Dortmund 1993.

6) **11 ♕g3** and now:

6a) **11...b5** 12 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 (or 12...♗xf6!? 13 ♗xb5 0-0) 13 e5 (13 ♕xg7!? ♖g8 14 ♕h6) dxe5 14 fxe5

♘d7 15 ♗xb5 axb5 16 ♘xb5 ♕b6! 17 ♕xg7 ♖f8 18 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 19 exd6 and now:

6a1) **19...♖xa2** 20 ♖he1 (20 ♔b1 ♖a7 21 ♖he1 ♘b8 22 ♕xh7 ♘c6 23 ♕g7 ♗d7 24 h4 ♘a5 25 ♘d4 ♘c6 26 ♘b3 ♘a5 27 ♘d4 ♘c6 ½-½ Shabalov-de Firmian, US Ch 1996) ♘b8! 21 ♕xh7 ♘c6 22 ♔b1 (22 ♕d3 ±) ♕a7 23 ♕e4 ♗d7 24 h4 ♕a4 25 ♕d5 ♖g8 26 h5! ♔f8 ∞ Curtacci-Mantyla, corr 1993.

6a2) **19...♘c5** 20 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 21 ♕f6 ♖a7 22 ♖he1 ♖d7 23 ♕f4 ♗b7 24 ♖e5 ♕c6 25 ♕b4 ♕xg2 26 ♖c5 ♖g8 ∓ Shabalov-Magerramov, USSR Ch 1991.

6a3) **19...♕e3+** 20 ♔b1 ♕e5 21 ♕g4 h5 22 ♕h4 ♕f6 23 ♕xh5 ♖h8 24 ♕g4 ♗b7 25 ♖he1 ♕h4 26 ♕g7 ♕f6 27 ♕g3 ∞ Kamsky-I.Gurevich, USA Ch 1991.

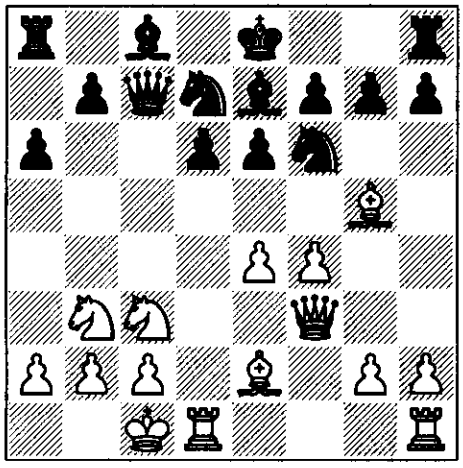
6b) **11...h6** 12 ♗xf6 (12 ♗h4 g5! 13 fxg5 ♖g8) ♗xf6 13 e5 dxe5 14 ♘e4 exf4 15 ♘xf6+ gxf6 16 ♕g7 ♖f8 and now:

6b1) **17 ♗d3** ♔e7 (17...f3 18 gxf3 ♕f4+ 19 ♔b1 ♘e5 20 ♗e4 ♗d7 21 ♗xb7 ♖a7 22 ♘c5 ± ♗c6? 23 ♘xe6! 1-0 Crusi More-Noble, corr 1993) 18 ♖he1 ♘e5 19 ♕xh6 ♗d7 20 ♔b1 ♘xd3 21 ♖xd3 ♖h8 –+ Bendana-Hertel, corr 1993.

6b2) **17 ♘d4** ♘b6 (17...♕a5 18 ♗d3 ♘c5 19 ♗c4 ♗d7 20 ♕xf6 ♘e4 21 ♕xf4 ♕g5 22 ♕xg5 hxg5 23 ♖he1 ± Epishin-A.Petrosian, Daugavpils 1989) 18 ♗e2 ♗d7 19 ♕xf6 ♖c8 (19...♘d5 20 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 21 ♖xd5 ♗xd5 22 ♖e1 ♗e6 23 ♗h5! ♔d7 24 ♗xf7! ♗xf7 25 ♖e7+ ♔c8 26 ♖xc7+ ♔xc7 27 ♕xf4+ ∞) 20 ♗f3 ♘c4 21 ♔b1 (21 ♖he1!?) e5 22 ♖he1 ♘e3 23 c3 ♖d8 24 ♘c2 ♘xd1 25 ♗h5! ♘e3 26 ♘xe3 fxe3 27 ♖xe3 ♗f5+! 28 ♕xf5 ♖d6 29 ♕xe5+ ♔d8 30 ♕g7 ♖e8 31 ♖xe8+ ♔xe8 32 ♕g8+ ♔d7 33 ♕xf7+ ♔c6 34 ♗f3+ ♔b6 35 ♕xc7+ ♔xc7 36 ♔c2 ½-½ Epishin-Portisch, Reggio Emilia 1991.

7) **11 ♗e2** *(D)* and now:

B

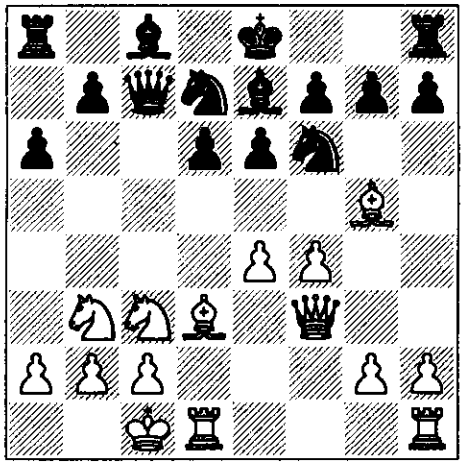


7a) **11...h6** 12 ♗h4 (12 ♕h3 0-0 13 ♗h4 ♘c5 14 ♘xc5 dxc5 15 ♕e3 ♘g4 16 ♗xg4 ♗xh4 17 ♗f3 ± Rosinski-Mendys, corr 1992) g5 13 fxg5 ♘e5 14 ♕e3 (14 ♕f2 ♘fg4 15 ♗xg4 ♘xg4 16 ♕f4 ♘e5 17 gxh6!? ♘g6 18 ♗xe7 ♘xf4 19 ♗xd6 ♕b6 20 ♗xf4 ∞ Timman-Hulak, Amsterdam 1977) ♘fg4 15 ♗xg4 ♘xg4 16 ♕d2 hxg5 17 ♗xg5 ♗xg5 18 ♕xg5 ♘e5 19 h4 ± Sax-Djukić, Yugoslavia 1971.

7b) **11...b5** 12 ♗xf6 (12 a3 ♗b7 13 ♕e3 ♖c8 14 ♘d4 0-0 15 ♖d2 ♖fe8 16 g4 ♕c5 17 h4 e5 18 fxe5 dxe5 19 ♘f5 ♕xe3 20 ♗xe3 ∓ Nyman-Tolush, corr 1962; 12 e5 ♗b7 13 ♕g3 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘e4 15 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 16 ♗d3 ♗xd3 17 ♖xd3 ♗xg5+ ½-½ Kr.Georgiev-Szekely, Plovdiv 1981) ♘xf6 13 e5 ♗b7 14 ♕g3 (14 exf6? ♗xf3 15 ♗xf3 ♗xf6 16 ♗xa8 ♗xc3 17 bxc3 d5 –+) dxe5 15 fxe5

♘d7 16 ♗f3 (16 ♖xd7?! ♔xd7! 17 ♕xg7 ♖af8 18 ♗h5 b4 19 ♗xf7 bxc3 –+ Szabo-Quinteros, Amsterdam 1973) 0-0 17 ♗xb7 (17 ♖he1 ♗xf3 18 gxf3 b4 19 ♘b1 ♖fc8 20 ♘d4 ♕a5 21 ♘xe6 fxe6 22 ♖xd7 ♕a4 23 ♖d2 ♕xa2 ∓ Poleszczuk-Kotenko USSR 1979) ♕xb7 18 ♖he1 ♖ac8 19 a3 ♕c7 20 ♔b1 ♘b6 21 ♖d3 ♖fd8 22 ♖f3 ♘c4 ∓ *Zugzwang*-A.Petrosian, Lippstadt 1993.

Now we return to the main line after 11 ♗d3 *(D)*:



B

11 ... b5

Or **11...h6** and now:

1) **12 h4** b5 (taking the bishop is also possible) 13 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 14 g4 h5 15 g5 ♘g4 16 ♖he1 ♗b7 17 ♔b1 g6 18 ♕g3 ♕b6 ∞ Ivanović-Szekely, Vukovar 1976.

2) **12 ♕h3** b5 (12...♖g8!? 13 ♘d4 {13 ♗h4 g5 ∞} hxg5 14 fxg5 ♘e5 15 gxf6 ♗xf6 ∓ Quednau-Adam, corr 1983) 13 a3 ♖b8 (13...♗b7 14 ♗h4 0-0-0 15 ♕e3 ♘c5 16 ♘xc5 dxc5 17 e5 ♘g4 18 ♕h3 ♗xh4 19 ♕xg4 ♗f2 20 ♘e4 ♗xe4 ½-½ Torre-Byrne, Reykjavik 1980) 14 f5?! ♘e5 15 ♗d2 b4 16 axb4 ♖xb4 17 ♖hf1 exf5 18 exf5 ♗b7 ∓ Subašić-Marjanović, Zenica 1987.

3) **12 ♗h4** g5 and now:

3a) **13 ♗g3** gxf4 14 ♗xf4 ♘e5 15 ♕e2 b5 16 ♖hf1 (16 a3 ♖b8 17 ♖hf1 ♘fd7 ½-½ Timman-Ljubojević, Tilburg 1984) ♘fd7 17 ♕h5 b4 18 ♗xe5 ♘xe5 19 ♘e2 ♗d7 20 ♘ed4 ∞ Menon-Paulucci, corr 1986.

3b) **13 fxg5** ♘e5 14 ♕e2 ♘fg4 15 ♘d4 hxg5 16 ♗g3 ♗d7 17 h3 ♘f6 18 ♘f3 ♘h5 19 ♗h2 = Morgado-Demitrow, corr 1976.

3c) **13 e5** gxh4 (13...dxe5 14 fxg5) 14 exf6 ♘xf6 15 f5 (15 ♖he1 ♗d7 16 f5 0-0-0 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♗f5 e5 19 a4 ♔b8 20 ♗xd7 ♖xd7 ∓ Kuntermann-Jesinski, corr 1980) e5 16 ♗e4 ♖g8 17 ♘d2 ♖b8 18 ♘f1 b5 19 ♘e3 ♗b7 20 ♗xb7 ♕xb7 21 ♘ed5 ♘xd5 22 ♘xd5 ♗g5+ 23 ♔b1 ± Rico-Pajares, corr 1989.

12 a3

Or:

1) **12 ♗xf6** ♘xf6 13 e5 (13 g4 b4 14 ♘e2 ♗b7 15 g5 ♘d7 16 ♖he1, Biriescu-Pavlov, Romanian Ch 1976, 16...a5 ∓) ♗b7 14 ♕g3 (14 ♕e2 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘d5 {15...♘d7 16 ♗e4 ♗xe4 17 ♕xe4 0-0 18 ♖he1 ♖fc8 19 ♔b1 ♘b6 ∓ Hirvonen-Ebeling, corr 1985} 16 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 17 ♔b1 0-0 18 ♗e4 ♗xe4 19 ♕xe4 ♖fd8 ∓ Formanek-Sunye Neto, Lone Pine 1978) dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘h5 16 ♕e3 h6 17 h4 g5 18 ♔b1 gxh4 19 ♘xb5 axb5 20 ♗xb5+ ♔f8 21 ♖d7 ♕c8 22 ♖f1 ♘g3 23 ♕f4! ♘xf1 24 ♖xe7 ♖h7 25 ♕b4, Danailov-Guerra, Dortmund 1980, 25...♔g8 26 ♖e8+ ♕xe8 27 ♗xe8 ♗xg2 ∓.

2) **12 ♖he1** and now:

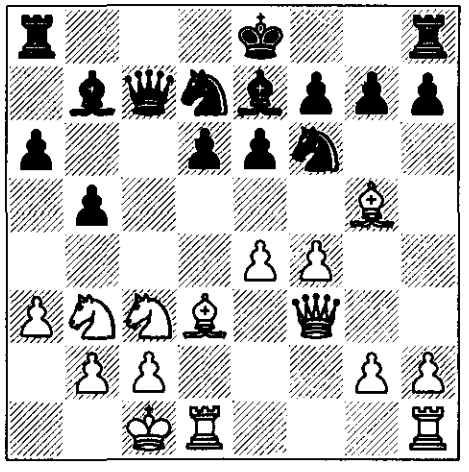
2a) **12...♗b7** 13 ♕h3 (13 ♕g3 b4 {13...h6 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6? 15 ♗xb5 axb5 16 ♘xb5 ♕b6 17 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 18 ♘xf7 ♔xf7 19 ♖xd7+ ♗e7 20

♖xe7+ 1-0 Lehmann-Hallier, corr 1982} 14 ♘b1 h6 15 ♗h4 g5 16 fxg5 ♖g8 17 ♕h3 hxg5 18 ♗f2 g4 19 ♕h6 ♘xe4 20 ♗e3, Kummerow-Klocker, Dortmund 1993, 20...♘f2! –+) 0-0-0 14 f5 e5 15 ♔b1 ♔b8 16 g4 h6 17 ♗d2 ♘c5 18 ♕g3 ♖c8 19 ♖c1 b4 20 ♘d5 ♘xd5 21 exd5 ♗g5 22 ♗xg5 hxg5 ∓ Yudasin-Marjanović, Minsk 1981.

2b) **12...b4** 13 ♘e2 (or 13 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 14 e5 ♗b7 15 ♘e4 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♘xe4 17 ♗xe4 ♗xe4 18 ♕xe4 0-0 19 ♘d4 ♖ac8 20 ♔b1 ♖fd8 ∓ Nijboer-Van der Wiel, Wijk aan Zee 1990) ♗b7 14 ♔b1 (14 ♘g3 ♘c5 15 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 16 f5 0-0-0 17 ♕e2 ♕a5 18 ♗c4 ♖he8 19 e5 ♘d5 20 ♗xe7 ♖xe7 21 exd6 ♖xd6 22 ♕e5 ± Olsen-Togeby, corr 1985) ♘c5?! 15 ♘xc5 dxc5 16 ♗xf6! ♗xf6 17 ♗c4 0-0, Stolz-A.Petrosian, Germany 1993, 18 ♕e3 ±.

12 ... ♗b7 *(D)*

12...♖b8 13 ♖he1 b4 14 axb4 ♖xb4 15 ♔b1 ♗b7 16 ♕h3 ♘c5 17 ♘a2? ♘xd3 18 ♗xf6 ♖xb3 19 ♗xg7 ♘xe1 20 ♕xb3 ♖g8 with a winning position for Black, Ellison-Collinson, Balatonbereny 1992.



13 ♖he1

Or:

1) **13 ♗xf6** ♘xf6 14 g4 ♖c8 15 ♖he1 ♘d7 16 ♔b1 ♘b6 17 g5 ♘c4 18 ♘e2 0-0 ∓ Ivanov-Adamski, Vrnjačka Banja 1963.

2) **13 ♔b1** 0-0-0 14 ♕e2 ♘c5?! 15 ♘xc5 dxc5 16 e5 c4 17 ♗e4 ♘xe4 18 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 19 ♕xe4 ♔b8 20 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 21 ♖xd8+ ♕xd8 22 ♕c6 ± Unzicker-Ellrich, German Ch 1963.

3) **13 ♖hf1** 0-0-0 14 ♕e2 ♘c5 15 ♘xc5 dxc5 16 e5 ♘d5 17 ♘xd5 exd5 18 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 19 c3 ½-½ Cuasnicu-Quinteros, Buenos Aires 1975.

4) **13 ♕e2** h6 14 ♗h4 g5 15 fxg5 ♘h7 16 ♖hf1 hxg5 17 ♗g3 ♘hf6 18 ♘d4 ♘e5 19 ♔b1 ♘fd7 20 ♘f3 ♕c5 21 h3 b4 22 axb4 ♕xb4 23 ♕f2 ± Liss-David, Tyniste 1995.

5) **13 ♕h3** 0-0-0 14 ♖he1 h6 15 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 16 ♔b1 ♔b8 17 f5 e5 18 ♕f3 ♖c8 19 ♘d5 ♗xd5 20 exd5 ♕b6 ∓ Akopian-Van Wely, Cap d'Agde 1996.

13 ... 0-0-0

Alternatively:

1) **13...♘c5** 14 ♕h3 (14 ♔b1 0-0-0 15 f5 ♘fxe4 16 ♘xe4 ♗xg5 17 ♕g4 ♗h6 18 ♘exc5 dxc5 19 fxe6 ♔b8 20 ♗e4 ± Okner-Pankevich, corr 1992) 0-0-0 15 ♘xc5 dxc5 16 e5 b4 (or 16...♘d5 17 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 18 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 19 ♕e3 ♖d7 ½-½ Spassky-Portisch, Tilburg 1979) 17 ♘b1 ♘d5 18 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 19 ♕g4 ♘g6 20 g3 c4 21 ♗xg6 hxg6 22 ♖xd8+ ♔xd8 with equality, S.Farago-Peredy, Budapest 1995.

2) **13...h6** 14 ♕h3 and now:

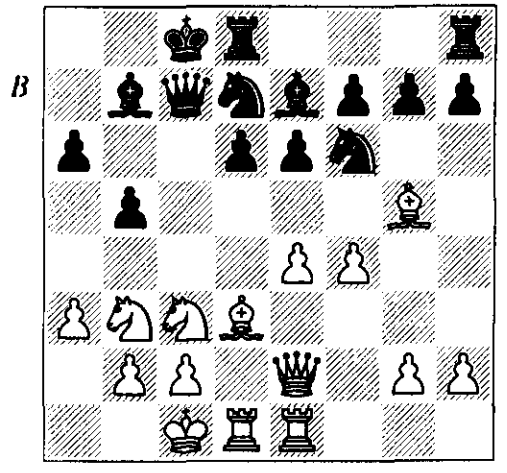
2a) **14...♖c8** 15 ♘d4? (15 ♖e2!?) ♕b6 16 ♘xe6 fxe6 17 e5 dxe5 18 ♗g6+ ♔d8 19 fxe5 ♘d5 20 ♗xe7+ ♘xe7 21 ♗f7 ♖xc3 22 ♕xc3 ♗d5

23 ♗h5 ♖f8 ∓ Kamsky-Ljubojević, Buenos Aires 1994.

2b) **14...0-0-0** 15 ♗xf6 (15 ♗h4 g5 16 ♗f2 gxf4 17 ♗xb5 axb5 18 ♘xb5 ♕c4 19 ♘a7+ ♔b8 20 ♘a5 ♕a6 21 ♕b3 ∞ Masserey-Van Wely, Horgen 1995) ♘xf6 (15...♗xf6!? 16 ♗xb5! ♗xc3 17 ♗xd7+ ♖xd7 18 bxc3 with an edge for White) 16 ♘d5! ♘xd5 17 exd5 ♗xd5 18 ♗xb5 ♗b7 19 ♗f1 ♔b8 (19...♗f6!) 20 ♖d4! ♖c8 21 ♕d3 d5 22 ♕d2! ♕b6 ∞ Van der Wiel-Portisch, Rotterdam 1989.

14 ♕e2 *(D)*

14 f5 e5 15 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 16 ♘d5 ♘xd5 17 exd5 ♔b8 18 g3 ♖c8 19 h4 ♗f6 20 ♔b1 ♕b6 21 ♖c1 ♖c7 22 ♕e4 ♖hc8 23 ♔a2 a5 ∓ Norgaard-Novikov, Copenhagen 1991.



14 ... h6

Alternatively:

1) **14...♔b8** 15 ♔b1 ♖c8? 16 e5 dxe5 17 fxe5 ♘g8 18 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 19 ♗xb5! axb5 20 ♘xb5 ♕d8 21 ♕e3 (21 ♘d6 ±) ♖c6? (21...♘c6) 22 ♕a7+ ♔c8 23 ♘a5 ♖b6 24 ♘xb7 1-0 Bogda-Garcia, Haifa OL 1976.

2) **14...♘c5** 15 ♘xc5 dxc5 16 e5 c4 17 ♗e4 ♘xe4 18 ♘xe4 ♗xg5 19 fxg5 ♗xe4 20 ♕xe4 ♕b7 21 ♕xb7+ ♔xb7 22 ♖f1 ♖xd1+ (this ending should be a draw, but oddly enough the two practical examples both ended decisively, with one win for each side) 23 ♖xd1 (23 ♔xd1 ♖d8+ 24 ♔e2 ♖d7 25 ♔e3 ♔c6 26 ♖f4 a5 27 ♖d4 ♖d5 ∓ L.Bronstein-Portisch, Rio de Janeiro IZ 1979) ♖c8 24 ♖d4 ♖c5 25 ♖f4 ♖c7 26 ♖h4 h6 27 gxh6 gxh6 28 ♖xh6 ♔c6 29 h4 ♔d5 30 ♖h5 ± Van der Wiel-R.Byrne, Palma de Mallorca 1989.

15 ♗h4 g5
16 ♗g3 gxf4
17 ♗xf4

and now:

1) **17...♘e5** 18 ♔b1 ♔b8 19 ♖c1 ♖c8 20 a4 bxa4 21 ♘xa4 ♘c4 22 ♘ac5 e5 23 ♘xb7 exf4 24 ♘7c5 ♘a3+ 25 bxa3 dxc5 ± Hechler-Schonherr, corr 1980.

2) **17...e5** 18 ♗e3 ♘c5 19 ♘xc5 dxc5 20 ♕f2 ♔b8 21 ♕f5 ♗c8 22 ♕f1 ♗e6 23 ♗e2 b4 24 ♘b1 c4 ∓ Bensiek-Kunzelmann, corr 1991.

10 Browne System (...h6 by Black)

In this chapter we consider various lines in which Black plays ...h6. If Black plays it at an early stage then White has to reply ♗h4 and Black can seize e5 for his knight by means of a timely ...g5, but White can often exploit the temporary weakening of Black's position to launch a direct attack. Therefore Black often delays ...h6 until White has played ♗d3, but then the reply ♕h3 pinning the h-pawn becomes possible.

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♗e7 8 ♕f3

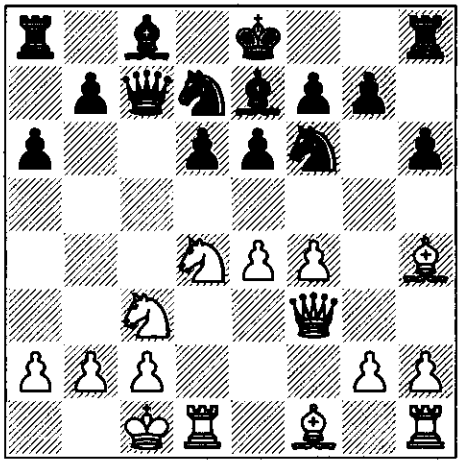
We now consider five lines, which fall naturally into two groups. The first group arises after **8...h6 9 ♗h4 ♕c7 10 0-0-0 ♘bd7** and now:
A: 11 ♕g3 and others
B: 11 ♗e2

The second group starts **8...♕c7 9 0-0-0 ♘bd7 10 ♗d3 h6** and now:
C: 11 ♗h4
D: 11 ♕h3
E: 11 h4?!

The first group involves Black playing ...h6 early on. In this case White's best is to avoid ♗d3 and play either ♕g3 or ♗e2. The ♗e2 line is especially dangerous for Black. If Black waits for ♗d3 before playing ...h6, then we have one of the lines in the second group. Both 11 ♗h4 and 11 ♕h3 are playable, although neither offers White many prospects of an advantage. The piece sacrifice line with 11 h4?! is almost certainly unsound.

A)

8	**...**	**h6**
9	**♗h4**	**♕c7**
10	**0-0-0**	**♘bd7** *(D)*



11 ♕g3

Here is a round-up of other white 11th moves (note that these can also arise from the unusual white 10th moves analysed in chapter 2 if ...h6 and ♗h4 are inserted at some point; in addition, some lines can arise from variation C of chapter 15):

1) **11 ♖d2** g5 12 fxg5 ♘e5 13 ♕f2 (13 ♕g3 ♘h5 14 ♕f2 hxg5 15 ♗g3 ♘xg3 16 ♕xg3 g4 17 ♔b1 b5 ∓ Barlocco-Tatai, Reggio Emilia 1994)

♘fg4 14 ♕e2 hxg5 15 ♗g3 ♗d7 16 h3 ♘f6 17 ♘f3 ♘h5 18 ♗h2 b5 19 ♕c3 b4 20 ♘d1 ♖g8 ∓ Jakovljević-Nurandzić, Serbia 1994.

2) **11 ♖e1** (aiming for e5, but once again if Black crosses this plan then White is left having wasted a tempo) g5 12 fxg5 ♘e5 13 ♕d1 ♘h7 (or 13...♘fg4 14 h3 hxg5 15 ♗g3 ♘f6 16 ♗e2 ♗d7 17 ♘f3 0-0-0?! 18 ♘xg5 ♘h5 19 ♗h4? {19 ♘xe6! ±} ♘f4 ∓ Semionova-Ioseliani, Sochi Ct (4) 1983) 14 ♗d3 hxg5 15 ♗g3 ♗d7 16 ♖hf1 0-0-0 17 ♘f3 f6 18 ♘xe5 dxe5 ½-½ Sandler-Seglinsh, USSR 1985.

3) **11 g4** g5 and now:

3a) **12 fxg5** ♘e5 13 ♕g3 ♘fxg4 (13...hxg5 14 ♗xg5 ♘fxg4 =) 14 gxh6 ♗xh4 15 ♕xh4 ♕e7 16 ♕g3 ♗d7 17 ♗e2 ♖xh6 18 h3 (18 h4 0-0-0? 19 ♗xg4 ♖g6 20 ♘f5! exf5 21 ♘d5 ♕f8 22 ♕c3+ ♘c6 23 ♗xf5 ♗xf5 24 exf5 +– Garcia-Monfa Sole, corr 1986) ♘f6 19 ♕e3 ♖h7 20 ♖hf1 0-0-0 21 ♖f2 ♖dh8 22 ♗f1 ♖g8 ∓ Thorhallsson-Postl, Oberwart 1991.

3b) **12 e5** dxe5 (12...gxh4 13 exf6 ♗xf6 14 ♕e2 {14 ♗g2} ♘b6 15 ♘e4 ♗e7 16 f5 e5 17 ♗g2 ♕c4 18 ♖d3 ♕xa2 ∓ Okner-Tiulin, corr 1988) 13 fxg5 hxg5 14 ♗g3 ♖b8? (14...♘f8 followed by ...♘g6 gives White difficulty justifying his sacrifice) 15 h4! gxh4 16 g5 ♘h5 17 g6 ♗g5+ (17...fxg6 18 ♘xe6 ♕b6 19 ♘d5 +– Kutuzović-Ott, Harkany 1994) 18 ♔b1 ♘df6 19 ♘e4! ♘xe4 20 ♗xe5 ♕e7 21 ♗xb8 1-0 Meštrović-Lakić, Yugoslavia 1981.

4) **11 ♗g3** b5 (11...h5!? 12 h3 {12 ♗h4 ∞} h4 13 ♗h2 b5 14 e5 ♗b7 15 ♕e2 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♘h5 17 ♘e4 ♘xe5 18 ♘xb5 axb5 19 ♕xb5+ ♗c6 20 ♗xe5 ♕c8 ∞ Soltis-DeFotis, Chicago 1973) 12 e5 ♗b7 13 ♕e2 ♘d5 (13...dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘d5 15 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 16 ♘f5 ∞) 14 ♘e4 dxe5 15 fxe5 0-0 16 ♘f6+ ♔h8 17 ♘f5 exf5 18 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 19 ♖xd5 ♘b6 ∓ Barczay-Kavalek, Sousse IZ 1967.

5) **11 f5** e5 12 ♘b3 b5 13 a3 ♖b8 14 g4 b4 15 axb4 ♖xb4 16 ♗e1 ♗b7 is equal, Ivanović-Martinović, Vrnjačka Banja 1977.

6) **11 ♕h3** (this can also arise from chapter 15, line C) and now:

6a) **11...♖g8** 12 f5 e5 13 ♘b3 b5 14 a3 ♗b7 15 ♗d3 0-0-0 16 ♖he1 ♔b8 17 ♔b1 ♖c8 18 a4 b4 19 ♘d5 ♘xd5 20 exd5 ♗xh4 21 ♕xh4 a5 = Kir.Georgiev-W.Schmidt, Warsaw Z 1987.

6b) **11...♘c5** 12 ♗d3 (or 12 f5 ♘cxe4 13 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 14 fxe6 0-0 15 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 16 ♕e3 d5 17 exf7+ ♖xf7 18 ♗d3 ♗g4 = Pavlov-Magerramov, Trnava 1981) b5 13 a3 ♗b7 14 ♖he1 0-0-0 15 ♗f2 ♔b8 16 ♔b1 ♖c8 17 ♘b3 ♖hd8 18 ♕g3 g6 19 h3 ♘xb3 20 cxb3 ♗c6 leading to a balanced position, Inkiov-Tringov, Plovdiv 1982.

6c) **11...♘b6?** 12 ♕g3! ♗d7 13 ♗e2 0-0 14 ♖hf1 ♘a4? 15 e5! dxe5 16 fxe5 ♘xc3 17 exf6! 1-0 (due to the line 17...♕xg3 18 ♗xg3 ♘xe2+ 19 ♘xe2 ♗xf6 20 ♖xd7) Kopylov-Herbrechtsmeier, corr 1988.

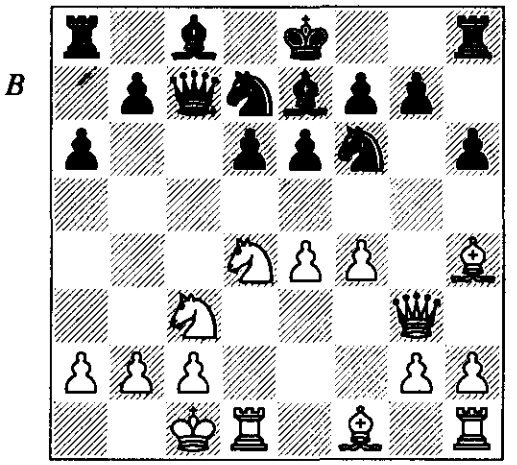
6d) **11...b5** 12 a3 (12 e5 dxe5 13 fxe5 ♘xe5 14 ♗g3 ♕c5 15 ♗e2 0-0 16 ♖he1 ♘g6 17 ♗f2 e5 and Black is clearly better, Ivanović-Bukić, Yugoslavia 1981) ♗b7 (12...♖b8 13 ♗d3 b4 14 axb4 ♖xb4 15 ♘b3 ♘c5 16 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 17 ♖he1 e5 18 f5 ♗b7 ∓ Ivanović-Marjanović, Yugoslav Ch 1982) 13 ♗e2 ♘c5 14 ♗xf6

♗xf6 15 ♗f3 ♕b6 16 e5 dxe5 17 fxe5 ♗xe5 18 ♗xb7 ♕xb7 19 ♕e3 ♘d7 ∓ Inkiov-Spassov, Bulgarian Ch 1982.

7) **11 ♗f2** b5 12 ♗d3 ♗b7 13 ♖he1 ♖c8 14 ♔b1 ♘c5 15 a3 0-0 (15...d5 {premature} 16 exd5 ♘xd5 17 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 18 ♕g4 ♗f6 19 ♘xe6! fxe6 20 ♗g6+ ♔f8 21 ♖xd5 +– Luna-Cano, corr 1975) 16 f5 e5 17 ♘b3 ♖fd8 18 g4 d5 19 ♘xc5 ♗xc5 20 ♗xc5 ♕xc5 21 exd5 ♘xd5 22 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 ∓ Ankerst-Orel, Bled 1992.

8) **11 ♗xf6** ♘xf6 (11...♗xf6 12 ♗e2 0-0? 13 g4 b5 14 g5 hxg5 15 ♖hg1 b4 16 e5 dxe5 17 fxg5 ♗b7 18 ♕h5 and White wins, Nicolini-Brossette, corr 1986) 12 g4 g5 13 fxg5 hxg5 14 ♗g2 ♗d7 15 h3 0-0-0 16 ♕e3 ♕c5 ∓ Pierra-De Villiers, Moscow OL 1994.

Now we return to the main line after 11 ♕g3 *(D)*:



11 ... g5

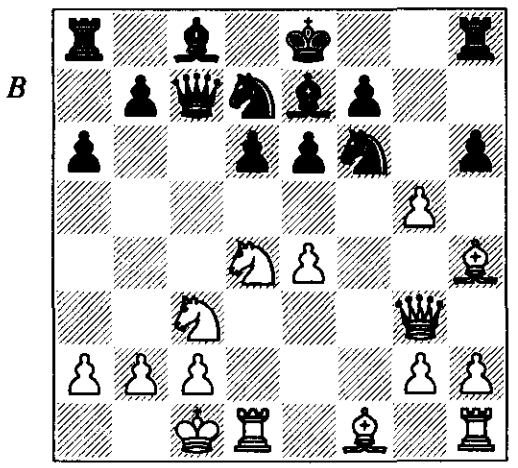
Or:

1) **11...0-0** 12 ♘f3 ♘c5 13 ♗d3 b5 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 15 e5 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♗e7 17 ♘e4 ♘xe4 18 ♗xe4 ♗b7 19 ♗xb7 ♕xb7 20 ♖d3 ♖ad8 ∓ Herbrechtsmeier-Düster, Mosbach 1980.

2) **11...♖g8** 12 ♗e2 (12 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 13 f5 ♘e5?! {13...♗e5} 14 ♕h3 ♕e7 15 fxe6 fxe6 16 ♘a4 ♔f7 17 ♘b6 ♖b8 18 ♕b3 ± Hase-Szmetan, Argentina 1974) transposes to line B, note to Black's 11th move.

3) **11...b5!?** 12 ♗xf6 (12 ♗xb5? axb5 13 ♘dxb5 ♕b8 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘xe5 16 ♖he1 ♘g6! {the position is the same as in line B of chapter 2, except that the moves ...h6 and ♗h4 have been interposed; this makes the position even better for Black} 17 ♗xf6 gxf6 18 ♘c7+ ♔f8 19 ♘xa8 ♕xa8 ∓ Novikov-Gavrikov, USSR 1981) and we have transposed to the note to White's 11th move in line B of chapter 2, except that the pawn is on h6 instead of h7. This makes little difference to the ensuing play.

12 fxg5 *(D)*



And now:
A1: 12...♘h5
A2: 12...♖g8

12...hxg5 13 ♗xg5 b5 14 ♗xb5!? (14 a3 ♖g8 15 ♗e2 – see line 2 in the note to Black's 13th move in variation A2) axb5 15 ♘dxb5 ♕b8 (15...♕c5 16 ♗e3 ♕c6 17 ♘xd6+ ±)

16 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 17 ♖xd6 ♖g8 18 h4 ♘h7 19 ♕d3 ♘xg5 20 hxg5 ± Ilipslis-Anikaev, USSR 1981.

A1)

12	**...**	**♘h5**
13	**♕e3**	**♕c5**
14	**♔b1**	

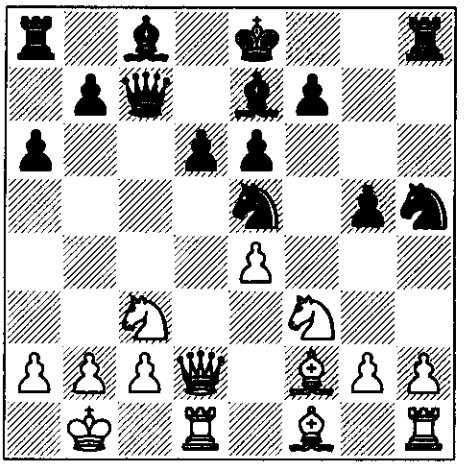
Or 14 ♕d2 (14 ♗e2 ♘f4! 15 ♕xf4 hxg5 16 ♕f2 ♖xh4 17 g3 ♖h7 ∓) ♗xg5 (14...hxg5?! 15 ♘b3! ♕e5 16 ♗f2 ♕g7 17 ♗d4 ♘e5 18 ♘a4 ±) 15 ♗xg5 ♕xg5 16 ♗e2 (16 ♘f3 ♕xd2+ 17 ♖xd2 ♔e7 18 ♗e2 ♘hf6 19 ♖hd1 ♘c8 20 a4 b6 21 b3 ♖a7 22 ♔b2 ♖c7 23 ♖d4 ♗b7 24 ♘d2 ♖g8 25 g3 ♖g5 26 ♖c4 ½-½ Short-Kir.Georgiev, Elenite 1995) ♘hf6! (16...♘df6? 17 ♖hf1 ♔e7 18 ♗xh5 ♘xh5 19 g4! ♕xd2+ 20 ♖xd2 ♘g7 21 ♖df2 ♖f8 22 ♘a4 ± Strautinš-Gorski, corr 1981; 16...♘f4 17 ♘f3 ♘xe2+ 18 ♘xe2 ♕xd2+ 19 ♖xd2 ♘f6 20 ♘c3 ♔e7 21 ♖hd1 ♖g8 22 g3 ♖g4 23 e5 dxe5 24 ♘xe5 ♖g5 25 ♘c4 b5 26 ♘d6 b4 27 ♘ce4 ♘xe4 28 ♘xe4 ♖a5 = Pontecorvo-Marchiani, corr 1986) 17 ♘f3 ♕xd2+ 18 ♖xd2 ♔e7 =.

14	**...**	**hxg5**

14...♗xg5 is also possible. After 15 ♗xg5 hxg5 16 ♕h3 (16 ♗e2 ♘f4 17 ♕d2 b5 18 ♗f3 ♘e5 ∞ Meier-Vitolinš, Riga 1984) ♕e5 17 ♘f3 ♕f4 18 g4 ♘df6! 19 gxh5 g4 20 ♕g3 ♕xg3 21 hxg3 gxf3 22 ♖xd6 ♖xh5 23 ♖xh5 ♘xh5 the complications led to an equal ending, Taiana-Rshaid, corr 1985.

15	**♗f2**	**♘e5**
16	**♕d2**	**♕c7**
17	**♘f3** *(D)*	
17	**...**	**♘xf3**

There is a wide range of alternatives:



1) **17...g4?** (leaves Black's kingside too weak) 18 ♘xe5 dxe5 19 ♗e2 ♘f6 20 h3 gxh3 21 ♖xh3 ♖xh3 22 gxh3 ♗d7 23 ♕h6 0-0-0 24 ♗h4 ♘g8 25 ♕h5 ♗e8 26 ♗g3 ♗d6 27 ♕g4 f5? 28 ♕xg8 1-0 Sax-Tatai, Graz 1984.

2) **17...♘f4?** 18 ♘xe5 dxe5 19 g3 ♘g6 20 ♗e3 f6 21 h4 gxh4 22 gxh4 ♗d7 23 ♖g1 ♘f4 24 ♖g7 ♖d8 25 ♗xf4 ♗c6 26 ♕xd8+ 1-0 Beliavsky-Magerramov, Baku 1980.

3) **17...b5** 18 ♘xg5 (18 ♗e3 g4 19 ♘xe5 dxe5 20 ♗d3 ♘f4 21 ♕f2 ♗b7 22 ♘e2 {22 ♗b6 ♕c6 23 a3 ♗xa3 ∓} ♗h4 23 ♕f1 ♘xd3 24 cxd3 f5 25 ♘c1 0-0 ∞ Kengis-Vitolinš, Jurmala 1983) ♗d7 (18...b4 19 ♘a4 ♗b7 20 ♘b6 ♖b8 ∞) 19 a3 ♖b8 20 h4 a5 21 ♘a2 b4 22 axb4 axb4 23 ♖h3 f6 24 ♘f3 ♕b7 25 ♘d4 ♕xe4 ∞ Leluashvili-Zelinsky, corr 1992.

4) **17...♖g8** 18 h4 (18 ♘xe5 dxe5 19 ♗e2 ♘f6?! {19...♘f4 =} 20 ♗e3 ♘d7 21 ♖hf1 ± Lanka-Bangiev, corr 1976; 18 ♗e3 g4 19 ♘xe5 dxe5 20 ♗d3 b5 21 ♖hf1 ♗d7 22 ♕f2 ♖g7 23 ♘e2 = Chiburdanidze-Gavrikov, USSR 1980) g4 (18...gxh4 19 ♗xh4 ♘f6 20 ♘xe5 dxe5 21 ♗e2 ♖g6 22 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 23 ♖h7 ♖g8 24 ♖f1 +–

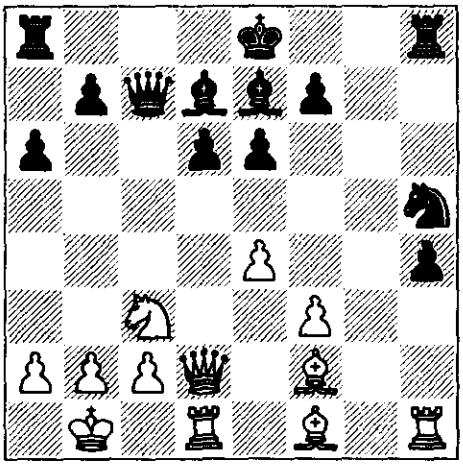
Grünfeld-Tarjan, Riga IZ 1979) 19 ♘xe5 dxe5 20 ♕h6 ♘f6 21 ♗e3 ♖g6 22 ♕h8+ ♖g8 23 ♕h6 ½-½ Balashov-Browne, Manila 1976.

18 gxf3 ♗d7

19 h4

19 ♖g1 (19 ♗e3 f6 20 ♕f2 ♔f7 21 f4 ♘xf4 22 ♗xf4 gxf4 23 ♕xf4 ♖ag8 24 ♗d3 ♕c5 25 ♖df1 ♖h3 ∓ Kulczewski-Siegl, corr 1987) 0-0-0 20 ♗e3 f6 21 ♕f2 ♘f4 22 ♗xf4 gxf4 23 ♖g4 ♕c5 24 ♕d2 ♕e5 ∓ Kupreichik-Beliavsky, USSR Ch 1974.

19 ... gxh4 *(D)*



and now:

1) **20 ♗e2** 0-0-0 21 ♗xh4 ♗c6 22 a3 (22 ♗f2 b5 23 a3 ♕b7 24 ♘a2 ♔b8 25 ♘b4 ± Westerinen-Petursson, Reykjavik 1976) ♘f6 23 ♗g3 ♖hg8 24 ♕e1 ♔b8 25 ♕f2 ♔a8 26 ♖d3 ♘d7 27 ♖hd1 ♘c5 28 ♖3d2 ± Kauranen-Sanakoev, corr 1978.

2) **20 ♗xh4** ♘g3 (this was the reason Westerinen prepared ♗xh4 by ♗e2, but it isn't too dangerous) 21 ♗xe7 ♖xh1 22 ♗f6! (22 ♗xd6? ♘xf1 23 ♕g2 ♘d2+! ∓; 22 ♕g5 ♖h5! 23 ♕g8+ ♔e7 24 ♕xa8 ♗c8 25 ♗d3 =) ♘xf1 (22...♖xf1 23 ♖xf1 ♘xf1 24 ♕g5 ♗b5 25 ♘d5 ♘d2+ 26 ♔c1 exd5 27 ♕g8+ is a draw; 22...♘h5!? 23 ♕g2 ♘xf6 24 ♕xh1 ±) 23 ♕g5 ♘d2+ 24 ♔c1 ♖xd1+ 25 ♔xd1 ♗b5 26 ♕g8+ ♔d7 27 ♕xa8 = Sakharov-Zelinsky, corr 1982.

A2)

12 ... ♖g8

13 ♗e2

Or:

1) **13 ♕e1** hxg5 14 ♗g3 ♘e5 15 ♘f3 b5 (15...♗d7 16 ♗xe5 dxe5 17 ♕g3 ♗c6 18 ♗d3 ♘d7 19 h4 0-0-0 20 hxg5 ♖g7 21 ♖h5 ♖dg8 22 ♖dh1 ♗b4 23 ♘d1 ♘c5 24 ♘f2 ± Mnatsakanian-Polugaevsky, USSR Ch 1967) 16 a3 ♗d7 17 ♕d2 ♖b8 18 ♕d4 ♘fg4 19 h3 ♘xf3 20 gxf3 ♘e5 21 ♗e2 a5 ∓ Mikenas-Spassky, USSR Ch 1957.

2) **13 g6** ♖xg6 14 ♕e1 ♘e5 15 ♘f3 ♗d7 16 ♘xe5 dxe5 17 ♖d3 b5 18 ♖g3 b4 19 ♖xg6 fxg6 20 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 21 ♘d1 ♖c8 ∓ Tatai-Ortega, Capablanca mem 1985.

3) **13 ♘f3** ♘h5 14 ♕e1 hxg5 15 ♗f2 b5 16 a3 ♗b7 17 ♔b1 ♖c8 18 ♗d3 ♘f4 19 g3 ♘h3! ∓ 20 ♗d4 g4 21 ♘h4 ♘e5 22 ♖f1 ♘g5 23 ♕f2? (23 ♕e2) ♘c4 24 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 25 ♗e3 ♘xe4! ∓ Timman-Van Wely, Wijk aan Zee 1996.

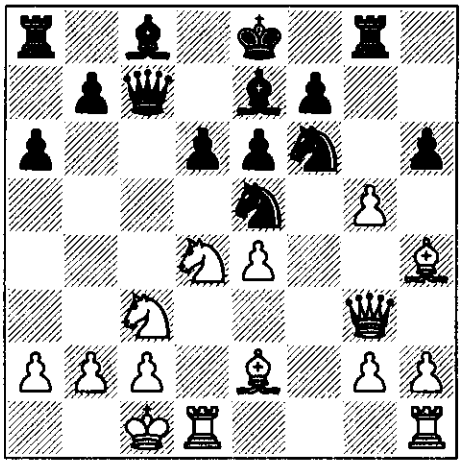
13 ... ♘e5 *(D)*

Other moves:

1) **13...♘c5** 14 ♕e3 hxg5 15 ♗g3 ♘cd7 16 h4 gxh4 17 ♗xh4 ♘e5 18 ♖df1 ♕d8 19 ♕f2 ♖g6 20 ♗h5 ♖h6 21 g4 ♘xh5 22 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 = Liberzon-H.Olafsson, Lone Pine 1979.

2) **13...hxg5** 14 ♗xg5 b5 (and not 14...♘h7? losing after 15 ♘xe6! ♗xg5+ 16 ♕xg5! +–) 15 a3 ♖b8 (15...♗b7 16 ♕h4 0-0-0 17 ♖hf1 ♖h8 18 ♕f2 ♖xh2 19 ♗xb5 axb5 20 ♘dxb5 ± Nicht-Kabisch, corr 1988)

16 ♖hf1 b4 17 axb4 ♖xb4 18 ♕h4 ♕c5 (18...♕a5 19 ♘c6 ♘xe4 20 ♘xe4 ♖xe4 21 ♕xe4 ♕xg5+ 22 ♔b1 ± Ermenkov-Inkiov, Bulgarian Ch 1979) 19 ♗e3 ♘g4 20 ♕g3 ♘df6 21 ♗xg4 ♖xg4 22 ♕h3 ♖g6 23 ♘f5 ± Planinc-Nemet, Štip 1978.



14 ♘f3

Alternatively:

1) **14 g6** ♘xg6 (14...♖xg6 15 ♕h3 b5 16 a3 ♗b7 17 ♖hf1 ♘xe4 18 ♗h5 ♘xc3 19 ♘xe6 ♕c4 20 ♗xg6 ∞ ♘e2+ 21 ♔b1 ♗c8? 22 ♘g7+ +– Bannik-Petrosian, USSR Ch 1957) 15 ♖hf1 ♘xh4 16 ♕xh4 ♖g6 17 ♗d3 ♘g4 18 ♕h5 ♘e5 19 ♘f3 ♕c5 20 ♘xe5 ♕xe5 21 ♕xe5 dxe5 = Tal-Fischer, Zurich 1959.

2) **14 ♖hf1** (promising) hxg5 (or 14...♘h7 15 ♗h5 hxg5 16 ♘f3 ±; 14...♗d7 15 ♘f3! ♘xf3 16 ♕xf3 hxg5 17 ♗g3 ± Zeller-Schrüfer, 2nd Bundesliga 1983) 15 ♗xg5 ♘h7 16 h4 and now:

2a) **16...f6** 17 ♗h5+ ♔d8 18 ♕h3 fxg5 19 ♘xe6+ ♗xe6 20 ♕xe6 forks e5 and g8.

2b) **16...♘xg5** 17 hxg5 b5? (a pointless move, since the bishop must stay defending the weak spot e6) 18 ♗h5 ♖xg5 19 ♕h3 b4 20 ♘ce2 ♘g6 21 ♗xg6 ♖xg6 22 ♕h8+ ♗f8 23 ♘f4 ♖h6 24 ♕g8 ♕e7 25 e5! d5 26 g4! 1-0 Pavlov-Marasescu, Romanian Ch 1985.

2c) **16...♗d7** 17 ♘f3 ♘xf3 18 ♕xf3 ♘xg5 19 hxg5 ♗xg5+ 20 ♔b1 ♖f8 21 ♕g3 ♗e7 22 ♖xf7 ♖xf7 23 ♗h5 0-0-0 24 ♗xf7 ± Perović-Dževlan, Yugoslavia Cht 1990.

14 ... hxg5

Or:

1) **14...♘fd7** 15 g6! (15 ♖hf1 b5! 16 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 17 ♕f2 b4 18 ♘a4 ♗b7 19 gxh6 ♗xe4 20 ♖d2 Liberzon-Browne, Buenos Aires 1979, 20...♖xg2 ∞) ♖xg6 16 ♕h3 with a plus for White. Lepeshkin continues his analysis 16...♘f6 17 ♘xe5 dxe5 18 ♖hf1 ♗d7 19 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 20 ♗h5 ♗g5+ 21 ♔b1 ♖g7 22 ♖xf7 ♖xf7 23 ♖f1 ♗f4 24 g3 +–.

2) **14...♘xf3** 15 ♗xf3 (15 ♕xf3 hxg5 16 ♗g3 ♗d7 17 h4! is also promising) hxg5 16 ♗xg5 ♕c5 (or 16...♘h7 17 ♗xe7 ♖xg3 18 ♗xd6 +–) 17 e5 (17 h4 ♘h7 18 e5 ♕xe5 {18...dxe5 19 ♘e4 ♕c7 20 ♗h5 +–} 19 ♕xe5 dxe5 20 ♗e3 ♖b8 21 ♗b6 ♗d7 22 ♗c7 ♖c8 23 ♗xe5 +– Weiner-Müller, corr 1971) ♘d7 18 h4 ♗xg5+ 19 hxg5 ♕e3+ (19...♕xe5 20 ♕xe5 dxe5 21 ♘e4 ±) 20 ♔b1 d5 21 ♘xd5! +– Prodkrajsek-Cakir, corr 1973.

15 ♗xg5

15 ♘xg5 ♘g6 16 ♖hf1 ♘xh4 (not 16...♕a5? 17 ♘xf7! ♔xf7 18 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 19 ♖d5! b5 {19...exd5 20 ♕g5 ♕d8 21 ♘xd5 +–} 20 e5 dxe5 21 ♖xf6+! +– Kupreichik-K.Grigorian, Leningrad 1974) 17 e5 (17 ♖xf6? ♕a5! wins, but not 17...♗xf6? 18 ♘xe6! +–) ♕c5! 18 exf6 (18 ♕xh4? ♘d5! ∓) ♕xg5+ 19 ♕xg5 ♖xg5 20

fxe7 ♖xg2 21 ♖xd6 ♔xe7 22 ♖fd1 ∓ Caprano-Salvadori, corr 1985.

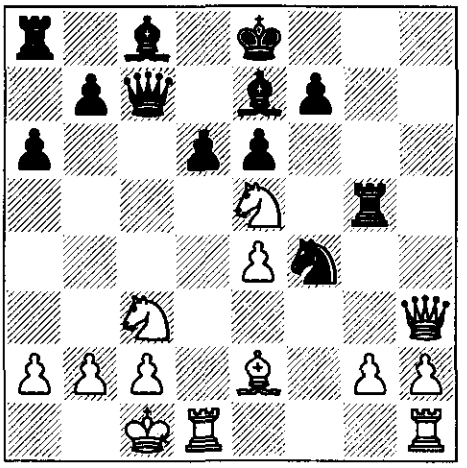
15 ... ♘h5

15...♘xf3 16 ♗xf3 ♕c5 17 h4 ♘h7 18 ♔b1 ♘xg5 19 hxg5 ♗d7 20 ♖h7 ♕xg5 21 ♕xg5 ♗xg5 22 ♖xd6 ± Lanka-Vitolinš, Jurmala 1983.

16 ♕h3 ♖xg5

16...♗xg5+ 17 ♘xg5 ♘f4 18 ♕h4 ♘xe2+ 19 ♘xe2 ♕e7 20 ♘f3 ♕xh4 21 ♘xh4 ♔e7 22 ♘c3 ♗d7 23 ♖he1 b5 24 a3 a5 with compensation for the pawn, Martin Gonzalez-Ricardi, Thessaloniki OL 1984.

17 ♘xe5 ♘f4 *(D)*



18 ♕h8+ ♗f8 19 ♘d3 ♘xe2+ 20 ♘xe2 ♗d7 21 ♖hf1 and now:

1) **21...♗c6** 22 ♘d4 ♕e7 23 h4 ♖g4 24 ♘xc6 bxc6 25 ♖f4 ♖xf4 26 ♘xf4 e5 27 ♘h5 0-0-0 28 ♕f6 ♕xf6 29 ♘xf6 ± Iskov-Hamann, Gausdal 1982.

2) **21...♖c8** 22 ♘c3 ♗b5 23 ♖f2 ♗xd3 24 ♖xd3 b5 25 ♖df3 b4 26 ♖f6! ♕e7 27 ♘e2 +– Werner-Theil, corr 1970.

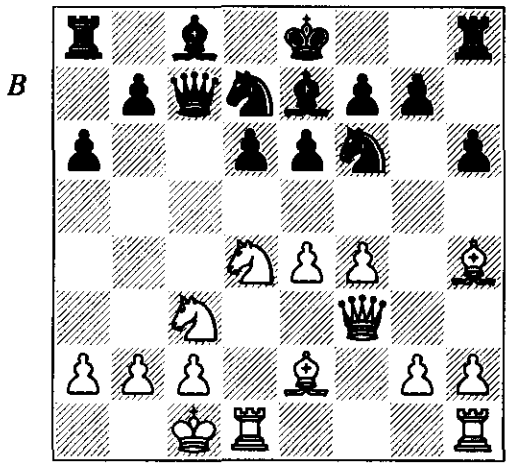
3) **21...♗a4** 22 ♘c3 ♖xg2 23 ♘e1 ♖g7 24 ♘xa4 ♕c4 25 ♘b6 ♕xf1 26 ♘xa8 ♕f4+ 27 ♔b1 ♕g4 28 ♖c1 ♕xe4 29 ♘d3 ♕c6 ∞ Grünfeld-de Firmian, Gausdal 1982.

My admittedly fairly subjective impression is that A1 is a safer option for Black than A2, with the overall conclusion being that 11 ♕g3 gives White few chances of an advantage against accurate defence.

B)

8 ... h6
9 ♗h4 ♕c7
10 0-0-0 ♘bd7
11 ♗e2 *(D)*

White seeks to take advantage of Black's early ...h6 by developing his bishop on a more effective square than d3. This line is probably the critical test of an early ...h6; if it is good for White then Black must wait for White to play ♗d3 before advancing his h-pawn.



11 ... ♖b8

It is already a bad sign for Black that he has to prepare ...b5 with this slightly artificial move. Alternatives:

1) **11...b5** and now:

1a) **12 ♗xf6** (the position is now the same as in line C of chapter 2, except that Black's pawn is on h6 and not h7; this does introduce a few differences, so we are covering this line independently, but of course many

variations are very similar) ♘xf6 (12...♗xf6 13 e5 dxe5 {13...♗b7 14 ♘dxb5 axb5 15 ♘xb5 +–} 14 ♘dxb5 axb5 15 ♕xa8 0-0 16 ♘xb5 ♕c5 17 ♕a3 and White wins, Thomas-Quaresma, corr 1990; 12...gxf6 13 ♕h5 ♘c5 14 a3 ♖b8 15 f5 ± Van der Klashorst-Stuijfzand, corr 1981) 13 e5 ♗b7 14 ♕g3 (14 exf6 is possible, which is very similar to the game Keres-Fischer in line C of chapter 2) dxe5 15 fxe5 with the branch:

1a1) **15...♘d7** 16 ♘xe6! fxe6 (in this line the position of the pawn on h6 makes a crucial difference) 17 ♕g6+ (17 ♗h5+ ♔d8 18 ♕xg7 ♖f8 19 ♗g4 ♖e8 20 ♔b1 ♕c4 21 ♗h5 ♖f8 22 ♖d3 ♖c8 23 ♖hd1 ♗d5 24 ♗f3 ♖xf3 25 gxf3 ♘b6 26 ♕xh6 ± Markland-Toothill, corr 1985) ♔d8 18 ♕xe6 ♖e8 19 ♕f5 ♗g5+ 20 ♔b1 ♔e7 21 ♖d6 b4 22 ♖hd1 ♘c5 23 ♗c4 1-0 M.Hansen-Stephan, corr 1984.

1a2) **15...♘d5** 16 ♘xe6 fxe6 17 ♕g6+ ♔d7 18 ♗g4 ♕xe5 19 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 (19...♕g5+ 20 ♘f4+! ♔c7 21 ♕xe6 ♕xf4+ 22 ♔b1 ♗c5 23 ♖d7+ ♔b8 24 ♖xb7+ ♔xb7 25 ♗f3+ ♔b8 26 ♗xa8 ±) 20 ♖xd5+ ♕xd5 21 ♖d1 ♗g5+ 22 ♔b1 ♕xd1+ 23 ♗xd1 (this position might appear unclear, but White's initiative, aided by the opposite-coloured bishops, turns out to be very dangerous) ♗f6 24 ♕f7+ (24 ♕e4 ♖hc8 25 ♕b7+ ♔d6 26 ♗f3 ♔c5 27 a3 +– Kunas-Ottens, Germany 1992) ♔d6 25 ♗f3 ♖ab8 26 ♕a7 ♖hd8 (26...b4 27 ♕xa6+ ♔e7 28 a4 bxa3 29 ♕xa3+ ♔d7 30 b4 ♖hc8 31 c4 ± Vaisman-Adam, corr 1970) 27 a3 a5 28 ♕xa5 ♔e7 29 ♕c7+ ♔f8 30 ♗h5 ♗e7 31 ♕e5 ♗f6 32 ♕xe6 +– Boll-Johansson, corr 1978.

1a3) **15...♘e4** 16 ♘xe6 ♕xc3 17 ♘xg7+ ♔f8 18 ♘e6+ ♔e8 19 ♕xc3 ♘xc3 (19...♗g5+ 20 ♘xg5 ♘xc3 21 bxc3 hxg5, Schönthier-Blaskowski, 2nd Bundesliga 1989, 22 ♗f3 ±) 20 ♘c7+ ♔f8 21 bxc3 ♖c8 22 ♘d5 ♗a3+ (22...♗g5+ 23 ♔b2 ♖e8 24 h4 ♖xe5 25 hxg5 ♗xd5 26 gxh6 ±) 23 ♔b1 ♔g7 24 ♘f6 ♖hd8 25 ♗f3 ♗xf3 26 gxf3 ± Martin del Campo-Herrera, Bayamo 1990.

1b) **12 e5** ♗b7 13 exf6 (13 ♕g3 dxe5 14 ♘xe6 fxe6 15 ♕g6+ ♔f8 16 ♗g4 exf4 17 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 18 ♗xe6 ♘e5 is definitely better for Black, Olthof-Deak, Eger 1987) ♗xf3 14 ♗xf3 d5! (without the moves ...h6 and ♗h4, Black could win by ...gxf6 here; 14...♗xf6 15 ♗xf6 ♖c8 16 ♗xg7 ♖h7 17 ♗h5 ♖xg7 18 ♘xe6 ♕c4 19 ♖he1 ♖xg2, Kliavin-Tal, Riga 1959, 20 ♖d4! ±) 15 ♘xe6 (15 fxg7 ♖g8 16 ♗xd5 ♗xh4 17 ♗xa8 ♗f6 18 f5 ♕f4+ 19 ♔b1 ♗xd4 20 ♘e2 ♕xf5 21 ♘xd4 ♕h5 22 ♗f3 ∞ Preinfalk-Keller, corr 1972) fxe6 16 ♗h5+ g6 17 ♗xg6+ ♔f8 18 fxe7+ ♔g7 19 ♗g3 b4! 20 f5! ♕c4 (or 20...♕c5!? 21 ♘e2 ∞) 21 fxe6! bxc3 22 exd7 ♕xa2 23 ♗e5+ ♔xg6 24 ♗xc3 ♕a1+ 25 ♔d2 ♕a4 26 ♗xh8 ♕f4+ 27 ♔c3 ♕c4+ 28 ♔d2 ♕f4+ 29 ♔c3 ♕c4+ 30 ♔d2 ♕f4+ ½-½ Bryson-Pereira, corr 1989.

2) **11...g5** 12 fxg5 ♘e5 and now:

2a) **13 ♕g3** ♖g8 transposes to line A2.

2b) **13 ♕f2** hxg5 14 ♗xg5 ♘fg4 15 ♕f4 ♘f2! (15...♗xg5 16 ♕xg5 ♘f2 17 ♕f6 +–) 16 ♕xf2 ♗xg5+ 17 ♔b1 ♗d7 18 h4 ♗e7 19 ♖h3 and Black does not have enough for the pawn, Burow-Walther, corr 1977.

2c) **13 ♕e3** and now:

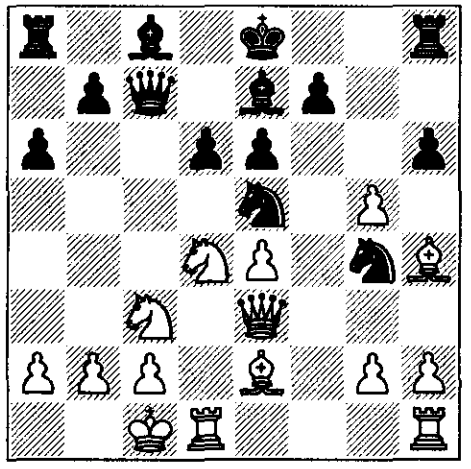
2c1) **13...♘h7** 14 ♘f3 (14 ♖hf1 hxg5 15 ♗g3 ♗d7 is fine for Black) hxg5 (14...♘xf3 15 ♗xf3 hxg5 16 ♗g3 ♘f8 17 e5 d5 18 ♗xd5 exd5 19 ♘xd5 +– Winslow-Popovych, New York 1985) and now:

2c11) **15 ♗xg5?** ♘xg5 16 ♘xg5 ♕c5! 17 ♕g3 ♗xg5+ 0-1 Vlahov-Bozinović, Croatia Cht 1994 is an easy trap to fall into.

2c12) **15 ♘xg5** ♕c5 (or 15...♕d8 16 ♘xh7 ♗xh4 17 ♕h6 and Black has no obvious way to exploit the apparent vulnerability of White's pieces) 16 ♕xc5 dxc5 17 ♘f3 ♗xh4 18 ♘xe5 ± Levchenkov-Vitolinš, USSR 1984.

2c13) **15 ♗g3** ♗d7 (15...♖g8 16 ♔b1 ♘f8 17 ♖hf1 ♖g7 18 ♕d2 ♗d7 19 ♘xe5 dxe5 20 ♗h5 ± Boudre-Sellos, Paris Ch 1989) 16 ♕d4 (16 h4 0-0-0 17 hxg5 ♘xf3 18 gxf3 ♗xg5 19 ♗f4 f6 20 ♗xg5 ♘xg5 21 ♖xh8 ♖xh8 22 ♕d4 ± Salov-Pablo, USSR 1982) f6 17 ♘xe5 fxe5 18 ♗h5+ ♔d8 19 ♕d3 ± Luther-Topalov, European jr Ch 1989.

2c2) **13...♘fg4** *(D)* with a further branch:



2c21) **14 ♕d2** hxg5 15 ♗xg5 ♘f2 16 ♘db5!? (16 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 17 ♗b5+ axb5 18 ♕xf2 b4 19 ♘cb5 ♖xa2 20 ♘b3 ♘c4 21 ♕d4 ♕g5+ ∞) axb5 17 ♗xb5+ ♗d7 (17...♘c6 18 ♗xe7 ♘xd1 19 ♗xd6 ♘xc3 20 ♗xc7 ♘xb5 21 ♗g3 ♖xa2 22 ♔b1 ±) 18 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 19 ♕xf2 ♗xb5 20 ♘xb5 ♕c6 21 ♘c3 b5 (it is certainly hard to believe that Black has compensation for two pawns) 22 ♖hf1 ♖h6 23 ♖d4 ♕c5 24 ♔b1 ♖xh2 25 ♕f6+ ♔f8 26 ♖d2 b4 27 ♘e2 ♕c4 28 b3 ♕xe4 29 ♕xe6 ♕g6 30 ♖f6! ± Pohling-Wagner, corr 1976.

2c22) **14 ♗xg4** ♘xg4 15 ♕d2 and now:

2c221) **15...hxg5** 16 ♗xg5 ♘f2 17 ♗xe7! ♘xd1 (17...♘xh1 18 ♘f5! exf5 19 ♗xd6 ♕d7 20 exf5 +–) 18 ♘d5! exd5 19 ♗f6 ♖h5 20 exd5 ♗g4 21 ♖e1+ ♔f8 22 h3 ♖e8 23 hxg4 ♖xe1 24 ♕xe1 ♘xb2 25 ♔xb2 ♖xd5 26 g5 ♖a5 27 g6 1-0 Planinc-Pokojowczyk, Polanica Zdroj 1979.

2c222) **15...♖g8** 16 ♘f3 ♘e5 17 gxh6 ♘xf3 18 gxf3 ♗xh4 19 h7 ♖h8 20 ♕h6 ♕e7 21 ♖hg1 ♔d7 22 e5 +– Niemi-Nieminen, corr 1981.

2c223) **15...♘e5** 16 ♘f3 hxg5 17 ♗xg5 f6 18 ♘xe5 dxe5 19 ♗e3 b5 20 ♘e2 ♗b7 21 ♘g3 ♖d8 22 ♕e2 ♖xd1+ 23 ♖xd1 ♖h4 24 ♗f2 ♕c4 25 ♕d2 ♗xe4 26 ♘xe4 ♖xe4 27 ♕h6 with an edge for White, Belavenets-Heigl, corr 1990.

3) **11...♖g8** and now:

3a) **12 ♕g3** g5 13 fxg5 is line A2.

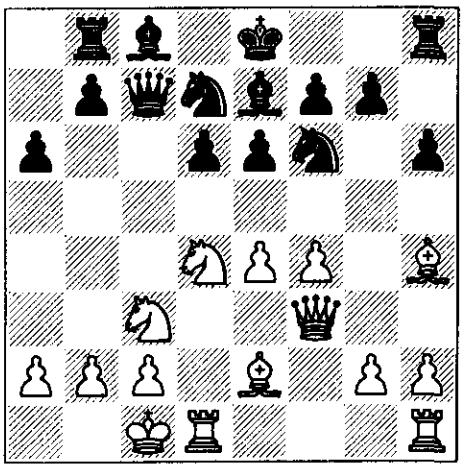
3b) **12 ♗xf6** ♘xf6 13 h4 h5? (13...b5) 14 ♕g3 b5 15 e5 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♗b7 17 ♘xe6! fxe6 18 ♕g6+ ♔f8 19 ♗xh5 ♘xh5 20 ♕xh5 b4 21 ♖hf1+ ♗f6 22 exf6 +– Wedberg-Jakobsen, Malmö 1982.

3c) **12 ♗g3** b5 (12...g5 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘xe5 15 ♕e3 ♘fd7 16

♘xe6!) 13 e5 ♗b7 14 ♕f1 dxe5 15 ♗xc5 ♘d5 16 ♘xe6!? (16 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 17 ♗f3 ± Tal-Ljubojević, Bugojno 1980, is safer) fxe6 17 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 18 ♖xd5 ♖c8 (18...exd5 19 e6 ±) 19 ♗d3 (19 ♖d2? ♗b4 ∓ Matulović-Ljubojević, Yugoslav Ch 1975) cxd5?! (19...♖f8 ∞) 20 e6 ♘e5 21 ♗xe5 ♕xe5 22 ♕f7+ ♔d8 23 ♕xg8+ ♔c7 24 ♕f7 ±.

3d) **12 ♗f2** g5 (12...b5 13 g4!?) 13 g3 b5 14 ♖he1 ♗b7 15 ♗d3 ♘c5 16 a3 d5 17 exd5 ♘xd5 18 ♘xe6!? ♘xe6 (18...fxe6 is critical) 19 ♘xd5 0-0-0 20 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 21 ♗e4 +– Palmiotto-Johansson, corr 1969.

Going back to the main line after 11...♖b8 *(D)*:



12 ♕g3

Several other moves have been tried in this position:

1) **12 g4** g5?! (12...b5; 12...♘xe4) 13 fxg5 ♘e5 14 ♕g3 hxg5 15 ♗xg5 ♘fxg4 16 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 17 ♘f3 ♖g8 18 ♘xe5 ♕g5+ 19 ♖d2 ♕xe5 20 ♗xg4 ♕xg3 21 hxg3 ♖xg4 22 ♖xd6 ± Mohaupt-Schulz, corr 1972.

2) **12 ♖he1** b5 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘xe5 15 ♗xb5+ axb5 16 ♘cxb5 ♕c5 17 ♖xe5 ♕xe5 18 ♗g3 ♗b7 19 ♗xe5 ♗xf3 20 gxf3 ♖c8 21 ♘c7+ ♔f8 22 a4 ∞ Stransky-Gouder, corr 1978.

3) **12 f5** e5 13 ♘b3 (13 ♘e6!? fxe6 14 fxe6 ♘b6 15 ♗xf6 0-0?! {15...♗xf6 is better} 16 ♗xe7 ♖xf3 17 ♗xd6 ♖xc3 18 ♗xc7 ♖xc7 19 ♖d8+ ♔h7 20 ♖f1 ♖e7 21 ♖ff8 h5 22 ♖h8+ ♔g6 23 ♖df8 ♗xe6 24 ♖xb8 ♗g4 25 ♗xa6 1-0 Soloviev-Gratvol, USSR 1968) b5 14 ♗xf6 (14 ♔b1 ♗b7 15 a3 ♗a8 16 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 17 ♕d3 0-0 18 ♗f3 b4 19 axb4 ♖xb4 20 ♕xa6 ♗c6 21 ♕d3 ♖a8 ∓ Jansa-Smejkal, Luhačovice 1969) ♘xf6 15 h4 ♗b7 16 g4 b4 17 ♘d5 ♗xd5 18 exd5 ♘d7 (18...a5 19 g5 ♘d7 20 f6 gxf6 21 gxf6 ♘xf6 22 ♘d2 a4 23 ♔b1 a3 24 ♘e4 ♘xe4 25 ♕xe4 ± Feldmann-Bukhman, USSR 1971) 19 ♘d2 0-0 20 f6? (20 ♔b1) ♖fc8 21 ♗d3 ♗xf6 22 ♘e4 ♘c5 ∓ Hauptmann-Effertz, corr 1991.

12 ... ♖g8 *(D)*

Or:

1) **12...b5?!** and now White has a choice of attacking lines:

1a) **13 e5** (but it isn't clear if this sacrifice is correct) dxe5 14 ♘xe6 fxe6 15 ♕g6+ ♔f8 16 f5! ♘c5 17 ♖hf1 h5? (17...♗d7 ∞) 18 ♗xh5 ♖xh5 19 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 20 ♕xh5 ♕f7 21 ♕h8+ ♕g8 22 ♖d8+! ♗xd8 23 fxe6+ ♗f6 24 e7+ ♔f7 25 ♕xg8+ 1-0 Tringov-Martinović, Trstenik 1978.

1b) **13 ♕xg7** (apparently very good for White) ♖h7 (13...♖g8 14 ♕xh6 ♗f8 15 ♘xe6 fxe6 16 ♕h5+ ♔e7 17 e5! dxe5 18 ♘e4 +–) 14 ♘xe6! fxe6 15 ♕g6+ ♖f7 16 e5 dxe5 17 ♖xd7! ♕xd7 18 ♖d1 ♘d5 19 ♕g8+ ♗f8 20 ♗h5 ♖b7 21 ♘e4 ♕c6 22 fxe5 1-0 Marcinkiewicz-Dobruchowsky, corr 1975. An excellent game.

1c) **13 f5** (also very good) ♘f8 (13...e5 14 ♕xg7 ♖g8 15 ♘d5 ♕d8 16 ♗xf6 ♖xg7 17 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 18 ♘xe7 exd4 19 ♘xc8 ♖xc8 20 g3 +– Rubinetti-Wirthensohn, Skopje OL 1972) 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 (14...gxf6 15 fxe6 fxe6 16 ♗h5+ ♔d8 17 ♕g7 ♖h7 18 ♕g8 ±) 15 fxe6 fxe6 16 ♗h5+ ♔d7 17 ♖hf1! +– ♔d8? 18 ♘c6+ 1-0 Schoneberg-Faifr, corr 1978.

2) **12...g5** 13 fxg5 hxg5 (13...♖g8 14 ♘xe6! fxe6 15 gxf6 ♖xg3 16 ♗h5+ +–, a typical trick in this line) 14 ♗xg5 and now:

2a) **14...b5** 15 ♖hf1 (15 a3 ♖g8 transposes to line A2, note to Black's 13th move, line 2) b4 16 ♘xe6 fxe6 17 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 18 e5 bxc3 (18...dxe5 19 ♕g6+ +–) 19 exd6 ♗xd6 20 ♖xd6 ♘e4 21 ♗h5+! +– Giertz-Zuse, corr 1979.

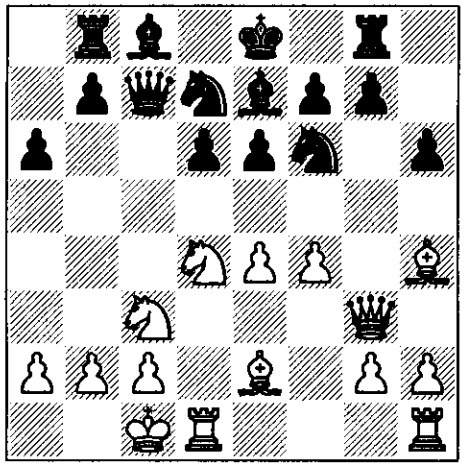
2b) **14...♖g8** 15 h4 (15 ♖hf1 b5 16 a3 is the same reference in line A2 as above; 15 ♕h4 ♕c5 16 ♘f3 b5 17 ♖he1 b4 18 ♘a4 ♕a5 19 e5 dxe5 20 ♖xd7 ♗xd7 21 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 22 ♕xf6 ♗xa4 23 ♘xe5 ♕c7 24 b3, Eraso-Ibran, corr, 24...♖c8 ±) b5 16 ♕e3! b4 17 ♘b1 ♗b7 18 ♘d2 ♖c8 19 ♔b1 d5 (19...e5 20 ♘f5 ♕xc2+ 21 ♔a1 ±) 20 exd5 ♘xd5 21 ♕f2 (21 ♕xe6!? ±) ± Nunn-Nemet, Biel 1983.

3) **12...0-0** and now:

3a) **13 ♖hf1** ♘c5 14 ♗f3 ♘h7 15 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 16 h4 ♗d7 17 e5 dxe5 18 fxe5 b5 19 ♘e4 ♘xe4 20 ♗xe4 ± Boudre-Ljubisavljević, Uzes 1989.

3b) **13 ♘d5** ♘xd5 14 exd5 ♗xh4 15 ♕xh4 e5 (15...♘f6 16 dxe6 fxe6 17 ♗d3 e5 18 fxe5 dxe5 19 ♘f5 e4 20 ♗xe4 ♕e5 21 ♕g3 ♕xg3 22 ♘xg3 ♘xe4 23 ♘xe4 ± Lorincz-Shirok, corr 1980) 16 ♘f5 ♘c5 ∞ Hamers-Oosterhoff, corr 1977.

3c) **13 ♗f3** ♘b6 (13...b5? 14 e5! dxe5 15 fxe5 and now both 15...♘xe5 and 15...♕xe5 lose to 16 ♘c6!) 14 ♖he1 (14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘fd5 16 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 17 ♘e4 ♘g6 18 ♘d6 ♖d8 ½-½ Lefik-Gatto, corr 1986, but 19 ♗h5! ±; 14 f5 e5 15 ♘b3 ♗d7 16 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 17 h4 ♖fc8 18 ♕f2 ♖a8 19 g4 a5 20 g5 hxg5 21 hxg5 ♗xg5+ 22 ♔b1 a4 23 ♕h2 ♔f8 24 ♕g1 ♗h6 25 ♖xh6 gxh6 26 f6 ♗e6 27 ♗e2 1-0 Fagerström-Canglotti, corr 1989) ♘c4 15 e5 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♘h7 17 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 18 ♗e2 ♕b4 19 ♘b3 b5 20 ♖d4 ± Vasiukov-Najdorf, Wijk aan Zee 1973.



13 ♖hf1

Or:

1) **13 e5** (playing for an immediate knock-out, but this is probably too ambitious) dxe5 14 ♘xe6 fxe6 15 ♕g6+ ♔f8 (15...♔d8 16 fxe5 ♕xe5 17 ♗g3 ♕e3+ 18 ♔b1 e5 19 ♖he1 ♖e8 20 ♗h5! ♕g5 21 ♗xe5 ♖h8 22 ♗xb8 ♘xh5 23 ♖xd7+ ♗xd7 24 ♕b6+ ♔e8 25 ♗d6 ♖f8 26 ♘d5 ♗e6 27 ♗xe7 1-0 Terentiev-Voitkevich, USSR 1979) 16 f5 e4 (after 16...♘c5 17 ♖hf1 ♗d7 18 fxe6 ♗xe6 19 ♘d5 ♗xd5 20 ♖xd5 ♕c6 I do not see more than a draw by 21

♗xf6 ♗xf6 22 ♖xc5 ♕xc5 23 ♖xf6+ gxf6 24 ♕xf6+) 17 fxe6, Garcia Martinez-Ortega, Havana 1984, but now 17...♕f4+ (17...♘e5 18 ♕f5 g6 19 ♕f1 was ± in the game) 18 ♔b1 ♘e5 19 ♕g3 ♕xg3 20 ♗xg3 ♘c6 21 ♗xb8 ♘xb8 22 ♗c4 b5 23 ♗b3 ♗b7 would have been equal according to Garcia Martinez.

2) **13 ♖he1** g5 14 fxg5 ♘e5 15 ♘f3 (the rook belongs on f1 and not c1) ♘fd7 (15...♘h5 16 ♕f2 ♘g4 17 ♕d4 hxg5 18 ♗xg5 ♗xg5+ 19 ♘xg5 ♖xg5 20 ♕h8+ ♔e7 21 ♗xg4 ♗d7 22 ♕h6 ♖xg4, Tarjan-Browne, USA Ch 1973, 23 ♘d5+! exd5 24 exd5+ ♗e6 25 ♕xh5 ♖xg2 26 ♕h7 +–) 16 g6 ♖xg6 17 ♕f2 b5 18 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 19 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 20 ♕h4+ ♔e8 21 ♗h5 ♖g5 22 ♗f3 ♖g6 = Cao-Wahono, Asian Cht 1995.

13 ... g5

Alternatively:

1) **13...b5** 14 e5 dxe5 15 ♘xe6 (with an extra tempo this is crushing) fxe6 16 ♕g6+ ♔d8 17 f5 (17 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 18 ♕f7 ♖h8 19 ♘e4 ♗e7 20 ♕xg7 ♖f8 21 ♕xh6 ♖b6 22 ♘g5 ± Barczay-Ribli, Hungarian Ch 1976) exf5 18 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 19 ♘d5 ♕c6 20 ♖xf5 ♖f8 21 ♗g4 ♖b6 22 ♖xf6 gxf6 23 ♕g7 ♖b7 24 ♕e7# Lombardy-Quinteros, Manila 1974.

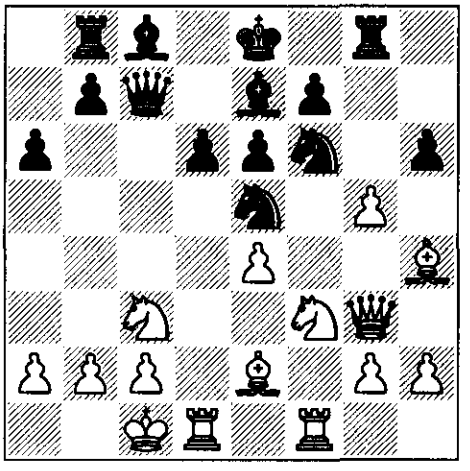
2) **13...♘c5** 14 e5! (14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 15 f5 ♗e5 16 ♕h3 b5 17 fxe6 ♘xe6 18 ♘d5 ± Kengis-Zaichik, USSR 1974) dxe5 (14...♘fe4 15 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 16 exd6 ♗xd6 17 ♕e3 ±) 15 fxe5 ♘fe4 16 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 17 ♕f4 ♗xh4 18 ♕xh4 ♘c5 19 ♘b5! axb5 20 ♖xf7! ♔xf7 21 ♗h5+ g6 22 ♕f6+ ♔e8 23 ♗xg6+ ♖xg6 24 ♕h8+! ♔f7 25 ♖f1+ ♔e7 26 ♕f8+ 1-0 Am.Rodriguez-Herrera, Havana 1990.

14 fxg5 ♘e5

14...♕a5 (14...hxg5 15 ♗xg5 is line 2b in the note to Black's 12th move) 15 ♘xe6! fxe6 16 gxf6 ♖xg3 17 ♖d5! ♕xd5 18 ♘xd5 ♘xf6 19 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 20 ♗xg3 +– Weinstein-DeFotis, Chicago 1973.

15 ♘f3 *(D)*

Or 15 g6 (simple and promising) ♖xg6 16 ♕h3 b5 17 ♗xf6 ♖xf6 18 ♖xf6 ♗xf6 19 ♕xh6 ♘g6 20 ♗h5 ♕c5 21 ♘f3 +– Diaz-Ortega, Bayamo 1984.



15 ... hxg5

Relatively best, for example:

1) **15...b5** 16 ♘xe5 b4 (16...dxe5 17 gxf6! ♖xg3 18 fxe7 ♖g5 19 ♗xg5 hxg5 20 ♗h5 +–) 17 ♘xf7! bxc3 18 gxf6! ♖xg3 19 fxe7 ♖g5 20 ♗xg5 hxg5 21 ♘xd6+ 1-0 Grefe-Browne, USA Ch 1973.

2) **15...♘h5** 16 ♕e1! ♘xf3 17 ♗xf3 ♗xg5+ 18 ♗xg5 ♖xg5 19 ♕d2 and wins.

3) **15...♘xf3** 16 ♗xf3 hxg5 17 ♗xg5 ♘h7 18 ♗xe7! ♖xg3 19 ♗xd6 ♕a5 20 hxg3! ♖a8 21 e5 +–.

4) **15...♘fd7** 16 ♕f2 hxg5 17 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 18 ♗h5 ♖g7 19 ♗g3 ♘g6 20 ♗xg6 fxg6 21 ♕d2 ± Konkolsky-Cmiel, corr 1982.

16 ♘xg5

Contrary to *The Najdorf for the Tournament Player*, 16 ♗xg5 (16 ♘xe5? gxh4 ∓) is playable, as the 'refutation' 16...♘h5 is met by 17 ♕h3! ± (17...♘xf3 18 ♗xe7). Since 16...♘xf3 17 ♗xf3 ♕a5 (17...♘h7? 18 ♗xe7!) 18 h4 ♘d7 19 ♖xd6! is very good for White, and 16...♘fd7 17 ♕f4! f6 18 ♘xe5 wins, it seems that 16 ♗xg5 is actually a good alternative to the text.

16 ... ♖g6

White has the advantage:

1) **17 ♕h3** b5 18 ♘f3 ♘c6 19 ♗g5 b4 20 ♘b1 ♘xe4 21 ♕h8+ ♗f8 22 ♗d3 b3 (22...♖xg5 23 ♘xg5 ♘xg5 24 h4 ±) 23 axb3 ♘b4 24 ♗xe4 ♘a2+ 25 ♔d2 ♕a5+ 26 ♔e2 ♖xg5 27 ♘xg5 ♕xg5 28 ♖xf7 1-0 Martin-Quaresma, corr 1992.

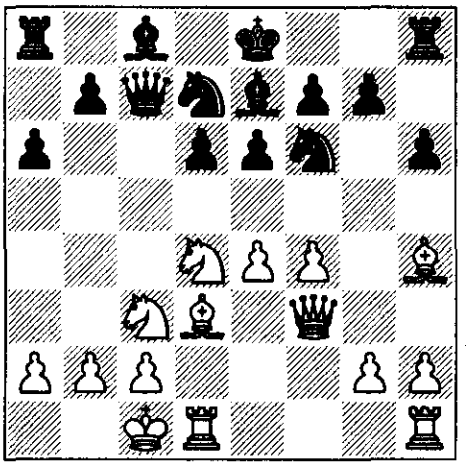
2) **17 ♕f4!** b5 18 ♘xf7! is probably even stronger, e.g. 18...b4 19 ♗xf6 bxc3 20 ♗xe7 +– or 18...♘xf7 19 ♗h5 e5 20 ♕f3 +–.

To sum up, 10 ♗e2 is extremely dangerous for Black and renders the idea of an early ...h6, if not unplayable, at least inadvisable.

C)

8	**...**	**♕c7**
9	**0-0-0**	**♘bd7**
10	**♗d3**	**h6**
11	**♗h4** *(D)*	
11	**...**	**g5**

B



Or:

1) **11...♘xe4?** 12 ♘xe6 is suicidal.

2) **11...♘c5** (this appears playable) and now:

2a) **12 e5** (aiming for an instant win) dxe5 13 fxe5 ♘xd3+ 14 ♖xd3 ♘d7 (14...♕xe5 15 ♘c6! ♕c7 16 ♘xe7 ♕xe7 17 ♘d5 1-0 Williams-Dewing, corr 1981) 15 ♘xe6 fxe6 16 ♕h5+ ♔d8 17 ♗g3? (White can force a draw by 17 ♗xe7+ ♔xe7 18 ♖f1 ♖f8 19 ♖xf8 ♔xf8 20 ♖f3+ ♔g8 21 ♕f7+ ♔h8 22 ♖g3 ♕xe5 23 ♘e4 b5 24 ♕e8+ ♔h7 25 ♕g6+) ♕c6 18 ♕f7 g5 ∓ Guyard-Röder, Paris 1995.

2b) **12 ♖he1** ♘fxe4 (12...♘xd3+ 13 ♖xd3 ♕a5 14 e5 dxe5 15 ♘b3 ♕c7 16 fxe5 ♘h7, Åkesson-Cederlind, corr 1974, 17 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 18 ♖ed1 ±) 13 ♘xe4 ♗xh4 14 ♕g4 ♘xe4 15 ♕xh4 ♘c5 16 ♘f5 ♔f8 17 ♘xd6 ♕e7 (17...g5 18 fxg5 ♕xd6 19 ♗h7 ♕e7 20 ♕xh6+ ♔e8 21 g6 ♕f6 22 ♖f1 wins for White, Cuoghi-Cova, corr 1986) 18 ♕xe7+ ♔xe7 19 ♗f1 b5 20 g3 ♖a7 21 ♗g2 ♗b7 22 ♗xb7 ½-½ De Greve-Prieditis, corr 1992.

3) **11...b5** and now:

3a) **12 ♗xf6** gxf6 (this is the only move which has been played, but there seems to be nothing drastically wrong with 12...♘xf6, for example 13 e5 ♗b7 14 ♕g3 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘d7 16 ♕xg7 ♕xe5 17 ♘xe6 ♗f6 and Black defends) 13 ♕h5 ♘c5 (13...♕c5? 14 ♘xe6) 14 f5 b4 15

♘ce2 e5 16 ♗c4 exd4 17 ♕xf7+ ♔d8 18 ♖xd4 ♖f8 19 ♕g7 ♗b7 20 ♘f4 a5 21 ♖hd1 and White is distinctly better, Prié-Sonnet, French Cht 1991.

3b) **12 e5** (a clear-cut route to an advantage) ♗b7 13 ♘xe6 fxe6 14 ♗g6+ with the branch:

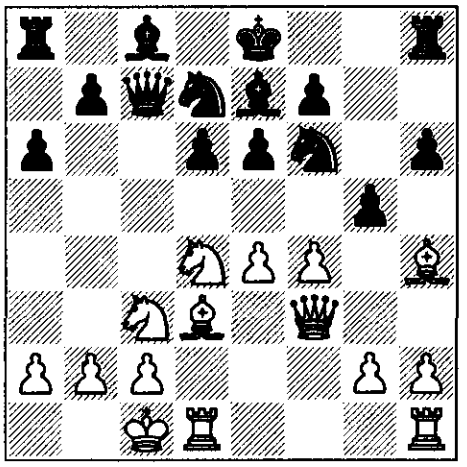
3b1) **14...♔f8** 15 exf6 with two alternatives:

3b11) **15...♗xf3** 16 fxe7+ ♔g8 17 gxf3 ♘f6 18 ♗xf6 gxf6 19 e8♕+ ♖xe8 20 ♗xe8 ♔f8 (20...d5? Gligorić-Bobotsov, Hastings 1959/60, 21 f5! ♕f4+ 22 ♔b1 ♕xf5 23 ♖hg1+ ♔f8 24 ♗d7! +–) 21 ♗g6 f5 22 ♖he1 b4 (22...♕d7 23 ♘e2 ♖g8 24 ♗h5, followed by ♘d4) 23 ♖xe6 bxc3 24 ♖f6+ ♔g8 25 ♗xf5 +– Montanelli-Galli, corr 1969.

3b12) **15...♗xf6** 16 ♕g4 ♗xc3 (16...♗xh4 17 ♕xh4 ♗xg2 18 ♖hg1 ♗b7 19 ♕g4 ♘c5 20 b4! ±) 17 bxc3 ♕c4 (17...♕xc3? 18 ♕xe6 ♕a1+ 19 ♔d2 ♕d4+ 20 ♔e1! ♕c3+ 21 ♖d2 +–) 18 ♖he1 ♕xc3 19 ♕xe6 ♕a1+ 20 ♔d2 ♕d4+ 21 ♔e2 ♕c4+ 22 ♕xc4 bxc4 23 ♖xd6 +– R.Burgess-Woldmo, corr 1990.

3b2) **14...♔d8** 15 ♕h3! ♘d5 (the line 15...♕c4 16 exf6 gxf6 17 ♖he1 b4 18 ♘e4 ♗d5 19 b3 ♕c6 is the best chance for Black, Kschiston-Tomson, corr 1965, but now 20 ♖xd5! exd5 {20...♕xd5 21 ♖d1} 21 ♘g3 ♘f8 {21...♕c3 22 ♘f5 +–} 22 ♖xe7 ♘xg6 23 ♖f7 ♘xh4 24 ♕xh4 ♕c3 25 ♘e2 and White wins) 16 ♕xe6 ♘f8 (16...♗xh4 17 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 18 ♖xd5 is again winning, Winterstein-Holfelder, Wiesbaden 1988) 17 ♕f7 ♘xg6 18 exd6 ♕xd6 19 ♘xd5 1-0 Ansner-Jalvemo, corr 1977.

After 11...g5 *(D)* we have:



C1: 12 fxg5
C2: 12 e5

C1)

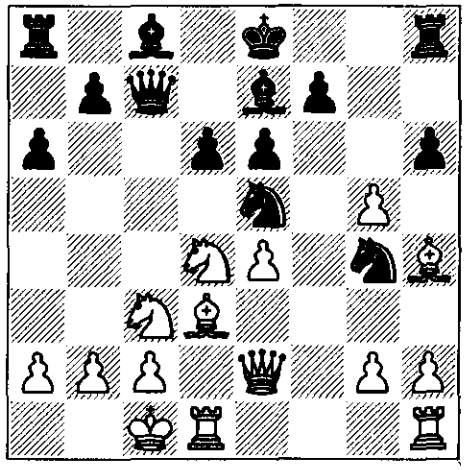
12 fxg5 ♘e5
13 ♕e2

13 ♕g3 ♘h5 14 ♕e3 ♕c5 (but not 14...hxg5 15 ♗xg5 ♘g4 16 ♕d2 ♗xg5 17 ♕xg5 ♘f2 18 g4 ♕c5 19 ♘f5! exf5 20 ♘d5 ♔f8 21 gxh5 ♗e6 22 ♕e7+ 1-0 Kaunz-Coman, corr 1986) 15 ♔b1 hxg5 16 ♗f2 ♘g4 ∓ Conroy-Savory, corr 1992.

13 ... ♘fg4 *(D)*

Or 13...♘h7 (13...♘fd7 14 ♕h5 ♘c5 15 gxh6 ♘cxd3+ 16 cxd3 ♕c5 17 ♘f5! exf5 18 d4 ♕b6 19 ♗xe7 ♘c4 20 ♕e2 ♕xb2+ 21 ♕xb2 ♘xb2, Kamsky-Polgar, Paris rpd 1992, 22 ♗f6! ♘xd1 23 ♗xh8 ♘xc3 24 h7 +–) 14 ♘f3 hxg5 15 ♗f2! ♘f8 (or 15...♗d7 16 ♘xe5 dxe5 17 ♕h5 ±) 16 ♗e3 ♖g8 17 ♘xe5 dxe5 18 ♕f2 ♗d7 19 ♗e2 ♘g6 20 ♖hf1 ♘f4 21 ♔b1 ♖g7 22 ♗g4 b5 23 g3 b4 24 ♘e2 ♘g6! (24...♘xe2 25 ♗xe2 ♗b5 26 h4 gxh4 27 gxh4 ♖d8 28 h5 ± Hort-Bobotsov, Wijk aan Zee 1970) 25 ♖d2 ♗c6 26 ♗f3 ♕b7 27 ♕g2 g4 28 ♗xg4 ♗xe4 29 ♗f3 ♘h4 30 ♗xe4 ♘xg2 31 ♗xb7 ♘xe3 32 ♖f3 ♘c4 33 ♖d1 ♖a7 leading to an equal

position, as in the game Fiandor-Marcinkiewicz, corr 1972.



14 ♘f3

Or:

1) **14 ♗g3** hxg5 15 ♖hf1 ♗d7 16 ♘f3 b5 17 a3 ♕c5 18 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 19 ♘b1?! a5 ∓ Gulko-Savon, Moscow 1973.

2) **14 ♔b1!?** hxg5 15 ♗g3 ♗d7 16 h3 ♘f6 (White's idea is that if Black plays ...♘xd3 followed by ...♘e5, then he will make use of ♔b1 by playing cxd3 and ♖c1) 17 ♘f3 ♘xf3 18 ♕xf3 e5 19 ♖df1 0-0-0 20 ♕e3 ♗c6, De Biase-Fissore, corr 1984, 21 ♕xg5! ±.

3) **14 h3** hxg5 15 ♗g3 ♘f6 (or 15...♘xd3+ 16 ♕xd3 {16 cxd3 ♘e5 17 ♔b1 ♗d7 18 ♖c1 ♕b8 19 ♖hf1 b5 20 ♘f3 b4 21 ♘xe5 dxe5 22 ♘d1 ♗b5 23 ♘e3 with a slight advantage for White, Battikhi-Houna, Thessaloniki OL 1984} ♘e5 17 ♗xe5 dxe5 18 ♘f3 f6 19 h4 g4 20 ♘h2 ± Bjarnason-Thorarinsson, Icelandic Ch 1994) and now:

3a) **16 ♖hf1** ♗d7 17 ♔b1 0-0-0 18 ♘f3 ♘h5 19 ♗h2 ♗f6 (19...♘f4 20 ♕d2 ♖dg8 21 ♖f2 ♘eg6 22 ♘e2 ♕c5 23 ♗g1 ♕c7 24 ♘h2 ♖g7 25 ♘g4 ♖d8 26 ♗h2 ♘xe2 27 ♕xe2 ♘e5 28 ♘f6 ♗c6 29 ♖df1 ± Somlai-Sziraki, Hungary Cht 1994) 20 ♕e3 ♖dg8 21 ♕a7 ♘f4 ∓ Cvetković-Minić, Pristina 1973.

3b) **16 ♗f2** ♗d7 17 ♗e3 ♖g8 18 ♕f2 b5 19 a3 ♖b8 20 ♘f3 b4 21 axb4 ♖xb4 22 ♘xe5 dxe5 23 ♖hf1 ♖g7 24 ♕e2 ♕a5 ∞ Solomon-Hmadi, Thessaloniki OL 1984.

3c) **16 ♔b1** ♗d7 17 ♗f2 0-0-0 18 ♘b3 ♖h5?! (a very odd move) 19 ♗d4 g4 20 ♕f2 ♖dh8 21 ♗b6 ♕b8 22 ♗e2 ± Szabo-Browne, Amsterdam 1972.

3d) **16 ♘f3** ♘fd7 (16...♘h5 17 ♗h2 f6 18 ♕e3 ♗d7 19 g4 ♘g7 20 ♗g3 b5 21 ♔b1 b4 22 ♘xe5 dxe5 23 ♘e2 ± Chavez-Santacruz, Corrientes Z 1985) 17 ♘xe5 (17 h4 gxh4 18 ♗xh4 ♗xh4 19 ♘xh4 ♖g8 20 ♖h3 ♘f8 21 ♕d2 ♗d7 22 ♗f1 ♗c6 23 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 24 ♖xd6 ♔e7 25 ♖d2 ♘fd7 26 ♘f3 ♖g4 ½-½ Jimenez Zerquera-Bielicki, Havana 1966) dxe5 18 ♖hf1 b5 19 ♕f2 ♖h7 20 ♔b1 ♗b7 21 ♕e3 ♖c8 22 ♘e2 ♘c5 was level in Matthews-Houna, Thessaloniki OL 1984.

14 ... hxg5

The older move **14...♘xf3** is quite playable, for example **15 gxf3** (15 ♕xf3 hxg5 {15...♘e5 16 ♕h5 ♘g6 17 ♗g3 hxg5 18 ♕e2 ♗d7 19 ♖hf1 ♘e5 20 h3 ♖h7 21 ♗xe5 dxe5 22 ♖f3 0-0-0 = Pacsay-Lüthke, corr} 16 ♗g3 ♘e5 17 ♗xe5 dxe5 18 ♗e2 {18 ♖hf1 ♖h7 19 h4 ♗d7 20 h5 0-0-0 21 g4 ♗b4 22 ♘e2 ♗a4 23 ♕e3 with a slight plus for White, J.Polgar-Gelfand, Vienna 1996} ♗d7 19 ♖d3 ♗c6 {19...♖h4 20 ♖f1 f6 21 ♖fd1 ♗c6 22 ♕f2 ♖d8 23 ♖xd8+ ♗xd8 24 g3 ♖h6 with equality, Tiemann-Druon, corr 1983} 20 ♖f1 ♖h7 21

♕f2! ± Matulović-Browne, Skopje 1970) **hxg5** and now:

1) **16 ♗e1** ♘e5 17 ♗d2 ♗d7 18 ♖dg1 f6 19 h4 0-0-0 20 hxg5 ♖xh1 21 ♖xh1 fxg5 22 f4 gxf4 23 ♗xf4 is level, Sigurjonsson-Szabo, Reykjavik 1968.

2) **16 fxg4** ♖xh4 (16...gxh4 17 ♖hf1 ♖h6 {17...♕c5 18 ♔b1 ♕e5 19 ♖f3 ♗d7 20 ♖df1 f6 21 ♖e3 b5 22 ♘d5! ♗d8 23 ♖f5! ± Sirotkin-Gorski, corr 1978} 18 e5 ♗g5+ 19 ♔b1 d5 20 ♕f3 ♕e7 = Prada-Conti, corr 1987) 17 ♖hf1 ♖h6 18 e5! (18 ♖f3 ♗d7 19 e5 dxe5 20 ♕f1 f6 21 ♖h3 ♖xh3 22 ♗g6+ ♔d8 23 ♕xh3 ♔c8 24 ♕h7 ♕d8 25 ♗f7 ♕f8 26 ♕d3 ♗c6 27 ♗xe6+ ± Ivanović-Ostojić, Vrnjačka Banja 1973; 18 ♕e3 ♗d7 19 ♖d2 f6 20 h4 ♖xh4 21 e5 dxe5 22 ♗g6+ ♔f8 23 ♗h5 ♔g7 ∓ Damjanović-Browne, San Juan 1969) dxe5 19 ♕f3 ♖f6?! (19...f6) 20 ♕h3 ♖xf1 21 ♕h8+ ♗f8 22 ♖xf1 with a very dangerous attack, Smejkal-Kavalek, Czechoslovakia 1963.

3) **16 ♗g3** ♘e5 and now:

3a) **17 ♕f2** ♗d7 18 h4 0-0-0 19 hxg5 ♗xg5+ 20 ♔b1 ♘xd3?! (better is 20...♗f6) 21 cxd3 ♔b8 22 ♖hg1 ♗e7 23 ♖c1 ♕a5 24 ♕e3 b6 25 ♗f2 ♔b7 26 a3 ♕c5 27 d4 ± Ziatdinov-Schweizer, Bern 1994.

3b) **17 f4** (this gives Black no problems) gxf4 18 ♗xf4 ♗d7 and now:

3b1) **19 ♔b1** 0-0-0 (19...b5 20 ♖df1 b4 21 ♗xe5 dxe5 22 ♘d1 ♗g5 23 h4 ♗f4 24 ♘e3 ♕c5 25 ♘g2 ♗h6 26 ♖h3 ♗c6 27 ♕h5 ♖a7 28 ♖hf3 ♗g7 29 ♕g5 ± Verduga-Youngworth, Lone Pine 1978) 20 ♕f2 ♖df8 21 h4 ♗c6 22 ♗xe5 dxe5 23 ♖h3 ♔b8 = Evans-Portisch, San Antonio 1972.

3b2) **19 ♖df1** ♖h7 (19...♗f6 20 h4 0-0-0 21 h5 ♘xd3+ 22 ♕xd3 ♗xc3 23 ♕xc3 ♕xc3 24 bxc3 ♗c6 = Ceria-Stassi, corr 1981; 19...♗c6 20 ♔b1 ♗h4 21 ♖hg1 0-0-0 22 ♖g7 ♗f6 23 ♖g3 ♕e7 24 ♘d1 ♘xd3 25 cxd3 d5 26 e5 ♗h4 ∓ Suder-Jedrejowski, corr 1994) 20 h4 (20 ♔b1 0-0-0 21 ♖hg1 ♖dh8 =) 0-0-0 21 h5 ♖g8 (21...♖dh8 22 ♔b1 ♔b8 23 h6 ♕d8! 24 ♖fg1 ♗c6! 25 ♖h3 ♗f8 26 ♕d2 f6! = Busemann-Schaaf, corr 1982; 21...♗f6 22 ♖h3 ♔b8 23 ♔b1 b5 24 ♗c1 ♗h8 25 ♖d1 ♘xd3 26 ♕xd3 ♗e5 27 ♘e2 ♗c6 ∓ Filipović-Lakić, Banja Luka 1981; 21...♕a5!?) 22 ♔b1 ♗g5 (22...♗c6 23 ♗xe5 dxe5 24 ♕e3 ♗g5 25 ♕a7 ♖gh8 ∓ Kusturin-Gatto, corr 1978) 23 ♖fg1 f6 24 h6 ♖g6 25 ♗xg5 fxg5 26 a3 ♖hxh6 27 ♖xh6 ♖xh6 28 ♖xg5 ♖h1+ 29 ♔a2 ♖h8 ½-½ Anelli-Conti, corr 1987.

3b3) **19 h4?** ♗xh4! 20 ♕f2 (20 ♗xe5 dxe5 21 ♕g4 ♕d8 22 ♖dg1 ♗g5+ 23 ♔b1 ♖xh1 24 ♖xh1 ♕f6 25 ♖h5 ♗h6 26 ♕g8+ ♗f8) ♗xf2 21 ♖xh8+ ♔e7 22 ♖xa8 ♕c5 23 ♔b1 ♗e3 ∓ Robatsch-Gheorghiu, Palma 1972.

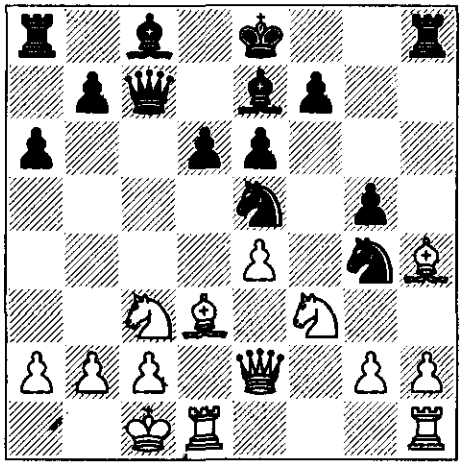
3c) **17 h4** gxh4 18 f4 and now:

3c1) **18...♘g6** 19 e5!? (19 ♗h2 ♗d7 20 e5 0-0-0 21 ♗xg6 fxg6 22 ♖hg1 d5 23 ♖xg6 ♖hf8 24 ♖g7 ♖de8 = Janošević-Minić, Vinkovci 1974) hxg3 20 ♖xh8+ ♘xh8 21 ♕h5 ♗d7 22 ♕xh8+ ♗f8 23 ♘e4 0-0-0 24 ♘xg3 dxe5 25 fxe5 ♕b6 ∓ Canda-Matthews, Dubai OL 1986.

3c2) **18...♘xd3+** 19 ♖xd3 (19 ♕xd3 ♗d7 20 f5 0-0-0 21 ♗f4 ♗c6 ∓ Maumey-Sonnet, corr 1991) ♗d7 20 ♕e1 (20 f5 0-0-0 21 ♗h2 ♗c6 22 fxe6 fxe6 23 ♕g4 ♕d7 24 ♖hd1

♖hg8 ∓ Wibe-Ljubojević, Buenos Aires OL 1978) ♗b5 21 ♖d1 ♗c6 (21...♗f6 22 e5! ∞ hxg3? 23 ♘d5! ±; 21...h3 22 f5 ♖d8 23 ♔b1 ♗c6 24 fxe6 fxe6 25 ♕f1 b5 26 ♖xh3 ♖f8 27 ♕d3 b4 28 e5! bxc3 29 ♕g6+ ♔d7 30 ♖h7 ♔c8 31 ♕xe6+ ♕d7 32 ♖xe7 ♕xe6 33 ♖xe6 dxe5 34 ♖xd8+ ♖xd8 35 bxc3 ± Ljubojević-Browne, Wijk aan Zee 1976) 22 ♗xh4 0-0-0 23 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 24 ♕d2 ♖xh1 25 ♖xh1 f5 26 ♖e1 fxe4 27 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 28 ♖xe4 with equality, Perov-Baranov, corr 1991.

Now we return to the main line after 14...hxg5 *(D)*.



15 ♗g3

Or:

1) **15 ♗e1** ♗d7 16 ♗d2 b5 17 a3 ♘xd3+ 18 cxd3 a5! 19 ♘d4 ♘e5 20 ♔b1 ♕b7 ∓ Ostojić-Nemet, Yugoslav Ch 1977.

2) **15 ♘xe5** ♘xe5 16 ♗g3 ♗d7 17 ♕e1 (17 ♖hf1 ♖h7 18 ♔b1 0-0-0 19 ♖d2 ♖g7 20 ♕d1 ♖h8 21 ♖df2 ♗e8 22 ♗e2 ♖hh7 23 ♕d4 ♘c6 24 ♕d2 ♘e5 25 h3 ± Ueter-Ostermeyer, Bundesliga 1989) b5 18 h4 b4 19 ♘e2 ♘xd3+ 20 ♖xd3 ♖c8 21 ♖d2 ♕c4 22 hxg5 ♖g8 23 ♔b1 e5 ∓ Asikainen-Koskinen, corr 1984.

3) **15 ♗xg5** ♗xg5+ 16 ♘xg5 ♕c5 and now:

3a) **17 ♘f3** ♘f2 18 ♘xe5 (a sacrificial line which gives White at most a draw) and now:

3a1) **18...dxe5** 19 ♘a4 ♕a7 20 ♗b5+! axb5 21 ♕xb5+ ♔e7 22 ♕b4+ ♔f6 23 ♘b6 ♘xh1 24 ♖f1+ ♔g6 25 ♕e7 f5 26 exf5+ exf5 27 ♕d6+ ♔f7 28 ♕d5+ ♔g6 29 ♕d6+ ♔f7 30 ♕d5+ ½-½ Ristić-Pablo, Tjentište jr Wch 1975.

3a2) **18...♘xd1** 19 ♘xf7 ♘xc3 20 ♕f3 ♖f8 21 ♖f1 ♘xa2+ 22 ♔b1 ♘b4 23 e5 ♘xd3 24 ♕xd3! (24 ♘xd6+ ♕xd6 25 ♕h5+ ♔d7 26 exd6 ♖xf1+ 27 ♔a2 ♘c1+ 28 ♔a3 ♔xd6) ♖xf7 25 ♕g6 ♔d7 26 ♕xf7+ ♔c6 27 ♖f3 ♔b6 28 ♖c3 ♕g1+ 29 ♔a2 dxe5 30 ♕f8 = is Lepeshkin's analysis – in *Winning with the Najdorf*, Danny King cryptically refers to an unspecified improvement for Black, but I don't see anything obviously wrong with Lepeshkin's line.

3b) **17 ♘h3** ♗d7 (White has extreme difficulty disentangling his pieces, but on the other hand he is a pawn up) and now:

3b1) **18 ♕d2** 0-0-0 19 ♗e2 ♘e3 20 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 21 ♖xd6 ♘xg2 22 ♘f2 ♘f4 23 ♖d2 ♖h4 24 b3 ♖dh8 with an equal position, Litvinov-Zhidkov, USSR 1973.

3b2) **18 ♖d2** 0-0-0 (18...b5!? 19 ♘d1 a5 20 ♘df2 ♘e3 21 ♘f4 a4 22 a3 ♘5c4 23 ♗xc4 ♘xc4 24 ♖dd1 ♕g5 ∓ Babulova-Kubikova, corr 1986) 19 ♘d1 ♖dg8 20 ♔b1 ♗c6 21 a3 ♔b8 (21...b5 22 ♘df2 ♘e3 23 g3 ♘3c4 24 ♗xc4 ♘xc4 25 ♖dd1 ♕e5 26 c3 f5 = Sommer-Kohl, corr) 22 b4 ♕b6 23 ♘b2 ♕d4 24 ♖e1 ½-½ Minić-Stoica, Bath Echt 1973.

3b3) **18 ♖de1** 0-0-0 19 ♘d1 ♖dg8 20 ♔b1 ♔b8 (20...♗c6! ∞) 21 ♕d2 b5 22 ♖e2 ♗c6 23 ♘df2 ♘f6 24 b4 ♕d4 25 c3 ♕b6 26 ♘g5 ♖h5 27 h4 ♔c7 28 g3 ± Occhipinti-Primavera, corr 1974.

15 ... ♗d7

15...♖g8 (15...♘xf3 transposes to the note to Black's 14th) 16 ♖hf1 ♘f6 17 ♘xe5 dxe5 18 ♖f2 ♗d7 19 ♖df1 ♖g6 20 ♘d5!? exd5 21 exd5 ± Suder-Stachanszyk, corr 1993.

16 h3 ♘xf3

Or **16...♘f6** (a pawn sacrifice) and now:

1) **17 ♘xg5** ♘h5 18 ♕e3 ♖g8! 19 ♗h4 ♕d8 20 g4 ♘g7 and there is no satisfactory answer to the threat of 21...♖h8, Jaloszynski-Siekaniec, corr 1992.

2) **17 ♗xe5** (if White is going to take the pawn, this is the best way to win it) dxe5 18 ♘xg5 ♘h5 19 ♕g4 ♘f4 20 h4 f6 21 ♘h3 0-0-0 22 g3 ♘h5 23 ♕f3 ± Zrzary-Lehmann, corr. The misplaced knight on h3 provides some compensation, but not enough.

3) **17 ♖hf1** ♘h5 18 ♗h2 ♖h7 19 ♔b1 0-0-0 20 ♕e3 g4 (20...♖g8? 21 ♘xe5 dxe5 22 ♕a7 +–) 21 ♘xe5 dxe5 22 hxg4 ♘f6 23 ♗g1 ♖g8 24 g5 ♘h5 25 ♕a7 ♕b8 26 ♕xb8+ ♔xb8 27 ♗xa6 ♗c8 28 ♗b5 ♖xg5 29 ♗d7 ♘f6 30 ♗xc8 ♔xc8 31 ♖d2 ♖g4 32 ♗b6 ♘d7 33 ♗g1 ♘f6 ½-½ Hamers-Boll, corr 1977.

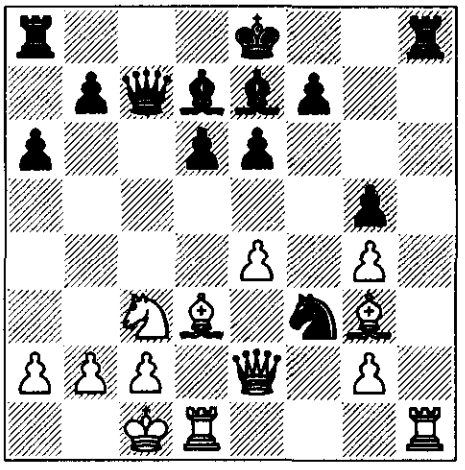
4) **17 ♖he1** ♘h5 18 ♗h2 0-0-0 19 ♕f2 ♘xd3+ 20 ♖xd3 ♗c6?! 21 ♘d5 exd5 22 exd5 ♗b5? 23 ♖c3 ♗c4 24 ♘d2 +– Packroff-Siebenhüner, corr 1988.

5) **17 ♕e3** ♘h5 18 ♗h2 ♖c8 19 g4 ♘f4 20 ♗xf4 gxf4 21 ♕xf4 ♕a5 22 ♖hf1 ♘g6 23 ♕e3 ♖xh3 = Stambulin-Egiazarian, Armenian Ch 1994.

17 hxg4 *(D)*

17 gxf3 ♘e5 is just bad, for example 18 ♔b1 (18 h4 is just line 3c of the note to Black's 14th move, but with Black having the extra tempo ...♗d7) ♗f6! (Black has a favourable version of the note to Black's 14th move) 19 ♖c1 ♘g6 20 ♘d1 ♗e5 21 ♗xe5 dxe5 ∓ Janošević-Martinović, Yugoslav Ch 1977.

B



17 ... ♖xh1

Alternatively, **17...♘h4 18 ♖h3 ♗c6** (18...0-0-0 19 e5 ♗c6 20 ♗xa6 bxa6 21 exd6 ♗xd6 22 ♖xd6 ♖xd6 23 ♕xa6+ ♔d7 24 ♗xd6 ♕xd6 25 ♖d3 ♗d5 26 ♕a7+ ♕c7 27 ♕a4+ ♕c6 28 ♘xd5! ± Estrin-Arnlind, corr 1980) **19 e5 d5** and now:

1) **20 ♗f2** 0-0-0 21 ♗d4 ♘g6 (21...♖hg8 22 g3 ♘g6 23 ♖h7 ♖df8 24 ♖f1 ♗e8 25 ♕e3 ♖h8 26 ♖fh1 ♖xh7 27 ♖xh7 ♖g8 = Grodzensky-Zelinsky, corr 1984; 21...♖df8 22 ♖dh1 ♘g6 23 ♗xg6 ♖xh3 24 ♖xh3 fxg6 25 ♖h7 ♕d8 26 g3 = Janocha-Lehmann, corr 1987) 22 ♗xg6 ♖xh3 23 gxh3 fxg6 24 ♕d3 ♖g8 25 ♖f1 ♕d8 26 ♖f7 ♕e8 27 ♕f1 ♖f8 = Barstatis-Zelinsky, corr 1984.

2) **20 ♕f2** ♖f8 (20...♖g8!? should also be met by 21 ♔b1 ±) 21 ♘e2 (21 ♔b1! was more accurate, so as to play ♘e2 next move) ♗b5 22 ♔b1 ♗c4 23 ♘d4 ♗c5 24 c3 ♗xd3+ 25 ♖xd3 = Grünfeld-Ljubojević, Thessaloniki OL 1984.

3) **20 ♕f1** ♖f8 21 ♘e2 ♕a5 22 ♔b1 ♕a4 23 ♘f4 0-0-0 24 ♕e2 b5 25 ♘h5 ♔b7 26 ♘f6 ♖c8 27 ♗xh4 gxh4 28 ♖xh4 ± G.Andersson-Kenez, corr 1987.

18 ♖xh1 ♘h4

and now:

1) **19 ♕f2** ♕c5 20 ♕xc5 dxc5 21 e5 c4 22 ♗e4 0-0-0 23 ♗f2 ♖h8 = Toothill-Silva, corr.

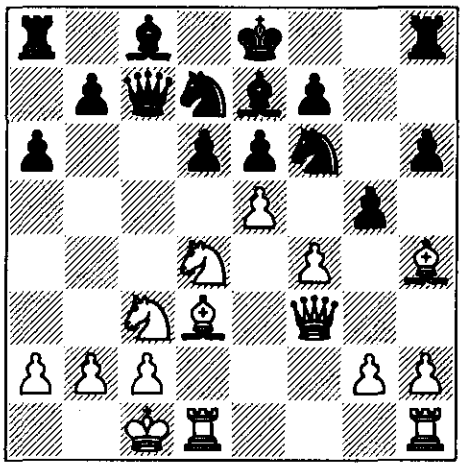
2) **19 ♖f1** ♘g6 20 ♕f2 (20 ♕f3 ♘h8 21 ♗f2 0-0-0 22 ♗d4 ♖f8 23 ♗g7! ♖g8 24 ♕h3 ♕d8 25 ♕h7 ♕e8 26 e5 d5 27 ♘e2 ♘g6 28 ♗xg6 fxg6 29 ♗f6 ± Barstatis-Rusakov, corr 1984; 20 e5?! ♘f4 21 ♗xf4 gxf4 22 exd6 ♗xd6! 23 ♘d5 ♕a5 24 ♘f6+ ♔e7 25 ♘xd7 ♕xa2! 26 c3 ♔xd7 ∓ Antonov-A.Timoshenko, corr 1990) ♘h8 21 ♕d4 0-0-0 22 ♘a4 (22 e5 ♗c6 23 exd6 ♗xd6 24 ♗xd6 ♕xd6 25 ♕xd6 ♖xd6 26 ♖h1 ♘g6 27 ♘e4 ♗xe4 28 ♗xe4 ♘e5 ∓ Del Vasto-Bertolucci, corr 1985) ♗e8 23 ♕xh8 ♗xa4 24 ♕d4 ♗e8 25 b4 ♕c6 with equality, Morgado-Pereira, corr 1990.

3) **19 e5!?** ♗c6 20 ♖f1 ♘xg2! (20...♗xg2 21 ♖f2 ♗c6 22 ♕f1 d5 23 ♖xf7 0-0-0 24 ♗f2 ± Portilho-Velloso, corr 1983) 21 exd6 ♗xd6 22 ♗xd6 ♕xd6 23 ♘e4 ♗xe4 24 ♗xe4! ♘f4 25 ♕c4 ∞.

The conclusion is that White has few chances for an advantage in this line.

C2)

12 e5 *(D)*



This move came to prominence when Black's resources in C1 started to appeared adequate. Although this line leads to unbalanced and double-edge positions, it probably gives White no advantage in theory.

12 ... gxh4

The alternative 12...dxe5 is crucial, but has hardly been played at all: 13 ♘xe6 (13 fxg5!? ∞) fxe6 (13...♕b6 14 ♘g7+ ♔f8 15 fxg5 hxg5 16 ♗f2 ± Wagman-Tatai, Reggio Emilia 1965/6) 14 ♗g6+ ♔d8 (14...♔f8 15 fxg5 hxg5 16 ♗xg5 ♔g7 17 ♕g3 is dangerous) 15 fxg5 ♘e8 (15...♘h7 16 ♗xh7 hxg5 ∞) 16 ♘e4 ♕a5 17 ♘f6 (17 ♗xe8 ♖xe8 18 ♘f6 ♕xa2 19 ♖xd7+ ♗xd7 20 ♕xb7 ♕a1+ 21 ♔d2 ♗b4+! is also a mess) ♘d6 (17...♕xa2!?) 18 ♘xd7 ♗xd7 19 ♖xd6 ♗xd6 20 ♕xb7 ♖c8 21 gxh6+ ♗e7 22 ♗f2 ♗c5 23 ♗h4+ ½-½ Sakharov-Gasanov, USSR 1980.

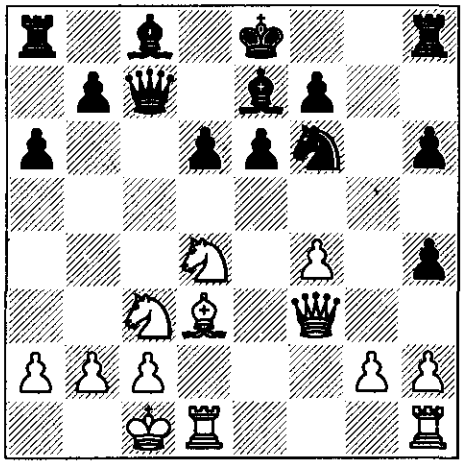
13 exf6 ♘xf6 *(D)*

Or **13...♗xf6** and now:

1) **14 ♕e4?!** ♘b6 15 ♖hf1 d5 16 ♕e3 ♕c5 17 ♘ce2 ♗d7 18 ♔b1 0-0-0 with an edge for Black, Tabarov-Zhidkov, USSR 1978.

2) **14 ♗e4** ♘c5 (14...♕b6 15 ♘b3 ♘c5 16 f5 ♗d7 17 fxe6 ♗g5+ 18 ♔b1 ♗xe6 19 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 20 ♗xb7 +– Arnason-Hanreck, Manchester 1981) 15 f5 0-0 16 ♔b1 (16 ♕h5!? ∞; 16 ♕g4+ ♗g5+ 17 ♔b1 d5 18 ♗xd5 exd5 19 ♘xd5 ♕e5 20 ♘f3 ♗xf5 21 ♘xe5 ♗xg4 22 ♘xg4 ♘e4 and Black's active minor pieces compensate for the broken pawns, Moskovich-Vitolinš, USSR 1984) d5 17 ♗d3 ♕e5! 18 ♖hf1! ♕xd4 19 fxe6 ♗xe6 20 ♗e2! ♕e5 21 ♕xf6 ♕xf6 22 ♖xf6 ♔g7 23 ♖f4 h3 24 gxh3 ♖ad8 = Barash-Zelinsky, corr 1981.

3) **14 ♘de2** ♘c5 (14...♕b6 15 ♔b1?! {15 ♗c4; 15 ♖hf1} ♘c5 16 f5 ♗e5 17 ♗c4 ♗d7 ½-½ Sakharov-Foigel, USSR 1979) 15 f5 ♗e5 (not 15...♗g5+ 16 ♔b1 ♗d7 17 fxe6 ♗xe6 18 ♗f5 ♗xf5 19 ♕xf5 ♕d7 20 ♘d4 ± Tavadian-Lapenis, USSR 1979) 16 fxe6 ♗xe6 17 ♗f5 ♕e7 18 ♗xe6 ♕g5+ 19 ♔b1 fxe6 20 ♘e4 ♘xe4 21 ♕xe4, Bryson-Hartman, Thessaloniki OL 1984, 21...0-0-0! ∓.



14 f5

Or **14 ♖he1 ♗d7** and now:

1) **15 ♔b1** ♖g8 16 ♕e2 0-0-0 17 ♘f5 ♗c6 18 ♘xh4 d5 19 g3 ♗b4 20 a3 ♗xc3 21 bxc3 ♘d7 ∓ Michalczak-Sehrt, 2nd Bundesliga 1994.

2) **15 ♕f2** 0-0-0 (15...♕b6!?) 16 ♘f5 ♗c6 17 ♕a7 ♖he8 18 ♘d4 ♘d7 19 f5 ♘e5 20 fxe6 ♗g5+ 21 ♔b1 fxe6, Westerinen-Evans, Siegen OL 1970, 22 ♗e4! ∞.

3) **15 f5** e5 16 ♘e4 0-0-0 17 ♘xf6 ♗xf6 18 ♘e2 (if only White had time to play ♘c3 and ♗e4) d5! 19 ♕xd5 ♗c6 20 ♕b3 ♗xg2 21 ♗c4 ♖xd1+ 22 ♖xd1 ♖d8 and the two bishops plus passed e-pawn gave Black the advantage in Jadoul-Grünfeld, Brussels 1985.

4) **15 ♖e3!** (a promising line) 0-0-0 (15...♗c6 16 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 17 ♗e4 ♘xe4 18 ♖xe4 0-0-0 19 ♘d5 exd5 20 ♖xe7 ♖de8 21 ♖xf7 ± Pasko-Labuz, corr 1994) 16 ♗xa6! bxa6 17 ♕a8+ ♕b8 18 ♕xa6+ ♕b7 19 ♕a5 ♘g4 (19...d5 20 ♘a4! ♗d6 21 ♖c3+ ♗c7 22 ♘b6+ ♔b8 23 ♖xc7 ♔xc7 24 ♘xd5+ ♔b8 25 ♘xf6) 20 ♖f3 ♗c6 21 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 22 ♘a4 ♔d7 23 ♖c3 1-0 Poli-Anelli, corr 1981.

14 ... e5

15 ♘de2 ♗d7

Or 15...d5!? (15...♕c6 16 ♗e4 ♘xe4 17 ♘xe4 ♗d7 18 ♘2c3 ♖c8 19 ♖d2 ♗g5 20 ♘xg5 hxg5 21 ♕g4 f6 22 ♖hd1 ♕c4 23 ♕xc4 ♖xc4 24 ♖xd6 ± Santacruz-Navarro, Asuncion 1995) 16 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 17 ♕xd5 ♗d7 18 ♕f3 0-0-0 19 f6 ♗c5 20 ♘c3 ♗c6 21 ♗e4 ♗xe4 22 ♕xe4 ♖d4!? = Isaev-Namark, corr 1987.

16 ♗e4

16 ♘e4 d5! (16...♗c6 17 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 18 ♗e4 0-0-0 19 ♘c3 ♔b8 20 ♔b1 ♖c8 21 ♘d5 ♗xd5 22 ♖xd5 with a slight advantage for White, Parma-Bukić, Ljubljana-Portorož 1977; 16...♘d5 17 f6 ♗f8 18 ♘4c3

♘b6 19 ♗e4 ♗c6 20 ♘d5 ± Kristensen-Molvig, Copenhagen 1995) 17 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 18 ♕xd5 ♗c6 19 ♕b3 (19 ♕c5 0-0-0 20 ♖hg1 ♔b8 21 g3 h3 ∓ Biriescu-Gheorghiu, Romanian Ch 1977) 0-0-0 20 ♗c4 ♗xg2 21 ♖hg1 ♗g5+ ∓ Parma-Bukić, Yugoslav Ch 1978.

16 ... ♗c6 *(D)*

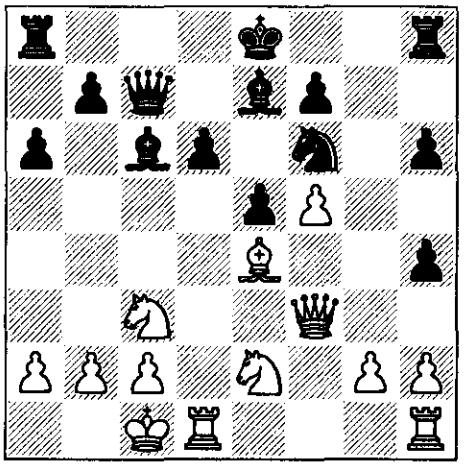
Or:

1) **16...0-0-0** 17 ♘d5 ♘xd5 18 ♗xd5 ♗g5+ 19 ♔b1 ♗c6 20 ♘c3 ± Stean-Szmetan, Haifa OL 1976.

2) **16...♖g8!?** 17 ♘d5 (17 ♗xb7 looks very risky) ♘xd5 18 ♗xd5 ♖g5 19 g4 hxg3 20 ♘xg3 ∞.

3) **16...♖c8!?** (an interesting idea; Black heads for an ending in which his central pawn mass compensates for the broken kingside pawns, provided that he can prevent White establishing a blockade on d5) 17 ♗xb7 ♗c6 18 ♗xc6+ ♕xc6 19 ♕xc6+ ♖xc6 20 ♖hf1 ♖g8 21 g3 ♖c5 22 a3 ♔d7 23 ♔b1 ♔c6 (Black's plan has been a success) 24 ♖f3 d5 ∓ Khlusevich-Neverovsky, Moscow 1986.

W



17 ♘d5 ♗xd5

18 ♗xd5 ♖c8 (18...♘xd5 19 ♖xd5 ♗g5+ 20 ♔b1 0-0-0 was Stean-Garcia, Lublin 1975, and now 21 ♕e4 stopping ...♕c4-f4 would have been good for White) 19 ♘c3 b5!? (or 19...♖b8 20 ♖he1 b5 21 ♗b3 ♖h7 ± Caturla-Goh, Penang 1974) with the alternatives:

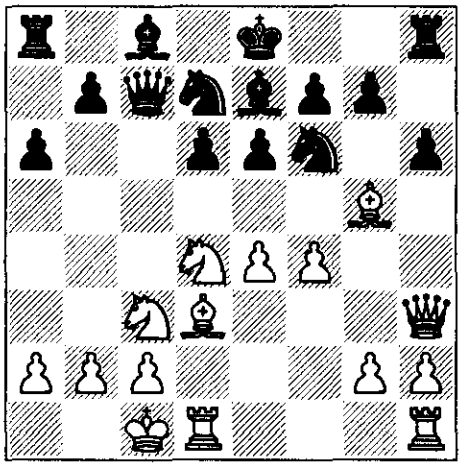
1) **20 ♗b3** ♕c6 21 ♕e2 ♖g8 22 ♘d5 a5! 23 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 24 ♗d5 ♕b6 25 ♖d3 ♖g5 (25...♔e7 26 ♖hd1 ♖c5 27 ♔b1 ∞ ½-½ Nunn-Ljubojević, London 1980) 26 ♔b1 ♔f8 27 c3 b4 28 c4 e4! 29 ♗xe4 ♖e8 30 ♖d5! h3! 31 g3 b3! (the start of a spectacular combination) 32 axb3 a4! 33 b4 a3! 34 bxa3 ♖g4! 35 ♕xg4 ♕f2 36 ♗c2 ♖e3! 37 ♖a5?! (37 ♕f4 ♖xa3! 38 ♖a5 ♖b3+ 39 ♔c1 ♗g5 ∓) ♕g2!! −+ 38 ♖d1 ♖b3+! 39 ♔c1 ♗b2+ 40 ♔b1 ♗d4+ 0-1 Isaev-A.Timoshenko, corr 1991.

2) **20 ♗b7!** ♖b8 (20...0-0 21 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 22 ♕e2 ♕c6, Monin-Rusakov, corr 1986, 23 ♖he1! d5 24 ♕xe5 b4 25 ♕xe7 bxc3 26 b3 ±) 21 ♗xa6 ♕c5 22 ♗xb5+! ♖xb5 23 ♕a8+ ♔d7 (23...♗d8 24 ♕a4 +−) 24 ♕xh8 ±.

D)

8 ... ♕c7
9 0-0-0 ♘bd7
10 ♗d3 h6
11 ♕h3 *(D)*

B



According to current theory, this offers White better chances than 11 ♗h4.

11 ... ♘b6

The best reply. Others:

1) **11...♘c5** and now:

1a) **12 ♗h4** e5 13 ♘f5 g6 (here the ...e5 and ...g6 idea does not work; 13...♗xf5 ±) 14 ♘xe7 ♗xh3 15 ♗xf6 ♗e6 16 ♘ed5 ♕a5 17 ♗xh8 ± Marcantoni-Bartha, Paris Ch 1991.

1b) **12 f5** ♗d7 13 fxe6 ♘xe6 (and not 13...fxe6 14 e5 ±) 14 ♗xf6 ♘f4 (14...♘xd4 15 ♘d5 ♕c5 16 ♗xd4 ♗g5+ 17 ♔b1 ♕xd4 18 ♕g3 ±) 15 ♕g3 ♗xf6 16 ♖hf1 ♗xd4 17 ♕xf4 ♗xc3 18 ♕xf7+ ♔d8 19 bxc3 ♕xc3 with equality, Benjamin-Lutz, Munich 1994.

1c) **12 ♖he1** ♖g8 (12...e5 13 ♘f5 ♗xf5 14 exf5 0-0-0 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 ♘d5 ♕c6, Mehner-Albrecht, corr 1987, 17 ♘e7+! ♗xe7 18 f6+ ♖d7 19 fxe7 ±; 12...♗d7 13 e5?! dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘d5 15 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 16 ♕g3 0-0 17 ♘e4 ♘xe4 18 ♖xe4 ♘f5 = Milosević-Sherwin, Switzerland Cht 1995) 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 hxg5 15 exf6 ♗xf6 16 ♘d5 ♕d8 17 ♗h7 ♖h8 18 ♘f5 g4 19 ♕g3 ♔f8 20 ♘xf6 1-0 Planinc-Najdorf, Wijk aan Zee 1973.

2) **11...b5** 12 e5 dxe5 13 ♘xe6 fxe6 14 ♗g6+ ♔d8 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 ♕xe6 ♕c4, Sakharov-Palatnik, USSR 1973, 17 ♖d5! followed by 18 ♖hd1 with an enormous attack.

3) **11...♘f8** 12 ♗xf6 (12 f5 ♘8h7 13 ♗e3 e5 14 ♘b3 b5 = Savon-Shusterman, USSR 1974) ♗xf6 13 ♗b5+! ♗d7 14 ♗xd7+ ♘xd7 (14...♕xd7 15 e5 dxe5 16 ♘db5 ♕c6 17 ♘d6+ ♔e7 18 ♘ce4 is very dangerous, for example 18...♕a4 {to stop ♕a3} 19 ♕f3 ♕xa2 20 ♘xf6 ♕a1+ 21 ♔d2 ♕a5+ 22 ♔e2 +−) 15 ♘xe6 fxe6 16 ♕xe6+ ♗e7 (16...♔f8 is critical; then 17 e5 ♘c5 18 ♕xd6+ ♕xd6 19 ♖xd6 ♗e7 20 ♖dd1 may be ±, but 17 ♖xd6! ♘c5 18 ♕d5 looks best, for example 18...♗xc3 19 bxc3 ♘xe4 20 ♖d7 ♕xf4+ 21 ♔b2, followed by ♖e1, is ±) 17 ♕g6+ ♔f8 18 e5 dxe5 19 ♕f5+ ♔e8 20 fxe5 ♗g5+ 21 ♔b1 ♘f8 22 ♘e4 ♖d8 23 ♖xd8+ ♔xd8 24 ♖d1+ ♔e7 25 ♘d6 ♘d7 26 ♕f7+ ♔d8 27 e6 ♗e7 28 ♘f5 1-0 Finocchiaro-Gatto, corr 1978.

4) **11...♖g8** and now:

4a) **12 ♗xf6** ♗xf6 (12...♘xf6 13 f5 e5 14 ♘de2 ♗d7 = J.Ivanov-Liangov, Kazanlak 1987) 13 ♗e2 (13 e5 dxe5 14 ♘xe6 ♕c6! ∓) ♕b6 14 ♘b3 ♘c5 15 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 16 ♖d3 ♗d7 ∓ Morrison-Bacon, USA 1976.

4b) **12 e5** dxe5 (12...hxg5 13 exf6 ♘xf6 14 fxg5 e5 15 ♘f5 g6 16 gxf6 ♗xf6 17 ♕h7 +− Morrison-Bacon, corr 1979) 13 ♘xe6 fxe6 (or 13...♕b6 14 ♘xg7+ ♖xg7 15 ♕xh6 ♖g8 16 ♖he1 ∞) 14 ♗g6+ ♔d8 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 ♕xe6 ♖f8 and now 17 ♖d6 or 17 ♖he1 is very dangerous for Black.

4c) **12 ♗h4** (odd, as there seems little point to ♕h3 if White is going to play ♗h4 immediately after) b5 (12...g5!?; 12...♘b6) 13 ♗f2 ♘c5 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘fd7 16 ♖he1 b4 17 ♘b1 ♗b7 18 ♘f3 ♗d5 = Blasovsky-Litvinov, corr 1989.

12 f5

This became the main line after other moves were abandoned:

1) **12 ♖he1** e5 13 ♘f5 ♗xf5 14 exf5 0-0-0 and now:

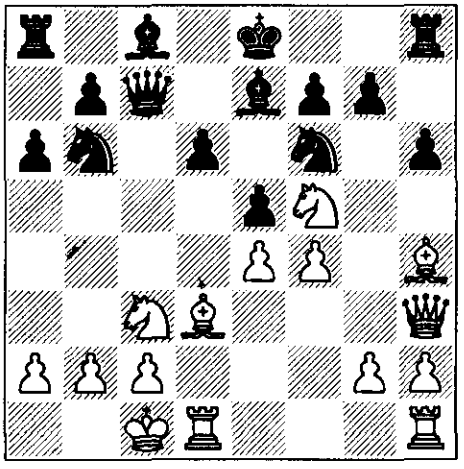
1a) **15 ♗h4** exf4 16 ♗f2 ♖he8 17 ♗xb6 ♕xb6 18 ♗c4 d5 19 ♗xd5 (19 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 20 ♗xd5 ♗f6 21

♕b3 ♕xb3 22 ♗xb3 ♖xe1 23 ♖xe1 ♗g5 ∓ Timman-Browne, Wijk aan Zee 1974) ♗b4 20 ♘a4 ♗d2+ (or 20...♕f2 21 ♖xe8 ♖xe8 22 ♕b3 ♕e3+ 23 ♔b1 ♕xb3 24 ♗xb3 ♖e2 = Planinc-Browne, Madrid 1973) 21 ♔b1 ♕f2 22 ♖f1 ♕d4 23 ♗b3 ♖e3 24 ♕h4 ♖e2 ∓ Zaitsev-Lorincz, corr 1980.

1b) **15 ♗xf6** ♗xf6 16 ♘e4 (16 fxe5 dxe5 17 ♘e4 ♗g5+ 18 ♔b1 ♔b8 19 c3 ♖he8 20 ♕g4 ♕e7 21 g3 ½-½ Wittmann-Grünfeld, Munich Z 1987) d5 17 ♘xf6 gxf6 18 fxe5 fxe5 19 ♗f1 ♔b8 20 ♖d3 e4 21 ♖c3 ♕e5 = Milošević-Borner, Switzerland Cht 1995.

2) **12 ♗h4** e5 (12...♗d7? 13 ♖he1 e5 14 ♘f5 ♗xf5 15 exf5 0-0-0 16 ♗f2 ±) 13 ♘f5 *(D)* and now:

B



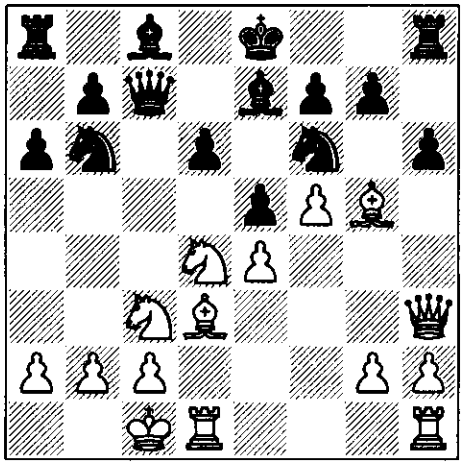
2a) **13...♗xf5** 14 exf5 (14 ♕xf5 g6 15 ♕h3 ♕c8 16 f5 gxf5 17 exf5 ♘bd7 18 ♗e4 ± Planinc-Portisch, Ljubljana/Portorož 1975) 0-0-0 (not 14...♘fd5?! 15 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 16 fxe5 dxe5 17 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 18 ♗xa6! ± Timman-Browne, Wijk aan Zee 1975; 14...exf4 15 ♕f3 0-0-0 16 ♕xf4 d5 ∞) 15 ♗f2 exf4 (15...♖he8 16 ♗xb6 ♕xb6 17 ♗c4 exf4 18 ♗xf7 ♖f8 19 ♗e6+ ♔b8 20 ♖d3 ± Estrin-Kletsel, corr 1975) with a likely transposition to line 1a after 16 ♖he1 ♖he8.

2b) **13...g6!** 14 ♘xe7 ♗xh3 15 ♗xf6 ♗e6 16 f5 ♖f8 (16...gxf5 17 exf5 ♗c4 18 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 19 ♖xd6 ♘d7 20 ♖xd7 ♔xd7 21 ♖d1+ ♔e8 22 ♘ed5 ♖g8 23 g3 ♖c8 24 ♗xe5 ♖c6 25 ♘f6+ ♖xf6 26 ♗xf6 ♕c7 27 ♖e1+ ♔f8 28 ♖d1 ½-½ Packroff-Ugge, corr) 17 fxe6 (17 ♗b5+ ♗d7! 18 ♘ed5 ♘xd5 19 ♘xd5 ♕a5! 20 ♗xd7+ ♔xd7 21 a4 ♕c5 22 b4 ♕c6 23 a5 gxf5 is clearly better for Black, as in Timman-Kavalek, Amsterdam 1975; 17 fxg6 fxg6 18 ♗b5+, Koppe-Kammel, corr 1987, 18...♔f7! 19 ♖hf1 ♕c5 20 ♗e2 ♖ae8 ∓) fxe6 18 ♗b5+ axb5 19 ♘xb5 ♕b8 20 ♘xd6+ ♕xd6 21 ♖xd6 ♘c4 22 ♗g7! ♖xa2 23 ♔b1 ♖xb2+ 24 ♔a1 ♖f2 25 ♖xe6 ♖bxc2 (25...♔f7 26 ♖f6+ ♖xf6 27 ♗xf6 ♔xf6 28 ♘d5+ =) 26 ♘f5+ (26 ♘d5+ ♔d7 27 ♖e7+ ♔d8 28 ♖xb7? {28 ♗xe5 ♖a2+ 29 ♔b1 ♘a3+ 30 ♔c1 ♖fc2+ 31 ♔d1 ♖d2+ 32 ♔e1 ♖xd5 ∓} ♖a2+ 29 ♔b1 ♘a3+ 0-1 Monti-Chiesa, corr 1977) ♔d7 27 ♖e7+ ♔c8 28 ♖e8+ ♔c7 29 ♗xe5+ ♘xe5 30 ♖xe5 gxf5 31 exf5 ♖a2+ 32 ♔b1 ♖fb2+ 33 ♔c1 ♖xg2 ∓. Needless to say an inferior ending is no recommendation for 12 ♗h4.

3) **12 ♖hf1** ♗d7 13 f5 (13 ♗h4 ♖c8 {13...0-0-0; 13...e5} 14 ♕g3 e5! 15 fxe5 dxe5 16 ♘f5 ♗xf5 17 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 18 ♖xf5 ♕e7 = Timman-Browne, Amsterdam 1976) e5 14 ♘b3 0-0-0 15 ♗e3 ♘a4 (compared with the main line below, the moves ♖hf1 and ...0-0-0 have been added; Black's extra move looks more useful than White's) 16 ♗d2 ♘xc3 17 ♗xc3 ♔b8 = Bronstein-Tukmakov, USSR Ch 1974.

4) **12 ♗xf6** ♗xf6 13 ♗b5+ ♗d7 (13...♔f8! wins material for insufficient compensation) 14 ♗xd7+ ♕xd7 15 e5 ♗e7 (15...dxe5 16 ♘db5 ♕c6 17 ♘d6+ ♔e7 18 ♘de4 is dangerous) 16 exd6 ♗xd6 17 g3 0-0-0 18 ♘e4 ♕a4 19 ♘xd6+ ♖xd6 ∓ Celli-Gatto, corr 1979.

12 ... e5 *(D)*



13 ♘de2

Or **13 ♘b3** (13 ♘f3 ♗d7 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 15 g4 0-0-0 16 ♕g3 ♗g5+ 17 ♘xg5 hxg5 18 h4 gxh4 19 ♖xh4 ♖xh4 20 ♕xh4 ♗c6 = Grefe-Browne, US Ch 1974) **♗d7** and now:

1) **14 ♔b1** 0-0-0 (14...♗c6 15 ♘d2 0-0-0 16 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 17 ♘c4 d5 18 ♘xb6+ ♕xb6 19 ♕h5 dxe4 20 ♗xe4 ♖d4 21 ♕f3 ♖hd8 22 ♖d3 ♕c5 23 ♖hd1 ♕c4 = Velimirović-Ilinčić, Bor 1986) 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 ♘d5 ♘xd5 17 exd5 e4 18 ♗xe4 ♕b6 19 ♗d3 ♖he8 with enough compensation for the pawn, Ciocaltea-Najdorf, Nice OL 1974.

2) **14 ♗e3** ♘a4 (14...♘c4? 15 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 16 ♘d2 ♕c6 17 ♗g5! ± Timman-Hamann, Amsterdam 1975) 15 ♘d5 (15 ♗d2?! ♘xc3 16 ♗xc3 a5 17 a3 ♗c6 18 ♖he1 b5 19 g4 b4 20 axb4 axb4 21 ♗xb4 ♕b7 22 ♗a3, Timman-Portisch, Plovdiv Echt 1983, and now 22...0-0! 23 ♕g2 ♖a4 24 ♘d2 ♖xa3 25 bxa3 d5 would have been excellent for Black according to Portisch) ♘xd5 16 exd5 ♘b6 (exchanging dark-squared bishops by 16...0-0-0 17 ♔b1 ♗g5?! rebounded after 18 ♗xg5 hxg5 19 ♕g4 f6 20 h4 gxh4 21 ♕xg7 ♖df8 22 ♖xh4 ± in Jovcić-Bukić, Belgrade 1977) 17 ♗xb6 ♕xb6 18 ♔b1 ♗f6 19 ♕f3 a5 (19...0-0-0 = Quinteros-Szmetan, Fortaleza 1975) 20 ♖he1 a4 21 ♘d2 a3 22 ♘c4 ♕c7 ∞ Sørensen-Arnovilli, corr 1977.

13 ... ♗d7

14 ♔b1

Or **14 ♗e3** (14 ♖he1 ♗c6 15 ♗e3 {15 ♘g3 ♖c8 16 ♔b1 ♘bd7 17 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 18 ♘h5 b5 = Gufeld-Savon, USSR 1975} ♘bd7 16 g4 0-0-0 17 ♕f3 b5 18 h4 ♘c5 ∞ Subašić-Bukić, Yugoslav Ch 1980; the text-move threatens 15 ♗xb6 and 16 ♗c4) and now:

1) **14...g6** 15 g4 h5 16 ♖hg1! 0-0-0 17 g5 ♘g4 18 ♖xg4 hxg4 19 ♕xg4 ± Nunn-Plaskett, Paris 1983.

2) **14...♘c4!?** 15 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 16 g4 ♖c8 (16...♗c6) 17 ♕f3 ♗c6 18 ♘g3 b5 19 ♖d3 ♗b7 20 b3 ♕c7 21 ♕e2 b4 22 ♘d5 ♘xd5 23 exd5 ♕a5 24 ♔b1 ♗xd5 ∓ Cramer-Dietz, corr 1989.

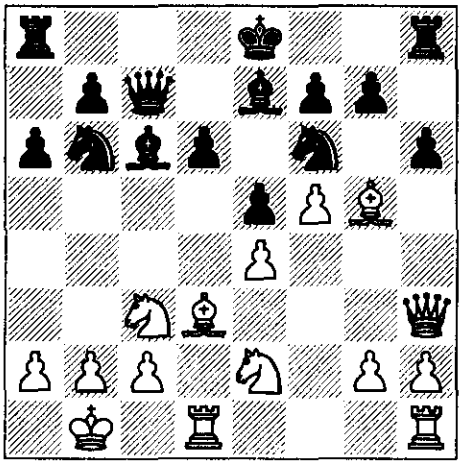
3) **14...♗c6** 15 g4 (15 ♕f3 0-0-0 16 ♗xb6 ♕xb6 17 ♗c4 ♘xe4! 18 ♘xe4 d5 19 ♕g4 ♕e3+ 20 ♘d2 h5 21 ♕xg7 dxc4 22 ♖he1 ♖xd2 0-1 Klaird-Burris, corr 1984) 0-0-0! (not 15...d5 16 g5! ♘xe4 17 ♗xe4 dxe4 18 gxh6 gxh6 19 ♗xb6 ♕xb6 20 ♘d5 ♗xd5 21 ♖xd5 ±) 16 ♕f3 d5! 17 ♗xb6 ♕xb6 18 exd5, Chandler-Browne, Bath 1983, 18...♖xd5! 19

♗e4 ♖xd1+ 20 ♖xd1 ♘xe4 gives Black a slight advantage.

14 ... ♗c6 *(D)*

14...0-0-0? doesn't give Black sufficient time to preserve his knight after 15 ♗e3 ♗c6 (15...d5 16 ♗xb6 ♕xb6 17 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 18 exd5 ♗a3 19 b3 ♔b8 20 ♕g3 ± d'Amore-Baldocchi, corr 1985) 16 ♗xb6 ♕xb6 17 ♗c4 ♔b8 18 ♘d5 ± Browne-Fraguela, Las Palmas 1977.

W



15 ♗e3 d5

15...♘bd7 (passive) 16 g4 0-0-0 17 ♕f3 ♘c5 (17...g5 18 a4 ♔b8 19 ♘c1 ♕a5 20 ♘b3 ♕b4 21 ♗d2 ♕b6 22 ♗c4 ♘c5 23 a5 ♕b4 24 ♕e2 ♘xb3 25 cxb3 ♕c5 26 b4 ± B.Andersson-Stewart, corr 1979) 18 ♗xc5 dxc5 19 ♗c4 ♖xd1+ 20 ♖xd1 ♖d8 21 ♘g3 ♖xd1+ 22 ♕xd1 ♗d8 23 ♗d5 ♘xd5 (23...♗e8 24 h4 c4 25 g5 hxg5 26 hxg5 ♘xd5 27 exd5 ♗xg5 28 ♘ge4 ♗d8 29 d6 ♕c6 30 ♕g4 ± Browne-Grefe, Lone Pine 1976) 24 exd5 ♗e8 25 d6 ♕d7 26 ♘ge4 b6 27 ♕d5 ♕c6 28 ♕xe5 ♗f6 29 ♕d5 ♗xc3 30 ♘xc3 ♔d7 = De Korte-Fijlstra, corr 1986. The fact that Black just scraped a draw in this one example is no recommendation for 15...♘bd7.

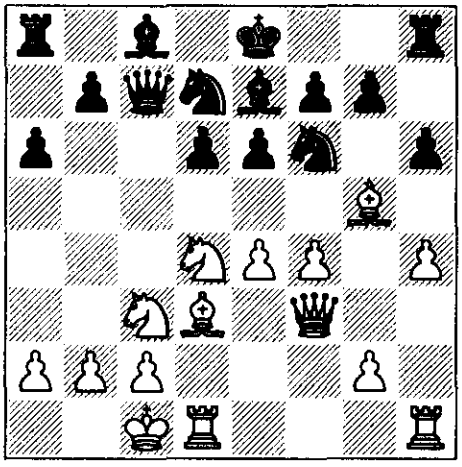
16 ♗xb6 ♕xb6

17 exd5 ♗a3 18 b3 ♗xd5 (not 18...♘xd5? 19 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 20 ♘c3 ♗c6 21 f6! trapping Black's king in the centre) 19 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 20 ♗e4! (20 ♗c4 ♘f6 21 ♘c3 0-0 22 ♘d5 ♘xd5 23 ♗xd5, Nunn-Browne, Tilburg 1982 and now 23...♖ad8 or 23...e4 would be at least equal for Black) ♘f6 21 ♕f3 ♖b8 22 ♘c3 ♕c5? (this line needs further tests, but after 22...0-0 the position appears equal) 23 ♘d5 ♘xe4 24 ♕xe4 0-0 25 b4 ♕b5 26 ♖d3 ♖fd8 27 ♖hd1 ♗xb4 28 a4 ♕a5 29 ♘xb4 +– Schäfer-Beyer, corr 1988.

E)

8 ... ♕c7
9 0-0-0 ♘bd7
10 ♗d3 h6
11 h4?! *(D)*

B



A crazy-looking move which is almost certainly unsound.

11 ... ♘c5

The best reply; Black continues his development while keeping the possibility of ...hxg5 hanging over White's head.

1) **11...hxg5** 12 hxg5 ♖f8 (the variation 12...♖xh1 13 ♖xh1 ♘g8 14

♖h8 ♔f8 15 ♕h3 d5 16 e5 ♗xg5 17 ♖xg8+ results in mate, Fiorentini-Villa, corr 1984) 13 gxf6 ♗xf6 14 ♘de2 ♘c5 15 ♔b1 ♖b8 16 g4 ± Silman-Tarjan, Lone Pine 1979.

2) **11...b5** (a playable alternative) 12 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 (12...gxf6 13 f5 {13 g4!?} ♘e5 14 ♕h5 b4 15 ♘ce2 ♘xd3+ 16 ♖xd3 e5 17 ♘e6 ♕b6 18 g4 ♗b7 19 ♘g3 ♖c8 20 g5? {20 ♔b1 ♕f2 21 ♖c1 ∞} ♕f2 21 c3 bxc3 22 bxc3 d5! –+ Ambrosino-Chiesa, corr 1977) 13 e5 ♗b7 14 ♕h3 (14 ♕g3 dxe5 15 fxe5 0-0! ∓ shows the dark side of h4) ♘d5 (14...dxe5 15 ♘xe6 fxe6 16 ♗g6+ ♔f8 17 ♕xe6 ♕c4 18 ♕xc4 bxc4 19 fxe5 ♗xg2 20 exf6 ♗xh1 21 fxe7+ ♔xe7 22 ♖xh1 +– Hakki-Sinprayoon, Lucerne OL 1982) 15 ♘xe6?! (critical, but apparently unsound; after other moves Black is at least equal) fxe6 16 ♕xe6 ♘xf4 17 ♗g6+ ♔d8 18 ♕g4 ♕c4 19 ♗f5 g6 ∓ Czaya-Born, corr 1975.

3) **11...♕b6** 12 ♘de2 ♘f8 (or 12...♘c5 13 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 {13...gxf6 14 f5 ±} 14 g4 ♗d7 15 g5 ±) 13 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 14 e5! dxe5 15 ♘e4 ♗d7 16 ♕g3! ± Velimirović-Garcia Martinez, Ljubljana-Portorož 1975.

4) **11...♘b6** 12 g4 hxg5 13 hxg5 ♖xh1 14 ♖xh1 ♘fd7 15 g6 ♗f6 16 gxf7+ ♔xf7 17 ♘xe6 ♔xe6 18 ♘d5 ♕d8 19 g5 ♗xg5 20 ♕g4+ ♔f7 21 ♕h5+ ♔e6 22 ♕g6+ ♘f6 23 fxg5 ♘bxd5 24 exd5+ ♔xd5 25 gxf6 ♕xf6 26 ♗e4+ ♔e6? 27 ♕e8+ ♕e7 28 ♗d5+ ♔f6 29 ♖f1+ 1-0 Chiesa-Ambrosino, corr 1977.

12 f5

Or:

1) **12 g4** hxg5 (12...♗d7 13 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 14 ♘ce2 0-0-0 15 g5 hxg5 16 hxg5 ♖xh1 17 ♖xh1 ♗xd4! 18 ♘xd4 e5 = Mariotti-Browne, Manila 1976) 13 hxg5 ♖xh1 14 ♖xh1 ♘fd7 15 g6 fxg6 16 ♖h8+ (or 16 ♗c4 ♘b6! 17 ♖h8+ ♗f8 18 f5 and now either 18...♕f7! or 18...♘xc4 19 fxe6 ♕e7 20 ♘d5 ♕g5+ refutes White's attack) ♘f8 17 f5 ♗g5+ 18 ♔b1 ♕f7 –+ Tolnai-Ruck, Budapest 1993.

2) **12 e5** ♘xd3+ (12...hxg5 13 exf6 ♗xf6? is a mistake because of 14 ♗b5+!) 13 ♕xd3 dxe5 (13...hxg5 14 exf6 ♗xf6 15 ♘e4 is less clear) 14 fxe5 ♕xe5! (14...hxg5 15 exf6 ♗xf6 16 ♘e4 ♗d7 17 hxg5 ♖xh1 18 ♖xh1 ♗e7 19 ♖h8+ ♗f8 20 g6 0-0-0 ∓ Schroder-Strausz, corr 1988) 15 ♗f4 ♕h5 gives White little for the pawn.

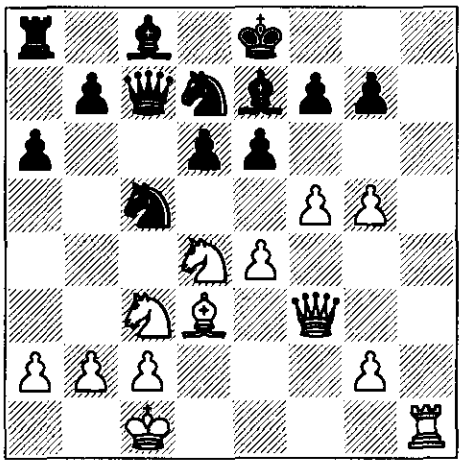
12 ... hxg5

Again best, for example 12...♗d7 (12...♘xd3+ 13 ♕xd3 ♗d7 14 fxe6 fxe6 15 e5 dxe5 16 ♕g6+ ♔f8 17 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 18 ♖hf1 ♗c8 19 ♖xf6+ gxf6 20 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 21 ♘f5 exf5 22 ♖d8+ 1-0 Carleton-Marcinkiewicz, corr 1981) 13 ♗e3 (13 fxe6 fxe6 14 ♗e3 {14 e5!?} 0-0-0 15 ♔b1 b5 16 g4 ♖hf8 17 ♕g2 b4 18 ♘ce2 ♕b7 ∓ Vayrynen-Paavilainen, corr 1982) 0-0-0 14 g4 h5 15 gxh5 ♘xh5 16 ♔b1 ♔b8 17 ♗g5 ♘f6 18 h5 ∞ Hesse-Capuano, corr 1981.

13 hxg5 ♖xh1
14 ♖xh1 ♘fd7! *(D)*

Better than 14...♘g8 15 f6! ♘xf6 (15...gxf6 16 ♖h8! ♔f8 17 gxf6 ♗d8 18 ♕g3 +–) 16 ♖h8+ ♔d7 17 gxf6 ♗xf6?! (17...♘xd3+ 18 ♕xd3 ♗xf6 ∞) 18 ♗c4! (18 e5 ♘xd3+ 19 cxd3 dxe5 20 ♘c2, Pantaveoni-Gatto, corr 1983, 20...♔e7! 21 ♘e4 b5 22 ♘xf6 ♗b7 23 ♖xa8 ♗xf3 24 ♘g8+ ♔d7 25 gxf3 ♕b7 26 ♖f8 ♕xf3 –+) ♗xd4 19 ♘b5! ♗e3+ 20 ♔b1 ♕b8 21 ♗d5! ♔e7 22 ♕xe3 ♘d7 23 ♕g5+

♘f6 24 ♕xg7 exd5 25 ♕f8+ 1-0 F.Larsen-Kubach, corr 1984.



15 ♖h8+

Or 15 fxe6 fxe6 (15...♘xe6!?) 16 ♕h5+ ♔d8 17 ♕h8+ ♘f8 18 ♖f1 ♗d7 19 ♕xg7 ♗e8 20 ♖xf8 ♗xf8 21 ♕xf8 ♕e7 ∓ Velimirović-Bukić, Banja Luka 1981. This may be relatively best for White, but of course it is hardly a tempting prospect.

15 ... ♗f8

15...♘f8 16 f6 gxf6 17 gxf6 b5 (17...♗d8 18 ♕f4 ♗xf6 19 ♕xf6 ♕e7 20 ♕h6 ♗d7 21 ♘f5 exf5 22 ♘d5 fxe4 23 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 24 ♕h4+ 1-0 Angantysson-Petursson, Icelandic Ch 1976) 18 ♗xb5+ (18 fxe7 ♕xe7 19 ♘c6 ♕g5+ ∞) axb5 19 ♘dxb5 ♕c6 20 fxe7 ♔xe7 21 ♕f4 ♗b7 22 e5 dxe5 23 ♕xe5 ♘cd7 24 ♕g5+ ♘f6 25 ♖h6 ♘8d7 26 ♖xf6 ♘xf6 27 ♘e4! ♖g8 28 ♕xf6+ ♔f8 ½-½ Gullotto-d'Arpino, corr 1983.

16 fxe6 ♘e5

Not 16...♘xe6 17 ♘xe6 fxe6 18 e5 ♕c6 19 ♗g6+ ♔d8, Harju-McClelland, corr 1981, and now 20 ♖xf8+ ♘xf8 21 ♕xf8+ ♔c7 22 ♕xg7+ ♔b8 23 ♗e4 ±.

After 16...♘e5 White has no way to force home his attack, for example 17 ♕h5 (17 ♘d5 ♘cxd3+ 18 ♔b1 ♕a5 19 exf7+ ♘xf7 0-1 Pannullo-Amovilli, corr 1986) ♘cxd3+ (the line 17...♘g6 18 ♘d5 ♘xd3+ 19 ♔b1 ♕a5 20 exf7+ ♔d8 21 ♘f3 ♘de5 is also effective) 18 cxd3 ♘g6 19 ♖g8 ♕c5 20 ♕f3 ♗xe6 21 ♘f5 0-0-0 −+ Mudelsee-Busch, Bundesliga 1989.

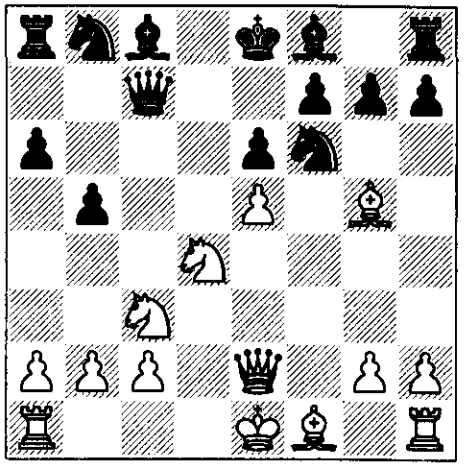
11 Polugaevsky with 10 ♕e2

In this and the following chapter we deal with one of the sharpest lines of the Najdorf. Polugaevsky reveals in his book *Grandmaster Preparation* that before playing it for the first time he devoted six months to the analysis of this variation. Despite many years of experience, no firm conclusions are possible; just as White comes up with one improvement, Black finds a new path to explore.

Condensing this material into two chapters has been very hard, since general considerations are of no value. Only deep tactical analysis can evaluate most of the positions, and one slip in this analysis can turn the assessment of a major line upside down.

Recently the Polugaevsky has declined in popularity. Perhaps the risks involved have put off many players, but it may also be that the increasing use of computers has turned players away from the sharpest lines – who wants to be beaten by a weaker player who has used his *Fritz* to come up with a killing novelty?

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 b5 8 e5 dxe5 9 fxe5 ♕c7 10 ♕e2 *(D)*



10 ... ♘fd7

Other moves are simply bad:

1) **10...b4** 11 ♘cb5! axb5 12 exf6 ♖a5 (12...♗d7 13 ♘xb5 or 12...♘d7 13 ♘xe6 +–) 13 ♘xb5 ♕b6 14 ♕e5 gxf6 15 ♗xf6 ♖g8 16 ♘c7+ ♔d7 17 ♖d1+ ♔c6 18 ♕e4+ ♖d5 19 ♘xd5 1-0 Gordienko-Kulakov, Moscow 1961.

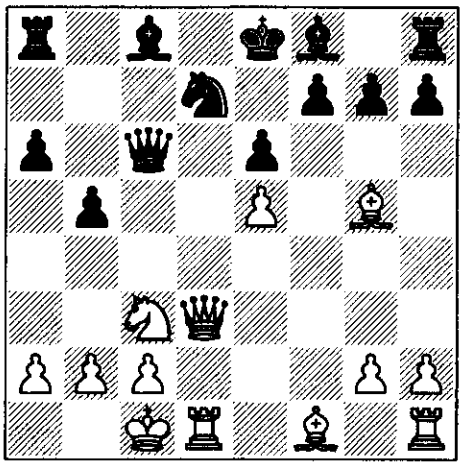
2) **10...♗b4** 11 exf6 ♗xc3+ 12 bxc3 ♕xc3+ 13 ♕d2 ♕xa1+ 14 ♔f2 0-0 (14...♘d7 15 fxg7 ♖g8 16 ♗e2 ♕xa2 17 ♗f3 ±) 15 fxg7 ♖e8 16 ♗xb5 ♕xh1 17 ♗xe8 ♗b7 18 ♗xf7+ ♔xg7 19 ♗h6+ ♔xf7 20 ♕f4+ ♔e8 21 ♕f8+ ♔d7 22 ♕f7+ ♔c8 23 ♕e8+ and White forces mate, Ralha-Jochem, corr 1986.

11 0-0-0 ♗b7

There are various alternatives, but of these only 11...♘c6 needs to be taken seriously. Indeed, this line probably represents Black's best chance in the 10 ♕e2 variation.

1) **11...♘c6** 12 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 13 ♕d3 *(D)* (13 ♘e4 ♗b7 14 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 15 ♖xd6 ♕c7 16 ♕e3 ♖c8 17 ♗d3 ♘c5 18 ♔b1 0-0 19 ♖c1 f5 leads to an equal position, Koch-H.Olafsson, Reykjavik 1993) and now:

B



1a) **13...♗c5** 14 ♗e2 ♕c7 15 ♘e4 0-0 16 ♕g3! ♔h8 17 ♗f4 ♗e7 18 ♘f6! ♕d8 19 ♗f3 ♖a7 20 ♗e3 +– Tomson-Kovačević, Lvov 1961.

1b) **13...♗b4** 14 ♗e2 ♖b8 15 ♘e4 0-0 16 ♘f6+! ♘xf6 17 ♗xf6 ♗b7 18 ♕h3! ± Kelečević-Bucan, Portorož 1971.

1c) **13...♗b7** 14 ♗e2 ♕c7 15 ♖hf1 (or 15 ♖d2 ♘xe5 16 ♕g3! ♗b4 17 ♗f4 ♗xc3 18 bxc3 f6 19 ♗xe5 fxe5 20 ♗h5+ g6 21 ♗xg6+ hxg6 22 ♕xg6+ ♕f7 23 ♕xf7+ ♔xf7 24 ♖d7+ and wins) ♘c5 16 ♕g3 h6 17 ♗xb5+ axb5 18 ♘xb5 +– McDonald-Buckley, British Ch 1991.

1d) **13...h6** with a further branch:

1d1) **14 ♗e2!?** and now:

1d11) **14...♗b7** 15 ♗f3 ♕c7 16 ♗xb7 ♕xb7 17 ♗h4 ♕c7 18 ♖he1 looks good for White.

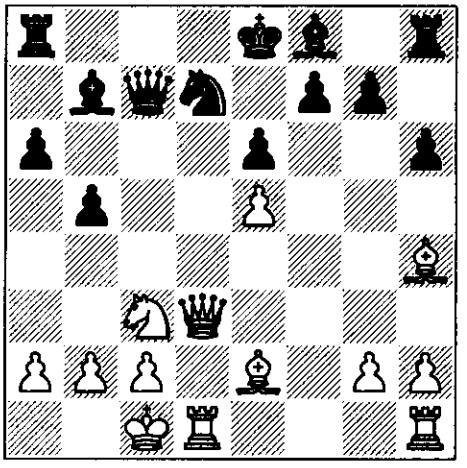
1d12) **14...hxg5** 15 ♗f3 ♕c7 16 ♗xa8 ♘xe5 17 ♕g3 f6 18 ♔b1 b4! (18...♖h4 19 ♗f3 favoured White in Yudasin-Oll, USSR 1989; the move 18...b4 was proposed by Polugaevsky shortly before his death) 19 ♘e2 (19 ♘e4 ♕b8) ♖h4 20 ♘d4 ♖xd4 21 ♖xd4 ♕a7 22 ♖hd1 ♕xa8 23 ♖d8+ ♔e7 24 ♕h3 ♕c6 25 ♕h8 ♘g6 26 ♕h5 ♘f4 ½-½ Pioch-Van Oosterom, corr 1995.

1d13) **14...♕c7** 15 ♕h3 (15 ♗h4 ♗b7 is line 1d2; 15 ♖hf1 hxg5 16 ♕f3 b4! ∞) ♕xe5 (15...♗b7?? 16 ♕xe6+ 1-0 actually occurred in one postal game) is unclear.

1d14) **14...b4** 15 ♗f3 ♕c7 16 ♘e4 hxg5 17 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 18 exd6 ♕a7 19 ♗xa8 ♕xa8 20 ♕g3 f6 21 h4 g4 22 ♕xg4 ♔f7 23 ♖he1 ± T.Bücker-Sobisch, corr 1985.

1d2) **14 ♗h4** ♗b7 15 ♗e2 ♕c7 *(D)* with a final branch:

W



1d21) **16 ♖he1** ♘c5 (16...♘xe5 17 ♕g3 g5 18 ♗xb5+ axb5 19 ♘xb5 ±) 17 ♕d4! (17 ♕h3 b4 18 ♘b5! axb5! 19 ♗xb5+ ♗c6 20 ♕f3 ♘b3+ 21 axb3 {21 ♔b1? ♘a5 –+ Grünfeld-Polugaevsky, Riga IZ 1979} ♖a1+ 22 ♔d2 ♕d7+ 23 ♔e3 ♗c5+ 24 ♔f4 g5+ 25 ♔g3 ♖xd1 26 ♗xc6 ♖xe1 27 ♗xd7+ ♔f8! ∞) g5 (17...♗e7 18 ♗xb5+ {18 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 19 b4! ±} axb5 19 ♘xb5 ♕c6 20 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 21 ♕h4+ g5 22 ♕f2 ♔f8 23 ♕f6, Agapov-Nepomnishay, 23...♖h7 24 ♖d8+ drawing; 17...♖c8 18 ♖d2 b4 19 ♘b5 ♕a5, Gorelik-Shvodas, corr 1986, 20 ♗c4! b3 21 ♕c3! ±) 18 ♗f2 ♖c8 19 ♔b1 ♗xg2 20 ♗h5 ♗h3 21 b4 ♘b7 22 ♘d5 exd5 23 e6 ♘d6 (23...♕xc2+ 24 ♔a1 ♖h7 25

exf7+ ♔d7 26 ♗g4+ +–) 24 ♕xh8 ♕xc2+ 25 ♔a1 ♕xf2 26 e7 ♔d7 27 exf8♕ ♖xf8 28 ♕xh6 ♗e6 29 ♖f1 ± Polaković-Halouzka, corr 1988.

1d22) **16 ♖hf1** (16 ♖d2, as in line 1c, no longer works as 16...♘xe5 17 ♕g3 allows 17...g5) ♘xe5 (16...♘c5 17 ♕h3 b4 {17...♖c8 18 ♖d2 b4 19 ♘a4 ♗d5 20 ♘b6! ♕xb6 21 ♖xd5 g5 22 ♗h5 ♖c7 23 ♖dd1! gxh4 24 ♕f3 +– Stilling-Peterson, corr 1993} 18 ♘b5 axb5 19 ♗xb5+ ♗c6 20 ♕f3 ♘b3+ 21 axb3 ♖a1+ 22 ♔d2 ♕d7+ 23 ♔e3 ♗c5+ 24 ♔f4 g5+ 25 ♔g3 ♗xb5 26 ♖xd7 ♖xf1 27 ♕a8+ ♔xd7 28 ♕b7+ ♔d8 29 ♕xb5 gxh4+ 30 ♔h3 ♖f5 31 ♕b8+ 1-0 Pereira-Assuncao, Portugal 1981; of course Black need not play exactly as in Grünfeld-Polugaevsky) 17 ♕g3 ♖c8! (17...g5 18 ♘xb5 ♕c5 19 b4! gxh4 20 ♕f4 ♕b6 21 ♕xe5 +– Klosterman-Pripoaie, corr 1982) 18 ♗h5 g5 19 ♕xe5 (19 ♕e1 ♗g7 20 ♖xf7 ♘xf7 21 ♕xe6+ ♕e7 22 ♗xf7+ ♔f8 is roughly equal) ♕xe5 20 ♖xf7 gxh4 21 ♖f5+ ♔e7 22 ♖f7+ ½-½ Class-Matt, corr 1992.

1d3) **14 ♗f4** ♗b7 15 ♗e2 ♘c5 16 ♕e3 ♖c8 17 ♖d2 ♕b6 18 ♕d4 ♖d8 19 ♕e3 ♖xd2 20 ♕xd2 b4 ∓ Luther-Stangl, Altensteig 1991.

1e) **13...b4!?** 14 ♘e4 (14 ♗e2 bxc3 15 ♗f3 ♕b6 16 ♕xc3 ♖b8 is unsound and 14 ♘e2 ♗b7 15 ♘d4 ♕c7 16 ♗e2 ♘xe5 17 ♕b3 is unclear) ♗b7 15 ♗e2 ♕d5 16 ♕g3?! ♕xa2 17 ♖xd7 ♔xd7 18 ♕f3 ♗d5 19 ♕xf7+ ♔c6 with advantage to Black, de Firmian-McCambridge, USA 1977.

2) **11...♗b4** 12 ♘e4 ♕xe5 13 ♘f3 ♕c7 14 a3 ♗f8 15 g4 (15 g3 is also good) ♗b7 16 ♗g2 ♕c4 (or 16...♘c6 17 ♗h4 ♕f4+ 18 ♔b1 ♕xg4 19 ♖xd7 ♔xd7 20 ♕d2+ ♔c8 21 ♖d1 ♗e7 22 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 23 ♘e5 ♕h5 24 ♕d7+ ♔b8 25 ♕d6+ ♔c8 26 ♗f3 ♕xh2 27 ♕c5+ 1-0 Cayford-Osbun, corr 1986) 17 ♕xc4 bxc4 18 ♘e5! c3 (18...♗e7 19 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 20 ♘xd7 ♘xd7 21 ♖xd7+ ♔xd7 22 ♘c5+ or 18...♗d5 19 ♘xc4! ♗xc4 20 ♘d2 ±) 19 ♘xd7 ♘xd7 20 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 21 ♗xb7 ♗e7 22 ♗f4 and White wins, Giterman-Stein, USSR Ch ½f 1960.

3) **11...♗e7** 12 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 13 ♕g4 ♕xe5 14 ♗xb5 ♗b7 (14...axb5 15 ♖he1 h5 16 ♕f3 ♕g5+ 17 ♔b1 ♖a7 18 ♘f5+ ♔f8 19 ♘d6 ♘b6 20 ♕f2 +–) 15 ♖he1 h5 16 ♘f5+ ♔d8 17 ♕h4+ g5 18 ♕xg5+ f6 19 ♗xd7 fxg5 20 ♗xe6+ 1-0 Kupper-Walther, Zurich 1961.

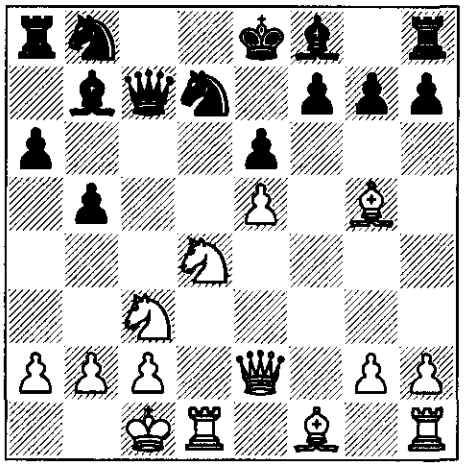
4) **11...b4** 12 ♘e4 ♕xe5 13 ♘f3 (13 g3! ♗b7 14 ♗g2 appears better, for example 14...♘c6 15 ♘xc6 bxc6 16 ♗f4 ±) ♕c7 14 ♕d2 f6 15 ♗d3 ♗e7 16 ♗f4 e5 17 ♗e3 0-0 18 g4 ♘b6 19 ♖hg1 ♗e6 20 g5 f5 21 ♘f6+ ♔h8 22 ♗xb6 ♕xb6 23 ♘xe5 ∞ Sanchez Almeyra-Tortarolo, Zurich 1989.

5) **11...♗c5** 12 h4 (12 ♘e4 ♕xe5 13 ♘b3 0-0 14 ♘bxc5 ♘xc5 15 ♗e7 ♘xe4 16 ♗xf8 ♔xf8 17 ♖d8+ ♔e7 18 ♖xc8 ± Juhandi-Melnikas, corr 1965) 0-0 13 ♗f4 ♗b7 14 ♖h3 ♗xd4 15 ♖xd4 ♘c6 16 ♖d6 f6 17 exf6 ♖xf6 18 ♘d5 exd5 19 ♖xf6 +– Barczay-Latas, Myslenice 1987.

6) **11...♕xe5** 12 ♕xe5 ♘xe5 13 ♘dxb5 +–.

7) **11...♘xe5** 12 ♘dxb5 axb5 13 ♕xe5 +–.

After 11...♗b7 *(D)* we have to consider a number of lines:



A: 12 ♘xe6
B: 12 ♕g4 ♕b6
C: 12 ♕g4 ♕xe5 13 ♗xb5
D: 12 ♕g4 ♕xe5 13 ♗d3
E: 12 ♕g4 ♕xe5 13 ♗e2

There are also several less important variations, which we will consider straight away. Note that the immediate sacrifice 12 ♘dxb5 axb5 13 ♘xb5 ♕c5 is unsound, while passive moves like 12 ♘f3 and 12 ♗f4 scarcely come into consideration.

1) **12 ♘f5** (after this the only question is whether or not White can draw) exf5 13 e6 ♘f6 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 ♕h5 ♗b4! (everything else is bad) 16 ♗xb5+ (16 ♘xb5 axb5 17 ♗xb5+ ♗c6 18 ♗xc6+ ♘xc6 19 ♖d7 ♕f4+ 20 ♔b1 ♘e5 –+ Guerra Acosta-Perez Perez, corr 1992; 16 exf7+ ♔f8 17 ♕h6+ ♔xf7 18 ♗e2 ♗xc3 19 ♗h5+ ♔e6 20 bxc3 ♗e4 –+) axb5 17 exf7+ ♔f8! 18 ♖he1 ♘d7! 19 ♕xf5 (19 ♖e8+? ♔g7 20 ♖d3 ♕f4+ 21 ♔b1 ♘e5 22 ♖g3+ ♘g4 23 a3 ♖f8! 0-1 Bonfa-Tatai, Cotronei 1978) ♘e5 20 ♕xf6 ♘g6! (20...♘xf7 21 ♘xb5 ♕c6 22 ♘d6 ♗xd6 23 ♖f1 ♗f4+ 24 ♕xf4 ♕e6 25 ♖de1 ♕g6 26 ♕b4+ ♔g7 27 ♖xf7+ ♕xf7 28 ♖e7 ±) 21 ♖e8+ ♖xe8 22 fxe8♕+ ♔xe8 23 ♖e1+ ♗e7 24 ♘xb5 ♕xh2 25 ♖xe7+ ♘xe7 26 ♕xh8+ ♔f7 ∓.

2) **12 ♕h5** (an inferior move which, by forcing ...g6, gives Black extra defensive possibilities based on the trick ...♕xg5+ and ...♗h6) g6 and now:

2a) **13 ♕g4** ♕xe5 14 ♗xb5 h5 (after 14...axb5 15 ♖he1 h5 16 ♕h4 ♕xg5+ 17 ♕xg5 ♗h6 18 ♘xe6, the line 18...fxe6 19 ♖xe6+ ♔f7 20 ♖e7+ ♔g8 21 ♖e8+ is just a draw, while 18...♗xg5+ 19 ♘xg5+ ♔f8 20 ♘xb5 offers White fair compensation for the piece) 15 ♕h4 ♕xg5+ 16 ♕xg5 ♗h6 17 ♕xh6 ♖xh6 18 ♗f1 h4 19 ♖g1 ♔e7 20 ♘b3 ♘c6 ∓ Bojković-Vitolinš, Yugoslavia v USSR 1963.

2b) **13 ♕h4** ♗g7 (the soundest line) 14 ♗e7 (14 ♗xb5 0-0! 15 ♗xd7 ♘xd7 16 ♗e7 ♗xg2 {16...♘xe5 17 ♗xf8 ♖xf8 18 ♕g3 ♕b6 19 ♖he1 ♘c4 ∞} 17 ♖hg1 ♗b7 18 ♗xf8 ♖xf8 19 ♕e7 ♗c8 20 ♕d6 ♗xe5 21 ♕xc7 ♗xc7 ∓) ♕xe5 15 ♗xb5 ♕h5! 16 ♗xd7+ (16 ♗a4 ♕xh4 17 ♗xh4 0-0 18 ♘xe6 fxe6 19 ♗xd7 ♘xd7 20 ♖xd7 ♗xg2 21 ♖g1 ♗xc3 22 bxc3 ♗d5 ∓ while Van der Vliet suggests 16 ♗c4 so as to sacrifice on e6 in some positions) ♘xd7 17 ♕xh5 gxh5 18 ♗g5?! (18 ♗h4 ♘e5 ∓) ♖g8! 19 ♗h4 ♗e5 ∓ Quinteros-Polugaevsky, Manila 1976.

A)

12 ♘xe6 fxe6
13 ♕g4

The alternative is 13 ♕h5+ g6 14 ♕g4. Obviously there are many similarities between this idea and the main line, and transpositions can certainly occur. However, the

differences are sufficient to demand separate analysis. After **13 ♕h5+ g6 14 ♕g4** Black may play:

1) **14...♗e7** 15 ♗xe7 ♘xe5 (not 15...♔xe7 16 ♖d6 ♘f8 17 ♗xb5! axb5 18 ♘xb5 ♕a5 19 ♕h4+ ♔e8 20 b4 +–) 16 ♕g3 (16 ♗d8 ♘xg4 17 ♗xc7 0-0 18 ♖e1 ± is simple, while an interesting idea is 16 ♕g5 ♘f7 17 ♗d8!? ♘xd8 {17...♘xg5 18 ♗xc7 ±} 18 ♗xb5+ ♘bc6 {18...axb5 19 ♘xb5 ±} 19 ♘d5! and White has a very strong attack) ♔xe7 17 ♗xb5 ♖c8! (17...axb5 18 ♕h4+ ♔f8 {or 18...♔e8 19 ♘xb5 +–} 19 ♖hf1+ ♘f7 20 ♕f6 ♖g8 21 ♖d8+ +–) 18 ♕h4+ (18 ♗a4 ♘f7 19 ♕h4+ ♔f8 20 ♖hf1 ♔g8 21 ♗b3 ♖e8 22 ♖de1 ∞ Lukov-Ermenkov, Varna 1983) ♔f8 19 ♕f6+ ♔g8 (19...♘f7 20 ♖hf1 ♔g8 21 ♗d7! ♖f8 22 ♗xe6 +–) 20 ♕xe6+ ♔g7 21 ♗a4 ♘bc6 (21...♗xg2 22 ♖hf1 ♘f3 {22...♗xf1 23 ♘d5 =} 23 ♘d5 ♕c5 24 ♖xf3 ♗xf3 25 ♕e5+ ♔h6 26 ♖d4, Gonzalez-Hernandez, Cuba 1981, 26...♘d7! ∞) 22 ♘d5 ♕f7 23 ♕xf7+ ♘xf7 24 ♘b6 ♘ce5 25 ♖hg1 ♖c7 26 ♘xa8 ♗xa8 27 ♖d2 h5 28 c3 h4 29 ♗d1 ♘h6 30 ♖e1 ♘c4 31 ♖de2 ♘f5 32 ♗c2 ♘cd6 ½-½ Fiorito-Rogalewicz, corr 1993.

2) **14...♘c5** 15 ♖d8+ ♕xd8 16 ♗xd8 ♔xd8 is a sensible idea since ...g6 is a useful move in the main line below, note to Black's 13th move.

3) **14...♕xe5** 15 ♗d3 and now:

3a) **15...♗e7** 16 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 17 ♖he1 h5 (17...♘f6 18 ♕b4+ ♕d6 19 ♖xe6+! ♔xe6 20 ♗f5+ +–; 17...♕f6 18 ♗e4 h5 19 ♕g3! ♗xe4 20 ♕d6+ ♔f7 21 ♘xe4 ♕e5 22 ♖f1+ ♔g8 23 ♕e7 ♖h7 24 ♘f6+! ♕xf6 25 ♕e8+ ♕f8 26 ♖xf8+ ♘xf8 27 ♖f1, Marcinkiewicz-Zinchenko, corr 1981) 18 ♕xg6 (this possibility is the key difference compared with the main line below) ♕f4+ (or 18...♕f6 19 ♕g3 ♖f8 20 ♗e4 ♗xe4 21 ♖xe4 ♔d8 22 a4 ♔c8 23 ♔b1 ♕f2 ∓) 19 ♔b1 (19 ♖d2 ♕g4 20 ♖xe6+ ♕xe6 21 ♖e2 ♘e5 22 ♕g7+ ♔d6 23 ♕xh8 ♘bd7 24 ♕xh5 ♖f8 ∓ Brus-Gallinnis, corr 1988) ♕g4 20 ♖xe6+ ♕xe6 21 ♕g7+ ♔d8 22 ♕xh8+ ♔c7 23 ♕xh5 ♗xg2 24 ♗f5 ♕e5 (24...♕e7 25 ♕g4 ♗c6 ∞) Grünfeld-Van der Vliet, Amsterdam 1982, is also unclear.

3b) **15...♘c5** and now White has no more than a draw:

3b1) **16 ♖hf1** ♗e7 17 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 18 ♖fe1 ♘xd3+ 19 cxd3 ♕d6 20 ♕g5+ ♔f7 21 ♖f1+ ♔e8 –+.

3b2) **16 ♖he1** ♘xd3+ 17 cxd3 ♕f5 18 ♖xe6+ ♔d7! defending.

3b3) **16 ♗xg6+** hxg6 17 ♖d8+ ♔f7 18 ♖f1+ ♔g7 19 ♗f6+ ♕xf6 20 ♖xf6 ♔xf6 21 ♕f4+ ♔e7 22 ♕d6+ ♔f7 23 ♕c7+ ♔f6 with a draw.

3b4) **16 ♕h4** ♘bd7 17 ♖he1 ♕g7 18 ♗e4 h6 19 ♗xb7 hxg5 20 ♕g3 ♖a7 21 ♗c6 ♔f7 ∓ Shabanov-Krimermann, corr 1986.

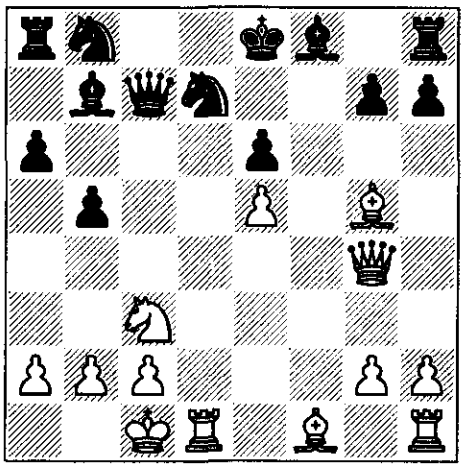
3b5) **16 ♗xb5+** ♘c6! 17 ♖he1 ♕f5 (17...h5 18 ♗xc6+ ♗xc6 19 ♖xe5 hxg4 20 b4 =) 18 ♕g3 axb5 19 ♖d5 ♕f7 20 ♘xb5 ♖c8 21 ♕c3 ♕f2! 22 ♕xh8 (22 ♗e3 ♘b4!) ♕xe1+ 23 ♖d1 ♘d3+ 24 cxd3 ♘d4+ 25 ♘c3 ♖xc3+ –+.

We now return to the main line after 13 ♕g4 *(D)*:

13 ... ♕xe5

Only **13...♘c5** is a genuine alternative:

1) **13...♕b6?** (13...♕c6? is also met by 14 ♖d6!) 14 ♖d6! ♗xd6 15 ♕xe6+ ♔f8 16 ♗xb5 axb5 17 ♖f1+ ♘f6 18 ♖xf6+ gxf6 19 ♗h6#.



2) **13...♘xe5** 14 ♕xe6+ ♗e7 15 ♗xb5+ ♔f8 16 ♖hf1+ ♗f3 17 ♖xf3+ ♘xf3 18 ♗xe7+ ♕xe7 19 ♕f5+ ♕f6 20 ♖d8+ wins.

3) **13...♘c6** 14 ♕xe6+ ♘e7 15 ♗xb5 axb5 16 ♘xb5 ♕c6 17 ♘d6+ ♔d8 18 ♘xb7+ ♕xb7 19 ♖xd7+ ♕xd7 20 ♖d1 ♖a7 21 ♖xd7+ ♖xd7 22 ♕b6+ with a decisive initiative for White.

4) **13...♘c5** 14 ♖d8+ ♕xd8 15 ♗xd8 ♔xd8 16 b4 ♘cd7 and now:

4a) **17 ♕xe6** ♗xb4 18 ♕b3 ♗xc3 19 ♕xc3 ♖e8 20 e6 ♖xe6 21 ♕xg7 ♘c6 ∞.

4b) **17 a3** g6! (17...♘c6 18 ♕xe6 ♘cxe5 and now both 19 ♗e2 ♖c8 20 ♖d1 ♖xc3 21 ♕xe5 ♖c7 22 ♗g4 and 19 ♗xb5 axb5 20 ♖d1 ♖xa3 21 ♕xe5 ♖a1+ 22 ♘b1 ♖a8 23 ♕xb5 are good for White) 18 ♕xe6 ♗g7 ∞.

4c) **17 ♗e2!** ♗e7 (17...g6 18 ♖d1 ♗g7 19 ♕xe6 ♖e8 20 ♕b6+ ♔c8 21 ♗g4 +–; 17...♘c6 18 ♖d1 ♘cxe5 19 ♕xe6 ♔c7 20 ♗xb5! +–; 17...h5 18 ♕xe6 ♗xb4 19 ♕b3 ♗xc3 20 ♕xc3 ♖e8 21 ♖d1 ♘c6 22 ♗xh5 ♖xe5 23 ♗f3 ♖e6 24 ♕xg7 ♖e7, Winslow-Browne, US Open Ch 1976, and now 25 ♕g5 ♖c8 26 ♖d6 ♖c7 27 ♖h6 +– – Shamkovich) 18 ♕xg7 (18 a3!?) ♖f8 ∞.

14 ♗d3

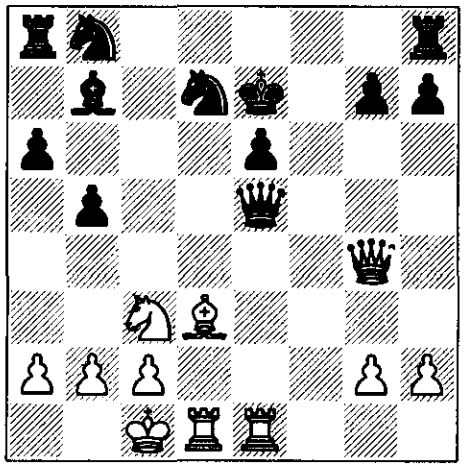
14 ♗xb5? axb5 (14...h5? 15 ♗d3!) 15 ♖he1 h5 16 ♕h4 ♕f5! –+.

14 ... ♗e7

Not 14...♘f6?! 15 ♗xf6 gxf6 16 ♔b1 ♔f7 17 ♖he1 ♖g8 18 ♕h3 ♗xg2 19 ♕xh7+ ♖g7 20 ♗g6+ ♔e7 21 ♕h4 +–.

15 ♗xe7 ♔xe7

16 ♖he1 *(D)*



16 ... h5

Or **16...♕f6** and now:

1) **17 ♔b1** ♖c8! 18 ♕b4+ ♖c5 19 ♗e4 a5 20 ♕xc5+ ♘xc5 21 ♗xb7 ♘xb7 22 ♘d5+ ♔f7 23 ♘xf6 gxf6 ∓.

2) **17 ♕b4+** ♔d8 (the only difference between this and the note to White's 17th move in the main line is that Black has not played ...h5; this favours White as ...h5 is a useful extra move, allowing ...♖h6 and keeping the white queen out in case of the sequence ♕h4+ g5) 18 ♗e4 ♕f4+ 19 ♔b1 ♖e8 (19...♕c7 20 ♖f1 is also dangerous) 20 ♖f1 ♕c7 21 ♖f7 ♖a7 22 ♕d4 ± Fernandez-A.Rodriguez, Mexico 1977. Of course, there are undoubtedly improvements for Black.

3) **17 ♗e4** and now:

3a) **17...♕h6+** 18 ♔b1 ♖a7 is proposed by F.Olafsson but 19 ♗f5!

♘c5 20 ♗xe6 ♘xe6 21 ♖xe6+ ♕xe6 22 ♕xg7+ wins on the spot.

3b) **17...♘c6** 18 ♕g3! ♘de5 (or 18...♕h6+ 19 ♔b1 e5 20 ♘d5+ ♔f7 21 ♕f3+ wins) 19 ♗xc6 ♗xc6 20 ♖xe5 ±.

3c) **17...♗xe4** 18 ♘xe4 ♕h6+ (18...♕g6 19 ♕h4+ +–) 19 ♘g5 e5 20 ♔b1 ♖a7 21 ♕b4+ ♔e8 22 ♘e4 ♕e6 (22...♘c6 23 ♘d6+ ♔d8 24 ♕e4 +–) 23 ♘d6+ ♔d8 ∞.

17 ♕b4+

The alternative 17 ♕h4+ ♕f6 (or 17...g5 18 ♕h3 g4 19 ♕h4+ ♕f6 20 ♕g3 ♘c5 21 ♗e4 ♗xe4 22 ♘xe4 ∞) 18 ♕b4+ ♔d8 19 ♗e4 at least has the virtue of being untested. However, I suspect that this line offers White at most equality.

17 ... ♕c5

18 ♕h4+ ♘f6

18...g5 is bad, for example 19 ♕h3 ♖h6 (19...♘e5 20 ♗e4! ♘bc6 21 ♕g3 ♖ag8 22 ♗xc6 h4 23 ♘d5+! 1-0 Verduga-L.Ortega, Cienfuegos 1979) 20 ♗e4 (20 ♗f5 ♘f8 21 ♗e4 ♗c6 22 ♗xc6 ♘xc6 23 ♘e4 ♕f5 24 ♕c3 e5 25 ♕c5+ ♔e8 1-0 Mori-Dobsa, corr 1986) ♘c6 21 ♗d5! ♘d8 (21...♘de5 22 ♕g3! and 21...♘f8 22 ♘e4 are also good for White) 22 ♕g3 (22 ♗xb7 ♘xb7 23 ♕f3 ♖a7 24 ♘e4 ♕e5 25 ♔b1 ♕f4 26 ♕c3 ♖g6 27 ♖f1! ♕b8 28 ♖xd7+ ♔xd7 29 ♖f7+ ♔e8 30 ♕h8+ 1-0 Jonasson-Yrjölä, Reykjavik 1986, since the rook on a7 will be trapped) g4 23 ♘e4 ♕b6 24 ♕h4+ ♘f6 25 ♗xb7 ♘xb7 26 ♕g5 +– Gild.Garcia-Van Wely, New York 1995.

After 18...♘f6 White is struggling to find compensation, e.g. **19 ♕g3** (19 ♕h3 ♘g4 slightly favours Black) and now:

1) **19...♖g8?!** 20 ♖e5 ♕b6 21 ♗f5 ♘bd7 22 ♖xe6+ ♕xe6 23 ♗xe6 ♔xe6 24 ♕d6+ ♔f7 25 ♕c7 ♗c8 26 a4!? (26 ♘d5 ♘xd5 27 ♖xd5 ♖e8! 28 ♖xd7+ ♗xd7 29 ♕xd7+ ♔g6 ½-½ Olafsson-Polugaevsky, Reykjavik 1978) ♖e8 27 axb5 axb5 28 ♔b1 ♗a6? (28...♔g8 ∞) 29 ♖xd7+ ♘xd7 30 ♕xd7+ ♔g6 31 b4 ± Kokkila-Tiihonen, corr 1991.

2) **19...♔f8!** 20 ♘e4 ♗xe4 21 ♗xe4 ♘c6 22 ♕c7 ♘xe4 23 ♖xe4 ♖h6! 24 b4 ♕g5+ 25 ♔b1 e5 26 ♖d6 ♘e7 27 ♖xh6 ♕xh6 28 ♕xe5 ♖e8 29 ♖e3, Sauermann-Lassen, corr 1993, 29...♕g6 30 ♖g3 ♘c8 ∓.

B)

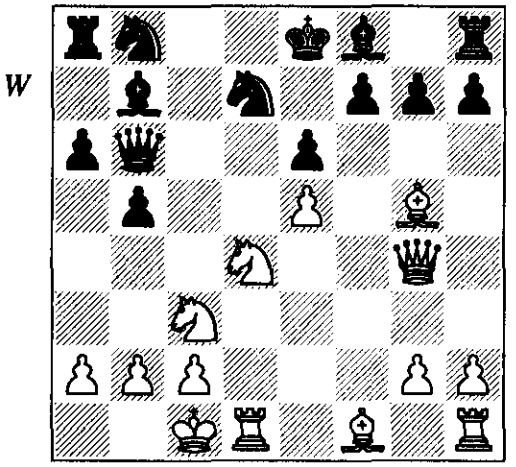
12 ♕g4 ♕b6 *(D)*

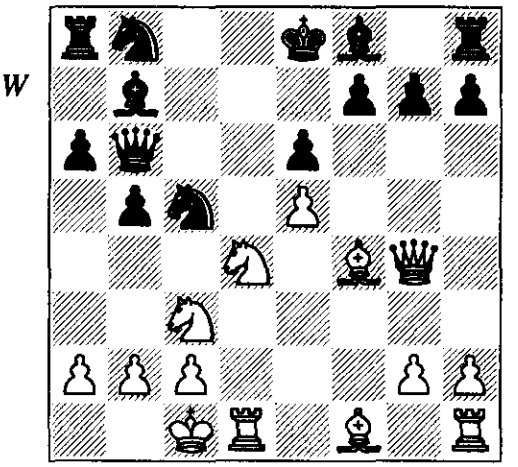
Black's alternatives after 12 ♕g4 really are restricted to 12...♕b6 and 12...♕xe5, for example **12...♘xe5?** 13 ♘xe6 fxe6 14 ♕xe6+ ♗e7 15 ♗xb5 +–, **12...♘c6?!** 13 ♗xb5 axb5 (13...♘dxe5 14 ♘xe6) 14 ♘cxb5 ♕b6 15 ♘xe6 +–, **12...h5** 13 ♕f4! ♘c6 (13...♗c5 14 ♘f3 followed by ♗e2 and ♖hf1) 14 ♗xb5 axb5 15 ♘dxb5 ♕b6 16 ♖xd7! ♔xd7 17 ♕xf7+ ♔c8 18 ♕e8+ ♘d8 19 ♖d1 ♗d5 20 ♘xd5 exd5 21 ♖xd5 +– or finally **12...b4** 13 ♘xe6 ♕c6 (or 13...♕b6 14 ♘d5) 14 ♘d8 +–.

13 ♗e2

Simple development is the best choice here:

1) **13 ♗xb5** axb5 14 ♘dxb5 ♘xe5 (or 14...♖xa2 {14...♘c6 15 ♖d6! is dangerous} 15 ♔b1 ♖a5 16 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 17 ♖xd6 ♕a7! 18 ♖xe6+ ♔f8 19 ♗e7+ ♔g8 20 ♗a3 ♖xe5 ∓) 15 ♕f4 ♘bc6! (15...♘bd7 16 ♖xd7! +–, but 15...f6!? is possible) 16 ♖he1 and now Shorno has pointed out that





the theoretical move **16...h6** loses to 17 ♖xe5! ♘xe5 (17...hxg5 18 ♖xe6+ fxe6 19 ♘c7+ wins) 18 ♕xe5 f6 19 ♗xf6 gxf6 20 ♕xf6 with a decisive attack (this trap has claimed several victims). **16...♗a6** also loses after 17 ♖xe5 ♘xe5 18 ♘d5!, but the alternative **16...♗c5!** is simply good for Black, e.g. 17 ♖xe5 ♘xe5 18 ♕xe5 0-0 19 ♕g3 ♔h8 ∓ Mauro-Tatai, Forli 1989.

2) **13 ♗f4** (an interesting alternative) and now:

2a) **13...♘c6?** 14 ♘xe6 ♘cxe5 15 ♘xg7+ ♗xg7 16 ♗xe5 (16 ♕xg7 is also good) ♗xe5 17 ♕xd7+ ♔f8 18 ♘d5 ♗xd5 19 ♕xd5 ± Kuhnel-Engholm, corr 1984.

2b) **13...g6** 14 ♗e2 ♘c5 (14...♗g7 15 ♗f3 0-0 16 h4 ♘c6 17 ♗xc6 ♗xc6 18 h5 b4 19 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 20 ♕h4! g5 21 ♕xg5 h6 22 ♕g3 ♔h8 23 ♖d6 ± Sarink-Bouwmeester, corr 1980) 15 b4!? (15 h4 and 15 ♗f3 are less double-edged) ♘cd7 16 a3 a5 17 ♘dxb5 h5 18 ♕g3 axb4 19 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 20 ♖xd6 ♗c6 21 ♘b5 was unclear in Louhi-Multala, corr 1971.

2c) **13...♘c5** *(D)* leads to another branch:

2c1) **14 b4** ♘e4 (14...♘cd7!?) 15 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 16 ♗g5 ♗d5 17 ♘xb5 ♘c6 (17...axb5 18 ♖xd5 exd5? loses after 19 ♕c8+) 18 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 19 exd6 ♘xb4 20 d7+ ♔xd7 21 ♗c4 ♕c5 22 ♖xd5+ ♘xd5 23 ♗xd5 f5 24 ♕a4+ ♕b5 25 ♕xb5+ axb5 26 ♗xa8 ♖xa8 27 ♖d1+ 1-0 Zielinsky-Giordanengo, corr 1971.

2c2) **14 ♗d3** b4 15 ♘a4!? (a remarkable idea – can it be sound?) ♘xa4 16 ♘xe6 ♕xe6 17 ♗f5 h5 18 ♕h3 ♗xg2 19 ♕xg2 ♕xf5 20 ♖hf1 ♘b6 (20...♖a7 21 ♗e3 ♕xe5 22 ♗d4 ♕c7 23 ♖de1+ ♗e7 24 ♖xf7 ∞) 21 e6! ♕xe6 22 ♖fe1 ♘8d7 23 ♖xe6+ fxe6 24 ♕g6+ ♔e7 25 ♖d6 +– e5? 26 ♗g5+ 1-0 Soderberg-Savkin, corr 1980.

2c3) **14 ♗e2** b4 (14...♘bd7 15 ♖hf1 ♖c8 16 ♗g3 b4 17 ♘b1 ♗e4! and Black is at least equal, Gutierrez-Rodriguez, Cienfuegos 1975) 15 ♘b1 ♘e4 (15...h5 16 ♕h4 ♘bd7 17 ♘d2 ♕c7 18 ♘c4 ♗e7 19 ♗g5 f6 20 exf6 gxf6 21 ♗f4!? {21 ♗xh5+ ♔f8 22 ♖hf1 also looks good} e5 22 ♘f5 ± Ueter-Stangl, Bundesliga 1987) 16 ♖hf1 h5 (16...♗d5 17 ♗f3 h5 18 ♕h4 ♗c5? 19 ♘xe6! fxe6 20 ♗xh5+ ♔d7 21 ♖xd5+ exd5 22 ♗g4+ is winning for White, Hallier-Haletzki, corr 1986; 16...♘d7!?) 17 ♕h3 ♘d7 18 ♗f3 (18 ♗xh5 0-0-0 ∓) ♖c8 19

♗xh5 g6 20 ♘xe6 led to a complete mess in Vojceh-Dobsa, corr 1979. White won after 20...♖xc2+, but it seems to me that 20...♘dc5! was the critical test of White's idea.

3) **13 ♘f3?!** ♘c6 14 ♕f4 (14 ♕g3 h6 15 ♗d2 ♕c7 16 ♖e1 ♖c8 17 ♗d3 ♘c5 18 ♔b1 ♘xd3 19 cxd3 ♕d7 with a clear advantage for Black, Novak-Stepien, corr 1991) h6 15 ♗h4, Kunerth-Geert, corr 1973, 15...g5 16 ♕d2 0-0-0 ∓.

4) **13 ♗e3!?** ♕c5 (13...♘xe5 14 ♕g3 ♕c7 15 ♗xb5+!) 14 ♕h3 ♕xe5 15 ♗d3 ♗xg2 (15...b4! ∞) 16 ♕xg2 ♕xe3+ 17 ♔b1 ♖a7 18 ♘f5 ♕c5 19 ♘xg7+ ♗xg7 20 ♕xg7 ± Ekenlov-Sciaretta, corr 1993.

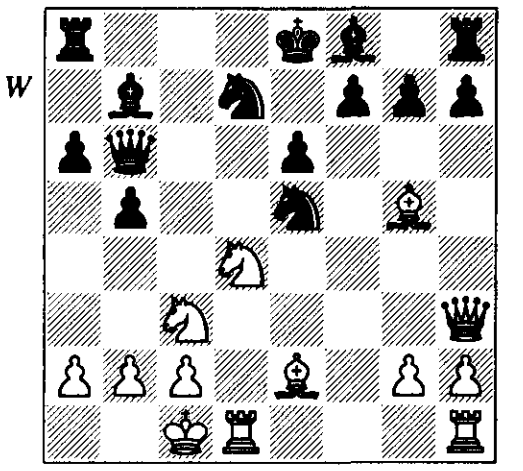
13 ... h6

Or **13...♘xe5** (13...♗c5 14 ♗e3 g6 15 ♘e4 ♗xe4 16 ♕xe4 ±; 13...♘c6 14 ♘xe6 ♘cxe5 15 ♘xf8! ♘xg4 16 ♘xd7 ♕g6 17 h4! gives White an enormous attack, e.g. 17...♘f2 18 ♖he1 ♗e4 19 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 20 ♗f3 f5 21 g4 +–) and now:

1) **14 ♕h5** ♘bd7 15 ♖he1 g6 16 ♕h4 ♗g7 ∓ Lambooy-Anjewierden, corr 1983.

2) **14 ♕g3** ♘bd7 15 ♗f4 (15 ♖he1 ♗c5! 16 ♗e3 0-0-0 ∓) b4 (15...f6 16 ♕h3 ♔f7 17 ♖hf1! +– g6 18 ♕g3 ♗d6 19 ♘f3 ♔g7 20 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 21 ♗h6+ ♔xh6 22 ♕h4+ ♔g7 23 ♕xf6+ ♔h6 24 ♖xd6 +– Klompus-Sokolovsky, corr 1980) 16 ♘a4 (16 ♘cb5 axb5 17 ♗xe5 ♘xe5 18 ♕xe5 0-0-0 ∓) ♕a5 17 ♘b3 (17 b3 g6 18 h4 ♗g7 19 h5 ♖c8?! {19...0-0-0! ∓} 20 hxg6 hxg6 21 ♘xe6 fxe6 22 ♖xh8+ ♗xh8 23 ♕h3 ∞ Alvir-Pliester, Dieren 1986) ♕xa4 18 ♗xe5 ♖c8 19 ♖he1 ♘xe5 20 ♕xe5 ♕c6 21 ♔b1 ♕c7 (21...♕xc2+ 22 ♔a1 ♕c7 may be possible) is also unclear, Balashov-Mecking, Manila 1976.

3) **14 ♕h3** ♘bd7 *(D)* and now:



3a) **15 ♗h5** g6 16 ♗f3 ♘xf3! (16...♗xf3 17 ♘xf3 ♗g7 18 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 19 ♘e4 0-0 20 ♘f6+ ♗xf6 21 ♗xf6 ♘c4 22 ♖d3 h5 23 g4! ± Gonzales-Ortega, Cienfuegos 1979; reserving the b7-bishop to eliminate a knight on e4 looks much sounder) 17 ♘xf3 ♗g7 18 ♖he1 ♘c5 19 ♗e3 ♕c6 20 ♘d4 ♕c8 (20...♕xg2? 21 ♕h4) 21 ♗h6 0-0 22 ♗xg7 ♔xg7 ∓ Consolimo-Nevio Joao, corr 1992.

3b) **15 ♖he1** with a final branch:

3b1) **15...h6**, transposing to the main line, is probably the best option.

3b2) **15...g6?** 16 ♗g4 h5 17 ♗xe6! fxe6 18 ♘xe6 ♖h7 19 ♘c7+! +– Wedberg-Rorvall, Swedish Ch 1977.

3b3) **15...♗c5?!** 16 ♘xe6! fxe6 (16...♕xe6 17 ♗g4 +–; 16...♗f2 17 ♘xg7+ ♔f8 18 ♘f5 ♖g8 19 ♖d6 ♕c5 20 ♕h6+ ♔e8 21 ♖e6+ fxe6 22 ♕xe6+ ♔f8 23 ♗h6+ 1-0 Hansen-Forthaus, corr 1981) 17 ♗h5+ ♔f8 18 ♖f1+ ♘f6 19 ♗xf6 gxf6 20 ♖xf6+ ♔g7 21 ♖xe6 ♗e3+ 22 ♔b1 ♖hd8 23 ♖xb6 ♗xb6 24 ♕e6 1-0 Rogobete-Buzbichi, Poiana Brasov 1978.

3b4) **15...♗b4** 16 ♘xe6 fxe6 (or 16...♗xc3 17 bxc3 fxe6 18 ♗h5+ ♔f8 19 ♖f1+ ♘f6 20 ♕h4 ♘ed7 21 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 22 ♖xf6+ 1-0 Altrock-Haletzki, corr 1987) 17 ♗h5+ ♔f8, Kuntermann-Brussino, corr 1991, and now 18 ♖f1+ ♔g8 (18...♘f6 19 ♗xf6 gxf6 20 ♖xf6+ wins after 20...♔e7 21 ♕h4 or 20...♔g7 21 ♖xe6) 19 ♖xd7 ♘xd7 20 ♗f7+ ♔f8 21 ♗xe6+ ♘f6 22 ♗xf6 gxf6 23 ♖xf6+ ♔e7 24 ♖f7+ ♔e8 25 ♖d7! ♕g1+ 26 ♘d1 ♕xg2 27 ♕h5+ ♕g6 28 ♕e5 wins for White.

14 ♕h3

Other lines:

1) **14 ♗f4** g5 15 ♗g3 ♗xg2 (it appears sounder to play 15...h5 16 ♕h3 g4 17 ♗xg4 ♗h6+ 18 ♔b1 hxg4 −+) 16 ♖hg1 h5 17 ♕xg5 ♗h6 0-1 Harju-Virtanen, corr 1978 – a somewhat premature resignation as White has fair compensation for the queen after 18 ♕xh6 ♖xh6 19 ♖xg2.

2) **14 ♗h4** ♘xe5 15 ♕h3 might transpose into the main line after 15...♘bd7 (Black does have other 15th moves, however) 16 ♖he1.

3) **14 ♗e3!?** ♘c6 (Black needs a better move here) 15 ♘d5! exd5 (or 15...♘cxe5 16 ♘xb6 ♘xg4 17 ♘xe6! +−) 16 e6 0-0-0 (16...♘c5 17 exf7+ ♔xf7 18 ♖hf1+ ♔g8 19 ♘e6 +−; 16...♘de5 17 exf7+ ♘xf7 18 ♕e6+ ♗e7 19 ♘f5 ♕c7 20 ♘xg7+ ♔f8 21 ♖hf1 ♗g5 22 ♗xg5 hxg5 23 ♖xf7+ ♕xf7 24 ♖f1 ±) 17 exd7+ ♔b8? (17...♖xd7 18 ♕h3 ♘e5 19 ♘xb5 ♗c5 20 ♗xc5 ♕xc5 21 ♘d4 is clearly better for White) 18 ♕g3+ ♔a8 19 ♘xb5 ♗c5 20 ♗xc5 ♕xc5 21 ♖xd5 1-0 Wierzbicki-Piper, Kansas 1983.

14 ... ♘xe5

14...♗c5? 15 ♘xe6 ♕xe6 16 ♗g4 ♕g6 17 ♗xd7+ ♔f8 18 ♗e3! and White wins.

15 ♖he1 ♘bd7

16 ♗h4 g5 *(D)*

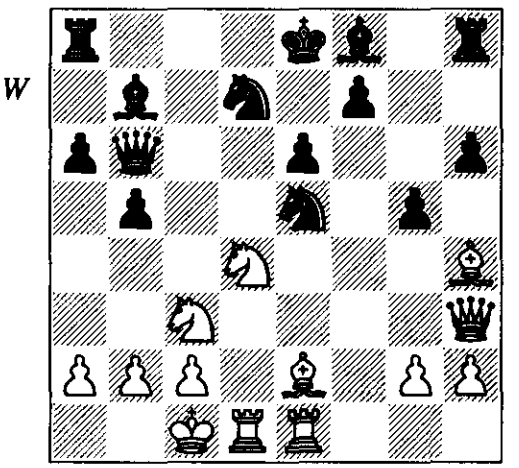
Or:

1) **16...g6** 17 ♗g4! h5 18 ♗xe6 ♗h6+ (18...fxe6 19 ♘xe6 ♖h7 20 ♖xd7!) 19 ♔b1 fxe6 20 ♘xe6 ♔f7! (not 20...♖h7?, as in Kavalek-Polugaevsky, Las Palmas 1974, when 21 ♖xd7! would have won) and now:

1a) **21 ♖xd7+!** ♘xd7 22 ♘f4 ♗xf4 (22...♘f6 23 ♗xf6 ♗xf4 24 ♗xh8 ♖xh8 25 ♕d7+ ♔f6 26 ♕e7+ ♔f5 27 ♘e2! +−) 23 ♕xd7+ ♔g8 24 ♖e6 ♕g1+ 25 ♘d1 ♖h7 (certainly not 25...♕xg2?? 26 ♖e7 1-0 Venni-Castalso, corr 1986) leading to perpetual check after 26 ♖e8+ or 26 ♖xg6+.

1b) **21 ♘g5+** ♗xg5 22 ♗xg5?! (22 ♖xd7+ ♘xd7 23 ♕xd7+ ♔g8 24 ♗xg5 ♕c6 25 ♕xc6 ♗xc6 26 ♖e6 ♗xg2 27 ♖xg6+ ∓) ♔g8! 23 ♗e7 ♖h7 24 ♗d6 ♘g4 ∓ Grünfeld-Klinger, Lugano 1984.

2) **16...h5!?** 17 ♗f3 ♗xf3 18 ♘xf3 ♘g4 19 ♘d5 ♕c5 ∞ Chandler-Vera, Innsbruck 1977.



17 ♘xe6

This move is probably best. The alternative is 17 ♗xg5 ♖g8 18 ♘xe6 hxg5 19 ♗h5 (19 ♗g4 fxe6 20 ♗xe6 0-0-0 21 ♖xe5 g4 is slightly better for Black, Berlinsky-Dvoirys, USSR 1978) g4! (19...♗d6? 20 ♕f5 ♖h8 21 ♗xf7+ ♔e7 22 ♘xg5 ♖h6, Kavalek-Polugaevsky, Manila 1975, and now 23 ♘ge4! is very good for White) 20 ♗xf7+ (20 ♗xg4 ♖xg4) ♔xf7 21 ♕h7+ ♖g7 and now the lines **22 ♘xg7** ♗xg7 23 ♖f1+ ♘f6 24 ♕h5+ ♘g6 25 ♘d5 ♖h8! 26 ♖xf6+ ♗xf6 27 ♕xh8 ♗xd5 28 ♕h7+ ♔f8, **22 ♖f1+** ♔xe6 23 ♕f5+ ♔e7 and **22 ♖xd7+** ♘xd7 23 ♘g5+ ♔f6 24 ♕h6+ (24 ♘ce4+ ♔e7! or 24 ♖e6+ ♕xe6) ♖g6 25 ♖f1+ ♔e7 are all good for Black.

17 ... fxe6

Or 17...gxh4 (17...♕xe6 18 ♗g4 ♘xg4 19 ♖xe6+ fxe6 20 ♕xg4 +–) 18 ♗h5 ♗d6 19 ♕f5 is very dangerous for Black, e.g. **19...♔e7?** 20 ♘f4 ±, **19...♖c8?** 20 ♗xf7+! ♘xf7 21 ♘g5+ ♘fe5 22 ♕f7+ ♔d8 23 ♘e6# or **19...b4** 20 ♘a4 ♕c6 21 ♗xf7+ ♔e7 22 ♘ec5! ♘xc5 23 ♖xd6 ♕xd6 24 ♖xe5+ ♔d8 25 ♘xc5 +–.

18 ♗f2! ♕xf2

Not 18...♗c5? (18...♕c6 19 ♗f3 ♘xf3 20 ♖xe6+ +–) 19 ♗xc5 ♘xc5 (19...♕xc5 20 ♕xe6+ ♔d8 {20...♕e7 21 ♗h5+ ♔d8 22 ♖xd7+ ♕xd7 23 ♕xe5 +–} 21 ♗xb5 axb5 22 ♖xe5 +–) 20 ♗h5+ ♘f7 21 b4 0-0 22 ♗xf7+ ♖xf7 23 ♕xh6 ♘a4 24 ♘xa4 bxa4 25 ♖xe6 +–.

19 ♕xe6+ ♔d8

20 ♗xb5

and now:

1) **20...axb5** 21 ♖xe5 ♗c8 (or 21...♖h7 22 ♘xb5 {22 ♖f5? ♖a6!} ♕f4+ {22...♖e7 23 ♖xd7+} 23 ♔b1 ♕xe5 24 ♕xe5 +–) 22 ♘xb5! ♗b4 23 ♖ed5 ♖a7 24 ♘xa7 ♕xa7 25 ♕f6+ ♔c7 26 ♕xh8 ♕xa2 27 c3 ♕a1+ 28 ♔c2 ♕a4+ 29 ♔b1 +– Goth-Smrcka, corr 1984.

2) **20...♕xe1** 21 ♖xe1 axb5 (after 21...♖h7 22 ♗xd7 ♘xd7 23 ♘d5 ♗xd5 24 ♕xd5 ♖b8 25 ♖f1 ♔c7, as in Sauermann-Partikas, corr 1990, White could have won by 26 ♕c4+ ♗c5 {26...♔d8 27 ♕g8; 26...♔b6 27 ♕d3 ♖g7 28 ♖xf8} 27 ♖f5 ♔b6 28 ♖xc5 ♘xc5 29 ♕b4+ +–) 22 ♖xe5 ♘xe5 (22...♗b4 23 ♖xb5 ♖e8 24 ♕xh6 +–) 23 ♕xe5! ♖g8 (23...♖h7 24 ♕f5 +–), Sauermann-Sokolovsky, corr 1977 and Atanasov-Pasev, corr 1989. In both these games 24 ♘d5 eventually led to a white win, but the simplest line is 24 ♕f6+ ♔d7 25 ♕f5+ ♔d6 (25...♔e7 26 ♕xb5 +–; 25...♔d8 26 ♕f7 +–) 26 ♘xb5+ ♔e7 27 ♕e5+ +–.

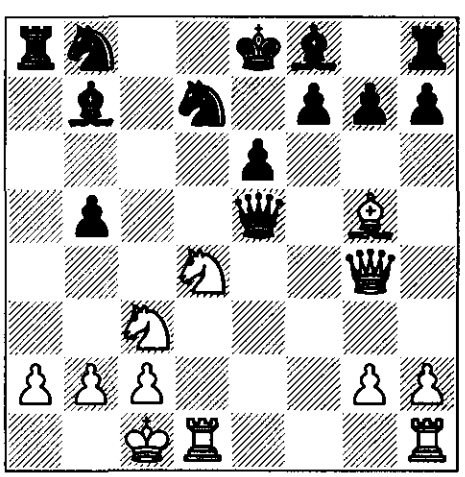
The conclusion is that the line with 12 ♕g4 ♕b6 favours White.

C)

12 ♕g4 ♕xe5

13 ♗xb5 axb5 *(D)*

13...h5 14 ♗xd7+ ♘xd7 15 ♕h4 and 13...h6 14 ♘xe6 are very good for White.



14 ♖he1

A major alternative is **14 ♘cxb5** and now:

1) **14...h5?** 15 ♘c7+! ♕xc7 16 ♘xe6 ♕e5 17 ♘c7+ ♕xc7 18 ♕e2+ ♘e5 19 ♕xe5+ and wins, a trap which has claimed at least four victims to date.

2) **14...♘a6?** 15 ♖he1 h5 16 ♕h4 ♕c5 17 ♘xe6 transposes to line 2a in note to White's 16th below.

3) **14...f5** 15 ♕h4 ♘a6 (15...♖xa2 leads to line 4 below; 15...♔f7 16 ♖he1 ♗e4 17 g4 ♖xa2 18 ♔b1 ♖a4 19 gxf5 exf5 ∓ Cassar-Gemmell, corr 1991 is simple and strong) 16 ♖he1 (16 ♗f4 ♕c5 17 ♘xe6 ♕xb5 18 ♖he1 ♗e4 19 ♘xf8 ♔xf8 20 ♗d6+ ♔g8 21 ♖xe4 fxe4 22 ♕xe4 ♔f7! −+) ♗e4 17 g4 (17 ♘c3 ♘dc5 18 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 19 ♘f3, Serrano-Badals, corr 1982, 19...♕a5! 20 ♖xe4 fxe4 21 ♕xe4 ♘c5 22 ♕c6+ ♔f7 23 ♘e5+ ♔g8 ∓) ♖c8 (17...♗b4? 18 gxf5 ♗xe1 19 ♖xe1 ♘dc5? 20 ♗f4 ♕d5 21 ♗d6 +− Georgiev-Soylu, Istanbul 1980) 18 gxf5 exf5 19 ♘a7 ♖c4 20 ♕h5+ g6 21 ♕e2 ♕c5 22 ♘ab5 ♘b4 wins for Black, Pereira-Jaschelin, corr 1988.

4) **14...♖xa2** 15 ♔b1 and now:

4a) **15...f5** 16 ♕h4 (16 ♕h3? ♖a6 17 ♖he1 ♗e4 18 g4 ♗b4 −+ Fedorowicz-Gralka, Hastings 1976/7, the difference being that after ♕h3 White lacks ♗f4) ♖a5 17 ♗f4 ♕f6 18 ♗g5 ♕e5 (18...♕g6 19 ♘xe6 is dangerous) with a draw.

4b) **15...h5** (risky) 16 ♕h4 ♖a4 (16...♖a5 17 ♗f4 ♗e7 18 ♕g3 h4 19 ♕c3 ♖xb5 20 ♗xe5 ♖xe5 21 ♖he1 ♖xe1 22 ♖xe1 ♗f6 23 ♕b4 ∞ Van Riemsdijk-Verduga, Lone Pine 1978) 17 ♖de1! ♕c5 18 ♘xe6 fxe6 19 ♕xa4 ♕xg5 20 ♘c7+ ♔f7 21 ♖hf1+ ♔g8? (21...♔g6 ∞) 22 ♘xe6 ♕d5 23 ♘xf8 ♗c6 24 ♕f4 g5 25 ♕f2 ♘c5 26 ♘g6 1-0 Forster-Löffler, Biel 1991.

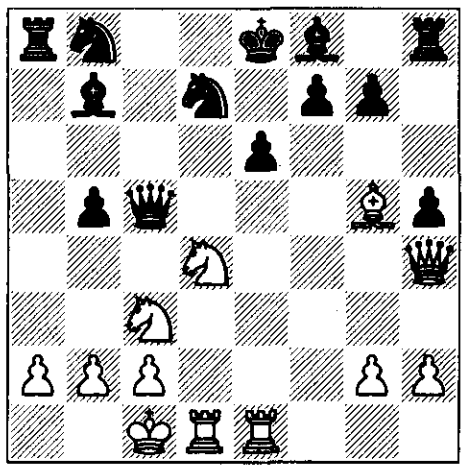
5) **14...♘f6** 15 ♗xf6 gxf6 16 ♖he1 ♕g5+ 17 ♕xg5 fxg5 18 ♘f5! ♘d7 19 ♘fd6+ ♗xd6 20 ♘xd6+ ♔e7 21 ♘xb7 ♖hb8 is about equal.

6) **14...♗e7** 15 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 16 ♖he1 ♕f6, Botoechov-Soetin, corr 1979, 17 ♘xe6! fxe6 18 ♖xe6+ ♕xe6 19 ♕xg7+ ♔d8 20 ♕xh8+ ♕e8 21 ♕f6+ ♕e7 22 ♕b6+ ♔e8 23 ♕xb7 and White wins.

14 ... h5

15 ♕h4 ♕c5 *(D)*

Not 15...♕c7?! 16 ♘cxb5 ♕b6 (16...♕a5 17 ♘xe6 fxe6 18 ♖xe6+ ♔f7 19 ♕c4 1-0 Ljiljak-Goddard, corr 1968) 17 ♕f4 ♗e7 18 ♘xe6 f6 19 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 20 ♖xd6 ♕a5 21 ♘xg7+ ♔d8 22 ♗xf6+ ♔c8 23 ♗c3 1-0 Przybisky-Mierzejewsky, corr 1974.



16 ♘cxb5

Or:

1) **16 ♘dxb5** ♘a6 (16...♗xg2? 17 ♕g3 +−) 17 ♕f4 (17 ♗e3 ♕c6 18 ♕f4 ♘f6 19 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 20 ♖xd6 ♕c8 21 ♗d4 ♖h6 22 ♗b6 ♘d7 23

♗d4 ♖g6 24 ♖f1 ♘f6 25 ♗b6 ♖g4 26 ♕e5 ♕c4 ∓ Berecz-Papp, Szeged 1993) ♗c6 18 b4 ♕xb4 19 ♖d4 ♕c5 (19...♕a5 20 ♖a4 ♕xb5 21 ♘xb5 ♗xb5 probably transposes) 20 ♖c4 ♕xb5! 21 ♘xb5 ♗xb5 22 ♖ce4 ♗a3+ 23 ♔d1 ♘ac5 24 ♖4e3 f6 25 ♕f3, Chapin-Boll, corr 1980, and now 25...0-0-0! gives Black a decisive attack.

2) **16 ♕g3** and now:

2a) **16...♘a6?** 17 ♘xe6 fxe6 18 ♖xe6+ ♔f7 19 ♖xd7+ ♔xe6 20 ♖xb7 ♗d6 21 ♗f4! ♘c7 (21...♗xf4+ 22 ♕xf4 ♖hf8 23 ♕e4+ ♕e5 24 ♖e7+ or 21...g5 22 ♗xd6 ♕xd6 23 ♕e3+ wins for White) 22 ♗xd6 ♕xd6 23 ♖b6! ♕xb6 24 ♕g6+ +– Stean-Ungureanu, Netanya 1976.

2b) **16...♗e7?** (also not 16...♗d6? 17 ♘xe6 +–) 17 ♘xe6! fxe6 18 ♖xe6 ♘c6 19 ♘d5 0-0 20 ♘xe7+ ♘xe7 21 ♖xe7 +–.

2c) **16...b4?** (also a bad idea) 17 ♘cb5 ♘a6 18 ♘xe6 fxe6 19 ♖xe6+ ♔f7 20 ♖xd7+ ♔xe6 21 ♕h3+ ♔e5 22 ♘d4 ♕xd4 23 ♕g3+ ♔e6 24 ♖xd4 ± Tramacere-de Vuyst, corr 1989.

2d) **16...♘f6** 17 ♘cxb5 ♘a6 18 ♖e5 ♕b6? (18...♘d5 is much better as 19 ♘xe6 fxe6 20 ♖xe6+ ♔f7 21 ♖f1+ ♔g8 22 ♕f3 is answered by 22...♘f6 23 ♕xb7 ♖b8!) 19 ♘xe6! fxe6 20 ♘d6+! ♗xd6 (20...♔e7 21 ♗e3) 21 ♖xe6+ ♔f7 22 ♖exd6 ♗c6 23 ♗xf6, Herbrechtsmeier-Schuh, Germany 1978, and White has the advantage since 23...gxf6 allows 24 ♖xf6+! ♔xf6 25 ♖d6+ and White forces mate.

2e) **16...g6** 17 ♘cxb5 ♕xg5+ 18 ♕xg5 ♗h6 19 ♘d6+ ♔f8 20 ♕xh6+ ♖xh6 21 ♘xb7 ♖xa2 22 ♔b1 ±.

2f) **16...h4** 17 ♗xh4 (17 ♕g4 ♖a6 18 ♘dxb5 ♖c6 19 ♖d5 ♕b6 20 ♘d4 ♘f6 21 ♗xf6 gxf6 22 ♖b5 ♕a6 23 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 ∞ Tarrio Hernandez-Rubio, corr 1983) ♖xh4 (Black must not allow ♖xe6+ or ♘xe6 followed by mate on g6) 18 ♕xh4 b4 19 ♘e4 ♗xe4 20 ♕xe4 ♖xa2 ∓.

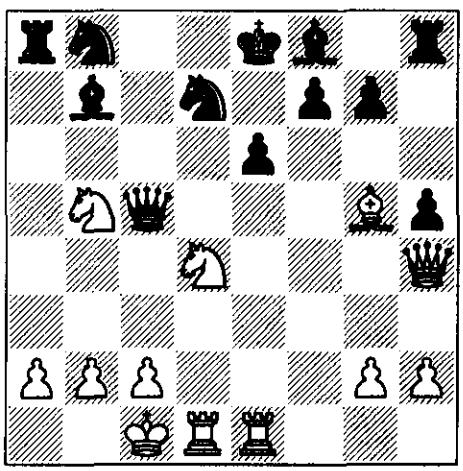
2g) **16...♗c6** and now:

2g1) **17 ♗f4** ♗e7 18 ♖xe6 0-0 19 ♘b3 (19 ♗h6 ♗g5+ 20 ♗xg5 fxe6 21 ♘xe6 ♕f2 22 ♘xf8 ♕xg3 23 hxg3 ♔xf8 ∓ Vennix-Boll, corr 1978) ♕xc3 20 ♕xc3 fxe6 ½-½ Wahls-Brunner, Bern Z 1990.

2g2) **17 h4** b4 18 ♕h3! (18 ♕d3 ♖h6! ∓) ♖h6 19 ♘xe6 fxe6 20 ♖xe6+ ♔f7 (20...♖xe6 21 ♕xe6+ ♗e7 22 ♘d5 ♗xd5 23 ♖xd5 ♕g1+ 24 ♖d1 ♕c5 is equal) 21 ♖xh6 gxh6 22 ♖f1+ ♔g7 23 ♕e6 hxg5 24 ♕f7+ ½-½ Scherfke-Brodhuhn, corr 1979.

In the complex position arising after 16 ♘cxb5 *(D)* there is a divergence of opinion:

B



16 ... ♖xa2!

Polugaevsky's recommendation is the most effective move. Others:

1) **16...♘a6?** 17 ♘xe6 fxe6 18 ♖xe6+ ♔f7 19 ♖xd7+ ♔xe6 20 ♕h3+ ♕f5 (20...♔e5 21 ♗e3 ♕c4

22 ♗d4+ ♔f4 23 ♕g3+ ♔f5 24 ♕e5+ ♔g6 25 ♖xg7+ forces mate) 21 ♘d4+ ♔xd7 22 ♕xf5+ ♔c7 23 ♗f4+ ♔d8 24 ♘e6+ ♔e7 25 ♘g5 wins for White.

2) **16...e5** is risky but no clear-cut refutation is visible. Neither **17 ♖xe5+** ♘xe5 18 ♘b3 ♕c8 19 ♖d8+ ♕xd8 20 ♗xd8 ♘a6 nor **17 b4** ♕b6 18 ♗d8 g5! 19 ♗xb6 gxh4 20 ♘c7+ ♔e7 21 ♘xa8 ♗xa8 offers White any advantage. At first I thought that I had found an incredible forced win by **17 ♘c6!** ♘a6 (17...♕xb5 18 ♖xe5+ ♕xe5 19 ♘xe5 ♖xa2 20 ♔b1 +–; 17...f5 18 ♘xe5! ♘xe5 19 ♕f4 ♘bd7 20 ♕xf5 ♗e7 21 ♖xd7 ♗xg5+ 22 ♔b1 also wins) 18 ♘xe5! ♘xe5 (18...♕xe5 19 ♕d4 +–) 19 ♘c7+! ♘xc7 (19...♕xc7 20 ♖xe5+ ♕xe5 21 ♕a4+) 20 ♕a4+! ♘b5 21 ♕xa8+ ♗xa8 22 ♖d8#. However, 17...f6! brought me down to earth, when 18 ♘c7+ ♔f7 19 ♘xb8 ♘xb8 20 ♘xa8 ♗xa8 is roughly equal.

3) **16...♗d5** and now:

3a) **17 b4** ♕c4 (17...♕b6 is also promising) 18 ♕f4 ♘a6! 19 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 20 ♕xd6 ♕xb4! 21 ♕xd5 ♕a3+ 22 ♔b1 0-0 23 ♕xd7 ♘c5 and Black wins.

3b) **17 ♖d3** ♘a6 18 a3 ♕b6 (18...♖b8!?) 19 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 20 ♖xe6+ ♕xe6 (after 20...fxe6 21 ♕e4 Black loses a rook but maintains an extra piece; 21...♘e5 and 21...♘f6 are feasible continuations) 21 ♖e3 ♕xe3+ 22 ♗xe3 is Torre-Mariotti, Manila 1976. Polugaevsky and Stean assess this position as good for White, Van der Vliet as unclear. The game eventually ended in a draw, but the impression was that Black had difficulties.

3c) **17 ♘xe6** ♗xe6 18 ♖d5 and in Babiak-Müller, corr 1991 White won after 18...♕c6? 19 ♕f4 ♗e7 20 ♘d6+ ♔f8 21 ♗xe7+ ♔g8 22 ♖xe6! +–. The critical line is 18...♕c8 19 ♕f4 ♘a6 20 ♖d6 (20 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 21 ♕xd6 ♘f6) ♘f6 21 ♖xa6 ♖xa6 22 ♘c7+ ♔d7, when White's attack appears insufficient.

17 ♔b1

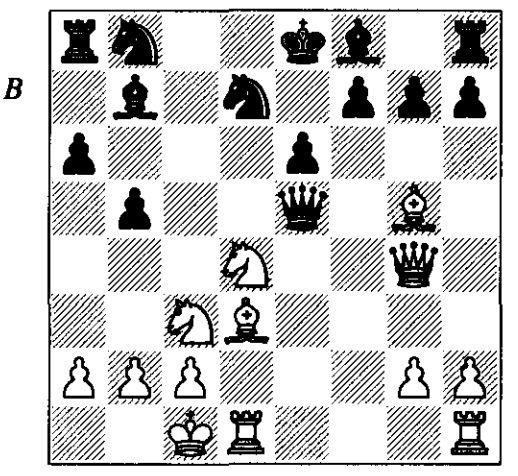
Now 17...♗d5! (after 17...♖a5 or 17...♖a6 White obtains a dangerous attack with 18 ♕f4) 18 ♖e3 (18 ♖d3 ♕b6 19 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 20 ♕c4 ♖a1+ 21 ♔xa1 ♕a5+ –+; 18 ♕g3 ♘a6 19 ♘c3 ♕a5 20 ♘xa2 ♕xa2+ 21 ♔c1 ♕a1+ 22 ♔d2 ♕xb2 –+ Marein-Hjermundet, corr 1981) ♕b6 19 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 (19...♖xb2+ 20 ♔xb2 ♕xb5+ 21 ♖b3 ♕xb3+ 22 cxb3 fxe6 ∞) 20 ♕c4 ♗c5! 21 ♖d6 0-0! 22 ♖exe6 ♕a5! 23 ♕xa2 ♕xb5 gives Black a winning position.

The conclusion is that the sacrifice on b5 gives White a draw at best.

D)

12 ♕g4 ♕xe5

13 ♗d3 *(D)*



B

13 ... h6

The alternatives are weaker:

1) **13...h5?** 14 ♕xe6+ ♕xe6 15 ♘xe6 +–.

2) **13...f5?** 14 ♘xf5 exf5 15 ♗xf5 also wins.

3) **13...♗e7** 14 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 15 ♖he1 h5 16 ♘f5+ ♔f8 17 ♕h4 g5 18 ♕xg5 ♕f6 19 ♕xf6 ♘xf6 was the game Steingrimsson-Van Wely, Reykjavik 1994, and now 20 ♗e4! ♘c6 21 ♘d6 ♘xe4 22 ♘cxe4 ±.

4) **13...♘f6** 14 ♗xf6! (Black has problems after this powerful move) gxf6 (14...♕xf6 15 ♖he1 h5 16 ♘xe6! hxg4 17 ♗xb5+ ♔e7 18 ♘xf8+ ♕e6 19 ♘xe6 fxe6 20 ♗c4 +– Felling-Lindblom, Geustal 1971, or 16...♗e7 17 ♗xb5+ axb5 18 ♘c7+ ♔f8 19 ♖d8+) 15 ♗f5 h5 (15...♕e3+ 16 ♔b1 h5 17 ♘xe6! ♕xe6 18 ♕d4 ♘c6 19 ♕d7+! +–; 15...exf5 16 ♘xf5 +–; 15...♗h6+ 16 ♔b1 ♕f4 17 ♘xe6 ♕xg4 18 ♘c7+ ♔f8 19 ♗xg4 ♖a7 20 ♖d8+ ♔g7 21 ♘e8+ +–) 16 ♕h3 ♗c5 (16...♗e7 17 ♖he1 ♕f4+ 18 ♔b1 exf5 19 ♘xf5 ♘c6 20 ♘d5 +–) 17 ♖he1 ♕f4+ 18 ♔b1 ♗xd4 19 ♗xe6! ♗xc3 (19...fxe6 20 ♕xe6+ ♔f8 21 ♕e8+ or 19...♗e5 20 ♘d5 ♕g5 21 ♕a3! ♘c6 {21...♗xd5 22 ♗xd5 ♖a7 23 ♕c5 ♖d7 24 ♗c6 +–} 22 ♘c7+ ♗xc7 23 ♗d7+ ♔d8 24 ♗f5+) 20 bxc3 0-0, Tukmakov-Anikaev, USSR Ch ½f 1969, and now 21 ♗xf7+! ♖xf7 (21...♔xf7 22 ♕xh5+ ♔g8 23 ♕g6+ ♔h8 24 ♖e7) 22 ♖e8+ ♔g7 (22...♖f8 23 ♕e6+ ♔g7 24 ♖xf8) 23 ♖dd8 with a very dangerous attack, for example:

4a) **23...♗e4** 24 ♕xh5 ♗h7 25 ♖h8 ♕f5 26 ♖dg8+ +–.

4b) **23...♘c6** 24 ♖g8+ ♔h6 25 ♖h8+ ♖h7 26 ♖xh7+ ♔xh7 27 ♕xh5+ +–.

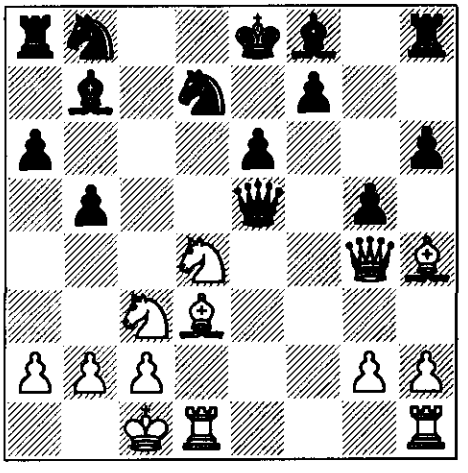
4c) **23...♔g6** 24 ♕d3+ f5 25 g3 ♕c7 (25...♕g5 26 ♕d4 ♕xd8 27 ♖xd8 ♘c6 28 ♖d6+ ♔h7 29 ♕h4 ±) 26 ♕d4 ♖g7 27 ♖e6+ ♔h7 28 ♕e3 ♕xd8 29 ♖h6+ ♔g8 30 ♕e6+ ♖f7 31 ♕g6+ ♖g7 32 ♕xh5 ♖h7 33 ♖xh7 ♕f6 34 ♖h6 ±.

4d) **23...♗c6** 24 ♖g8+ ♔h6 25 g4 ♕e5 26 ♕d3! ♕e1+ 27 ♔b2 ♗e4 28 g5+ and wins.

14 ♗h4

14 ♘xe6 hxg5 15 ♖de1 (vacating d1 for the queen; 15 ♖he1 ♖h4! 16 ♕xh4 gxh4 17 ♖xe5 ♘xe5 18 ♘c7+ ♔e7 19 ♘xa8 ♗xa8 ∓) ♖h4 16 ♕d1 fxe6 17 ♖xe5 (17 ♗g6+ ♔e7 18 ♖xe5 ♘xe5 19 ♕d2 ♖f4 ∓ Gruchacz-Van der Vliet, Brighton 1980) ♘xe5 is assessed as ∓ by Polugaevsky. Meštrović-Planinc, Čačak 1969, continued 18 ♕e2 (18 ♖e1 ♘bc6 19 ♕e2 0-0-0 ∓ Gola-Gadourek, corr 1980) ♘bd7 19 ♗e4 0-0-0 20 g3 ♖xe4 21 ♘xe4 ♘f6 22 ♘xg5 ♗xh1 23 ♕xe5 ♗d6 24 ♕xe6+ ♔b8 ∓.

14 ... g5 *(D)*



15 ♘xe6

There is a major divergence here:

1) **15 ♗g3** ♕e3+ and now:

1a) **16 ♖d2** h5 17 ♕d1 ♕xd4 18 ♗xb5 ♕b6 (18...♕g4 19 ♗xd7+

♘xd7 20 ♖xd7 ♕xd1+ 21 ♖hxd1 ♗xg2 22 ♗e5 ♖h6 23 ♖c7, Lea-Waerstad, corr 1979 gives White fair play for the pawn; 18...♕xd2+ 19 ♕xd2 axb5 20 ♘xb5 ♘a6 21 ♖f1 f5 22 ♗d6 ♗c6 ∞ Hacker-Jancić, corr 1982) 19 ♗xd7+ ♘xd7 20 ♖xd7 ♖d8 (20...♗xg2 21 ♖e1 ♖d8 22 ♖xd8+ ♕xd8 23 ♕e2 ♗b7 24 ♕e5 ∞) 21 ♖xd8+ ♕xd8 22 ♕e2 ♗g7 23 ♗e5 f6 24 ♖d1 ♕c8 25 ♗d6 ♔f7 = Vuori-Makinen, corr 1982.

1b) **16 ♔b1** h5 17 ♖he1 ♕xe1 (17...hxg4 18 ♖xe3 ♘c5 19 ♘cxb5 axb5 20 ♗xb5+ ♘bd7 21 b4 0-0-0 22 ♖c3 ♗xg2 ∞) 18 ♕xg5 ♗h6 (after 18...♗e7 19 ♕c1! ♕xd1 20 ♕xd1 ♗xg2 21 ♕d2! White has a dangerous initiative, for example 21...♗b7 22 ♘xe6! fxe6 23 ♗g6+ ♔f8 {or 23...♔d8 24 ♘d5} 24 ♗xb8 ♘f6 25 ♗e5 +–) and now:

1b1) **19 ♕h4** (suggested in *The Najdorf for the Tournament Player*, but still untested, so here is some more tempting analysis) ♕e3 20 ♘xe6 ♕xe6 (20...fxe6 21 ♗g6+ ♔f8 22 ♖f1+ ♔g7 23 ♕e7+ ♔xg6 24 ♕f7+ ♔g5 25 ♗f4+ ♕xf4 26 ♕xf4+ ♔g6 and now White can mate in five) 21 ♖e1 ♗e3 (after 21...♕xe1+ 22 ♗xe1 White's queen is better placed than in line 1b2) 22 ♘e4!? (22 ♘d1 is also possible) and White retains a dangerous attack, for example 22...♗xe4 23 ♖xe3 ♘f6 24 ♗xe4 ♔f8 25 ♗f4 ♘xe4 26 ♖xe4 ♕d5 27 ♕e7+ ♔g8 28 ♖e5 +–.

1b2) **19 ♕xh5** ♕e3 20 ♘xe6 ♕xe6 21 ♖e1 ♕xe1+ 22 ♗xe1 ♗g7 23 ♕g4 ♔f8! (23...0-0? 24 ♕h4 ♖e8 25 ♘e4 ♖e6 26 ♘g5 ♖h6 27 ♗h7+ ♔f8 28 ♘e6+! fxe6 29 ♗b4+ 1-0 Litvinov-Zarenkov, Minsk 1973) 24 ♗g3 (24 ♘e4 ♖h6 25 ♗b4+ ♔g8 26 ♗c3 ♖g6 27 ♘g5 ♘f6 ± Lanka-Feldman, corr 1977, but 24...♖xh2! 25 ♗b4+ ♔g8 26 c3 ♘e5 27 ♕g3 ♖h1+ 28 ♔c2 ♘bd7 ∓ is given by Konikowski; 24 h4 ♘f6 25 ♕f4 ♘bd7 26 g4 ♖e8 27 ♗f2 ♘e5 28 ♗f5 ♘d5 ∓ Timmerman-Van der Drift, corr 1987) ♘f6 25 ♕b4+ ♔g8 26 a4 ♗xg2! 27 axb5 axb5 28 ♘xb5 ♘c6 and Black is clearly better, Bogner-Rogalewicz, corr 1978.

2) **15 ♖de1** h5 16 ♕xg5 ♗h6 (16...♕xe1+? 17 ♖xe1 ♗h6 18 ♕xh6 ♖xh6 19 ♘f5 wins) 17 ♘xe6 transposes to the main line.

3) **15 ♖he1** h5 (not 15...♕f4+ 16 ♕xf4 gxf4 17 ♖xe6+ nor 15...♘f6 16 ♕h3 ♕f4+ 17 ♔b1 ♕xh4 18 ♖xe6+) with the branch:

3a) **16 ♕h3?** ♕f4+ 17 ♔b1 ♕xh4 (17...gxh4? 18 ♘xe6 fxe6 19 ♕xe6+ ♔d8 20 ♗xb5! ♔c7 {20...axb5? 21 ♕b6+ ♕c7 22 ♕f6+ mates} 21 ♗xd7 ♖h6 22 ♘d5+ ♗xd5 23 ♕xd5 wins for White) 18 ♖xe6+ and now 18...fxe6?! gave White good swindling chances in Thipsay-Hodgson, British Ch 1984. However, 18...♔d8 wins, e.g. 19 ♕e3 fxe6 (19...♗c5 is also good) 20 ♘xe6+ ♔c8 21 ♗xb5 axb5 22 ♕b6 ♗d6! 23 ♕xd6 ♕c4 24 ♖d4 ♕c6 25 ♘xb5 ♖a5! and White's attack collapses.

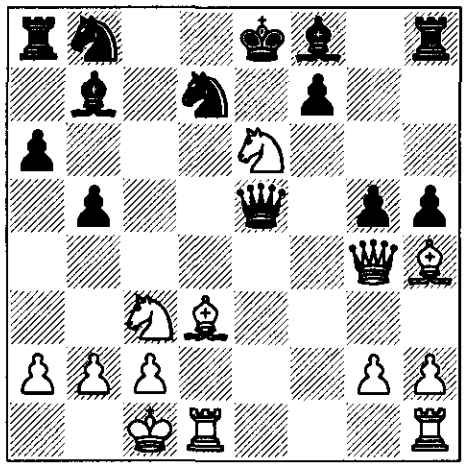
3b) **16 ♕xg5** (objectively best) ♗h6 17 ♖xe5 (17 ♘xe6 leads to the main line) ♘xe5 18 ♗xb5+ axb5 19 ♕xh6 ♖xh6 20 ♘f5 ♘bd7 21 ♘xh6 ♗xg2 22 ♘xb5 ♖xa2 23 ♔b1 ♖a4 =.

15 ... h5! *(D)*

Not 15...fxe6? 16 ♖he1 +–.

16 ♕h3!

This move puts the whole variation in a new light. The older line **16**



♕xg5 (16 ♘c7+ ♔d8 17 ♕h3 ♕f4+ 18 ♔b1 ♕xh4 19 ♕xh4 gxh4 20 ♘xa8 ♗xa8 ∓) **♗h6** is just bad for White:

1) **17 ♖he1** fxe6 (17...♕xe1 18 ♖xe1 ♗xg5+ 19 ♘xg5+ ±) 18 ♗g6+ ♔f8 19 ♖f1+ ♕f6! (19...♔g8 20 ♗f7+ ♔h7 21 ♗g6+ ½-½ Dueball-Kerr, Skopje OL 1972) 20 ♖xf6+ (Black also comes out material up after other moves) ♘xf6 21 ♖f1! (the only chance; 21 ♖d8+ ♔g7 22 ♖xh8 ♗xg5+ 23 ♗xg5 ♔xg6 –+) ♘bd7 22 ♗e4 and White retains some slight drawing chances in the resulting ending, despite being the exchange for a pawn down.

2) **17 ♖de1** fxe6 (this is better than 17...♗xg5+ {not 17...♕xe6? 18 ♖xe6+ fxe6 19 ♗g6+, which really does win for White} 18 ♘xg5 0-0 19 ♖xe5 ♘xe5 20 ♗f5 ♘g6 21 ♗g3 ♘c6 22 ♗d6 ♖fd8 23 ♗c7 ± Ljubojević-Mariotti, Manila 1976; White has good compensation for his small material deficit) 18 ♗g6+ ♔f8 19 ♖hf1+ ♕f6! 20 ♕xh6+ (20 ♖xf6+ ♘xf6 21 ♖f1 transposes to line 1) ♖xh6 21 ♗xf6 ♖xg6 22 ♖xe6 ♘xf6 23 ♖fxf6+ ♖xf6 24 ♖xf6+ ♔g7 with excellent winning chances for Black, Vegemaa-Kois, USSR 1979.

16 ... ♗h6

16...fxe6 (16...g4? 17 ♘c7+ ♕xc7 18 ♖he1+ ♘e5 19 ♗xb5+ axb5 20 ♖xe5+ ♗e7 21 ♕g3 1-0 Avolio-Montanelli, corr 1983) 17 ♖he1 ♕f4+ 18 ♔b1 ♕g4 (not 18...gxh4? 19 ♕xe6+ transposing into the bracket after Black's 17th move in line 3a of the note to White's 15th move; 18...♖h6 19 ♖xe6+ ♔d8?? 20 g3 1-0 Majewski-Rogalewicz, corr 1993) 19 ♖xe6+ ♔d8 20 ♕xg4 hxg4 21 ♗xg5+ ♔c7 22 ♗f4+ ♔d8 23 ♗f5! ♗xg2 24 ♘d5 ♗xd5 25 ♖xd5 ♗e7, Sarink-Boll, corr 1990, 26 ♗xb8! ♖xb8 27 ♖xa6 ♖xh2 28 ♖xd7+ ♔e8 29 ♗xg4 and White wins.

17 ♔b1

Alternatively:

1) **17 ♗xg5** ♗xg5+ 18 ♘xg5 (18 ♔b1 fxe6 19 ♖he1 ♕g7 –+) ♕xg5+ 19 ♔b1 ♗xg2 forces the queens off.

2) **17 ♘xg5** (untested, but in my view promising) ♗xg5+ 18 ♔b1 ♗xh4 19 ♕xh4 ♕f6 20 ♖he1+ ♔f8 21 ♕b4+ ♔g7 22 ♘e4! with a very dangerous attack.

17 ... g4

17...fxe6? 18 ♖he1 g4 19 ♗g6+ ♔f8 20 ♕d3 +–.

18 ♘c7+!

Not 18 ♕g3 ♕xg3 19 hxg3 fxe6 ∓.

18 ... ♕xc7

18...♔f8 19 ♕g3 ♗f4 (19...♕xg3 20 ♗xg3 ♖a7 21 ♗f2 +–) 20 ♘e6+ fxe6 21 ♖hf1 ♗f3 22 ♖xf3! gxf3 23 ♕xf3 ♔g7 24 ♕xa8 +– Smolka-Zdenek, corr 1993.

19 ♖he1+ ♔f8

Not, however, 19...♘e5 20 ♕g3 ♗g7 (20...♘bd7 21 ♗f5 wins for White) 21 ♗xb5+ ♘bc6 22 ♘d5 ♕b8 23 ♘f6+ +–.

20 ♗e7+ ♔g8

and now 21 ♕xh5 ♗g7 22 ♕g5 (22 ♕xg4 ♘e5 23 ♕g5 ♘bd7 24 ♗f5 ♖h6 ∞) ♘c6 (22...♕xh2 23 ♗d6 ♕xd6 24 ♗h7+ ±; 22...♖h6 23 ♗f5 ♗c6 24 ♗d8 ♕b7 25 ♘e4 ♗xe4 26 ♖xe4 f6 27 ♖e8+ ♘f8 28 ♕xg4 +–) 23 ♗f5 ♘ce5 24 ♗d6 ♕d8 (24...♕b6 25 ♖xe5 ♘xe5 26 ♗xe5 f6 27 ♕xg4 1-0 Mendes-Ribeiro, Portugal 1988) 25 ♕xd8+ ♖xd8 26 ♗xe5 ♗xe5 27 ♖xe5 ♘xe5 28 ♖xd8+ ♔g7 29 ♖xh8 ♔xh8 ± Magnusson-Kristinsson, corr 1990.

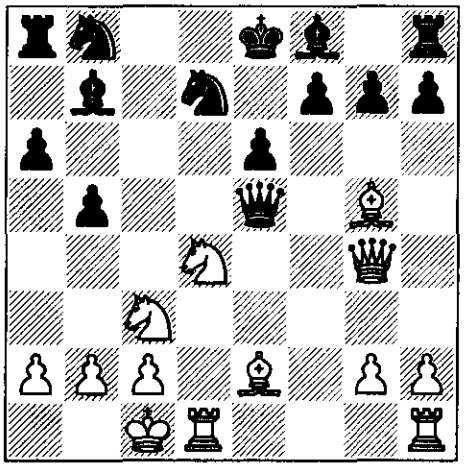
At one time this line was held to be good for Black, whereas now the opposite opinion looks nearer the truth. The main line above is very promising, and White can also investigate alternatives such as line 1b in the note to White's 15th move and line 2 in the note to White's 17th.

E)

12 ♕g4 ♕xe5

13 ♗e2 *(D)*

B



By restricting his material investment to a mere pawn White forces Black to survive a long period of difficult defence, whereas in other lines Black has only to survive the immediate holocaust in order to win. The practical results with this line are very much in White's favour.

13 ... ♗c5

Other moves:

1) **13...b4** 14 ♗f3! ♗xf3 (the alternative 14...bxc3 15 ♗xb7 ♖a7 16 ♖he1 is also dangerous) 15 ♘xf3 ♕c5 16 ♘e4 followed by ♖he1 with strong pressure.

2) **13...h6** 14 ♗f4 (possible as the knight on d4 is defended by the rook in this line) ♕f6 (14...♕c5 15 ♘xe6 fxe6 16 ♕xe6+ ♗e7 17 ♗xb8 ♘xb8 18 ♕g6+ ♔f8 19 ♖hf1+ ♗f6 20 ♖xf6+ gxf6 21 ♕xf6+ ♔e8 1-0 Pax-Karnaoukh, Kettig 1994; 14...h5 15 ♕g3 ♕c5 16 ♘xe6! fxe6 17 ♕g6+ ♔d8 18 ♕xe6 ♗c6 19 ♗f3 ♗xf3 20 gxf3 ♕c4 21 ♖xd7+ ♘xd7 22 ♗g5+ ♔c8 23 ♘d5 +–) 15 ♖hf1 e5 16 ♗e3 ♕b6 17 ♘f5 ♕g6 18 ♕xg6 fxg6 19 ♘h4 ± Damele-Montanelli, corr 1983.

3) **13...♘f6** 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 (after 14...♕xf6 15 ♘cxb5! White wins, e.g. 15...axb5 16 ♗xb5+ ♔e7 17 ♕g3 e5 18 ♖he1 1-0 Sakharov-Feldman, corr 1977, or 15...♕e5 16 ♖he1 ♗e7 17 ♘c7+! ♕xc7 18 ♘xe6 fxe6 19 ♕xg7 ♕f4+ 20 ♔b1 ♕f7 21 ♕xh8+ ♗f8 22 ♗h5 1-0 Sakharov-Lucker, corr 1982) 15 ♖he1 ♕g5+ (15...h5 16 ♕h3 ♘d7 {or 16...♕g5+ 17 ♔b1 ♗xg2 18 ♗xb5+ axb5 19 ♘xe6!} 17 ♗xb5 ♕f4+ 18 ♔b1 0-0-0 19 ♗c6 ± Torre-Sigurjonsson, Geneva 1977) 16 ♕xg5 fxg5 17 ♗h5 ♔e7 18 ♖f1 f5 (18...f6 19 ♘f5+ leads to mate) 19 ♖fe1 ♗xg2 20 ♖xe6+ ♔d7 21 ♖e2 is winning for White, as in Balinas-Tarjan, Odessa 1976.

4) **13...h5** 14 ♕h4 f6 (14...g6 15 ♗f3 ♖a7 16 ♔b1! {16 ♖he1? ♕xg5+ 17 ♕xg5 ♗h6 18 ♘xe6 fxe6 19 ♖xe6+ ♔f7 20 ♖e7+ ♔g8 21 ♖e8+ =} ♗h6 17 ♗xh6 ♖xh6 18 ♖he1 ♕f6 19 ♕f2 ♖a8 20 ♘e4 ♗xe4 21 ♖xe4 +—) 15 ♗f4 g5 16 ♕xh5+ ♖xh5 17 ♗xh5+ ♔e7 18 ♗xe5 ♘xe5 19 ♗f3 ♘xf3 20 ♘xf3 is better for White, but there are a lot of technical problems ahead in converting the extra exchange into a win, Balashov-Quinteros, Manila IZ 1976.

5) **13...♗b4** 14 ♗f3 (14 ♖he1! looks much more dangerous for Black) ♗xc3 15 ♗xb7 ♗xd4 16 ♖he1 h5 (16...♗xb2+ 17 ♔b1 ♖a7 18 ♖xe5 ♗xe5 19 ♕f3 ±) 17 ♕h4 ♕c5 18 ♕xd4 ♕xd4 19 ♖xd4 ♖a7 20 ♗f3 g6 21 ♖e3 0-0 22 ♖d6 with adequate play for the pawn, Mäki-Abousami, Thessaloniki OL 1988.

14 ♘f3 *(D)*

The theory of this line is still fairly undeveloped, so there is plenty of scope for original play:

1) **14 ♗f3?!** ♗xd4 15 ♗xb7 ♗xc3 16 bxc3 (16 ♗xa8 ♗xb2+ 17 ♔b1 ♗a3 18 ♗c1 ♗xc1 19 ♔xc1 ♘b6 20 ♖he1 ♕a1+ 21 ♔d2 ♕f6 22 ♕f3 ♕h6+ 23 ♔e2 0-0 ∓ Lanc-Verduga, Camaguey 1987) ♖a7 17 ♖he1 h5 (17...♕xc3? 18 ♖xe6+) 18 ♕h4 (18 ♖xe5 hxg4 19 ♖c5 0-0 20 ♖c7 ♘c5! 21 ♖xc5 ♖xb7 ∓ Grigorian-Rogovsky, USSR 1977) ♕xc3 19 ♖d3 (19 ♖e3? ♕a1+ 20 ♔d2 ♕xa2 21 ♕b4 f6! –+ Stean-Sigurjonsson, England v Iceland telex 1977) ♕c4 (19...♕a1+? 20 ♔d2 ♕xa2 21 ♕b4 f6 22 ♗d5 1-0 Fraczkiewicz-Warczynski, corr 1977) 20 ♕g3 0-0 and the burden is on White to prove his compensation for the pawns.

2) **14 ♖he1** is an untested suggestion of Van der Vliet.

3) **14 ♗f4** ♕f6 15 ♗g5 is a draw.

4) **14 ♖hf1** ♗xd4 (14...f5 15 ♘xf5 exf5 16 ♖xf5 +–; 14...0-0 15 ♗f4 ±; 14...♘f6 15 ♗xf6 gxf6 16 ♕g7 ♖f8 17 ♘xe6! ♕xe6 {17...fxe6 18 ♕xh7! +–} 18 ♖fe1 ±) 15 ♖xd4 and now:

4a) **15...0-0** 16 ♖d3 f5 17 ♕h4 b4 (17...♘c5 18 ♖h3 h6 19 ♗xh6 gxh6 20 ♖g3+ wins for White, Dessen-Klein, corr 1987) 18 ♕xb4 ♗xg2 19 ♖g1 ♗e4 (19...♕xh2 20 ♕d4) 20 ♘xe4 fxe4 21 ♖dg3 ♘c6 22 ♕b7! ♖ab8 23 ♕xd7 ♕xb2+ 24 ♔d1 ♘d4 (24...♘b4 25 ♗f6!) 25 ♕xg7+! ♔xg7 26 ♗d8+ ♔h8 27 ♖g8+! ♖xg8 28 ♗f6+ ♖g7 29 ♗xg7+ ♔g8 30 ♗xd4+ ♔f7 31 ♖f1+ ♔e7 32 ♗xb2 1-0 Westerinen-Sigurjonsson, New York 1977.

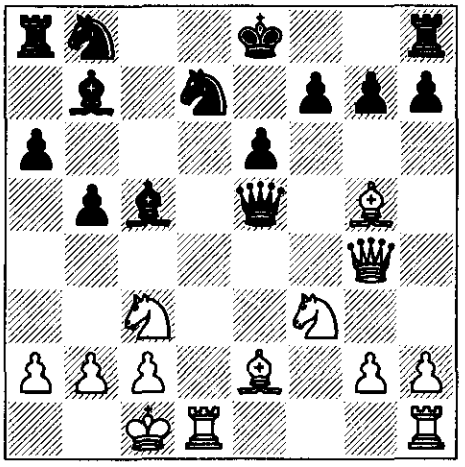
4b) **15...♕xh2** 16 ♗f3 h5 17 ♖xd7! ♔xd7 (17...♘xd7 18 ♕b4 f6 19 ♗xb7 ♖a7 20 ♗f4 ♕h4 21 ♘e4 +–) 18 ♕d4+ ♕d6 19 ♕xg7 ♗xf3 20 ♖xf3 +–.

4c) **15...♘c6** 16 ♖xd7 ♔xd7 17 ♖xf7+ ♔c8 18 ♗f4 is winning for White.

4d) **15...♘f6** is an untested idea of Van der Vliet – one possible line is 16 ♗xf6 gxf6 17 ♘e4 ♗xe4 (17...f5 18 ♕h4) 18 ♖xe4 ♕g5+ 19 ♕xg5 fxg5 20 ♗h5 0-0 21 h4 ±.

4e) **15...f6** 16 ♗d2 (16 ♗f4 ♕xd4 17 ♕xg7 ♖f8 18 ♗h5+ ♔d8 is inadequate; 16 ♗h4 0-0 17 ♖fd1 ♕e3+ 18 ♔b1 f5 19 ♕h5 g6 was good for Black in Timman-Van der Vliet, Dutch Ch 1978) f5 17 ♕h4 0-0 18 ♖d3 ♕f6 19 ♗g5 ♕f7 20 g4 (20 ♗h5 g6 21 ♗f3 ♘e5 22 ♖d6 ♗xf3 23 gxf3 ♘c4 ∓ K.Schneider-Birnbaum,

corr 1987) ♖c8 21 ♔b1 ♘f8, Ponish-Pfeiffer, corr 1989, and now 22 gxf5 exf5 23 ♗f3 ♗xf3 24 ♖dxf3 g6 25 ♘e4 gives White a dangerous attack.


B

14 ... h5

Or:

1) **14...♗e3+** 15 ♔b1 h5 and now:

1a) **16 ♘xe5** hxg4 17 ♘xf7 ♔xf7 18 ♗xe3 ♗xg2 19 ♖hg1 ♗f3 20 ♖df1 ♘e5 21 ♘e4 ♔g8! (21...♖xh2? 22 ♗xf3 gxf3 23 ♗f4 ♖e2 24 ♘g3 ♘ed7 25 ♖xf3 1-0 Dewar-Hariman, corr 1989) 22 ♗xf3 ♘xf3 23 ♖g2 ♘d7 =.

1b) **16 ♕h3** ♕c5 17 ♗xe3 ♕xe3 18 ♖he1 (18 ♖d3!? ♕b6 19 ♖hd1) ♕c5 19 ♘d4! ♖h6? (19...♖a7 ∞) 20 ♗f3 ♗xf3 21 ♕xf3 ♖a7 22 ♘e4 ♕f8 23 ♘c6! ♘xc6 24 ♘d6+ ♔e7 25 ♘f5+ ♔e8 26 ♕xc6 1-0 Zaremba-Muller, corr 1993.

1c) **16 ♕h4** transposes to the main line.

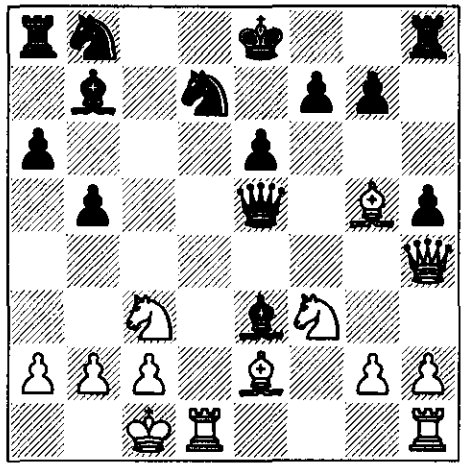
2) **14...♕f5** 15 ♕xf5 exf5 16 ♗d3 f6 17 ♖he1+ ♔d8 (17...♔f7 18 ♗xf5) 18 ♘e5 ♘xe5 19 ♖xe5 ♗b4 20 ♗h4 ♔c7 21 ♖xf5 ±.

3) **14...♕c7** 15 ♗f4 ♕d8 16 ♕xg7 ♕f6 17 ♕g3 ±.

4) **14...♗xf3** 15 ♗xf3 h5 16 ♕h4 ♗e3+ 17 ♗xe3 ♕xe3+ 18 ♔b1 ♖a7 19 ♖he1 ♕h6 20 ♕d4 ♖c7 21 ♕d6 ♖c4 22 ♗d5 +– Maes-Gilles, Belgium 1992.

15 ♕h4 ♗e3+ *(D)*

15...♕c7 is relatively untested. **16 ♖hf1** ♘c6 17 ♔b1 ♘e7 18 ♗f4 e5 19 ♖xd7 ♕xd7 20 ♘xe5 ♕e6 21 ♗g4 ♕f6 left White with insufficient compensation in Mäki-Sorvari, corr 1991, but White has better 16th moves. One idea is **16 ♗f4** ♕b6 (16...e5? 17 ♘xe5 +–; 16...♕d8 17 ♕g3 0-0 18 ♘g5 ±) 17 ♕g5, more or less forcing the weakening 17...g6. **16 ♘e4!?** ♗xe4 (16...f6 17 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 18 ♗d2 ∞) 17 ♕xe4 ♘c6 18 ♖d2 is also worth considering.


W

16 ♔b1

Better than the alternative 16 ♗xe3 ♕xe3+ 17 ♔b1 ♘f6 18 ♖d3 (18 ♖he1 ♕c5 19 g4 ♘bd7 20 ♘g5 ♖c8 21 ♗d3 ♘e5 ∓ Øe-Lassen, corr 1983) ♕c5 (18...♕b6 is similar) 19 ♖hd1 ♘bd7 20 ♘g5 ♕e7 21 ♘ge4 ♗xe4 22 ♘xe4 ♘d5 23 ♕g3 g6 24 ♗f3 ♔f8 25 ♘c3 ♘7f6 26 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 27 ♗xd5 exd5 28 ♖xd5 ♔g7 ± Hjorth-Kelstrup, corr 1981.

16 ... ♗xf3

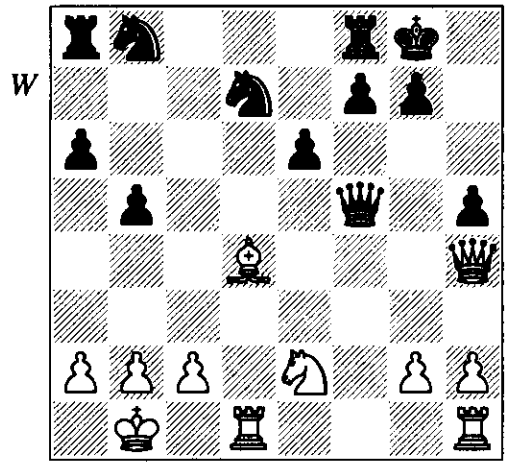
16...♗xg5 17 ♘xg5 is awkward for Black, for example 17...♘f6 18

♖d8+ winning, or 17...♗xg2 18 ♘xf7 ♔xf7 19 ♕f2+ ♘f6 20 ♕xg2 ♘bd7 21 ♖hg1 ±.

17 ♗xe3 ♗xe2
18 ♗d4 ♕f5

Or 18...♗xd1 (18...♕c7 19 ♘xe2 e5 20 ♘c3! exd4 21 ♘d5 ♕d6 22 ♖he1+ ♘e5 23 ♖xe5+ ♕xe5 24 ♖e1 +–) 19 ♗xe5 ♗xc2+ 20 ♔xc2 ♘xe5 21 ♕g5 ♘bc6 (21...♘g6 22 ♘e4 ♘d7 23 ♖f1 ±) 22 ♘e4 ♘d4+ 23 ♔b1 ♘f5 24 ♖d1 ♘g6 25 ♘d6+ ♘xd6 26 ♖xd6 0-0 27 ♕xh5 ± Bryson-Zoltai, corr 1988.

19 ♘xe2 0-0 *(D)*



20 h3 e5
21 ♗c3

Now there are various alternatives, but none looks tempting for Black:

1) **21...♘c6?** 22 ♖d6 b4 (22...♘d4 23 ♗xd4 exd4 24 ♘xd4 +–) 23 ♗d2 (23 ♘g3, Bryson-Gallagher, Nottingham 1987, appears less clear after 23...♕h7! since now 24 ♗d2 may be met by 24...♘d4) ♘db8 24 ♘g3 ♕f2 25 ♗e1 ♕xg2 26 ♖d2 ♕f3 27 ♖f1 ♕e3 28 ♘f5 and White is winning.

2) **21...♕g6** 22 g4 f5 and White has several routes to a clear advantage, for example 23 gxh5 ♕f6 (or else ♖hg1 and ♖g6) 24 ♕f2 with either ♘f4 or ♖hg1 to come, or 23 ♘g3 f4 (23...fxg4 24 ♘xh5 ±) 24 ♘f5 ♕f6 25 ♘e7+ ♔f7 26 ♕xh5+ ♔xe7 27 ♗b4+ ♔d8 28 ♗xf8 ♕xf8 29 ♕xe5.

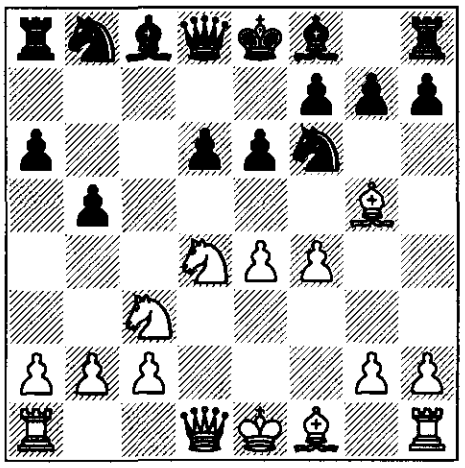
3) **21...♘f6** 22 g4! ♕f3 (22...♕e6 23 gxh5 ♘d5 24 ♖hg1 ♘xc3+ 25 ♘xc3 ♘c6 26 ♕g5 +–) 23 ♘g3 ♘c6 24 ♖df1 (24 ♖hf1? ♖ad8!) ♕d5 25 gxh5 with a decisive kingside attack.

4) **21...a5** 22 g4 ♕f3 23 ♘g3 b4 24 ♗d2 ♘c5 25 ♖hf1 ♕b7 26 gxh5 and again the white attack is irresistible.

12 Polugaevsky: Others

In this chapter we deal with all variations of the Polugaevsky except 10 ♕e2, which was covered in the previous chapter.

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 b5 *(D)*



W

8 e5

Several other moves have been tried, but without any real success. If Black is allowed to get away with his ambitious plan of playing a quick ...b5, then he is assured a comfortable game. Note that, in the analysis below, ...♕c7 by Black will probably transpose to chapter 14, and we do not mention each such transposition. One of the reasons why the variations below are more favourable for Black than chapter 14 is that Black can often play ...♕d8-b6 directly, saving a tempo by missing out the stopover on c7:

1) **8 a3** (this passive move cannot possibly be good) ♘bd7 (8...♗b7 is possible but more complicated; it will often transpose to the analysis below) and now:

1a) **9 ♕f3** ♗b7 10 0-0-0 (10 ♗d3 ♕b6 11 ♘de2 ♖c8 12 ♗h4 ♗e7 13 ♗f2 ♕c7 14 0-0 0-0 15 ♘d4 ♖fe8 with at least equality for Black, Lehmann-Tatai, Las Palmas 1972) ♖c8 11 f5 (11 ♗d3 ♖xc3 12 bxc3 ♕a5) e5 12 ♘de2 (12 ♘b3 ♗e7 13 ♗d3 0-0 14 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 15 ♘d5 ♗xd5 16 exd5 ♕c7! ∓ Nikitin-Polugaevsky, USSR Ch 1959, or even 13...♖xc3 14 bxc3 d5 with good chances) ♕c7 13 ♖d2 ♗e7 14 h4 and now both 14...0-0, Ervin-Browne, New York 1974, and 14...♕a5, Fabian-Polugaevsky, Marianske Lazne 1959, are good for Black.

1b) **9 ♕e2** ♕b6 10 0-0-0 ♗b7 11 g4 ♖c8 12 ♗g2 ♖xc3 13 bxc3 d5 14 f5?! (14 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 15 e5 ∞) ♗xa3+ 15 ♔b1 dxe4 and Black is better, Malevinsky-Anikaev, RSFSR Ch 1976.

2) **8 ♗e2** b4 (8...h6 9 ♗xf6 ♕xf6 10 0-0 ♗e7 11 a4! b4 12 ♘a2 ♗b7 13 f5 e5 14 ♘b3 ♗xe4 15 ♘xb4 is good for White while 8...♗b7 9 ♗f3 ♘bd7 10 e5 ♗xf3 11 ♘xf3 dxe5 12 fxe5 h6 13 ♗e3 or 13 ♗h4 is unclear) 9 ♘a4 ♗e7 (simple development is best) 10 ♗f3 ♖a7 11 0-0 ♗d7 12 b3 ♗xa4 13 bxa4 0-0 14 ♘b3 ♘bd7 ∓ Suetin-Polugaevsky, USSR Ch 1960.

3) **8 ♗d3** ♘bd7 and now there are three alternatives:

3a) **9 f5** e5 10 ♘c6 ♕b6 11 ♘b4 ♗b7 12 ♕e2 ♗e7 13 0-0-0 ♖c8 14 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 15 g4 ♕a5 16 a3 ♖xc3 17 bxc3 d5! with a definite advantage to Black, Spassky-Polugaevsky, USSR Ch 1960.

3b) **9 ♕e2** ♕b6 10 ♘f3 (10 ♘xe6? fxe6 11 e5 dxe5 12 fxe5 ♕c5! and White cannot regain his piece, Sakharov-Polugaevsky, USSR Ch 1960) ♗b7 11 ♗h4 b4 12 ♘b1 d5 13 e5 ♘e4 and Black had at least equality in Tolush-Hottes, Hamburg 1960.

3c) **9 ♕f3**. Black's usual reply to this is 9...♗b7 transposing to line 4 below, but he might still try 9...♕b6.

4) **8 ♕f3** ♗b7 9 0-0-0 (9 a3 is 1a above while 9 ♗d3 will probably transpose to the text) ♘bd7 10 ♗d3 and:

4a) **10...♗e7** 11 ♖he1 ♕b6 12 ♘ce2 (12 ♕e3 b4 13 ♘ce2 ♘c5 =) ♘c5 13 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 14 g4 ♘a4!? (14...0-0-0 is safer and quite good) 15 c3 b4 16 ♗c2 ♘xb2!? 17 ♔xb2 bxc3+ 18 ♔xc3 0-0 19 ♖b1 ♕a5+ 20 ♔d3 ♖ac8 21 ♕f2?! ♗a8 22 ♖b3? e5 23 g5 exd4 24 ♘xd4 ♗xd4 0-1 Kupper-Tal, Zurich 1959.

4b) **10...♕b6** 11 ♘b3 b4 12 ♘a4 ♕c7 and after 13 ♖he1 ♗e7 or 13 ♘d4 ♗e7 Black's position is entirely satisfactory, which is not surprising as he is just a tempo up on chapter 14, line A2, note to White's 12th move.

5) **8 ♕e2**. Apart from 8...♕c7 9 0-0-0 ♘bd7, which leads to line B2 of chapter 14, Black can try Polugaevsky's suggestion 8...♗e7 9 0-0-0 b4, at once driving the knight away.

The conclusion is that 8 e5 is the only real test of 7...b5.

8 ... dxe5

Or **8...h6 9 ♗h4 g5** and now:

1) **10 ♗g3** b4! (10...gxf4 11 ♗h4 dxe5 12 ♘xe6 ♕xd1+ 13 ♖xd1 fxe6 14 ♗xf6 ±; 10...dxe5 11 fxe5 ♘d5 12 ♘xd5 ♕xd5 13 ♗e2 ♗b7 14 ♗f3 ♕d7 15 ♘xe6 ± Paoli-Primavera, Italian Ch 1959) 11 exf6 (11 ♕f3 looks critical, but it may still be OK for Black, e.g. 11...bxc3 12 ♕xa8 cxb2 13 ♖b1 ♕a5+ 14 ♔d1 ♘fd7 15 ♗b5 ♕b6 16 ♗xd7+ ♔xd7! ∞) bxc3 12 bxc3 gxf4 13 ♗h4 ♕c7 ∓ Zuse-Braun, Bundesliga 1987.

2) **10 fxg5!** ♘h7 11 ♕h5 (11 exd6 hxg5 12 ♗f2 ♗b7 13 ♘xe6 +– Dueball-Braun, Bundesliga 1989) hxg5 12 ♗g3 ♗g7 13 0-0-0 d5 14 ♗d3 b4 15 ♖hf1 ♖a7 16 ♘cb5 axb5 17 ♘xb5 ♘f8 18 ♕f3 +– Kasparov-Ehlvest, Daugavpils 1978.

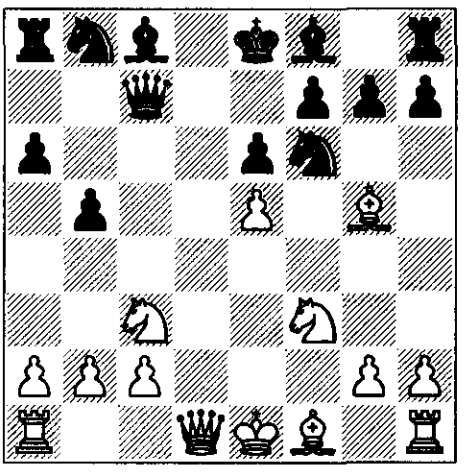
9 fxe5 ♕c7

10 exf6

Or:

1) **10 ♘f3** *(D)* (this move has been unfairly neglected – in fact it appears to be quite dangerous for Black; 10 ♕e2 is chapter 11) and now:

B



1a) **10...♘fd7** and now White has a choice between several dangerous moves:

1a1) **11 ♘e4** ♗b7 12 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 13 exd6 ♕c5 14 ♕d2 0-0 15 ♗e2 ♗d5 16 b3 ♖c8 17 c4 bxc4 18 bxc4 ♗xc4 19 ♖c1 ♕d5 20 ♕f4 e5 21 ♕g4 e4 22 ♗h6 g6 23 ♘d2 1-0 Tolush-Coolen, corr 1962.

1a2) **11 ♗d3** ♘xe5 12 ♗e4 ♘ec6 13 0-0 ♗c5+ 14 ♔h1 0-0 15 ♘h4 ♗b7 16 ♗xh7+ ♔xh7 17 ♕h5+ ♔g8 18 ♘e4 ♕e5 19 ♘f6+ gxf6 20 ♘g6 fxg6 21 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 22 ♖f3 ♕f5 23 ♖xf5 exf5 24 ♗xf6+ ♖xf6 25 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 26 ♖e1 ± Weber-Gerhardt, corr 1964 is noteworthy for reaching the rare material balance of four minor pieces against a queen.

1a3) **11 ♕d2** ♗b4 12 0-0-0 0-0 13 ♗f6 ♘xf6 14 exf6 ♖e8 15 ♕g5 g6 16 h4 ♘d7 17 h5 ♗xc3 18 ♖xd7 ♗xd7 19 bxc3 ♕xc3 20 hxg6 1-0 Marcinkiewicz-Krynicki, corr 1977.

1b) **10...b4** 11 ♘b5 (11 exf6 bxc3 and now 12 fxg7 ♗xg7 13 b3 0-0 14 ♗d3 ♗b7 15 0-0 ♘c6 and 12 b3 ♘d7 13 fxg7 ♗xg7 14 ♗e2 ♗b7 15 0-0 ♘c5 are equal) axb5 12 exf6 ♘d7 13 ♗xb5 ♖a5 14 ♕e2 gxf6 15 ♗xf6 ♖g8 and now:

1b1) **16 ♘e5** ♖xb5! 17 ♕xb5 ♖xg2 18 ♕a4 (or 18 ♖d1 ♗d6! 19 ♘xd7 ♗xd7 20 ♕d3 ♗e7 21 ♗xe7 ♕e5+ 22 ♔f1 ♗b5 ∓ Kotkov-Shaposhnikov, RSFSR Ch 1958) ♗h6 (18...♕c5 19 0-0-0 b3!?) 19 ♘xd7 ♖e2+ 20 ♔xe2 ♕c4+ with at least a draw for Black.

1b2) **16 ♗e5** ♕b7 17 ♗xd7+ ♗xd7 18 0-0-0 ♖xa2 19 b3 ♗c6 ∓.

1b3) **16 ♘d4** ♕b6 with a last branch:

1b31) **17 ♗c6** ♖g6 18 ♗h8 (18 ♗e5 ♖xe5! 19 ♕xe5 ♗g7 ∓ Adzhemian-Tukmakov, Alma Ata 1964) ♗e7 19 0-0-0 ♖xa2 20 ♔b1 ♖a7 21 ♕b5 ♕a6 22 ♕xa6 ♖xa6 ∓ Haase-Siegl, corr 1980.

1b32) **17 ♗xd7+** ♗xd7 18 0-0-0 (18 0-0 ♗b5) ♖xa2 19 ♔b1? (19 ♘b3 ∓) ♖a8 20 ♘b3 ♕a7 0-1 Schuler-Kammel, corr 1967.

1b33) **17 ♕c4!** ♗c5 18 ♗xd7+ ♗xd7 19 0-0-0 ♗e7?! 20 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 21 ♖hf1 ± Belloc-Millan, corr 1980.

2) **10 ♗xb5+** (this is not at all bad, but Tal's loss with it in the stem game seems to have dissuaded other players from adopting it) axb5 11 exf6 ♕e5+ 12 ♕e2 ♕xg5 (White wins after 12...♕xd4 13 ♖d1 ♕b6 14 fxg7 ♗xg7 15 ♕xb5+) 13 ♘dxb5 and now:

2a) **13...♘a6?** 14 ♘e4 ♕e5 15 fxg7 (15 ♖d1 is also good: 15...gxf6 16 0-0 ♗c5+ {16...♗e7 17 ♘ed6+ ♗xd6 18 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 19 ♕xe5 fxe5 20 ♘xf7 +–} 17 ♔h1 ♔e7 18 ♖xf6 ♖f8 19 ♕g4 gives White a decisive attack; for example, the ingenious 19...♗g1 is met by 20 ♖h6! +–) ♗xg7 16 ♘bd6+ ♔e7 17 0-0 f5 18 ♖ad1 h5 19 ♕e3 ♔f8 20 ♕g5 +– Rechel-Heinelt, Hessen Ch 1989.

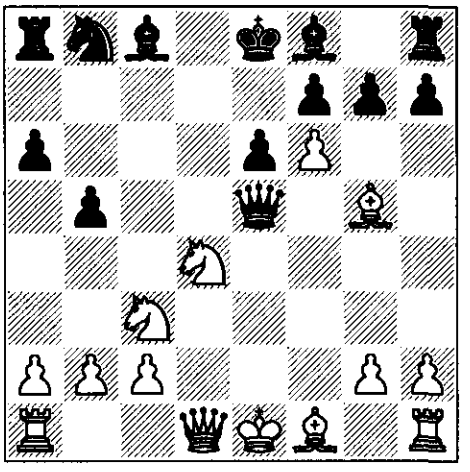
2b) **13...♖a5!** 14 fxg7 ♗xg7 (the alternative 14...♕xg7 is answered by 15 0-0 ♗c5+ 16 ♔h1 0-0 17 ♖f3 according to Taulbut and 15 0-0-0 ♗e7 16 ♘c7+ ♔f8 17 ♖hf1 according to Lepeshkin, but Polugaevsky himself believes the move is playable) 15 ♘e4 ♕e5 (nobody seems sure how to assess 15...♖xb5 16 ♘xg5 ♖xg5) 16 ♘bd6+ ♔e7 17 0-0 f5 18 ♖ad1 ♖d5 (18...♗a6? 19 ♕h5 ♖f8 20 ♕h4+ ♖f6 21 ♘xf6 ♕xf6 22 ♕b4 +– Rechel-Kobs, Hessenliga 1994) 19 ♕c4 ♖xd1 (19...♗d7? 20 ♕b4 ♘c6 21 ♘xf5+ ♔f7 22 ♘e7+ ♔e8 23 ♘xc6 +– Jonvik-Nilssen,

corr 1987) 20 ♖xd1 fxe4 21 ♘xc8+ ♔f7 22 ♘d6+ ♔g6 23 ♘xe4 ± Tal-Polugaevsky, Alma Ata Ct (2) 1980.

3) **10 ♗f4** ♗b4 (10...♘fd7) 11 ♗xb5+!? axb5 12 0-0 ♗xc3 13 exf6 ♗xd4+ 14 ♕xd4 ♘c6 15 fxg7 ♖g8 16 ♕c3 ♕b7 17 ♗g5 ♖a4 18 ♖ad1 ♖c4?! (18...f5) 19 ♕f6 ♕c7 20 ♖d6 e5?? (20...h6) 21 ♖fd1 ♖d4 22 ♖1xd4 1-0 Apicelli-Bucholz, corr 1978.

4) **10 ♗xf6** gxf6 11 exf6 ♕e5+ (11...♗b7 12 ♕h5! ♕f4?? 13 ♗xb5+ +– Makinen-Vayrynen, corr 1983) 12 ♗e2 ♗b7 (12...♖a7) 13 ♕d3 (13 ♘f3 ♗xf3 14 gxf3 ♕xf6 15 ♕d3 ♕h4+ 16 ♔d1 ♖a7 ∓ Kühn-Wolf, 2nd Bundesliga 1993) ♗h6? (13...b4) 14 ♖d1 ♕xf6? 15 ♘xe6 fxe6 16 ♗h5+ ♔f8 17 ♕d6+ 1-0 Ljungström-Kretschmer, corr 1984.

10 ... ♕e5+ *(D)*



11 ♗e2

There are three alternatives:

1) **11 ♕e2** ♕xg5 12 ♘e4 (12 ♕e4 ♖a7 13 ♖d1 gxf6 or 12 g3 ♖a7 13 ♘e4 ♕e5 14 c3 ♗b7 15 fxg7 ♗xg7 16 ♗g2 0-0 17 0-0 b4 = Murei-Van der Vliet, Amsterdam 1983) ♕e5 13 0-0-0 and now:

1a) **13...♗b7?!** with three variations:

1a1) **14 ♕d2!** ♗xe4 15 ♘xb5 ♗d5 16 ♗c4 axb5 17 ♖he1 ♕d6 18 ♗xd5 ♖a6 19 ♕g5! g6 20 ♗xe6 fxe6 21 ♖xd6 +–.

1a2) **14 ♘f5** ♕xf5 (14...♗xe4 15 fxg7 exf5 16 ♕d2 ♗e7 17 gxh8♕+ ♕xh8 18 ♗d3 ∞; 14...exf5 15 ♕d2! ♕c7 {15...♗d5 16 ♘c3 ±} 16 fxg7 ♗xg7 17 ♘d6+ ♔f8 18 ♘xb7 ♘c6 ±) 15 fxg7 ♕f4+ 16 ♔b1 ♗xg7 17 ♘d6+ ♔e7 18 ♘xb7 ♕e5 19 ♕xe5 ♗xe5 =.

1a3) **14 ♘xb5?!** axb5 15 ♕d2 (15 fxg7 ♗xg7 16 ♘d6+ ♔e7 17 ♕xe5 ♗xe5 18 ♘xb7 ♖xa2 ∓ Romantchouk-Leroy, Paris Ch 1993) ♗d5 16 ♗xb5+ ♔d8 17 ♘g5 ♖xa2 18 c3 ♔c8! and it is hard to see any compensation for the piece, since Black's attack is just as strong as White's.

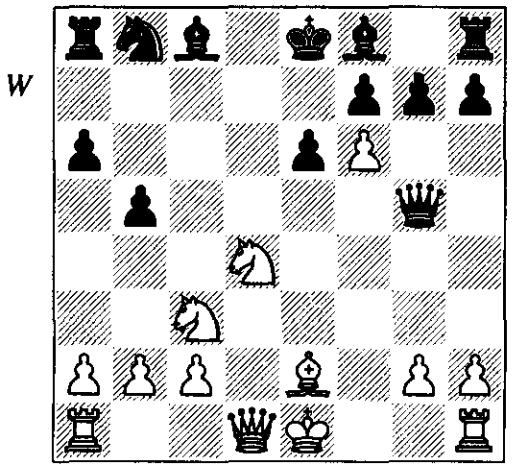
1b) **13...♖a7!** (best) 14 ♕e3 (14 ♘f3 ♕f4+ 15 ♔b1 ♖d7 16 ♖xd7 ♘xd7 17 g3 ♕c7 18 fxg7 ♗xg7 19 ♕d2 0-0 20 ♕d6 ♕xd6 21 ♘xd6 ♘b6 22 ♘xc8 ♖xc8 23 c3 ♘a4 24 ♗d3? ♘xb2 25 ♗c2 ♘c4 0-1 Stein-Sakharov, Ukraine Ch 1960) ♖d7 15 ♘f3 ♖xd1+ 16 ♔xd1 ♕c7 (or even 16...♕xb2) 17 ♗d3 ♘d7 ∓.

2) **11 ♘e4** ♕xe4+ 12 ♘e2 (12 ♗e2 ♕xg2 13 ♗f3 ♕xg5 14 ♗xa8 ♕h4+ ∓) ♘c6 13 ♕d2 h6! 14 ♗e3 ♗b7 15 ♘g3 (15 ♘c3 ♕h4+ and 16...♕xf6 or 15 fxg7 ♗xg7 16 0-0-0 ♖d8 and Black stands well) ♕e5 16 fxg7 ♗xg7 17 ♗d3 ♘b4! ∓ Nezhmetdinov-Polugaevsky, USSR Ch 1961.

3) **11 ♘de2** ♕xg5 12 ♘e4 ♕h4+? (12...♕e5 ∓) 13 ♘2g3 gxf6 14 ♕d4 ♔e7 15 ♕c5+ ♔d8 16 ♕b6+ ♔e8 17 ♕d4 ♔e7 18 ♕c5+ ♔d8 19 ♕b6+ ♔e8 20 ♕d4 ♔e7 21 ♕c5+

'Von Neumann'-H.Olafsson, Philadelphia 1993 was the famous game in which White allegedly received his moves from a computer. Actually, Olafsson was even a bit lucky: had White played 15 ♕b4+! ♔d8 16 ♕a5+ followed by ♗xb5 he might well have lost.

11 ... ♕xg5 *(D)*

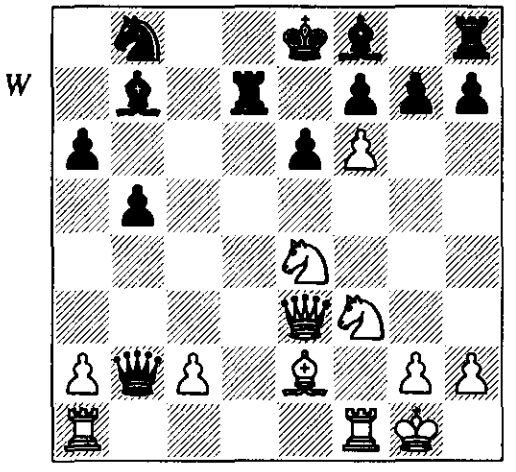


Now the way divides:
A: 12 0-0
B: 12 ♕d3

A)

12 0-0 ♕e5

The alternative is 12...♖a7 but this is currently considered to be very risky: **12...♖a7** (12...♗b7 13 ♗f3 ±; 12...♗c5 13 ♔h1 ±) **13 ♕d3 ♖d7 14 ♘e4 ♕e5** (14...♕g6 15 ♕e3 ♗b7 16 ♗f3 ♕h6 17 ♕xh6 gxh6 18 ♘b3 ♗xe4?! 19 ♗xe4 ♗d6 20 ♖ae1 ± Gligorić-Bhend, Zurich 1959) **15 ♘f3** (15 c3 ♗b7 is fine for Black) **♕xb2** (15...♖xd3 16 ♘xe5 ♖e3 17 ♗d3 ±; 15...♗c5+ 16 ♔h1 ♕xb2 17 ♖ab1! ♕xb1 18 fxg7 ♕b2 19 ♘e5!! ♕xe5 20 ♕g3 +–; 15...♕c7 16 ♕e3 ♗b7 {16...g6 17 c4! b4 18 ♗d1! ♗b7 19 ♗a4 ♗c6 20 ♗xc6 ♘xc6 21 ♖ad1 ± Zagorovsky-Kaverin, USSR 1961} 17 ♘fg5 ♗xe4 18 ♘xe4 ♕a7 19 ♕xa7 ♖xa7 20 c4 ± Murei-Feldman, USSR 1965) **16 ♕e3 ♗b7** *(D)* (best; 16...♘c6 17 ♖ab1 ♕xa2 18 ♖a1 ♕d5 19 ♖ad1 ♕a2 20 ♕c3! +–; 16...♕b4 17 c3 ♕a5 18 ♘e5 ±) and now White can play:



1) **17 ♖ad1?** (often played, but bad) ♖xd1! 18 ♖xd1 ♗xe4 19 ♕a7 (19 ♕xe4 ♗c5+ 20 ♔h1 ♕xf6; 19 ♕b6 ♘d7) ♗d6 20 ♖xd6 0-0 –+.

2) **17 fxg7?** ♗xg7 18 ♗d3 ♗d4 19 ♘xd4 ♕xd4 20 ♕xd4 ♖xd4 21 ♘f6+ ♔e7 ∓ Shmit-Kovačević, USSR v Yugoslavia 1961.

3) **17 ♔h1** ♗xe4 18 ♕xe4 gxf6 19 c4 b4 20 c5 ♗xc5? 21 ♖ab1 ♕c3 22 ♖b3 f5 23 ♕a8 ± Shabalov-Tataev, Philadelphia 1991.

4) **17 c4** ♗xe4 18 ♕xe4 ♕xf6 19 ♘e5 (19 cxb5 ♗c5+ 20 ♔h1 0-0) ♗c5+ 20 ♔h1 ♖d4 21 ♕e3 ♖d5! 22 ♕g3 ♕xe5 23 cxd5 ♕xg3 24 hxg3 ♔e7 was roughly level, Simovich-Vitolinš, Baku 1961. Black might also try 18...b4 in this line.

5) **17 ♖ab1** (a very dangerous move) ♕xc2 18 ♘fg5 and now:

5a) **18...h6** 19 ♖bc1 ♕a4 (no better is 19...♕xa2 20 ♕a7 ♘c6 21 ♖xc6 ♗xc6 22 ♕b8+ ♖d8 23 ♕c7

hxg5 24 ♕xc6+ ♖d7 25 ♕a8+ ♖d8 26 ♗xb5+) 20 ♘xe6 fxe6 21 ♗h5+ ♖f7 22 fxg7 +–.

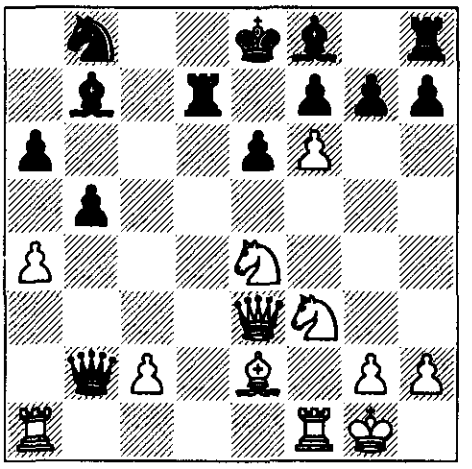
5b) **18...g6** (another bad idea) 19 ♖bc1 ♕xa2 (19...♕a4 20 ♘xe6 fxe6 21 f7+ ♖xf7 {21...♔d8 22 ♕g5+ ♖e7 23 ♖fd1+ ♗d5 24 ♘c5 +–} 22 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 23 ♕xe6+ ♖e7 24 ♖c8+ +–) 20 ♕a7 ♘c6 21 ♖xc6 ♗xc6 22 ♕b8+ ♖d8 23 ♕c7 ♗c5+ 24 ♘xc5 0-0 25 ♘xf7! +–.

5c) **18...♗xe4** 19 ♘xe4 ♕c7 20 ♖bc1 ♕d8 21 ♖c2 ♖c7 22 ♖d1 ♘d7 23 fxg7 ♗xg7 24 ♘d6+ ♔e7 25 ♘f5+ ♔f8 26 ♕g3 +–.

5d) **18...♖g8** 19 ♖bc1 ♕xa2 (after 19...♕a4, then 20 ♘xe6 as usual) 20 ♕a7 ♘c6 21 ♖xc6 ♗xc6 22 ♕b8+ ♖d8 23 ♕c7 ♗d7 24 ♗h5 g6 25 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 26 ♕xd6 and mate.

5e) **18...♕c7** 19 fxg7 ♗xg7 20 ♘f6+ (20 ♘xe6 fxe6 21 ♘g5 ♕e5 22 ♗h5+ ♔d8 23 ♕b6+ ♔c8, as in Parma-Tatai, Athens 1968, and now 24 ♖bc1+ ♘c6 25 ♖xc6+ ♔b8 and 24 ♘xe6 ♕d4+ win for Black) ♗xf6 21 ♖xf6 with a very dangerous attack, for example 21...♕c6 22 ♗f3 (22 ♕f2 ♖g8) ♕c2 23 ♖c1 ♕b2 24 ♖xf7! +–.

6) **17 a4** *(D)* (considered best, but see line 6d – note that this position can arise from a number of move-orders) and now:



6a) **17...♕b4** (Van der Vliet's idea) 18 c4 ♗xe4 19 ♕xe4 ♕c5+ 20 ♔h1 b4 21 ♕f4 (21 ♘e5 ♖d4 22 ♕e3 gxf6 23 ♘d3 ♕d6 24 ♘xb4 ♕e5 25 ♕xe5 fxe5 ∓ Thierry-Van der Hooven, corr 1985) ♗d6 (21...♕c7 22 ♘e5 ♗d6 23 fxg7 ♗xe5 24 gxh8♕+ ♗xh8 25 ♕g5 ♗xa1 26 ♕g8+ ♔e7 27 ♕xf7+ ♔d6 28 ♕f8+ ♖e7 29 ♖xa1 ± Diaz-Vera, Cuban Ch 1986) 22 fxg7 ♖g8 23 ♕h6 ♗e5 (23...♕f5 24 c5 ♗xc5 25 ♖ac1 threatening 26 ♖xc5 and 27 ♕xh7) 24 ♕xh7! (this simple move is effectively a refutation) ♖xg7 25 ♕h8+ ♔e7 26 ♖ad1 (or 26 ♘xe5 ♕xe5 27 ♕h4+ {27 ♗h5! looks even better} ♕g5 28 ♕f2 ♖c7 29 ♖ad1 ♘d7 30 ♖d4! ± Am.Rodriguez-Stangl, Biel 1988) b3 (26...♕c6 27 ♖g1! ♕c7 28 ♘xe5 ♕xe5 29 ♗f3 ♖g5 30 ♕c8 ♖xd1 31 ♖xd1 ♔f6 32 ♕f8! ±) 27 ♘xe5 ♕xe5 28 ♗f3 ♖g5 29 ♕c8 ♖xd1 30 ♖xd1 ♔f6 31 ♕b7 and White ends up a clear pawn ahead.

6b) **17...h6** 18 axb5 axb5 (there is nothing better, e.g. 18...♕xc2 19 ♖fc1 ♕xe4 20 ♖c8+ ♖d8 21 ♖xd8+ ♔xd8 22 ♕b6+ ♔e8 23 bxa6 +–) 19 ♖ab1 ♕xc2 20 ♖xb5 with a winning attack.

6c) **17...♗xe4** 18 ♕xe4 ♗c5+ 19 ♔h1 ♕xf6 20 axb5 0-0 21 bxa6 ±.

6d) **17...b4** and now:

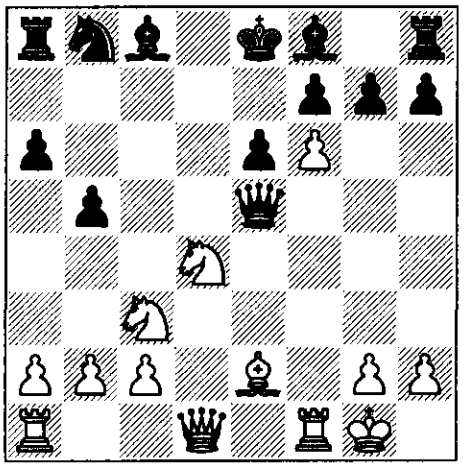
6d1) **18 c3** ♗xe4 (18...♕c2 19 ♘fg5 b3 20 ♖ac1 ♕a2 21 ♗c4! g6 22 ♘xf7! and now Minić-Rajković, Poreč 1973, continued 22...♕xa4 {22...♖xf7 23 ♗xe6 +–} 23 ♘ed6+ ♖xd6 24 ♘xd6+ ♔d7 25 ♕xe6+ ♔c7 26 ♘xb7 +– while Stean suggests 22...♗c5, but then 23 ♕xc5

♗xe4 24 ♖f2 b2 25 ♘d6+ ♖xd6 26 f7+ ♔d7 27 ♕xd6+ ♔xd6 28 ♖d1+ wins) 19 ♕xe4 ♗c5+ 20 ♔h1 gxf6 21 ♗xa6 (21 ♖fc1 b3 and it is not clear how White continues, e.g. 22 ♖ab1 ♕a3 23 ♗xa6 {23 ♕c4 ♔e7!} ♘xa6 24 ♕a8+ ♖d8 25 ♕c6+ ♔f8 26 ♕xa6 and Black is better) ♘xa6 (21...♖g8!?) 22 ♕a8+ ♔e7 23 ♕xh8 bxc3 24 ♕xh7 c2 ∓ Ocana-Perez, corr 1988.

6d2) **18 ♖ab1** ♕xc2 19 fxg7 ♗xg7 20 ♖xb4 virtually forces Black to give up his queen by 20...♗xe4 (20...♕c7 21 ♖c1 ♘c6 22 ♕g5 f5 23 ♘f6+ ♗xf6 24 ♕xf6 ♖f8 25 ♕xe6+ ♖e7 26 ♕b3 +–) 21 ♖c1 0-0 22 ♖xc2 ♗xc2 23 ♘e5 with an edge for White, although the most likely result is a draw.

In conclusion, 12...♖a7 cannot be recommended: lines 5 and 6 above both look very dodgy for Black. It is worth mentioning some nuances of move-order here. After 12 ♕d3 Black may play 12...♖a7 when 13 ♘e4 ♕e5 14 0-0 (or 14 ♘f3 ♕xb2 15 0-0 ♖d7) ♖d7 15 ♘f3 ♕xb2 transposes to the above lines. The advantage of these lines is that 12 0-0 ♕e5 is avoided and in the latter case the line where Black plays ...♕c7 instead of ...♕xb2 is also avoided, as it would shut in the rook on a7. The disadvantage is that after 12 ♕d3, 12...♕xf6 is permitted.

Now back to the main line after 12...♕e5 *(D)*:



13 ♘f3!

There are a number of alternatives, of which only line 4 need be seriously considered:

1) **13 fxg7** ♗xg7 14 ♘f3 ♕e3+ (14...♕c5+ 15 ♔h1 ♗b7 16 ♕d3 0-0 17 ♖ad1 ♘c6 18 ♘e4 ♕e7 19 ♘eg5 f5 ∞ Belov-Polugaevsky, RSFSR Ch 1960) 15 ♔h1 0-0 16 ♕d3 ♕xd3 17 ♗xd3 ♖a7 ∓ Camilleri-Soylu, Zouberi Z 1993.

2) **13 ♖e1** ♕xf6 14 ♗f3 ♖a7 15 ♘d5 ♕d8 and White has nothing, e.g. 16 ♘f5 ♗c5+ 17 ♔h1 0-0.

3) **13 ♗h5** g6 14 ♗f3 ♖a7 15 ♘e4 ♖d7 16 c3 ♗b7 17 ♘g3 ♗xf3 18 ♕xf3 ♗c5 19 ♔h1 ♗xd4 20 cxd4 ♖xd4 21 ♖ae1 ♕d5 ∞ ½-½ Kavalek-Polugaevsky, Bugojno 1980.

4) **13 ♔h1** ♖a7 (13...gxf6 14 ♗f3 {14 ♗h5!? is also dangerous} ♖a7 15 ♖e1 ♕c7 16 ♘d5 ♕d8 17 ♕d2 and ♕f4 with a strong attack) and now:

4a) **14 ♕d3** ♖d7 15 ♘f3 ♕xf6 16 ♕e3 ♗d6 17 ♘e4 ♕f4 18 ♘xd6+ ♕xd6 19 ♘e5 ♖e7 20 ♘xf7! ♖xf7 21 ♖xf7 ♔xf7 22 ♖f1+ ♔g8 (or 22...♔e8 23 ♕c3! +–) 23 ♗h5 g6 (23...♘d7 24 ♗f7+ ♔f8 25 ♗xe6+ ♔e8 ∞) 24 ♕g5 ♕d7? (24...e5! 25 ♖f6 ♕d5 =) 25 ♕f4 ♕e8 26 ♕xb8 gxh5 27 ♕g3+ ♕g6 28 ♕c7 ♕e8 29 ♖d1 1-0 Maumey-Sidhoum, corr 1982.

4b) **14 ♗d3!?** and now:

4b1) **14...♗b7** 15 fxg7 (15 ♘f3 ♕h5 16 ♗e4 ♘d7 17 g4 ♕c5 18

♗xb7 ♖xb7 19 ♘e4 ♕c6 20 fxg7 ♗xg7 21 ♘d6+ ♔e7 22 ♘xb7 ♕xb7 23 ♕d2 ± Stodola-Halouzka, corr 1988) ♕xg7 (15...♗xg7 16 ♘f5!) 16 ♗e4 ♗e7 17 ♘xe6! fxe6 18 ♕h5+ ♔d8 19 ♖f7 ♕g8 20 ♕e5 ♘d7 21 ♕xe6 ♕e8 22 ♖d1 ♗xe4 23 ♘xe4 +– Novotny-Halouzka, corr 1984.

4b2) **14...♖d7** with two possibilities:

4b21) **15 fxg7** ♕xg7 (15...♗xg7 16 ♘f5!) 16 ♘f3 ♗b7 17 ♕e2 ♗d6? (17...♗e7) 18 ♖ae1 0-0 19 ♘e4 ♘c6 20 ♘fg5 ♘d4 21 ♘f6+! ♕xf6 22 ♕h5 ♕g7 (22...♕h8 23 ♗xh7+ ♔g7 24 ♖xe6! +–) 23 ♗xh7+ ♔h8 24 ♖f6! ♗d5 25 ♖ef1 1-0 Walczak-Rogalewicz, corr 1993.

4b22) **15 ♘f5?!** gxf6 (15...g6 16 ♘g3 h5 17 ♕f3 ♗b7 18 ♗e4 h4 19 ♗xb7 hxg3 20 h3 b4 21 ♘e2 ♗d6 22 ♖ad1 ♖h4 ∓ Krakops-Savko, Latvian Ch 1993) 16 ♖e1 ♕c5 17 ♕h5 ♔d8 18 ♕h4 ♗e7 19 ♘xe7 ♕xe7 20 ♘e4 f5 21 ♘f6 ♖d6 ∓ Galicki-Müller, corr 1991.

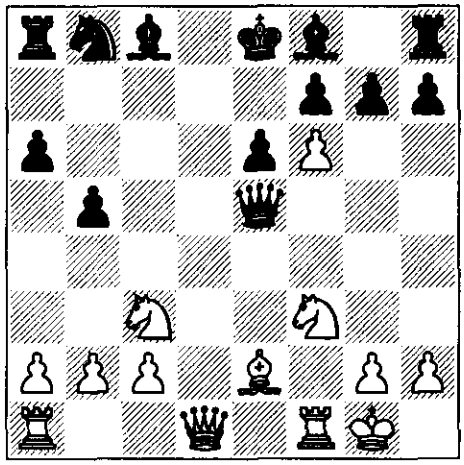
4c) **14 ♕e1!?** ♕xd4 (14...♖d7 15 ♗xb5 ♕xd4 16 ♖d1 ♕a7 {16...♕b6 17 ♗xd7+ ♘xd7 18 ♘d5 ♕c5 19 ♖f3 +–} 17 ♗xd7+ ♘xd7 18 ♘d5 g6 19 ♕a5 ♗d6 20 ♘e7! +–) 15 ♖d1 ♕b6 (15...♕c5 16 ♕g3 gxf6 17 ♘e4 +–) 16 ♘d5 exd5! (according to Lepeshkin, the lines 16...♕c5 17 b4 ♕c6 18 ♖f3 ♖d7 19 ♖c3 ♕b7 20 ♗f3, 16...♕c6 17 ♖f3 b4 18 ♖f4 and 16...♕d8 17 fxg7 ♗xg7 18 ♘f6+ ♕xf6 {18...♗xf6 leads to a fork on c3 instead} 19 ♖xf6 ♗xf6 20 ♕f2 all favour White) 17 ♗xb5+ ♔d8 18 ♕e8+ ♔c7 19 ♕xf7+ ♘d7 20 fxg7 ♗xg7 21 ♗xd7 (21 ♕xg7 is roughly equal) ♖f8 22 ♕xg7 ♖xf1+ 23 ♖xf1 ♗xd7 ∓.

5) **13 ♗f3** (not dangerous) ♖a7 14 ♘c6 (14 ♖e1 ♕xf6 15 ♘d5 {15 ♗c6+? ♘xc6 16 ♘xc6 ♖d7 17 ♘d5 ♗c5+ 18 ♔h1 ♕h4! ∓ Ortega-Polugaevsky, Havana 1962} ♕d8 16 b4 ♗e7 17 ♘f5 ♗f6! ∓; 14 ♘e4!? ♖d7 15 c3 gxf6 16 ♕e1 f5? 17 ♘xf5! ♗b7 18 ♘fg3 ♗xe4 19 ♘xe4 ♗g7 20 ♕h4 b4 21 ♖ae1 ± Caprifichi-Bosco, corr 1990) ♘xc6 (the alternative 14...♕c5+ 15 ♔h1 is more risky) 15 ♗xc6+ ♗d7 16 ♗xd7+ ♖xd7 17 ♕f3 ♗d6 (17...♗c5+ 18 ♔h1 0-0 19 ♘e4 ±) and now:

5a) **18 g3** ♕xf6 19 ♕a8+ ♕d8 20 ♕xa6 b4 21 ♘e4 0-0 22 ♕b5 (22 ♘xd6 ♖xd6 23 ♕a7 ♖d2 24 ♖f2 ♖d1+ 25 ♖xd1 ♕xd1+ 26 ♔g2 ♕d5+ 27 ♔g1 e5 ∓ Ripol-Lanz, corr 1992) ♗e7 ∓ Mariotti-Ribli, Manila 1976.

5b) **18 ♕h3** b4! 19 fxg7 (if Black had incautiously checked on move 17 before playing ...♗d6, then White could play ♘d5! here) ♖g8 20 ♘a4 ♖xg7 ∓ since White's knight isn't doing anything.

Returning to the main line after 13 ♘f3 *(D)*:



B

13 ... ♗c5+

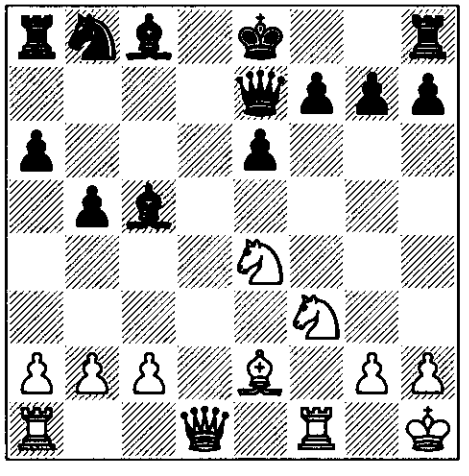
The various alternatives are just bad:

1) **13...♕e3+** 14 ♔h1 gxf6 15 ♘d5! exd5 16 ♕xd5 ♕a7 (16...♖a7 17 ♖ae1) 17 ♘g5 (after 17 ♖ad1 ♗e7 18 ♘g5 0-0 there is no obvious continuation for White) ♕b7 (17...fxg5 18 ♗h5! +–) 18 ♗xb5+ axb5 19 ♖fe1+ ♗e7 20 ♕xf7+ ♔d8 21 ♖ad1+ ♗d7 22 ♕xe7+ ♔c7 23 ♘e6+ ♔c8 24 ♘c5 ♕c6 25 ♘xd7 ♘xd7 26 ♖e6 ♕b7 27 ♖xd7 ♕xd7 28 ♕c5+ ♔d8 29 ♕b6+ ♕c7 30 ♖d6+ ♔c8 31 ♖c6 +– Runowiecki-Muller, corr 1990.

2) **13...♕c5+** 14 ♔h1 ♗b7 15 ♘d2 ♕e5 16 ♘de4 ♘d7 17 fxg7 ♕xg7 18 ♖xf7! +– Madsen-Kelstrup, corr 1981.

3) **13...♕xf6** (too risky) 14 ♘e4 ♕f4 (14...♕e7 15 ♘e5 ♕c7 16 ♘xf7 ♗c5+ 17 ♔h1 0-0 18 ♘eg5 ♕d7 {18...h6 19 ♗d3 hxg5 20 ♗h7+} 19 ♗d3 g6 20 ♕f3 ♖a7 21 ♕f6 +– S.Salov-Förster, Bad Ragaz 1992) 15 ♘fg5 ♕e3+ 16 ♔h1 ♖a7 17 ♗h5 g6 18 ♘f6+ ♔e7 19 ♘d5+ (or 19 ♘xf7) exd5 20 ♖e1 ♕xe1+ 21 ♕xe1+ 1-0 Wolff-Pliester, New York 1989.

14 ♔h1 ♕xf6
15 ♘e4 ♕e7 *(D)*



16 ♘fg5

The other possibility is **16 ♘e5 f5** and now:

1) **17 ♗xb5+** axb5 18 ♘xc5 0-0 (18...♕xc5 19 ♕h5+ g6 20 ♘xg6 hxg6 21 ♕xh8+ {21 ♕xg6+ ♔f8 22 ♕f6+ ♔g8 23 ♖ad1 ♗d7 24 ♖d3 ♕c7 is a draw} ♔f7 {21...♕f8 22 ♕e5 ♗d7 23 c3 ±} 22 ♖ad1 ♘c6 23 ♕h7+ ♔f6 24 ♕c7 ± Dimitrov-Luft, Velden 1993) 19 b4 ♘a6 20 ♕f3 ♘xc5 21 ♕xa8 ♘e4 22 ♕a5 (22 ♕c6!?) ♕h4 23 ♔g1 and Black is struggling to find enough compensation.

2) **17 ♗h5+** g6 18 ♘xg6! (18 ♗xg6+ hxg6 19 ♘xg6 ♖xh2+! 20 ♔xh2 ♕h7+ –+) hxg6 19 ♗xg6+ ♔f8 20 ♘xc5 ♖h6 (20...♕xc5? 21 ♕d8+ ♔g7 22 ♕g5 +–; 20...♔g7 21 ♘xe6+ ♔xg6 {21....♗xe6 22 ♗xf5 ♗xf5 23 ♖xf5 ♕h4 24 ♕d6 +–} 22 ♘f4+ ♔g7 23 ♖f3 ♖h4 24 ♖g3+ ♖g4 25 ♕d4+ ♔f7 26 ♖xg4 fxg4 27 ♕d5+ +– Denaro-Olsen, corr 1989) 21 ♘xe6+ ♗xe6 22 ♗xf5 ♗f7 23 ♕f3 ♘c6 (23...♖a7 24 ♖ae1 ♕d6 25 h3 ♘c6 26 ♖d1 ♕f6 ½-½ Wells-Lamford, corr 1989) 24 ♗e4 ♘e5 ∞ Diaz-Vera, Havana 1986.

16 ... f5

After **16...0-0 17 ♘xf7** Black can try:

1) **17...♗b7** (aiming to liquidate to an ending in which Black can probably hold the draw) 18 ♘xc5 (18 ♗d3!? appears more promising) ♕xc5 19 ♕d6 ♕xd6 20 ♘xd6 ♖xf1+ 21 ♖xf1 ♗d5 22 ♘c8 ♘c6 23 ♘b6 ♖d8 24 ♘xd5 exd5 25 ♖d1 d4 26 a4 bxa4 27 ♗xa6 ♖b8 28 b3 axb3 ½-½ Corkett-Lamford, corr 1989.

2) **17...♖xf7** (with an accurate follow-up, this seems to be the best line) 18 ♖xf7 ♔xf7 19 ♗h5+ ♔g8 (19...g6 20 ♘xc5 ♔g8 {20...♖a7 21 ♘e4 gxh5 22 ♘d6+ and ♘xc8 +–}

21 ♗f3 ♖a7 22 b4 ♘d7 23 ♘xe6 ♕xb4 24 ♕g1! +– Ljubčić-Novijan, corr 1989) 20 ♘xc5 ♖a7! (20...♘d7 21 ♘xe6 ♗b7 {21...♕xe6 22 ♗f3} 22 ♗f3 ♗xf3 23 ♕xf3 ♖e8 24 ♘d4 with an extra pawn for White, Beliavsky-Polugaevsky, USSR 1979) 21 ♘e4 ♖d7 22 ♕e2 ♘c6 23 c3 ♘e5 = Denaro-Bosco, corr 1990.

17 ♗h5+

17 b4 ♗xb4 (17...fxe4 18 ♘xe4! and 19 ♗h5+ ±) 18 ♗h5+ g6 19 ♘xh7 ♔f7 20 ♖xf5+ exf5 21 ♘eg5+ ♔g8! 22 ♕d5+ (22 ♗xg6 ♘d7! –+) ♗e6! 23 ♕xa8 ♔g7! ∓.

17 ... g6

18 ♘xc5

18 ♘xh7 ♔f7! (not 18...gxh5 19 ♘ef6+ ♔f7 20 ♕xh5+ ♔g7 21 ♖f3 ♗d6 22 ♕g5+ ♔f7 23 ♖h3 +–) 19 ♘hg5+ ♔g7 20 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 21 ♗f3, Plaskett-Gallagher, Telford 1982, and now Black should continue 21...♖a7 ∓.

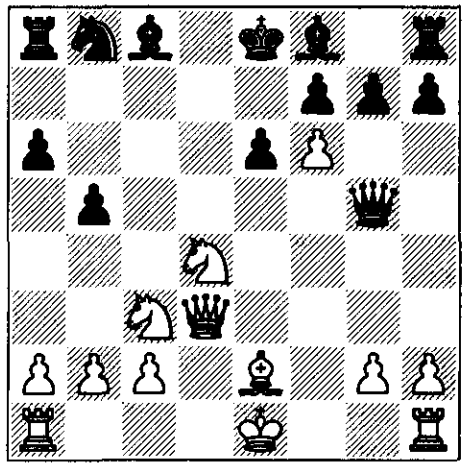
18 ... ♕xc5

19 ♖e1 ♖a7 20 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 21 ♖xe6+ ♔f7 22 ♖d6 ♖e8 (22...gxh5 23 ♕xh5+ ♔e7 24 ♖ad1 ♕xd6 25 ♖xd6 ♔xd6 26 ♕h6+ picks up a rook) 23 ♗f3 ♖ae7 24 ♕d5+ ♕xd5 25 ♗xd5+ (White has a microscopic advantage because the a6-pawn is weak) ♔g7 26 ♔g1, Nataf-Leroy, France Cht 1993, and now 26...♖d7 should draw.

The main line of this variation looks drawish. White players should investigate either 13 ♔h1 or 16 ♘e5 f5 17 ♗xb5+ in order to obtain genuine winning chances.

B)

12 ♕d3 *(D)*



12 ... ♕xf6

The currently fashionable move, but there are various alternatives. However, only line 6 is worth looking at closely:

1) **12...♕h4+** 13 g3 ♕xf6 (the check is a bad idea for two reasons: Black is deprived of the chance to check on f4 after 0-0-0 by White, and ...♕e5 followed by ...♕xh2 is impossible) 14 ♖f1 (14 0-0-0 ♖a7 15 ♘e4 ♕e5 16 ♘xb5 ♖d7 17 ♘bd6+ ♗xd6 18 ♘xd6+ ♔e7 19 ♘xc8+ ♖xc8 20 ♕a3+ ♕c5 21 ♖xd7+ ♔xd7 22 ♖d1+ ♔e7 23 ♕d3 ± Hector-Zimmer, Geneva 1995) ♕e5 (14...♕g6 15 ♕e3 is slightly better for White than the corresponding variation in the main line) 15 ♖d1 (after 15 0-0-0 Black has checks on the c1-h6 diagonal) ♖a7 16 ♘dxb5 ♖d7 17 ♕c4 ♗c5 18 ♘e4 0-0 19 ♕xc5 (19 ♘xc5 ♖xd1+ 20 ♔xd1 axb5 21 ♕xb5 is also good for White since Black cannot regain his pawn by taking on h2) ♖xd1+ 20 ♔xd1 ♕xe4 21 ♘d6 ♕d5+ 22 ♕xd5 exd5 23 ♘xc8 ♖xc8 24 ♖f5 ♖d8 25 ♗f3 ±.

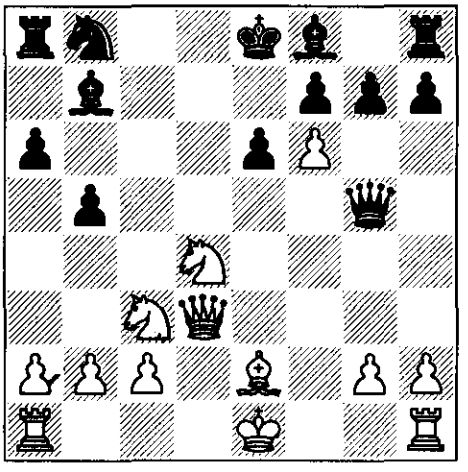
2) **12...gxf6** (this is also dubious) 13 ♘e4 ♕e5 (13...♕g6 14 0-0-0 or 13...♕h6 14 ♗f3 ♖a7 15 ♕c3 ♗d7 16 ♘xb5 axb5 17 ♘xf6+ and ♘g4

wins for White) 14 ♘f3 ♕xb2 15 0-0 f5 16 ♘d6+ (16 ♘fg5, Schleiffer-Schwibbe, corr 1985, is less convincing after 16...fxe4 17 ♕xe4 ♖a7) ♗xd6 17 ♕xd6 ♕f6 18 ♘d4 ♘d7 19 ♗f3 ♖a7 20 ♗c6 ± Matulović-Ermenkov, Sombor 1972.

3) **12...♘d7** (also bad) 13 ♕f3 ♖a7 (13...♖b8 14 ♘e4 ♕d5 15 ♖d1 +–) 14 ♘e4 ♕e5 15 ♘c6 ♕xb2 16 ♖d1 with decisive threats.

4) **12...♗d7** 13 ♕f3 ♕h4+ 14 g3 ♕xd4 15 ♕xa8 ♗d6 16 ♖d1 ♕b6 17 ♖xd6 ♕xd6 18 ♘e4 ♕e5 19 fxg7 ♖g8 20 ♘f6+ ♕xf6 21 ♕xb8+ ♕d8 22 ♕e5 +–.

5) **12...♗b7** *(D)* and now:



5a) **13 ♗f3** ♖a7 (13...♗xf3 14 ♕xf3 ♖a7 15 ♘c6 ♖d7 16 ♘xb8 ♕e5+ 17 ♘e4 ♕xb8 18 0-0 g6 19 ♖ad1 is very dangerous for Black) 14 ♖d1 ♕xf6 15 ♖f1 and White has a dangerous attack.

5b) **13 ♖d1** (possibly even better than 13 ♗f3) ♕xf6 14 ♖f1 ♕g5 (14...♕d8 15 ♘cxb5 axb5 16 ♕xb5+ ♕d7 17 ♘xe6 and White wins) 15 ♘f3 ♗xf3 16 ♗xf3 ♖a7 17 ♘e4 ♕e7 18 ♗h5 ♖d7 19 ♖xf7 ♕h4+ 20 g3 ♖xd3 21 gxh4 ♖e3+ 22 ♔f2 g6 23 ♖xh7! ±.

6) **12...♖a7** 13 ♘e4 (Winge-Ernst, Swedish Ch 1984 continued 13 ♖f1 ♖d7 14 ♖d1 ♕e5! 15 ♖f3 and now 15...gxf6 is ∓ according to Schüssler; however Black actually played 15...♗c5?! 16 fxg7 ♖xd4? and lost after 17 ♕xh7! ♖xd1+ 18 ♔xd1 ♖xh7 19 g8♕+ ♗f8 20 ♕xh7 +–) ♕e5 14 0-0-0 (White may transpose to line A, note to Black's 12th, by 14 ♘f3 ♕xb2 15 0-0 ♖d7 16 ♕e3; 14 0-0 will also transpose) ♖d7 15 ♕c3 (15 ♕g3 gives Black no problems after 15...♕xg3 16 hxg3 ♗b7 17 ♖h4 ♗xe4 18 fxg7 ♗xg7 19 ♖xe4 or 15...gxf6 16 ♕xe5 fxe5 17 ♘f6+ ♔e7 18 ♘xd7 ♗xd7, Minić-Fischer, Skopje 1967) ♗b7 (15...♕f4+ 16 ♔b1 ♖c7 17 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 18 fxg7 ♖xc3 19 gxh8♕, 15...♕xe4 16 ♕xc8+ ♖d8 17 ♕xd8+ ♔xd8 18 ♘xe6+ ♔c8 19 ♖d8+ ♔b7 20 ♗f3 and 15...♕c7 16 ♘xb5 axb5 17 fxg7 ♕xc3 18 gxf8♕+ ♔xf8 19 ♘xc3 are all very good for White) 16 ♘xb5 (16 ♗f3 b4 17 ♕c4 ♗d5 18 ♕d3 gxf6 and Black defends) ♕xc3 (16...♕xe4 17 ♕c7! winning, Herbrechtsmeier-Potterat, Biel 1994) 17 ♘bxc3 ♖xd1+ 18 ♖xd1 gxf6 19 ♘xf6+ ♔e7 20 ♘fe4 (20 ♘ce4 ♗g7 21 ♖f1 is best met by 21...♘d7 22 ♘xd7 ♗xe4 23 ♘c5 ♗xg2 rather than 21...♗xf6 22 ♘xf6 ♗xg2 23 ♖f2 ♗h3 24 ♗d3 h6 ⩲) f5 21 ♘c5 ♗h6+ 22 ♔b1 ♗xg2 23 ♗c4! (23 ♘xa6 ♘xa6 24 ♗xa6 ♗f4 or 24...f4 is unclear; in this position the central passed pawns supported by the two bishops can outweigh any material advantage, so White's first task must be to blockade them) e5 (23...♖c8!?) 24 ♘d5+ (24 ♗d5 ♗xd5 25 ♘xd5+ ♔d6! 26 ♘b7+ ♔c6 27 ♘a5+ ♔b5 28 ♘b3 f4 leads to a very

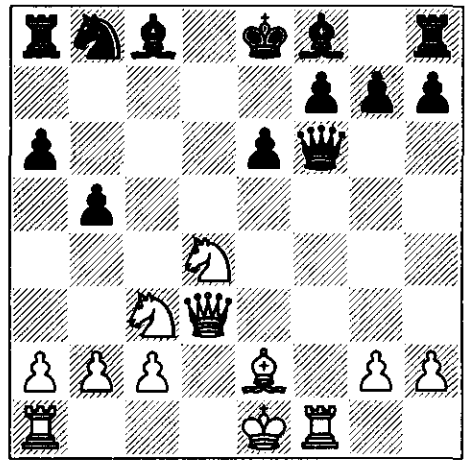
murky position) ♗xd5 25 ♖xd5 ♗f4 (25...♗g7 26 ♘xa6 is favourable for White) 26 h4 ♖c8 (26...h5 27 ♘d3 is ±, and 26...♗g3 27 ♔c1 ♗xh4 28 ♖xe5+ ♔f6 29 ♖e6+ is at least ±) 27 b4 ♖c6 28 h5 ± Herbrechtsmeier-Boll, corr 1984. I doubt if this ending offers White real winning chances, so the best line is almost certainly one of the options to transpose into line A.

13 ♖f1 *(D)*

The only significant alternative is **13 0-0-0** (other moves are not dangerous, e.g. 13 ♘e4 ♕e5 or 13 ♕e4 ♖a7 14 ♖f1 ♕g6 15 ♕f4 transposing to 13...♕g6 below) and now:

1) **13...♖a7** 14 ♕g3 stops Black re-centralising his queen; Schubert-Arnold, W.Germany 1976 continued 14...e5 15 ♖hf1 ♕h6+ 16 ♔b1 ♗d6 17 ♘dxb5! axb5 18 ♘xb5 ♖d7 19 ♘xd6+ ♖xd6 20 ♕xe5+ and White wins.

2) **13...♗e7!** 14 ♖hf1 ♕h6+ 15 ♔b1 0-0 16 ♕g3 (16 ♗f3 ♖a7 ∓) ♕g5! 17 ♕e1 ♖a7 (17...♗b7!?) 18 ♘f3, Hector-Polugaevsky, Haninge 1990, and now 18...♕c5 19 ♘e4 ♕c7 favours Black.



B

13 ... ♕e5

The odd-looking move **13...♕g5** has been played a couple of times: 14 ♘e4 (14 ♖d1 ♗b4 15 ♖xf7 ♔xf7 16 ♕f3+ ♔e7 17 ♕xa8 ♗d7 18 ♕e4 ♗xc3+ 19 bxc3 ♖f8 ½-½ Mathes-Albrecht, corr 1988) ♕e5 15 ♖d1 ♗b4+ 16 c3 ♗e7 17 ♘f3 ♕c7 18 ♘eg5 ♗f6 19 ♘xh7 ♘d7 = Gufeld-Bronstein, Vilnius Z 1975. However, 15 0-0-0 seems better; then Bronstein gives 15...♖a7, but this loses to 16 ♘xb5.

The main alternative is **13...♕g6** and now:

1) **14 ♕f3** ♖a7 leading to the variations:

1a) **15 ♕f4** ♘d7 16 ♘c6 e5 (16...♖b7 17 ♗d3 {17 ♖d1!? is more dangerous} ♕h5 18 g4 ♕h4+ 19 ♖f2 ♘f6 20 0-0-0 ♗c5 21 ♘e4 ♘xe4 22 ♗xe4 0-0 ∓ Guseinov-Yuferov, USSR 1975) 17 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 18 ♕xe5+ ♕e6 and after 19 ♕xe6+ or 19 ♕g3, Nunn-Gallagher, London 1979, Black is at least equal.

1b) **15 ♖d1** (15 ♘c6 ♗b7 16 ♗d3 ♗xc6 17 ♕e3 ♕h5 18 ♕xa7 ♗d6 and Black can be happy) ♖d7 (not 15...♗b4?! 16 ♘c6 ♘xc6 17 ♕xc6+ ♗d7 18 ♕b6 ♖a8 19 ♖xd7! with a tremendous attack) 16 ♕a8 ♗d6 17 ♘dxb5 axb5 (or 17...♗xh2) 18 ♖xd6 ♖xd6 19 ♕xb8 ♖d8 is fine for Black.

1c) **15 0-0-0** ♗e7 16 ♔b1 0-0 17 ♗d3 ♕h6 18 ♕g3 ♗d7 19 ♗e4 ♕g5?! (19...♗f6 ∓) Orzechowski-Müller, corr 1992, and now White could have kept the balance with the unlikely-looking combination 20 ♖xf7 ♔xf7 21 ♖f1+.

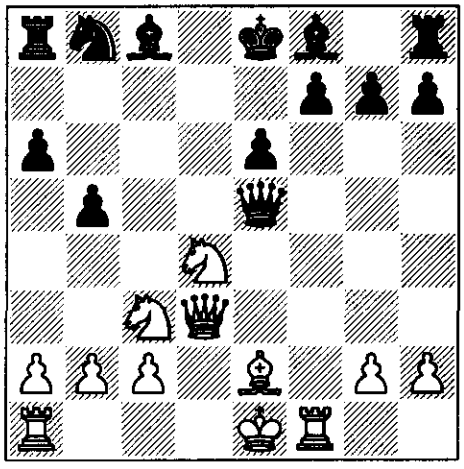
2) **14 ♕e3** ♗c5 15 ♗f3 ♖a7 16 ♘e4 ♗b4+ (this induces a slight weakening of White's position; instead 16...♖c7 17 ♕f4 ♗b6 18 ♘d6+

♔e7 19 ♖d1 gives White a very strong attack, e.g. 19...♖d8 20 ♗e4 f5 21 ♗xf5! ♕f6 22 ♘xc8+ ♖cxc8 23 ♘xe6 ±) 17 c3 ♗e7 18 ♘xe6 (18 ♘xb5 ♖d7) ♕xe6 (18...♖d7 19 ♗h5) 19 ♕xa7 ♘c6 20 ♕c7 f5 21 0-0-0 fxe4 22 ♖fe1! (22 ♗h5+ g6 23 ♗g4 ♕xg4 24 ♕xc6+ ♗d7 25 ♖xd7 ♕xd7 26 ♕a8+ ♕d8 27 ♕c6+ ♕d7 28 ♕a8+ ½-½ Matulović-Polugaevsky, Belgrade 1974) 0-0 (22...♕h6+ 23 ♔b1 ♗f5 24 ♗xe4 ♗xe4+ 25 ♖xe4 0-0 26 ♖xe7 ♘xe7 27 ♕xe7 ♕xh2 28 ♕e6+ ♔h8 29 ♕xa6 ♕xg2 30 ♕xb5 and here White has winning chances) 23 ♗xe4 ♗g5+ (23...♕h6+ 24 ♔b1 ♗g4 25 ♗xc6 ♗xd1 26 ♗d5+ 1-0 was Matulović-Böhmfeldt, Dortmund 1977) 24 ♔b1 ♘e7 25 ♗xh7+ ♔xh7 26 ♖xe6 ♗xe6 and in my view White is substantially better.

3) **14 ♕h3** ♖a7 15 ♗h5 ♕g5 (after 15...♕h6, 16 ♘e4 covers d2 so that 16...♖d7 may be answered by 17 ♘xe6) 16 ♘e4 ♕e5 17 0-0-0 ♗b4 (17...♕xe4 18 ♕c3! +–) 18 ♕h4 0-0 (18...♖d7 19 ♖xf7 ♖xf7 20 ♘xe6 +–) 19 ♘f3 ♗e7 20 ♗xf7+ ♔h8 (20...♖xf7 21 ♘xe5 ♗xh4 22 ♖xf7 ♖xf7 23 ♘xf7 ♔xf7 24 ♘d6+) 21 ♕xh7+ ♔xh7 22 ♘xe5 and White is winning, Jansson-Åkesson, Sweden 1981.

After 13...♕e5 *(D)* there are three moves:
B1: 14 0-0-0
B2: 14 ♖d1
B3: 14 ♘f3

B1 is weak, B2 is the main line and B3 is infrequently played, but may offer White good chances.



B1)

14 0-0-0 ♖a7

This is almost universally played:

1) **14...♗c5** (this looks risky, but there is no definite refutation) 15 ♘xe6 ♕e3+ 16 ♖d2 (16 ♔b1 ♕xd3 17 ♘c7+ ♔d8 18 ♘xa8 ♕xd1+ 19 ♖xd1 ♘d7 20 ♘e4 ♗a7 21 ♘d6 ♔e7 22 ♘c7 ♘b8! =) ♕xd3 17 ♘c7+ ♔d8 18 ♖xd3+ ♔xc7 19 ♖xf7+ ♘d7 20 ♗g4 ♖f8! 21 ♖xg7 ♖f1+ 22 ♘d1 ♗d6 ∞.

2) **14...♗e7** 15 ♕f3 (other moves are less clear, e.g. 15 ♗f3 ♖a7 16 ♘c6 ♘xc6 17 ♗xc6+ ♔f8 or 15 ♖xf7 ♔xf7 16 ♕f3+ ♗f6 17 ♕xa8 ♖d8) ♗g5+ 16 ♔b1 ♖a7 17 ♘dxb5 axb5 18 ♗xb5+ ♔f8 19 ♖d7 ♖xd7 20 ♗xd7 ♔e7 21 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 22 ♕xf7+ ♔d6 23 ♕b7 ♖xc3 24 ♖d1+ ♔c5 25 a4 +–.

15 ♘f3

15 ♕f3 ♗c5, 15 ♘xe6 ♖d7 16 ♘d4 ♗c5 and 15 ♘dxb5 ♖d7 16 ♕c4 ♗c5 are at least equal for Black.

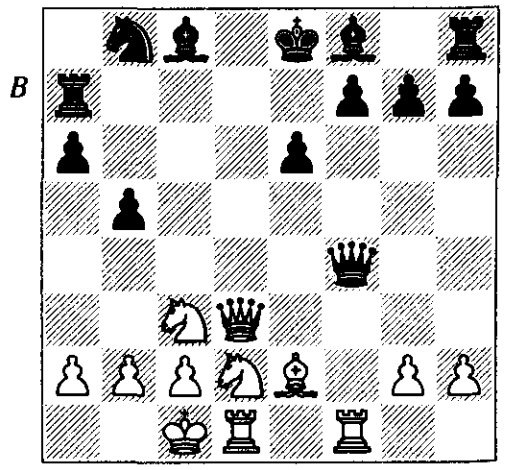
15 ... ♕f4+

Note that this check is another reason why Black should not preface ...♕xf6 by ...♕h4+. The alternative 15...♕c7 16 ♘e5 ♗e7 (16...f5?! 17 ♗h5+ g6 18 ♘xg6 hxg6 19 ♗xg6+ ♔e7 20 ♖xf5 +–) 17 ♘xf7 0-0 18

♘d6 ♖d8 19 ♘ce4 ♘c6 20 ♕f3 ♘e5 21 ♕e3 is better for White – Polugaevsky.

16 ♘d2 *(D)*

16 ♔b1 ♖d7 is clearly fine for Black.



16 ... ♕c7

Black already has a draw by 16...♕e5 17 ♘f3 ♕f4+ but 16...♕d6 is very risky, e.g. 17 ♕f3 ♕c6 18 ♘de4 b4 19 ♕f2! ♖d7 20 ♖xd7 ♘xd7 21 ♕xf7+ ♔d8 22 ♘g5 with a clear plus for White, Ljubojević-Mecking, Las Palmas 1975.

17 ♗h5 g6
18 ♕d4 e5
19 ♕f2

Or 19 ♕e3 (19 ♖de1 ♗e6! 20 ♖xe5 ♗g7) ♗e6 (19...♗c5 20 ♕h6 ♗f8 looks like another draw) 20 ♘de4 ♗e7 21 ♗g4! f5 22 ♗xf5 gxf5 23 ♕h6 (Marić) and now Van der Vliet gives 23...♕c6, e.g. 24 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 25 ♕xe6+ ♗e7 26 ♕xf5 ♘d7 and White still has to prove his attack. This does seem a better chance than 19 ♕f2, however.

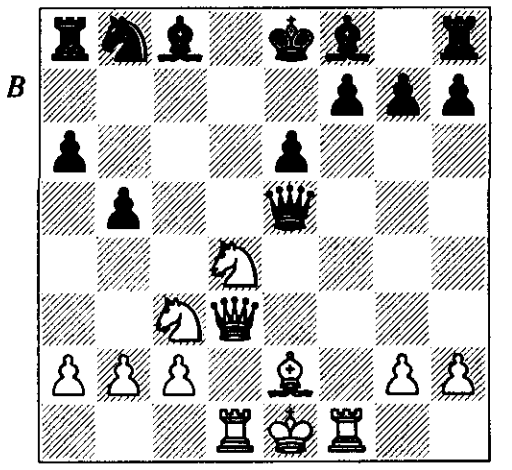
19 ... ♗c5

20 ♕f6 0-0 21 ♘d5 ♗e7! 22 ♕f3 ♗b7 23 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 24 ♕f2 ♗d5 25 ♗f3 ♗xa2 26 ♘e4 ♖c7 27 ♕b6 ♖fc8 28 ♘f6+? ♕xf6 0-1 Gheorghiu-Ljubojević, Amsterdam 1975.

Thus 14 0-0-0 is a draw at best.

B2)

14 ♖d1 *(D)*



This aims to avoid the check on f4 which saved Black in the previous line, but White's king gets stuck in the middle of the board.

14 ... ♖a7

Or:

1) **14...♕c7** 15 ♗h5 g6 16 ♗f3 ♖a7 17 ♘c6 ♘xc6 18 ♗xc6+ ♗d7, Beliavsky-Polugaevsky, Moscow 1981, 19 ♗xd7+ ♕xd7 20 ♕e3! +–.

2) **14...♗b4** 15 ♘xe6 ♗e7 16 ♕d5! ♕xe6 (16...♕xd5 17 ♘xd5 ♗b4+ 18 c3 ♗xe6 19 ♘c7+ ♔e7 20 ♘xa8 ♗a5 21 b4 ♗d8 22 ♗f3 ♗xa2 23 ♔f2 is also good for White) 17 ♕xa8 ♘c6 18 ♘d5, Klinger-Vera, Havana 1985 and Black has insufficient compensation for the sacrificed exchange.

3) **14...♗e7?** 15 ♕f3 +–.

4) **14...♗b7?** 15 ♘c6 +–.

15 ♘f3

15 ♘dxb5 ♖d7 16 ♕c4 and now:

1) **16...♗c5** 17 ♘e4 0-0 18 ♕xc5 (18 ♘xc5 ♖xd1+ 19 ♔xd1 axb5 20

♕xb5 is no good with the pawn on g2 since Black may simply reply 20...♕xh2) ♕xe4 19 ♘d6 ♕h4+ (once again Black benefits from having the pawn on g2) 20 g3 ♕e7 21 ♖f4 ♗b7 22 ♘xb7 ♖xd1+ 23 ♔xd1 ♕xb7 ∓.

2) **16...♔d8?** 17 ♘d4 ♗d6 18 ♘f3! ♕a5 was played in Wolff-Polugaevsky, Groningen 1993, and now 19 ♕g4! f5 20 ♕g5+ ♔c7 21 ♖xd6! ♔xd6 22 ♕g3+ e5 23 ♘d2! gives White a distinct advantage.

3) **16...♗b7** 17 ♖xd7 axb5 18 ♕c7 ♘xd7 19 ♕xb7 b4 ∞ Krcvnik-Janjić, corr 1983.

15 ... ♕c7

16 ♘g5

Better than 16 ♘e5 ♗e7 17 ♘xf7 ♕xh2 (17...0-0 18 ♘d6 ♖xf1+ 19 ♔xf1 ♗d7 20 ♘ce4 ♘c6 =, Ljubojević-Polugaevsky, Hilversum 1973, is a safe line) 18 g3 (18 ♘xh8 ♗h4+ 19 ♔d2 ♖d7) 0-0 (18...♖d7 19 ♕f3! ♗b7 20 ♕g4 0-0 21 ♖xd7 ♘xd7 22 ♕xe6 ♕xg3+ 23 ♔d1 ♘f6 24 ♘h6+ ♔h8 25 ♕xe7 wins) 19 ♘e5 (19 ♕f3 ♗b7 20 ♕e3 ♖xf7! and Black has more than sufficient compensation for the exchange according to Ljubojević) ♖xf1+ (19...♗f6 20 ♘g4 ♕g2 ∞ may be best) 20 ♗xf1 and Black has more problems than might appear at first sight, for example 20...♕g1 21 ♕f3 ♗f6 22 ♘e4 ♘d7 23 ♘xf6+ gxf6 24 ♘c6 ± Becker-Thinius, corr 1989 or 20...♘d7 21 ♘c6 ♗c5 22 ♖d2 ♕g1 (22...♕h5 23 ♘xa7 ♗xa7 24 ♕d6 ± Van der Kleij-Schellingerhout, corr 1988) 23 ♘xa7 ♗xa7 24 ♘e4 h6 25 ♕c3 ♘f8 26 ♘d6 ♗d7 27 ♕f3 ± Roselli-Bouaziz, Dubai OL 1986.

16 ... f5

Or:

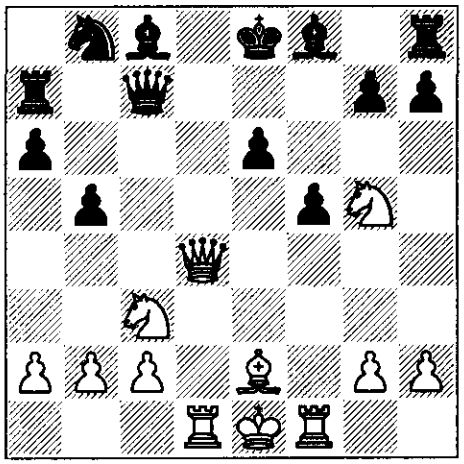
1) **16...♕b6** and now White has a choice of promising lines:

1a) **17 ♗h5** g6 18 ♘ce4 ♗e7 (18...gxh5 19 ♘f6+ ♔e7 20 ♘xf7! ♘d7 21 ♕c3! +−) 19 ♖xf7 (19 ♘xf7 0-0 20 ♗xg6 has been played in a number of postal games but, amazingly, I have yet to find a win against 20...hxg6) ♗b4+ 20 c3 ♖xf7 21 ♘xf7 ♕g1+ (21...♔xf7 22 cxb4 gxh5 23 ♕f3+ wins) 22 ♔d2 ♕xg2+ 23 ♗e2 ♔xf7 24 cxb4 and White's attack on the dark squares should be decisive.

1b) **17 ♘ce4** ♗b4+ 18 c3 ♗e7 19 ♘xf7 0-0 20 ♘h6+! gxh6 (20...♔h8 21 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 22 ♕f3 ♗e7 23 ♖d8+!) 21 ♕g3+ ♔h8 22 ♕e5+ ♔g8 23 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 24 ♘f6+ ♔h8 25 ♘d7+ ♗g7 26 ♕xg7+ ♔xg7 27 ♘xb6 ♗b7 28 ♘d7 with a near-decisive endgame advantage for White.

2) **16...♗e7** (this also appears dubious) 17 ♖xf7 ♘c6 (17...♕xh2 18 ♖xe7+! ♔xe7 19 ♕e3 ±; 17...♕e5 18 ♘f3 ±) 18 ♖xg7 (18 ♘ce4 ♘e5? 19 ♖xe7+! Andraca-Azpiri Medina, corr 1993) ♕xh2 19 ♖xh7 ♘e5, Ostos-Verduga, Caracas 1982, 20 ♖xe7+! ♔xe7 21 ♕d6+ ♔f6 22 ♘ce4+ ♔g6 23 ♘xe6 +−.

17 ♕d4! *(D)*



Now there is a further split:
B21: 17...h5
B22: 17...♕e7!

17...e5!? is a suggestion which has not been played in practice; the idea is 18 ♕d5 ♗b4 or 18 ♕h4 g6 19 ♘d5 ♕g7, but the whole concept looks dreadful for Black.

17...♖g8 looks even worse, and sure enough 18 ♖xf5 ♗e7 (18...exf5 19 ♘d5 ♕a5+ 20 ♔f1 ♘c6 21 ♕f6! is a nice win) 19 ♖f7 ♕c5 20 ♖xe7+ ♕xe7 21 ♘ce4 was 1-0 in Maeder-Czaya, corr 1978.

B21)

17 ... h5

It seems incredible that Black, who is only a pawn up, can defend after making so many concessions. Nevertheless Tal was unable to find a convincing line against Polugaevsky in their 1980 Candidates match. However, with correct play the position does indeed seem to favour White.

18 ♖xf5

Lepeshkin prefers the preparatory **18 a4** with the lines:

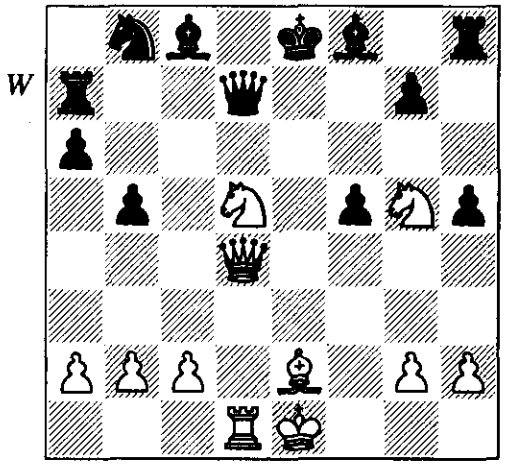
1) **18...b4** 19 ♗b5+ axb5 (anything to d7 leaves e6 hanging) 20 ♘xb5 ♕e7 21 ♘xa7 ♗a6 22 ♕e5 ♕xa7 23 ♘xe6 with a winning attack.

2) **18...bxa4** 19 ♖xf5 exf5 20 ♘d5 and it is claimed that the availability of c4 for the bishop improves White's attacking chances. However, this claim has not been tested in practice.

3) **18...♘c6** (the only response that has received a practical test) 19 ♕h4 ♕e5 (19...♗b4 20 ♖f3 ♕e5 21 axb5 axb5 22 ♔f1 ♗xc3 23 ♖xc3 ♖a4 24 ♕f2 ♗d7 25 ♘f3 ♕b8 26 ♕c5 ♕a7 27 ♕xa7 1-0 Pichler-Poppe, corr 1986) 20 axb5 axb5 21 ♘xb5 ♖b7? (21...♖d7 22 ♕c4 ±) 22 ♕c4! ♗d7 23 ♖xd7 ♔xd7 24 ♘f7 +– A.Rodriguez-Vera, Havana 1982.

18 ... exf5
19 ♘d5 ♕d7 *(D)*

19...♕a5+ and now White may play 20 c3 or 20 ♔f1, e.g. **20 ♔f1** ♘c6 21 ♘f6+ (21 ♕e3+ ♗e7 22 ♘e6 ♔f7 or 21 ♕h4 ♗e7) gxf6 22 ♕xf6 ♖g7 (or else ♕g6+) 23 ♕xc6+ ♗d7 24 ♖xd7 ♖xd7 25 ♕g6+ ♔d8 26 ♕f6+ ♔c8 27 ♕xh8 ♕d8 28 ♕xh5 with some advantage for White. It is hard to see why c3 is better than ♔f1, but nevertheless Van der Wiel-Grooten, Dutch Ch 1980, went **20 c3** ♗d6?! 21 ♘f6+ gxf6 22 ♕xf6 ♖e7 23 ♖xd6 ♖g8 24 ♔f1 ♗d7 25 ♗xh5+ ♔d8 26 ♘e6+ ♔c8 27 ♕xe7 ♕xa2 28 ♖xd7 ♘xd7 29 ♕d6 1-0.



20 ♖d3!

Taulbut originally pointed out the strength of this move. The alternatives are unconvincing:

1) **20 ♕h4** ♗e7 21 ♔f1 (21 ♘f4 ♗xg5 22 ♕xg5 ♕e7 or 21 ♗xh5+

♔f8 22 ♘f4 ♕e8!) ♗xg5 22 ♗xh5+ ♔f8 23 ♕xg5 ♖xh5?! (23...♕d6! is good according to Taulbut) 24 ♕xh5 ♕f7 25 ♕h8+ ♕g8 26 ♕h4 ♔f7 (26...♘c6! 27 ♘b4 ♗d7 28 ♘xc6 ♗xc6 29 ♖d8+ ♗e8 ∓) 27 ♕h5+ g6 28 ♕h4 ♕g7 29 ♕d8 ♗e6 30 ♕xb8 ♖d7 31 c4? (31 ♘c3 is just slightly better for Black) bxc4? (31...♕xb2! ∓) 32 ♘c3 ♖xd1+ 33 ♘xd1 ♕d4 34 ♘c3 ♕d3+ 35 ♔f2 ♕d4+ 36 ♔f1 ♕d3+ ½-½ Tal-Polugaevsky, Alma Ata Ct (4) 1980.

2) **20 ♕e5+** ♗e7 21 ♘c3 0-0 22 ♖xd7 ♖xd7 23 ♕e6+ ♔h8 24 ♕g6 ♗xg5 25 ♕xg5 gave White the superior ending in Falkowski-Rauhut, corr 1984, but 21...♕c6! is critical.

20 ... ♖h6

Or:

1) **20...♘c6** (20...f4? loses to 21 ♕e4+ ♗e7 22 ♕g6+) 21 ♖e3+ ♘e7 (21...♔d8 22 ♕b6+ or 21...♗e7 22 ♕xg7) 22 ♘f6+! gxf6 23 ♕xf6 with a winning attack, e.g. 23...♖g8 24 ♗xh5+ ♔d8 25 ♕b6+ ♕c7 26 ♖d3+ ♘d5 27 ♕f6+.

2) **20...♖b7** 21 ♖e3+ ♔d8 22 ♘e6+ ♕xe6 23 ♖xe6 ♗xe6 24 ♘f4+ ♗d7 and now Taulbut gives 25 ♘g6 but 25 ♗f3! is winning, e.g. 25...♖c7 26 ♘e6+ ♔c8 27 ♘xc7 ♔xc7 28 ♕a7+ or 25...♔c8 26 ♗xb7+ ♔xb7 27 ♘g6.

21 ♖e3+ ♔d8

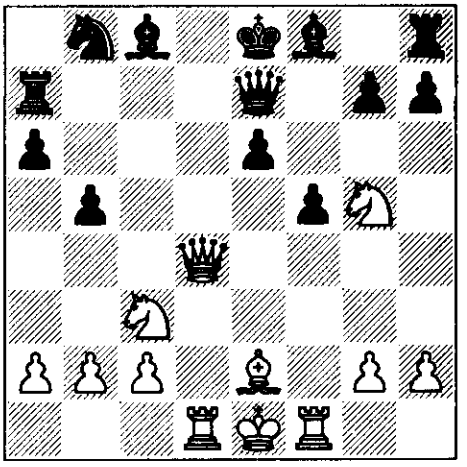
22 ♕h4!

winning, e.g. 22...♕xd5 23 ♘e6+ ♔e8 24 ♘c7+ ♔f7 25 ♘xd5 +– Van de Drift-Sprinkhuizen, corr 1986.

B22)

17 ... ♕e7! *(D)*

Hodgson discovered this remarkable resource. Black moves his queen yet again, but general principles mean nothing in such a position. Polugaevsky himself adopted this move in the 1985 Biel Interzonal.



18 ♗h5+

Or:

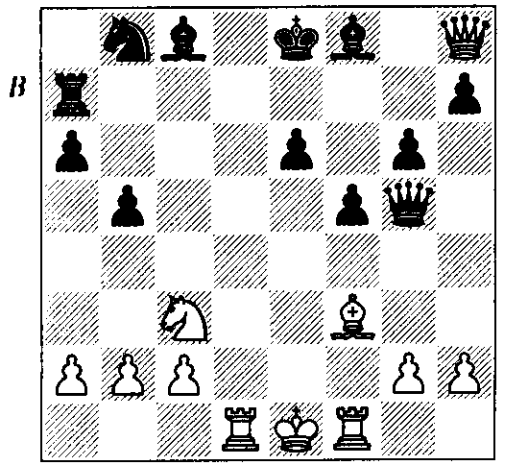
1) **18 ♘ge4** h5 (not 18...fxe4? 19 ♗h5+ g6 20 ♕xh8 gxh5 21 ♖xf8+ +–) 19 ♘d6+ ♕xd6 20 ♕xa7 ♕e5 (20...♕xh2 was played in Van der Wiel-Hodgson, Ostend 1983, when 21 ♖d3! ♘c6 {21...♗e7 22 g3 ♘d7 23 ♕a8 and 21...♗d7 22 ♖h3 ♕e5 23 ♖e3 ♗c5 24 ♖xe5 ♗xa7 25 ♖fxf5 are very good for White} 22 ♕b6 would have caused Black problems) 21 ♕d4 (21 ♖d3 ♗c5 is assessed as unclear by Polugaevsky) ♘d7! and now:

1a) **22 ♕xe5** ♘xe5 23 ♔d2 (White should play a4 at some stage since otherwise he cannot do anything with his queenside pawn majority) ♗d6 24 ♔c1 ♔e7 25 ♖fe1 ♗d7 26 ♗f1 ♖c8 27 ♔b1 g5 ∓ A.Rodriguez-Polugaevsky, Biel IZ 1985.

1b) **22 a4** b4 23 ♘a2 ♗c5 24 ♕xe5 ♘xe5 25 c3 bxc3 26 b4 ♗e7 27 ♖c1 ♗b7 28 ♖xc3 ♔d7 29 ♔f2 ♗d5 30 ♖c2 ∞ Pichler-Grahl, corr 1987.

2) **18 h4** (an odd move) h5 19 ♖xf5 exf5 20 ♘d5 ♘c6 21 ♕b6 (21 ♘xe7 ♘xd4 22 ♘xc8 ♖d7 –+) ♕d6 (21...♕b7 22 ♕e3+ ♗e7 is possible) 22 ♗f3, Minquell-Martin Gonzalez, Barcelona 1984, 22...♖d7 –+.

18 ... g6
19 ♕xh8 ♕xg5
20 ♗f3 *(D)*



One of the critical positions for the assessment of the whole Polugaevsky.

20 ... ♖g7

The main alternative is **20...♘d7** (20...b4 21 ♘e2 ♕e7 22 ♕e5 ♖c7 23 ♖d2 ♗g7 24 ♕a5 ♕c5 25 ♕xc5 ♖xc5 = Van Kempen-Freeman, corr 1991) and now:

1) **21 ♖f2** ♕h6? (21...♘f6! 22 ♗c6+ ♔f7 23 ♖d8 ♗h6! 24 ♖xc8 ♕e3+ 25 ♔f1 ♕c1+ 26 ♔e2 ♕d2+ =) 22 ♖d6! ♘b6 (22...♔f7 23 ♖xe6! ♔xe6 24 ♖e2+ ♔d6 25 ♕d4+ ♔c7 26 ♕xa7+ ♔d8 27 ♕e3 +–) 23 ♖e2 ♘c4 24 ♕f6! ♗e7 25 ♗c6+ ♗d7 26 ♖dxe6 1-0 Hellers-Polugaevsky, Haninge 1989.

2) **21 ♕d4** ♖c7 22 a3 ♕h6 23 ♖d2 ♕xh2 24 ♔d1 ♕e5 25 ♕h4 h5 26 ♖e1 ♕f6 27 ♕g3 ♔d8 ∓ Castelfranchi-Leroy, Budapest 1994.

3) **21 ♕xh7** looks best. After 21...♕e3+ 22 ♘e2 ♘e5 23 ♕h4, intending ♕f4 or ♕d4, Black must still justify his sacrifice.

21 ♖f2 b4
22 ♖fd2

White has a promising alternative in 22 ♘e2 ♘d7 23 ♘d4 ♘f6 and now Hellers gives 24 ♘c6 ♗d7 25 ♖e2 ♖g8 26 ♖xe6+ ♗xe6 27 ♖d8+ ♔f7 28 ♘e5+ with a draw, but 24 ♖e2! appears very strong, for example 24...♖g8 25 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 26 ♖xe6+ ♗e7 27 ♖xf6! +–.

22 ... ♗d7
23 ♘e2

The position is very unclear, but the general impression is that White has the advantage, for example:

1) **23...e5** 24 ♖d5 ♕e7 (24...e4 25 ♖e5+ ♔f7 26 ♗xe4 ♕h4+ 27 g3 ♕xh2 28 ♗d5+ +–) 25 ♘c1 e4 26 ♗e2 f4!? 27 ♖1d4 (27 ♔f1!? f3 28 gxf3 ♗h3+ 29 ♔f2 ♕h4+ 30 ♔g1 ±) f3 28 gxf3 exf3 29 ♖f4 ♘c6 (not 29...fxe2 30 ♖e5 +–) 30 ♖xf3 ♗f5 31 ♔d1 (31 ♘d3!) ♗e4 32 ♖e3 ♗xd5 33 ♖xe7+ ♔xe7 34 ♘d3 ♗g8! 35 b3 a5 36 ♔d2 g5! 37 ♔e3? ♔f6 38 ♗f3 ♘e7 39 ♗e4 ♘f5+! 40 ♔d2 ♘h6 41 ♗d5 ♔e7 ½-½ Rittner-Boll, corr 1990.

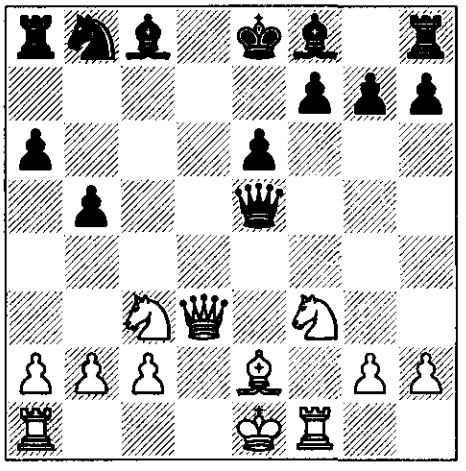
2) **23...♕d8** 24 ♘f4 ♕f6 25 ♖e2 e5 26 ♘d5 ♕d6 27 c3!? e4 28 ♗xe4 fxe4 29 ♖xe4+ ♔f7 30 g4 ♗xg4 31 ♖xg4 ♕e6+ 32 ♔d2 ♕xd5+ 33 ♔c1 ♕f5 34 ♖gg1 ♗c5 35 ♖ge1 ♖g8 36 ♕xh7+ ♖g7 37 ♕h8 ♖g8 38 ♕h7+ ♖g7 39 ♕h4 ♘d7 40 ♕c4+ ♔f8 41 cxb4 1-0 Koch-Gallagher, Lyon 1993.

B3)

14 ♘f3 *(D)*

This attempts to combine the best features of lines B1 and B2. In view of Black's counterplay against the king on e1 in the last line, White once again aims to castle queenside, but only after depriving Black of the check on f4 as in line B1. The question is whether this compensates for the tempo Black saves by missing out ...♖a7.

B



14 ... ♕d6

This prevents castling, at the cost of another tempo after a later ♖d1. Other moves:

1) **14...♕c7** 15 ♘g5 f5 16 ♕e3 (16 ♕d4 h5 17 0-0-0 also appears promising; it is similar to line B2 but with the white king better placed) ♕e7 17 0-0-0 g6 18 ♘ge4!? ♕a7! 19 ♕g5 ♗e7 20 ♕h6 ♗f8 21 ♘d6+ (21 ♕g5 is a draw) ♗xd6 22 ♖xd6 ♕e7 23 ♖fd1 ♖a7, Labuz-Rogalewicz, corr 1993, and now 24 ♖d8+ ♕xd8 25 ♖xd8+ ♔xd8 26 ♕h4+ followed by 27 ♕d4 wins immediately.

2) **14...♕c5** 15 0-0-0 ♗e7 16 ♘e4 ♕c7 17 ♘fg5 f5 18 ♕h3! g6 (or 18...♗xg5+ 19 ♘xg5 g6 20 ♕e3 ♕e7 21 ♗f3 ♖a7 22 ♖fe1 0-0 23 ♘xe6 ± Gusev-Yuferov, Tallinn 1976) 19 ♘xh7 ♕e5 (19...fxe4 20 ♕h6 ♖g8 21 ♗h5! ±) 20 ♕h6 ♖g8 21 ♗h5 ♕g7 22 ♗xg6+ ♕xg6 23 ♘hf6+ ♔f7 24 ♘xg8 ♕xg8 25 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 26 ♖xd6 ±.

15 ♕e4

15 ♕e3!? (a logical and noteworthy move, keeping e4 clear for the knight and preventing ...♖a7) ♘d7 16 ♘g5 ♘f6 17 ♗h5 ♘xh5 18 ♘xf7 ♕xh2 19 0-0-0 ♗e7 20 ♘xh8 ♕xg2 21 ♘f7 ♗d7 22 ♘e4 ♘f6 23 ♘fd6+ ♔f8 24 ♖g1 ♕h2 25 ♕g5 1-0 Van Buuren-Boll, corr 1980.

15 ... ♖a7

After 15...♕c6 16 ♕f4 the continuations 16...♗d6 17 ♘e5, 16...f6 17 ♘e5! and 16...♕d6 17 ♘e5 f6 18 ♗h5+ ♔e7 19 ♖d1 are all very good for White.

16 ♖d1

and now:

1) **16...♕c6** 17 ♕f4 ♕c7 18 ♘e5 ♗d6 19 ♕xf7+ ♕xf7 20 ♘xf7 ♖xf7 21 ♖xd6 leads to a slight advantage for White.

2) **16...♕c5!?** 17 ♘e5 (17 ♖d5 ♕b4; 17 ♕f4!?) ♗d6 18 ♘d3 ♕b6 19 ♘f4 0-0 is good for Black, Pantaleoni-Ricci, corr 1991.

3) **16...♕b4** 17 ♕e3 ♖d7 18 ♘e5 ♗c5 19 ♕g3 0-0 20 ♘d3 ♖xd3 21 ♗xd3 ♘d7 22 ♖f4 ♕xb2 23 ♗xh7+ ♔xh7 24 ♖h4+ ♔g8 25 ♖g4 g6 26 ♖xg6+ fxg6 27 ♕xg6+ drawing, Watson-Hodgson, Reykjavik 1989.

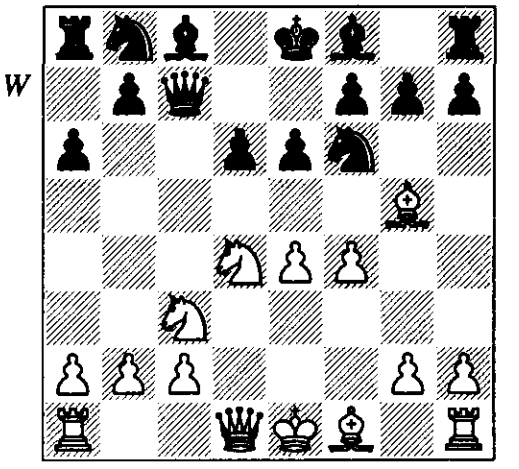
14 ♘f3 has few practical tests, but it appears promising.

13 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♕c7

In this and the following chapter Black delays, or omits entirely, the move ...♗e7, preferring instead to develop his queenside play with a quick ...b5, while restraining White's e4-e5. The next chapter deals with 7...♘bd7 and we consider here only those lines which do not quickly transpose to chapter 14.

In many ways, 7...♕c7 is a logical move. If Black does not want to venture into the Polugaevsky Variation, then he must prevent e4-e5 before pushing his b-pawn. Since ...♕c7 is a move Black will almost certainly play sooner of later, it is an efficient way of preparing the queenside advance. Despite this, it is not a very popular move. Many players have a vague feeling that it looks a little dubious, but the concrete analysis below shows that it is not easy for White to put his finger on a specific defect.

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♕c7 *(D)*



White has three major lines:

A: 8 ♗xf6
B: 8 ♕f3
C: 8 ♗d3

A is relatively harmless, giving White at most an edge, while C is almost untested. B is the critical line and it is because of variation B1 that 7...♕c7 has declined. However, this perception is probably not valid.

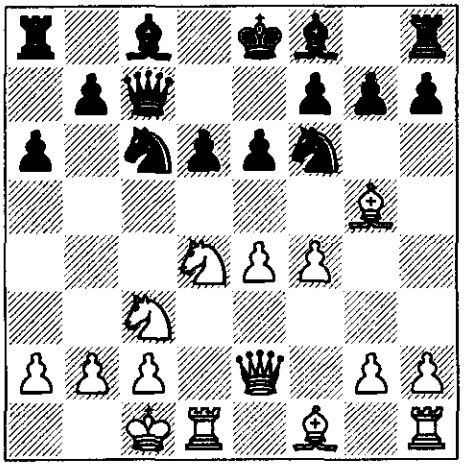
Other moves:

1) **8 f5** ♗e7 (8...♘c6 9 fxe6 fxe6 10 ♘xc6 bxc6 11 ♗e2 ♗e7 12 e5 dxe5 13 ♗h5+ g6 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 15 0-0 ∞ Vitolinš-Kengis, Latvian Ch 1975) 9 ♕d3!? (9 fxe6 fxe6 10 g3 {10 ♗e2 0-0 11 ♗g4 ♘xg4 12 ♕xg4 e5 13 ♘f5 ♗xf5 14 exf5 ♗xg5 15 ♕xg5 ♘c6 = Vitolinš-Gutman, USSR 1975} ♘c6 11 ♗h3 ♕a5! 12 ♘xc6 bxc6 13 ♕d2 ♖b8 14 ♖b1 h6 15 ♗e3 0-0 16 0-0 ♕h5 = Matulović-Tukmakov, Titograd 1982) ♘c6 10 0-0-0 ♘xd4 11 ♕xd4 (now the position resembles a Richter-Rauzer) ♗d7 12 ♗c4 b5 13 fxe6 fxe6 14 ♗b3 ♕c5 15 ♗xf6 gxf6 16 ♕d3 ♕g5+ 17 ♔b1 h5? 18 e5! d5 19 ♘xd5! +– Niedermaier-Degenhardt, Bundesliga 1991.

2) **8 ♕e2** (this has become more popular recently) ♘c6 (8...♘bd7 is chapter 14; 8...♗e7 9 0-0-0 b5 10 e5 dxe5 11 fxe5 ♘d5 12 ♗xe7 ♘xc3 13

♕g4 ♕xe5 ∞; 8...b5 9 e5 b4? {Black should prefer 9...dxe5 10 fxe5 ♘fd7, which leads to chapter 11} 10 exf6 {10 ♘cb5! axb5 11 exf6 is simple and strong} bxc3 11 0-0-0 ♕b6 12 b3 ♕a5 13 ♖d3 ♕xa2 14 ♖xc3 ± Tukmakov-Rashkovsky, USSR 1966) 9 0-0-0 *(D)* and now:

B



2a) **9...♘xd4** 10 ♖xd4 ♗e7 (if 10...b5, then 11 g3 ±) and now:

2a1) **11 ♗h4!?** 0-0 12 e5 dxe5 13 fxe5 ♘d5 14 ♘xd5 exd5 15 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 16 ♕e3 ♖e8! 17 ♖xd5 ♗e6 ∞.

2a2) **11 ♕d3** 0-0 12 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 13 ♖xd6 ♗e7! ∓.

2a3) **11 g3** ♗d7! (11...b5? 12 ♗g2 ♗b7 13 ♖hd1 0-0 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 ±) 12 ♗g2 h6 (12...♗c6!? 13 ♖hd1 h6 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 15 e5 dxe5 16 ♗xc6+ bxc6 17 ♖d7 ♕a5 18 ♘e4 ♕xa2! 19 ♕h5 0-0 20 ♘xf6+ gxf6 ∞) 13 ♗h4 ♗c6 and now:

2a31) **14 ♖c4** ♕b6 15 a3 (15 e5 ♗xg2 16 ♕xg2 dxe5 17 fxe5 ♘d5 18 ♗xe7 {18 ♘xd5 exd5 19 ♕xd5 ♖d8! ∓} ♘xe7 19 ♕e4 ♘c6 20 ♘a4 ♕c7 21 ♘c5 ♕xe5 22 ♘xb7 ♕xe4 23 ♘d6+ ♔e7 24 ♘xe4 ♖hc8 ½-½ Luther-Sadler, Altensteig 1992) ♖d8 (15...0-0 16 e5 ♗xg2 17 ♕xg2 dxe5 18 fxe5 ♕e3+ 19 ♔b1 ♕xe5 20 ♕xb7 ♖fe8 ∓) 16 ♗f3 0-0 17 ♖f1 ♖d7 18 e5 ♗xf3 19 ♕xf3 dxe5 20 fxe5 ♘d5 21 ♘xd5 exd5 22 ♗xe7 dxc4 23 ♗xf8 ♔xf8 24 ♕f5 ♕b5 25 e6 ♕xf5 26 ♖xf5 ♖e7 27 exf7 ♖xf7 with equality, Ljubojević-Xu, Novi Sad OL 1990.

2a32) **14 f5** 0-0 15 ♖hd1 b5!, Ljubojević-Kasparov, Belgrade 1989, and now Kasparov and Dvorković give 16 fxe6 fxe6 17 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 18 ♖xd6 b4 19 ♖xc6! ♕xc6 20 e5 ♕c7 21 ♗xa8 bxc3 ∞. However, 21 exf6 bxc3 22 ♕xe6+ wins instantly, e.g. 22...♔h8 23 ♕e7 or 22...♕f7 23 ♕xf7+ ♔xf7 24 fxg7, etc. Black can improve earlier by 17...♖xf6.

2a4) **11 e5** dxe5 12 fxe5 ♘d5 13 ♗xe7?! (13 ♗d2!? ♘xc3 14 ♗xc3 0-0 15 ♕e4 ♗d7 16 ♗d3 g6 17 ♗b4 is equal) and now:

2a41) **13...♘xe7** 14 ♘e4 0-0 15 ♕h5 ♘g6 16 ♘g5 h6 17 ♘f3, Ivanchuk-Kasparov, Tilburg 1989, and now Kasparov's line 17...♖d8! 18 ♖xd8+ ♕xd8 19 ♕g4! ♕a5! 20 ♗c4 ♗d7 21 ♖e1 ♗c6 would have been good for Black due to White's weak e-pawn.

2a42) Kasparov gives **13...♘xc3** 14 ♕g4 ♕xe5 15 ♗h4 ♕e3+ 16 ♖d2 ♘xa2+ 17 ♔d1 0-0 18 ♕a4 e5 19 ♗f2 ♕f4 20 ♕xa2 ♗g4+ 21 ♗e2 ±. However, 18...♕e5! 19 c3 b5 appears very promising for Black, so this line may also favour Black.

2b) **9...♗e7** and now:

2b1) **10 ♘xc6** ♕xc6 (10...bxc6 11 e5 dxe5 12 ♕xe5 ♕b6 13 ♘a4 ♕b4 14 ♖d4 ♕b8 15 ♗e2 c5 16 ♖c4 ♕xe5 17 fxe5 ♘d7 18 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 19 ♖e1 ♘xe5 20 ♖xc5 ♘d7 = Hraček-Wojtkiewicz, Warsaw Z 1990) 11 e5 dxe5 12 fxe5 ♘d5 13 ♗xe7

♘xe7 14 ♖d6 ♕c7 15 g3 with an edge for White.

2b2) **10 g3** 0-0 (10...h6 11 ♗h4 ♗d7 12 ♗g2 ♘xd4 13 ♖xd4 is line 1c above) 11 ♗g2 ♗d7 12 ♔b1 h6 13 ♗h4 ♖fe8 14 ♘f3 ♖ad8 15 e5 dxe5 16 ♘xe5 ♘b8 17 ♘e4 ♗b5 18 c4 ♘xe4 ½-½ Luther-Kaminski, Dresden 1992.

2b3) **10 ♘f3** 0-0 11 ♕e1 (if White has to play this simply in order to develop his bishop, then the whole idea appears artificial) ♖d8 (11...b5 12 ♗d3 h6 13 ♗xh6 gxh6 14 e5 ♘h7 15 h4 dxe5 16 fxe5 f6 17 ♖h3 ♔h8 18 ♖g3 ♖a7 is very unconvincing, although White did later manage to draw in Prié-Renet, French Ch 1991) 12 ♗d3 ♘b4 13 ♖f1 b5 14 e5 ♘xd3+ 15 ♖xd3 dxe5 16 ♖xd8+ ♕xd8 17 fxe5 ♘d7 18 h4 h6 19 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 20 ♘e4 ♗b7 = Biriescu-Takacs, Romanian Ch 1988.

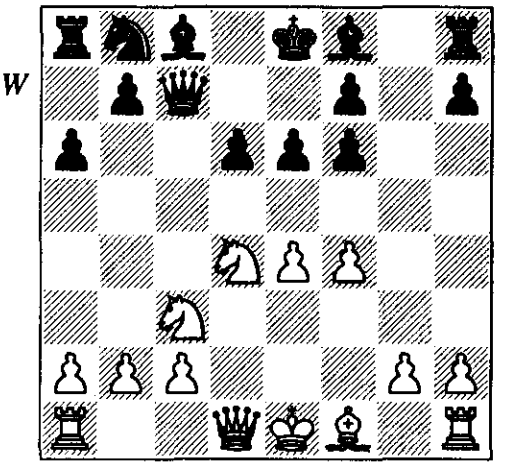
A)

8 ♗xf6

This is White's safest system against 7...♕c7. The general structure arising is very similar to some lines of the Richter-Rauzer. White has chances to gain an edge, but it is hard to get wildly excited about his position.

8 ... gxf6 *(D)*

9 ♗e2



There are various other ideas:

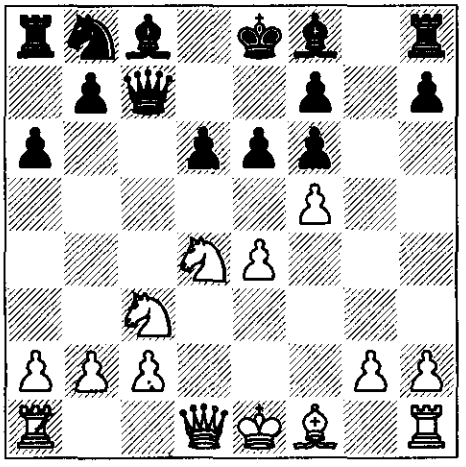
1) **9 ♕h5** ♕c5! is safe for Black.

2) **9 ♕d3** (an interesting idea; the queen can easily switch to the kingside) ♘c6 (9...b5 10 0-0-0 ♘d7 11 ♕h3 ♘c5 12 a3 ♖b8 13 f5 b4 14 axb4 ♖xb4 15 fxe6 fxe6 16 ♗e2 ± Videki-Robović, Kecskemet 1994) 10 0-0-0 ♗d7 11 ♗e2 h5 12 ♔b1 0-0-0 13 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 (13...♗xc6 14 ♕h3 ♕a5 15 f5 ♕e5 16 ♖he1 ♔b8 17 ♗xh5 b5 18 ♕e3 ± Am.Rodriguez-Minaya, Bogota 1992) 14 ♕h3 ♕c5 15 f5 ♔b8 16 ♖hf1 b5 17 ♗d3 ♕e5 18 ♘e2 ♗h6 19 c3 ♗g5 20 ♘d4 ♕c5 21 ♗c2 e5 22 ♘f3 ± Am.Rodriguez-Nisipeanu, Erevan OL 1996.

3) **9 ♕d2** (this may transpose to the main line; here we only consider variations without an early ♗e2) ♘c6 (9...b5 10 a4 b4 11 ♘a2 ♗b7 12 f5 e5 13 ♘b3 ♗xe4 14 ♘xb4 ♘d7 15 ♘xa6?! {15 ♗d3 ±} ♕b7 16 ♘b4 ♖g8 17 ♖g1 ♕b6 ∓ Matulović-Vaisman, Zrenjanin 1980) 10 0-0-0 ♗d7 (10...h5 11 ♔b1 ♗d7 12 f5? ♗h6 13 ♕e2 ♘xd4 14 ♖xd4 ♗f4 15 g4 hxg4 16 ♕xg4 ♗e5 ∓ Mochocki-Banaszkiewicz, corr 1992) 11 ♔b1 (11 ♘b3 b5 12 ♔b1 h5 13 f5 ♘e5 14 fxe6 fxe6 15 ♘d4 b4 16 ♘ce2 ♗h6 17 ♘f4 ♗xf4 18 ♕xf4 ♔e7 19 ♗e2 ± Yudasin-Polgar, Oviedo rpd 1992) 0-0-0 (11...h5 12 g3 0-0-0 13 ♗h3 ♔b8 14 f5 ♘xd4 15 ♕xd4 ♗e7 16 ♖d2 ± Gebuhr-Kleym, corr 1988; 11...♗e7 12 g3 ♘xd4 13 ♕xd4 ♕c5 14 ♕d3 ♗c6 15 f5 e5 16 ♕c4 ♕a5 17 ♗e2 0-0 18 g4 ♖ac8 19 ♕b3 b5 20 h4 ± Goldberg-Degenhardt, German Cup 1992) 12 f5 (12 ♗e2 will

transpose to the main line; 12 ♘ce2 ♔b8 13 g3 h5 14 ♗g2 ♗e7 15 h4 ♘xd4 16 ♘xd4 ♖dg8 ∓ Rowson-Am.Rodriguez, Erevan 1996) h5 (or 12...♔b8 13 ♗c4 ♘xd4 14 ♕xd4 ♗e7 15 ♗b3 ♕c5 16 ♕d3 h5 17 ♕f3 with a slight advantage for White, Shmuter-Vaulin, St Petersburg 1993) 13 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 14 fxe6 fxe6 15 ♕f2 ♗e7 16 ♖d4 b5 17 a4 ♕c5 18 axb5 axb5 19 h4 ♖hf8 20 ♕d2 ♗c6 21 ♖h3 f5 22 ♘a4 ♕e5 23 ♖c3 ♔b7 24 ♖b4 d5 25 ♖xc6! ♔xc6 26 ♗xb5+ ♔d6 27 ♖c4 ♕g3 28 e5+ 1-0 Brodsky-Avrukh, Groningen 1993.

4) **9 f5** *(D)* (premature) and now:



B

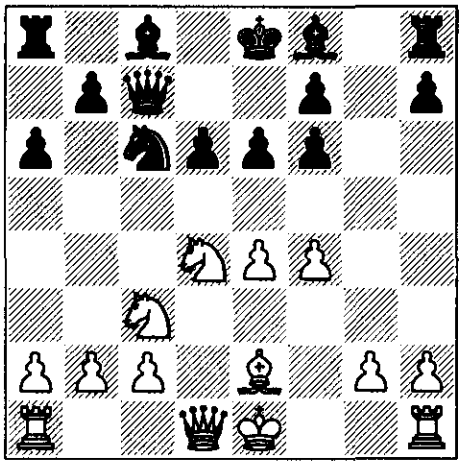
4a) **9...♘c6** 10 fxe6 (10 ♗c4 ♘xd4 11 ♕xd4 ♖g8 12 g3 ♕c5 13 0-0-0 ♕xd4 14 ♖xd4 ♗d7 = Gufeld-Rashkovsky, USSR 1975; 10 ♗e2 ♕b6! 11 ♘b3 ♕e3 {11...♗d7 12 ♗h5 ♕e3+ 13 ♕e2 ♕xe2+ 14 ♔xe2 ♔e7 ∓ Werner-Sauermann, corr 1956} 12 ♕d3 {12 ♘d2 ♘e5 ∓ Kotkov-Balashov, USSR 1970} ♕h6 13 ♕f3 ♗d7 14 0-0 ♗e7 15 ♕h5 ♕xh5 16 ♗xh5 ♔f8 17 ♖ad1 ♘e5 = Lengyel-Dao Thien Hai, Budapest 1993) fxe6 11 ♗e2 (11 ♗c4 ♘xd4 12 ♕xd4 ♖g8! ∓) ♕b6 12 ♗h5+ ♔e7 13 ♘xc6+ bxc6 14 ♕d2 (14 ♕f3 ♗h6 15 ♖d1 a5 ∓ Vaskan-Sakharov, USSR 1961) ♖b8 15 b3 ♕c5 16 0-0-0 ♗g7 ∓ Ruxton-Badea, Oakham 1990.

4b) **9...♕c5** (this appears less reliable) 10 ♕d3 (10 fxe6 fxe6 11 ♗e2 h5 12 ♕d3 ♗h6 13 ♖d1 ♔e7 14 ♕f3 h4? 15 0-0 ♗g5 16 ♔h1 ♗d7 17 e5 +– Hetenyi-Kiss, Budapest 1995; 10 ♗e2 ♘c6 11 ♘b3 ♕e3 12 fxe6 fxe6 13 ♕d2 ♕xd2+ 14 ♘xd2 ♘e5 15 ♖f1 ♔e7 16 ♘a4 ♘d7 17 ♖f3 b5 18 ♘c3 ♗h6 ∓ Vasiesiu-Nisipeanu, Romanian Ch 1994) ♘c6 11 ♘b3 (11 ♘xc6 bxc6 12 0-0-0 ♗h6+?! 13 ♔b1 ♗f4 14 e5! exf5 15 exd6 ♗e6, Stummer-Gavrikov, Bern 1990, 16 ♕f3! ♗xd6 17 ♘a4 ♕e5 18 ♕xc6+ ♔e7 19 ♘b6 ±) ♕e5 (11...♕b6 12 0-0-0 ♗d7 13 ♕h3 0-0-0 14 ♗c4 ♖e8 15 ♖hf1 ♘e5 16 ♗e2 ♔b8 17 ♔b1 ♗e7 18 ♖d4 ♖c8 19 ♖f4!? h6 20 ♖h4 ♗f8 21 a3 ∞ Zelinsky-Kopylov, corr 1988) 12 0-0-0 (12 fxe6 fxe6 13 0-0-0 b5 14 ♔b1 ♗b7 15 ♕e3 ♗e7 16 ♗e2 0-0 17 ♕h3 ♔h8 18 ♗g4 b4 19 ♘e2 ♘d8 20 ♘g3 a5 21 ♘d4 ± Kavalek-Chandler, Bundesliga 1983) ♗d7 13 ♔b1 ♗e7 14 ♘a4 ♘b4 15 ♕d2 ♗xa4 16 ♕xb4 ♗c6 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♘d4 d5 19 ♕b3 ♗c5 20 exd5 ♗xd5 21 ♗c4 ± Zelinsky-Kopylov, corr 1993.

9 ... ♘c6 *(D)*

Or 9...b5 (dubious) 10 ♗h5 (10 0-0 b4 11 ♘a4 ♗d7 12 b3 ♗g7 13 ♕d2 ♗xa4 14 bxa4 ♘c6 15 ♖ad1 0-0 16 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 17 ♕xb4 ♕xc2 ∓ Dijkstra-Van der Plassche, corr 1990) b4 (10...♕b6 11 f5 e5 12 ♘e6! ♗b7 13 ♘d5 ♗xd5 14 ♕xd5 ♖a7 15 0-0-0 ♖d7 16 ♖d3 ± Arkhangelsky-Kopylov, corr 1981) 11 ♘ce2 ♗g7 (11...♕c5 12 f5 ♔e7 13 ♕d2 ♘d7? 14 ♗xf7 +–) 12 f5 0-0 13 fxe6 fxe6

14 ♘f4 ♕e7 15 0-0 e5 (15...a5 16 ♔h1 ♘a6 17 ♕g4! ♘c7 18 ♖ae1 ± Efimov-Kengis, USSR 1977) 16 ♘f5 ♕a7+ 17 ♔h1 ♗xf5 (17...exf4 18 ♕d5+ ♔h8 19 ♘xd6 is dangerous) 18 exf5 exf4 19 ♗f3 ± Ljubojević-Miličević, Yugoslavia 1974.



10 ♘b3

Or:

1) **10 ♗h5** ♕b6 11 ♘xc6 ♕xb2! 12 ♘a4 ♕b5 13 ♕d4 bxc6 14 ♕xf6 ♕xh5 15 ♕xh8 ♕a5+ 16 ♘c3 e5 ∓ Kargol-Burris, corr 1982.

2) **10 ♕d3** ♘xd4 (10...♕b6 11 ♘b3 h5 12 0-0-0 ♗d7? 13 ♘d2! ♘b4 14 ♕h3 ♖c8 15 ♔b1 a5 16 ♘c4 ♕c5 17 a3 ♘a6 18 ♖d2! ± A. Rodriguez-Csom, Berlin 1979) 11 ♕xd4 ♕c5! 12 ♕d2 (12 ♕d3 ♗d7 13 0-0-0 0-0-0 14 ♔b1 ♔b8 15 ♖hf1 h5 16 a3 ♖c8 17 ♗f3 ♖c7 18 h4 ♗h6 19 ♗e2 ♗f8 20 ♕d4 ♗e7 21 ♕d3 ½-½ Barash-Kopylov, corr 1986) ♗d7 13 ♖f1 ♖c8 14 0-0-0 b5, Tal-Tukmakov, USSR Ch 1978, 15 ♗f3 ± (Tal).

3) **10 ♕d2** ♗d7 (10...b5 11 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 12 ♗f3 ♗b7 13 0-0-0 b4 14 ♘e2 ♕b6 15 f5 ± Mikhalchishin-Tukmakov, Ashkhabad 1978) 11 0-0-0 (11 ♗h5 ♗h6 12 g3 0-0 13 0-0-0 ♘e5 14 ♔b1 ♘c4 15 ♕d3 b5 16 ♘ce2 b4 17 g4 a5 18 h4 a4 19 g5 ∞ Erneste-E.Sakhatova, Manila wom OL 1992) h5 (11...♘xd4 12 ♕xd4 ♕c5 13 ♕xc5 {13 ♕d2 and 13 ♕d3 are similar to line 1} dxc5 14 ♗h5 ♗c6 15 f5 ♗h6+ 16 ♔b1 ♔e7 = Boudre-Pytel, Romans 1982) 12 ♔b1 (12 ♖hf1 ♕b6 {12...0-0-0 will probably transpose to line 3b of this note} 13 ♘b3 h4 14 ♖f3 ♘e5 15 ♖ff1 ♖c8 16 ♔b1 ♘c4 17 ♗xc4 ♖xc4 18 ♖f3 ± Savon-Rashkovsky, USSR Ch 1991) and now:

3a) **12...♗e7** (12...♘xd4 13 ♕xd4 ♕c5 is clearly bad now, e.g. 14 ♕xf6 ♖g8 15 ♖d3! ♖xg2 16 ♖g3 +–) 13 ♗f3 ♘xd4 14 ♕xd4 0-0-0 15 ♕a7 (15 f5 ♔b8 16 ♕d2 h4 17 ♘e2 ♗c8 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♘f4 ♖hg8 20 ♕e3 ♖g5 ∞ Timman-Kasparov, Nikšić 1983) ♗c6 (15...♕c5! =) 16 ♖d3 ♕b8 17 ♕b6 ♕c7 18 ♕a7 ♕b8 19 ♕e3 h4?! 20 ♘d5 ± Barotek-Fuka, corr 1988.

3b) **12...0-0-0** 13 ♖hf1 ♔b8 and now:

3b1) **14 f5** ♗e7 (14...♘xd4 15 ♕xd4 ♗e7 16 ♗f3 ♖c8 17 ♕d2 ♕c5 18 ♘e2 h4 19 ♘f4 exf5 20 ♘d5 ♗d8 21 c3 ♖e8 = Sanchez Almeyra-Sadler, Cannes 1992) 15 ♘xc6+ ♗xc6 16 ♗f3 ♕a5 17 ♘e2 ♕e5 18 ♘f4 d5 19 exd5 ♕xf5 20 ♕e3 ♗b5 21 ♘d3 ♕g5 22 ♕e1 ♖d6 23 ♖f2 ♖c8 24 ♖fd2 = Morović-Smirin, Wijk aan Zee 1994.

3b2) **14 ♘b3** ♗e7 15 ♖f3 ♘a5! 16 ♖h3 ♘xb3 17 axb3 h4 18 ♕e1 d5! 19 exd5 ♕xf4 20 ♕g1 ♗c8 21 ♖hd3 f5! ∞ Savon-Yudasin, Podolsk 1991.

3b3) **14 ♖f3** ♘xd4 15 ♕xd4 ♗e7 16 ♕d2 ♕c5 17 ♖d3 ♕f2 18 ♖g3 h4 19 ♖g7 ♗e8 20 ♖f1 ♕c5 21 f5 ♗f8

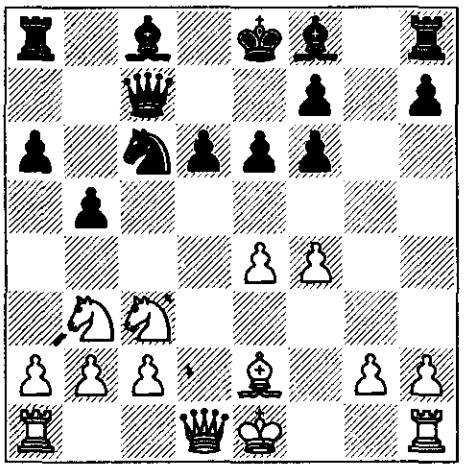
22 ♖g4 ♗h6 23 ♕d3 ♗g5 = Brodsky-Zhelnin, Smolensk 1991.

4) **10 f5** transposes to line 4a of the note to White's 9th move.

10 ... b5 *(D)*

Or 10...♕b6 (10...♗d7 will probably transpose to another line) 11 ♕d2 (11 ♕d3 transposing to Rodriguez-Csom above is better) h5 12 a4 ♘a5 13 ♘xa5 ♕xa5 14 0-0 ♗d7 15 ♔h1 ♖c8 16 ♕d4 ♗e7 17 ♗f3 ♕c5 with an equal position, Tal-Balashov, USSR Ch 1977.

The text-move is slightly risky, as the broken kingside pawns mean that Black wants to play ...0-0-0, and ...b5 also makes it hard to castle queenside.



11 a3

Or **11 ♗h5** (11 ♕d2 ♗b7 12 0-0?! h5 13 ♕e3 h4 14 ♕h3 b4 15 ♘d1 ♘e7 16 ♗d3 d5 17 ♘f2 0-0-0 ∓ Brunner-Hölzl, Graz 1991) and now:

1) **11...♕b6?!** 12 ♕f3 b4 (also unsatisfactory is 12...♗h6 13 ♘e2 ♔e7 14 ♕h3 ♗g7 15 0-0-0 a5 16 ♘bd4 ♘xd4 17 ♘xd4 a4 18 ♔b1 a3 19 ♕b3 ♖d8 20 ♘f5+ ♔f8 21 e5! ± Rusakov-Kopylov, corr 1979) 13 ♘e2 a5 14 0-0-0 ♗d7 15 ♘bd4 ♖c8 16 ♔b1 ♖g8 17 ♖d2 ♗e7 18 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 19 ♘d4 ♕c4 20 e5! ± Lanka-Yuferov, USSR 1977.

2) **11...b4!?** 12 ♘e2 ♕b6 13 ♕d2 a5 is untested.

3) **11...♗g7** 12 ♕g4 0-0 13 0-0-0 ♘e7 14 ♘d4 b4 15 ♘ce2 f5! ∞ Yudasin-Kasparov, USSR Ch 1981.

After 11 a3, Black may try:

1) **11...♗g7** 12 0-0 0-0 13 ♗d3 ♗b7 14 ♖f3 ♘e7 15 ♖g3 ♔h8 16 ♕h5 ♘g6 17 ♖f1 with a dangerous attack, Voitkevich-Oll, USSR 1982.

2) **11...♗b7** 12 ♗d3 h5 13 0-0 ♘e7 (13...♗e7 14 ♕f3 h4 15 ♕h3 ♘a5 16 ♘xa5 ♕xa5 17 f5 e5 ½-½ Dimitrov-H.Grünberg, Stara Zagora Z 1990) 14 f5 e5 15 ♗e2 h4 16 h3 ♖g8 17 ♗h5 ♗h6 18 ♕d3 ♖d8 19 ♗f3 ♗f4 = Wittmann-Gavrikov, Vienna 1990.

3) **11...♕b6** 12 ♕d2 h5 13 ♗f3 ♗b7 14 ♕f2 ♕xf2+ 15 ♔xf2 h4 16 ♖ad1 0-0-0 17 ♘e2 ♗e7 18 ♘ed4 = K.Andersson-Lehmann, corr 1980.

B)

8 ♕f3 b5

Or **8...♘c6 9 0-0-0** and now:

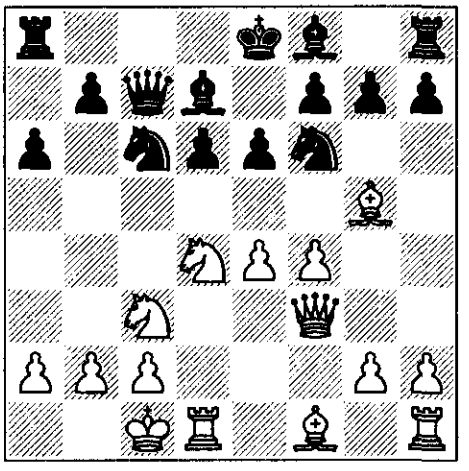
1) **9...♘xd4** 10 ♖xd4 ♗e7 11 ♗e2 (11 ♗c4!? 0-0 {11...e5 12 fxe5 dxe5 13 ♗xf6 gxf6 14 ♘d5! ♕d6 15 ♖d2 ±} 12 ♗b3 b5 13 ♖hd1 ♖d8 14 f5 ♖b8 15 a3 a5 16 a4 bxa4 17 ♗xa4 = Nieminen-Hartikainen, corr) and now:

1a) **11...b5** 12 e5 ♗b7 13 ♕g3 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘d5 15 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 16 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 17 ♕xg7 0-0-0, Höpfl-Kleinegger, Dortmund 1992, 18 ♖hf1 ±.

1b) **11...0-0** 12 ♖hd1! (12 ♕g3 ♘e8 13 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 14 e5 b5 15 ♖hd1 dxe5 16 fxe5 was also good for White, Martin Gonzalez-Gutman,

Biel 1985) ♘e8 (12...e5 13 ♖4d2 exf4 14 ♗xf4 with an evident advantage for White) 13 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 14 ♕e3 b5 15 e5 dxe5 16 fxe5 ± Richter-Vandorffy, corr 1963.

2) **9...♗d7** *(D)* with a wide range of alternatives for White:



2a) **10 ♗h4** 0-0-0 (10...♗e7 11 g4 ♘xd4 12 ♖xd4 ♗c6 13 ♗g2 ♖c8 14 ♖hd1 0-0 15 g5 ♘d7 16 ♖4d2?! ♘c5 17 ♕e3 b5 18 ♘e2 ♕b7 19 ♘g3 g6 = Keres-Ståhlberg, Gothenburg IZ 1955) 11 g4 h6 12 ♗g2 ♗e7 13 ♘b3 ♔b8 14 ♖he1 ♔a8 15 ♗f2 ♖c8 16 ♔b1 ± d5 17 e5 ♘g8 18 ♖xd5?! exd5 19 ♘xd5 ♕d8 20 ♘b6+ ♔b8 ∞ Fuderer-Panno, Gothenburg IZ 1955.

2b) **10 ♗xf6** gxf6 11 f5 (weakening the dark squares, not necessarily the right follow-up to exchanging off the dark-squared bishop) ♘xd4 (11...0-0-0 12 fxe6 fxe6 13 ♕xf6 ♗e7 14 ♕f2 {14 ♕h6 ♘xd4 15 ♖xd4 ♔b8 16 ♔b1 ♖hf8 17 ♕d2 ♕b6 18 ♘d1 ♗c6 19 ♗e2 d5 20 exd5 ♗xd5 ∓ McDonald-Dao Thien Hai, Budapest 1996} ♖hf8 15 ♘f3 ♘e5 16 ♗e2 ♗f6 17 ♕a7 ♕c5 18 ♕xc5+ dxc5 19 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 = Ziatdinov-Dao Thien Hai, Amsterdam 1996) 12 ♖xd4 ♕c5 13 ♖d3 ♕e5 14 ♗e2 0-0-0 15 ♖f1?! ♕xh2 16 g3 ♕h6+ 17 ♔b1 ♗e7 ∓ Gattermayer-Schuh, Austria 1990.

2c) **10 ♗c4** ♗e7 11 ♗b3 ♖c8 (11...0-0 12 h4 ♘a5 13 h5 ♘xb3+ 14 axb3 ♗c6 15 ♘xc6 bxc6 16 ♕g3 ♘e8 17 f5 ♗xg5+ 18 ♕xg5 h6 19 ♕g3 e5 20 ♕d3 ∞ Nisipeanu-Ceteras, Singeorz 1993) 12 ♖he1 0-0 13 h3 b5 14 g4 ♘xd4 15 ♖xd4 a5 16 e5 dxe5 17 fxe5 ♘d5 18 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 19 ♕d3 ♗c6 20 ♘xb5 ♕b6 21 ♘d6 ♖b8 22 ♕c3 ± Grabczewski-Szapiro, Polish Ch 1955.

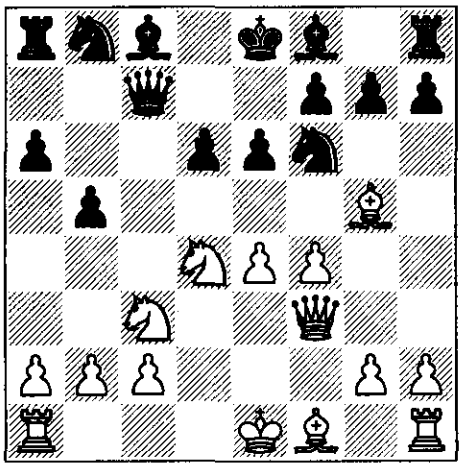
2d) **10 ♘xc6** (promising) ♗xc6 (10...bxc6 11 ♗c4 ♗e7 12 ♖d3 h6 {12...e5 13 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 14 ♖hd1 0-0 15 ♖xd6 +– Keres-Panno, Amsterdam Ct 1956} 13 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 14 ♖hd1 ♗e7 15 ♕g4 g5 16 f5 h5 17 ♕g3 h4 18 ♕e1 e5 19 ♕e2 a5 20 ♖h3 ♖d8 21 ♗b3 ♕b7 22 g3 ± Ragozin-Borsony, corr 1956) 11 ♗xf6 gxf6 12 f5 ♕e7 13 ♗c4 0-0-0 14 ♖he1 ♗d7 15 ♔b1 ♖e8 16 ♖f1 ♗g7 17 ♕f4 ♔c7 18 ♖f3 ± Vennix-Janos, corr 1992.

2e) **10 ♘b3** ♗e7 11 ♗h4 0-0 (11...b5 12 e5 dxe5 13 fxe5 ♕xe5 14 ♖xd7 ♘xd7 15 ♕xc6 ♖d8 16 ♗g3 ♕e3+ 17 ♔b1 ± Rabar-Panno, Gothenburg IZ 1955) 12 g4 ♖fc8 13 ♗g3 b5 14 e5 ♘e8 15 ♕e2 b4 16 exd6 ♗xd6 17 ♘e4 ♗xf4+ 18 ♔b1 ♗xg3 19 hxg3 ♘e5 ∓ Rabar-Najdorf, Gothenburg IZ 1955.

2f) **10 ♗e2** ♗e7 11 ♔b1 (11 ♖he1 ♘xd4 12 ♖xd4 ♗c6 13 ♖ed1 ♖c8 14 ♕e3 0-0 15 e5 ♘d5 16 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 17 ♗d3 ♗xg5 18 exd6 ♕xd6 19 fxg5 ♕xh2 ∓ ½-½ Geller-Najdorf, Gothenburg IZ 1955) 0-0 12 ♕g3 ♖ac8 13 ♗h6 (13 ♘f3 intending e5)

♘e8 14 f5 ♘xd4 15 ♖xd4 ♗f6 16 ♖c4 ♗c6 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♗g4 ♕e7 ∓ Garcia-Xu, Manila OL 1992.

After 8...b5 *(D)* White has three main lines, all of them very interesting:



B1: 9 ♗xf6
B2: 9 0-0-0
B3: 9 f5

There are two less important variations:

1) **9 ♗d3** b4 10 ♘ce2 ♘bd7 (or 10...♗b7 11 0-0 ♘bd7 12 ♖ae1 ♗e7 13 ♔h1 h6 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 15 ♕h5 ♕c5! 16 e5? dxe5 17 ♘xe6 ♕c6 −+ Rogić-Yuferov, Bled 1994) 11 0-0-0 (11 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 12 g4 ♗b7 13 g5 ♘d7 14 0-0-0 g6 15 ♔b1 ♗g7 16 h4 ♕b6 17 ♘b3 0-0-0 18 h5 a5 19 h6 ♗f8 20 c3 a4 21 ♘d2 d5 ∓ Gild.Garcia-Wojtkiewicz, New York 1989) ♗b7 12 ♔b1 ♗e7 13 ♖he1 ♘c5 14 ♘g3 h6 15 ♗h4 0-0-0 16 ♕e2 ♔b8 17 ♘b3 g5 18 fxg5 ♘fd7 19 ♘f1 hxg5 20 ♗g3 a5 ∓ Leiber-Wojtkiewicz, Bad Wörishofen 1991.

2) **9 a3** (too passive to be good) ♘bd7 (9...♗b7 10 ♗xf6 {10 0-0-0 ♘bd7 11 ♔b1 ♗e7 12 g4 ♖c8 13 ♗xf6 gxf6 14 ♗g2 ♘b6 15 ♗f1 d5 16 ♗d3 ♗c5 17 ♘de2 b4 18 axb4 ♗xb4 ∞ 19 exd5? ♘xd5 ∓ J.Rodriguez-Topalov, Oviedo rpd 1992} gxf6 11 0-0-0 h5 12 ♕h3 ♘d7 13 ♗e2 0-0-0 14 ♖he1 ♔b8 15 ♔b1 ♘b6 16 ♕e3 ♖c8 17 ♖d2 ♘c4 18 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 = Grzegorczyk-Banaszkiewicz, corr 1992) and now:

2a) **10 ♗d3** ♗b7 (10...♗e7 11 0-0-0 is just chapter 2 with White having played the passive move a3) 11 0-0-0 (11 ♘de2 ♗e7 12 ♖d1 0-0 13 0-0 ♖ac8 14 ♘g3 ♖fd8 15 ♘h5 h6 16 ♘xf6+ ♘xf6 17 ♗h4 ♘xe4! ∓ Markov-Stoisavljević, Yugoslavia Cht 1993) ♘b6 12 ♖he1 ♖c8 13 f5 e5 14 ♘b3 ♗e7 15 ♖e2 0-0 16 h4 ♖fd8 17 g4 d5 = Makarov-Rashkovsky, USSR 1973.

2b) **10 g4** ♖b8 11 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 12 f5 b4 13 axb4 ♖xb4 14 0-0-0 e5 15 ♘b3 ♗b7 (readers should compare this with variation 5 in the note to Black's 12th move in line B of chapter 1; here Black has played ...b4 instead of ...♗e7, and White's knight is on b3 instead of e2) 16 ♗d3 (comparing this with similar variations shows a number of points in Black's favour; despite this, he hasn't done very well from this position) d5?! (probably premature; 16...♗e7) 17 exd5 ♖xg4 (17...♖xb3 18 cxb3 ♗xd5 19 ♕e2 ♗xh1 20 ♖xh1 ♗b4 21 ♗b5+ ♔e7 22 ♗c4 ♕a5? 23 ♘d5+ ♘xd5 24 ♕xe5+ ♔f8 25 ♗xd5 ± Bjornsson-Wojtkiewicz, Reykjavik 1990) 18 ♖he1! (18 ♘e4 ♖f4 19 ♘xf6+ gxf6 20 ♕g2 h5 21 ♖hf1 ♖g4 22 ♕e2 ♗xd5 23 ♗xa6 ♗h6+ 24 ♔b1 ♗xb3 25 ♕b5+ ♔f8 26 ♕xb3 ♔g7 ∞ Zurakhov-Spassky, USSR Ch 1956) ♖b4 19 ♕g3 ♘d7 20 ♔b1 g6 21 fxg6 hxg6 22 ♗xg6 ♖g8 23

♗xf7+ ♔xf7 ∞ 24 ♕h3 ♖g6 25 ♖g1 ♖bb6?? 26 ♕h7+ 1-0 Luther-Vökler, German Ch 1995.

2c) **10 ♗e2** ♗b7 11 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 12 g4 d5 13 e5 ♘d7 14 ♗d3? g5 15 fxg5 ♕xe5+ 16 ♘ce2 ♕xg5 –+ Lapshin-Wojtkiewicz, New York 1993.

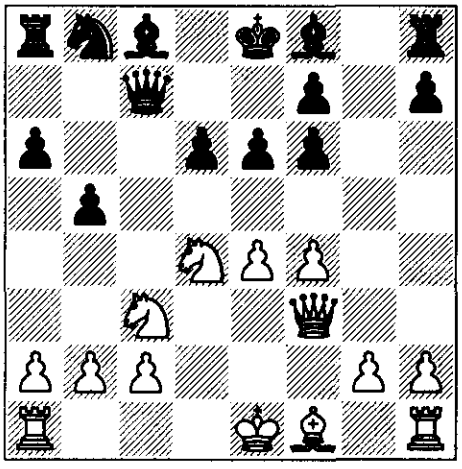
2d) **10 0-0-0** ♖b8 (10...♗b7 is also completely satisfactory, reaching positions from chapter 1 with White having played a3) 11 ♗xf6 (11 f5 e5 12 ♘b3 b4 13 axb4 ♖xb4 14 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 is line 2b) ♘xf6 and now:

2d1) **12 g4** b4 13 axb4 ♖xb4 14 g5 ♘d7 15 f5 (15 ♘b3 ♘c5 16 ♘xc5 ♕xc5 17 f5 ♗e7 18 h4 0-0 19 f6 ♗d8 20 ♗d3 ♗b6 21 ♖de1 ♕e5 ∓ Aronin-Zlotnik, USSR 1968) ♘e5 16 ♕h3 (16 ♕g3 ♕b6 17 ♘b3 a5 18 ♕g1 ♗e7 19 fxe6 fxe6 20 ♗e2 ♗a6 ∓ Blosze-Hutschenreiter, corr 1987) ♕b6 17 ♘b3 ♗e7 18 g6 fxg6 19 fxe6 ♖xb3 20 cxb3 ♕xb3 21 ♕g3 ♗xe6 22 ♘d5 (22 ♘e2 0-0 23 ♕xb3 ♗xb3 24 ♖d4 ♘f3 ∓ Bronstein-Polugaevsky, Moscow 1967) ♗xd5 23 ♖xd5 ♕b4 ∓ Litvinov-Yuferov, Minsk 1978.

2d2) **12 e5** ♗b7 (12...dxe5 13 ♕c6+ ♕d7 14 fxe5 ♘g4 15 ♕f3! ♘xe5 16 ♕g3 is dangerous for Black) 13 ♕h3 (13 ♕e3 dxe5 14 ♘cxb5 axb5? {14...♕c5! 15 fxe5 ♘d5 16 ♕f2 ♗e7 ∞} 15 ♗xb5+ ♔e7 16 ♘c6+ ♗xc6 17 ♕c5+ ♔e8 18 ♗xc6+ ♘d7 19 ♖xd7 ♗xc5 20 ♖xc7+ ♔f8 21 fxe5 +– Lyman-Burger, USA 1979) dxe5 (13...♘d5!? 14 ♘xd5 {14 ♘e4 ♘xf4 15 exd6 ♗xd6 16 ♘xd6+ ♕xd6 17 ♕g3 ♕e5 ∓} ♗xd5 15 ♕g3 dxe5 16 fxe5 g6 17 ♗d3 ♗g7 18 ♖he1 0-0 19 b3 b4 ∓ Stefanishin-V.Gurevich, Simferopol 1991) 14 ♘cxb5 ♕b6! (but not 14...axb5? 15 ♗xb5+ ♔e7 16 fxe5 ♕xe5 17 ♖he1 ♘e4 18 ♗c6! ♕f4+ 19 ♔b1 f5 20 ♖xe4 ♕xe4 21 ♗xe4 ♗xe4 22 ♕g3 1-0 Kupreichik-Gutman, USSR ½f Ch 1970) 15 fxe5 ♘d5 16 ♘c3 ♘xc3 17 ♕xc3 ♗e7 followed by ...0-0 with compensation for the sacrificed pawn.

B1)

9 ♗xf6 gxf6 *(D)*



10 e5

The sharpest line. Alternatives:

1) **10 ♗d3** ♘c6 (10...♘d7 11 0-0-0 ♗b7 12 ♖he1 0-0-0 13 f5 ♘c5 14 fxe6 fxe6 15 ♕h3 = Suetin-Balashov, Sochi 1973; 10...h5 11 0-0-0 ♗b7 12 ♖he1 ♗e7 13 ♘d5 ♕d8 14 ♕g3 ♘c6 15 ♕g7 ± Tischbierek-Ghinda, Timisoara 1987) 11 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 12 f5 transposes to Nunn-Chandler in line B3, note to Black's 9th move.

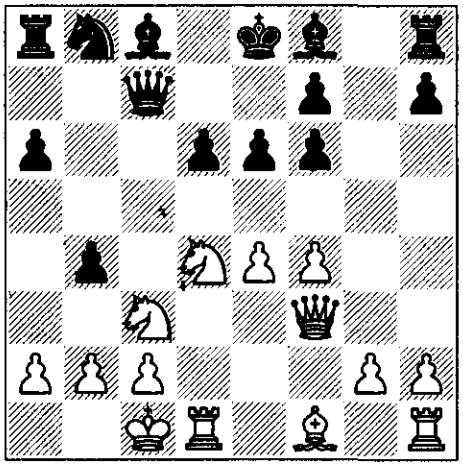
2) **10 a3** and now:

2a) **10...♘c6** 11 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 12 ♗e2 (12 f5 ♖a7 13 ♗e2 ♕c5 14 0-0-0 ♖c7 15 ♖hf1 ♖g8 16 fxe6 fxe6 17 ♕xf6 ♕g5+ {17...♗g7 18 ♕f4 ♗e5 ∞} 18 ♔b1 ♕xf6 19 ♖xf6 ♗g7 = Van der Wiel-Tukmakov, Wijk aan

Zee 1984) ♖b8 13 0-0 ♗e7 14 ♔h1 h5 15 f5 ♕c5 16 ♕g3 ♔f8 17 ♖f4 ♕e5 18 ♖af1 a5 19 fxe6 ♗xe6 (19...fxe6 20 ♕g6 +–) 20 ♕f2 b4 21 axb4 axb4 22 ♘d1 ± Zuse-Degenhardt, Bundesliga 1991.

2b) **10...♗b7** 11 ♗e2 h5 12 ♕h3 (12 0-0-0 ♘d7 13 f5 e5 14 ♘b3 ♖c8 15 ♔b1 = Van Kempen-Loginov, corr 1994) ♘d7 13 0-0-0 (13 ♗xh5 0-0-0 14 f5 e5 15 ♘b3 ♘c5 16 ♘xc5 dxc5 17 0-0 c4 18 ♖fd1 ♗c5+ 19 ♔f1, Chod-Fiensh, corr 1989, 19...♗d4 ∞) 0-0-0 14 ♗xh5 ♔b8 15 ♕g4 f5 16 ♕e2 ♘f6 17 ♗f3 fxe4 18 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 19 ♗xe4 d5 20 ♗f3 ♕xf4+ 21 ♔b1 ♖xh2 22 ♖xh2 ♕xh2 ∓ Unzicker-Balashov, Munich 1979.

3) **10 0-0-0** b4 *(D)* (10...♗b7 11 ♕h5 ♕c5 12 f5!? ±) and now:



3a) **11 ♘ce2** ♘d7 (11...h5 12 f5?! {unnecessarily committal} e5 13 ♘b3 h4 14 ♔b1 ♘d7 15 ♘ec1 ♗b7 16 ♗d3 ♗h6 17 ♖he1 ♔e7 18 ♘d2 ♘b6 ∓ Dorfanis-Wojtkiewicz, Komotini 1992) 12 ♕h5 (12 e5 ♗b7 13 ♕h5 ♘c5 14 exf6 0-0-0 15 ♘g3 d5 16 ♕f3 ♘e4 17 f5?! {17 ♗d3 ∞} e5 18 ♘e6 fxe6 19 fxe6 ♔b8 20 e7 ♗h6+ 21 ♔b1 ♖c8 ∓ Kupreichik-Rashkovsky, USSR 1974) ♘c5 13 ♘g3 ♗b7 14 f5 0-0-0 15 fxe6 fx**e6** 16 ♕h3 ♕d7 17 ♗c4 d5 18 ♘b3 ♘xb3+ 19 axb3 ♗d6 20 exd5 ex**d5** 21 ♘f5 ± Khlusevich-Kopylov, corr 1988.

3b) **11 ♘d5** exd5 12 exd5 ♕c5! 13 ♗d3 (13 ♘b3 ♕b6 14 ♗d3 ♖a7 15 ♖he1+ ♖e7 16 ♖xe7+ ♗xe7 17 ♘d4 ♔d8 ∓ Dragović-Savanović, Yugoslavia Cht 1994) ♖a7 14 ♗f5 ♔d8 (14...♗xf5?! 15 ♘xf5 ♔d7 16 ♖he1 ♖c7 17 ♕e4 ♔c8 18 ♖d4 a5 19 b3 ♔b7 20 ♖c4 ± Petrushin-Rashkovsky, USSR 1979) 15 ♗xc8 ♔xc8 16 ♕h3+ ♔b7 17 ♖he1 ♔a8 ∞ Dorfman-Yuferov, USSR 1978.

10 ... ♗b7

1) **10...♕b7** 11 ♘e4 fxe5 12 fxe5 dxe5 13 ♗d3 exd4 (not 13...f5? 14 ♘xe6! fxe4 15 ♗xe4 ♕b6 16 ♘xf8 ♖xf8 17 ♕h5+ ♖f7 18 ♕xe5+ ♗e6 19 0-0-0 ♖a7 20 ♖d6 ♕e3+ 21 ♔b1 ♖ae7 22 ♖xe6 1-0 Parma-Balashov, Moscow 1971) 14 ♘f6+ ♔e7 15 ♗e4 ♕c7 16 0-0 (16 ♗xa8 ♕e5+ 17 ♘e4 f5 18 ♕g3 ♕xg3+ 19 ♘xg3 ♘d7 with compensation) ♖a7 17 ♘d5+ exd5 18 ♕f6+ ♔e8 19 ♗xd5 ♗e6 20 ♖ae1 ♘d7 21 ♕xh8 ♕d6! ∞ Grafe-Vaisman, corr 1972.

2) **10...d5** 11 exf6 and now:

2a) **11...b4** 12 ♘ce2 (12 ♘xd5 exd5 13 ♕xd5 ♗b7 14 ♗b5+ axb5 15 ♘xb5 ♕c6!? may lead to perpetual check after 16 ♕e5+ ♔d8 17 0-0-0+ ♘d7 18 ♖he1 ♗c5 19 ♖xd7+ ♔xd7 20 ♖d1+ ♔c8 21 ♕f5+ ♔b8 22 ♕e5+) ♘d7 13 f5 e5 14 ♘e6 fxe6 15 fxe6 ♘xf6 16 ♕xf6 ♗g7 = Adler-Semeniuk, USSR 1974.

2b) **11...♘d7** 12 0-0-0 ♘xf6 13 f5!? e5 14 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 15 ♕xd5 ♗b7 16 ♗xb5+!? axb5 17 ♕xb5+ ♔e7 18 f6+ ♔xf6 19 ♖hf1+ ♔g6 20

♕d3+?! (20 ♘f3 ♖a5 21 ♘h4+ looks like a draw; 20 ♔b1!? ∞) e4 21 ♕h3 ♗c8 22 ♖f5?! h5 ∓ Berelovich-Mukhutdinov, Moscow 1992.

3) **10...dxe5** (an interesting idea which is probably not quite sufficient for equality) 11 ♘dxb5 ♕b7 12 ♕xb7 ♗xb7 13 ♘c7+ ♔e7 14 ♘xa8 ♗xa8 (although White is the exchange up, he cannot easily develop his pieces and Black's bishops are very active):

3a) **15 f5** ♖g8 16 ♖g1 (16 0-0-0 ♖g5 17 ♗d3 ♖xg2 18 ♖dg1 ♗h6+ 19 ♔b1 ♖d2 20 ♗e4 ♗xe4 21 ♘xe4 ♖d4 22 ♘g3 ♘c6 23 ♖f1 ♖h4 24 c3 e4 ∞ McDonald-Sadler, London Lloyds Bank 1993) ♔e8 (16...♘c6 17 ♗xa6 ♘d4 18 ♗d3 exf5 19 ♘e2 ♘xe2 20 ♔xe2 e4 21 ♗c4 f4 22 ♖af1 ♗h6 23 ♖d1 ♖g5 24 h4 ♖h5 25 ♖d4 ♖xh4 26 ♗d5 ♗xd5 27 ♖xd5 ± Liss-Sadler, Biel 1993) 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♗c4 ♗c5 19 ♗xe6 ♖g7 20 ♖f1 ♗xg2 21 0-0-0 ♗e3+ 22 ♔b1 ♗xf1 23 ♖xf1 ♖g1 24 ♖xg1 ♗xg1 ½-½ Liss – Har-Zvi, Tel Aviv 1991.

3b) **15 fxe5** fxe5 16 ♖g1 (a very straightforward plan; 16 0-0-0 f5 ∞) f5 17 g4 f4 18 ♗d3 ♔f7 19 ♘e4 ♗xe4 20 ♗xe4 ♗c5 21 ♖g2 ♗e3 22 ♖d1 ♔e7 23 g5 ± Coco-La Rosa, corr 1988.

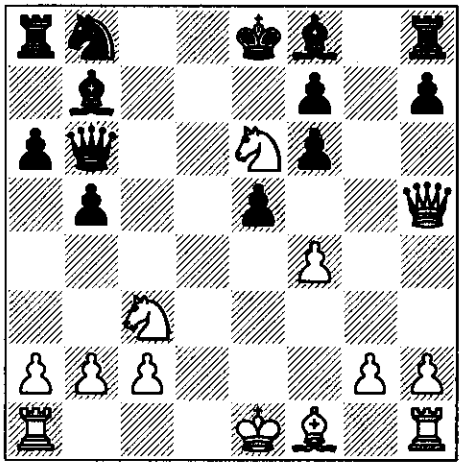
3c) **15 ♗d3** (the most popular idea is simply to give up the g2-pawn in the interests of rapid development) ♗xg2 16 ♖g1 ♗c6 17 f5 ♗h6 18 ♔e2 ♗b7 19 ♘e4 ♖c8 20 ♖af1 ♘d7 21 ♖g4 exf5 22 ♖xf5 ♗f4 23 ♖fxf4 exf4 24 ♖xf4 ± Gild.Garcia-Brunner, Manila OL 1992.

3d) **15 ♗e2** ♗xg2 16 ♖g1 ♗c6 17 f5 exf5 (17...♗h6 18 ♖d1 e4! 19 ♖g3 {19 ♔f2!?} ♗g5 20 ♔f1 h5 21 ♖d4 ♗f4, Ziatdinov-Rashkovsky, USSR 1987, 22 ♘xe4!? ∞) 18 ♖d1 ♗h6 19 ♘d5+ ♗xd5 20 ♖xd5 ♖c8 (20...♘c6 ±) 21 c4 ♗f4 22 h4 ♘c6 23 ♖g7 ♔f8 24 ♖xh7 ♔g8 25 ♖h5 ± Rallo-La Rosa, corr 1988.

11 ♕h5 dxe5

Or 11...b4 12 ♘xe6 ♕c8! (and not 12...♕e7 13 ♗c4! fxe5 {13...bxc3 14 exd6 ♕xd6 15 ♖d1 +–} 14 ♘d5 ♗xd5 15 ♗xd5 ♖a7 16 fxe5 +– Perecz-Kavalek, Netanya 1971) 13 ♗b5+ axb5 14 ♘xb5 ♕xc2 15 ♘bc7+ ♔d7 16 ♕xf7+ ♗e7 17 exf6 ♕e4+ 18 ♔d1 ♕d3+ 19 ♔e1 ♕e3+, Wedberg-Novoselski, Kladovo 1980, 20 ♔d1 (20 ♔f1? ♗e4! –+) with a draw by perpetual check.

12 ♘xe6 ♕b6 *(D)*



13 ♘xf8

White has a very sharp alternative in 13 f5!? ♗b4 (13...♕e3+ 14 ♗e2 ♗b4 15 ♖d1 ♗xc3+ 16 bxc3 ♕xc3+ 17 ♔f2 ♔e7 18 ♖d3 ∞ ♕c6 19 ♖hd1 ♖a7?? 20 ♖g3 {threatening 21 ♕xf7+} 1-0 was an amusing finish, Sukhinina-Balashova, corr 1991) 14 0-0-0 ♗xc3 15 bxc3 ♔e7 16 ♗e2 ♗e4 (16...fxe6 17 ♕h6 ♖f8 18 ♗h5 +–) 17 ♖he1 b4 18 ♗c4 bxc3 19 ♗b3 ♕b4 20 ♖d4! ♕a3+ (20...exd4

21 ♘g7) 21 ♔d1 +– Sukhinina-Leikina, corr 1986.

13 ... ♕e3+

13...♖xf8 14 0-0-0 ♘d7 15 ♗e2 ♕e3+ 16 ♔b1 ♕xf4 17 ♕h3 ± Sakharov-Anikaev, Tbilisi 1973.

14 ♕e2

14 ♗e2 ♗xg2? (14...♖xf8 15 ♖f1 ♘d7 ∞) 15 ♘e6! ♕b6 (15...♗xh1 16 ♘c7+ ♔d8 17 ♕xf7 ♕g1+ 18 ♗f1 ♕e3+ 19 ♘e2 ♖a7 20 ♕xf6+ ♔xc7 21 ♕xh8 ±) 16 ♘g7+ ♔f8 17 ♘f5 ♗xh1 18 0-0-0! ♗b7 19 ♕h6+ ♔e8 20 ♘d6+ ♔e7 21 ♘xb7 +– Salov-Zhuravlev, USSR 1986.

14 ... ♕xf4

14...♕xe2+ 15 ♗xe2 ♗xg2 (or 15...♖xf8 16 0-0 ±) 16 ♖g1 ♗b7 17 fxe5 fxe5 18 ♘e6! fxe6 19 ♗h5+ with a very good ending for White.

15 ♘xh7!

15 ♕d3 ♕h4+ 16 g3 ♕d4 17 0-0-0 ♕xd3 18 ♗xd3 ♗xh1 19 ♘xh7 ♗c6 20 ♘xf6+ ♔e7 21 ♘cd5+ ♔e6 22 ♗e4 ♖a7 with a slight advantage for Black, as in the game Lukovnikov-Zilbershtein, USSR 1978.

15 ... ♖xh7

16 g3 ♕f3 (16...♕b4 17 0-0-0! ♗xh1 18 ♕d3 ♘c6 19 ♕xh7 ± Balashov-Chandler, Minsk 1982) 17 ♕xf3 ♗xf3 18 ♗d3! ♖h6 (18...♗xh1 19 ♗xh7 ♘d7 20 0-0-0 ♗b7, Yudasin-Rashkovsky, USSR Ch 1986, and now the simple 21 ♘d5 ♗xd5 22 ♖xd5 would have been very good for White. Not only does Black have severe light-squared weaknesses, but the fact that White can make passed pawns on both wings rules out a rook exchange by Black.

The main line with 10 e5 appears to be a forced draw (see the note to Black's 11th move), so the main interest lies in White's 10th move alternatives. However, none of these appears to offer much hope of an advantage for White.

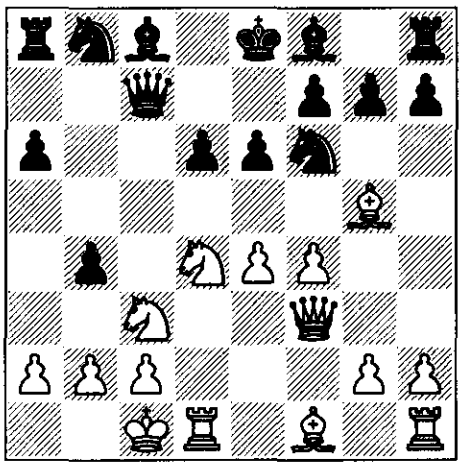
B2)

9 0-0-0 b4 *(D)*

9...♗b7 (9...♘bd7 transposes to chapter 14) is risky after **10 ♗xf6** (10 ♗d3 ♘bd7 also transposes to chapter 14) **gxf6** and now:

1) **11 f5** b4 12 ♘cb5!? axb5 13 fxe6 ♔e7, Heinola-Kontulainen, corr 1987, 14 ♘f5+ ♔e8 (14...♔xe6 15 ♗xb5 +–) 15 ♗xb5+ ♗c6 16 ♘d4! and White is clearly better.

2) **11 ♕h5** ♕e7 (11...♕c5 12 f5 ♔e7 13 ♕h3 ♘c6 14 ♘xc6+ ♗xc6 15 fxe6 fxe6 16 ♗d3 b4 17 ♘e2 h5 18 ♘f4 1-0 Damjanović-Barczay, Reggio Emilia 1971) 12 f5 b4 13 fxe6 bxc3 14 ♗c4 cxb2+ 15 ♔b1 ♘c6 16 ♘f5 ♕c7, Kumerov-Tal, Moscow 1991, and now White could have won by 17 exf7+! ♔d7 (17...♔d8 18 ♕h4) 18 ♘xd6 ♗xd6 19 ♕f5+ ♔e7 20 f8♕+ ♔xf8 21 ♕xf6+ ♔e8 22 ♕xh8+ ♗f8 23 ♖hf1 ♕g7 24 ♕xg7 ♗xg7 25 ♖f7 +–.



10 e5

Or:

1) **10 ♘d5** exd5 11 ♗xf6 gxf6 12 exd5 transposes into the note to White's 10th move in B1, line 3b.

2) **10 ♘b1** ♘bd7 11 ♘d2 ♗b7 12 ♗d3 ♗e7 13 ♔b1 ♘c5 14 ♖he1 h6 15 ♗h4 0-0 16 ♕h3 = Cela-Soylu, Zouberi Z 1993.

3) **10 ♘ce2** ♘bd7 and now:

3a) **11 ♘g3** ♗b7 12 ♗d3 ♖c8 (12...♗e7 13 ♘h5 0-0 14 ♖he1 ♖fe8 15 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 16 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 17 ♕g3 d5 18 e5 ♘e4 19 ♕e3 = Feher-Dao Thien Hai, Hungary Cht 1995) 13 ♖he1 ♕b6 14 ♘b3 a5 15 ♘d2 a4 16 ♘c4 ♕c5 17 ♕e2, Ciuksyte-Stoisavljević, Litomysl European girls Ch 1994, 17...♗e7 =.

3b) **11 g4!?** ♗b7 12 ♘g3 d5! (or 12...♗e7 13 ♔b1 0-0-0 14 ♗g2 ♘c5 15 ♕e2 ♔b8 16 ♖he1 ♖he8 17 f5 ♘fd7 18 ♗xe7 ♖xe7 19 g5 ♘e5 20 f6 gxf6 21 gxf6 ♖ed7 22 ♕h5 ∞ Podkrznik-Bukić, Portorož 1995) and now:

3b1) **13 e5** ♘e4 14 ♘xe4 dxe4 15 ♕e2 h6 16 ♗h4 g5 17 fxg5 hxg5? (17...♕xe5 =) 18 ♗xg5 ♕xe5 19 h4 ♖c8 20 ♔b1 ♘b6 21 ♗c1 ♘a4 22 g5 ± Outerelo-Teran, Spain Cht 1993.

3b2) **13 ♗xf6** dxe4! 14 ♘xe4 ♘xf6 15 ♗d3 ♗e7! 16 h4 0-0-0 17 ♗xa6 ♗xa6 18 ♘xf6 ♗b7 19 ♘e4 ♕a5 ∓ Wobbe-Neurohr, St Ingbert 1994.

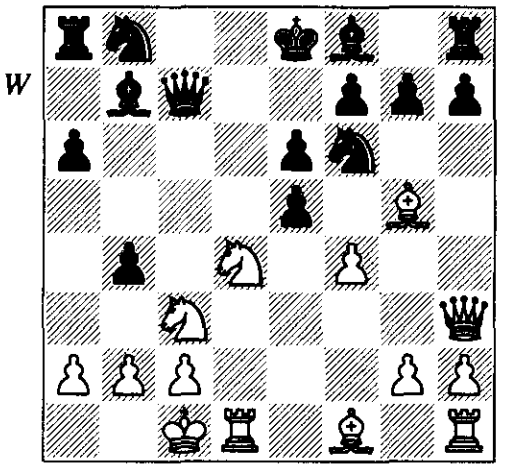
3b3) **13 ♗d3** ♗c5! 14 ♘b3 dxe4 15 ♘xe4 ♗e7 16 ♖he1 ♖c8! 17 ♖e2 0-0 18 ♗xf6! ♘xf6 19 f5 a5 20 ♔b1 a4 21 ♘bd2 ∓ Luther-Yudasin, Budapest 1989.

10 ... ♗b7

Not 10...dxe5? 11 ♘db5! axb5 12 ♕xa8 bxc3 (12...♗b7 13 ♗xb5+ ♔e7 14 ♕xb8! +–) 13 ♗xf6 cxb2+ 14 ♔b1 ♗d6 (14...gxf6 15 ♗xb5+ +–) 15 ♗xb5+ +–.

11 ♘cb5

Or **11 ♕h3** (11 ♘db5 axb5 12 ♘xb5 transposes into the note to White's 12th move) **dxe5** *(D)* (the only move, e.g. 11...bxc3? 12 exf6 cxb2+ 13 ♔b1 ♗d5 14 c4! ♗xc4 15 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 16 ♖he1 ± Kosten-Formanek, Ramsgate 1981) and now White has no effective continuation:



1) **12 ♘cb5** (unsound) axb5 and now:

1a) **13 ♗xb5+** ♗c6! (13...♘c6 14 fxe5 ♕xe5 15 ♗xf6 gxf6 16 ♖he1 ♕g5+ 17 ♔b1 ♗e7 ½-½ Lhagvasuren-Savon, Belgorod 1991, even though 18 ♗xc6+ ♗xc6 19 ♘xc6 is ±) 14 fxe5 ♗xb5 15 exf6 ♗d7! (15...♕e5? 16 ♘f3 ♕c7 17 fxg7 ♗xg7 18 ♕g3 is dangerous) 16 ♘f5 (other moves are also inadequate) gxf6! 17 ♗xf6 ♖g8 18 ♕xh7 b3 19 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 20 ♖xd6 ♖f8! 0-1 Psakhis-Tukmakov, USSR 1st League 1979.

1b) **13 fxe5** and now:

1b1) **13...♘fd7** 14 ♘xe6 ♕b6 (not 14...♕xe5? 15 ♘c7+ ♕xc7 16 ♕e3+) 15 ♘xf8 (15 ♘d4 ♖xa2 –+) ♔xf8 16 ♖xd7 ♘xd7 17 ♕xd7 ♕c6 ∓.

1b2) **13...♕xe5** 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 (or 14...♕xf6 transposing into the note to White's 12th move) 15 ♗xb5+ ♔e7 16 ♖he1 ♗e4 17 ♕h4 ♕g5+ 18 ♕xg5 fxg5 19 ♖xe4 ♖xa2 ∞.

2) **12 fxe5** ♕xe5 13 ♗xf6 gxf6! (13...♕xf6? 14 ♘cb5! ♗c5 15 ♘xe6! axb5 {15...fxe6 16 ♕h5+} 16 ♗xb5+ ♘c6 17 ♗xc6+ ♗xc6 18 ♘c7+ ♔f8 19 ♘xa8 ♕f4+ 20 ♔b1 ♕b8 21 ♖hf1 ♗e7 22 ♕e6 1-0 Chiburdanidze-Tukmakov, USSR 1st League 1980) 14 ♗b5+ (14 ♘a4 ♘c6 15 ♘b3 ♖d8 is clearly better for Black, Lepeshkin-Dubinsky, Moscow 1964) axb5 15 ♖he1 ♕f4+ (15...♗xg2 16 ♕xg2 ♕g5+ 17 ♕xg5 fxg5 18 ♘cxb5 is unclear; one line runs 18...♖xa2 19 ♔b1 ♖a5 20 ♘c7+ ♔e7 21 ♘dxe6 fxe6 22 ♖xe6+ ♔f7 23 ♖f1+ ♔g7 24 ♖ef6 =) 16 ♔b1 ♖a6 17 ♘cxb5 (17 ♕h5 bxc3 18 ♘xe6 ♖xe6 19 ♖xe6+ ♗e7 20 ♕xb5+ ♗c6 21 ♖xc6 ♘xc6 22 ♕xc6+ ♔f8 23 ♕xc3 ♗d6 ∓ Yudasin-Tukmakov, USSR Ch 1981) ♗d5 18 b3 (18 ♘b3 ♗xb3 19 axb3 ♖c6! 20 ♕d3 ♗e7 21 ♖e4 ♕g5 0-1 Korolev-Kopylov, corr 1988) ♘d7 19 ♕h5 ♗e7 20 ♘f5 ♕xf5 21 ♘c7+ ♔d8 22 ♕xf5 exf5 23 ♘xa6 ♗e6 ∓ Goedkoop-Van der Plassche, corr 1991.

11 ... axb5

11...♕b6 12 ♕h3!? (12 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 13 ♕b3 ♗e7 14 exf6 gxf6 15 ♗h4 ♘d7 16 f5 e5 17 ♘f3 ♘c5 18 ♕e3 ♘a4 19 ♕b3 ♘c5 20 ♕e3 ♘a4 ½-½ Georgiev-Rashkovsky, Dubna 1979) and now:

1) **12...♘e4** 13 ♘xe6 axb5 14 ♗xb5+ ♘c6 (14...♗c6 15 ♘xg7+) 15 exd6 ♗xd6 (15...♘xd6 16 ♖he1 +–) 16 ♖he1 with a clear advantage for White.

2) **12...axb5** 13 exf6 ♖xa2 14 ♔b1 ♕a5 15 ♗xb5+ ♗c6 16 ♘b3 ±.

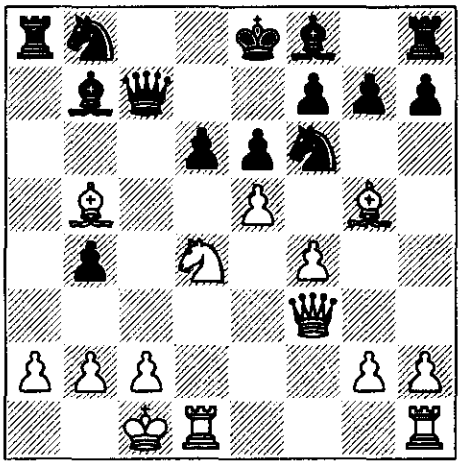
3) **12...dxe5** 13 fxe5 axb5 14 exf6 ♖xa2 15 ♗xb5+ ♘c6 16 ♘xe6 ♖a1+ 17 ♔d2 ♕f2+ 18 ♗e2 +–.

12 ♗xb5+ *(D)*

The odd move **12 ♘xb5** was a success in Carbonnel-Estrada, Paris Ch 1992 after 12...♕d7 13 ♕e3 ♘d5 14 ♖xd5 ♗xd5 15 ♕b6 f6 16 ♘c7+ ♔f7 17 ♘xa8 ♗e7 18 ♘c7 fxg5 19 f5 dxe5 20 fxe6+ ♗xe6 21 ♗b5 ♕d6 22 ♖f1+ ♔g6 23 ♕xd6 ♗xd6 24 ♘xe6 ±. However, 12...♕c8! appears better.

Delaying the capture on b5 does not help, for example **12 ♕h3** b3 13 ♕xb3 ♗d5 14 ♘xb5 ♕c5 15 ♕c3 ♕xc3 16 bxc3 ♘e4 17 ♖xd5 exd5 18 ♘c7+ ♔d7 19 ♘xa8 ♔c6 ∓ El Taher-Magem Badals, Novi Sad OL 1992.

B



12 ... ♘bd7

Not **12...♘fd7?** and now:

1) **13 ♕h3?** b3! (13...♖xa2 14 ♘xe6 ♕b6 15 ♖he1! ♖a1+ 16 ♔d2 ♖xd1+ 17 ♔xd1 dxe5 18 ♖xe5 +–; 13...♗e4 14 ♖he1 d5 15 ♖xe4 dxe4 16 ♘xe6 ♕c8 17 ♘xf8 ±) 14 axb3 (14 ♕xb3 ♗d5) dxe5 15 ♘xe6 ♖a1+ 16 ♔d2 ♖xd1+ 17 ♖xd1 ♕d6+ –+.

2) **13 ♘xe6!** fxe6 14 ♕h3 ♔f7 (14...♗d5 15 ♖xd5 ♔f7 16 exd6 ♗xd6 17 ♖e1 +–) 15 f5 ♗e4 (15...b3 16 fxe6+ ♔g8 17 ♕xb3 ♘c5 18 ♕c4 d5 19 ♖xd5 +–) 16 fxe6+ ♔g8 17 ♕b3 ♗xc2 18 ♕xc2 ♕xc2+ 19 ♔xc2 ♘xe5 20 e7 ♗xe7 21 ♗xe7 ♘bc6 22 ♗xd6 and wins, Kr.Georgiev-Kasparov, Malta OL 1980.

13 ♕h3

Or 13 ♘xe6? fxe6 14 ♕h3 ♔f7! 15 exf6 ♗e4 16 ♕h5+ g6 17 ♕e2 ♘c5 18 ♖he1 ♖xa2 –+ Jankowski-Jaworski, corr 1992.

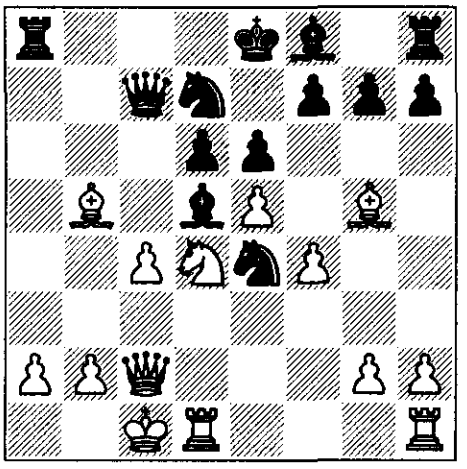
13 ... b3
14 ♕xb3

Black wins after 14 exf6 bxa2 15 ♔d2 (15 ♘xe6 a1♕+ 16 ♔d2 ♕ca5+ 17 ♔e3 ♕b6+ 18 ♘d4 ♖a3+ 19 bxa3 ♕xa3+ 20 ♖d3 ♕xd4+ –+) ♕a5+ 16 c3 0-0-0! 17 b4 (17 fxg7 ♗xg7 18 ♗xd8 ♖xd8 19 ♗xd7+ ♖xd7 ∓) ♕a3 18 fxg7 ♕b2+! 19 ♘c2 ♗xg7 20 ♗xd8 ♖xd8 21 ♗xd7+ ♔xd7 22 ♕d3 ♔e7 23 c4 d5 24 ♔e3 f5 25 cxd5 ♖c8 26 d6+ ♔d8 27 ♘d4 ♗xd4+! 0-1 Heinrich-Hefka, corr 1992.

14 ... ♗d5
15 c4 ♘e4
16 ♕c2

16 ♔b1 ♗b7 17 ♖he1 ♘xg5 18 fxg5 0-0-0 19 ♗xd7+ ♖xd7 20 ♘b5 ♕c5 is distincstly better for Black, Milu-Istratescu, Belgrade 1994.

After 16 ♕c2 *(D)* Black has a choice of promising continuations:



1) **16...♖xa2** 17 ♔b1 ♕a7 18 ♘b3 ♗b7! (not 18...♗a8 19 c5! d5 20 c6 ♗xc6, Kosten-Kuligowski, Lewisham 1981, 21 ♕xc6! ♖xb2+ 22 ♔c1! ♖c2+ 23 ♕xc2 ♗a3+ 24 ♔b1 0-0 25 ♗xd7 leaves White a rook and a piece up) 19 ♖he1! (19 ♗xd7+ ♔xd7 20 c5 ♗d5 21 exd6 ♗xd6! 22 ♖xd5 exd5 23 cxd6 ♖a8 –+ Günthner-Belenko, corr 1987) ♘xg5 20 exd6?! (20 fxg5 is the critical line) ♔d8! 21 fxg5 g6 22 ♕c3 ♖g8 23 ♖e2 ♗g7 24 ♕b4 ♘e5 25 ♘c5 ♗c6! 26 ♖dd2 ♘d7! with a clear plus for Black, Morgado-Bryson, corr 1991.

2) **16...♗b7** and White has no promising reply:

2a) **17 ♗h4** ♗e7! 18 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 19 exd6+ ♘xd6 20 ♗xd7 ♖xa2! (20...♕xd7! 21 c5 ♖hc8 22 ♔b1 ♔f8 is also good) 21 c5 ♘e4 0-1 Chouinard-Maliangkay, corr 1993.

2b) **17 b4** ♘xg5 18 fxg5 0-0-0 19 exd6 ♗xd6 20 c5 ♘xc5 21 bxc5 ♗xc5 ∓ Bokan-Rashkovsky, Sverdlovsk 1989.

2c) **17 ♖hf1!?** d5! 18 ♔b1 ♗c5 19 cxd5 ♗xd5 20 ♘b3 ♗b6 21 ♕xc7 ♗xc7 22 ♗h4 ♗d8 23 ♗e1 ♖a7 24 f5! ♖b7! 25 ♖xd5!? exd5 26 ♗c6 ♖c7 27 ♗xd5 ♘dc5 ∓ Larsen-Maliangkay, corr 1991.

2d) **17 ♖he1** ♘xg5 18 fxg5 0-0-0 19 ♗xd7+ (19 exd6 ♗xd6 20 g3 ♘b6 21 ♘b3 ♗e7 22 c5 ♘d5 23 c6 ♗a8 24 ♗a6+ ♔b8 25 ♘d4 ♘b4 –+ Hamers-Van Wieringen, corr 1987) ♖xd7 20 ♘b5 ♕b6 21 ♔b1, Van der Wiel-Brunner, Baden-Baden 1992, and now 21...dxe5! 22 ♖xd7 ♔xd7

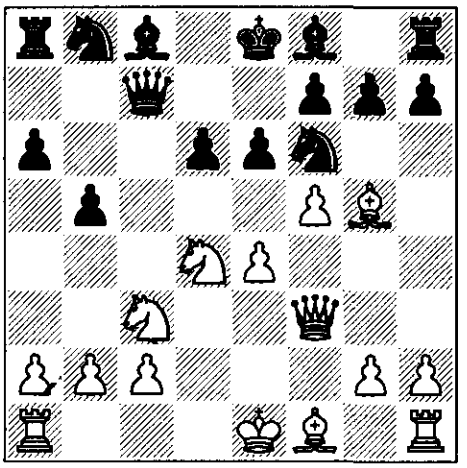
23 ♖d1+ ♔c8 24 ♕d2 ♗c5 should win for Black.

The conclusion is that the sacrificial lines arising after 9 0-0-0 do not favour White.

B3)

9 f5!? *(D)*

A provocative move. The pressure against e6 makes ...♗b7 impossible and normal developing moves such as 9...♗e7 fail to 10 fxe6 fxe6 11 e5 dxe5 (11...♗b7 12 ♘xe6) 12 ♘dxb5 and 13 ♕xa8. In fact Black has only two playable moves, 9...♘c6 and 9...b4.



B

9 ... b4

This is the critical continuation. The alternative **9...♘c6** is good for White, e.g. **10 ♘xc6** (10 e5 ♘xd4 11 ♕xa8 dxe5 and 10 ♘cxb5 axb5 11 ♗xb5 ♗d7 12 fxe6 ♘xd4 13 ♗xd7+ ♔e7 are bad for White) **♕xc6** and now:

1) **11 fxe6** fxe6 12 ♗xf6 gxf6 13 ♕xf6 ♖g8 (Black has sufficient play for the pawn) 14 ♗e2 ♗e7 15 ♕d4 ♖xg2 (15...♖b8?! 16 ♗h5+ ♔d7 17 ♗f3 ♕b6 18 ♕d3 ♕c5 19 0-0-0 ♕e5 20 ♘e2 ♗b7 21 ♔b1 and Black doesn't have very much for the pawn, Yudasin-Ehlvest, Pamplona 1991) 16 0-0-0 ♗b7 (Yudasin gave 16...♕c5 17 ♕h8+ ♔d7 18 ♗f3! as the critical line, but he didn't mention 18...♕e3+ winning a piece; instead, 18 ♗f1 ♕g5+ 19 ♔b1 ♕g7 is equal) 17 ♖dg1 ♖xg1+ 18 ♖xg1 ♕c5 19 ♕xc5 dxc5 20 e5 ♖d8 21 ♖g7 ♖d7 = Nisipeanu-Szuhanek, Romania 1994.

2) **11 ♗xf6** gxf6 (eliminating the black knights stops one of them being established at e5) 12 ♗d3 ♗g7 (12...♗e7 13 0-0-0 {13 0-0! ±} ♗d7 14 ♖he1 ♖c8 = Browne-Balashov, Skopje 1970) 13 fxe6! fxe6 14 ♕h5+ ♔d8 15 e5! ♕c5 16 0-0-0 ♕xe5 17 ♕f3 ♖b8 18 ♖he1 ♕xh2 19 ♔b1! ♗d7 20 g3 ♕h6 21 ♖h1 ♕g5 22 ♖h5 1-0 Nunn-Chandler, London 1985 (for detailed notes, see *John Nunn's Best Games*).

10 ♘cb5!

Not 10 fxe6 bxc3 11 ♗xf6 cxb2 12 ♖b1 gxf6 13 ♕xf6 ♕c3+ 14 ♔f2 fxe6 15 ♕xh8 ♘c6 and Black is winning.

10 ... axb5

Black has an interesting alternative in **10...♕b7!?**. The game Ernst-Ungureanu, Berlin 1988 continued 11 fxe6 fxe6 **12 ♗xf6** gxf6 13 ♕xf6 ♕xe4+ 14 ♔f2 ♕e5 15 ♘c7+ ♔d7 16 ♕xe5 dxe5 17 ♘xa8 ♗c5 18 ♗e2 ♗b7 19 ♗f3 ♘c6 20 c3 bxc3 21 bxc3 ♗xa8 22 ♖hd1 ♗a7 0-1. Although ...♕b7 looks odd, a refutation is not to hand, for example 11 fxe6 (11 e5 ♘e4 12 ♘c7+ ♕xc7 13 ♕xe4 ♗b7 14 exd6 ♗xd6 15 ♕e2 e5 ∞) fxe6 **12 e5** and now:

1) **12...dxe5** 13 ♕xb7 ♗xb7 14 ♘c7+ ♔f7 15 ♘dxe6 ±.

2) **12...♘e4** 13 ♘c7+ ♕xc7 14 ♕xe4 d5 15 ♕h4 ♕xe5+ 16 ♗e2 ♗c5 17 0-0-0 ♗xd4 18 ♗h5+ g6 19 ♖xd4 gxh5 20 ♖xd5 ♕xd5 21 ♕xh5+ ♔d7 22 ♖d1 ♗b7 23 ♕f7+ ♔c8 24 ♖xd5 ♗xd5 25 ♗f6 ♖d8 26 ♗xd8 ♔xd8 27 ♕xh7 ±.

3) **12...♕xf3!** 13 gxf3 (13 ♘c7+ ♔d7 14 ♘xf3 ♔xc7 15 exf6 gxf6 16 ♗xf6 ♖g8 =) axb5 14 exf6 ♔f7! with an unclear ending.

11 ♗xb5+

After 11 fxe6 ♗e7 12 e5 dxe5 13 ♗xf6 (13 ♘xb5 ♕b7 14 ♕xb7 ♗xb7 ∓ Piaeren-Averkin, USSR 1969) gxf6 14 ♗xb5+ ♔f8 15 ♘f5 ♗xe6 (15...fxe6 16 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 17 ♕xa8 ♕b6 18 ♕a4 ♕d4 19 a3 ♗d7, Murei-Spraggett, Paris Ch 1991, 20 ♗xd7! ♕e3+ 21 ♔f1 ♕f4+ 22 ♔e2 ♕e4+ 23 ♔d1 ±) 16 ♘xe7 ♖a5 17 ♕xf6 ♖xb5 18 ♖f1 ♕xc2 19 ♕xe6 ♕e4+, Murei-Yudasin, Podolsk 1991 the game ends in perpetual check.

11 ... ♗d7

11...♔e7 12 fxe6 followed by 0-0 or ♖f1 is very dangerous; if another piece goes to d7, White takes on e6 in any case.

12 fxe6 ♗xb5
13 ♘xb5 ♕c5

Or:

1) **13...♕b7** 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 0-0 ♕xb5 16 ♕xf6 ♕e5 17 ♕xf7+ ♔d8 18 ♕b7 ♕c5+ (18...d5 19 ♖f5 ♕d4+ 20 ♔h1 +−) 19 ♔h1 ♕c6 20 ♖xf8+ ♖xf8 21 e7+ ♔e8 22 exf8♕+ ♔xf8 23 ♖f1+ +−.

2) **13...♕c4** 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 ♕xf6 ♕xe4+ 16 ♔d1 ♕d5+ 17 ♔c1 ♕xb5 18 exf7+ ♔d7 19 ♕xh8 ♕g5+ 20 ♔b1 ♕xg2 21 ♖c1 (a very odd position!) ♘c6 22 a3 ♘e5 23 ♕xh7 ♕d5 24 ♕f5+ ♔c7 25 axb4 ♖xa1+ 26 ♔xa1 +− Mäki-Arnason, Helsinki 1991.

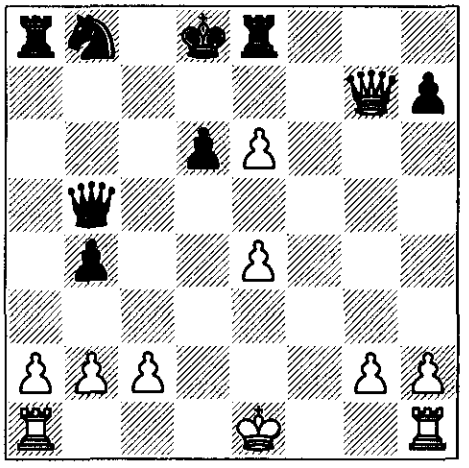
14 ♗xf6 ♕xb5

Or 14...fxe6 15 ♘d4! (15 ♕h3 gxf6 16 ♕xe6+ ♗e7 17 0-0-0 ♕xb5 18 ♕c8+ ♔f7 19 ♕xh8 ♖xa2 20 ♕xh7+ ½-½ Monin-Kopylov, corr 1988) gxf6 16 ♘xe6 (16 ♕xf6? ♕e5) ♕c4 17 ♕xf6 ♘d7 (17...♕xe4+ 18 ♔d1 only opens up fresh lines of attack against Black's king) 18 ♘c7+ ♕xc7 19 ♕xh8 ♘e5 20 0-0 ♕g7 21 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 22 ♕xh7 ± (Rashkovsky).

15 ♗xg7

15 e5 fxe6 16 ♕xa8 gxf6 17 0-0-0 fxe5 18 ♕f3 ♗e7 was good for Black in the game Luther-Rashkovsky, Sverdlovsk 1989.

15 ... ♗xg7
16 ♕xf7+ ♔d8
17 ♕xg7 ♖e8 *(D)*



Perhaps the critical position for the assessment of 9 f5.

18 ♖f1

Or **18 0-0-0** and now:

1) **18...♖xa2** 19 ♖xd6+ ♔c8 20 ♔b1 (20 b3 ♖xc2+ transposes) ♕a5 21 b3 ♖xc2! 22 ♔xc2 ♕c5+ 23 ♔b1 ♕xd6 24 ♖c1+ ♘c6 and perpetual check is the most likely outcome.

2) **18...♖xe6** 19 ♖d5 (19 ♕g8+ ♕e8 ∞; 19 ♖hf1 ♘d7 ∓) ∞.

18 ... b3

18...♖xe6 19 ♖f8+ ♖e8 20 0-0-0 wins.

19 cxb3

19 0-0-0!? is a creative alternative, for example 19...♕c5 (19...bxa2 20 ♖xd6+ ♔c8 21 ♕c3+ ♔b7 22 ♖f7+ +–) 20 ♕f6+? (Ganesan correctly points out that 20 axb3! would have been much more dangerous) ♔c7 21 axb3 ♘c6 22 ♕g7+ ♔b6 23 ♖f7? ♖g8 24 ♖b7+ ♔a6 25 ♕c7 ♖ac8 26 ♕d7 ♖gd8 0-1 Hertzler-Ganesan, corr 1991.

After 19 cxb3 Black can play:

1) **19...♕b4+** 20 ♔f2 ♕c5+ 21 ♔e2 (21 ♔g3 ♖a7 22 ♕f6+ ♖ae7 23 ♖ad1 is equal, Velimirović-Gaprindashvili, Bela Crkva 1984) ♕b5+ (21...♖a7 22 ♕f6+ ♖ae7 23 ♖ac1 ±) 22 ♔e3 ♕c5+ 23 ♕d4 ♕xd4+ 24 ♔xd4 may be ±.

2) **19...♕a5+** 20 ♔d1 ♕h5+ 21 g4 ♕b5 22 ♖f3 ♖xe6 23 ♖f8+ ♖e8 24 ♕f6+ ♔c7 25 ♖f7+ ♔b6 26 ♕xd6+ ♘c6 27 ♖f5 ♖ad8 28 ♖xb5+ ♔xb5 with equality, Hector-Rashkovsky, Snekkersten 1992.

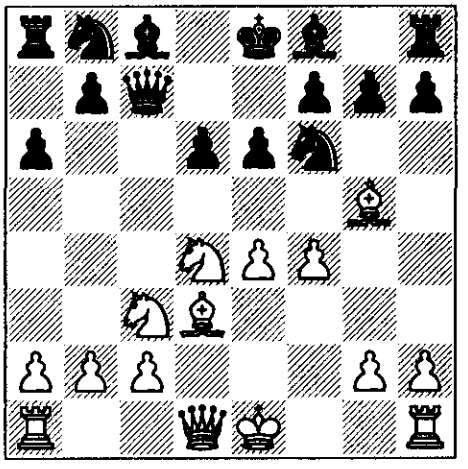
These lines have a certain drawish tendency, both because White's king is exposed to perpetual check and because many endings are drawn even if White has four or five pawns for the piece. The reason for the latter is that White is unable to defend his far-flung pawn islands against a concerted attack by Black's rook and knight.

Line B3 certainly requires very accurate defence by Black. However, drawish positions tend to arise in the main line.

C)

8 ♗d3 *(D)*

B



This move has a tendency to transpose into either chapter 2 (if Black plays ...♗e7) or chapter 14 (if Black plays ...♘bd7 but not ...♗e7). Here we only consider independent variations.

8 ... ♘bd7

Or:

1) **8...♗e7** and now:

1a) **9 ♕f3** b5 10 0-0-0 leads to chapter 2 if Black plays 10...♘bd7. Black can vary by 10...b4, but then 11 e5 ♗b7 12 exd6 ♗xd6 13 ♘e4 looks good for White.

1b) **9 ♕e2?!** is bad since after 9...h6! White has the choice between losing a pawn by 10 ♗h4 ♘xe4 or giving up the two bishops by 10 ♗xf6.

1c) **9 ♘f3** ♕b6 10 ♕d2 ♕xb2 11 0-0 ♘c6 and Black is relatively well off compared with the Poisoned Pawn.

2) **8...b5** (the most thematic move) 9 ♕e2 (9 ♗xf6 may be better now than on move 8, as ...b5 is less useful when Black may want to castle queenside) b4 10 ♘d1 (10 ♘b1 ♘bd7 11 ♘d2 ♗e7 12 ♘c4 d5 13 exd5

♘xd5 = Lerner-Averkin, USSR 1st League 1974) ♘bd7 11 ♘f2 ♗b7 (11...♗e7 12 0-0 ♕b6 13 ♘b3 ♗b7 14 f5 ♘e5 15 ♗e3 ♕c7 16 ♘d4 ♕d7 17 fxe6 fxe6 18 ♘h3 ♘xd3 19 cxd3 0-0 20 ♘g5 e5 21 ♘f5 h6 22 ♘f3 ± Geller-Balashov, USSR Ch 1975) 12 0-0-0!? (12 0-0 ♗e7 13 ♘f3 h6 14 ♗h4 ♘h5! 15 ♗xe7?! ♘xf4 16 ♕d2 ♘xd3 17 cxd3 ♔xe7 18 ♕xb4 ♕b6! ∓ Spraggett-Gelfand, Manila IZ 1990) ♗e7 13 ♖he1 h6! 14 ♗h4 ♘c5 15 e5 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♘d5 17 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 18 g3 0-0 19 ♘e4 ♘xe4 20 ♗xe4 ♖fd8 21 ♕f3 ♖ac8! ∓ Nisipeanu-Istratescu, Mamaia 1991.

9 ♕e2

9 ♕f3 b5 10 0-0-0 ♗b7 11 ♖he1 transposes to chapter 14.

The plan of ♗d3 and ♕e2 is very dangerous here. The reason is that White builds up for e5 without having his e-pawn pinned by the b7-bishop, so after only a few moves (♕e2, 0-0-0 and ♖he1) White is ready for a crushing central advance. Normally White cannot achieve this formation, because an early ♗d3 is met by ...♕b6 attacking b2 and d4. Thus the ♗d3 and ♕e2 plan is only really effective against an early ...♕c7, because then ...♕b6 would involve losing a tempo. In the main line below Black continues with his normal developing moves, but this proves very risky. Therefore Black should deviate at some stage (probably at move eight).

9 ... b5

Or **9...♗e7** and now:

1) **10 0-0-0** (this looks best) h6 11 ♗h4 b5 (11...♘c5? 12 e5) 12 ♖he1 g5 13 fxg5 hxg5 14 ♗xg5 b4 (14...♖xh2? 15 ♗f4 ♖h8 16 ♗xb5!) 15 ♘b1 ♗b7 16 ♖f1 leaves Black without enough for the pawn.

2) **10 ♘f3** (rather slow) h6 (not 10...b5? 11 e5) 11 ♗h4 ♘c5 (11...e5 12 g3?! {12 f5} 0-0 13 0-0-0 ♖e8 14 f5 b5 15 g4 ♗b7 16 g5 hxg5 17 ♘xg5 d5 18 ♘xd5? ♗xd5 19 exd5 e4 0-1 Clement-Florea, corr 1979) 12 0-0-0 b5 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘d5 15 ♘xd5 exd5 16 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 17 h3 0-0 18 ♘d4 ♕g5+ 19 ♔b1 ♘e6 20 ♘c6 ♘f4 21 ♕f2 ♗d7 22 h4 ♕g4 23 ♘e7+ ♔h8 24 g3 ♘xd3 25 ♖xd3 ♖ae8 26 ♘xd5 ♖xe5 ∓ Tal-Balashov, USSR Ch 1969.

10 0-0-0 ♗b7

10...b4 11 ♘d5! ♕b7 12 ♖he1 e5 13 ♘f3 ♘xd5 14 exd5 f6 15 ♗h4 ♗e7 16 fxe5 ♘xe5 17 ♘xe5 fxe5 18 ♕h5+ wins, Sharavdorj-Tayvanbaatar, Mongolian Ch 1994.

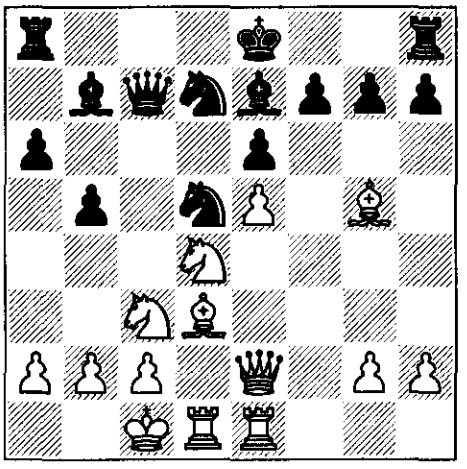
11 ♖he1 ♗e7

Allowing e5 is risky, but there is no forced win for White. The alternative is 11...0-0-0, although bearing in mind that White is a tempo up over the already favourable line 4d4 in the note to Black's 11th move in line A2 of chapter 14, one cannot offer Black much hope. Indeed, the immediate 12 ♗xb5 (12 e5? dxe5 13 fxe5 ♕xe5!) is very dangerous.

12 e5 dxe5
13 fxe5 ♘d5 *(D)*
14 ♗xe7

Keres's suggestion **14 ♘xe6** is also interesting. He gave the variations:

1) **14...fxe6** 15 ♕h5+ ♔d8 (or 15...g6 16 ♗xg6+ hxg6 17 ♕xg6+ {17 ♕xh8+ ♘f8 18 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 19 ♘e4 ±} ♔d8 18 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 19 ♗xe7+ ♔c8 20 ♖e3 ♔b7 21 ♗d6 ±) 16 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 17 ♗xe7+ ♔xe7 18



♕g5+ ♔e8 (18...♔f8 19 ♖f1+ ♔**g8** 20 ♕e7) 19 ♕xg7 ±.

2) **14...♗xg5+** 15 ♘xg5 ♘xc3 16 bxc3 ♕xc3 17 ♕g4! ♕**a3+** 18 ♔d2 (18 ♔b1? ♗d5) ♕a5+ 19 ♔e2! and Black loses material.

However, there are improvements for Black in this analysis. First of all, in line 1 Black can play 18...♔f8 19 ♖f1+ ♔**e8!** and now 20 ♕xg7 can be met by 20...♕xe5!. Even more clear-cut is **17...♘c5!** in line 2. This threatens to take on d3, and after 18 ♔b1 ♘xd3 19 cxd3 0-0 White's king is the more exposed.

14 ... ♘xc3

But not 14...♔xe7 (14...♘xe7 15 ♗xb5 +–) 15 ♕g4 ♘xc3 16 ♘xe6! ♕c6 17 ♕g5+ +–.

15 ♕g4

15 bxc3 ♔xe7 16 ♕g4 ♗d5! is unclear.

15 ... ♘xd1

Not 15...♘xe5 (15...♔xe7 16 ♘**xe6** +– as above) 16 ♕xg7 ♘xd1 17 ♖**xe5** ♕xe7 (17...♔xe7 18 ♖xe6+ ♔d7 19 ♕xf7+ ♔c8 20 ♖e8+ +–) 18 ♕xh8+ ♔d7 19 ♕g7 ♘f2 20 ♗xh7 with a clear plus for White.

16 ♘xe6

16 ♗d6 favours White, according to Keres. He gave:

1) **16...♘f2** 17 ♕xg7 ♘xd3+ 18 ♔b1 0-0-0 19 cxd3!.

2) **16...♕a5** 17 ♕g5! f6 18 ♕h5+ ♔d8 19 ♘xe6+ ♔c8 20 ♖xd1.

3) **16...♕b6** 17 ♕g5 ♘f6 18 exf6 ♕xd6 19 ♘f5! ±.

However, once again this needs correcting. Black can play **16...♘xe5!** 17 ♗xe5 ♘f2! 18 ♕xg7 ♘xd3+ 19 ♔b1 ♘xe5 20 ♕xh8+ ♔e7 21 ♕xe5 ♕xe5 22 ♖xe5 ♗xg2 and Black should win.

16 ... ♕c6?

After 16...fxe6 17 ♗d6 ♕b6 18 ♕xe6+ ♔d8 19 ♗f5 ♗c6 20 ♖xd1 ♕e3+ 21 ♔b1 ♕e2 the position is unclear.

17 ♘xg7+ ♔xe7

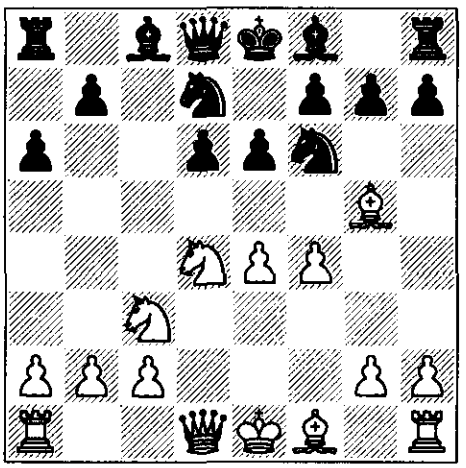
White is winning.

The game Spassky-Rashkovsky, USSR Ch 1973 concluded: 18 ♕g5+ f6 (18...♔f8 19 ♘f5 ♘f2 20 e6! +–) 19 exf6+ ♔d8 20 f7+ ♔c7 21 ♕f4+ 1-0.

14 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♘bd7

This is another line in which Black attempts to play ...b5 before completing his development. Once again play becomes very sharp as White tries to break through in the centre. However, it seems that the most violent attempts do not offer White any advantage.

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5 e6 7 f4 ♘bd7 *(D)*



Now there are three plans:

A: 8 ♕f3
B: 8 ♕e2
C: 8 ♗c4

Or **8 ♗e2** (8 ♗d3?! ♕b6 9 ♘b3 h6 is fine for Black) and now:

1) **8...♕b6** 9 ♕d2 ♗e7 (there seems little point to 8...♕b6 if Black is not going to take the pawn) 10 0-0-0 h6 11 h4!? (11 ♗h4 is possible) hxg5 12 hxg5 ♖xh1 13 ♖xh1 ♘g8 14 ♖h8 ♔f8 15 g6 ♘c5 16 gxf7 ♔xf7 17 ♗h5+ ♔f8 18 ♗g6 with a dangerous attack, Westerinen-Vitolinš, Jurmala 1978.

2) **8...♗e7** 9 ♕d2 (9 0-0 ♕b6 10 ♔h1 ♕xb2 11 ♕d2 ♕b6 12 ♗f3 0-0 13 ♖ab1 ♕c7 14 f5 ♘e5 15 ♘ce2 ♘c4 16 ♕e1 e5 ∓ Niedermaier-Dietze, Bundesliga 1985) ♕c7 10 ♗f3 h6 11 ♗xf6 (11 ♗h4? ♘xe4 ∓) ♗xf6 12 h4 ♘b6 13 0-0-0 ♗d7 14 g4 ♘c4 15 ♕d3 ♖c8 16 b3 ♘e3! 17 ♕xe3 ♕xc3 18 ♕xc3 ♖xc3 ∓ Ljubojević-Gelfand, Linares 1991.

A)

8 ♕f3 ♕c7

8...♗e7 9 ♗c4 is good for White, e.g. 9...h6 10 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 11 0-0-0 ♕b6 12 ♘xe6! fxe6 13 ♗xe6 ♘f8 14 ♗b3 ♗e6 15 e5 dxe5 16 ♖he1 with more than enough for the piece, Budde-Schultz, Bundesliga 1986.

9 0-0-0

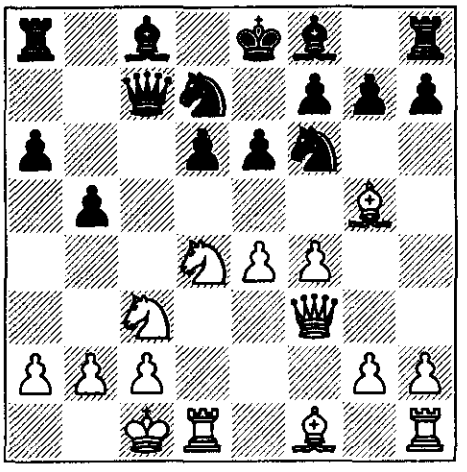
This is the most natural move, although several others have been tried. Here are a few samples:

1) **9 ♗e2** b5 10 f5!? (very sharp) b4 (10...♘e5 11 ♕g3 b4 12 ♗xf6 gxf6 13 ♘d1 ♕c5 14 ♘b3 ♕xc2 15 fxe6 fxe6 16 ♗h5+ ♔e7 17 0-0 ♗h6 18 ♘e3 ♕d3!? ∞) 11 fxe6 ♘e5!? (11...bxc3 12 exd7+ ♘xd7 13 0-0 ♘e5 14 ♕xc3 ±) 12 ♕xf6! gxf6 13 ♘d5 ♕a7! 14 ♘xf6+ ♔d8 15 ♘d5+ ♔e8 16 ♘f6+ ♔d8 17 ♘d5+ ½-½ Ljubojević-Gelfand, Novi Sad OL 1990.

2) **9 a4!?** ♗e7 10 ♗e2 h6 11 ♗h4 ♘xe4 12 ♗xe7 ♘xc3 13 bxc3 ♔xe7 14 0-0 ♖e8 ∓ Shabalov-Wolff, USA Ch 1993.

3) **9 ♗d3** h6 10 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 11 0-0-0 e5? (11...♗e7 =) 12 ♘f5 ♗e6 13 ♘d5 ♗xd5 14 exd5 ♘d7 15 ♖he1 0-0-0 16 ♖e4 ♕a5 17 a3 g6 18 ♘e3 f5 19 ♖c4+ ♔b8 20 ♕g3 ∞ Boey-Gutman, Brussels OHRA 1987.

9 ... b5 *(D)*



Now we have three lines, all critical for the assessment of 7...♘bd7. In line A3 White sacrifices a piece, while in A1 two pieces are invested in the attack. The relatively calm 10 ♗d3 (A2) may be met by the solid 10...♗b7 11 ♖he1 0-0-0, but if Black plays 11...♕b6, then White sacrifices again. All these lines are very sharp, so assessments may change with the discovery of a single tactical finesse, but at the time of writing line A2 appears to offer White the best chance. However, this line has the defect that Black can transpose to chapter 2, and he should probably take this chance.

A1: 10 e5
A2: 10 ♗d3
A3: 10 ♗xb5

Other moves:

1) **10 a3** transposes into chapter 13, line B, note to White's 9th.

2) **10 g4** b4 (10...♗b7 is a safe and sensible reply; Black can transpose to chapter 1 by 10...♗e7) 11 ♘ce2 (11 ♘d5!? exd5 12 exd5 ♗b7 13 ♖e1+ ♔d8 14 ♘c6+ ♗xc6 15 dxc6 ♘b6 16 ♗xf6+ gxf6 17 ♕e4 ♗e7, Dengler-V.Gurevich, Cham 1992, 18 ♗c4! ♘xc4 19 ♕xc4 is unclear) ♗b7 (11...d5 12 ♘g3 is too risky, e.g. 12...dxe4 13 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 14 ♕xe4 ♘b6 15 ♘b5! axb5 16 ♗xb5+ 1-0 Albrecht-Spoden, corr 1975) 12 ♘g3 ♖c8 13 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 14 ♗d3 g6 15 ♖hf1 ♗g7 16 f5 e5 17 ♘b3 ♗h6+ 18 ♔b1 ♗g5 19 ♘d2 0-0 20 ♖h1 d5 21 exd5 ♘xd5 ∓ Vatter-Dvoirys, Budapest 1989.

3) **10 ♗xf6** ♘xf6 (10...gxf6 11 ♗d3 {11 e5 ♗b7 12 ♕h3 fxe5 13 ♘xe6 fxe6 14 ♕xe6+ ♗e7 15 ♗xb5 ♔d8! 16 fxe5 axb5 17 ♘xb5 ♕c8 18 ♘xd6 ♗xd6 19 ♕xd6 ♖a6 ∓ Iacob-Berecz, corr 1991} h5 12 ♖he1 b4 13 ♘d5 exd5 14 exd5+ ♘e5 15 fxe5 fxe5 16 h3 ♕e7 17 ♘c6 ± Gemeinder-Kettler, Hessenliga 1993) 11 e5 ♗b7 and now:

3a) **12 ♗xb5+?** axb5 13 ♘dxb5 ♕b8! (13...♕b6? 14 ♖xd6! ±) favours Black.

3b) **12 ♕g3** and now:

3b1) **12...♘d5** 13 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 14 ♔b1 0-0-0 15 ♗e2 ± Strauts-Baburin, USSR 1986.

3b2) **12...♘e4** 13 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 14 ♗d3 (14 exd6 ♗xd6 15 ♕xg7 ♗xf4+ 16 ♔b1 ♗e5 17 ♕g4 f5 ∓) ♗xd3 15 ♖xd3 g6 16 f5!? gxf5 17 ♘xf5 dxe5 18 ♘g7+ ♗xg7 19 ♕xg7 ♖f8 20 ♖hd1 ± Sendera-Kr.Georgiev, Myslenice 1987.

3b3) **12...dxe5** 13 ♘cxb5! (not 13 fxe5 ♘d7 14 ♘f3 ♖c8 ∓ Rashidian-Karpman, Gießen 1994) ♕b6! (13...axb5? 14 ♗xb5+ ♔e7 15 fxe5 ♘e4 16 ♕f4! ♖xa2 {not 16...g5? 17 ♘f5+! exf5 18 ♕xf5 +–} 17 ♔b1 ♕a5 18 ♘b3 ♕xb5 19 ♖hf1 ♕e8 20 ♔xa2 ±) 14 fxe5 ♘e4 15 ♕b3 ♗c5 16 ♘d6+ ♘xd6 17 ♕xb6 ♗xb6 18 exd6 = ½-½ Diaz-Shneider, Havana 1990.

3c) **12 ♕h3** dxe5 13 ♘cxb5 (13 ♘xe6 fxe6 14 ♕xe6+ ♕e7 15 ♕b6 is an incredible idea; 15...♖c8 16 fxe5 ♘e4 17 ♘xb5 ♕c5 18 ♕e6+ ♗e7 19 ♕d7+ ♔f8 20 ♘d4 ♗d5 21 ♗xa6 ± was Pinkas-Skalik, Poland Ch 1993 and although it is hard to believe that the sacrifice is sound, no obvious refutation is visible) ♕b6! (13...axb5 14 ♗xb5+ ♔e7 15 fxe5 ♕xe5 16 ♖he1 ♕f4+ 17 ♔b1 ♗d5 18 ♘c6+ ♗xc6 19 ♗xc6 ♖b8 20 ♕a3+ ♕b4 21 ♕a7+ 1-0 Rogulj-Kr.Georgiev, Varna 1977) 14 fxe5 ♘e4 (the calm 14...♘d5! ∞ gives Black sufficient play in return for the pawn) 15 ♗c4 0-0-0? 16 ♘xe6 is winning for White, Krakops-Skomorokhin, Berlin Summer 1993.

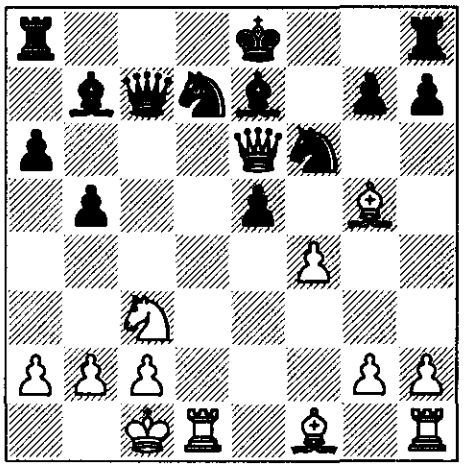
A1)

10 e5 ♗b7
11 ♕h3

Not 11 ♘dxb5? axb5 12 ♘xb5 ♕b6 13 ♖xd6 ♗xd6 14 ♕xb7 ♕e3+ 15 ♔d1 0-0 16 ♕f3 ♘g4 and Black wins, Bode-Röschlau, Lugano 1989.

11 ... **dxe5**
12 ♘xe6 **fxe6**
13 ♕xe6+ ♗e7 *(D)*

Of the three choices, A11 leads to perpetual check, A12 is unclear and A13, which has been played quite



frequently recently, seems to be at least equal for Black:

A11: 14 ♗xf6
A12: 14 ♗xb5
A13: 14 ♘xb5

A11)

14 ♗xf6 **gxf6**

Not 14...♘xf6? 15 ♗xb5+ ♔f8 16 fxe5 ♗c8 (there is nothing better; 16...axb5 17 exf6 +–; 16...♗xg2 17 ♗c4 +–) 17 ♕c6 ♕a7 18 exf6 gxf6 19 ♗c4 +– Richardson-Mostow, corr 1965.

15 ♗e2

15 ♗xb5!? axb5 16 ♘xb5 ♕c6 17 ♘d6+ ♕xd6 18 ♖xd6 ♘c5 19 ♕f5 ♗e4 20 ♕h5+ ♗g6, Tseitlin-Gutman, USSR 1971, 21 ♕d1 ♘b3+ 22 ♔b1 ♖c8 23 ♖d3 ♘d4 24 fxe5 fxe5 25 ♖e1 ∞.

15 ... **h5**

Not 15...♕c6? 16 ♗h5+ ♔d8 17 ♖xd7+ ♕xd7 18 ♖d1 nor 15...♗c6? 16 ♗h5+ ♔d8 17 ♘d5, and White wins in both cases.

16 ♘d5

This move heads for a draw. Plenty of other moves have been tried, but of the alternatives only line 4 is interesting:

1) **16 ♗f3** ♗xf3! (16...e4? 17 ♗xe4 ♘f8 18 ♕f5 ♗c8 19 ♘d5 ♕d6 20 ♘xf6+ ♔f7 21 ♗d5+ ♔g7 22 ♘e8+ 1-0 Jongman-Kolenbrander, corr 1978) 17 gxf3 ♘f8 18 ♕f5 ♕c8 (18...♖d8 19 ♖xd8+ ♗xd8 20 ♖d1 ♖h6 21 fxe5 fxe5 22 f4 ♘e6 23 ♘d5 ♕g7 ∓ Martins-Barcenilla, Parnaiba U-26 Wcht 1995) 19 ♕e4 ♖a7! 20 fxe5 f5 21 ♕e2 ♘e6 ∓ Wittmann-Ježek, corr 1992.

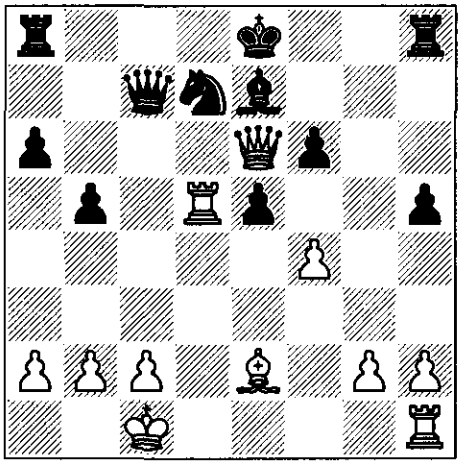
2) **16 ♘xb5?!** axb5 17 ♗xb5 0-0-0 18 ♕xe7 was Westerinen-Jakobsen, Raach Z 1969 and now 18...exf4! is slightly better for Black.

3) **16 ♗d3** ♘f8 17 ♕h3 exf4 18 ♖he1 ♖d8 19 a4 b4 20 ♘e4 ♔f7 21 g3 b3 22 ♕f1 ♖d4 23 ♘c3 bxc2 24 ♗g6+ ♘xg6 −+ Tringov-Polugaevsky, Skopje 1971.

4) **16 fxe5** ♘f8 17 ♕b3 ♖d8 (not 17...fxe5? 18 ♖hf1 ♗g5+ 19 ♔b1 ♖d8 20 ♖de1 ♖d7 21 ♖f5 ♗d2 22 ♖ef1 ♕c5 23 ♘xb5 axb5 24 ♗xb5 ± Meiers-Gusakov, Riga 1992) 18 exf6 ♕f4+ 19 ♔b1 ♖xd1+ 20 ♖xd1 ♕xf6 21 ♘xb5 axb5, Kuindzhi-Tseitlin, USSR 1971, 22 ♗xb5+ ♗c6 23 ♖f1 ♕d6 24 ♗xc6+ ♕xc6 25 ♕b8+ ♔d7 26 ♕a7+ =.

16 ... ♗xd5

17 ♖xd5 *(D)*



B

17 ... ♘b6

17...♘c5 also seems to lead to a draw after **18 ♕f5 ♕c6! 19 ♕g6+ ♔f8** and now:

1) **20 ♖xe5?!** ♖c8! (20...♕e8 21 ♕f5 ♕c8 22 ♕g6 ♕e8 23 ♕f5 ♕c8 ½-½ Schulman-Parma, Lugano OL 1968) 21 ♖xh5 (21 ♗xh5 ♘d3+! 22 ♕xd3 fxe5 ∓) ♖g8! 22 ♕h6+ ♔f7! with an edge for Black.

2) **20 ♖hd1** ♕e8 (20...♘e6 21 ♗xh5 ♖xh5 22 ♕xh5 ♘xf4 23 ♕h8+ ♔f7 24 ♕h7+ ♔f8 {24...♔e6 25 ♖5d2 ±} 25 ♕h8+ =) 21 ♕f5 ♕c8 (21...exf4? 22 ♖xc5 ♗xc5 23 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 24 ♕g5+! ♔f8 25 ♕xc5+ +−) 22 ♕g6 ♕e6 23 ♗xh5 ♕g8 24 ♖d8+ (24 ♕f5 ♕xg2 25 ♖xc5 ♖xh5! 26 ♕xh5 ♗xc5 27 ♕h8+ ♔e7 28 ♕h7+ is also a draw) ♖xd8 ½-½ Van der Wiel-Kasparov, Amsterdam 1991 as 25 ♖xd8+ ♗xd8 26 ♕e8+ ♔g7 27 ♕g6+ is perpetual check.

After 17...♘b6, White's best is probably to take the draw:

1) **18 ♗xh5+** ♖xh5 19 ♕g8+ ♗f8 20 ♕e6+ ½-½ Capelan-Polugaevsky, Solingen 1974.

2) **18 ♗d3?!** ♔f8 (18...♖h6 is an immediate draw by 19 ♕g8+) 19 ♗g6 ♔g7! (19...♗d8? 20 ♖xd8+! ♖xd8 21 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 22 ♗f7+ ♕xf7 23 ♕xd8+ ± Khavsky-Gutman, Sevastopol 1970) 20 ♕f7+ ♔h6 21 ♗e4 (or 21 ♗f5 ♖ag8 22 ♖d3 ♕c4 23 ♕xh5+ ♔g7 −+) ♖ag8 22 ♖d3 ♗d8 23 ♕e6 ♕c8 −+ Georgadze-Gutman, USSR 1972.

3) **18 ♖d3** (the only reasonable way to try to avoid the draw) ♘a4 (18...♖c8?! 19 ♖c3 ♘c4 20 ♖d1 exf4 {20...♕c6 21 ♗xh5+ ♖xh5 22 ♕g8+ ♗f8 23 ♕g6+ ♔e7 24 ♕xh5 ±} 21 ♗d3 ♖h6 22 ♕g8+ ♗f8 23

♖e1+ ♔d7 24 ♕e6+ 1-0 Howell-Britton, Sheffield 1991) 19 ♕f5 (19 ♖g3 ♔f8 20 ♗xh5 ♕c4! refutes the attack) exf4? 20 ♗xh5+ ♔f8, Titie-Lundholm, corr 1965, 21 ♕d5 ♖xh5 22 ♕xh5 ♖c8 23 ♕h8+ ♔f7 24 ♕h7+ ♔f8 25 ♖h3 +–. However, improvements on Black's 19th move are not hard to find, for example 19...♔f8.

A12)

14 ♗xb5 axb5
15 ♘xb5 ♕c6

Definitely best. After 15...♕b6 16 ♘d6+ ♔d8 17 ♘xb7+ ♔c7 18 ♕xe7 ♖xa2, Engel-Nikolić, corr 1983, and now White can continue 19 b4! ♕f2 20 ♖xd7+ ♘xd7 21 ♕d6+ ♔c8 22 ♕c6+ ♔b8 23 ♔b1 ♖a7 24 ♘a5 ±.

16 ♘d6+ ♔d8
17 fxe5

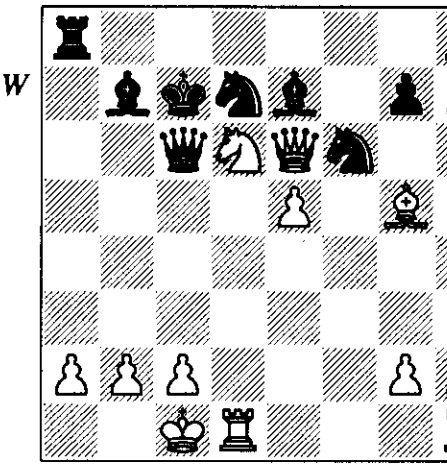
Not 17 ♘xb7+? ♔c7 18 ♕xe7 ♖xa2 ∓, nor 17 ♘f7+? ♔c7 18 ♕xe7 ♘d5! 19 ♖xd5 ♕xd5 20 ♘xh8 ♖xa2 21 ♔b1 ♖a8 –+ Haag-Kluger, Budapest 1968.

17 ... ♔c7 *(D)*

Or:

1) **17...♘d5** 18 ♗xe7+ ♘xe7 (or 18...♔c7 19 ♔b1 ±) 19 ♘f7+ (19 ♕f7 ♗c8! {19...♗a6 20 e6 ♘c5 21 ♖d4 ♘d3+ 22 ♔b1 ♘e5 23 ♘f5+ ♘d5 24 ♖xd5+ 1-0 Astashin-Freod, USSR 1968} and I cannot see a good continuation for White) ♔e8 (not 19...♔c7? 20 ♖d6 ♕a4 21 ♖hd1 ♗d5 22 ♖6xd5 ♘xd5 23 ♕d6+ ♔c8 24 ♕xd5 winning, Aria Nejad-Rahim Khani, Teheran 1991) 20 ♘d6+ (20 ♕xc6 ♗xc6 21 ♘xh8 ♗d5 22 e6 ♗xe6 23 ♖he1 ♖a6 24 a4 ♘c8 25 ♖d3 ♔e7 26 ♖de3 ∞ Hector-Nedobora, Aceimar 1995) ♔d8 21 ♖d2!? (avoiding the draw) ♘c8 (21...♔c7!) 22 ♖hd1 ♘cb6 23 ♕b3 ♔c7 24 ♘xb7 ♕xb7? (24...♘xe5 ±) 25 ♖xd7+ +– Dragomirescu-Malanca, Romania Cht 1992.

2) **17...♖e8** 18 exf6 gxf6 19 ♘xb7+ ♔c7 (19...♕xb7 20 ♗f4 ±) 20 ♖xd7+ (20 ♗f4+ ♘e5 ∞) ♕xd7 21 ♗f4+ ♔c8 22 ♕xd7+ (22 ♕b3 ♕a4! ±) ♔xd7 23 ♖d1+ ♔e6 24 a3 ♖a6 25 ♖d3 ♖c8, Bronstein-Ciocaltea, Kislovodsk 1968, and now according to Spassky White is better after 26 ♖b3.



18 ♕xe7

Or:

1) **18 ♗xf6** (the safest) gxf6 19 ♕xe7 ♖xa2 20 ♘xb7 (20 c4 ♔b8 21 ♕g7 ♖c8 22 ♖he1 ♕b6 23 ♖e2 ♕b3 24 ♖c2 ♕b4 25 ♔b1 ♕a5 26 ♖c3 ♕a4 0-1 Kupka-Tseitlin, Czechoslovakia 1973) ♖a1+ 21 ♔d2 ♕d5+ 22 ♔e2 ♕xg2+ 23 ♔e3 ♕g5+, Winsnes-Svensson, Swedish Ch 1991, 24 ♔f2 ♕h4+ 25 ♔e3 ♕g5+ is a draw.

2) **18 ♔b1** (this was mentioned in *The Najdorf for the Tournament Player*, but it has not been repeated) ♘d5?! (18...♗xd6 19 ♖xd6 ♕xg2 20 ♖hd1 is very dangerous since 20...♕xg5? 21 ♖xd7+ ♘xd7 22 ♖xd7+ ♔b8 23 ♕d6+ ♔a7 24 ♕c5+

mates; 18...♗f8!? could be best, and indeed it is hard to see a good reply to this move) 19 ♗xe7 ♖xa2 20 c4! (20 ♔xa2? ♘b4+) ♕a4 (20...♖a1+ 21 ♔xa1 ♕a4+ 22 ♔b1 ♘c3+ 23 ♔c1 +–) 21 ♘b5+ ♔c8 22 ♗a3! ♖xa3 23 bxa3 ♘c3+ 24 ♔c1! ♘xd1 25 ♖xd1 ♔b8 26 ♖xd7 ♖c8 27 ♖xb7+ ♔xb7 28 ♘d6+ 1-0 Espig-Bramauer, Strobeck 1970.

3) **18 ♖he1!?** (a new idea) ♘d5 19 ♗xe7 ♖xa2 20 c4 ♘xe7 21 ♕xe7 ♖a1+ 22 ♔d2 ♖xd1+ 23 ♖xd1 ♗a6 24 ♔c3 ♔b8 25 b3 ♘c5 26 ♖d5 ♕b6 27 b4 ♘b7 ∞ Kofidis-Kotronias, Greek Ch 1996. Even though White has three useful pawns for the piece, his exposed king makes perpetual check a likely outcome.

18 ... ♖xa2

18...♘d5 may be better, for example 19 ♖xd5 ♕xd5 20 ♖d1 ♕xe5! 21 ♘xb7 (21 ♘e8+ ♖axe8 22 ♖xd7+ ♔c6 –+) ♕xe7 22 ♗xe7 ♖xa2 23 ♖d3 (23 ♔b1 ♖ha8 24 ♗a3 ♖2xa3 25 bxa3 ♖b8 –+) ♖a1+ 24 ♔d2 ♖g1 with an edge for Black.

After 18...♖xa2 White can try:

1) **19 ♖d4?** (an unjustified winning attempt) ♖a1+ 20 ♔d2 ♕xg2+ 21 ♔c3 ♕f3+ 22 ♔b4 ♖a4+! 23 ♔xa4 ♗c6+ 24 ♔b4 ♖b8+ 25 ♔c4 ♘d5! 26 ♘e8+ ♖xe8 27 ♕d6+ ♔b7 –+ Planinc-Minić, Ljubljana-Portorož 1973.

2) **19 ♗xf6** ♖a1+ (19...gxf6 transposes to line 1 in the note to White's 18th move) 20 ♔d2 ♕d5+ 21 ♔e2 ♕xg2+ 22 ♔e3 ♕f3+ 23 ♔d2 ♕d5+ drawing, Ajanski-Commons, Plovdiv 1976.

3) **19 exf6** ♖a1+ 20 ♔d2 ♕d5+ 21 ♔c3 ♕a5+ 22 ♔d3 ♕d5+ ½-½ Vitolinš-Yuferov, Moscow 1972.

While a few points remain unclear, one gains the strong impression that one way or another this line should lead to a draw.

A13)

14 ♘xb5 axb5

15 ♗xb5 ♗e4! *(D)*

The strongest move. Alternatives:

1) **15...0-0-0** 16 ♕xe7 and now:

1a) **16...♗xg2?!** 17 ♖he1 exf4 (17...♗e4 18 ♗d3 ±) 18 ♕b4! with a very strong attack.

1b) **16...♘c5?!** 17 ♕xc7+ ♔xc7 18 fxe5 ± Van der Wiel-Schendstock, Netherlands 1981.

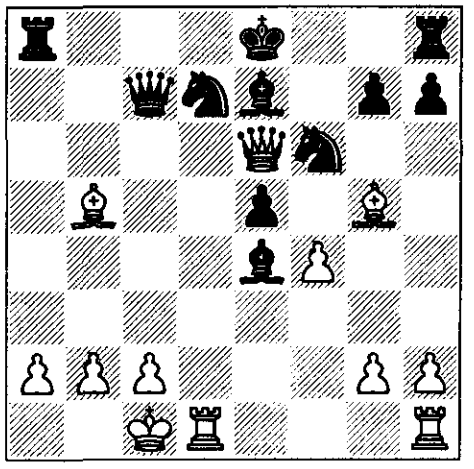
1c) **16...h6** 17 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 (this is slightly better than 17...gxf6?! 18 ♗xd7+ ♖xd7 19 ♕xf6 ±) 18 ♕xc7+ ♔xc7 19 fxe5 ♘e4 20 e6, Van der Wiel-Ginting, Lucerne OL 1982, and now 20...♘d6 21 ♗a4 ♗c6 would have been ±.

1d) **16...exf4** 17 ♕xg7 (17 ♕b4 ♘e5 18 ♕xf4 ♖d5 19 ♖xd5 ♘xd5 20 ♕f5+ ♔b8 21 ♖e1 ♘g6 ∞ Zheliandinov-Polugaevsky, USSR Ch 1967; 17 ♖d4?! ♘c5 18 ♕xc7+ ♔xc7 19 ♗xf4+ ♔b6 20 ♖xd8 ♖xd8 21 a4 ♗c6 22 ♗xc6 ♔xc6 ∓ L.Garcia-Yudasin, Seville 1993) ♖hg8 18 ♗xd7+ ♘xd7 19 ♗xd8 ♖xg7 20 ♗xc7 ♔xc7 21 ♖hf1 ♖xg2 22 ♖xf4 ♖xh2 23 ♖f7 ♗c6 24 b3 h5 25 a4 ±.

2) **15...♖d8** 16 ♖he1 e4 17 ♗xf6! gxf6 18 g3 ♖f8 (18...f5 19 ♖e3 ♗c8 20 ♕xf5 ±) 19 ♖e3 ♖f7 (19...♗c8! 20 ♖xe4 ♖f7 is unclear) 20 ♖c3 ♕a5 21 ♖c5! ± Chudinovskikh-Grigoriadis, USSR 1982.

3) **15...♗d5?** 16 ♖xd5 ♘xd5 17 ♖d1! (17 ♕xd5? ♖c8 ∓) 0-0-0 (or 17...♖c8 18 c4! ♕d6 19 ♕xd6 ♗xd6 20 ♖xd5 +–) 18 ♖xd5 ♗xg5 19 fxg5

e4 20 ♖d6 ♖he8 (20...♕a7 21 b3! e3 22 ♖c6+ ♔b7 23 ♖a6 +–) 21 ♗xd7+ ♕xd7 22 ♕c4+ ♕c7 23 ♖c6 and White wins, Chudinovskikh-Kuporosov, USSR 1980.



16 ♖d2

Or:

1) **16 ♗xd7+** ♔f8 17 c3 ♗a3! (17...♖a3? 18 ♕xe5!) 18 ♕xe5 ♕b6 19 ♖d2 ♖a5! ∓.

2) **16 c4** 0-0-0 17 ♕xe7 h6 18 ♗xf6 gxf6 19 ♖xd7 ♖xd7 20 ♗xd7+ ♕xd7 21 ♕c5+ ♕c7 22 ♕xc7+ ♔xc7 23 fxe5 f5! 24 ♖hf1 ♖a8 ∓ Zheliandinov-Gutman, USSR 1970.

3) **16 c3** and now:

3a) **16...♖d8** 17 fxe5 ♗d5 18 ♖xd5 ♘xd5 19 ♖d1 ♕b6 (19...♔f8 20 ♗xe7+ ♘xe7 21 ♗xd7 +–) 20 ♗c6 ♕xc6 21 ♕xc6 ♗xg5+ 22 ♔b1 ♘e7 23 ♕b5 +– Chudinovskikh-Karpman, Smolensk 1991.

3b) **16...0-0-0** 17 ♕xe7 ♕b6! (17...♖he8? 18 ♕b4 ♗b7 19 fxe5 ♕xe5 20 ♗f4 ♕e7 21 ♕c4+ ♕c5 22 ♖xd7 +– M.Přibyl-Vasilchenko, Hlinsko 1993) 18 ♕b4 ♕e3+ 19 ♖d2 h6?? (an incredible blunder allowing mate in two; after 19...♘b8! Black is winning) 20 ♗a6+ 1-0 Van der Wiel-Gutman, Amsterdam 1984.

16 ... ♔f8

Not 16...0-0-0 17 ♕xe7 h6 18 ♗xf6 gxf6 19 ♖hd1 ±.

17 ♗c4!

17 ♗xd7 ♗b4! 18 c3 ♗xc3 19 bxc3 ♕xc3+ 20 ♔d1 ♕a1+ 21 ♔e2 ♕xh1 and now Black's king can escape the checks on g6, while after 22 ♗xf6 ♕xg2+ 23 ♔e1 ♕g1+ 24 ♔e2 ♗f3+! 25 ♔xf3 ♖a3+ White has to give up his queen.

After 17 ♗c4! Black has an edge: 17...♗g6 18 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 19 fxe5 ♗b4! 20 ♖f2 ♗f7 (20...♖e8? 21 ♖xf6+! +–) 21 ♕xf7+ ♕xf7 22 ♗xf7 ♔xf7 23 a3 ♗e7 (or 23...♗c5 24 ♖f3 ♖he8 25 exf6 gxf6 26 ♖hf1 ♖a6 27 g4 h6 ∓ Wittmann-Gutman, Beersheba 1985) 24 exf6 ♗xf6 25 c3 h5 26 ♖d1?! (26 ♖e2!? h4 27 h3 ♖h5 28 ♖d1) h4 27 h3 ♖he8 ∓ Kamsky-Gelfand, Linares 1993.

The general conclusion is that the complications arising from 10 e5 tend to lead to a draw.

A2)

10 ♗d3 ♗b7

Or:

1) **10...b4?!** 11 ♘d5! (11 ♘ce2 ♗b7 is inferior) exd5 12 ♖he1 ♗b7 (12...♗e7 transposes to chapter 2, line A, note to Black's 11th) 13 exd5+ ♔d8 14 ♘c6+ ♗xc6 15 dxc6 ♘c5 16 ♗xf6+ gxf6 17 ♗c4 ♖a7 18 ♕d5 ♘e6 19 f5 ♘g7 20 ♖e4 ♕b6 21 ♗b3 ♖c7 22 ♗a4 ♔c8 23 ♕d2 ± Grünfeld-Gutman, Holon 1986/7.

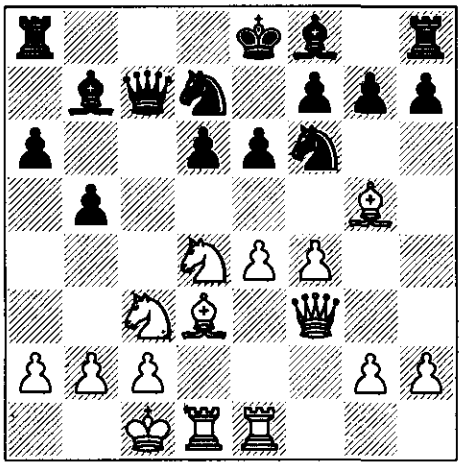
2) **10...♕b6** 11 ♖he1 (11 ♗xf6 gxf6 12 e5 ♗b7 13 ♗e4 d5 14 ♗xd5 ♗xd5 15 ♘xd5 exd5 16 e6 fxe6 17 ♕h5+ ♔d8 18 ♕f7 ♕d6 is moderately unconvincing, Wu Shaobin-Lin

Weguio, Beijing 1993) b4?! (not the best; 11...♕xd4 12 e5 ♕a7 13 exf6 gxf6 14 ♗h4 is also good for White, but Black can and should transpose to the main line by 11...♗b7) 12 ♘d5! exd5 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘e4 15 e6! fxe6, Buzbuchi-Gutman, Porz 1984, and now 16 ♗xe4! dxe4 17 ♕xe4 ♗b7 18 ♕g4 e5 19 ♘f3 ♕c6 20 ♖xd7 would have given White a decisive attack.

11 ♖he1 *(D)*

The most logical move. 11 g4 is too slow after 11...♕b6! 12 ♘b3 b4 13 ♘e2 a5 14 ♘bd4 ♗e7 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 ♗b5 0-0-0 17 g5 ♗e7 ∓ Djeno-Timoshchenko, Vienna 1991.

B



11 ... ♕b6

Or:

1) **11...♗e7** is chapter 2, line A.

2) **11...b4?!** 12 ♘d5 exd5 13 exd5+ ♔d8 14 ♗f5! ♗e7 (14...♘b6 and 14...♕c5 are also met by 15 ♗e6 while 14...♔c8 15 ♘c6 and 14...♘c5 15 ♗h3 are good for White) 15 ♗e6 ♖f8 16 ♗xf7 ♖xf7 17 ♘e6+ ♔c8 18 ♘xc7 ♔xc7 19 ♕e2 ± Kavalek-Gheorghiu, Skopje OL 1972.

3) **11...h6** and now:

3a) **12 ♕h3** 0-0-0 13 ♗xf6 (13 f5 e5 14 ♘e6? hxg5! 15 ♕xh8 fxe6 16 fxe6 ♘c5 ∓ Spassky-Donner, Amsterdam 1973) ♘xf6 14 ♘d5! ♘**xd5** (14...♕a5?? 15 ♘b3 1-0 Timman-Polugaevsky, Hilversum 1973) **15** exd5 ♗xd5 16 a4 ♕b6 17 axb5! ♕**xd4** 18 ♗e4 ♕xe4 19 ♖xe4 ♗xe4 **20** ♖d4 ±.

3b) **12 ♗h4** ♗e7 (this looks like a position from chapter 2 or chapter 10, but it cannot normally arise from the move-orders given in those chapters) 13 ♕g3 (13 ♘d5?! ♘xd5 14 exd5 ♗xh4 15 ♘xe6 fxe6 **16** ♕h5+ ♔d8 17 ♕xh4+ ♘f6 18 dxe6 ♖e8 ∓ Geller-Polugaevsky, Kislovodsk 1972; 13 ♕e2 ♘b6 14 a3 0-0-0 transposes to line 4d4 below) g5 (13...♘h5 14 ♕g4 ♘df6 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 ♗xb5+ and wins, Vayrynen-Rusek, corr 1979) 14 fxg5 ♘h5 (14...♖g8 15 g6 0-0-0 16 ♕h3 ♖xg6 17 ♘xe6 fxe6 18 e5 ± Savalov-Samochin, corr 1976) 15 ♕e3 b4 16 ♘d5 exd5 17 ♘f5 with a dangerous attack for White.

4) **11...0-0-0** (this may well be the best move) and now:

4a) **12 ♕h3** b4 (12...♔b8 **13** ♗xb5! axb5 14 ♘dxb5 ♕b6 {or 14...♕c5 15 e5 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♔c8 17 a3 ♘xe5 18 ♖xd8+ ♔xd8 19 b4 ±} 15 e5 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♘d5 17 ♗xd8 ♕xd8 18 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 19 ♖xd5!? exd5 20 ♕g3 ± Steiner-Borloy, corr 1973) 13 ♘d5!? (13 ♘ce2 ♘c5 14 ♘g3 ♗e7 is fine for Black; 13 ♗xf6 gxf6 14 ♘ce2 ♘c5 15 ♔b1 ♔b8 16 f5 e5 17 ♘b3 ♘xd3 18 ♕xd3 ♖g8 19 g3 ♖g4 20 ♘ec1 d5 = Bezgodov-Nisipeanu, Budapest 1996) exd5 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♗c5! 16 exf6 ♗xd4 17 fxg7 ♗xg7 18 ♗xd8 ♖xd8 19 ♕g4 ♗f6 20 ♕xb4 ♘e5 ∓ S.Garcia-Dorfman, Polanica Zdroj 1978.

4b) **12 ♕g3** b4 13 ♘b1 ♗e7 14 ♘d2 h6 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 ♕e3 e5 17 ♘4f3 exf4 18 ♕xf4 ♘c5 19 ♔b1 ♔b8 20 ♘b3 ♖he8 = Kengis-Gelfand, Tilburg 1992.

4c) **12 f5** e5 (12...b4 13 fxe6 bxc3 14 exd7+ ♖xd7 15 ♔b1 ♗e7 16 ♘f5 ♕b6 17 ♘xe7+ ♖xe7 18 b3 ± Bachmayr-Lehmann, 2nd Bundesliga 1992; 12...♘e5 13 ♕h3 ♘xd3+ 14 ♖xd3 e5 15 ♗xf6 gxf6 16 ♘f3 ±) 13 ♘b3 (13 ♘de2 ♔b8 14 ♔b1 ♖c8 15 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 = Kunze-Röschlau, Mengen 1990) ♗e7 (13...♘c5? 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 ♔b1 ♘a4 16 ♘d5! ♗xd5 17 exd5 ♔b8 18 ♖e4! ♖c8 19 c4 b4 20 c5! dxc5 21 ♗xa6 ± Ernst-Gutman, Lugano 1987) 14 ♔b1 ♔b8 (14...♘c5 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 ♘d5 ♗xd5 17 exd5 ♔b8 18 ♕g4 ♖c8 19 c3 ♕b6 20 ♗f1 ♔a7 21 ♕b4 ♗d8 22 g3 f6 = Kamsky-Shneider, Barnaul 1988) 15 a3 ♖he8 16 g4 ♘b6 17 ♘a5?! ♗a8 18 ♗d2 h6 19 h4 d5! 20 g5 hxg5 21 hxg5 dxe4 22 ♘xe4 ♘fd5 with equality, Hage-Noomen, corr 1993.

4d) **12 a3** ♗e7 and now:

4d1) **13 ♗h4!?** ♔b8 14 ♗f2 ♘c5 15 ♔b1 d5 16 e5 ♘fe4 17 ♗xe4 ♘xe4 18 ♘xe4 dxe4 19 ♕e3 ♗d5 20 ♘e2 b4! 21 axb4 ♗xb4 22 c3 ♗e7 23 ♕b6+ ♕b7 24 ♘g3 h5 = Becerra Rivero-Van Wely, Matanzas Capablanca mem 1994.

4d2) **13 ♕g3** ♘c5 14 ♘f3 h6 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 e5 dxe5 17 fxe5 ♗e7 18 ♗f1 g5 19 ♘d4 ♕b6 20 ♔b1 ♔b8 ∓ Krakops-Gurevich, Berlin Summer 1993.

4d3) **13 ♕f1** (a rather odd move) ♕b6 (13...h6 14 ♗h4 g5 15 fxg5 hxg5 16 ♗xg5 ♖xh2 17 ♗f4 ♖h5 18 ♗xb5 ♘c5!? 19 b4 e5 20 bxc5 exd4 21 ♖xd4 ♖xc5 22 ♗xa6 ± Petrushin-Vitolinš, USSR 1978; 13...♔b8 is a solid alternative) 14 ♘f3 ♖he8 15 h3 ♘c5 16 f5 exf5! 17 exf5 d5 = Georgadze-Schneider, Lvov 1986.

4d4) **13 ♕e2!** (a more natural method of preparing the advance e5) h6 (13...♘c5 14 ♗xb5!? is dangerous) 14 ♗h4 ♘c5 (14...♘b6 15 ♗f2 ♘fd7 16 f5 ♘c5?! 17 ♕g4 ♗g5+ 18 ♔b1 ♖he8 19 fxe6 fxe6 20 ♘xe6! ♘xe6 21 ♘d5 ± Minić-Miličević, Yugoslavia 1975) 15 ♗f2 (15 ♗xb5? ♘fxe4) d5 16 e5 ♘fe4?! 17 ♗xe4 dxe4, Adams-Gelfand, Wijk aan Zee Ct (1) 1994, and now 18 ♕e3! f5 19 exf6 gxf6 20 ♔b1 would have been clearly better for White.

12 ♘d5!?

This leads to unclear complications. The main alternative is not dangerous for Black: **12 ♘b3** (12 ♘xe6? fxe6 13 ♕h3 e5 14 ♘d5 ♗xd5 15 exd5 0-0-0 16 ♗f5 ♔c7! ∓ Geller-Polugaevsky, Portorož 1973) **b4** (12...0-0-0 13 f5 b4 14 fxe6 fxe6 15 ♘e2 e5 16 ♗e3 ♕c7 17 g4 ♘c5 18 ♘g3 ♔b8 19 g5 ♘fd7 20 ♔b1 g6 21 ♖f1 ± Ndhlovu-Rohl, Moscow OL 1994) and now:

1) **13 ♘b1** ♗e7 (13...d5 14 ♘1d2 h6 15 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 16 e5 ♘d7 17 f5 ♘c5 18 fxe6 ♘xd3+ 19 ♕xd3 ♕xe6 was Bockelmann-Brix, corr 1989, 20 ♘a5 ±) 14 ♘1d2 ♕c7 15 ♔b1 h6 16 ♕h3 ♖g8 17 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 18 f5 e5 19 ♘c4 a5 20 ♘bd2 a4 21 ♕e3 ♘d7 22 ♕e2 ♘c5 23 g3 0-0-0 24 ♘e3 ± Ehlvest-Gelfand, Linares 1991.

2) **13 ♘a4** ♕c7 (13...♕c6 14 ♘a5 ♕xa4 15 ♘xb7 ♕xa2 16 e5 ±) 14 ♘d4 (14 ♕h3 ♗c6 {14...♗e7 15 ♘d4 transposes} 15 ♘d4! ♗xa4 16 e5 dxe5 17 ♘xe6 fxe6 18 fxe5 ♘xe5

19 ♕xe6+ ♗e7 20 ♖xe5 ± Barlov-Georgiev, Kragujevac 1980, but in such a complex line improvements may very well be possible, for example 18...♕a5!?) ♗e7 15 ♕h3 0-0-0! (15...♘c5? 16 ♘xc5 dxc5 17 ♘xe6! fxe6 18 ♗c4! ♖d8 {18...0-0 19 ♗xe6+ ♔h8 20 e5 ♘e4 21 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 22 ♖d7 ±; 18...♗c8 19 ♗xe6 ♗xe6 20 ♕xe6 h6 21 ♗xf6 gxf6 22 e5 +−} 19 ♕xe6 ♖xd1+ 20 ♖xd1 ♖f8 21 ♗xf6 ♖xf6 22 ♕g8+ ♗f8 23 g3! ± Spassky-Tukmakov, USSR Ch 1973) 16 f5 (16 ♘xe6 fxe6 17 ♕xe6 ♖he8 ∓) and now:

2a) **16...♘c5** 17 fxe6 ♘xa4 18 exf7+ ♔b8 19 ♘e6 ♕a5 20 e5 ♖c8 21 exf6 gxf6 22 ♗f4 ♘xb2 23 ♔xb2 ♖c3 24 ♔c1 +− Timman-Mecking, Wijk aan Zee 1978.

2b) **16...♕a5** 17 e5 ♘xe5 18 fxe6, Kotronias-Kr.Georgiev, Ano Liosia 1995, and now after 18...♘xd3+, followed by taking on g5, White has inadequate compensation for the piece.

2c) **16...e5** 17 ♘f3 ♔b8 ∓ Becker-Micheel, corr 1988, since the knight on a4 is dangerously exposed.

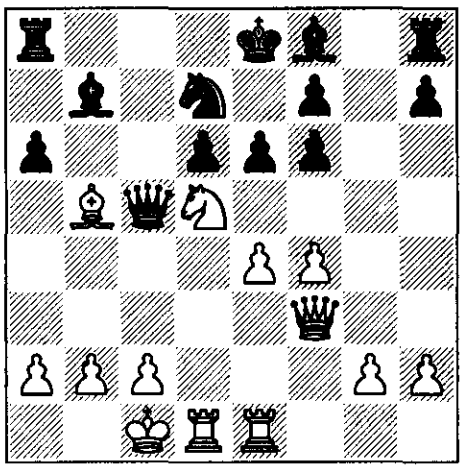
12 ... ♕xd4

Better than 12...exd5? (12...♘xd5 13 exd5 ♕xd4 14 ♖xe6+ fxe6 15 ♕h5+ and mates; 12...♗xd5 13 exd5 ♕xd4 14 dxe6 +−) 13 ♘c6! ♗xc6 (13...d4 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘d5 16 e6 ♘7f6 17 exf7+ ♔d7 18 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 19 ♗f5+ ♔c7 20 ♕f4+ ♗d6 21 ♖e7+ ♔xc6 22 ♗e4+ ♔c5 23 ♖e5+ +−) 14 exd5+ ♗e7 15 dxc6 ♘c5 16 ♗xf6 gxf6 (16...♘xd3+ 17 ♕xd3 gxf6 18 ♖xe7+) 17 ♗f5 ♕c7 18 b4 ♘e6 19 ♕h5 ♘g7 20 ♗d7+ ♔f8 21 ♕h6 d5 22 ♖xe7 ♔xe7 23 ♖e1+ ♔f8 24 ♕xf6 ♔g8 25 ♖e7 ♖f8 26 ♗e6 ♕xe7 27 ♕xe7 fxe6 28 **c7** h5 29 ♕xf8+ 1-0 Chiburdanidze-Dvoirys, USSR 1980.

13 ♗xf6 gxf6

14 ♗xb5 ♕c5 *(D)*

Not 14...♕a7 15 ♘xf6+ ♔e7 **16** ♗xd7 ♔xf6 17 ♕c3+ ♔e7 18 ♗xe6! ♖g8 19 ♖xd6! ♔xd6 20 ♖d1+ and White wins, nor 14...♕xd1+ 15 ♕xd1 axb5 16 ♘c7+ ♔e7 17 ♘xa8 ♗xa8 18 ♕d3 ±.



15 b4

Taking the queen gives White a theoretical material advantage, but Black's minor pieces are very active. White has a safer (and possibly better) alternative in 15 ♘xf6+ ♔d8 (15...♔e7 16 ♗xd7 ♗g7 17 ♘h5 ♗xb2+ 18 ♔xb2 ♖ab8 19 ♔c1 ♔xd7 20 f5 e5 21 ♕b3 ♔e7 22 f6+ ♔d7 23 ♕xf7+ ♔c8 24 ♕b3 +− Lehtinen-Vasiliev, corr 1989) 16 ♘xd7 (16 ♗xd7 ♗e7! 17 ♕b3 ♗xf6 18 ♕xb7 ♖a7 ∓) ♕xb5 17 ♘xf8 ♖xf8 18 ♕a3! ± (18 ♖xd6+ ♔c7).

15 ... ♕xb5

16 ♘c7+

and now:

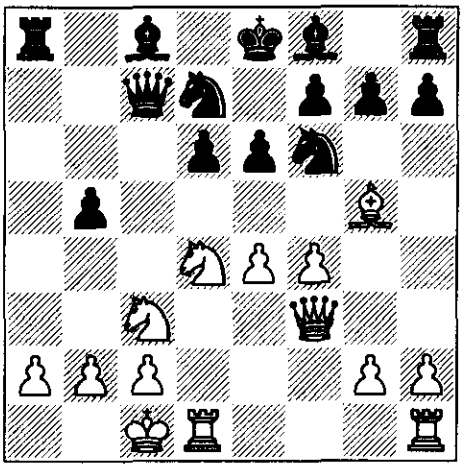
1) **16...♔d8** 17 ♘xb5 axb5 18 ♕h5 ♖xa2 19 ♕xb5 ♖a1+ 20 ♔b2 ♖xd1 21 ♖xd1 ♗xe4 22 ♖a1 ♗f5 23

♖a7 e5 24 ♕f1 ± Janetschek-Wallner, Austria Cht 1992.

2) **16...♔e7** 17 ♘xb5 axb5 18 ♕d3 ♖a6 19 ♕xb5 ♖b6 20 ♕c4 (20 ♕d3 ♗h6 21 g3 ♗a6 22 ♕f3 ♖c8 23 ♕h5 ♗f8 24 a3 ♔e8 25 ♖d2 ♖c3 26 ♔b2 ♖bc6 ∓ Mnatsakanian-Kr.Georgiev, Erevan 1982) ♗h6 21 g3 ♖c8 22 ♕d4 e5 23 ♕d2 ∞ Jackowski-Siekaniec, corr 1992.

A3)

10 ♗xb5 axb5 *(D)*



Now there are two variations. The first is not especially dangerous for Black; he has various reasonable options, many of which lead to perpetual check. Recent attention has therefore concentrated on A32. Although this line is dangerous for Black, the latest games suggest that Black can defend with accurate play.

A31: 11 e5
A32: 11 ♘dxb5

A31)

11 e5 ♗b7

Other moves are rather dubious:

1) **11...♕b7** 12 ♘dxb5 dxe5 13 fxe5 ♖xa2 (13...♘d5 {13...♘xe5 14 ♗xf6 +−} 14 ♖xd5 exd5 15 ♘xd5 ♖a7 {15...♗c5 16 ♘bc7+ ♔f8 17 ♗e7+!} 16 ♖f1 ♘c5 {16...♘xe5 17 ♕c3 +−} 17 ♘xa7 ♕xa7 18 ♘b6 +−) 14 ♔b1! ♕xf3 (14...♖a5 15 exf6 ♕xf3 16 ♘c7+! ♔d8 17 fxg7+ ♔xc7 18 gxh8♕ ♕a8 19 ♗d8+ 1-0 Poleschuk-Foigel, corr 1977) 15 gxf3 ♖a5 16 exf6 gxf6 17 ♗h4 ♗b4 18 ♖d4 ♗xc3 19 ♘xc3 ♔e7 20 ♖hd1 ± Dimitrov-J.Ivanov, Elhovo 1988.

2) **11...♕b8** 12 exf6 gxf6 13 ♖he1! h5 (13...fxg5 14 ♘c6 followed by 15 ♖xe6+) 14 ♕h3 e5 15 ♘d5 fxg5 16 ♘c6 ♕b7 17 ♖xe5+! ♗e7 (17...dxe5 18 ♘f6+) 18 ♖xe7+ ♔f8 19 ♕f5 ♘e5 20 ♕f6 1-0 Šibarević-Bukić, Banja Luka 1976.

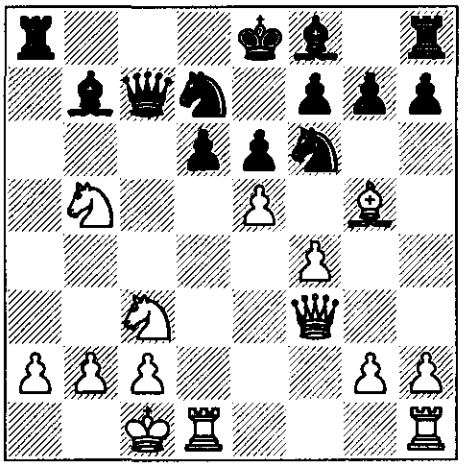
3) **11...♖a5** 12 exf6 (12 ♘dxb5 ♕b8 transposes to line A32) gxf6 13 ♖he1 b4 (13...fxg5? 14 ♘d5 and 15 ♘xe6) reaches a critical position. Semkov-Kr.Georgiev, Varna 1977 continued **14 ♘c6** (threat 15 ♖xe6+) ♖g8! 15 ♘e4 (15 ♘d5 ♖xd5 16 ♕xd5 ♘c5 17 ♗xf6 ♗b7 ∓) ♖xa2 16 ♔b1 ♗b7 17 ♘xf6+?! ♘xf6 18 ♗xf6 ♖g6! 19 ♗h4 ♗xc6 20 ♕b3 ♖a5 21 f5 ♕a7 0-1, but White has many other ideas at move 14. Perhaps the best is **14 ♕h5!** (Short; 14 ♘d5!?) bxc3 15 ♖xe6+ ♗e7 16 ♖xe7+! ♔xe7 17 ♖e1+ ♖e5 18 ♘f5+ ♔e6 (18...♔d8 19 fxe5 fxg5 20 ♘xd6 cxb2+ 21 ♔b1 ♕c3 22 ♖d1 ♖f8 23 ♕xg5+ f6 24 exf6 h6 25 ♕d5 ♘xf6 26 ♘b5+ ♘xd5 27 ♖xd5+ ♔e7 28 ♘xc3 +−) 19 fxe5 cxb2+ 20 ♔b1 dxe5 (20...♘xe5 21 ♕h6 +−) 21 ♗h4 ♖g8 22 ♖d1 ♖xg2 23 ♘e3 +−.

12 ♘dxb5 *(D)*

12 ... ♕b8

The most popular move, but other squares are also possible:

B



1) **12...♕b6** 13 ♕e2 (13 ♖xd6? ♗xf3 {13...♕xb5?! 14 ♘xb5 ♗xf3 15 ♘c7+! ∞} 14 ♖xb6 ♘xb6 15 exf6 ♗c6 16 ♘c7+ ♔d7 ∓) and now:

1a) **13...♘e4?** 14 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 15 exd6! ♖c8 16 ♘c7+ ♖xc7 17 dxc7 ♗b7 18 f5! e5? 19 ♕xe5+! 1-0 De Wit-Gutman, Wijk aan Zee 1984.

1b) **13...dxe5** 14 fxe5 ♘d5 (alternatively, 14...♕c5 15 exf6 ♕xg5+ 16 ♔b1 ♖c8 17 ♕d3 ♗c6 18 fxg7 ♗xg7 19 ♘d6+ ♔e7 20 ♘xc8+ ♖xc8 21 ♖he1 ∞ Knecht-Mazi, Finkenstein 1993) 15 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 16 ♖xd5 exd5 (16...♖xa2 17 ♕c4! ♗e7 18 ♘d6+ ♔f8 19 ♗xe7+ ♔xe7 20 ♕xa2 wins, Guseinov-Samedzade, USSR 1976) 17 ♘d6+ (17 e6 ♘f6) ♗xd6 18 exd6+ ♔f8 19 ♕e7+ ♔g8 20 ♕xd7 h6 21 ♗e7! (21 ♗d2 ♖xa2 22 ♕c8+ ♔h7 23 ♕f5+ ½-½ Gusiev-Tseitlin, USSR 1975; 21 ♖f1 hxg5 ½-½ Pliester-Britton, Charlton 1983) ♖xa2 22 ♕c8+ ♔h7 23 ♕f5+ ♔g8 24 d7 ♕xb2+ (24...g6 25 ♕f6! +– Leisebein-Scheppeit, corr 1987) 25 ♔d2 ♕d4+ 26 ♔e2 ♖xc2+! 27 ♕xc2 ♕e5+ (27...♕g4+ 28 ♔d2 ♕xd7 29 ♖a1 ± Niering-Lehmann, Germany 1994) 28 ♔d1 ♕xe7 29 ♕f5! (29 ♕c8+ ♔h7 30 ♖e1 ♕f6 31 ♖e8 ♕d4+ leads only to perpetual check, Novikov-Ionov, USSR 1978) with every chance of a win, e.g. 29...♕h4 (29...g6 30 ♖e1) 30 ♖e1 and the king can hide on h1 if Black starts checking.

1c) **13...h6!** (an excellent innovation) 14 ♗xf6 (14 ♗h4 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘h7!? ∓) gxf6 15 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 16 ♖xd6 ♕b4 17 ♕d2 ♘b6 18 a3 ♕a5 19 ♕d4 ♘c8! ∓ Hellers-I.V.Ivanov, Philadelphia 1992.

2) **12...♕c8!?** (this move has been played very little, perhaps because 12...♕b8 appears promising for Black) and now:

2a) **13 exf6** ♗xf3 (13...gxf6 14 ♘e4! ♗xe4 15 ♕xe4 ∞) 14 fxg7 ♖g8! (14...♗xg7? 15 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 16 ♘xc8 ♗xd1 17 ♖xd1 ♖xc8 18 ♖xd7 ♗xc3 19 bxc3 ♔g7 20 ♗e7 is ± since 20...♖xc3 loses to 21 ♗d6!) 15 gxf8♕+ ♔xf8 16 gxf3 d5 ∓.

2b) **13 ♕e2** dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘d5 and now:

2b1) **15 ♘e4** ♖a6 (15...♕c6?? 16 ♖xd5! h6 17 ♘bd6+ 1-0 Korsunsky-Konoval, USSR 1978) 16 ♘bd6+ ♗xd6 17 ♘xd6+ ♖xd6 18 exd6 0-0 ∓ Medvery-Khorava, Szeged U-18 Wch 1994.

2b2) **15 ♘xd5** ♗xd5 16 ♖xd5 exd5 17 e6 (17 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 18 exd6+ ♔f8 ∓) ♘f6 18 ♗xf6 (18 e7 ♘e4 ∓) gxf6 19 ♕h5 ♕b7 20 exf7+ ♔d8 21 ♖d1 ∞.

13 ♕e2 dxe5

Not 13...d5 (13...♗e7 14 exf6 gxf6 15 ♗h4 ±) 14 exf6 gxf6 15 f5! fxg5 16 fxe6 ♘f6 17 ♖hf1 ♗e7 18 exf7+ ♔f8 19 ♖de1 ♘e4 20 ♖f5! ♗b4 21 ♘xe4 dxe4 22 ♕c4 ♖a4 23 ♕d4 ♗d2+ 24 ♕xd2 h6 25 ♕c3 1-0 Auziņš-Ausmanis, corr 1977.

14 ♕c4

Now:

1) **14...♘c5!?** is untested.

2) **14...♕c8** 15 ♘c7+ ♔d8 16 ♘3b5 intending 17 ♗xf6+ gxf6 18 ♖xd7+ ♕xd7 19 ♖d1.

3) **14...♗xg2** 15 ♗xf6 gxf6 16 ♘c7+ ♔d8 17 ♖xd7+ ♔xd7 18 ♖d1+ ♗d5 19 ♘7xd5 exd5 20 ♕xd5+ ♗d6 21 ♘e4 +– Lensky-Charyjarov, corr 1992.

4) **14...♗c5** 15 ♗xf6 gxf6 16 ♖xd7! ♗e3+ 17 ♔b1 ♔xd7 18 ♖d1+ ♗d4 (18...♔e8 19 ♘c7+ ♔f8 20 fxe5 ♖a5 21 exf6 ♗d5 22 ♘3xd5 exd5 23 ♕c3 ♖c5 24 ♕xe3 ♖xc7 25 ♖e1 h5 26 ♕a3+ 1-0 Vitolinš-Anikaev, Riga 1973) 19 fxe5 fxe5 20 ♘xd4 exd4 21 ♕xd4+ ♔e7 (21...♗d5 22 ♘xd5 exd5 23 ♕xd5+ ♔e7 24 ♕c5+ +–) 22 ♕c5+ ♔f6 23 ♖f1+ ♔g6 24 ♕e7! +– Tal-Stean, Hastings 1973/4.

5) **14...♗e7** 15 ♘c7+ ♔f8 16 ♖xd7 (16 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 17 fxe5 ♘d5 18 ♘3xd5 exd5 19 ♘xd5 is equal according to Kengis) ♘xd7 17 ♖d1 (or 17 ♗xe7+ ♔xe7 18 ♖d1 ♗d5 {18...♖a5!?} 19 ♘3xd5+ exd5 20 ♘xd5+ ♔d8 21 ♘b4 ♕c7 22 ♕xf7 ∞ Van der Wiel-Renet, Cannes rpd 1992) ♗xg5 18 fxg5 (18 ♖xd7 ♕c8! ∓) ♗c8 (18...♔e7 19 ♕b4+ ♔d8 20 ♘xa8 ♕xa8 21 ♕d6 ∞) 19 ♘3b5! g6 20 ♖f1 ♔g8 21 ♖xf7, Kengis-Dvoirys, USSR 1982, 21...♕b6 22 ♖e7 ♕g1+ 23 ♔d2 ♕xg2+ 24 ♔d1 ♕g1+ is perpetual check.

A32)

11 ♘dxb5 ♕b8

11...♕b6 12 e5 ♗b7 is line 1 in the note to Black's 12th in A31; 11...♕b7 12 e5 is line 1 in the note to Black's 11th in A31.

12 e5

12 ♖he1 (too slow) h6 (12...♖xa2 13 ♘xd6+ ♕xd6 14 ♘xa2 is unclear; 12...e5!? ∞) 13 ♗h4 ♗b7 (less accurate than 13...♖xa2! 14 ♘xa2 {14 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 15 ♘xa2 ♗xf4+ –+} ♕xb5 ∓) 14 ♕d3 ♘c5 15 ♕c4 ♘fd7? 16 b4 and by now White has an attack, Vitolinš-Gutman, USSR 1973.

12 ... ♖a5

12...♗b7 is the main line of A31.

13 exf6

13 ♘d4 ♗b7 (13...dxe5? 14 ♘c6 ♗b7 15 ♗xf6 ♕c7 16 ♖xd7 ♕xd7 17 ♖d1 gxf6 {17...♗d6 18 ♘e4 +–} 18 ♖xd7 ♔xd7 19 ♘xe5+ ♔c7 20 ♕h5! fxe5 21 ♕xf7+ ♔b6 22 ♕f6 +–) 14 ♕h3 dxe5 (14...♘d5 15 ♘xe6! ♘xc3! 16 ♕xc3 ±; 14...♘xe5 15 fxe5 ♖xe5 ∞) 15 ♘xe6 ♗xg2 16 ♘xg7+ ♗xg7 17 ♕xg2 ♕a8 18 ♕g3 ♖xa2 19 ♘xa2 ♕xa2 ∓.

13 ... gxf6

14 ♗h6!

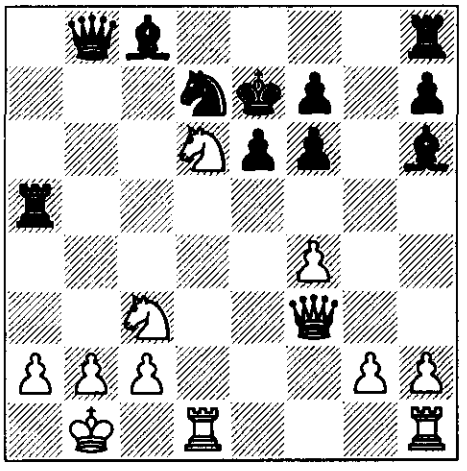
14 ♗h4 ♖xb5 is hopeless.

14 ... ♗xh6

15 ♘xd6+ ♔e7

16 ♔b1 *(D)*

16 ♖he1 ♘e5! 17 ♕e4 ♖d8 18 b4, Lhagvasuren-Dvoirys, Cheliabinsk 1990, 18...♖a6! ∓.



16 ... ♖d8 *(D)*

Or:

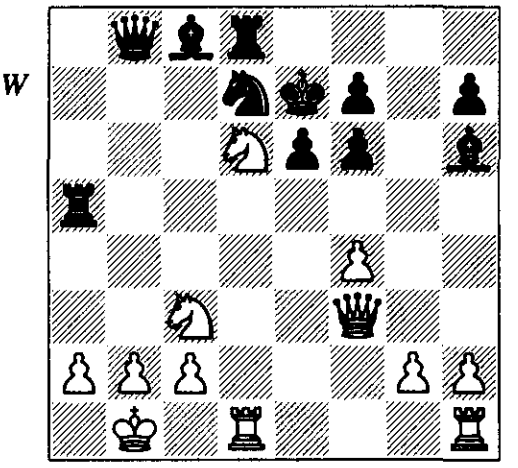
1) **16...♖g8?!** 17 ♖he1 f5 18 ♕h5 ♖g6 19 ♕h4+ f6 20 g4 ♕xd6 21 ♖xd6 ♔xd6 22 b4 ♖a6 23 gxf5 exf5 24 ♕f2 ♖g8 25 ♕d4+ ♔c7 26 b5 1-0 Perenyi-Krum Georgiev, Budapest 1985.

2) **16...♘b6** and now:

2a) **17 ♕e4** ♖d8 18 ♘db5 (18 ♘xc8+ ♖xc8 19 ♕b4+ ♖cc5 20 ♘e4 ♖b5 ∓; 18 ♘b7 ♗xb7 19 ♕b4+ ♖d6 20 ♕xa5 ♗xf4 ∓; 18 ♕b4 ♖xd6 19 ♖xd6 ♕xd6 20 ♕xa5 ♗xf4 21 ♖d1 ♘c4 22 ♕a7+ ♕c7 ∓ Dimitrov-Genov, Bulgarian Ch 1995) ♖xb5 19 ♘xb5 ♘d5 20 c4 (20 ♕d3!?) ♗a6 21 cxd5 ♕xb5 22 d6+! (not 22 dxe6? ♕d3+! nor 22 ♖he1?! ♗b7! 23 ♕xh7 ♗xd5 24 ♕xh6 ♖b8! –+ Balashov-Polugaevsky, Manila IZ 1976) ♔f8 (22...♖xd6 23 ♖xd6 ♔xd6 24 ♖d1+ ♔e7 25 ♕d4 +–) 23 ♕xh7 ♗g7 24 ♕c2 f5 ∞.

2b) **17 ♘ce4** ♘a4 18 ♘xc8+ (18 ♕a3? ♕xb2+ –+) ♖xc8 19 ♕a3+ ♘c5 20 ♕xa5 ♘xe4 21 ♕a3+ ♘c5 22 g3 f5 23 ♖he1 (23 ♖d2!?) ♔f8! (23...♕b6 24 ♖d4 ♗g7 25 ♖c4 ♕d6 26 ♕a5 ♘b7 27 ♕b4 ♖b8 28 ♖d1 ± Psakhis-Anikaev, USSR 1979) 24 ♖d4 ♗g7 25 ♖c4 ♕d6 26 ♕b4 ♔g8 27 a3 ♗f8 28 ♖d4 ♕c7 29 ♖ed1 ♖b8 30 ♕e1 ♘e4 ∓ Stuart-Noomen, corr 1993.

3) **16...♕a8** 17 ♕f2 (17 ♕e3 ♗g7?! {17...♖d8} 18 ♘c4 f5 19 ♘xa5 ♕xa5 20 ♖d5 ♕a6 21 ♖hd1 ♕c4 22 ♖5d3 ♖d8 23 ♘d5+ ♔f8 24 ♘b6 +– Reuszner-Kunzelmann, corr 1990) ♕c6 (17...♗g7 18 ♕d4 ♕a7 19 ♕d2 ♕b8 20 ♖he1 ♖c5 21 g4 ♖d8 22 ♕d3 ♔f8 23 ♕xh7 ♖xc3 24 ♕h5 ♘e5 25 fxe5 ♖c7 26 ♕h4 ∞ Packroff-Kunzelmann, corr 1988) 18 ♕h4 ♗g7 19 ♖he1 h5 20 f5 ♘e5 21 ♕b4 ♕c5 22 ♕b3 ♖a7 23 ♘cb5 ♗d7 24 ♘xa7 ♕xa7 was unclear in Boudre-Kr.Georgiev, France-Bulgaria m 1990.



17 ♕e4

Or:

1) **17 ♘d5+?** exd5 18 ♘f5+ ♔f8 19 ♘xh6 (White has exchanged a useful knight for a bishop which was shut out of the game in any case) ♘c5 20 ♖he1 ♘a4 21 b3 ♕b4 22 ♖e3 ♖e8 23 ♕h5 ♖a7 24 ♘g4 ♕xf4 25 ♖xe8+ ♔xe8 26 ♖e1+ ♖e7! –+ Kengis-A.Shneider, USSR 1984.

2) **17 ♖he1** ♘b6 18 ♘db5 ♖xb5 (18...♗a6) 19 ♘xb5 ♘c4 20 ♕b3 ♘d2+ 21 ♖xd2 ♖xd2 22 ♕b4+ ♖d6 23 g3 ♗d7 24 ♕xd6+ ½-½ Brodsky-Timoshchenko, Moscow 1992.

3) **17 ♘ce4** ♗b7 (or 17...♗g7 18 ♕c3 ♖a6 19 f5 ♔f8, as in Kengis-Dvoirys, Vilnius 1984, and now 20 g4! ♘e5 21 ♖hg1 would have been unclear according to Kengis) 18 ♕c3 ♖a4 19 ♘xb7 ♕xb7 20 ♖xd7+ ♖xd7 21 ♕xf6+ ♔e8 22 ♕h8+ ♗f8 (22...♔e7 is an immediate draw) 23 ♘f6+ ♔e7 24 ♘xh7 (24 ♘xd7 ♕xd7 25 ♕e5 ♖d4 26 ♖c1 ♕d6 ∓

Pokojowczyk-Staniszewski, Polish Ch 1986) ♖d8 25 ♕f6+ ♔e8 26 ♕h8 ♕b4!? 27 a3 ♕d6 28 ♘f6+ ♔e7 29 ♕h4 ♕d4! 30 ♘e4+ ♔e8 31 ♘f6+ is perpetual check.

17 ... f5!

Or 17...♘f8 (17...♘b6 transposes to line 2a of the note to Black's 16th move) 18 ♘c4 ♖a6 (18...♖xd1+ 19 ♖xd1 ♖c5 20 ♕d4 ♘d7 21 ♘d6 ♔f8 22 g3 ♗g7 23 f5 exf5 24 a4 ♖c6 25 ♘xf5 h5 26 ♘b5 winning, Petrushin-Dvoirys, USSR 1984) 19 ♖xd8 ♔xd8 20 ♖d1+ ♗d7 21 g3 f5 22 ♕d4 ♔e7 23 ♕c5+ ♔f6 24 ♘d6 (24 ♕d4+ is a draw) ♕a7 25 ♕e5+ ♔g6 26 g4 f6 27 gxf5+ exf5 28 ♕d5 ♔g7 29 ♘xf5+ ♗xf5 30 ♕xf5 ♕b8 31 ♘d5 ♖d6 32 c4 ± B.Moore-B.Nikolić, corr 1980.

18 ♕d4

Black has some advantage, for example: 18...♖g8 (18...♗a6 19 ♖he1 ♘f6 20 ♖e5! ±) 19 ♖he1 (19 ♘xc8+ ♕xc8 20 ♕b4+ ♕c5 21 ♖xd7+ ♔xd7 22 ♕b7+ ♔e8? {22...♕c7! ∓} 23 ♕b8+ ♔e7 24 ♕xg8 ♗xf4 25 ♖d1 ± *WChess*-Wolff, Harvard Cup rpd 1994) ♗g7 20 ♕d3 (20 ♘xc8+ ♕xc8 21 ♕b4+ ♕c5 22 ♕b7 ♖d8 23 ♖d5 ♕a7 24 ♕b4+ ♘c5 ∓) ♗f6! (20...♖c5? 21 ♘ca4 ±; 20...♗a6? 21 ♘xf5+ ♖xf5 22 ♕xf5 ♗xc3 23 ♖xd7+ ♔xd7 24 ♕xf7+ +–) 21 a4, Shmuter-Karpman, Ostrava 1991, 21...♗a6! 22 ♘db5 (22 ♘xf5+ ♔f8 23 ♕xd7 ♖xf5 ∓) ♗xb5 23 ♘xb5 ♘c5 ∓.

B)

8 ♕e2 ♕c7

9 0-0-0 *(D)*

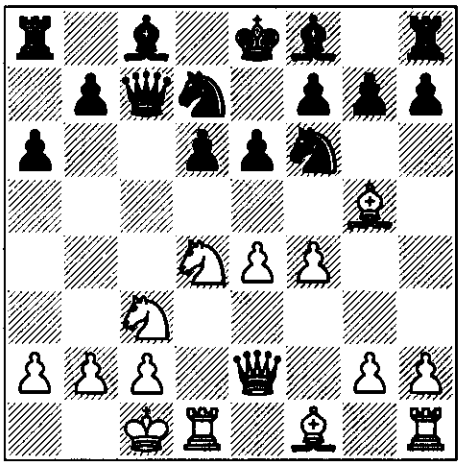
The most natural move, but alternatives have been tried:

1) **9 g4** will probably transpose into lines considered later, for example 9...b5 10 a3 (10 0-0-0 transposes to the note to White's 10th move in B2) ♗e7 11 ♗g2 ♗b7 12 0-0-0 transposes to the note to Black's 10th in B1, line 1c.

2) **9 g3** ♗e7 (9...b5!? 10 0-0-0 is the note to White's 10th in B2) 10 ♗g2 (10 0-0-0 is the note to White's 10th in B1) h6 11 ♗h4 ♖g8!? 12 ♘f3 ♕a5! 13 ♕d2 ♘b6! 14 b3 d5!? 15 ♗xf6 gxf6 16 a3 dxe4 17 b4! ♗xb4 18 axb4 ♕xa1+ 19 ♔f2, Prié-Akopian, Lyon 1990, and now Black could have played 19...e3+ 20 ♕xe3 (20 ♔xe3 ♕xh1) ♕b2 21 ♕xb6 ♕xc3 ∓.

In this line White would prefer to do without a3 and 9 0-0-0 gives him the best chance of doing so.

B



After 9 0-0-0 we have two lines. There are many possible move-orders over the next few moves, but we have classified lines according to whether or not Black plays ...♗e7. If he does, then we are in B1; otherwise we are in B2.

B1: 9...♗e7
B2: 9...b5

B1)

9 ... ♗e7

10 g4 *(D)*

Or:

1) **10 g3** 0-0 (10...h6 11 ♗h4 b5 12 ♗g2 b4 13 e5 dxe5 14 ♘db5! axb5 15 ♘xb5 ♕a5 16 ♗xa8 0-0 was Korsunsky-Se.Ivanov, Leningrad Cht 1989, and now 17 ♗c6 ±) 11 ♗g2 ♖b8 (11...♘b6 12 h4 e5 13 ♘f5 ♗xf5 14 exf5 ♖ac8 15 g4 exf4 16 ♗xf4 ♘c4 17 ♖h3 ♕b6 18 b3 ± Prié-Wians, Brussels Z 1993) 12 h4 b5 13 e5 dxe5 14 ♘c6 ♗d6 15 ♖xd6 ♕xd6 16 fxe5 ♘xe5 17 ♗f4 +– Prié-Beran, Clichy 1990.

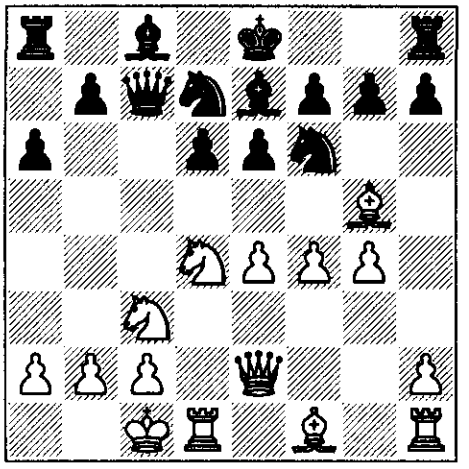
2) **10 ♘f3** (a promising move) and now:

2a) **10...h6** 11 ♗h4 g5!? (this does not look sound) 12 fxg5 hxg5 13 ♗xg5 b5 14 a3 ♖b8 **15 ♕d2** ♕b7!? 16 b4 ♕c7 17 ♗d3 ½-½ Luther-Bangiev, Germany 1994. However, White can improve easily enough. For example, after **15 h4** b4 16 axb4 ♖xb4 17 ♖d4 Black's compensation looks very slim.

2b) **10...b5?!** 11 e5 b4 12 exf6 gxf6 13 ♘d5 exd5 14 ♗h4 ♔d8 15 ♘d4 ±.

2c) **10...e5** 11 g4 h6 12 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 13 g5 hxg5 14 fxg5 ♘h5 15 ♘d5 ♕c6 16 g6 f5 17 ♗g2 ♗e6?! 18 ♘xe7 ♘f4, Shirazi-Lerner, Philadelphia 1990, 19 ♘xc6 ♘xe2+ 20 ♔b1 bxc6 21 ♖xd6 ♔e7 22 ♖d2 ♘f4 23 ♘xe5 and White wins.

2d) **10...♘b6** 11 ♔b1 (11 e5 {premature} dxe5 12 ♘xe5 0-0 13 g3 h6 14 ♗h4 ♗d7 15 ♗g2 ♗b5 16 ♕f3 g5 17 fxg5 hxg5 18 ♖he1 ♘h7! ∓ Kavalek-Ljubojević, Las Palmas 1974) h6 12 ♗h4 d5 (opening the position is very risky, but Black's pieces are clumsily placed in any case) 13 exd5 ♘bxd5 14 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 15 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 16 ♕e5 ♘f6 17 g4 ♗d7 18 g5 ♘h5 19 ♖g1 ± Wegener-Heinemann, Bundesliga 1994.



B

10 ... h6

Or:

1) **10...b5** 11 ♗g2 ♗b7 (11...b4 12 e5 bxc3 13 exf6?! {13 ♗xa8! was critical} gxf6 14 ♗xa8 fxg5 15 ♕f3 gxf4 16 ♗c6 cxb2+ 17 ♔b1 0-0 18 ♗xd7, Kuzmin-Dorfman, USSR 1978, 18...♗xd7! ∓) with three possibilities:

1a) **12 ♖he1** ♘b6! (12...♖c8 13 e5?! {13 ♗xf6 gxf6 =} dxe5 14 ♗xb7 ♕xb7 15 fxe5 b4! 16 ♘cb5 axb5 17 exf6 ♘xf6 18 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 19 ♘f5 0-0! wins for Black, Shamkovich-Weinstein, USA 1976) 13 a3 (13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘fd5 ∓) 0-0-0 14 ♖d3 ♔b8 15 ♗h4 ♖c8 16 ♗f2 ♘fd7 ∓ Nunn-Britton, Nottingham 1979.

1b) **12 ♗xf6** ♘xf6 (12...♗xf6 13 ♘dxb5?! {13 g5 transposes} axb5 14 ♘xb5 ♕b6 15 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 ∓; 12...gxf6 13 f5 ±) 13 g5 ♘d7 14 a3 ♖c8 15 ♔b1 ♕c4 16 ♖d3 ± Shamkovich-Quinteros, Lone Pine 1975.

1c) **12 a3** ♖c8 (12...♘b6 13 ♗h4 h6 14 ♗g3 0-0-0 15 ♗f3 g5 16 fxg5

hxg5 17 e5! ± Kuzmin-Stean, Hastings 1973/4) 13 ♗xf6 (13 ♗h4?! ♕c4! 14 ♕xc4 ♖xc4 15 ♗f3 ♘c5 16 ♗e2 ♘fxe4! ∓ Savon-Mecking, Petropolis IZ 1973) ♘xf6 14 g5 ♘d7 15 h4 followed by f5 ±.

2) **10...0-0** 11 ♗g2 (11 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 12 g5 looks good; 11 ♗h4 ♘c5 12 g5 ♘fd7, Bordonada-Bachtiar, Manila 1979, 13 f5 ♘e5 14 ♗h3 ±) ♖b8 12 h4 ♘c5 13 e5 ♘e8 14 ♕e3 f6 15 exf6 ♘xf6 16 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 17 g5 ♗xd4 18 ♖xd4 b5 19 ♘e4 ± Brüggemann-Fecht, Bundesliga 1992.

3) **10...♘b6** 11 ♗g2 (11 ♔b1 ♗d7 12 e5 dxe5 13 fxe5 ♘fd5 14 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 15 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 16 ♗g2 ♖c8 ∞ Lanka-Chekhov, USSR 1980) ♗d7 12 ♗xf6 (12 h4?! ♘c4 13 h5 ♖c8 14 ♖h3 b5 ∓ Malevinsky-Dvoirys, USSR 1984) ♗xf6 13 g5 ♗xd4 14 ♖xd4 e5 15 ♘d5 ♘xd5 16 exd5 0-0 is equal.

11 ♗h4

11 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 12 ♗g2 ♘b6 13 h4 ♗d7 14 g5 (14 ♖h3? h5! ∓ Stein-Najdorf, Mar del Plata 1965, as 15 g5 ♗xd4 16 ♖xd4 e5 wins material) hxg5 15 hxg5 ♖xh1 16 ♗xh1 ♗xd4 17 ♖xd4 0-0-0 ±.

11 ... g5
12 fxg5 ♘h7
13 ♘f5! exf5

13...hxg5 14 ♗g3 ♘e5 (14...exf5 15 ♘d5 ♕d8 16 exf5 ±) 15 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 16 h4 ♗d7 17 ♕d2 ♖hg8 18 ♗e2 b5 19 a3 ♖ab8 20 hxg5 ♘xg5 21 ♖h6 ± Howell-Timoshchenko, Hastings Challengers 1991.

14 ♘d5 ♕d8

14...♕a5 15 exf5 ♘e5 16 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 17 ♗e1! ♕xa2 18 ♗c3 ♖d8 19 b3 ± Rodriguez-Quinteros, São Paulo 1972.

15 exf5 ♘e5
16 ♗g3!

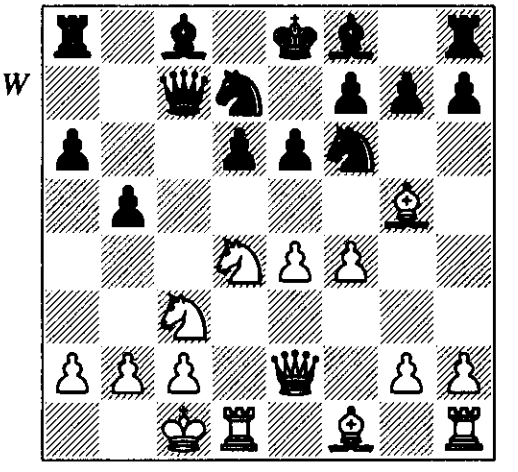
16 f6 ♗f8 17 g6 (17 h3 ♘xg5 18 ♗f2! ♘e6 19 ♗b6 ♕d7 20 ♔b1 ∞) ♗xg4 18 g7?! (18 ♕e3 ♗xd1 19 ♔xd1 ♘g5 20 g7 ♖g8 21 ♗g2 ♖c8 22 ♗g3 was the critical line) ♗xe2 19 gxh8♕ ♗xd1 20 ♔xd1 ♕a5 ∞ Ernst-Azmaiparashvili, Groningen 1979/80.

16 ... ♗xg5+

17 ♔b1 0-0 (17...♗f6 18 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 19 ♖xd6! +–; 17...♘f6 18 ♗xe5 dxe5 19 ♕xe5+ ♔f8 20 h4 +–; 17...♔f8 18 h4 ♗e7 19 ♘xe7 ♕xe7 20 ♖xd6 +–) 18 h4 ♗f6 19 g5 hxg5 20 hxg5 ♗xg5 21 ♗xe5 dxe5 22 ♕g4 ♔g7 23 f6+ ♔g8 24 ♕e4 1-0 Calvo-Kavalek, Las Palmas 1974.

B2)

9 ... b5 *(D)*



Readers are reminded that in this section we only consider lines without an early ...♗e7 and we will not mention instances of transposition to line B1 via ...♗e7.

10 f5

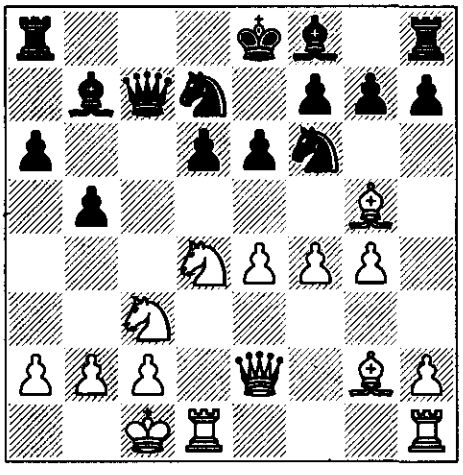
Or:

1) **10 a3** ♗b7 (10...♖b8?! 11 ♘d5! exd5 12 exd5+ ♗e7 13 ♘c6 ♘b6 14

♗xf6 gxf6 15 g3! ♗b7 16 ♘xb8 ♕xb8 17 ♗g2 ± Bronstein-Gheorghiu, Petropolis IZ 1973) 11 g4 (11 f5 e5 12 ♘b3 ♗e7 13 ♔b1 0-0 14 h4 h5 15 g4 hxg4 16 ♗g2 ♕c4 17 ♕e1 b4 ∞ Ginsburg-Karpman, Simferopol 1991) 0-0-0 (11...♖c8 12 ♗xf6 {12 ♖g1 ♗e7 13 f5 e5 14 ♘f3 ♘b6 15 ♗xf6 gxf6 16 ♖g3 ± Zhelnin-Zilbershtein, USSR 1976} gxf6 13 f5 e5 14 ♘d5 ♕d8 15 ♘e6! fxe6 16 fxe6 ♗xd5 17 exd7+ ♕xd7 18 ♖xd5 ± Malevinsky-Petkevich, USSR 1975) 12 ♗g2 ♔b8 13 e5 dxe5 14 ♘dxb5 axb5 15 ♘xb5 ♕b6 16 ♗xb7 ♕xb7 17 fxe5 h6 was unclear in Karasev-Balashov, USSR 1970.

2) **10 g4** ♗b7 (10...b4 11 ♘d5 exd5 12 exd5+ ♗e7 and now 13 ♘c6 or 13 ♘f5 gives White a dangerous attack) 11 ♗g2 *(D)* and now:

B



2a) **11...0-0-0?** 12 e5! dxe5 13 fxe5 ♘xe5 (13...♕xe5 14 ♗xb7+ ♔xb7 15 ♕f3+ ♔b6 16 ♕c6+ ♔a7 17 ♕xd7+ +–) 14 ♗xb7+ ♔xb7 15 ♘dxb5 ♖xd1+ 16 ♖xd1 axb5 17 ♕xb5+ ♔c8 18 ♕a6+ ♔b8 19 ♘b5 and White wins.

2b) **11...b4?!** 12 ♘d5 exd5 13 exd5+ ♔d8 14 ♖he1 ♔c8 15 ♘c6 ♕b6 16 ♖d4 a5 17 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 18 g5 ♘d7 19 ♕e8+ ♔c7 20 ♕xf7 ± Findlay-Coleman, British Ch 1988.

2c) **11...♘b6** 12 a3 (12 ♖he1 ♗e7 transposes to B1) ♖c8 13 ♗h4 h6 14 ♗e1 g6 15 h4 ♕c4 16 ♖d3 ♗g7 17 ♘b3 ♕c7 18 ♘d4 ♕c4 19 f5 ∞ Dementiev-Balashov, USSR 1972.

3) **10 ♘d5** (dubious) exd5 (not 10...♕b7 11 ♘xf6+ ♘xf6 12 ♗xf6 gxf6 13 g3 ± Tatai-Prada, Las Palmas 1995) 11 exd5+ ♗e7 12 ♖e1 ♘b6 13 ♗xf6 gxf6 14 g3 ♔f8? (14...♗b7 ∓) 15 ♗g2 f5 16 ♕h5 ♗f6? 17 ♕h6+ ♗g7 18 ♖e8+ ♔xe8 19 ♕xg7 1-0 Minakov-Kopylov, corr 1993.

4) **10 g3** b4 (10...♗b7 11 ♗h3 0-0-0 12 f5 exf5 13 ♗xf5 ♗e7 14 ♗xf6!? ♗xf6 15 ♘dxb5 axb5 16 ♘xb5 ♕c5 17 ♘xd6+ ♔b8 18 ♘xb7 ♕b4 19 c3 ♕xb7 20 ♗xd7 ♖xd7 21 ♖xd7 ♕xd7 22 ♖d1 ♕c6 23 ♖d5 ± Weinzettl-Steiner, Austrian Ch 1987) 11 ♘d5 (this sacrifice is unconvincing) exd5 and now:

4a) **12 exd5+** ♗e7 13 ♘f5 ♘c5 14 ♘xg7+ ♔d8 (14...♔f8?! 15 ♘h5) 15 ♖e1 (15 ♗g2 ♖g8 16 ♖de1 was the correct move-order, transposing into the game) ♖g8 (15...♘fe4! 16 ♗g2 f5! 17 ♘h5 ♗xg5 18 fxg5 b3! winning for Black would have exploited White's inaccuracy) 16 ♗g2 ♘fe4 (16...♖xg7? 17 ♗xf6 +–) 17 ♗xe4 ♖xg7 ∞ ½-½ Yudasin-Gelfand, Manila IZ 1990.

4b) **12 ♗g2!?** ♗e7 13 ♘f5 ♘b6 (13...h6!?) 14 ♘xg7+ ♔f8 (alternatively, 14...♔d8!? 15 e5 ♗g4 16 ♕f2 ♘e8! 17 exd6 ♘xd6 18 ♗xd5 ♗xd1 19 ♖xd1 ♘xd5 20 ♖xd5 h6 21 ♖xd6+ ♕xd6 22 ♘f5 hxg5 23 ♘xd6 ♗xd6 =) 15 ♗h6 ♔g8 16 ♘h5 ♘g4 (16...dxe4) 17 ♗g7 ♕c4 18 ♕xc4 ♘xc4 19 e5 ♘ge3 20 exd6 ♘xd6 21

♖he1 ∞ Shirov-Gelfand, Dos Hermanas 1995.

10 ... e5

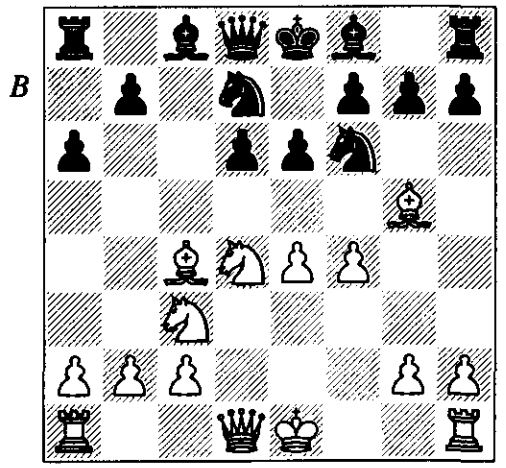
10...b4 11 fxe6 bxc3 12 exd7+ ♘xd7 (12...♗xd7 13 ♗xf6 gxf6 14 ♕c4 ♕xc4 15 ♗xc4 ♗h6+ 16 ♔b1 ♗f4 17 bxc3 ♔e7 18 ♖d3 ± Tukmakov-Averkin, USSR Ch 1973) 13 ♕c4 cxb2+ 14 ♔b1 ♕xc4 15 ♗xc4 ♘e5 16 ♗d5 ♖b8 17 ♗f4 f6 18 ♖he1 ♗e7 19 ♖e3 ♗d8 20 h3 ♗d7 21 ♖b3 ± Tukmakov-Polugaevsky, USSR Ch 1973.

11 ♘d5 ♘xd5

12 exd5 ♘c5 (12...♘b6 13 ♕h5 ♗e7 14 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 15 ♘c6 ♕f6 16 g4 h6 17 ♔b1 ♗d7 18 ♗g2 = *HIARCS*-Wolff, Harvard Cup 1994) 13 ♕h5! ♗e7 14 ♘c6 ♗xg5+ 15 ♕xg5 f6 16 ♕h5+ ♕f7 17 ♕f3 ♗b7 18 ♔b1 0-0 19 g4 ∞ Tukmakov-Browne, Madrid 1973.

C)

8 ♗c4 *(D)*



B

8 ... ♕b6

Or:

1) **8...♕c7** 9 ♗xe6! (9 ♕e2 ♘b6 10 ♗b3 ♗e7 11 0-0-0 h6?! 12 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 13 ♘db5! axb5 14 ♘xb5 ♕c5 15 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 16 f5 ♕e5 17 c3 ♗e7 18 ♘xf7 ♔xf7 19 ♕h5+ ♔f8 20 ♖hf1 ♗g5+ 21 ♔b1 ♔e7 22 fxe6 ♗xe6? 23 ♖f7+ ♔e8 24 ♖f5+ 1-0 Kameshvaran-Aaron, India 1972) fxe6 10 ♘xe6 ♕c4 11 ♘xf8 ♖xf8 (11...♘xe4 12 ♘xd7 ♘xc3 13 bxc3 ♕xc3+ 14 ♔f2! ±) 12 ♕xd6 ♘c5 13 0-0-0 ♘e6 14 ♗xf6 1-0 Rogalewicz-Koryczan, corr 1976.

2) **8...♕a5** 9 ♕e2 h6 (9...b5? 10 ♗d5! b4 11 ♗xa8 bxc3 12 b3 d5 13 exd5 ♘xd5 14 ♖d1 ♘5f6 15 ♗c6 ♗e7 16 ♗xf6 gxf6 17 0-0 +– Matulović-Barlov, Smederevska Palanka 1982) 10 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 11 0-0-0 ♗e7 12 ♗b3 ♗d7 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘h7 15 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 16 ♗xe6 0-0 17 ♗b3 ± Jovčić-Prieditis, corr 1971.

3) **8...b5** 9 ♗xe6 (9 ♗b3 ♕b6 is not critical for Black) fxe6 10 ♘xe6 (this sacrifice has long been thought favourable for White, but in fact it is not at all clear – see line 3b22 below) and now:

3a) **10...♕b6?!** 11 ♘d5! ♘xd5 12 ♕xd5 ♕e3+ 13 ♔f1 ♘b6 14 ♘c7+ ♔d7 15 ♕f7+ ♔c6 16 ♘d5! ♕xe4 17 ♕c7+ ♔xd5 18 ♖d1+ ♔e6 19 ♖e1 ♕xe1+ 20 ♔xe1 h6 (20...♘d5 21 ♕c6 +–) 21 f5+ ♔d5 22 ♕xb6 hxg5 23 ♔f2 ♖h4 24 ♖d1+ ♔e5 25 ♕c6 ♖b8 26 ♕e8+ 1-0 Matanović-Gufeld, Skopje 1969.

3b) **10...♕a5** and now:

3b1) **11 ♘xf8** ♖xf8 12 ♕xd6 ♕b6 13 0-0-0 ♕xd6 14 ♖xd6 b4 15 ♘e2! (15 ♘a4 h6 16 ♗h4 a5 17 ♖hd1 ♖a6 18 ♖6d4 ♖c6 19 h3 ♘h5 20 f5 g5 21 ♗e1 ♘f4 = Tseitlin-Polugaevsky, USSR Ch 1971) h6 (15...♘c5 ∞) 16 ♗h4 ♘c5 17 ♘g3 ♗b7 18 ♖e1 ♖c8 19 b3 a5 20 ♔b2 ♖f7 21 ♗xf6 ♖xf6 22 ♘f5 ∞ Matulović-Tringov, Vrnjačka Banja 1973.

3b2) **11 0-0** with a final branch:

3b21) **11...b4?!** 12 ♘d5 ♔f7 13 f5! (13 ♘dc7 ♖a7 14 e5 ♖xc7 15 ♘xc7 ♕xc7 ∞) ♗b7 (13...h5? 14 a3! ♘xd5 15 exd5 ♘f6 16 ♗xf6 gxf6 17 axb4 ♕xb4 18 ♖a3! ± Vitolinš-Schmidt, USSR 1973) 14 c4 bxc3?! (14...♗xd5 15 exd5 ±) 15 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 16 ♘g5+ ♔g8 17 ♘xf6+ gxf6 18 ♕b3+ ♗d5 19 exd5 fxg5 20 bxc3 ± Sakharov-Yuferov, USSR 1973.

3b22) **11...♗b7!** 12 ♕e2 (12 e5 dxe5 13 fxe5 ♕b6+ 14 ♔h1 ♕xe6 15 exf6 0-0-0 16 fxg7 ♗xg7 17 ♗xd8 ♖xd8 ∓; 12 ♘xf8 ♕b6+ ∓) ♔f7! 13 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 14 ♘g5+ ♔g8 15 e5 dxe5 16 fxe5 ♖e8 17 exf6 ♗c5+ 18 ♔h1 ♖xe2 −+ Boudre-Baburin, St Michel 1993.

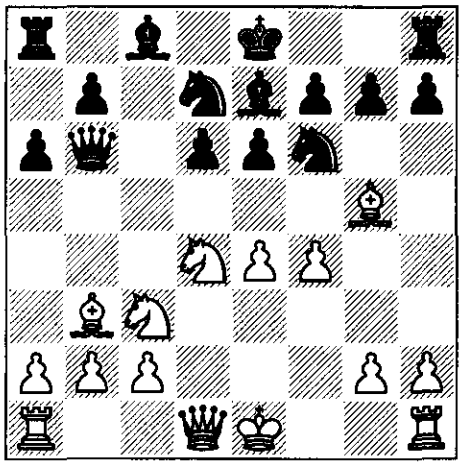
9 ♗b3

Or:

1) **9 ♗xf6!?** ♘xf6 (9...♕xb2 10 ♘xe6 fxe6 {10...♘xf6 11 ♘c7+ ♔d8 12 ♘7d5 ±} 11 ♖b1 ♕a3 12 ♗d4 ±) 10 ♗b3 e5! 11 ♘de2 exf4 12 ♘xf4 ♕e3+ 13 ♘fe2 ♗e7 14 ♕d4 ♕xd4 15 ♘xd4 g6 16 0-0 0-0 17 ♖ad1 ♘g4 18 h3 with perhaps a faint edge for White, Beliavsky-Gelfand, Linares 1994.

2) **9 ♕d2** ♕xb2 10 0-0 ♕b4 11 ♗b3 ♗e7 12 ♖ad1 ♘c5 13 ♕e1 h6 14 ♗h4 ♘fxe4 15 ♘xe4 ♕xe1 16 ♖fxe1 ♗xh4 17 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 ∓ Richardson-Kletsel, corr 1984.

9 ... ♗e7 *(D)*



10 f5

If 10 ♕d2, then 10...♘c5 =.

10 ... ♘c5!

11 fxe6 fxe6 12 ♗e3 (12 ♘a4 ♕c7 13 ♘xc5 dxc5 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 15 ♘xe6 ♕e5 16 ♕d5 ♕xe6 17 ♕xe6 ♗xe6 18 ♗xe6 ♗xb2 19 ♖d1 ½-½ Estrin-Bukić, Primorsko 1972; 12 ♕e2 ♘xb3 13 ♘xb3 0-0 14 0-0-0 ♕c7 15 ♖he1 ♗d7 16 e5 dxe5 17 ♕xe5 ♕xe5 18 ♖xe5 ♖ad8 19 ♘d4 h6 20 ♗d2 ½-½ Ljubojević-Gheorghiu, Palma de Mallorca 1972) ♕c7 (12...♘fxe4 13 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 14 ♕g4 ±) 13 0-0 b5 and now:

1) **14 ♕f3** 0-0 15 e5 (15 ♕h3?! ♘xb3 16 cxb3 e5! 17 ♘f5 b4 18 ♘a4 ♘xe4 ∓ Matulović-Ljubojević, Poreč 1973) dxe5 16 ♕c6 ♖a7 17 ♕xc7 ♖xc7 18 ♘f5 ♗d8 ∓ Matulović-Gheorghiu, Helsinki 1972.

2) **14 a3** ♘xb3 15 cxb3 0-0 16 b4 ♖e8 (16...♕d7 17 ♕e2 ♗b7 18 ♗f2 ♖ac8 19 e5 ♘d5 = Bronstein-Savon, Moscow 1970) 17 h3 ♗d8 18 ♘b3 ♗b7 19 ♖ac1 ♕d7 with an equal position, Matulović-Ciocaltea, Novi Sad 1973.

To summarise this chapter, C is harmless, B doesn't offer White much against accurate defence (however, Black should prefer B2 to B1), so we are left with the sharp lines of A. Of these, A2 appears to be White's most dangerous try.

15 6 ♗g5: Other Lines

This is the only chapter in which I have deviated even slightly from the word 'Complete' in the title of the book. In my database there are a massive 1198 games falling into the area covered by this chapter. However, this only proves that if you have a sufficiently large database then, in the opening stages at least, you can find an example of virtually every legal move! For example, there are 27 games featuring the unappealing move 6...e5. Not a single one of these games features a player of IM strength or above as Black. There is little point in covering such a move in detail – it is just bad after 7 ♗xf6 ♕xf6 (7...gxf6 8 ♘b3 ±) 8 ♘d5 ♕d8 9 ♘f5 ±. Moves which can be refuted with the aid of general principles and a little common sense are not mentioned in this book.

We therefore focus our attention on those unusual lines which have some claim to being a genuine 'system', i.e. which do not consist solely of random developing moves, but which have some strategic point.

Readers should note that many of these lines have changed little since *The Najdorf for the Tournament Player* was published. In these cases we give only a summary concentrating on any recent developments, so readers should also refer to the earlier book. This applies particularly to lines A, B, C and E. Lines F and G are new to this book.

A: 6...♘bd7
B: 6...e6 7 ♕d3
C: 6...e6 7 ♕f3
D: 6...e6 7 f4 ♗d7
E: 6...e6 7 f4 ♗e7 8 ♕f3 h6 9 ♗h4 g5
F: 6...e6 7 f4 ♘c6
G: 6...e6 7 f4 ♗e7 8 ♕f3 ♕a5

Here are some other ideas which do not occur frequently enough to deserve a place in the above list: **6...e6** (6...♘c6 transposes to an poor line of the Richter-Rauzer) and now:

1) 7 ♕**e2** h6 8 ♗h4 ♗e7 (8...g5 9 ♗g3 ♘bd7 10 0-0-0 ♕c7 11 h4 ♖g8 12 hxg5 hxg5 13 f3 ♘e5 14 ♗e1 b5 15 a3 ♗b7 16 g3 ± Yurtaev-Rashkovsky, USSR 1982) 9 ♗g3?! (9 f4 ♘xe4 10 ♗xe7 ♘xc3 11 ♕c4 ♔xe7 12 ♕xc3 ♕b6 ∓; 9 0-0-0 ♘xe4 10 ♗xe7 ♘xc3 11 ♗xd8 ♘xe2+ 12 ♘xe2 ♔xd8 13 ♖xd6+ ♔e7 =) e5! 10 ♘b3 b5 11 f4 0-0 12 ♕d3 ♘bd7 ∓ Smyslov-Portisch, Tilburg 1979. White has wasted time with his dark-squared bishop.

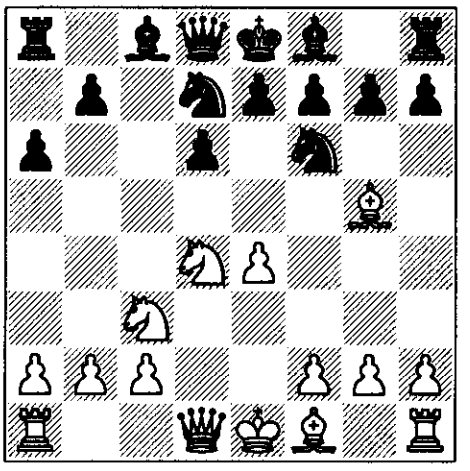
2) 7 ♕**d2** is well met by 7...h6 (7...♘c6 is a Richter-Rauzer). Since 8 ♗h4 ♘xe4 loses a pawn, White has to play 8 ♗e3 (when Black replies 8...♘g4), or 8 ♗xf6. In both cases White's crucial dark-squared bishop is exchanged, immediately giving Black a good game. In my database, Black has scored a stunning 64% after 7 ♕d2 h6. This is an example of a bad move (played an incredible 109

times in my database) which can be refuted by common sense.

3) **7 ♗e2** has also been played quite often, usually with the idea of castling kingside. This is dubious rather than genuinely bad. White is mixing up two disparate systems: the aggressive ♗g5 and the positional plan of ♗e2 and 0-0. Black's 59% is an indication that he normally faces no problems. The usual response is 7...♗e7; if then 8 0-0, we reach a kind of Scheveningen in which White has played the odd move ♗g5. The only other idea is 8 ♕d2, when 8...0-0 (now 8...h6 can be met by 9 ♗e3, and Black cannot play ...♘g4) 9 f4 ♕c7 10 0-0-0 ♘bd7 11 ♗f3 ♘b6 12 g4 ♗d7 13 ♖he1 ♘c4 14 ♕d3 ♖ac8 was unclear in J.Polgar-Lautier, Tilburg 1996.

A)

6 ... ♘bd7 *(D)*



Although this is played relatively often, it does not have a good theoretical reputation. Not only does Black have to play the opening accurately to avoid a tactical disaster, he faces the prospect of a positionally inferior middlegame at the end. 7 f4 allows Black to transpose to other lines, so 7 ♗c4 is considered the crucial test.

7 ♗c4

Or:

1) **7 ♗e2** is playable, e.g.: 7...e6 (7...h6 8 ♗e3 is similar to the 6 ♗e2 ♘bd7 line of the Najdorf, except that Black has weakened his kingside with ...h6; 7...g6 leads to the same line; 7...e5!?) 8 0-0 ♕c7 (8...♗e7 9 a4 h6 10 ♗h4 ♘xe4 11 ♘xe4 ♗xh4 12 ♘xd6+ is dangerous for Black; 8...b5!?) 9 a4 (9 ♗h5 led to a famous win in Keres-Kotov, Budapest 1950, after 9...♕c4? 10 ♘xe6! ♕xe6 11 ♘d5 ♔d8 12 ♗g4 ♕e5 13 f4! ±, but 9...g6 is =) b6 10 f4 ♗b7 11 ♗f3 ±.

2) **7 f4** and now:

2a) **7...b5** (7...e6 and 7...♕c7 followed by ...e6 will transpose to chapter 13 or 14) 8 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 9 e5 b4!? 10 ♘a4 ♘e4 (10...♗g4 11 ♕d3 dxe5 12 fxe5 ♘d5 13 ♕e4 ♗d7 14 e6 fxe6 15 ♘c5 ♘f6 16 ♕f3 ♖a7 17 ♘dxe6 ♗xe6 18 ♘xe6 ± Van Kempen-Asaturjan, corr 1991; 10...♗d7 11 exf6 ♗xa4 12 ♕f3 e6 13 f5 e5 14 ♗c4 gxf6 15 ♕b7 ♗e7 16 ♘c6 ♗xc6 17 ♕xc6+ ♔f8 18 ♕d5 ± Zelinsky-Govashellshvili, corr USSR 1993) 11 ♗d3 ♗b7 12 e6 ♕a5 13 exf7+ ♔xf7, Lieutenant-Pohla, Huy 1991, 14 ♕e2! ±.

2b) **7...♕b6** and now:

2b1) **8 ♘b3** (too passive) h6 9 ♗xf6 (9 ♗h4 ♕e3+ 10 ♗e2 ♕xf4 ∓) ♘xf6 10 ♗e2 (10 e5 dxe5 11 fxe5 ♘g4 12 ♕e2 ♘e3 ∓) e6?! (10...♕e3! =) 11 ♕d3! ♕c7 12 ♗f3 ♗e7 13 0-0-0 ♘d7 14 ♔b1 ± Vakhrushev-Soloviev, USSR 1978.

2b2) **8 ♕d2** ♕xb2 9 ♖b1 (9 ♘b3 e6 transposes to chapter 8) ♕a3 10 ♗xf6 gxf6 (10...♘xf6 11 e5 dxe5

{11...♘g4 12 h3 ♘h6!? ∞} 12 fxe5 ♘g4 13 ♘d5 ♕c5 14 ♘b3 ♕c6 15 ♘a5 ♕d7 16 ♘c4 ±) 11 ♘d5 with a final branch:

2b21) **11...♕c5** 12 ♖b3 e6 13 ♖c3 ♕a7 14 ♘c7+ ♔e7, Klovan-Hermlin, USSR 1980, and now simply 15 ♘xa8 (15 ♗xa6 was played in the game) ♕xa8 16 ♗e2 ±.

2b22) **11...♖b8** 12 ♖b3 ♕xa2 (12...♕a4 13 ♗xa6! bxa6 14 ♕c3 ♕xb3 15 cxb3 +– Vitolins-Arakas, USSR 1978) 13 ♕b4! a5 14 ♕c3 e6 15 ♗b5! a4 (15...exd5 16 0-0 will trap the black queen?) 16 ♕c7! exd5 17 ♕xb8 ♔d8 18 ♗xd7 ♔xd7 19 ♖xb7+ 1-0 Van der Wiel-Danner, Lucerne 1982.

2b23) **11...♔d8** 12 ♗e2 e6 (not necessarily best; 12...♘c5!? is interesting) 13 ♖b3 ♕xa2 (13...♕a4 14 ♕c3 exd5 15 ♖a3 ♕xa3 16 ♕xa3 ± Klovan-Pohla, USSR 1981) 14 0-0 exd5 15 ♕c3 dxe4 16 ♖a1 ♕xa1+ 17 ♕xa1 a5 18 ♗c4 ♗e7 19 ♗xf7 ♘c5 20 ♖a3 a4 21 ♕b2 (21 ♕a2 ♗d7 22 ♘e6+ ♗xe6 23 ♗xe6 ♔c7 24 ♕c4 b5 25 ♕d5 b4 26 ♖g3 ∞ Liermann-Mathes, corr) ♗d7 22 ♕b6+ ♔c8 23 ♗d5 ♔b8 24 ♗c4 ♖c8 ∞ Goldberg-Mathes, corr 1988.

7 ... ♕a5

Black has tried no fewer than eight different moves here, but most of them need not detain us:

1) **7...g6** 8 f3 ♗g7 9 ♕d2 0-0 10 0-0-0 ♘e5 11 ♗b3 ♗d7 is just a Yugoslav Attack in which Black has wasted time on the irrelevant ...a6.

2) **7...h6** 8 ♗xf6! ♘xf6 9 ♕e2 e6 (9...g6 10 0-0-0 ♕a5 {10...♕c7 11 f4 ♗g4 12 ♘f3 e5 13 ♘d5 ± Bagirov-Spassky, USSR 1963} 11 h3 ♗g7 12 f4 ♘h5 13 ♘b3 ♕c7 14 ♘d5 ♕d8 15 ♕e3 0-0 16 e5 ± Yudovich-Moiseev, USSR 1968; 9...b5 10 ♗b3 ♗b7 11 0-0-0 e5 12 ♘f5 g6 13 ♘e3 ♗e7 14 ♘g4 ♘xg4 15 ♕xg4 ♖c8 16 ♖d3 ± Lobron-Budde, Bundesliga 1986) 10 0-0-0 ♕c7 11 f4 e5 (11...♗e7 12 e5 dxe5 13 fxe5 ♘h7 14 h4 ♗b4 15 ♖h3 ♗d7 16 ♗xe6! ♗xe6 17 ♘xe6 fxe6 18 ♕g4 ♕e7 19 ♖f3 ♘f8 20 ♘e4 with a dangerous attack, Kunerth-Neu, corr) 12 ♘d5! ♘xd5 13 exd5 ♗e7 14 fxe5 dxe5 15 ♘e6! ± Tal-Bilek, Amsterdam 1964.

3) **7...b5** 8 ♗d5! ♘xd5 9 ♘xd5 ♗b7 10 0-0 ♘b6 11 ♘xb6 ♕xb6 12 ♖e1 g6 13 a4! ± Gosztola-Andics, corr 1990.

4) **7...e6** 8 0-0 ♕c7 (not 8...b5? 9 ♗xe6 fxe6 10 ♘xe6 ♕b6 11 ♘d5 and wins, Ehlvest-Anastasian, Erevan 1988; 8...h6 9 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 10 ♗b3 b6 11 f4 ♗b7 12 ♕d3 ♗e7 13 ♘xe6! fxe6 14 ♗xe6 b5 15 e5 ± Stean-Browne, Nice OL 1974) 9 ♗xe6 (9 ♗b3 h6 10 ♗h4 g5 11 ♗g3 ♘e5 12 f4 gxf4 13 ♖xf4 ♗g7 14 ♔h1 h5! ∞ Wolff-Yudasin, Philadelphia 1992) fxe6 10 ♘xe6 ♕c4 11 ♘d5 (11 ♘xf8 ♖xf8 12 ♕xd6 ±) ♔f7 12 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 (12...♔xe6? 13 ♗c3! ± Keres-Sajtar, Amsterdam 1954) 13 b3 ♕xf1+ 14 ♕xf1 ♗xe6 15 ♘c7 ♖c8 16 ♘xe6 ♔xe6 17 f4 ±.

5) **7...♕c7** 8 ♕e2, followed by 0-0-0, with a large lead in development.

8 ♕d2 e6

8...h6 (8...b5 9 ♗d5! ♘xd5 10 ♘xd5 ♕xd2+ 11 ♔xd2 ±) 9 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 10 0-0-0 e6 11 ♖he1 ♗e7 12 f4 0-0 13 ♗b3 ♖e8 14 ♔b1 ♗f8 15 g4! ± Spassky Petrosian, Moscow Wch (19) 1969.

9 0-0-0

Or **9 0-0** and now:

1) **9...b5?!** 10 ♗d5! exd5 11 exd5 ♘c5 (11...♗e7 12 ♖ae1 and wins) 12 ♖fe1+ ♔d7 13 ♕f4! +–.

2) **9...♘e5** 10 ♗b3 b5, Rogers-Halpin, Australia 1982, 11 ♗xf6 gxf6 12 f4 ±.

3) **9...♗e7** 10 ♖ad1 h6 (better than 10...♘c5?! 11 ♖fe1 ♗d7 12 a3 ♕c7 13 b4 ♘a4 14 ♘xa4 ♗xa4 15 ♗xe6! fxe6 16 ♘xe6 ♕xc2 17 ♕d4 ± Tal-Polugaevsky, Riga 1959) 11 ♗h4 g5 (11...♘xe4 12 ♘xe4 ♕xd2 13 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 14 ♖xd2 ±) 12 ♗g3 ♘e5 (12...♘h5? 13 ♘xe6! fxe6 14 ♗xd6) 13 ♗e2 (13 ♗b3 ♘h5 14 ♗a4+ b5 15 ♗xe5 dxe5 16 ♘c6 ♕c7 17 ♘xe7 ♔xe7 18 ♗b3 ♘f6 = Tal-Korchnoi, USSR Ch 1959) ♗d7 (13...b5 14 a3 ♗b7 15 f4 ♘c4 16 ♗xc4 bxc4 17 fxg5 ♕xg5 18 ♕f2 ± Sevecek-Atabek, corr 1967) 14 f4 gxf4 15 ♖xf4 ♘g6 16 ♖f2 ♕g5 17 ♘f3 ♕xd2 18 ♘xd2 d5 (18...b5? 19 ♖df1! +–) 19 exd5 ♘xd5 (19...♗c5 20 ♘de4 ♘xe4 21 ♘xe4 ♗xf2+ 22 ♔xf2 ±) 20 ♘xd5 exd5 21 ♘b3 ± Lepeshkin-Bangiev, USSR 1975.

4) **9...h6** 10 ♗h4 g5 (10...♗e7 transposes to line 3 above; 10...b5 11 ♗d5! exd5 12 exd5 ±; 10...♘e5 11 ♗b3 g5 12 f4! gxh4 13 fxe5 ♕xe5 14 ♖ae1 ♘g4 15 ♘f3 ±) 11 ♗g3 ♘h5?! (11...♗e7 12 ♖ad1 is line 3; 11...♘e5 12 ♗e2 will probably also lead to line 3) 12 ♗xe6! fxe6 13 ♘xe6 ♘xg3 14 fxg3 ♘e5 15 ♖xf8+ ♖xf8 16 ♕xd6 ♖f6 17 ♕c7! b6 18 ♘g7+ ♔f8 19 ♘h5 +– Moyano Garcia-Mancebo, corr 1986.

The fact that both 9 0-0-0 and 9 0-0 seem to be good for White has dissuaded players from adopting this line as Black.

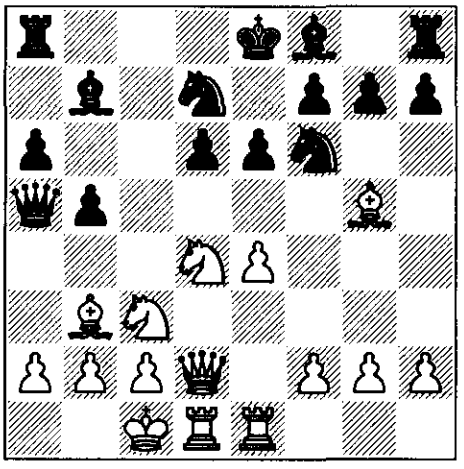
9 ... b5

10 ♗b3

Not 10 ♗d5 (10 ♗xe6 fxe6 11 ♘xe6 ♔f7 12 ♘xf8 ♖xf8 13 ♕xd6 b4 14 ♘d5 ♕xa2 15 ♖he1 and now 15...♕a1+ 16 ♔d2 ♕xb2 draws at least, while 15...♔g8 16 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 is simply good for Black) b4! (not 10...exd5? 11 ♘c6 ♕b6 12 exd5 +–) 11 ♗xa8 bxc3 12 bxc3 ♘b6 13 ♗c6+ (13 ♘b3 ♕a3+ 14 ♔b1 ♘xa8 ∓) ♗d7 14 ♗xd7+ ♔xd7 15 ♕f4 ♘c4 ∞ Tukmakov-Petkevich, USSR 1973.

10 ... ♗b7

11 ♖he1 *(D)*



B

11 ... 0-0-0

The alternatives are very risky:

1) **11...♘c5** and now:

1a) **12 ♗xf6** gxf6 13 ♕f4 (13 ♔b1 b4 14 ♘d5! exd5 15 exd5+ ♔d7 16 ♘c6 ♘xb3 17 cxb3 ♗xc6 18 dxc6+ ♔c7 19 ♕f4 ∞ Schmid-Kaniuth, corr 1964) ♗e7 14 ♕g4 0-0-0 15 ♗d5!? (15 ♘d5 might be even more effective) b4? (15...♕c7 or 15...h5 ±) 16 ♗xb7+ ♔xb7 17 ♘d5! exd5 (17...♖hg8 18 ♘c6!) 18 exd5 ± Stein-Tal, USSR 1962.

1b) **12 e5** (less convincing) dxe5 (12...b4 13 ♘a4 ♘xa4 14 exf6 ♘c5

15 ♗xe6! ±) 13 ♗xe6 fxe6 (13...b4 14 ♖xe5 fxe6 is also possible) 14 ♘xe6 b4! and it is not clear how White proceeds.

2) **11...♖c8** and now:

2a) **12 ♗xf6** gxf6 (12...♘xf6? 13 e5 dxe5 14 ♖xe5 ±) 13 ♔b1 ♘c5 (13...b4 14 ♘d5 exd5 15 exd5+ ♔d8 16 a3 ±) 14 ♕f4 ♗e7 15 ♕g4 ± (15 ♘d5 e5! 16 ♘xf6+ ♔d8 ∞).

2b) **12 e5** b4 (12...dxe5? 13 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 14 ♘xe6 fxe6 15 ♖xe5 ±; 12...♘xe5 13 ♘xe6 fxe6 14 ♖xe5 dxe5 15 ♗xf6 ♕c7 16 ♗xe5 ♕f7 17 f4 ± Shamkovich-Titenko, Moscow 1963) 13 exf6 bxc3 14 ♕f4 ♘c5 15 ♗xe6! fxe6 16 ♘xe6 ♘e4 17 f7+ ♔d7 18 ♘xf8+ ♖cxf8 19 ♖xe4 ♔c8 20 ♖c4+ 1-0 Berta-Kallinger, corr.

3) **11...♗e7** 12 f4 ♘c5 13 ♗xf6! and now:

3a) **13...gxf6** 14 ♔b1 (14 ♗d5?! b4 15 ♗xb7 bxc3 16 ♗c6+ ♔f8 17 ♕xc3 ♕xc3 18 bxc3 ♖c8 =; 14 ♕e3 0-0-0 15 a3 ♔b8 16 ♔b1 ♕b6 17 ♗a2 ± Matanović-Ostojić, Yugoslavia 1962) b4? 15 ♘d5 ♘xe4 16 ♖xe4 ♗xd5 17 ♗xd5 ♕xd5 18 ♕e2 ± Tal-Johansson, Stockholm 1961.

3b) **13...♗xf6** 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♗e7 (15...♗h4 16 g3 ♗e7 17 ♗xe6! 0-0 18 ♗b3 ♖ad8 19 ♕f4 ± Spassky-Polugaevsky, USSR Ch 1958) 16 ♗xe6 0-0 17 ♗b3 h6 18 ♔b1 ♗g5 19 ♕f2 b4 20 ♘d5 ♖ad8 21 h4 ♗xh4 (this is why Polugaevsky was wrong to force g3) 22 ♕xh4 ♗xd5 23 ♗xd5 ♖xd5 = Kiuru-Hammar, corr 1974.

4) **11...b4?** 12 ♘d5 exd5 13 exd5+ ♔d8 14 ♘c6+ ♗xc6 15 dxc6 ±.

12 a3

Or 12 f3 (12 f4?! b4 13 ♘a4 ♘c5 14 e5 {14 ♗xf6 gxf6 15 a3 ♘xb3+ 16 cxb3 d5! ∓} h6 15 ♗h4 ♘xa4 16 exf6 g5 17 ♗xa4 ♕xa4 18 fxg5 hxg5 19 ♗g3 ∓ Nunn-Kosten, London 1979) ♗e7 (12...h6 13 ♗h4 g5 14 ♗f2 ♘e5 15 ♔b1 ♔b8 16 a4! ± Parma-Saidy, Sarajevo 1971) 13 ♔b1 (13 a3 transposes to the main line) b4 (possibly too provocative; 13...♔b8 is the alternative, when the question is whether White can profit from having omitted a3) 14 ♘d5! exd5 15 exd5 ♘e5 (15...♖he8 16 ♖xe7 ♖xe7 17 ♘f5 ♖e5 18 ♘xd6+ ♔b8 19 ♘c4 ± Klovans-Lagland, corr 1974) 16 ♘f5 ♗f8 17 ♗xf6 gxf6 18 ♖e4 ♕b5 19 ♖xb4 ♕d7 20 g4 ♔b8 21 f4 ♘xg4 22 ♘d4 ♔a8 23 ♗a4 ♕c7 24 ♘c6 1-0 Erpel-Albrecht, corr 1986.

12 ... ♗e7

Attempts to do without this are very risky: 12...♔b8 13 ♗xe6! (a stunning 'innovation' which makes the old line with 13 f4 redundant) fxe6 (13...b4 14 axb4 ♕a1+ 15 ♘b1 doesn't help) 14 ♘xe6 ♖c8 (14...♖e8 is much the same) 15 ♘xf8 ♖hxf8 16 ♕xd6+ ♔a8 17 e5 ♖xc3 18 bxc3 ♘e4 19 ♖xe4 ♗xe4 20 f3 +– Palmiotto-Banti, corr 1960 (nobody noticed this game before...).

13 ♔b1

13 f4 is a very interesting move, creating possibilities of either e5 or f5. Fedorowicz-Westerinen, New York 1977 continued 13...h6 14 ♗h4 g5 15 fxg5 hxg5 16 ♗xg5 ♖xh2 17 ♔b1 ♖g8 18 ♘d5 ♕xd2 19 ♘xe7+ ♔d8 20 ♘dc6+ ♗xc6 21 ♘xc6+ ♔c7 22 ♗xd2 ±. Ilić suggests two possible improvements, 14...♘xe4 15 ♘xe4 ♕xd2+ 16 ♖xd2 ♗xh4 17 ♘xd6+ ♔c7 and 14...♘c5. Unfortunately the first line just loses material after 18 g3! ♔xd6 19 ♘xe6+

♔c6 20 ♘xd8+ ♗xd8 21 ♗d5+ ♔c7 22 ♗xb7, so Black's hopes rest on Ilic's 14...♘c5.

13 ... ♕b6

13...♔b8 (13...♖he8? 14 ♗xe6!) 14 f4 ♘c5 (14...h6? 15 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 16 f5 ±) 15 ♗a2 b4 16 axb4 ♕xb4 17 f5 ♘fxe4, Wittmann-Danner, Ljubljana 1982, 18 ♘xe4 ♕xd2 19 ♗xd2 ♘xe4 20 ♗a5! ♖de8 21 fxe6 ±.

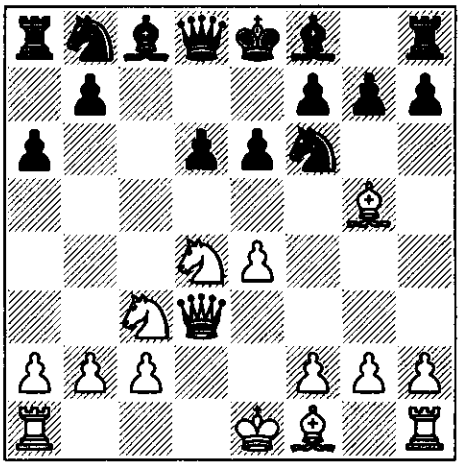
14 f3 ♔b8

15 ♗e3 ♘c5 16 ♗a2 b4 17 axb4 ♕xb4 18 ♘b3 ♘fd7 19 ♕f2!? (19 ♗g5 f6 20 ♗e3 ♘b6 21 ♘xc5 dxc5 22 ♕e2 ± Gulko-Petrosian, Moscow 1976) ♘xb3 20 ♗xb3 ♘c5, Mesing-Martinović, Yugoslav Ch 1977, 21 ♖d4 ♕b6 22 ♗a2 ±.

B)

6 ... e6

7 ♕d3 *(D)*



The idea behind this move is that the queen is heading for g3 and it makes little difference whether it goes via f3 or d3. Moreover there are certain advantages to playing ♕d3, for example if Black plays ...h6 White can sometimes exploit the weak g6-square tactically with an e5 and ♘xe6 combination. Moreover, White can play f4 without having to commit his queen. We do not explicitly mention the numerous transpositions into chapters 2 and 10 if White plays ♕g3 at some stage.

7 ... ♘bd7

Or:

1) **7...b5** (a very sensible and good response) and now:

1a) **8 f4** b4 9 ♘ce2 ♘bd7 10 0-0-0 ♗b7 11 ♘g3 ♕a5 12 ♔b1 ♘c5 13 ♕e3 ♘fxe4 ∓ Martin Gonzalez-Gual, Barcelona 1990.

1b) **8 0-0-0** b4 9 ♘ce2 (9 e5?! bxc3 10 exf6 gxf6 11 ♕f3 fxg5 12 ♕xa8 ♕b6! ∓ Neuronov-Zaichik, USSR 1979) ♗b7 10 f4 ♗e7 11 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 12 g4 ♘d7 13 g5 ♘c5 14 ♕e3 ♗e7 15 ♗g2 ♕b6 16 h4 0-0-0 17 ♘g3 ♖he8 = Tisdall-H.Olafsson, Nordić Ch (Torshavn) 1987.

1c) **8 a3** ♘bd7 9 0-0-0 ♗b7 10 ♕h3 ♖c8 (10...♗e7 11 ♗d3 ♖c8 12 ♖he1 ♖xc3 13 bxc3 ♕a5 14 ♘b3 ♕xa3+ 15 ♔b1 0-0 ∓ Sareen-Howell, Calcutta 1996) 11 f4 ♕a5 12 ♘b3 ♕b6 13 ♗d3 ♖xc3 14 bxc3 ♗xe4 ∓ Levertow-Borwell, corr 1979.

2) **7...h6** 8 ♗h4 ♗e7 (8...g5 9 ♗g3 ♘bd7 10 h4 ♖g8 11 hxg5 hxg5 12 ♘f3 g4 13 ♘d2 ♘e5 14 ♕d4 ♘fd7 15 ♘c4 ♕c7 16 0-0-0 ♘xc4 17 ♗xc4 ♘e5 18 ♗b3 ± Timman-Van Wely, Amsterdam Donner mem 1996) 9 0-0-0 ♘bd7 (9...b5 10 f4 g5 11 e5! gxh4 12 exf6 ♗xf6, Romero Holmes-Kuczynski, Dubai OL 1986, 13 ♗e2 ±) 10 f4 and now:

2a) **10...♕c7** 11 ♗e2 b5 12 ♗f3 (12 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 13 ♗f3 ♗b7 14 e5 dxe5 15 ♘dxb5 ♕b8 16 fxe5 {16 ♗xb7 – see the analogous position in the note to Black's 8th move} ♗xf3 17 ♕xf3 axb5 18 ♕c6+ ♔f8 19 exf6 ♗xf6 20 ♕c5+ ♔g8 21 a3 ♔h7 ∓: 12

e5?! dxe5 {12...♘c5? 13 ♕g3 dxe5 14 fxe5 g5 15 exf6 ♗d6 16 ♘xe6! +−} 13 fxe5 ♘xe5 ∓: ♘c5 (12...♗b7 13 ♘xe6 fxe6 14 e5 dxe5 15 ♕g6+ ♔f8 16 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 17 ♗h5 ∞ Mukhin-Platonov, USSR 1968) 13 ♕e2 ♗b7 14 e5 dxe5 15 fxe5 ♘h7 ∞.

2b) **10...g5** 11 fxg5 ♘g4 12 ♘f3 (12 ♗g3 ♘ge5 13 ♕e2 hxg5 14 ♘f3 ♕c7 15 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 16 ♕f2 ♗d7 17 ♗e2 b5 18 ♖hf1 f6 19 a3 0-0-0 20 a4 ♕b7 21 axb5 axb5 22 ♕d4 ♗c6 = Nikolin-Arakhamia, Tuzla wom IZ 1987) ♘de5 (12...♘ge5 13 ♕d4 hxg5 14 ♗g3 ♕c7 15 ♗e2 ♖g8 16 ♖hf1 g4 17 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 18 ♗xe5 dxe5 19 ♕a4+ ♔f8 20 h3 gxh3 21 gxh3 ± Ant.Rodriguez-Ch.Toth, Paranana U-26 Wcht 1993) 13 ♕d4 hxg5 14 ♗g3 f6 15 ♗e2 ♗d7 16 ♘xg5! ♘c6 17 ♕d2 ♘ge5 18 ♘h3 ♕a5 19 ♘f4 0-0-0 20 ♕e3 b5 21 a3 ± Timman-Kamsky, Amsterdam Donner mem 1996.

8 0-0-0 b5

After 8...♗e7 9 f4 ♕c7 10 ♗e2 b5 (this position can also arise via other move-orders, particularly those involving an early ♗e2) 11 ♗xf6 (11 ♗f3 ♗b7 12 ♗xf6 gxf6 13 a3 ∞) ♘xf6 (11...gxf6 12 ♗h5 ♘c5 13 ♕e3 b4 14 ♘ce2 ♗d7 15 ♔b1 ±) 12 ♗f3 ♗b7 (12...e5 13 ♘f5 ♗xf5 14 exf5 ♖c8 15 g4 b4 16 ♘d5 ♘xd5 17 ♗xd5 exf4 18 ♗b3 0-0 19 h4 ± Pandovos-Ipek, Istanbul 1982) 13 e5! dxe5 14 ♘dxb5 ♕b8 (14...♕c8 15 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 16 ♕xd6 e4 17 ♗e2 ♕c6 18 ♕a3 ± Pandovos-Soylu, Istanbul 1982) 15 fxe5 (15 ♗xb7 ♕xb7 16 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 17 ♕xd6 exf4 18 ♖d4 ♖c8 19 ♕a3 ± Gavrilakis-Marjanović, Thessaloniki OL 1984) ♗xf3 16 ♕xf3 axb5 17 ♕c6+ ♔f8 18 exf6 ♗xf6 19 ♕c5+ ♔g8 20 a3 is exactly like the corresponding variation in the note to Black's 7th move, except that the h-pawn is still on h7; this effectively deprives Black of a vital tempo, so in this version of the position White is better.

9 f4 ♗b7

It makes sense for Black to avoid ...h6 because of tactics involving ♕g6+. After 9...♕c7 (9...b4 10 ♘ce2 ♗b7 11 ♘g3 ∞) 10 ♗e2 ♗e7 (or 10...♘c5 11 ♕e3 b4 ∞) we transpose to the last note.

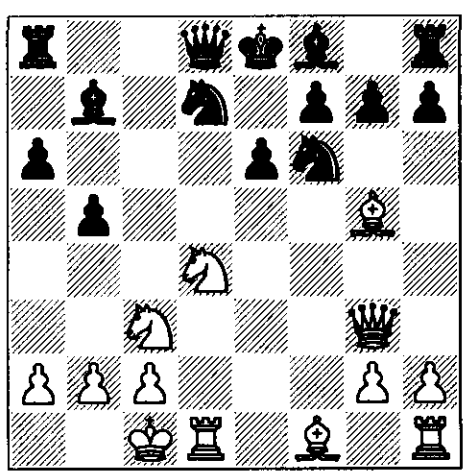
10 e5

If White plays 10 a3, then he is admitting that his opening hasn't turned out well, so this attempt to smash Black flat is critical.

10 ... dxe5

11 fxe5 ♘xe5

12 ♕g3 ♘ed7 *(D)* (12...♕b8?! 13 ♘dxb5! axb5 14 ♗xb5+ ♘c6 15 ♕f3 ♕c7 16 ♗xf6 gxf6 17 ♕xf6 ♖g8 18 ♘d5! ♕a5?! {18...♕d6! 19 ♖hf1 ♖g7 20 ♘b6 ♕e7 21 ♘xa8 ♕xf6 22 ♘c7+ ♔e7 23 ♖xf6 ♔xf6 24 ♘e8+ ♔e7 25 ♘xg7 ♗xg7 26 a4 is ±} 19 ♖hf1 ♖g7 20 a4! ♖d8 21 b4 ♗xb4 22 ♘xb4 ♖xd1+ 23 ♖xd1 ♖g6 24 ♗xc6+ ♗xc6 25 ♕h8+ 1-0 Martin Gonzalez-Magem Badals, Spanish Ch 1986) and now:



1) **13 ♗xf6** gxf6 14 ♗e2 b4 and now:

1a) **15 ♗h5** ♗h6+ 16 ♔b1, Nasybulin-Lavdansky, USSR 1978, and now 16...bxc3! 17 ♘xe6 ♕b6 18 ♘c7+! (18 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 19 ♖xd7+ ♔e8! ∓) ♔f8 (18...♔d8 19 ♕xc3 ♕c6 20 ♕xc6 ♗xc6 21 ♘xa8 ♗xa8 22 ♗g4 ♗c6 23 ♖xd7+ ♗xd7 24 ♖d1 ±) 19 ♕xc3 ∞.

1b) **15 ♖he1!** bxc3 16 ♘xe6 ♗h6+ 17 ♔b1 ♕b6 18 ♗b5!! +– axb5 (18...fxe6 19 ♗xd7+ ♔f8 20 ♕xc3 e5 21 ♖xe5! ♗d2 22 ♕xd2 fxe5 23 ♕g5 ♗d5 24 ♕xe5 +–) 19 ♘c5+ ♔d8 20 ♖xd7+ ♔c8 21 ♖ee7 ♗e4 22 ♖c7+ ♔d8 23 ♘b7+ 1-0 Batyrov-Irzhanov, Ashkhabad 1996. A superb game.

2) **13 ♘cxb5** axb5 14 ♗xb5 ♖xa2! 15 ♔b1 ♕a8 16 ♘b3 ♗d5 17 ♗xf6 ♖a1+! (17...gxf6? 18 ♖xd5 ∞) 18 ♘xa1 ♕a2+ 19 ♔c1 ♕xa1+ 20 ♔d2 ♕a5+ 21 ♗c3 ♕xb5 ∓ Kataly-mov-Gofshtein, USSR 1977.

3) **13 ♘dxb5** axb5 14 ♗xb5 ♗c8 15 ♗xf6 gxf6 16 ♖d3 ♕b6 17 ♕f3, Smirin-Rõtšagov, USSR 1985 and now 17...♖b8!, in conjunction with a subsequent ...♗h6+, sets up an awkward pin against b2 and poses White the problem of how he is going to justify his sacrifice.

The spectacular line 1b just above is critical for the assessment of the main line. However, the theoretical status of 7 ♕d3 depends more on the reply 7...b5.

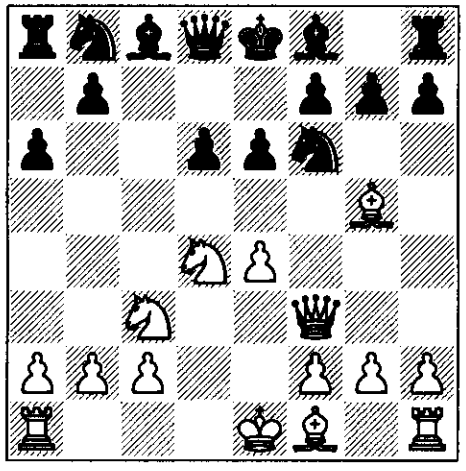
C)

6 ... e6

7 ♕f3 *(D)*

Just as in line B, White's queen is heading for g3. However, this time the queen is played to the f3-a8 diagonal in order to prevent an immediate 7...b5. The defect is that sooner or later White will have to play f4, and in order to achieve this White has to commit his queen earlier than he would like. Again there are many possible transpositions into chapters 2 and 10, which we do not explicitly mention.

B



7 ... h6

Or **7...♘bd7 8 0-0-0** and now:

1) **8...♗e7** 9 ♔b1!? h6 10 ♗c1 ♕c7 11 ♕g3 ♖g8 12 f4 g5 13 f5 e5 14 ♘b3 b5 15 h4 ♗b7 16 hxg5 hxg5 17 ♕e1 = Ivanović-Ftačnik, Manila IZ 1990.

2) **8...h6** 9 ♗e3! (this is the defect of delaying ...h6) ♕c7 10 ♕g3 e5 11 ♘b3 b5 12 a3 ♗b7 13 ♗d3 g6 14 f3 ♗g7?! 15 h4! h5 16 ♗xb5 axb5 17 ♘xb5 ♕b8 18 ♘xd6+ ♔f8 19 ♖d2 ♔g8 20 ♖hd1 ± Zude-Nunn, Bundesliga 1995.

3) **8...♕a5** 9 h4 h6 (9...♗e7 10 ♗e2 ♘c5 11 g4 {11 e5 dxe5 12 ♘c6 bxc6 13 ♕xc6+ ♘cd7 14 ♕xa8 0-0 15 ♖xd7 ♗xd7 16 ♕xa6 ♕c7 ∞ Kivioya-Bronstein, USSR 1971} 0-0 12 ♕e3 ♗d7 13 f4 ♘a4 14 ♘xa4 ♕xa4 15 ♔b1 ± Milov-Berkovich,

Alushta 1992) 10 ♗d2 ♕c7 11 g4 (it is hard to believe this pawn sacrifice) ♘e5 12 ♕g2 ♘exg4 13 ♗e2 (13 ♖h3 ♗d7 14 f4 h5 15 f5 ♗e7 16 ♗e2 ♖c8 17 ♗g5 b5 18 fxe6 fxe6 19 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 20 ♗xg4 hxg4 21 ♕xg4 ♕c5 ∓ Conquest-Tisdall, Reykjavik 1996) h5? (13...♘e5 ∓) 14 ♗g5 ♗d7 15 f3 ♘e5 16 f4 ♘c6 17 ♗f3 ♖c8 18 ♔b1 ♘g4 19 ♗xg4 hxg4 20 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 21 ♕xg4 f6 22 ♗xf6 gxf6 23 f5 ♔e7 24 ♖he1 exf5 25 ♕g6 ♖h6 26 ♘d5+ 1-0 Lejlić-Tisdall, Gausdal 1996.

4) **8...♕c7** and now:

4a) **9 ♗e2** ♗e7 (9...b5) 10 ♕g3 (10 ♖he1 ♘c5 11 ♘b3 ♘xb3+ 12 axb3 0-0 13 ♕g3 b5 14 ♗h6 ♘e8 15 ♗e3 ♗d7 16 ♗d3 ± Zaja-Shneider, Jyväskylä 1994) h6 (10...♘c5 11 ♕e3 0-0?! 12 f4 b5 13 e5 dxe5 14 fxe5 ♘d5 15 ♘xd5 ♗xg5 16 ♕xg5 exd5 17 ♗f3 ± Rogalewicz-Turlej, corr 1993) 11 ♗e3 b5 12 a3 ♖b8 13 f4 b4 14 axb4 ♖xb4 15 ♗f3 ♖g8 16 ♖he1 g5 was unclear in Morozevich-Anand, Moscow rpd 1995.

4b) **9 ♕g3** b5 (after 9...♗e7 10 ♗e2 {10 f4 h6 11 ♗h4 transposes to chapter 10} Black faces similar problems, since 10...b5 11 ♗xb5 axb5 12 ♘dxb5 will transpose to the main line of this note) 10 ♗xb5 axb5 11 ♘dxb5 ♕b8 12 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 13 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 14 ♖xd6 h6 (14...0-0 15 ♖hd1 is similar) 15 ♗h4 (15 ♗d2 and 15 ♗xf6 are also ±) g5 16 ♗g3 ♘c5 17 f3 ± Jorge-Fairclough, Thessaloniki OL 1984. These endings are just bad for Black; the three connected passed pawns plus a lead in development are worth more than the knight.

8 ♗h4

Or :

1) **8 ♗xf6** ♕xf6 9 ♕xf6 gxf6 10 0-0-0 (10 ♗e2 h5 11 0-0-0 ♗d7 12 ♔b1 ♔d8 13 f4 ♘c6 14 ♖hf1 ♔c7 15 ♖f3 ♗e7 = Bokucheva-Platonov, Gori 1971) b5 11 a3 ♗b7 12 f4 ♘d7 13 ♗e2 h5 = Sidorov-Polugaevsky, corr 1953.

2) **8 ♗e3** e5 (8...♘bd7 9 ♕g3 e5 10 ♘b3 b5 11 f3 ♕c7 12 ♕f2 b4 13 ♘d1 d5 14 ♗d3 dxe4 15 fxe4 ♗e7 ∓ J.Littlewood-Nunn, British Ch 1979) 9 ♘b3 ♗e6 (9...b5 is also good) 10 a4 ♘c6 11 ♗d3 ♘b4 12 ♘d2 ♗e7 13 0-0 0-0 14 a5 ♘xd3 15 cxd3 d5 ∓ Van Riemsdijk-Stean, São Paulo 1979.

8 ... ♘bd7

8...♗e7 9 0-0-0 ♕c7 10 g4 (10 ♗d3 ♘bd7) ♘bd7 11 ♕h3 ♘b6 12 f4 ♗d7 13 ♖g1 0-0-0 14 ♕f3 ♗c6 15 ♗e2 ± Ivanović-Bykhovsky, Yugoslavia tt 1993.

9 0-0-0 ♕c7

9...♘e5 10 ♕e2 (10 ♕e3 g5 11 ♗g3 ♕c7 12 ♗e2 ♗e7 13 ♖hf1 b5 14 a3 ♖b8 15 f4 gxf4 16 ♖xf4 h5 17 h3 b4 18 axb4 ♖xb4 19 ♗h4? ♘fg4! ∓ Kupreichik-Grigorian, USSR 1976) g5 11 f4!? (11 ♗g3 ♗d7 12 h4 ♖g8 13 hxg5 hxg5 14 ♘f3 ♕c7 with equality, Spassky-Petrosian, USSR Ch 1955) gxf4 (11...♘g6!) 12 g3 fxg3 13 ♘f3 ♗d7 14 ♘xe5 dxe5 15 ♗h3 ♗e7 16 ♖hf1 ∞ Giurumia-Armas, Romania 1982.

After 9...♕c7, White may try:

1) **10 ♗d3** ♗e7 11 ♕e2 b5 12 f4 b4 13 ♘d5 (13 ♘b1 ♗b7 14 ♘d2 ♘c5 15 ♔b1 0-0 16 ♗g3 a5 ∓ Kagan-Nunn, Hastings 1977/8) exd5 14 ♘f5 ♘c5 15 ♘xe7 ♕xe7 16 ♖he1 dxe4 ∓ Milov-Savon, Alushta 1992.

2) **10 ♗e2** ♗e7 11 ♖he1 (11 ♕e3 g5 12 ♗g3 ♘e5 13 h4 ♖g8 14 hxg5 hxg5 15 ♕d2 ♗d7 16 ♘f3 ♘fg4 17 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 18 ♖h7 ♕c5! ∓ Liberzon-Portisch, Skara Echt 1980) g5 12 ♗g3 ♘e5 13 ♕e3 b5 14 a3 ♖b8 ∓ Tal-Platonov, USSR 1959.

3) **10 ♕h3** ♗e7 (10...b5 11 ♘xe6 fxe6 12 ♕xe6+ ♗e7 13 ♗xb5 ♔d8 14 ♕xe7+ ± Milov-Ruck, Zalakaros 1993) 11 f4 transposes to line 6 on page 197.

D)

6	**...**	**e6**
7	**f4**	**♗d7**
8	**♕f3**	

8 ♕d2?! h6! forces White to exchange his bishop (9 ♗h4 ♘xe4), while 8 e5 dxe5 9 fxe5 ♕a5 10 ♗b5 ♘e4! 11 ♘b3 ♘xc3 (11...♕b4!?) 12 ♕xd7+ ♘xd7 13 ♗xd7+ ♔xd7 14 ♘xa5 ♗b4 15 ♘c4 ♘d5+ 16 c3 ♗e7 was equal in Amrein-Bigaliev, Budapest 1996.

8	**...**	**♘c6**
9	**0-0-0**	**♘xd4**
10	**♖xd4**	**♗c6**
11	**♗c4**	

Or 11 ♗e2 (11 f5!?) ♗e7 12 ♖hd1 ♕a5 13 ♕e3 h6 14 ♗h4 e5 15 fxe5 dxe5 16 ♖4d3 0-0 17 ♔b1 ♖fd8 (17...b5!?) 18 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 19 ♘d5 ± Tal-Larsen, Reykjavik 1957.

11	**...**	**♗e7**

12 ♖hd1 ♕a5 13 ♕h3!? (13 ♕e2 h6 14 ♗h4 e5? 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 ♖xd6 exf4 17 ♘d5 ♗xd5 18 ♖1xd5 +– Panno-Lombardy, Varna 1958) ♖d8 (13...0-0-0 14 ♗xe6+ fxe6 15 ♕xe6+ ♖d7 16 e5 ±; 13...0-0 14 ♗b3 e5 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 ♖xd6 exf4 17 ♘d5 ♗xd5 18 ♖6xd5 ♕c7 19 ♕f5 ±) 14 ♗b3 e5 (14...0-0 15 f5 ±) 15 ♗xf6 exd4? (15...♗xf6 16 ♖xd6 ♖xd6 17 ♖xd6 exf4 18 e5! ♗xe5 19 ♕f5 0-0 20 ♖d5 ♗xd5 21 ♕xe5 ±) 16 ♗xg7 dxc3 17 ♗xc3 1-0 P.Gaprindashvili-Wielgo, corr 1990.

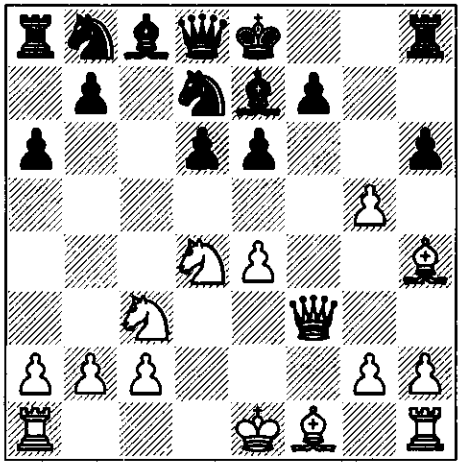
E)

6	**...**	**e6**
7	**f4**	**♗e7**
8	**♕f3**	**h6**
9	**♗h4**	**g5**

The so-called Gothenburg variation, which was played three times in round 14 of the 1955 Gothenburg Interzonal by Argentinean players against Soviet opponents, with uniformly unsuccessful results. The line is unpopular today, but there seems to be no objective reason for this.

10	**fxg5**	**♘fd7** *(D)*

W



Now there are two main lines. Line E1 is thought to be a forced draw, while E2, although avoiding the draw, also seems to give White no advantage.

E1: 11 ♘xe6
E2: 11 ♕h5

11 ♗g3 ♘e5! (not 11...hxg5?! 12 0-0-0 ♕c7 13 ♗b5! ±) 12 ♕f2 (12

♕h5 is line E2) hxg5 13 0-0-0 (13 ♗e2 ♕b6 14 0-0-0 ♘bc6 15 ♘a4 ♕a7 was equal in Stein-Calvo, Las Palmas 1973) ♕b6 14 ♘xe6!? ♕xf2 15 ♘c7+ ♔d8 16 ♗xf2 ♔xc7 17 ♘d5+ ♔d7 18 ♗d4 b5! 19 ♘b6+ ♔c6 20 ♘xa8 ♘bd7 is unclear as the knight on a8 is lost.

E1)

11 ♘xe6

Of the Soviet trio it was Geller who first took on e6.

11	**...**	**fxe6**
12	**♕h5+**	**♔f8**
13	**♗b5!**	

The move that plunged the Argentinean trio into deep thought. After 13 ♗d3 or 13 ♗e2 Black reinforces his e5-knight by 13...♘e5 14 0-0+ ♔g7 15 ♗g3 ♘bd7.

13	**...**	**♖h7!**

Other moves are bad, for example 13...♘e5 14 ♗g3 ♖h7 15 ♗xe5 dxe5 16 ♖d1 ± or 13...♔g7 14 0-0 ♘e5 15 ♗g3 ♘g6 16 gxh6+ ♖xh6 17 ♖f7+ ♔xf7 18 ♕xh6, Spassky-Pilnik, Gothenburg IZ 1955 and Keres-Najdorf, Gothenburg IZ 1955. See *The Najdorf for the Tournament Player* for the gory details.

14 0-0+

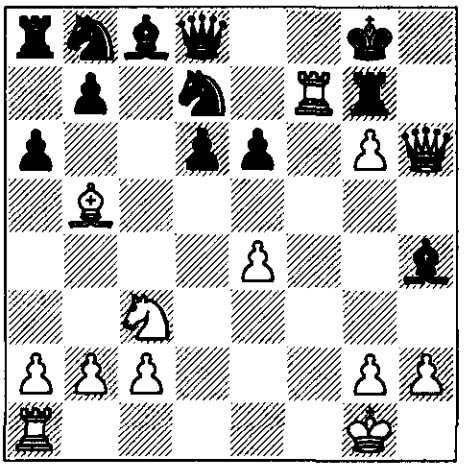
Or 14 ♕g6 ♖f7 15 ♕xh6+ ♔g8 16 ♖f1 (16 ♕g6+ ♖g7 17 ♕xe6+ ♔h8 18 ♗xd7 ♘xd7 19 0-0-0 ♘e5 ∓ Gligorić-Fischer, Portorož 1958) ♖xf1+ 17 ♗xf1 ♘e5 18 ♗c4! ♘xc4 ½-½ Timman-Stean, London 1973, in view of 19 ♕g6+ ♔h8 (19...♔f8 20 ♔e2!) 20 ♕h6+ with perpetual check.

14	**...**	**♔g8**
15	**g6**	**♖g7**
16	**♖f7**	**♗xh4**

16...♗g5?! 17 ♗xd7 ♘xd7 18 ♖af1 b5 19 e5 d5 20 ♔h1! (20 ♘xd5 is also good) ♖a7 21 ♘xd5! exd5 22 e6 ♘f8 23 ♗xg5 hxg5 24 ♕xg5 ♖e7 25 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 26 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 27 ♕f6+ 1-0 Romanov-Gulbrandsen, corr 1964.

17 ♕xh6 *(D)*

B



17	**...**	**♖xf7**

According to current theory this move leads to perpetual check. The alternative is 17...♕f6, avoiding the immediate draw. The critical position arises after 18 ♖f1 (18 ♗xd7 ♘xd7 19 ♖xf6 ♗xf6 20 ♖f1 ♗d4+ 21 ♔h1 ♗xc3 22 bxc3 ♘e5, Skrobek-Inkiov, Polanica Zdroj 1981, and now 23 ♕d2 is ± according to Parma) axb5 19 e5! ♕xe5 20 ♕xh4 ♘c6 21 ♘e4. Now Diaz-Alzate, Bayamo 1984 continued 21...d5 22 ♘f6+ ♘xf6 23 ♖1xf6 ♗d7? (23...♕e3+ 24 ♖f2 ♕e1+ 25 ♖f1 ♕xf1+ 26 ♔xf1 ♖xf7 27 gxf7+ ♔xf7 28 ♕h7+ ♔f6 29 ♕h8+ ♔f7 30 h4 ±) 24 ♖xg7+ ♔xg7 25 ♖f7+ ♔xg6 26 ♕h7+ ♔g5 27 h4+ 1-0. 21...♖xf7!? is interesting, but after 22 gxf7+ ♔f8 23 c3! (preventing a check on d4) Black is amazingly tied up, for example 23...d5 24 ♘c5 ♘f6 25 ♕h6+ (25

♖xf6 ♕e3+ is a perpetual check) ♔xf7 26 ♘d3 is awkward for Black. It seems that by avoiding the draw, Black risks falling into an inferior position.

18 gxf7+ ♔xf7
19 ♖f1+ ♗f6
20 ♕h7+ ♔f8!

Better than 20...♔e8 21 ♕g6+ ♔f8 22 e5 dxe5 23 ♘e4 ♕b6+ 24 ♔h1 axb5 25 ♘xf6 ♔e7 26 ♕e8+ ♔d6 27 ♕xc8 ♘xf6 28 ♖xf6 ♘d7 29 ♕xa8 ♘xf6 30 ♕f8+ ♔d5 31 ♕xf6 with a very favourable ending.

After 20...♔f8! White might as well take the draw straight away. Although various winning attempts have been tried, close examination shows that White only risks losing if he tries one of these. After 21 e5 (Beliavsky's 21 ♗e2 remains untested, but it is hard to see anything other than a draw after 21...♘c6 22 ♗h5 ♘de5) dxe5 22 ♘e4, for example, Black should play 22...♕b6+ 23 ♖f2 axb5. Geller then gave 24 g4 as winning, while *The Najdorf for the Tournament Player* gave a draw after 24...♖a4! 25 g5 ♖xe4 26 ♕xe4 ♕d4 27 ♕g6 ♕g4+ 28 ♔f1 (28 ♔h1? b6!) ♕d1+. Now I don't even see a draw after 28...♘c6! 29 ♕h6+ ♔f7 30 ♕h7+ (30 gxf6 ♘f8 31 ♖g2 ♕f4+) ♔e8 31 ♕g8+ (after 31 gxf6 ♘f8 32 ♕c7 ♗d7 33 ♕xb7 ♘d8 Black's material advantage is decisive) ♔e7 32 gxf6+ ♘xf6 33 ♕xc8 ♘d5 34 ♔e1 ♕g5 and the attacking power of the queen and two knights should win for Black.

E2)

11 ♕h5 ♘e5
12 ♗g3

Or 12 ♗f2 ♗xg5 13 h4 ♗e7 (13...♗f6 14 0-0-0 ♘bc6 15 ♗e2 ♘xd4 16 ♗xd4 ♗d7 17 ♖hf1 ♕e7 18 ♖f4! threatening ♖df1 was good for White in Jansa-Milev, Bad Liebenstein 1963) 14 0-0-0 ♘bc6 (not 14...♕a5 15 g4 ♘bd7 16 g5 ♘g6 17 ♘b3 ♕e5 18 ♗d4! ♕f4+ 19 ♘d2 and the threats of 20 ♗xh8 and 20 ♘e2 are decisive) 15 ♗e2 ♗d7 16 ♖hf1 ♕a5 may give White an edge.

12 ... ♗xg5
13 ♗e2

Others are no more promising, for example 13 ♘f3 ♘bc6! 14 ♖d1 ♗f6 15 ♗e2 ♖h7 16 ♗f2 ♕a5 17 ♘d4 ∞ Geenen-Spasov, corr 1993 or 13 h4 ♗f6 (13...♗e3 14 ♖d1 ♕c7 15 ♘db5 axb5 16 ♘xb5 ♕a5+ 17 c3 ∞) 14 ♗e2 ♘bc6 15 ♘xc6 bxc6 =.

13 ... ♕b6

The best move, e.g. 13...♘g6 (or 13...♘bc6 14 ♘xc6 bxc6 15 0-0 ♖a7 16 ♗xe5 dxe5 17 ♖f3 ±; 13...♗d7 14 h4 ♗f6 15 0-0-0 ±) 14 ♖d1 ♕b6 15 ♘b3 ♗e7 16 ♖f1 ♘d7 17 ♗f2 ♕d8 18 ♗d4 e5 19 ♕f3 ♖h7 20 ♗c4 ♘f6 21 ♘d5 ± Harju-Vayrynen, corr 1988.

14 ♗xe5 dxe5
15 ♘f3 ♕xb2

Even 15...♖f8 16 ♘xg5 ♕xb2 is playable. This is universally given as losing after 17 0-0 hxg5 18 ♖xf7 (18 ♖ad1 ♘c6 ∞) ♖xf7 19 ♖f1 ♕xc3 (19...♕b6+? 20 ♔h1 ♕c7 21 ♕h8+ ♔e7 22 ♖xf7+ ♔xf7 23 ♕h7+ +–) 20 ♖xf7, but 20...♕c5+ 21 ♔h1 ♘d7 seems safe enough (22 ♕xg5 leads to perpetual check).

16 ♘d1 ♕b4+

Or 16...♕xa1 17 ♘xg5 ♖f8 18 ♘xf7 ♔d7! 19 c3 (19 ♘xe5+ ♔c7 20 ♕xh6 ♘d7 and White cannot castle) ♕xa2 20 0-0 ♕a3! 21 ♘xe5+

♔d8 22 ♘f7+ ♔c7 23 ♘e3 ½-½ Parma-Minić, Cateske Toplice 1968. Black is better in the final position.

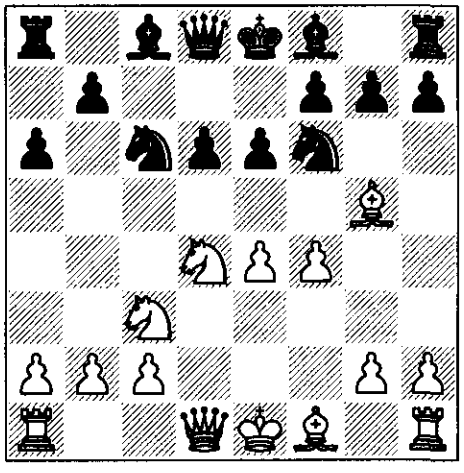
17 c3 ♕e7

18 0-0 ♖h7! 19 ♘f2 ♘d7 20 ♘g4 (20 ♖ad1 ♘f6 21 ♕h3 ♗f4 ∞) ♔d8! (20...♘f6 21 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 22 ♖ad1 ♗d7 23 ♘d2 ♕e7 24 ♘c4 ♗c6 25 ♔h1 ♖d8 26 ♖xd8+ ♕xd8 27 ♘xe5 ♕c7 28 ♘xc6 ♕xc6 29 ♕h3 ± ½-½ Sakharov-Nasybulin, USSR 1979) 21 ♗d3 ♔c7 22 g3 f6 23 ♖ae1 ♘f8 24 ♔h1 ♗d7 ∓ Dimovski-Ninov, corr 1990.

In summary, the only thing wrong the Gothenburg variation is that White has a forced draw.

F)

6 ... e6
7 f4 ♘c6 *(D)*



8 ♘xc6

Various other moves have been tried, but apart from the critical 8 e5, they are either weak or transpose into various lines of the Richter-Rauzer. However, **8 e5** is dangerous for Black: **8...h6** (8...dxe5 9 ♘xc6 ♕xd1+ 10 ♖xd1 bxc6 11 fxe5 ♘d5 12 ♘e4 is similar to line 2 below) **9 ♗h4** and now:

1) **9...g5** and now:

1a) **10 ♗g3** ♘xd4 (10...dxe5 11 ♘xc6 ♕xd1+ 12 ♖xd1 bxc6 13 fxe5 ♘d5 14 ♘e4 ♗g7 15 ♗d3 ♔e7 16 ♘d6 a5 17 0-0 ♘f4 18 ♗xf4 gxf4 19 ♘c4 ± Anand-Bologan, Geneva rpd 1996) 11 ♕xd4 dxe5 12 ♕xd8+ ♔xd8 13 fxe5 ♘d7 14 0-0-0 ♗g7 15 ♗c4 b5 16 ♗e2 ♔e7 17 ♗f3 ♖a7 18 ♖he1 ♗b7 = Tseitlin-Smirin, Israeli Ch 1992.

1b) **10 fxg5** ♘d5 11 ♘xd5 exd5 12 exd6 (12 ♘xc6 bxc6 transposes to the main line) ♕xd6 13 ♕e2+ ♗e7 14 ♘xc6 bxc6 15 ♗g3 ♕g6, Brodsky-Shabalov, USSR Ch 1991, 16 ♕e5 ♖g8 17 ♗d3 ♕xg5 =.

2) **9...dxe5** 10 ♘xc6 ♕xd1+ 11 ♖xd1 bxc6 12 fxe5 ♘d5 13 ♘e4 ♖b8 (13...♗e7 14 ♗f2 {14 ♗xe7 ±} ♖b8 15 ♗d4 ♘b4 16 ♖d2! ♘xa2 17 c3 ♘c1 18 ♗c4 ♘b3 19 ♗xb3 ♖xb3 20 ♗c5 ∞ Ljubojević-Ivanchuk, Tilburg 1989) 14 b3 ♗e7 (14...g5?! 15 ♗g3 ♗b4+ 16 ♔e2 f5!? 17 exf6 e5 18 ♔f3 g4+ 19 ♔f2 ♗f5 20 ♗xe5 ♗xe4 21 ♗xb8 ± Brodsky-Rechel, Groningen 1993) 15 ♘d6+!? ♗xd6 16 exd6 ♔d7 17 ♗d3 ♘c3 18 ♖d2 f6 ∞ Luther-Bykhovsky, Sochi 1990.

8 ... bxc6
9 e5 h6
10 ♗h4 g5

Not 10...dxe5 11 ♕xd8+ ♔xd8 12 fxe5 g5 13 ♗xg5! hxg5 14 exf6 and White has the better ending, Mikhalchishin-Shneider, Lvov 1986.

11 fxg5 ♘d5
12 ♘e4

Or **12 ♘xd5 cxd5** (12...exd5 13 ♕e2 {13 exd6 hxg5 14 ♕e2+ ♗e6 15 ♗g3 ♗xd6 16 ♗xd6 ♕xd6 17 g3 ♔d7 18 0-0-0 ♕b4 = Howell-Saravanan, Calcutta 1996} hxg5 14 ♗g3

♕a5+ 14 ♕d2 ♕xd2+ 15 ♔xd2 ♗e6 was level in Yermolinsky-Browne, USA Ch 1992) **13 ♕h5** (13 ♕g4 ♗e7! =) **♕b6 14 ♗e2 ♗g7** and now:

1) **15 c3** dxe5 16 ♗f2 ♕xb2 17 0-0 ♕b7 18 ♗c5 ♕c7 19 ♗d6 ♕b6+ 20 ♔h1 ♖a7 21 ♗a3 ∞ Jonsson-Maksimenko, Odessa Student Wch 1990

2) **15 ♖f1** ♖a7 16 ♗f2 d4 17 0-0-0 dxe5 18 g6 f5 19 ♗c4 ♖b7 20 ♗b3 0-0 ∞ Sakharov-Odeev, corr 1989.

3) **15 g6** 0-0 (15...♖a7 16 ♗f2 d4 17 0-0 dxe5 18 gxf7+ ♔f8 19 c3 +− Elters-Khakpoor, Novi Sad OL 1990) 16 ♗f6 ♖a7! 17 ♗xg7 ♔xg7 18 gxf7 ♖axf7 19 ♕g4+ ♔h8 20 0-0-0 ♕e3+ 21 ♔b1 dxe5 22 ♖he1 ♖g7 23 ♕b4 ♕f4 ∓ Mackić-Maksimenko, Yugoslavia 1994.

12 ... ♕b6
13 ♗d3

Or:

1) **13 c4** dxe5 (13...♕xb2 14 exd6 ♘e3 15 d7+ ♗xd7 16 ♘f6+ ♕xf6 17 gxf6 ♘xd1 18 ♖xd1 ♖g8 19 ♗e2 ♖xg2 20 ♔f1 ♖g8 21 ♗f3 0-0-0 ∓ Enders-King, Bundesliga 1995) 14 cxd5 ♕b4+ 15 ♘c3 ♕xh4+ 16 g3 ♕xg5 17 dxc6 ♗c5 18 ♕f3 f5 19 ♗e2 h5 20 ♖f1 ♖a7 21 ♖d1 ♖c7 22 a3 e4 ∓ Bauer-Stangl, Bundesliga 1990.

2) **13 c3** dxe5 14 ♗g3 hxg5 15 ♗xe5 ♖h4!? 16 ♗d3! f5 (16...♗b7!?) 17 ♘d2 ♗c5 (17...♕xb2!? 18 0-0 ♕b6+!? 19 ♔h1 ♘e3 20 ♕e2 ♘xf1 21 ♖xf1 ♗e7 and White has some compensation, but not enough) 18 ♕e2 ♕xb2 19 ♖b1 ♕xa2 20 g3, Oll-Gelfand, Debrecen 1989, 20...♖h6! 21 c4 ♘b4 22 ♖b2 ♘xd3+ 23 ♕xd3 ♕a3! ∓.

13 ... hxg5

and now:

1) **14 ♗xg5** ♕xb2 15 ♘f6+ ♘xf6 16 ♗xf6 ♕c3+ 17 ♔e2 ♖g8 18 ♖b1, was Solomon-Leskiewicz, Brisbane 1995, and now 18...♖xg2+ 19 ♔f1 ♖d2 20 ♕e1 ♖xd3 21 cxd3 ♕xd3+ 22 ♔f2 dxe5 is fine for Black.

2) **14 ♗g3!?** dxe5 (14...♕xb2!?) 15 ♗xe5 ♖h4 16 ♕f3 ♗e7 17 0-0-0 ♕e3+ 18 ♕xe3 ♘xe3 19 g3 ± ♖h6 20 ♖d2 ♘g4 21 ♗g7 f5 22 ♗xh6 fxe4 23 ♗xe4 ♔f7 24 ♖f1+ ♔g8 1-0 Lendwai-Ermenkov, Miskolc 1990.

3) **14 ♗f2** ♕xb2 15 0-0 ♕xe5 16 ♗g3 ♕d4+ 17 ♔h1 f5! (17...♘e3?! 18 ♕f3 ♘xf1 19 ♖xf1 f5 20 c3! ♕b6 {20...g4?! 21 ♕e2 ♕g7 22 ♖xf5! ± Vitolinš-Shabalov, USSR 1990} 21 ♘xd6+ ♗xd6 22 ♗xd6 ♖a7 23 ♖b1 ∞ Vitolinš-Drilinš, USSR 1990) 18 c3 ♘xc3 19 ♘xc3 ♕xc3 20 ♖c1 ♕a5 21 ♕e2!? (21 ♖xc6 ♗b7 22 ♕b3 ♗xc6 23 ♕xe6+ ♔d8 24 ♖xf5, Arencibia-Martin del Campo, Matanzas Capablanca mem 1994, and now 24...♕a3! ∓) ♗e7 22 ♗xf5 exf5 23 ♗xd6 ♕d8! 24 ♖cd1 ♖h6 25 ♗e5, Shabalov-Browne, USA Ch 1994, and now 25...♗d7! ∓.

G)

6 ... e6
7 f4 ♗e7
8 ♕f3 ♕a5

This odd move, introduced by the Austrian master Danner, became popular after it was recommended in Danny King's book *Winning with the Najdorf*. While there is no refutation, it is less reliable than the main lines of the Najdorf.

9 0-0-0

Lines in which White plays ♘b3 are similar to lines from chapter 9

(i.e. 8 ♘b3 against the Poisoned Pawn). However, White can wait for Black to play ...♗d7 and ...♘c6 before playing ♘b3. Although White's knight again ends up on a passive square, Black has been forced to play his knight to c6, where it is usually less well placed than on d7.

9 ... ♗d7

Necessary preparation as 9...b5 10 e5 and 9...♘c6 10 ♘xc6 bxc6 11 e5 are lost for Black. After 9...♗d7 White may play:

1) **10 ♗h4** ♘c6 11 ♘b3 ♕c7 12 g4 h6 13 ♗g3 0-0-0 14 h4 ♗e8 (14...d5? 15 exd5 ♘xd5 16 ♖xd5! exd5 17 ♘xd5 +– Brodsky-Rowson, Cappelle la Grande 1996) 15 g5 ♘d7 16 ♗h3 g6 17 ♕e3 ± Ljubojević-J.Polgar, Moscow OL 1994.

2) **10 g4** ♘c6 11 ♘b3 ♕c7 12 ♗h4 is line 1.

3) **10 ♗d3** ♘c6 11 ♘b3 ♕c7 12 ♖he1 h6 13 ♗h4 ♘xe4! 14 ♖xe4 ♗xh4 15 ♕g4 ♗f6 16 ♘d5 ♕d8 17 ♗f1 0-0 18 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 19 ♖xd6 ♖ad8 20 ♕d1 ♗c8 21 g3 ♕e7 22 ♖xd8 ♖xd8 = Vl.Georgiev-Rowson, Halle jr Wch 1995.

4) **10 ♗xf6** ♗xf6! 11 e5 is met by 11...dxe5 12 ♕xb7? (12 fxe5 ♗c6 14 ♘xc6 ♗g5+ 15 ♔b1 ♘xc6 16 ♘e4 ♗e7 17 ♘d6+ ♗xd6 18 exd6 0-0 =) exd4 13 ♕xa8 ♕c7! threatening both 14...♗c6 and 14...dxc3.

5) **10 e5** (probably the most critical move) **dxe5 11 fxe5** (11 ♘b3 ♕c7 12 fxe5 ♗c6 13 ♕g3 ♘e4 {not 13...♘fd7 14 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 15 ♕g5+ ♔e8 16 ♖d6 ± Rutherford-Curtis, Melbourne 1996} 14 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 15 ♗d3 ♗xd3 16 ♖xd3 ♗xg5+ 17 ♕xg5 ♘c6 18 ♕xg7 ♕xe5 19 ♕h6 ±) **♘c6** and now:

5a) **12 ♘xc6** ♗xc6 13 ♕g3 ♘h5 (13...♘d5 14 ♘xd5 ♗xg5+ 15 ♕xg5 ♗xd5 16 ♕xg7 0-0-0 17 a3 ♕c7 18 ♗d3 ♖hg8 19 ♕xh7 ♗xg2 20 ♖hg1 ♕e7, Tejas-Sowray, London 1996, and now 21 ♗c4! ±) 14 ♕h4 ♗xg5+ 15 ♕xg5 g6 16 ♗d3 with a slight plus for White.

5b) **12 ♘f5** (ingenious, but Black can survive) exf5 13 exf6 gxf6 14 ♗f4 (14 ♖d5 ♕c7 15 ♗f4 ♘e5 16 ♕g3 0-0-0 17 ♖xe5 fxe5 18 ♗xe5 ♕c6 19 ♗xh8 ♖xh8 20 ♗d3 =) 0-0-0 (14...♗e6!?) 15 ♘d5 ♗e6 16 ♗c4 ♗d6?! (16...♗c5! ∞) 17 ♗d2 ♘b4 18 a3 ♗xd5 19 ♕xf5+ ♔b8 20 ♗xb4 ♗xb4 21 ♗xd5 ± Howell-D.James, Hastings 1995/6.

6) **10 ♗c4 ♘c6 11 ♗b3 h6 12 ♗h4 g5** (12...♕h5 {boring, but best} 13 ♕xh5 ♘xh5 14 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 15 ♖hf1 g5 16 f5 ♘f6 17 ♘xc6+ ♗xc6 18 ♖fe1 ♘g4 19 h3 ♘e5 = Enders-Wahls, German Ch 1994) and now:

6a) **13 ♗e1** ♕c7 14 f5 ♘a5?! (14...♘xd4 15 ♖xd4 ♖c8 16 fxe6 fxe6 17 ♖d2 b5 18 ♖f1 b4 19 ♘e2 g4 20 ♕e3 ♕c5 21 ♕d4 a5 = Luther-S.Pedersen, Minsk 1994) 15 ♗xe6! fxe6 16 fxe6 ♗c6 17 ♘xc6 bxc6 18 e5 0-0 (18...dxe5 19 ♕f5 +–) 19 ♕d3 d5 20 exf6 ♗xf6 21 e7 ♖f7 22 ♕g6+ ♗g7 23 ♘xd5! +– Howell-Borne, Cannes 1995.

6b) **13 fxg5** ♘e5 14 ♕e2 ♘h7 15 ♗g3 hxg5 16 ♘f3 ♘f8 17 ♘xe5 dxe5 18 ♕f2 ♘g6 19 ♖xd7! ♔xd7 20 ♕xf7 +– McDonald-McShane, Hastings 1994/5.

There is relatively little practical experience with Danner's line, but my recommendation would be either line 1 above, or line 5 with 11 ♘b3.

Index of Variations

Numbers refer to pages. A symbol such as '12W' is shorthand for 'alternative White 12th moves'. Likewise '8B' means 'alternative Black 8th moves'.

1 e4 c5 2 ♘f3 d6 3 d4 cxd4 4 ♘xd4 ♘f6 5 ♘c3 a6 6 ♗g5

6 ... e6

6...♘bd7 7 ♗c4 (7W *302*) ♕a5 (7B *303*) 8 ♕d2 e6 9 0-0-0 (9 0-0 *304*) b5 *304*

7 f4

7 ♕d3 (7 ♕f3 *308*; 7W *301*) ♘bd7 (7B *306*) 8 0-0-0 *307*

A: 7...♗e7 (Main Line)
B: 7...♕b6 (Poisoned Pawn)
C: 7...b5 (Polugaevsky)
D: 7...♕c7
E: 7...♘bd7

Other lines:
1) 7...h6 8 ♗h4 ♕b6 *175*
2) 7...♗d7 *310*
3) 7...♘c6 *313*

A)

7 ... ♗e7
8 ♕f3 ♕c7

8...h6 (8...♕a5 *314*) 9 ♗h4 ♕c7 (9...g5 10 fxg5 ♘fd7 11 ♕h5 {11 ♘xe6 *311*} ♘e5 *312*) 10 0-0-0 ♘bd7 and now there are two main possibilities for White:

1) 11 ♕g3 (11W *196*) g5 (11B *197*) 12 fxg5 ♖g8 (12...hxg5 *198*; 12...♘h5 *199*) 13 ♗e2 (13W *200*) ♘e5 (13B *200*) 14 ♘f3 (14W *201*) *201*

2) 11 ♗e2 ♖b8 (11B *202*) 12 ♕g3 (12W *205*) ♖g8 (12B *205*) 13 ♖hf1 (13W *206*) g5 *207*

9 0-0-0 ♘bd7
10 g4

10 ♗d3 (10 ♕g3 *78*; 10 ♗e2 *80*; 10W *65*) b5 (10...h6 {10B *66*} 11 ♗h4 {11 ♕h3 *216*; 11 h4?! *220*} g5 12 fxg5 {12 e5 *214*} *209*) 11 ♖he1 (11 ♗xf6 *67*) ♗b7 (11...b4 *67*) 12 ♕g3 (12 ♘d5 *68*; 12W *68*) b4 (12B *72*) 13 ♘d5 exd5 14 e5 (14 exd5 *74*) dxe5 15 fxe5 *75*

10 ... b5

10B *5*

11 ♗xf6

11W *6*

11 ... ♘xf6

11...gxf6 (11...♗xf6 79) 12 f5 (12W *9*) ♘e5 (12B *10*) 13 ♕h3 0-0 (13B *11*) 14 ♖g1 (14W *11*) ♔h8 15 ♘ce2 (15 ♗d3 *13*) ♖g8 (15B *13*) 16 ♖g3 (16 ♘f4 *14*) ♗d7 (16B *14*) 17 ♘f4 *15*

12 g5

12 a3 *16*

12 ... ♘d7
13 f5

13 a3 (13W *19*) ♖b8 (13...♗b7 *20*) 14 h4 (14W *21*) b4 15 axb4 ♖xb4 16 ♗h3 (16W *24*) ♕c5 (16...♘b6 *25*; 16...♘c5 *25*; 16...♕b6 *27*; 16...0-0 *28*) 17 ♘b3 (17 ♕d3 *29*) ♕b6 *30*

13 ... ♘c5

13...♗xg5+ (13B *32*) 14 ♔b1 ♘e5 (14B *33*) 15 ♕h5 ♕d8 (15B *34*) 16

♖g1 (16W *36)* ♗f6 (16B *37*) 17 fxe6 0-0 (17B *38*) 18 ♗h3 g6 19 ♘d5 *39*

14 f6

14 h4 (14W *40*) b4 (14B *40*) 15 fxe6 (15 ♘ce2 *41*; 15 ♘b1 *40*) fxe6 (15B *43*) 16 ♘ce2 g6 (16B *44*) 17 ♗h3 (17W *44*) e5 *45*

14 ... gxf6

14B *45*

15 gxf6 ♗f8

16 ♖g1

16 ♕h5 (16 ♕e3 *46*; 16 a3 *46*; 16 ♘f5 *49*; 16 ♗h3 *50*) ♗d7 (16B *53*) 17 ♗h3 (17W *55*) b4 18 ♘ce2 (18 ♘d5 *55*) 0-0-0 *56*

16 ... ♗d7

16B *57*

17 ♖g7

and now 17...♗xg7 (17B *61*) 18 fxg7 ♖g8 19 e5 0-0-0 (19B *62*) 20 exd6 ♕b6 (20...♕b7 *62*) 21 ♘e4 (21 ♕xf7 *63*) ♗c6 (21...♘xe4 *63*) 22 ♘xc6 *64*

B)

7 ... ♕b6

8 ♕d2

8 ♘b3 (8 ♕d3 *177*; 8 a3 *177*; 8W *179*) ♘bd7 (8B *180*) 9 ♕f3 (9W *184*) ♗e7 (9B *187*) 10 0-0-0 (10W *189*) ♕c7 (10...h6 *190*) 11 ♗d3 (11W *190*) b5 (11B *193*) 12 a3 (12W *193*) ♗b7 *194*

8 ... ♕xb2

9 ♖b1

9 ♘b3 and now:

1) 9...♕a3 10 ♗xf6 (10W *158*) gxf6 11 ♗e2 (11W *159*) ♘c6 (11...h5 *160*) 12 0-0 ♗d7 13 ♔h1 (13W *164*) ♖c8 *166*

2) 9...♘c6 10 ♗xf6 (10 ♗d3 *167*) gxf6 11 ♘a4 (11 ♗e2 *169*) ♕a3 12 ♘b6 ♖b8 13 ♘c4 ♕a4 (13B *171*) 14 a3 (14W *171*) b5 *172*

3) 9...♘bd7 *173*

9 ... ♕a3

10 f5

Or:

1) 10 ♗xf6 gxf6 11 ♗e2 ♗g7 (11...h5 *86*; 11...♘c6 *86*) 12 0-0 (12 f5 *89*; 12 ♖b3 *89*) f5 13 ♖fd1 ♘c6 (13...0-0 *90*) 14 ♘xc6 *90*

2) 10 ♗e2 ♗e7 (10B *92*) 11 0-0 ♘bd7 (11...0-0 *93*; 11...♘c6 *93*; 11...♕a5 *94*; 11...h6 *94*; 11...♕c5 *96*) 12 e5 (12W *101*) dxe5 13 fxe5 ♘xe5 14 ♗xf6 gxf6 (14...♗xf6 *102*) 15 ♘e4 *103*

3) 10 e5 dxe5 (10B *106*) 11 fxe5 ♘fd7 (11B *108*) 12 ♗c4 (12 ♗e2 *108*; 12 ♘e4 *109*) ♗b4 (12...♗e7 *112*; 12...♕a5 *114*; 12B *111*) 13 ♖b3 (13 ♘xe6 *118*) ♕a5 14 0-0 (14W *119*) 0-0 (14B *119*) 15 ♗f6 *120*

10 ... ♘c6

10...b5 *142*

11 fxe6 fxe6

12 ♘xc6 bxc6

13 e5

13W *144*

13 ... dxe5

13...♘d5 (13...♘d7 *149*) 14 ♘xd5 (14W *150*) cxd5 *151*

14 ♗xf6 gxf6

15 ♘e4

15 ♗e2 *122*

15 ... ♗e7

15...♕xa2 (15...♕e7 *123*; 15B *122*) 16 ♖d1 (16 ♘xf6+ *124*) ♗e7 *124*

16 ♗e2 h5

17 ♖b3

17 ♗f3 *127*

17 ... ♕a4

18 ♘xf6+

18 c4 *128*

18 ... ♗xf6

19 c4

19W *131*

19 ... ♖a7
19...♗h4+ (19B *132*) 20 g3 ♗e7 21 0-0 ♖a7 (21B *133*) 22 ♖b8 ♖c7 23 ♕d3 (23W *135*) ♗c5+ (23...♕a3 *136*) 24 ♔h1 *136*
20 0-0
and now: 20...♖f7 (20B *137*) 21 ♕d6 (21W *139*) ♗e7 *140*

C)
7 ... b5
8 e5
8W *244*
8 ... dxe5
8...h6 *245*
9 fxe5 ♕c7
10 ♕e2
10 exf6 (10W *245*) ♕e5+ 11 ♗e2 (11W *247*) ♕xg5 12 ♕d3 (12 0-0 *248*) ♕xf6 (12B *253*) 13 ♖f1 (13 0-0-0 *255*) ♕e5 14 ♖d1 (14 0-0-0 *256*; 14 ♘f3 *261*) ♖a7 (14B *257*) 15 ♘f3 (15 ♘dxb5 *257*) ♕c7 16 ♘g5 (16W *258*) f5 (16B *258*) 17 ♕d4 ♕e7 (17B *259*) 18 ♗h5+ (18W *260*) g6 *261*
10 ... ♘fd7
10B *223*
11 0-0-0 ♗b7
11...♘c6 (11B *224*) *223*
12 ♕g4
12 ♘xe6 (12W *226*) fxe6 13 ♕g4 (13 ♕h5+ *226*) ♕xe5 (13...♘c5 *227*) 14 ♗d3 *228*
12 ... ♕xe5
12...♕b6 (12B *229*) 13 ♗e2 (13W *229*) h6 (13...♘xe5 *231*) 14 ♕h3 (14W *232*) *242*
13 ♗d3
13 ♗xb5 (13 ♗e2 *240*) *233*
13 ...h6
13B *237*
After 13...h6: 14 ♗h4 (14 ♘xe6 *237*) g5 15 ♘xe6 (15W *237*) h5 16 ♕h3 (16 ♕xg5 *239*) *239*

D)
7 ... ♕c7
8 ♕f3
8 ♗xf6 (8 ♗d3 *280*; 8W *263*) *265*
8 ... b5
8...♘c6 *268*
9 0-0-0
9 ♗xf6 (9 f5 *278*; 9W *270*) *271*
9 ... b4
9B *274*
After 9...b4: 10 e5 (10W *275*) ♗b7 (10...dxe5 *275*) 11 ♘cb5 (11 ♕h3 *275*) axb5 (11...♕b6 *276*) *276*

E)
7 ... ♘bd7
8 ♕f3
8 ♕e2 (8 ♗c4 *301*; 8W *283*) ♕c7 9 0-0-0 (9W *297*) b5 (9...♗e7 *298*) *299*
8 ... ♕c7
9 0-0-0
9W *283*
9 ... b5
10 e5
10 ♗xb5 (10 ♗d3 *289*; 10W *284*) axb5 11 ♘dxb5 (11 e5 *293*) *295*
10 ... ♗b7
11 ♕h3 dxe5
12 ♘xe6 fxe6
13 ♕xe6+ ♗e7
and now White can play: 14 ♘xb5 (14 ♗xf6 *285*; 14 ♗xb5 *287*) axb5 15 ♗xb5 288


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